



Bhāmatī

Vācaspati Miśra's commentary on Śaṅkara's Brahmasūtrabhāṣya

Translated from the original Sanskrit into Maithili

Gajendra Thakur



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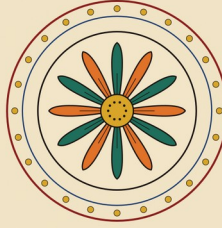
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भामती

शंकरक ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यपर वाचस्पति मिश्रक टीका

मूल संस्कृतसँ मैथिली अनुवाद
गजेन्द्र ठाकुर



अध्यास-भाष्यपर वाचस्पतिक अमर टीका

पवित्रित संस्करण २०२६ • प्रथम संस्करण २००४



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© 2004/2026 गजेन्द्र ठाकुर / प्रीति ठाकुर। मैथिली अनुवाद, सम्पादकीय सामग्री आ पुस्तक-विन्यासपर सर्वाधिकार सुरक्षित। मूल संस्कृत ग्रन्थ भारतीय दार्शनिक परम्पराक शास्त्रीय धरोहर अछि।

लेखक अथवा प्रकाशकक लिखित अनुमति बिना एहि संस्करणक कोनो पैघ अंशक पुनरुत्पादन, सञ्चयन वा प्रसारण नहि कएल जाए। समीक्षा, अनुसन्धान आ शैक्षिक सन्दर्भ लेल यथोचित उल्लेखसहित संक्षिप्त उद्धरण देल जा सकैत अछि।

ई संस्करण विदेहक ग्रन्थ-शृङ्खलाक अन्तर्गत प्रकाशित अछि।

भामती

(चतुःसूत्री)

अनुक्रम

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प्रस्तावना, दार्शनिक अनुशीलन आ स्रोत-सङ्केत

वाचस्पति मिश्रक भामती (चतुःसूत्री) आ गजेन्द्र ठाकुर कृत मैथिली अनुवाद: एकटा विस्तृत
दार्शनिक आ साहित्यिक अनुशीलन

प्रस्तावना

भारतीय दर्शनक सुदीर्घ परम्परामे अद्वैत वेदान्तक स्थान सर्वोच्च अछि। उपनिषद्, भगवद्गीता आ ब्रह्मसूत्र—एहि प्रस्थानत्रयीपर आधारित अद्वैत वेदान्तक जे भव्य प्रासाद आचार्य शंकर निर्मित कएलनि, तकर आधारस्तम्भक रूपमे शारीरक भाष्य प्रतिष्ठित अछि। एहि शारीरक भाष्यपर अनेक टीकासभ रचित भेल, मुदा नवम शताब्दीमे मिथिलाक महान् दार्शनिक वाचस्पति मिश्र द्वारा रचित "भामती" टीका अपन विशिष्ट मौलिकता, दार्शनिक गाम्भीर्य आ सूक्ष्म तर्क-पद्धतिक कारण अद्वैत वेदान्तक एकटा स्वतन्त्र प्रस्थान (भामती-प्रस्थान) क रूपमे प्रतिष्ठित भेल। सहस्राधिक वर्ष धरि ई महान् ग्रन्थ संस्कृत वाङ्मयक परिधिमे सीमित छल। मुदा, विदेह ई-पत्रिकाक सम्पादक आ विशिष्ट साहित्यकार गजेन्द्र ठाकुर द्वारा वाचस्पति मिश्रक "भामती (चतुःसूत्री)" क मूल संस्कृतसँ शुद्ध मैथिलीमे अविकल अनुवाद एकटा ऐतिहासिक उपलब्धि अछि।

ई अनुवाद केवल भाषान्तरण मात्र नहि, अपितु अद्वैत दर्शनक जटिलतम गुत्थीसभ—यथा अध्यास, ख्यातिवाद, मोक्षक कूटस्थ नित्यता आ वेदान्त-वाक्यक स्वतन्त्र प्रामाण्य—कें मैथिली लोकवाणीक सहजताक संग प्रस्तुत करबाक एकटा सफल बौद्धिक अनुष्ठान अछि। प्रथम संस्करण २००४ मे आ परिवर्धित संस्करण २०२६ मे प्रकाशित ई कृति (ISSN 2229-547X) मैथिली दार्शनिक गद्यक मानक स्थापित करैत अछि। ई ग्रन्थ विदेहक ग्रन्थ-शृङ्खलाक अन्तर्गत आएल अछि, जाहिमे मूल संस्कृत ग्रन्थ कें भारतीय दार्शनिक परम्पराक शास्त्रीय धरोहर मानि ओकर सार्वजनिक स्वरूपक सम्मान कएल गेल अछि।

वाचस्पति मिश्र: 'सर्वतन्त्रस्वतन्त्र' व्यक्तित्व आ ऐतिहासिक सन्दर्भ

वाचस्पति मिश्र भारतीय दर्शनक इतिहासमे एकटा अलोकसामान्य प्रतिभाक धनी छलाह। हुनक आविर्भाव नवम शताब्दीमे भेल छल। वाचस्पति मिश्र अपन न्याय ग्रन्थ "न्यायसूचीनिबन्ध" क अन्तमे ओकर रचनाकाल ८९८ विक्रम संवत् अर्थात् ८४१ ई. देलनि अछि ("न्यायसूचीनिबन्धोऽसावकारि सुधियां मुदे। श्रीवाचस्पतिमिश्रेण वस्वङ्कवसुवत्सरे"), जाहिसँ हुनक ऐतिहासिक काल-निर्धारण स्पष्ट होइत अछि। वैशेषिक दर्शन कें छोड़ि, भारतीय दर्शनक प्रायः सभ आस्तिक प्रस्थानपर हुनक अधिकारपूर्ण टीकासभ उपलब्ध अछि, जकर कारणेँ हुनका 'सर्वतन्त्रस्वतन्त्र' क उपाधिसँ विभूषित कएल गेल अछि।

न्याय दर्शनमे हुनक 'न्यायवार्तिकतात्पर्यटीका' (जकरा कारण न्याय सम्प्रदायमे हुनका 'तात्पर्याचार्य' क रूपमे ख्याति भेटल), सांख्य दर्शनमे ईश्वरकृष्णक सांख्यकारिकापर 'सांख्यतत्त्वकौमुदी', योग दर्शनमे व्यासभाष्यपर 'तत्त्ववैशारदी', पूर्वमीमांसाके मण्डन मिश्रक विधिविवेकपर 'न्यायकणिका' आ 'तत्त्वबिन्दु', तथा मण्डन मिश्रक 'ब्रह्मसिद्धि' पर 'ब्रह्मतत्त्वसमीक्षा' (जे आब अनुपलब्ध अछि) सन महान् ग्रन्थक रचनाक पश्चात् हुनक अन्तिम आ सर्वश्रेष्ठ कृति 'भामती' प्रकाशमे आएल। दार्शनिक प्रौढ़ताक चरम शिखरपर रचित भामती, शारीरक भाष्यक केवल व्याख्या नहि अछि, अपितु अद्वैत वेदान्तक सिद्धान्तसभक एकटा स्वतन्त्र आ व्यवस्थित रूपरेखा अछि। भामतीमे मण्डन मिश्रक 'ब्रह्मसिद्धि' क अनेक विचार प्रतिध्वनित होइत अछि, जकर कारणेँ वाचस्पति मिश्र कें 'वाचस्पतिर्मण्डनपृष्ठसेवी' सेहो कहल गेल अछि। मण्डन मिश्रक ध्यान-विधान आ नियोग-

काण्डक सूक्ष्म प्रभाव वाचस्पतिक दार्शनिक दृष्टिपर दृष्टिगोचर होइत अछि, यद्यपि शारीरक भाष्यक मूल अद्वैत भावसँ ओ कतहु विचलित नहि भेल छथि।

अद्वैत वेदान्तक प्रस्थान-भेद: भामती आ विवरण

अद्वैत वेदान्तक इतिहासमे शारीरक भाष्यक व्याख्याक दुइ मुख्य धारा प्रवाहित भेल—वाचस्पति मिश्रक 'भामती-प्रस्थान' आ पद्मपादाचार्यक 'पञ्चपादिका' पर प्रकाशात्मयति द्वारा रचित 'पञ्चपादिका-विवरण' टीकासँ उद्भूत 'विवरण-प्रस्थान'। एहि दुनू प्रस्थानक तात्त्विक भेद अद्वैत दर्शनक सूक्ष्मता केँ बुझबाक लेल नितान्त आवश्यक अछि, जकर निर्वाह गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक अनुवादमे पूर्ण निष्ठासँ भेल अछि।

तात्त्विक आ ज्ञानमीमांसक बिन्दु	भामती-प्रस्थान (वाचस्पति मिश्र)	विवरण-प्रस्थान (पद्मपाद / प्रकाशात्मयति)
अविद्याक आश्रय (Locus of Avidya)	अविद्याक आश्रय 'जीव' अछि (जीवाश्रित अविद्या)। ब्रह्म अविद्याक विषय अछि, आश्रय नहि।	अविद्याक आश्रय 'ब्रह्म' अछि (ब्रह्माश्रित अविद्या)। अज्ञान ब्रह्ममे स्थित अछि।
जीव आ ईश्वरक स्वरूप	अवच्छेदवाद (Avacchedavada): जीव अविद्यासँ सीमित (अवच्छिन्न) ब्रह्म अछि, जहिना घटाकाश आ महाकाश।	प्रतिबिम्बवाद (Pratibimbavada): जीव अविद्यामे ब्रह्मक प्रतिबिम्ब अछि, जहिना जलमे सूर्यक प्रतिबिम्ब।
अविद्याक एकत्व-नानात्व	अविद्या अनेक अछि (नाना जीव, नाना अविद्या)। प्रत्येक जीवक अपन अविद्या अछि।	मूलाविद्या एक अछि। सम्पूर्ण प्रपञ्च एकहि अविद्याक कार्य अछि।
ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कारक साधन	मननजन्य अन्तःकरणक ब्रह्माकार वृत्ति (मन) अपरोक्ष ज्ञानक मुख्य साधन अछि।	महावाक्य (शब्द) साक्षात् अपरोक्ष ज्ञानक साधन अछि (शब्दापरोक्षवाद)।
सृष्टिक्रम आ भूत-मिश्रण	त्रिवृत्करण (तीन भूतसभक मिश्रण—तेज, जल, अन्न/पृथ्वी) मान्य अछि।	पञ्चीकरण (पाँच भूतसभक मिश्रण—आकाश, वायु, तेज, जल, पृथ्वी) मान्य अछि।

भामतीमे जीव केँ कर्ता, भोक्ता आ अविद्याक आश्रय मानल गेल अछि। अविद्याक जीवाश्रयत्वक ई सिद्धान्त भामतीक आधारभूत विशेषता अछि। वाचस्पति मिश्रक अनुसार, अविद्या वास्तवमे अनिर्वचनीय अछि आ ओकरा दुइ भागमे विभक्त कएल जा सकैत अछि—आवरण आ विक्षेप (मूलाविद्या आ तूलाविद्या/संस्कार)। ई सम्पूर्ण पृष्ठभूमि गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक अनुवादमे स्वतः प्रतिध्वनित होइत अछि, जतय अनुवादक बिना कोनो बाह्य टिप्पणीक पाठ-निष्ठ रहि भामतीक आशय केँ स्पष्ट करैत छथि।

भामती-टीकाक परम्परा आ उप-प्रस्थान

वाचस्पति मिश्रक भामती एतेक प्रौढ आ गम्भीर अछि जे ओकरा बुझबाक लेल स्वयं भामतीपर अनेक टीकासभ रचित भेल। तेरहम् शताब्दीमे अमलानन्द सरस्वती (जिनकर गुरु अनुभवानन्द छलाह) भामतीपर 'वेदान्तकल्पतरु' नामक प्रसिद्ध टीका लिखलनि, जाहिसँ भामती-प्रस्थान केँ अद्वैत

वेदान्तक क्षेत्रमे अपूर्व प्रतिष्ठा भेटल। अमलानन्दक कल्पतरुपर सोलहम शताब्दीमे अप्पय दीक्षित 'कल्पतरुपरिमल' आ लक्ष्मीनृसिंह 'आभोग' नामक टीका लिखलनि। एहि अतिरिक्त भामतीपर वल्लालसूरी कृत 'भामतीतिलक', अखण्डानुभूति यति कृत 'ऋजुप्रकाशिका', अच्युतकृष्णतीर्थ कृत 'भामती-भावदीपिका' आ सुब्रह्मण्यशास्त्री कृत 'भामती-विवरण' सन अनेक टीकासभ उपलब्ध अछि।

एहि टीकासभमे कतहु-कतहु भामती आ कल्पतरुक सिद्धान्तसभक सूक्ष्म मतभेद परिलक्षित होइत अछि। अप्पय दीक्षित अपन 'परिमल' मे जतय वाचस्पति आ अमलानन्दक शारीरक भाष्यसँ असमानता देखलनि, ओतय हुनका लोकनिक खण्डन कऽ शारीरक भाष्यक समर्थन कएलनि। मुदा 'आभोग' कार लक्ष्मीनृसिंह परिमलक एहि व्यवस्थाक तीव्र आलोचना कऽ भामतीकार आ कल्पतरुकारक समर्थन कएलनि। एहि प्रकार भामती-प्रस्थानक भीतर सेहो दुइ उप-प्रस्थान विकसित भेल। ई सम्पूर्ण टीका-सम्पत्ति वाचस्पति मिश्रक मूल ग्रन्थक बौद्धिक वर्चस्व प्रमाणित करैत अछि।

गजेन्द्र ठाकुर कृत मैथिली अनुवादक संरचना आ दार्शनिक गाम्भीर्य

गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक समीक्ष्य ग्रन्थ "भामती (चतुःसूत्री)" संचयी संस्करणक पृष्ठ १ सँ ४९१ धरि विस्तृत अछि आ "एतय चतुःसूत्री-भामती समाप्त होइत अछि" एहि पुष्पिकापर समाप्त होइत अछि। एहिमे ग्रन्थक मङ्गलाचरण, अध्यास-भाष्य (उपोद्धात) आ ब्रह्मसूत्रक प्रथम चारि सूत्र—अथातो ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा (१.१.१), जन्माद्यस्य यतः (१.१.२), शास्त्रयोनित्वात् (१.१.३), आ तत्तु समन्वयात् (१.१.४)—क सम्पूर्ण टीकाक अविकल अनुवाद समाहित अछि।

अनुवादक संरचना एहि क्रममे अछि: १. आवरण आ प्रकाशकीय पृष्ठ। २. शंकरक अध्यासभाष्यक मूल पाठक मैथिली रूपान्तर। ३. वाचस्पति मिश्रक सात मङ्गलश्लोकक अनुवाद। ४. "अध्यास" प्रकरणपर भामती-टीकाक सम्पूर्ण गद्यानुवाद। ५. प्रथम सूत्र सँ चतुर्थ सूत्र धरिक विस्तृत शास्त्रार्थ आ व्याख्याक मैथिलीकरण। ग्रन्थक लगभग एक-तिहाइ अंश केवल 'तत्तु समन्वयात्' (समन्वयाधिकरण) सूत्रक व्याख्या अछि, जे अद्वैत प्रमाणमीमांसा आ मोक्ष-स्वरूपक सूक्ष्मतम विवेचन अछि, जे अनुवादकक धैर्य आ मूल ग्रन्थक प्रति हुनक निष्ठाक द्योतक अछि।

मङ्गलाचरणक भाषिक सौन्दर्य

भामतीक प्रवेशद्वार हुनक सात मङ्गलश्लोक अछि। दार्शनिक ग्रन्थक अनुवादमे छन्द-सुरक्षाक अपेक्षा अर्थ-सुरक्षा केँ प्राथमिकता दैत गजेन्द्र ठाकुर एहि श्लोकसभक गद्यानुवाद कएलनि अछि। पहिल श्लोकमे ब्रह्म केँ "अपरिमेय आनन्द आ ज्ञानस्वरूप" कहि, "दुइ प्रकारक अनिर्वचनीय अविद्या केँ मन्त्री बना कऽ" पञ्चभूतक मिथ्या अभिव्यक्तिक कर्ता रूपमे प्रणाम कएल गेल अछि। एतय 'मन्त्री' शब्दक प्रयोग मूल संस्कृतक राजनैतिक रूपक केँ मैथिलीमे जीवन्त करैत अछि आ अद्वैतक द्विविध अविद्या (आवरण आ संस्कार) क सङ्केत दैत अछि।

दोसर श्लोकक अनुवादमे लौकिक आ देशज भाषाक अपूर्व सौन्दर्य देखाइत अछि: "वेद हुनक श्वास छथि, पाँचो महाभूत हुनक दृष्टि छथि, चल-अचल जगत हुनक मुस्की अछि आ हुनक निद्रा महाप्रलय अछि।" एतय 'मुस्की' (स्मित/smile) शब्दक प्रयोग ब्रह्माण्डीय लीला केँ घरेलू आ

आत्मीय रूप दैत अछि। सातम श्लोकक विनयोक्ति—“जहिना राजपथक पानि गङ्गाक धारमे पड़ि शुद्ध भऽ जाइत अछि, तहिना हमरा सन लोकक तुच्छ वचन आचार्यक रचनासँ जुड़ि पवित्र भऽ जाइत अछि”—टीकाकारक आत्मस्थापनक शास्त्रीय मर्यादाक प्रतिरूप अछि।

अध्यास-भाष्यक सूक्ष्म मीमांसा

शंकराचार्यक अध्यासभाष्यपर वाचस्पति मिश्रक टीका एकटा विस्तृत पूर्वपक्षसँ आरम्भ होइत अछि। पूर्वपक्षक युक्ति अछि जे आत्मा जिज्ञासाक विषय नहि भऽ सकैत अछि, कारण जकर ज्ञानमे कोनो सन्देह नहि आ जकर ज्ञानसँ कोनो प्रयोजन सिद्ध नहि हो, तकर विचार निरर्थक अछि।

पूर्वपक्षक निर्माण आ तार्किक खण्डन

पूर्वपक्षी तर्क दैत अछि जे “हम” (अहम्) क अनुभव कृमि-पतङ्गसँ लऽ कऽ देवता आ ऋषि धरि सभमे निर्विवाद अछि। पूर्वपक्षी एहि अनुभवक सन्देहशून्यता आ निष्प्रयोजनता स्थापित करबाक लेल चुटीला दृष्टान्त दैत अछि—“तेज इजोतमे उपस्थित, मनसहित नेत्रेन्द्रियक सम्पर्कमे आयल घट; अथवा कौआक दाँत”। गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक अनुवाद एहि लौकिक दृष्टान्तसभक चुटीलापन केँ मैथिलीमे यथावत् रखने अछि।

बाल्यकालसँ वृद्धावस्था धरिक प्रत्यभिज्ञा (“हम, जे बाल्यकालमे अपन माता-पिताक संग आनन्द पबैत छलहुँ, एखन वृद्धावस्थामे अपन नाती-पोताक संग आनन्द पबैत छी”) द्वारा पूर्वपक्षी देहसँ भिन्न आत्माक स्वतःसिद्धता तर्कित करैत अछि। पूर्वपक्षक चरम उद्घोष अछि: “हजार शास्त्र मिलियो घट केँ पट नहि बना सकैत अछि”। अर्थात्, प्रत्यक्ष अनुभवविरोधी श्रुति गौणार्थक मानल जाय। ई प्रसिद्ध न्यायवाक्य ठेठ मैथिली लयमे अनूदित भेल अछि, जे शास्त्रार्थक आक्रामकता केँ सुरक्षित रखैत अछि।

सिद्धान्त-पक्षमे वाचस्पति मिश्र उपक्रम-उपसंहार-अभ्यास आदि तात्पर्यलिङ्गक आधारपर श्रुतिक निरुपाधिक आत्म-प्रतिपादन स्थापित करैत छथि। श्रुतिजन्य ज्ञान प्रत्यक्षक व्यावहारिक प्रामाण्य केँ नष्ट नहि करैत, केवल पारमार्थिक प्रामाण्यक निषेध करैत अछि। “दीर्घा चिचिया रहल अछि” जकाँ गौणी वृत्तिक विश्लेषण आ कुण्डपायिनाम् अयनक ‘अग्निहोत्र’, सिंह-शिष्य, तैल-सरिसोक तेलक दृष्टान्त द्वारा सिद्ध कएल गेल अछि जे गौण प्रयोग भेदज्ञानपूर्वक होइत अछि, मुदा “हम” क प्रयोगमे देहसँ भेदज्ञानक अभाव रहबाक कारण ओ गौण नहि, अपितु मिथ्या (अध्यास) अछि।

ख्यातिवाद-विमर्श आ अनिर्वचनीयख्यातिक स्थापना

भ्रम-ज्ञानक स्वरूप की अछि? एहि प्रश्नपर भारतीय दर्शनमे ख्यातिवादक विस्तृत शास्त्रार्थ अछि। गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक अनुवादमे ई दार्शनिक विवाद बिना कोनो तर्क-हानिक आएल अछि: १. **आत्मख्याति (बौद्ध-सौत्रान्तिक/विज्ञानवादी)**: बाह्य वस्तुक असत्ता मानि, भीतरक ज्ञानाकारक बाह्य आरोप। २. **अख्याति (मीमांसक-प्राभाकर)**: स्मृति आ ग्रहणक भेदाग्रह; स्मृतिक स्मृतित्व लुप्त भऽ जाएब। ३. **अन्यथाख्याति (नैयायिक)**: एक विद्यमान वस्तुक दोसर रूपमे ज्ञान (यथा सीपमे बाजारक रजतक भान)।

वाचस्पति मिश्र एहि सभ मतक तीक्ष्ण खण्डन करैत छथि। नैयायिक अन्यथाख्यातिक खण्डन करैत ओ व्यङ्ग्य करैत छथि: “अहा! बेचारा ज्ञानक ई केहन महान सौभाग्य अछि जे असत्यक द्वारा सेहो निश्चितता प्राप्त कऽ लैत अछि!”। ई कटाक्ष मैथिलीक व्यङ्ग्य-सामर्थ्यसँ पूर्णतः मेल खाइत

अछि। वनाग्निमे झुलसल ईखक बीआसँ कदलीकाण्डक उत्पत्ति आ भस्मक-रोगीक जठराग्नि क दृष्टान्तसँ दोषसँ कारणमे कार्यान्तर-सामर्थ्यक विश्लेषण सूक्ष्मतासँ अनूदित अछि। वाचस्पति मिश्रक आत्म-सन्दर्भ—“एहि आपत्तिक उत्तर हम न्याय-कणिकामे दऽ चुकल छी” आ “ओकर विस्तृत विवेचन ब्रह्मतत्त्वसमीक्षामे देखबाक चाही”—अनुवादमे सुरक्षित अछि, जाहिसँ हुनकर विस्तृत वाङ्मयक बोध होइत अछि।

सिद्धान्त रूपमे वाचस्पति मिश्र **अनिर्वचनीयख्याति** स्थापित करैत छथि। किरणपर आरोपित जल (मृगतृष्णा) “ने सत्य अछि, ने असत्य, आ ने सत्य-असत्य दुनू; कारण अन्तिम विकल्प आत्मविरोधी अछि”। सदसद्विलक्षणताक ई स्थापना अद्वैत वेदान्तक प्रमाण-मीमांसाक हृदय अछि। जँ आरोपित जल सत्य होइत तँ ज्ञान “किरण” वा “गङ्गाक जल” रूपक होइत, मुदा ज्ञान “एतयक जल” रूपक अछि। “प्रकाशमानता मात्रे यथार्थता नहि”—जँ एना होइत तँ मृगतृष्णाक “ऊँच-नीच तरङ्गमालासहित मन्दाकिनी” लग उतरि अबितय आ तृषार्त ओकर जल पीबि सकितय। ई सिद्धान्त मैथिली अनुवादमे अपन पूर्ण चित्रात्मकतासहित अविकल उपस्थित अछि।

आत्माक स्वयंप्रकाशता आ जीवभाव

अध्यासक सम्भावनापर शङ्का होइत अछि जे जे आत्मा अविषय आ स्वयंप्रकाश अछि, ताहिपर अनात्माक आरोप केना? वाचस्पति मिश्र तर्क दैत छथि जे जँ आत्मा केँ जड मानल जाय, तँ “अन्तर अन्तरक हाथ पकड़ि प्रत्येक डेगपर खसैत अछि” (अन्धपरम्परा-दोष) सन स्थिति उत्पन्न होएत। ज्ञानान्तर-कल्पनामे अनवस्था दोष अछि। विज्ञानवादीक विषय-प्रकाशवादक निरास कएल गेल अछि जे विषय सीमित-स्थूल रूपँ भासैत अछि, मुदा प्रकाश आन्तरिक आ अपरिच्छिन्न रूपँ भासैत अछि।

आत्माक स्वयंप्रकाशता स्थापित कएलाक बाद, “प्रौढवादक रीति” सँ ओ उत्तर दैत छथि जे अप्रत्यक्ष आकाशपर सेहो अविवेकी बालक मलिनता वा “इन्द्रनील मणिसँ बनल विशाल उलटल कटोरा” क आरोप करैत अछि। घट-कलश-पात्रक उपाधिभेदसँ आकाशक भेदाभास जकाँ, अविषय आत्मापर बुद्धि-मन-देहोपाधिसँ जीवभावक निष्पत्ति होइत अछि।

अध्यासक पशु-साम्यक उदाहरण—“लाठी उठौने मनुष्य देखि भागब, हरियर घास देखि लग जाएब”—मैथिलीक गद्यमे एतेक जीवन्त अछि जे ग्राम्य-जीवनक एकटा स्पष्ट चित्र सोझाँ ठाढ़ भऽ जाइत अछि। धर्माध्यास (हम गूँग छी, एकनयन छी, बहिर छी) आ धर्म्यध्यासक सूक्ष्म विवेचनक संगे “यथार्थज्ञानक अभ्याससँ भ्रम-संस्कारक उच्छेद” रूपी प्रतिज्ञापर अध्यासभाष्यक उपोद्घात पूर्ण होइत अछि।

प्रथम सूत्र: 'अथातो ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा'

“अतः आब ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा”—प्रथम सूत्रक व्याख्यामे ‘अथ’ (अन्तर/आनन्तर्य), ‘अतः’ (कारण) आ ‘ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा’ (समास-विमर्श) क विस्तृत मीमांसा अछि। १. **अथ शब्दक मीमांसा:** ‘अथ’ शब्दक मङ्गल, आरम्भ आ अधिकार अर्थक निरास कऽ ‘आनन्तर्य’ अर्थ स्थापित कएल गेल अछि। मङ्गल ध्वनिक दृष्टान्त “मृदङ्ग वा शङ्खक ध्वनि” आ “दोसर प्रयोजन लेल आनल जलपूर्ण कलशक दर्शन” सँ देल गेल अछि। २. **कर्म-ज्ञान आनन्तर्यक खण्डन:** धर्मजिज्ञासाक अनन्तर ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा हो—एहि मीमांसक पूर्वपक्षक तीव्र खण्डन कएल गेल अछि। मोक्ष उत्पाद्य (आटाक गोला), विकार्य (दही), संस्कार्य (ओखलीक प्रोक्षण), वा आप्य (दूध दुहब) नहि अछि। कर्म केवल

वैराग्य आ बुद्धिशुद्धिक "दूरस्थ सहायक" अछि। ३. **साधन-चतुष्टयः** नित्यानित्यवस्तुविवेक, इहामुत्रार्थभोगविराग, शमदमादिसाधनसम्पत्ति, आ मुमुक्षुत्व। एहि प्रकरणमे वैराग्य-विरोधी तर्कक रसमय दृष्टान्त—यथा काँटासहित माछ आनि भोग्यांश लेब, भूँसीसहित धान, वन्य पशुक डरे बीज नहि छोड़ब, भिखारीक डरे भोजन नहि छोड़ब—मैथिली गद्यक एकटा अनुपम उत्सव अछि। "मधुमे विष मिलल भोजनसँ श्रेष्ठतम पाककुशलो विष अलग कऽ केवल मधु नहि खा सकैत अछि"—ई दृष्टान्त लौकिक बुद्धिक वेदान्तसँ जोड़ैत अछि। ४. **ब्रह्मजिज्ञासाक समासः** "ब्रह्मणे जिज्ञासा" (चतुर्थी समास) क खण्डन कऽ "ब्रह्मणः जिज्ञासा" (षष्ठी तत्पुरुष) क स्थापना। कात्यायनक नियमसँ (यूपाय दारु जकाँ) एकर सिद्धि कएल गेल अछि। ई ऎजिञ्जिक दृष्टिँ महत्त्वपूर्ण अछि, कारण वाचस्पति एतय शाङ्कर-पूर्व वृत्तिकार-परम्पराक खण्डन करैत छथि।

द्वितीय सूत्रः 'जन्माद्यस्य यतः'

"जाहिसँ एहि जगतक जन्म आदि होइत अछि।" पूर्वपक्षी तर्क दैत अछि जे ब्रह्म सीमित, जड़ आ विनाशी जगतक लक्षणसँ केना परिभाषित भऽ सकैत अछि? सिद्धान्त रूपमे **तटस्थलक्षण** स्थापित कएल गेल अछि: "जहिना विभिन्न देशमे पहुँचब सूर्यक गतिक लक्षण होइत अछि"। 'जन्मादि' मे नपुंसकलिङ्गक लाघव अछि। यास्कक छह भावविकार (जायते, अस्ति, वर्धते, विपरिणमते, अपक्षीयते, विनश्यति) केँ उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाश (लय) मे अन्तर्भाव कएल गेल अछि (वृद्धि उत्पत्तिमे, क्षय विनाशमे)।

सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान कारणक सिद्धिक लेल जगतक नियत-व्यवस्थाक अपूर्व प्राकृतिक दृष्टान्त देल गेल अछि: "निश्चित देशमे कृष्णमृगक उत्पत्ति, निश्चित कालमे कोइलीक कूजब, निश्चित कारणसँ वर्षाक आरम्भमे मेघगर्जनक कारण बगुलाक गर्भाधान।" ई प्रकृति-चित्र अपन देशज सौरभक संगे मैथिलीमे अनूदित अछि। एहि सूत्रमे ई स्थापित कएल गेल जे सूत्र अनुमानक स्वतन्त्र प्रमाण नहि, अपितु भृगु-वरुण संवाद (तैत्तिरीय श्रुति) आ उपनिषद्-वाक्यक सूचक अछि। अविद्यासहित रस्सीक सर्प-उपादानता दृष्टान्तसँ ब्रह्मक (अविद्यासहितक) उपादान-कारणता सिद्ध कएल गेल अछि।

तृतीय सूत्रः 'शास्त्रयोनित्वात्'

"शास्त्रक स्रोत होयबाक कारण।" एहि सूत्रक दुइ शास्त्रसम्मत व्याख्या प्रस्तुत अछि: १. **शास्त्रक कारण ब्रह्मः** ऋग्वेद आदि असङ्ख्य विद्यास्थानसँ परिपूरित "मशाल जकाँ सभ वस्तु केँ प्रकाशित करैत विशाल शास्त्र-समूह" क योनि (कारण) ब्रह्म छथि। जेना पाणिनिक ज्ञान हुनक व्याकरण शास्त्रसँ बेसी व्यापक अछि, तहिना ब्रह्माण्डक स्रष्टाक ज्ञानक की कहब! ईखक रस, दूध आ गुड़क मिठासक शब्दातीत भेदक उदाहरणसँ वक्तृज्ञानक आधिक्य द्योतित अछि। "जौक खीर नोनगर नहि अछि" सन मैथिली कहबीसँ 'अत्यल्प प्रयास' द्योतित कएल गेल अछि। २. **ब्रह्मक प्रमाण शास्त्रः** शास्त्र ब्रह्मक योनि (प्रमाण) अछि। ब्रह्म केवल शास्त्रसँ ज्ञात होइत छथि, स्वतन्त्र अनुमानसँ नहि।

वेद-नित्यता विमर्शमे जैमिनीय आ व्यासमतानुयायीक समन्वय अद्भुत अछि। वर्ण-नित्यतावादी मीमांसकक क्रमविशिष्ट शब्द-वाक्यक अनित्यता स्वीकार करए पड़त। गुरु-शिष्य परम्परामे वेद-पाठक क्रम नृत्य-शिक्षक आ शिष्यक अङ्गसञ्चालनक दृष्टान्तसँ स्पष्ट कएल गेल अछि। "कोनो सृष्टिमे ब्रह्महत्या पुण्यक कारण नहि बनैत, नहि अश्वमेध पापक; जहिना अग्नि कखनो भिजबैत नहि, जल कखनो जरबैत नहि"—नियत स्वभाववादक ई सूक्ष्म विवेचन मैथिलीमे सहजतासँ बोधगम्य अछि।

चतुर्थ सूत्र: 'तत्तु समन्वयात्'

समन्वयाधिकरण सम्पूर्ण ग्रन्थक लगभग एक-तिहाइ अंश समेटने अछि आ सभसँ सघन शास्त्रार्थ अछि। पूर्वपक्ष पूर्व-मीमांसाक विधिके आधार बनाबैत अछि: "शास्त्रक प्रयोजन कर्मक शिक्षा अछि।" वेदान्त-वाक्य केँ 'अमरत्व चाहनिहार लेल ब्रह्मोपासनाक विधान' (प्रतिपत्तिविधि) मानबाक मीमांसक-यत्न उपस्थित कएल गेल अछि। "नदीक तटपर फल अछि" सन विद्यमान वस्तुक वाक्य केँ पुनर्वचन मानि खण्डित करबाक प्रयास कएल गेल अछि।

सिद्धान्त: समन्वय आ स्वतः प्रामाण्य

सिद्धान्त-पक्ष उपक्रम-उपसंहार आ तात्पर्यलिङ्गसँ (उपांशुयाज-न्यायक स्मरणसहित) स्थापित करैत अछि जे "समस्त वेदान्त-वाक्य एकहि तात्पर्यसँ ब्रह्ममे समन्वित होइत अछि।" अद्वैत दर्शनमे ज्ञान 'वस्तुतन्त्र' अछि, 'पुरुषतन्त्र' नहि (जहिना कर्म होइत अछि)।

मोक्षक कूटस्थ नित्यता आ भेदाभेदवादक निरास

मोक्ष कर्मजन्य नहि अछि। यदि ई कर्मजन्य होइत तँ अनित्य होइत।

- **उत्पाद्य नहि:** दही वा घट जकाँ मोक्ष नवीन उत्पन्न वस्तु नहि अछि।
- **आप्य नहि:** नाविक-नौकाक रमणीय दृष्टान्तसँ (परिवर्तनशील तट-फेन-तरङ्ग छोड़ि शान्त मध्यभागमे पहुँचब) ब्रह्मक नित्यप्राप्तता सिद्ध कएल गेल अछि।
- **संस्कार्य नहि:** गुणाधान (लाखक रससँ रंगल जवा फूल) आ दोषापनयन (ईटक चूर्णसँ घसल दर्पण)—दुनू ब्रह्ममे असम्भव अछि। आत्माक क्रियाश्रयत्व-निषेध अछि। "स्नान-आचमनक शुद्धि व्यावहारिक-जीवाश्रयता अछि, नायिकाक सुगन्ध सखीपर आरोपित जकाँ"। निष्कर्षतः, "एहि चारि प्रकार बाहेक कोनो पाँचम मार्ग नहि... ज्ञान बाहेक कर्मक छायो मोक्षमे प्रवेश नहि पबैत अछि।" गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक अनुवादक ई पङ्क्ति अद्वैतक सारतत्त्व केँ पूर्णता दैत अछि।

एहि प्रसङ्गमे कूटस्थनित्यता आ परिणामिनित्यताक विवेक, तथा भेदाभेदवादक विस्तृत खण्डन अछि—"घट केँ एहिमे बदरी अछि नहि कहल जाइत, आ चैत्र-मैत्र एक आसनपर रहितहुँ चैत्र मैत्र अछि नहि कहल जाइत।" दूरसँ सुवर्ण-ज्ञान भेलहुँ कुण्डलक अज्ञान, आ भेद-अभेदक परस्पराश्रय-दूषणक तर्क कोनो ग्रन्थि छोड़ने बिना अनूदित अछि।

सिद्धवस्तु-वाक्यक फलवत्ता आ भाषा-दर्शन

पूर्वपक्षक आक्षेप छल जे सिद्ध वस्तुक वाक्य निष्फल होइत अछि। वाचस्पति एकर खण्डन करबाक लेल सुमेरु-पर्वतक अलङ्कृत वर्णन आ 'आर्यभाषा नहि जाननिहार द्रविड़क' प्रसिद्ध आख्यान दैत छथि। दूत जखन पिता केँ "देवदत्त, अहाँक समृद्धि बढ़य; अहाँक पुत्र जन्मल अछि" कहैत अछि, तँ द्रविड़ व्यक्ति देवदत्तक रोमाञ्च आ पूर्ण विकसित कमल जकाँ खिलल मुख देखि वाक्यार्थ-ज्ञानक अनुमान करैत अछि। एहिसँ सिद्ध होइत अछि जे शब्द-शक्तिक व्युत्पत्ति सिद्ध-वस्तुमे सेहो होइत अछि। ई भाषा-दर्शनक युगान्तकारी तर्क (जे परवर्ती वेदान्तमे शब्दबोध-विमर्शक आधार बनल) मैथिलीमे कथा जकाँ प्रवाहमय अछि।

निषेध-मीमांसा आ जीवन्मुक्ति

"ब्राह्मणकें नहि मारबाक चाही"—नञ्-पदक अभाव-बोधकता, प्रजापतिव्रत ("उगैत सूर्यकें नहि देखू") क पर्युदास-व्यवस्था, आ "कवच हटिते, जँ बाणक आक्रमण नहि, योद्धाक जीवन तत्काल नष्ट नहि होइत" जकाँ अपूर्व उपमासँ निवृत्ति-औदासीन्यक मीमांसा अनूदित अछि।

अन्तमे गौण आ मिथ्या अहंबुद्धिक विवेक (अयालवला पशुमे "सिंह"क मुख्यार्थ, शूरवीर मनुष्यमे गौण) आ जीवन्मुक्तिक स्थापन अछि—"धन त्यागि धनाभिमानसँ मुक्त व्यक्तिके चोरीक भय नहि"; "साँपक त्यक्त केंचुली बाँबीपर मृत आ फेकल पड़ल रहैत अछि, तहिना ई शरीर पड़ल रहैत अछि"। अनादि देह-सम्बन्धक "अन्हराक शृङ्खला" (अन्धपरम्परा) क उपमा आ "हम ब्रह्म छी—एहि ज्ञानमे सभ विधि आ अन्य समस्त प्रमाण समाप्त भऽ जाइत अछि" ई चरम-सिद्धान्त शास्त्रार्थक उपसंहार करैत अछि। पृथक् शास्त्रारम्भक औचित्य प्रथम सूत्रसँ अन्विति साधि उपसंहार करैत अछि, जे रचना-शिल्पक दृष्टिँ वृत्त-पूर्ति (ring composition) अछि।

अनुवाद-सिद्धान्त, भाषा-रणनीति आ देशज मुहावरा

गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक अनुवाद "अर्थानुगामी किन्तु वाक्-स्वतन्त्र" सिद्धान्तपर आधारित अछि। मूलक तर्क-क्रम, दृष्टान्त-क्रम आ प्रमाण-क्रमसँ तनिकहु विचलन नहि अछि, मुदा वाक्य-विन्यास पूर्णतः मैथिलीक अपन देशज प्रकृतिमे अछि। एहि अनुवादक भाषा-रणनीति तीन स्तरपर काज करैत अछि:

१. **पारिभाषिक शुद्धता:** अध्यास, अनिर्वचनीय, समानाधिकरण, प्रत्यभिज्ञा, अर्थापत्ति, कूटस्थ, उपादान सन पारिभाषिक शब्द यथावत् राखल गेल अछि, मुदा प्रत्येकक प्रथम प्रयोगपर हुनक मैथिली व्याख्या देल गेल अछि। एहिसँ मैथिलीमे मीमांसा आ वेदान्तक पारिभाषिकीक सफल निर्माण भेल अछि, जकर दूरगामी महत्त्व अछि। २. **मैथिलीकरण आ वाक्य-संरचना:** संस्कृतक दीर्घ समास-गुम्फित वाक्य कें तोड़ि "बात ई अछि—", "मानि लिअ।", "कहल ई जा रहल अछि—", "एकर उत्तर... दैत छथि" सन सूत्रधार-पदक प्रयोग कएल गेल अछि। संस्कृत 'ननु' क स्थानपर 'मानि लिअ' क ई निर्वाह एतेक सुसंगत अछि जे पाठक पूर्वपक्ष-सिद्धान्तक आवाजाही कतहु नहि बिसरैत अछि। ३. **देशज मुहावरा आ लोकोक्ति:** संस्कृत न्यायोक्ति कें मैथिली लोकवाणीमे रूपान्तरित करब एहि अनुवादक सर्वोत्कृष्ट पक्ष अछि:

- "अन्हर अन्हरक हाथ पकड़ि प्रत्येक डेगपर खसैत अछि" (अन्धपरम्परा-दूषण)।
- "जौक खीर नोनगर नहि अछि" (अत्यल्प प्रयासक द्योतन)।
- "हजार शास्त्र मिलियो घट कें पट नहि बना सकैत अछि" (अनुभवविरोधी श्रुतिक निषेध)।
- "हजार कारीगरो घटसँ वस्त्र नहि बना सकैत"।
- "बाणक दाँतक परीक्षा जकाँ निरर्थक वस्तुमे जिज्ञासा"।

शब्द-चयनमे देशज गन्ध—यथा इजोत, अन्हार, मुस्की, बाछा, आँठी, केंचुली, बाँबी, धुँधलका, गड़ेरिया, भूँसी, ओखली, जुलाहा, कुम्हार—दार्शनिक गद्य कें जीवन-गन्ध दैत अछि, आ तैयो कतहु ग्राम्यताक अतिरेकसँ गम्भीरता खण्डित नहि होइत अछि। लिङ्ग-वचन-सङ्गति, "छथि" (आदरार्थ प्रयोग: ब्रह्म, आत्मा, आचार्यक हेतु) आ "अछि" (सामान्य) क अनुशासित प्रयोग, तथा नुक्ता (ङ/ढ मात्र) क सङ्गति "AUDIT_CORRECTED" संस्करणक सम्पादकीय श्रम प्रमाणित करैत अछि। स्रोत-सङ्केत (बृहदारण्यक, भगवद्गीताक स्थल-निर्देश) पाठकीय उपयोगिता बढ़बैत अछि।

मैथिली वाङ्मयमे विदेह आ गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक योगदान

वाचस्पति मिश्र मैथिल छलाह—ई गौरव-वाक्य मैथिलीमे बेर-बेर दोहराओल जाइत अछि, मुदा हुनक ग्रन्थ मैथिलीमे नहि छल। गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक ई अनुवाद ओहि ऐतिहासिक अभावक पूर्ति अछि आ ओहि गौरव केँ पाठ्य-सम्पत्तिमे बदलैत अछि। विदेह ई-पत्रिका (स्थापना २०००, ISSN 2229-547X) आ ओकर ग्रन्थ-शृङ्खलामे शास्त्रीय संस्कृत ग्रन्थक जे मैथिली-सेतु बनि रहल अछि, ताहिमे भामती-सन दर्शन-ग्रन्थक समावेश ई सिद्ध करैत अछि जे मैथिली केवल गीत-कथाक नहि, कठोरतम शास्त्र-विमर्शक सेहो सक्षम वाहिका अछि।

मिथिलाक नैयायिक-मीमांसक परम्परा (जाहिमे स्वयं वाचस्पति, आ आगाँ गङ्गेश उपाध्यायक तत्त्वचिन्तामणि-धारा अबैत अछि) क संग एहि अनुवादक अन्तःसूत्र स्पष्ट अछि। भामतीक ख्याति-विमर्श आ प्रामाण्य-विमर्श परवर्ती नव्यन्यायक पूर्वपीठिका अछि; अतः मैथिलीमे भामतीक उपलब्धता मिथिलाक अपन बौद्धिक इतिहासक पुनरधिग्रहण अछि। विश्वविद्यालयीय स्तरपर मैथिली-माध्यमे दर्शनशास्त्रक पाठ्यक्रम, शोध आ शास्त्रार्थ-प्रशिक्षणक हेतु ई ग्रन्थ आधार-पाठ बनबाक योग्य अछि।

भावी संस्करणक लेल सम्पादकीय विमर्श

विस्तृत समीक्षाक क्रममे समग्र शुद्धताक बीच किछु सूक्ष्म सम्पादकीय बिन्दु भावी संस्करणक हेतु द्रष्टव्य अछि:

- "अपरोक्ष" रूप पाठमे सात ठाम आएल अछि जखन कि शुद्ध "अपरोक्ष" चारि ठाम—एहि द्वैधक एकरूपीकरण वाञ्छनीय अछि।
- प्रतिलिप्यधिकार-पङ्क्तिमे "प्रीति ठाकर" मुद्रित अछि; अभीष्ट "प्रीति ठाकुर" बुझना जाइत अछि।
- रूपान्तरण-त्रयक गणनामे "धर्मलक्षणक अनुसार तीन प्रकारक कहल गेल अछि—" ई वाक्य जतय अछि ओतय गणना-सूची तुरन्त नहि आबि अगिला अनुच्छेदमे व्याख्या अबैत अछि; एकटा योजक-वाक्यसँ प्रवाह आर सहज भऽ सकैत अछि।
- उपयोगिताक दृष्टिँ भावी संस्करणमे पारिभाषिक शब्दक मैथिली-संस्कृत कोश-परिशिष्ट, सूत्र-भाष्य-टीका स्तरक मुद्रण-भेद (यथा भिन्न टङ्कन-शैली), आ अधिकरण-अनुक्रमणिका जोड़ल जा सकैत अछि।

ई सभ परिष्कार-सुझाव अछि, दोष-गणना नहि। पृष्ठ १ सँ ४९१ धरिक एहि विशाल पाठमे स्खलनक ई अल्पता स्वयं "AUDIT" प्रक्रियाक सफलताक प्रमाण अछि।

समग्र मूल्याङ्कन

गजेन्द्र ठाकुर कृत "भामती (चतुःसूत्री)" क ई शुद्ध मैथिली रूपान्तर मैथिली गद्यक इतिहासमे एकटा मानक-स्थापक कृति अछि। ई एक संग तीन काज करैत अछि—वाचस्पतिक तर्क-सौध केँ अविकल मैथिलीमे उतारब, मीमांसा-न्याय-वेदान्तक पारिभाषिकीक मैथिली-प्रतिमान गढ़ब, आ मिथिलाक अपन दार्शनिक धरोहर केँ मिथिलाक अपन भाषामे घुरा आनब।

अध्यासभाष्यक सूक्ष्मतम ख्याति-विमर्शसँ लऽ कऽ समन्वयाधिकरणक विराट शास्त्रार्थ धरि—
 कतहु तर्कक कड़ी टूटल नहि अछि, कतहु भाषाक साँस फूलल नहि अछि। ग्रन्थक उदाहरण, पूर्वपक्ष,
 उत्तर, पुनःशङ्का, समाधान आ निष्कर्षक क्रम सुरक्षित रहबाक कारण पाठक केवल निष्कर्ष नहि,
 अपितु शास्त्रार्थक सम्पूर्ण प्रक्रिया देखैत छथि। भारतीय काव्यशास्त्रक कसौटीपर ई अनुवाद "प्रसाद-
 गुण" क आदर्श अछि—अर्थ-गाम्भीर्य रहितहुँ शब्द-प्रसन्नता; आ शास्त्रीय गद्यक "समता" (एकरूप
 रचना-शैली) एकर स्थायी धर्म अछि।

"जहिना राजपथक पानि गङ्गाक धारमे पड़ि शुद्ध भऽ जाइत अछि"—वाचस्पतिक ई विनयोक्ति
 एहि अनुवादपर उनटा कऽ लागू होइत अछि: आचार्यक गङ्गा-धार आब मिथिलाक राजपथ धरि आबि
 गेल अछि, आ पथिक-मात्र ओहिमे अवगाहन कऽ सकैत छथि। मैथिली दर्शन-वाङ्मयक हेतु ई ग्रन्थ
 दीर्घकाल धरि सन्दर्भ-स्तम्भ रहत, आ शेष भामतीक (प्रथमाध्यायक अवशिष्ट अंशसँ चतुर्थाध्याय
 धरिक) मैथिली-आगमनक प्रतीक्षा एहि संस्करणक पाठक स्वाभाविके करताह। अद्वैत वेदान्तक
 जीवन्तता आ मैथिली भाषाक बौद्धिक सामर्थ्यक ई एकटा अद्वितीय सङ्गम अछि, जे ज्ञानमीमांसा,
 अर्थ-सिद्धान्त आ चेतना-दर्शनक विद्यार्थीक हेतु तुलनात्मक अध्ययनक समृद्ध सामग्री उपलब्ध करबैत
 अछि।

अध्याय २

भामती (चतुःसूत्री)

शंकरक ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यपर वाचस्पति मिश्रक टीका

विस्तृत दार्शनिक, अनुवाद-समीक्षात्मक आ साहित्यिक समीक्षा

मूल संस्कृत: वाचस्पति मिश्र

संस्कृतसँ शुद्ध मैथिली अनुवाद: गजेन्द्र ठाकुर

समीक्षित पाठ: अध्यासभाष्यसँ चतुःसूत्री-समाप्ति धरि

विदेह — प्रथम मैथिली पाक्षिक ई-पत्रिका

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एहि समीक्षामे ग्रन्थक मङ्गलाचरण, अध्यास-प्रकरण, ब्रह्मसूत्रक पहिल चारू सूत्रक व्याख्या, भामती-प्रस्थानक विशिष्ट सिद्धान्त, अनुवादक भाषा-रणनीति, तर्क-शैली, भारतीय आ पाश्चात्य समीक्षा-दृष्टि, मैथिली वाङ्मयमे एकर स्थान तथा भावी संस्करणक सम्पादकीय आवश्यकता—सभक क्रमबद्ध परीक्षण कएल गेल अछि।

१. ग्रन्थ-परिचय आ समीक्ष्य पाठक स्वरूप

भारतीय दर्शनक इतिहासमे मिथिलाक जे सभसँ उज्ज्वल देन अछि, ताहिमे वाचस्पति मिश्र (नवम शताब्दी)क "भामती" अग्रगण्य अछि। शंकराचार्यक ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यपर लिखल ई टीका अद्वैत वेदान्तक "भामती-प्रस्थान"क आधारग्रन्थ अछि, आ एकर रचयिता स्वयं मिथिलाक सन्तान छथि। तथापि विडम्बना ई जे सहस्राधिक वर्ष धरि मैथिल पाठक अपनहि माटिक एहि दार्शनिक शिखर धरि संस्कृतक सीढ़ी बिना नहि पहुँचि सकैत छलाह। गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक ई अनुवाद ओही ऐतिहासिक अभावक पूर्ति अछि — भामतीक चतुःसूत्री अंश (शंकरक अध्यासभाष्यपर टीका आ ब्रह्मसूत्रक प्रथम चारि सूत्रक व्याख्या) पहिल बेर सम्पूर्ण रूपेँ, अविकल आ शुद्ध मैथिलीमे उपलब्ध भेल अछि।

समीक्ष्य पाठ संचयी संस्करणक पृष्ठ 1 सँ 491 धरिक सामग्री समेटैत अछि आ "एतय चतुःसूत्री-भामती समाप्त होइत अछि" एहि पुष्पिकापर समाप्त होइत अछि। ग्रन्थक संरचना एहि क्रममे अछि — (क) आवरण आ प्रकाशकीय पृष्ठ, (ख) शंकरक अध्यासभाष्यक मूल पाठक मैथिली रूपान्तर, (ग) वाचस्पतिक सात मङ्गलश्लोकक अनुवाद, (घ) "अध्यास" शीर्षकसँ अध्यासभाष्यपर भामती-टीकाक सम्पूर्ण अनुवाद, (ङ) "अतः आब ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा" (अथातो ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा) — प्रथम सूत्रक टीका, (च) "जाहिसँ एहि जगतक जन्म आदि होइत अछि" (जन्माद्यस्य यतः) — द्वितीय सूत्रक टीका, (छ) "शास्त्रक स्रोत होयबाक कारण" (शास्त्रयोनित्वात्) — तृतीय सूत्रक टीका, आ (ज) "परन्तु ओ, समन्वयक कारण" (तत्तु समन्वयात्) — चतुर्थ सूत्रक विशालकाय टीका। समन्वयाधिकरणक अंश सम्पूर्ण ग्रन्थक लगभग एक-तिहाइ अछि, जे मूल भामतीक अनुपातक प्रति अनुवादकक निष्ठा देखबैत अछि।

प्रकाशकीय पृष्ठपर प्रथम संस्करण 2004 आ परिवर्धित संस्करण 2026क उल्लेख अछि — अर्थात् ई कृति दुइ दशकक परिपक्व साधनाक फल अछि। प्रकाशक विदेह ई-पत्रिका (स्थापना 2000, ISSN 2229-547X) अछि आ ई ग्रन्थ विदेहक ग्रन्थ-शृङ्खलाक अन्तर्गत आएल अछि। प्रतिलिप्यधिकार गजेन्द्र ठाकुर आ प्रीति ठाकुरक संयुक्त नाम अछि, आ मूल संस्कृत ग्रन्थ केँ "भारतीय दार्शनिक परम्पराक शास्त्रीय धरोहर" कहि ओकर सार्वजनिक स्वरूपक सम्मान कएल गेल अछि — ई प्रकाशकीय विवेक प्रशंसनीय अछि।

२. मङ्गलाचरणक समीक्षा

वाचस्पतिक सात मङ्गलश्लोक भामतीक प्रवेशद्वार अछि आ अनुवादमे ई सभ अपन दार्शनिक भार आ काव्यगत लालित्य दुनू सुरक्षित रखने अछि। पहिल श्लोकमे ब्रह्म केँ "अपरिमेय आनन्द आ ज्ञानस्वरूप" कहि, "दुइ प्रकारक अनिर्वचनीय अविद्या केँ मन्त्री बना कऽ" पञ्चभूतक "मिथ्या अभिव्यक्ति" करनिहार प्रभु रूपमे प्रणाम कएल गेल अछि — एतहि भामती-प्रस्थानक बीज-सिद्धान्त (द्विविध अविद्या: आवरण आ संस्कार/मूलाविद्या-तूलाविद्या दिशाक सङ्केत) पाठक केँ पहिनहि भेटि जाइत अछि। "मन्त्री" रूपक अनुवादमे मूलक राजनैतिक रूपकक चमक बाँचल अछि।

दोसर श्लोकक अनुवाद — "वेद हुनक श्वास छथि, पाँचो महाभूत हुनक दृष्टि छथि, चल-अचल जगत हुनक मुस्की अछि आ हुनक निद्रा महाप्रलय अछि" — मैथिलीक "मुस्की" शब्दक प्रयोगसँ एकटा आत्मीय सौन्दर्य पाबि लैत अछि; ब्रह्माण्डक लीला घरेलू भाषामे उतरि अबैत अछि। आगाँ वेद-भव, मार्तण्ड-तिलकस्वामिन्-महागणपति, व्यास ("द्वितीय सृष्टिकर्ता आ भगवान् हरिक ज्ञानशक्तिक अवतार") आ शंकर ("निर्मल ज्ञानस्वरूप, कृपाक समुद्र")क वन्दना क्रमशः आबि अछि। सातम श्लोकक विनयोक्ति — "जहिना राजपथक पानि गङ्गाक धारमे पड़ि शुद्ध भऽ जाइत अछि, तहिना हमरा सन लोकक तुच्छ वचन आचार्यक रचनासँ जुड़ि पवित्र भऽ जाइत अछि" — टीकाकारक आत्मस्थापनक शास्त्रीय शैलीक सुन्दर मैथिली प्रतिरूप अछि। अनुवादक श्लोकसभ केँ गद्यानुवाद रूपमे राखि अर्थ-सुरक्षा केँ छन्द-सुरक्षासँ ऊपर राखलनि — दार्शनिक ग्रन्थक हेतु ई निर्णय उचित अछि।

३. अध्यास-प्रकरण: शाङ्कर उपोद्घातपर वाचस्पतिक टीकाक अनुवाद

३.१ पूर्वपक्षक भव्य निर्माण: आत्मा जिज्ञासाक विषय नहि

टीका "युष्मद्-अस्मत्" भाष्यक व्याख्यासँ पहिने एकटा दीर्घ पूर्वपक्ष ठाढ़ करैत अछि — जाहि वस्तुमे सन्देह नहि आ जकर ज्ञानसँ प्रयोजन नहि, ओ जिज्ञासाक विषय नहि; "तेज इजोतमे उपस्थित, मनसहित नेत्रेन्द्रियक सम्पर्कमे आयल घट; अथवा कौआक दाँत" — ई दुनू दृष्टान्त (निष्सन्दिग्ध आ निष्प्रयोजन) अनुवादमे अपन चुटीलापन रखने अछि। पूर्वपक्षी क्रमशः देखबैत अछि जे "हम"क अपरोक्ष अनुभव "कृमि-पतङ्गसँ लऽ कऽ देवता आ ऋषि धरि" सभमे अछि; देह अधिष्ठान नहि, कारण बाल्यसँ वृद्धावस्था धरिक प्रत्यभिज्ञा ("हम, जे बाल्यकालमे अपन माता-पिताक संग आनन्द पबैत छलहुँ, एखन वृद्धावस्थामे अपन नाती-पोताक संग आनन्द पबैत छी") देह-भेदक पार जाइत अछि; फूल आ गूँथनिहार सूतक दृष्टान्त, स्वप्नमे दिव्य देहक बाध, योगबलसँ बाध बननिहारक आत्माभिन्नता, "जे हम स्वयं देखलहुँ, से एखन छुबैत छी"क इन्द्रिय-व्यभिचार — सभ तर्क क्रमबद्ध अनूदित अछि। "दीर्घा चिचिया रहल अछि"क गौणी-वृत्तिक लौकिक उदाहरण मैथिलीमे सहज उतरल अछि।

पूर्वपक्षक चरम एहि उद्धोषमे अछि — "हजार शास्त्र मिलियो घट केँ पट नहि बना सकैत अछि" — अनुभवविरोधी श्रुति गौणार्थक मानल जाए। अनुवादक एहि प्रसिद्ध न्यायवाक्य केँ ठेठ मैथिली लयमे राखलनि अछि, जाहिसँ पूर्वपक्षक आक्रामकता जीवन्त भऽ गेल अछि। एकर बाद अणु-परिमाण आ देह-परिमाण आत्माक विकल्प, अवयविवेचना-प्रत्यवयवचेतनाक दूषण, आ क्षणभङ्गुर विज्ञान केँ अहम्-आश्रय मानबाक खण्डन — ई सभ नैयायिक-बौद्ध-मीमांसक पृष्ठभूमिक तर्क यथाक्रम आएल अछि।

३.२ श्रुति-प्रत्यक्ष-विरोधक समाधान

सिद्धान्त-पक्षमे टीका उपक्रम-उपसंहार-अभ्यासादि तात्पर्यलिङ्गसँ श्रुतिक निरुपाधिक आत्म-प्रतिपादन देखबैत अछि — "पुनरुक्ति सँ विषयक महत्ता सिद्ध होइत अछि — जहिना अहो, सुन्दर! अहो, सुन्दर!" ई अनुवाद मीमांसा-परिभाषा केँ लोकोक्तिक सरसतासँ जोड़ैत अछि। श्रुतिक अपौरुषेयता, स्वतःप्रामाण्य, आ "श्रुतिजन्य ज्ञान प्रत्यक्षक व्यवहारिक प्रामाण्य केँ नष्ट नहि करैत; ओ

केवल पारमार्थिक प्रामाण्यक निषेध करैत अछि" — ई सूक्ष्म व्यावहारिक-पारमार्थिक भेद, जे अद्वैत-प्रमाणमीमांसाक मेरुदण्ड अछि, अत्यन्त स्पष्ट मैथिलीमे आएल अछि। ह्रस्व-दीर्घ ध्वनिधर्मक वर्णपर आरोप रहितहुँ "नग" आ "नाग"सँ यथार्थ अर्थबोधक दृष्टान्त, शुक्ति-रजतमे पूर्वज्ञानक उत्तरज्ञानसँ बाध, जैमिनिसूत्र ("जतय पूर्व आ उत्तरक सम्बन्ध हो, ओतय पूर्व पक्ष दुर्बल होइत अछि") — सभ प्रमाण-सामग्री अविकल अछि।

गौणी वृत्तिक विश्लेषण एहि प्रकरणक एक रत्न अछि: "अग्निहोत्र" शब्दक कुण्डपायिनाम् अयनक मास-अग्निहोत्रमे गौण प्रयोग, शिष्यमे "सिंह" शब्द, आ "तैल" शब्दक सरिसोक तेलमे रुढ़ि — तीनू उदाहरणसँ सिद्ध कएल गेल जे गौण प्रयोग भेदज्ञानपूर्वक होइत अछि, आ "हम"क प्रयोगमे देहसँ भेदज्ञान नहि रहबाक कारण ओ गौण नहि, मिथ्या अछि। ई विवेक आगाँ चतुर्थ सूत्रक अन्तमे पुनः विकसित होइत अछि, आ अनुवाद दुनू स्थलक पारिभाषिक एकरूपता निभेने अछि।

३.३ अध्यास-लक्षण आ ख्यातिवाद-विमर्श

"पहिने देखल वस्तुक स्मृतिसदृश स्वरूपमे आन ठाम प्रकट होएब" — अध्यासक एहि भाष्यीय लक्षणक पदशः व्याख्या (पूर्वदृष्ट, अवभास, स्मृतिरूप, परत्र) अतिव्याप्ति-अव्याप्तिक परीक्षासहित अनूदित अछि: कालाक्षी गाएमे गोत्वक प्रत्यभिज्ञा आ पाटलिपुत्र-माहिष्मतीक देवदत्तक यथार्थ प्रत्यभिज्ञासँ अतिव्याप्तिक शङ्का, स्वप्नज्ञानसँ अव्याप्तिक परिहार, "शुक्ति पीयर अछि" आ "चीनी तीत अछि"मे पित्तदोषक प्रक्रिया, दर्पण-जलपट्टक प्रतिबिम्बभ्रम, द्विचन्द्र, दिशाभ्रम, अलातचक्र, मृगतृष्णा, बाँसमे साँप — भ्रमक ई समग्र लौकिक कोश मैथिलीमे पूर्ण उतरल अछि।

तकर बाद भाष्यक "किछु लोक... आन किछु लोक..." वाक्यक ओटमे ख्यातिवादक शास्त्रार्थ अछि — सौत्रान्तिक-विज्ञानवादीक आत्मख्याति (ज्ञानाकारक बाह्य आरोप), प्राभाकरक अख्याति (स्मृति-ग्रहणक भेदाग्रह; "स्मृतिक स्मृतित्व लुप्त भऽ जाएब"), आ नैयायिकक अन्यथाख्याति। वाचस्पतिक व्यङ्ग्य-वैभव अनुवादमे अद्भुत जीवन्तता पओने अछि: "अहा! दीर्घजीवी महोदय एहि बाधक ज्ञानपर विचार करथि", "देवप्रिय हुनकर बुद्धिक प्रशंसा करथि!", "अहा! बेचारा ज्ञानक ई केहन महान सौभाग्य अछि जे असत्यक द्वारा सेहो निश्चितता प्राप्त कऽ लैत अछि!" — संस्कृत शास्त्रार्थक कटाक्ष-परम्परा मैथिलीक व्यङ्ग्य-सामर्थ्यसँ मिलि गेल अछि। अन्यथाख्याति-खण्डनमे "गवय गाए जकाँ अछि" ई ज्ञान गाए खोजनिहार केँ गवय दिस नहि बढ़बैत — ई तर्क, आ रजतार्थिक प्रवृत्ति-क्रम (भेदाग्रह → आरोप → रजतत्व-हेतुक अनुमान → प्रवृत्ति)क विश्लेषण सटीक अछि।

वनान्निमे झुलसल ईखक बीआसँ कदलीकाण्ड आ भस्मक-रोगीक जठराग्नि — दोषसँ कारणमे कार्यान्तर-सामर्थ्यक ई दृष्टान्त, तथा "अग्नि उष्ण नहि अछि" सन बाधित-विषय अनुमानक दूषण — सभ यथावत् अछि। विशेष उल्लेखनीय ई जे वाचस्पतिक आत्म-सन्दर्भ — "एहि आपत्तिक उत्तर हम न्याय-कणिकामे दऽ चुकल छी" आ "ओकर विस्तृत विवेचन ब्रह्मतत्त्वसमीक्षामे देखबाक चाही" — अनुवादमे सुरक्षित अछि; एहिसँ मैथिल पाठक केँ वाचस्पतिक ग्रन्थ-परम्परा (न्यायकणिका, ब्रह्मतत्त्वसमीक्षा)क बोध स्वतः भेटैत अछि।

३.४ अनिर्वचनीयख्यातिक स्थापना

सिद्धान्त-रूपमे अनिर्वचनीयताक स्थापना एहि अंशक दार्शनिक शिखर अछि: किरणपर आरोपित जल "ने सत्य अछि, ने असत्य, आ ने सत्य-असत्य दुनू; कारण अन्तिम विकल्प आत्मविरोधी अछि" — सदसद्विलक्षणताक ई त्रैविध्य-निषेध, आ तकर पूर्वक सूक्ष्म तर्क (आरोपित रूप जँ किरण होइत तँ

ज्ञान "किरण"रूपक होइत, जँ गङ्गाजल होइत तँ "गङ्गाक जल"रूपक — मुदा ज्ञान "एतयक जल"रूपक अछि) मैथिलीमे तर्कक कोनो कड़ी छोड़ने बिना आएल अछि। "प्रकाशमानता मात्रे यथार्थता नहि" — नहि तँ मृगतृष्णाक "ऊँच-नीच तरङ्गमालासहित मन्दाकिनी" लग उतरि अबितय आ तृषार्त ओकर जल पीबि सकितय — ई काव्यमय दूषण अनुवादमे मूलक चित्रात्मकता समेत उपस्थित अछि। सत्य-अनृतक "मिथुनीकरण"मे च्वि-प्रत्ययक व्याकरणिक सूक्ष्मता ("जे वस्तु ओ नहि अछि, मानो ओही बनि जाए") सेहो छूटल नहि अछि — ई अनुवादकक शास्त्रीय सतर्कताक प्रमाण अछि।

३.५ आत्माक स्वयंप्रकाशता-विमर्श

"फेर, केना" भाष्यांशक व्याख्यामे चैतन्यक स्वप्रकाशताक दीर्घ शास्त्रार्थ अछि — आत्मा कर्ता-कर्म दुनू नहि भऽ सकैत; ज्ञप्तिक जड़त्वमे "अन्हर अन्हरक हाथ पकड़ि प्रत्येक डेगपर खसैत अछि" ई अन्धपरम्परा-दूषण; ज्ञानान्तर-कल्पनामे अनवस्था; "पुत्र विद्वान् अछि, तँ की पिता सेहो विद्वान् भऽ जाएत?" ई स्वभाव-सम्बन्धक खण्डनक चुटीला दृष्टान्त; जुगनूक इजोत जकाँ स्वमात्रप्रकाशी चेतनाक आपत्ति; विज्ञानवादीक विषय-प्रकाशवादक निरास (विषय सीमित-स्थूल रूपँ भासैत अछि, प्रकाश आन्तरिक-अपरिच्छिन्न रूपँ) — आ अन्ततः निष्कर्ष: "ई प्रकाशे — जे स्वयंप्रकाश, एक, अविकारी, नित्य आ निरवयव अछि — अन्तरात्मा अछि।" चैत्र-नगर-गमनक कर्म-कर्तृ-विश्लेषण सेहो यथावत् अछि। एतय अनुवादक जटिलतम प्रकरण केँ जाहि धैर्यसँ वाक्य-दर-वाक्य खोललनि अछि, से मैथिली दार्शनिक गद्यक क्षमताक कसौटी आ प्रमाण दुनू अछि।

३.६ अविषय आत्मापर अध्यासः आकाश-दृष्टान्त आ जीवभाव

"अपरोक्ष अनुभूति"क मुख्य उत्तर आ "प्रौढवादक रीति"सँ देल दोसर उत्तर — "आ एहि विषयमे कोनो नियम नहि" — दुनू क्रमशः अनूदित अछि। अप्रत्यक्ष आकाशपर "बालक" (अविवेकी) लोकक तल-मलिनताक आरोप, "इन्द्रनील मणिसँ बनल विशाल उलटल कटोरा"क उपमा, नीलकमल-पङ्खुड़ी आ राजहंस-पाँतेक वर्ण-आरोप — ई सभ चित्र मैथिलीमे मनोहर अछि। घट-कलश-पात्रक उपाधिभेदसँ आकाशक भेदाभास जकाँ अविद्याकल्पित बुद्धि-मन-देहोपाधिसँ जीवभावक निष्पत्ति; "ई नहि" आ "ई"क स्वरूप-सम्भिन्न जीवक अहंप्रत्यय-विषयता; बीआ-अङ्कुर-न्यायसँ अन्योन्याश्रयक परिहार — अध्यास-सिद्धान्तक ई सम्पूर्ण ताना-बाना अविकल अछि।

३.७ अविद्या-लक्षण, प्रमाण-प्रवृत्ति आ पशु-साम्य

"उपर्युक्त स्वरूपक एहि अध्यास केँ ज्ञानी लोक अविद्या कहैत छथि; आ ताहिसँ भिन्न वस्तुक वास्तविक स्वरूपक निश्चय केँ ज्ञान कहैत छथि" — मिथ्याज्ञान-सम्यग्ज्ञानक ई युग्म-लक्षण, आ "अन्तरात्मापर अनात्माक अध्यासे समस्त अनर्थक एकमात्र कारण अछि, शुक्तिमे रजतक भ्रम नहि" ई विवेचन स्पष्ट अछि। प्रमातृत्वक अध्यासाधीनता ("देह, इन्द्रिय आदिमे हम आ हमरक अभिमानसँ रहित व्यक्ति ज्ञाता भऽ सकैत अछि — ई बुद्धिगम्य नहि"), जुलाहा-तुरीक दृष्टान्तसँ करण-प्रेरणाक विश्लेषण, आ असङ्ग आत्माक अकर्तृत्व — सभ सोपान क्रमबद्ध अछि। पशु-साम्यक प्रसिद्ध भाष्यांश — लाठी उठौने मनुष्य देखि भागब, हरियर घास देखि लग जाएब; तरुआरि उठौने उग्र पुरुष देखि विद्वानो हटब — मैथिलीमे एतेक सहज अछि जे ग्राम्य-जीवनक चित्र सोझाँ ठाढ़ भऽ जाइत अछि। शास्त्रीय व्यवहारमे अधिकार-विश्लेषण, श्येनयागक अधिकारिभेद ("क्रोधरूपी शत्रु केँ

जीतनिहार व्यक्ति निषेधक अधिकारी अछि; मुदा क्रोधरूपी शत्रुक वशमे रहल व्यक्ति श्येन आदिक उपदेशक अधिकारी अछि"), आ वर्ण-आश्रम-वयोवस्थाध्यासक उदाहरण-चतुष्टय ("राजा राजसूय यज्ञ करए", "गृहस्थ समान वर्णवाली स्त्रीसँ विवाह करए", "जकर केश कृष्ण अछि, से अग्निसेवा करए", "जकर रोग असाध्य अछि, से जलमे प्रवेश कऽ प्राणत्याग करए") — ई सभ शास्त्रीय सामग्री यथातथ्य अछि।

अध्याय-प्रकरणक उपसंहारमे "हम" आ "हमर"क अध्यास-द्वैविध्य (धर्माध्यास आ धर्म्यध्यास), पुत्र-पत्नीक स्वस्थता-अस्वस्थतासँ "हम स्वयं स्वस्थ/अस्वस्थ छी"क अनुभव, इन्द्रियधर्म ("हम गूँग छी, एकनयन छी, बहिर छी, अन्हर छी") आ अन्तःकरणधर्म (इच्छा-सङ्कल्प-संशय-निश्चय)क आरोप, आ "एहि अनर्थक कारणक निवारण आ आत्मैकत्वज्ञानक प्राप्तिक लेल सम्पूर्ण वेदान्त आरम्भ होइत अछि" ई शारीरकमीमांसा-प्रतिज्ञा — सम्पूर्ण उपोद्धात एहि ठाम पूर्णता पबैत अछि। रस्सी-सर्पक "हजारो बेर"क भ्रमज्ञानसँ रस्सीस्वरूपक अबाध, आ यथार्थज्ञानक अभ्याससँ भ्रम-संस्कारक उच्छेद — ई सिद्धान्त-वाक्य आगाँक सूत्रव्याख्याक सेतु बनैत अछि।

४. प्रथम सूत्र: "अतः आब ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा" (अथातो ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा)

४.१ "अथ" पदक मीमांसा

सूत्रव्याख्याक आरम्भमे जिज्ञासा-पदसँ संशय आ फल — दुनूक सूचन, "अपनहि गरदनमे पड़ल हार"क दृष्टान्तसँ प्राप्तस्य प्राप्तिक स्वरूप, आ मीमांसा-शास्त्र-सूत्र पदक निर्वचन आएल अछि। "अथ" शब्दक चारि अर्थ-विकल्पक परीक्षा — आनन्तर्य, आरम्भ ("अथातोऽयं ज्योतिष्टोमः", "अथ शब्दानुशासनम्", "अथ योगानुशासनम्"क उदाहरणसहित), मङ्गल, आ अधिकार (पूर्वप्रकृतापेक्षा) — पूर्ण शास्त्रीय विधिसँ अनूदित अछि। मङ्गल-पक्षक निरासमे "मृदङ्ग अथवा शङ्खक ध्वनि" आ "दोसर प्रयोजन लेल आनल जलपूर्ण कलशक दर्शन"क दृष्टान्त, तथा "ॐ आ अथ — ई दुइ शब्द ब्रह्माक कण्ठसँ पहिने प्रकट भेल" स्मृतिक समन्वय ध्वनि-मात्रसँ मङ्गल मानि कएल गेल अछि। "दण्डधारी अनुमति आ प्रत्युत्तरक पाठ करैत अछि"मे दण्डक गौण-विवक्षाक दृष्टान्तसँ जिज्ञासाक प्राधान्यक रक्षा — ई सूक्ष्म मीमांसा-तर्क सेहो अविकल अछि।

४.२ कर्मज्ञानानन्तर्यक खण्डन आ कर्मक वास्तविक स्थान

"धर्मजिज्ञासाक अनन्तर ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा" ई पक्ष विस्तारसँ उठाओल आ खण्डित कएल गेल अछि। एहि क्रममे ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कारक उत्पाद्य-विकार्य-संस्कार्य-आप्य चतुर्विध कार्यतासँ बहिर्भाव (आटाक गोला, धान-चाउर, ओखलीक प्रोक्षण, दूध दुहब — चारू दृष्टान्त), जाइसँ ठिठुरल व्यक्तिक भावित अग्निक अप्रामाण्य, परदा-नर्तकीक आवरणभङ्ग-दृष्टान्त, "खम्भा अथवा मनुष्य"क संशयावृत्तिसँ निश्चयक अनुत्पत्ति, संगीताभ्याससँ षड्जादि-स्वर-साक्षात्कारक उपमा, आ "तत्त्वमसि"क श्रवण-मनन-निदिध्यासन-क्रम — सभ आएल अछि। कर्मक विषयमे विविध मत (मलक्षय, संस्कार, ऋणत्रय-परिशोध, संयोगपृथक्त्व — खदिर-यूपक दृष्टान्तसहित) आ "यज्ञादिक शास्त्रीय वचनक कारण ब्रह्मभावनामे सभक आवश्यकता अछि, जहिना अश्वक प्रसङ्गमे" ई बादरायण-सूत्र उद्धृत अछि; मुदा सिद्धान्ततः कर्म केवल "दूरस्थ सहायक" ठहराओल गेल — नित्यकर्मसँ पापक्षय, ताहिसँ बुद्धिशुद्धि, ताहिसँ वैराग्य, ताहिसँ जिज्ञासा। "योग प्राप्त करबाक इच्छुक मुनिक लेल कर्म कारण कहल गेल

अछि; योगारूढ़क लेल शम" — गीता-वचनक समन्वय, "अथवा छात्रावस्थासँ सेहो सीधे संन्यास ग्रहण करए" जाबालश्रुतिसँ क्रमवादक खण्डन, "जहि दिन वैराग्य उत्पन्न हो, ओही दिन संन्यास ग्रहण करए" — ई सभ प्रमाण-जाल अनुवादमे सुव्यवस्थित अछि।

तपस्याक व्याख्यामे अनुवादक व्यावहारिक विवेक चमकैत अछि: "पूर्ण उपवास करैत व्यक्ति नहि, कारण ओ मरि जाएत" — शुष्क शास्त्रीयताक बीच एहन ऋजु वाक्य पाठक केँ मुस्की दैत अछि, आ ई मूलक आशयक प्रामाणिक प्रतिध्वनि अछि। गोदोहन-पात्र आ दर्शपूर्णमास-सोमक क्रम-विमर्श, "हृदय छेदनक प्रसङ्गमे तत्काल क्रमक नियम" — पाठक्रम-स्थान-मुख्य-प्रवृत्ति प्रमाणक सम्पूर्ण मीमांसक तन्त्र सेहो छूटल नहि अछि।

४.३ साधन-चतुष्टय आ "अतः" पद

नित्यानित्यवस्तुविवेक, इहामुत्रार्थभोगविराग, शमदमादिसाधनसम्पत्ति आ मुमुक्षुत्व — एहि साधन-चतुष्टयक व्याख्या ग्रन्थक सर्वाधिक प्रवाहमय अंशमे अछि। विवेकक "निश्चय भेने ब्रह्म ज्ञात, सामान्य भेने वैराग्यक अनुत्पत्ति" ई उभयतःपाश आ तकर समाधान (अधिष्ठान-गुणक सामान्यतः नित्यानित्य-विभाग), वैराग्य-विरोधी पूर्वपक्षक रसमय दृष्टान्त-शृङ्खला — काँटा-शल्कसहित माछ आनि भोग्यांश लेब, भूँसीसहित धान, वन्य पशुक डरे बीज नहि छोड़निहार किसान, भिखारीक डरे भोजन नहि छोड़ब, "हम सोम पी चुकल छी, अमर भऽ गेल छी" श्रुतिक अमरत्व-वाद — आ सिद्धान्ततः "मधुमे विष मिलल भोजनसँ श्रेष्ठतम पाककुशलो विष अलग कऽ केवल मधु नहि खा सकैत अछि" तथा "प्रलय धरि स्थायित्व केँ अमरत्व कहल जाइत अछि" पौराणिक वचनसँ सोमवाक्यक गौणत्व-व्यवस्था — ई सम्पूर्ण प्रकरण मैथिली गद्यक उत्सव अछि। शम-दमक व्याख्यामे "शान्त आ प्रशिक्षित बाछा हल अथवा गाड़ी खींचबाक योग्य बनैत अछि" ई कृषक-जीवनक उपमा मूलक भावकेँ माटिसँ जोड़ि दैत अछि। कालगणनाक सूची — "क्षण, मुहूर्त, याम, दिन, राति, पक्ष, मास, ऋतु, अर्धवर्ष, वर्ष, युग, चारि युगक काल, मन्वन्तर, प्रलय आ महाप्रलय" — सत्यलोकसँ अवीचि धरिक त्रिविध दुःखक चिन्तनक संग अविकल अछि।

४.४ "ब्रह्मणः" पदक समास-मीमांसा आ जिज्ञासाक विषय

ई अंश ऐतिहासिक दृष्टिएँ महत्त्वपूर्ण अछि: "पूर्ववर्ती व्याख्याकारसभक चतुर्थी-समासरूप ब्रह्मणे जिज्ञासा — ब्रह्म लेल जिज्ञासा — व्याख्या एतय निरस्त बुझबाक चाही" — एतय वाचस्पति शाङ्कर-पूर्व अथवा भिन्न वृत्तिकार-परम्पराक (चतुर्थीसमास-पक्षक) खण्डन करैत छथि, आ कात्यायनक "चतुर्थी-समासमे आधारभूत वस्तु आ ओकर विकारक सम्बन्ध" (यूपाय दारु) नियमसँ षष्ठी-तत्पुरुष स्थापित करैत छथि। षष्ठीक कर्मार्थता-शेषार्थताक विवाद — "सूर्य वा चन्द्रमा देखलाक बाद ई ककर सम्बन्धी अछि? एहन खोज नहि उठैत; मुदा ज्ञान शब्द सुनला पर ककर ज्ञान? किएक नहि पूछल जाएत?" — आ "एतय राजा जाइत छथि" कहला पर अनुचरवर्गक अर्थापत्त्या ग्रहण जकाँ ब्रह्माश्रित शेष-विषयक स्वतः-सङ्ग्रह — ई सभ तर्क सटीक अनूदित अछि। ब्रह्मशब्दक अर्थ-सन्देह (ब्रह्महत्यामे ब्राह्मणजाति, ब्रह्मोज्झाम्मे वेद, "ब्रह्म केँ जाननिहार स्वयं ब्रह्म भऽ जाइत अछि"मे परमात्मा)क निरास अगिला सूत्रक लक्षणसँ कएल गेल अछि।

ज्ञात-अज्ञात-विकल्पक प्रसिद्ध आक्षेपक उत्तरमे "नित्य शुद्ध, बुद्ध, मुक्त, सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान ब्रह्म"क पद-पद व्याख्या (नित्यसँ क्षयदुःखनिषेध, शुद्धसँ उपाधिदुःखनिषेध, बुद्धसँ स्वप्रकाश-आनन्द), "धूलिसँ भरल पएरवाला साधारण कृषको धरि" आत्मरूपेँ ब्रह्मक प्रसिद्धि, आ आत्मस्वरूपक विषयमे

मतवैविध्यक ऐतिहासिक सर्वेक्षण — लोकायतक चैतन्यविशिष्ट देह, इन्द्रियात्मवाद, मन-आत्मवाद, क्षणिकविज्ञानवाद, शून्यवाद, देहान्तरगामी कर्ता-भोक्ता, केवल-भोक्ता (सांख्य-दिशा), जीवभिन्न सर्वज्ञ ईश्वर, आ "ईश्वर ओहि भोक्ता जीवक आत्मा छथि" (अद्वैत) — ई सम्पूर्ण दार्शनिक मानचित्र, तत्-त्वम् दुनू पदार्थक विप्रतिपत्तिसहित, मैथिली पाठक केँ भारतीय दर्शनक एकटा लघु-विश्वकोश उपलब्ध करा दैत अछि। "एहि मतसभमे सँ कोनो एक मत केँ विचार-विमर्श बिना स्वीकार कएनिहार व्यक्ति परम कल्याणसँ वञ्चित भऽ अनर्थ प्राप्त करत" — शास्त्रारम्भक ई प्रयोजन-वाक्य प्रकरणक समापन करैत अछि।

५. द्वितीय सूत्र: "जाहिसँ एहि जगतक जन्म आदि होइत अछि" (जन्माद्यस्य यतः)

लक्षण-जिज्ञासाक पूर्वपक्ष — अनुभवगम्य वस्तु सीमित-अशुद्ध-जड़-विनाशी अछि, ब्रह्म तद्विपरीत; स्वगुणसँ लक्षण असम्भव, कारण ओ अप्रसिद्ध — आ सिद्धान्ततः तटस्थलक्षणक स्थापना: "ब्रह्मसँ उत्पन्न होएबाक कारण जगत ब्रह्मक लक्षण भऽ सकैत अछि — जहिना विभिन्न देशमे पहुँचब सूर्यक गतिक लक्षण होइत अछि।" ई सूर्य-दृष्टान्त तटस्थलक्षणक शास्त्रीय व्याख्याक सुन्दर मैथिली वाहक अछि। "जन्मादि"मे नपुंसकलिङ्गक लाघव, उत्पत्ति-स्थिति-भङ्गक ग्रहण, यास्कक छह भावविकार (जायते, अस्ति, वर्धते, विपरिणमते, अपक्षीयते, विनश्यति)क उत्पत्त्यादि-त्रयमे अन्तर्भाव — वृद्धि उत्पत्तिमे (दुइ सूतसँ पैघ कपड़ा), धर्म-लक्षण-अवस्था तीनू परिणाम उत्पत्तिमे (सुवर्ण-कड़कणक उदाहरण), क्षय विनाशमे — ई सम्पूर्ण निरुक्त-विमर्श आ "वेदमे कहल उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाशे ग्रहण कएल गेल" ई श्रुत्यनुसारिताक हेतु स्पष्ट अछि।

जगद्वैचित्र्यसँ सर्वज्ञ-सर्वशक्तिमान् कारणक स्थापना — "नाम आ रूपसँ विभक्त, अनेक कर्ता आ भोक्ता सँ युक्त, तथा देश, काल, कारण, क्रिया आ फलसँ निश्चित रूपेँ व्यवस्थित" जगतक "रचना-बिन्द्यास मनसँ कल्पना करबो कठिन अछि" — कुम्हार-घटक बुद्धिपूर्वक-निर्माण-दृष्टान्त, प्रधान-काल-ग्रहदेवता-आकस्मिकता-स्वभाव-अभावक कारणत्व-निरास, आ नियत-व्यवस्थाक अपूर्व उदाहरण-चतुष्टय: "किछु प्राणी निश्चित देशमे उत्पन्न होइत अछि — जहिना कृष्णमृग। किछु निश्चित कालमे — जहिना कोइलीक कूजब। किछु निश्चित कारणसँ — जहिना वर्षाक आरम्भमे मेघगर्जनक कारण बगुलाक गर्भाधान।" — ई प्रकृति-चित्र मैथिलीमे अपन देशज सौरभ समेत उतरल अछि। कर्ता-भोक्ताक विभाग (रसोइया-ऋत्विज् कर्ता, श्राद्धक पितर आ वैश्वानरेशिक पुत्र भोक्ता) सेहो सटीक अछि।

प्रकरणक निर्णायक मोड़ ई अछि जे सूत्र अनुमानक सङ्केत नहि, वेदान्त-वाक्यक उपन्यास अछि: "सूत्रसभक प्रयोजन वेदान्त-वाक्यसभ केँ फूलक माला जकाँ एक सूत्रमे गूँथब अछि।" भृगु-वरुण-संवादक तैत्तिरीय-वाक्य ("जाहिसँ ई सभ प्राणी उत्पन्न होइत अछि... ओ ब्रह्म अछि") आ आनन्द-वल्लीक वाक्य निर्णायक रूपेँ उद्धृत अछि; अविद्यासहित रस्सी-सर्पक उपादानता-दृष्टान्तसँ ब्रह्मक (अविद्यासहितक) उपादान-कारणता, "बाँझ स्त्री माता अछि" सन जन्मबाधित प्रतिज्ञाक नैयायिक-निदर्शन, श्रुत्यनुगृहीत तर्कक (मनन) स्थान — "पण्डित बुद्धिमान व्यक्ति गान्धार देश पहुँचि जाइत अछि" श्रुतिसहित — आ धर्मजिज्ञासासँ ब्रह्मजिज्ञासाक प्रमाण-भेद (एतय अनुभव-पर्यवसायी ज्ञान) तथा वस्तुतन्त्र-पुरुषतन्त्रक प्रथम उपस्थापन ("वस्तु एहि प्रकार वा ओहि प्रकार नहि, अस्ति वा

नास्ति — एहन विकल्प नहि करैत"; अतिरात्रक षोडशी-ग्रहण आ सूर्योदयक पूर्वापर होमक विकल्प-दृष्टान्त) — ई सभ आगाँ चतुर्थ सूत्रक भूमिका रचैत अछि।

६. तृतीय सूत्र: "शास्त्रक स्रोत होयबाक कारण" (शास्त्रयोनित्वात्)

अनुवादमे एहि सूत्रक दुनू शास्त्रसम्मत व्याख्या क्रमशः आएल अछि। पहिलः सर्वज्ञकल्प शास्त्रक कारण होएबासँ ब्रह्मक सर्वज्ञता — "ऋग्वेद आदि सँ बनल, असङ्ख्य विद्यास्थानसँ परिपूरित, मशाल जकाँ सभ वस्तु केँ प्रकाशित करैत विशाल शास्त्र-समूह"क योनि ब्रह्म; पाणिनि-व्याकरणक दृष्टान्तसँ "रचयिता ओहि शास्त्रक विषयसँ बेसी व्यापक ज्ञान रखैत छथि" ई व्याप्ति; ईखक रस, दूध आ गुड़क मिठासक शब्दातीत भेदक उदाहरणसँ वक्तृज्ञानक आधिक्य; "जौक खीर नोनगर नहि अछि" सन कहबीसँ "अत्यल्प प्रयास"क अर्थ-द्योतन; आ "एहि महान् पुरुषक श्वासक समान" वेदोत्पत्तिक श्रुति। दश विद्यास्थानक (पुराण, न्याय, मीमांसा आदि) वेद-पूरकताक उल्लेख सेहो अछि। दोसर व्याख्या: शास्त्र ब्रह्मक योनि अर्थात् प्रमाण — "ब्रह्मक विशिष्ट, असाधारण स्वरूपक ज्ञान केवल शास्त्रसँ होइत अछि" — जाहिसँ जन्मादिसूत्रक अनुमान-सङ्केत-शङ्का निर्मूल होइत अछि। दुनू व्याख्याक तामाश्रय-सम्बन्ध ("अगिला सूत्र पहिल सूत्रक निश्चय करैत अछि") स्पष्ट कएल गेल अछि।

एहि प्रसङ्गमे वेद-नित्यता-विमर्श विशेष मूल्यवान अछि: वर्ण-नित्यतावादी मीमांसको केँ क्रमविशिष्ट शब्द-वाक्यक अनित्यता स्वीकार करए पड़त; अभिव्यक्तिक अनित्यता; आ नृत्य-शिक्षक-शिष्यक अपूर्व दृष्टान्त — शिष्य गुरुक अङ्गसञ्चालनक क्रमक अनुकरण करैत अछि, ठीक ओही सञ्चालन नहि; तहिना वेद-पाठक क्रमक अनुवर्तन। जैमिनीय (सृष्टि-प्रलय अस्वीकार कऽ अनादि अध्ययन-परम्परा) आ व्यासमतानुयायी (सर्वज्ञ परमात्मा पूर्वसृष्टिक अनुरूप क्रमसँ वेद-सर्जक)क समन्वय; "कोनो सृष्टिमे ब्रह्महत्या पुण्यक कारण नहि बनैत, नहि अश्वमेध पापक; जहिना अग्नि कखनो भिजबैत नहि, जल कखनो जरबैत नहि" — नियत-स्वभाववादक ई प्रतिपादन; आ "अपौरुषेय" पदक उभय-सम्मत अर्थ (कर्ताक पूर्ण स्वच्छन्दताक अभाव) — ई सम्पूर्ण वेद-प्रामाण्य-मीमांसा मैथिलीमे पहिल बेर एहि गहराइसँ उपलब्ध भेल अछि। अन्तमे शास्त्राधीन ब्रह्मविचारक स्वरूप — "सूत्रकार शास्त्रप्रमाणक अधीन रहि कऽ ब्रह्मविचार आरम्भ करैत छथि, नहि कि शास्त्रसँ निरपेक्ष तर्कद्वारा" — चतुर्थ सूत्रक भूमिका बान्हि दैत अछि।

७. चतुर्थ सूत्र: "परन्तु ओ, समन्वयक कारण" (तत्तु समन्वयात्)

७.१ पूर्वपक्ष: वेदक कार्यपरता

समन्वयाधिकरण ग्रन्थक सभसँ विशाल आ शास्त्रार्थ-सघन अंश अछि। पूर्वपक्ष मीमांसक सिद्धान्तपर ठाढ़ अछि — "शास्त्रक प्रयोजन कर्मक शिक्षा अछि"; विद्यमान वस्तुक वाक्य पुनर्वचन ("नदीक तटपर फल अछि") अथवा अन्यप्रमाण-परतन्त्र; वेदान्त या तँ विधि-शेष (कर्ता-देवताक बोधक), या ध्यानादि कर्मक विधायक, या "अमरत्व चाहनिहार लेल ब्रह्मोपासनाक विधान" (प्रतिपत्तिविधि-वाद); "विधिसँ वाक्यक एकता होयबाक कारण ओ विधिक स्तुति करैत अछि" जैमिनि-सूत्रक बल; अपूर्व-कल्पनासँ वेदक अपौरुषेयत्व-रक्षाक मीमांसक-यत्न आ तकर प्रतीकार (चैत्यवन्दनक बौद्ध-वाक्यमे अपूर्वापत्तिक अतिप्रसङ्ग); "तत्त्वमसि सुनलाक बादो संसारधर्म — सुख, दुःख, भय आदि —

पहिनेक जकाँ बनल रहैत अछि" ई अनुभव-मूलक आक्षेप; आ यूप-आहवनीय-न्यायसँ विद्यमान आत्माक विधि-अङ्गता — पूर्वपक्षक ई सम्पूर्ण दुर्ग अनुवादमे अपन पूरा शक्तिसँ ठाढ़ कएल गेल अछि, जे शास्त्रार्थ-धर्मक निर्वाह अछि: प्रतिपक्ष केँ दुर्बल कऽ जीतब वाचस्पतिक रीति नहि।

७.२ समन्वयसँ स्वतन्त्र प्रामाण्य

सिद्धान्त-पक्षक आधार-वाक्य — "समस्त वेदान्त-वाक्य एकहि तात्पर्यसँ ब्रह्ममे समन्वित होइत अछि" — क पुष्टिमे "सदेव सोम्य इदमग्र आसीत्", "एकमेवाद्वितीयम्", "आत्मा वा इदमेक एवाग्र आसीत्" आदि श्रुतिसमूह, उपक्रमोपसंहारक एकवाक्यता (उपांशुयाज-न्यायक स्मरणसहित), आ "प्रत्यक्ष रूपेँ कहल विषयक परित्याग आ अकहल विषयक कल्पना करबाक दोष" — ई तात्पर्य-मीमांसा सुगठित अछि। वेदक स्वतःप्रामाण्य-रक्षामे "परनिर्भरता वस्तु विद्यमान होयबाक कारण नहि, बल्कि वाक्य मनुष्यक रचना होयबाक कारण उत्पन्न होइत अछि" ई विवेक, आ इन्द्रियक स्थिर-कारणतासँ प्रत्यक्षक दृष्टान्त — प्रमाण-शास्त्रक ई सूक्ष्मता अनुवादमे यथावत् अछि।

७.३ मोक्षक नित्यता: चतुर्विध कार्यताक निरास

मोक्ष उत्पाद्य, विकार्य, संस्कार्य वा आप्य — चारू विकल्पक क्रमिक खण्डन एहि अधिकरणक मेरुदण्ड अछि: "दही जकाँ विकार आ घट जकाँ उत्पाद्य वस्तु कखनो नित्य नहि होइत"; आप्यताक खण्डनमे नाविक-नौकाक रमणीय दृष्टान्त (परिवर्तनशील तट-फेन-तरङ्ग छोड़ि "तरङ्गरहित, शान्त, स्वच्छ, स्थिर" मध्यभागमे पहुँचब) आ सर्वव्यापी ब्रह्मक नित्यप्राप्तता; संस्कार्यताक खण्डनमे गुणाधान (लाखक रससँ रंगल जवा फूल) आ दोषापनयन (ईटक चूर्णसँ घसल दर्पण) — दुनूक ब्रह्ममे असम्भवता, आत्माक क्रियाश्रयत्व-निषेध, अन्याश्रित कर्मक अनुपकारकता ("दर्पण घसलापर रत्न शुद्ध नहि होइत"), आ स्नान-आचमन-यज्ञोपवीतक शुद्धिक व्यावहारिक-जीवाश्रयता ("नायिकाक सुगन्ध सखीपर आरोपित" जकाँ) — द्वा सुपर्णा मन्त्रक भोक्ता-साक्षी-विभागसहित। "एहि चारि प्रकार बाहेक कोनो पाँचम मार्ग नहि, जकर द्वारा कर्म मोक्षमे प्रवेश कऽ सकय। अतएव ज्ञान बाहेक कर्मक छाया मोक्षमे प्रवेश नहि पबैत" — ई निष्कर्ष-वाक्य अनुवादक सर्वोत्तम पङ्क्तिसभमे अछि।

एही क्रममे कूटस्थनित्यता-परिणामिनित्यताक विवेक (सम्पूर्ण वा एकदेश-परिणामक विकल्प-दूषण), भेदाभेदवादक विस्तृत खण्डन — सुवर्ण-कङ्कण-कुण्डलक समानाधिकरण-विमर्श, "घट केँ एहिमे बदरी अछि नहि कहल जाइत, आ चैत्र-मैत्र एक आसनपर रहितहुँ चैत्र मैत्र अछि नहि कहल जाइत" ई प्रतिदृष्टान्त, दूरसँ सुवर्ण-ज्ञान भेलहुँ कुण्डलक अज्ञान, आ भेद-अभेदक परस्पराश्रय-दूषण — तथा "माटि मात्र सत्य अछि" (वाचारम्भण) श्रुतिसँ कूटस्थपक्षक निर्णय; मोक्षक साध्यन्तताक श्रुति-राशि ("जे ब्रह्म जानैत अछि, ओ ब्रह्म भऽ जाइत अछि", "हृदयक ग्रन्थि छिन्न होइत अछि", "हे जनक, अहाँ अभय प्राप्त कऽ लेलहुँ"); वामदेवक "हम मनु भेलहुँ, हम सूर्य भेलहुँ" आ "ठाढ़ रहिते ओ गाबैत अछि"क अव्यवधान-न्याय; तथा न्यायसूत्रक दुःख-जन्म-प्रवृत्ति-दोष-मिथ्याज्ञानक उत्तरोत्तर-नाश-क्रमक सादर किन्तु सीमित स्वीकार — ई सभ अंश तर्कक कोनो ग्रन्थि छोड़ने बिना मैथिलीमे आएल अछि।

७.४ ज्ञान वस्तुतन्त्र, विधिच्छाया आ सिद्धवस्तु-वाक्यक फलवत्ता

"ज्ञान, यद्यपि मानसिक वृत्ति अछि, तथापि वस्तुतन्त्र अछि" — ई भाष्यीय सिद्धान्त, "मन वास्तवमे अग्नि अछि, गौतम" सन आरोपमूलक उपासना (पुरुषतन्त्र) आ प्रसिद्ध अग्निक अग्निबुद्धि

(वस्तुतन्त्र)क भेदसँ, आ "उज्ज्वल प्रकाशमे घटक अनुभव" जकाँ उपनिषद्वाक्य-सामर्थ्यसँ स्वतःसिद्ध ब्रह्मात्मैक्य-ज्ञानसँ स्थापित अछि। "द्रष्टव्यः" आदि विधिच्छाया-वाक्यक प्रयोजन — "पाथरपर चलाओल छुराक धार जकाँ कुण्ठित" विधिक बीच ओ सभ बहिर्मुख पुरुष केँ "स्वाभाविक कर्मक विषयसभसँ विमुख" कऽ "अन्तर्मुख आत्माक प्रवाहमे" प्रवृत्त करैत अछि — ई व्याख्या, बृहदारण्यकक "ई सभ जे अछि, ओ आत्मे अछि" (२.४.६), "केकर द्वारा आ केकरा देखल जाएत?" (४.५.१५), "ई आत्मा ब्रह्म अछि" (२.५.१९), "जँ मनुष्य आत्माकेँ हम ओ छी एहि रूपमे जानि लैत..." (४.४.१२) आ गीता १५.२०क सन्दर्भ-सङ्केतसहित अनूदित अछि — मूल-स्थलक ई अङ्कन अध्येता-पाठकक हेतु अनुवादक मूल्यवान सेवा अछि।

सिद्धवस्तु-वाक्यक फलवत्ताक स्थापनामे भामतीक दुइ अविस्मरणीय स्थल अनुवादमे अपन पूर्ण आभा रखने अछि। पहिल, सुमेरु-वर्णनक अलङ्कृत गद्य — "ब्रह्मलोकसँ झहरैत मन्दाकिनीक जलधारासँ धोएल सुवर्णशिलासँ बनल... स्फटिकसदृश पक्षीक स्वर सँ मनोहर" — जे आनन्दजनक सिद्धार्थ-वाक्यक उदाहरण अछि। दोसर, आर्यभाषा नहि जाननिहार द्रविड़क प्रसिद्ध आख्यान: दूत "देवदत्त, अहाँक समृद्धि बढ़य; अहाँक पुत्र जन्मल अछि" कहैत अछि, आ द्रविड़ देवदत्तक "रोमाञ्च, आँखि आ मुखकेँ पूर्ण विकसित कमल जकाँ खिलल देखि" वाक्यार्थ-ज्ञानक अनुमान करैत अछि — शब्द-शक्तिक व्युत्पत्ति सिद्ध-वस्तुमे सेहो होइत अछि, ई भाषा-दर्शनक युगान्तकारी तर्क (जे परवर्ती वेदान्तमे शब्दबोध-विमर्शक आधार बनल) मैथिलीमे एतेक सजीव अछि जे कथा जकाँ पढ़ाइत अछि।

७.५ निषेध-मीमांसा आ गौण-मिथ्या-विवेक

"ब्राह्मणकेँ नहि मारबाक चाही"क विश्लेषण — नञ्-पदक अभाव-बोधकता, प्रजापतिव्रत ("उगैत सूर्यकेँ नहि देखू")क पर्युदास-व्यवस्था, "इन्धन समाप्त अग्नि जकाँ" स्वयं शान्त होमयवला अभावज्ञान, आ कवच-योद्धाक अपूर्व उपमा ("कवच हटिते, जँ बाणक आक्रमण नहि, योद्धाक जीवन तत्काल नष्ट नहि होइत") — निवृत्ति-औदासीन्यक ई सम्पूर्ण मीमांसा, बालकक वृद्धव्यवहारसँ शक्तिग्रह ("ज्वर भेलापर पथ्य भोजन करू", "साँपकेँ अपन आँठी नहि दिअ"क दृष्टान्तसहित) आ इष्टसाधनताज्ञान-इच्छा-प्रवृत्तिक कार्यकारणभाव-विश्लेषणक संग, अनुवादमे विरल स्पष्टतासँ आएल अछि।

अन्तिम प्रकरणमे गौण आ मिथ्या अहंबुद्धिक विवेक — अयालवला पशुमे "सिंह"क मुख्यार्थ, शूरवीर मनुष्यमे गौण, आ भेदाज्ञानीक भ्रम; साँझक धुँधलकाक खम्भा-पुरुष; "गड़ेरिया आ बकरी चरबनिहार जकाँ" विद्वानोक व्यवहार; पुत्रादिमे गौण ("वाहिक बैल अछि" जकाँ) आ देहादिमे मिथ्या आत्मबुद्धिक भेद — तथा जीवन्मुक्तिक स्थापन: धन त्यागि धनाभिमानसँ मुक्त व्यक्तिमे चोरीक भय नहि; "साँपक त्यक्त केंचुली बाँबीपर मृत आ फेकल पड़ल रहैत अछि, तहिना ई शरीर पड़ल रहैत अछि" श्रुति; स्थितप्रज्ञ-प्रकरणक स्मृति-साक्ष्य — ई सभ अंश अद्वैतक व्यावहारिक फलश्रुति केँ मूर्त करैत अछि। अनादि देह-सम्बन्धक "अन्हराक शृङ्खला" (अन्धपरम्परा)क उपमा, राजाक निकटतामात्रसँ कर्तृत्वक खण्डन, आ "हम ब्रह्म छी — एहि ज्ञानमे सभ विधि आ अन्य समस्त प्रमाण समाप्त भऽ जाइत अछि" ई चरम-सिद्धान्त, तथा प्रमातृत्व-भेदक व्यावहारिक प्रामाण्य ("आत्माक निर्णय होयब धरि") आ "विद्या आ अविद्या दुनूकेँ संग-संग जाननिहार..." ईश-श्रुतिसँ अविद्याद्वारा अविद्या-नाशक समर्थन — एहि सभसँ ग्रन्थ अपन तार्किक वृत्त पूर्ण करैत अछि। पृथक् शास्त्रारम्भक औचित्य ("जँ एकर तात्पर्य ध्यानविधि होइत, तखन अथातो धर्मजिज्ञासा सँ आरम्भ भेल शास्त्रमे

ओकर आरम्भ पहिनहिँसँ भऽ गेल होइत") प्रथम सूत्रसँ अन्विति साधि उपसंहार करैत अछि — रचना-शिल्पक दृष्टिँ ई वृत्त-पूर्ति (ring composition) ध्यातव्य अछि।

८. भामती-प्रस्थानक वैशिष्ट्य: एहि अंशमे यथोपलब्ध

चतुःसूत्री-अंशमे भामती-प्रस्थानक अनेक बीज-सिद्धान्त उपस्थित अछि, आ अनुवाद ओकरा उजागर होमय दैत अछि: (क) मङ्गलश्लोकक "दुइ प्रकारक अनिर्वचनीय अविद्या" आ आगाँ "द्विविध — आवरण आ संस्कार — नाश"क उल्लेख; (ख) "अविद्या ब्रह्ममे स्थित नहि, जीवमे स्थित कहल जाइत अछि" — अविद्याक जीवाश्रयत्वक भामती-मत, जे विवरण-प्रस्थानक ब्रह्माश्रयत्वसँ एकर भेदक आधार अछि; (ग) ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार केँ "मननजन्य साक्षात्कार — अन्तःकरणक ब्रह्माकार वृत्तिरूप अनुभूति" कहब आ निदिध्यासनक अन्वय-व्यतिरेकसिद्ध कारणता — शब्दसँ परोक्षज्ञान आ मनः-परिणतिसँ अपरोक्षक भामती-रीति; (घ) "अध्यास भेदक अनवगतिक अधीन अछि" — भेदाग्रह-मूलक अध्यास-प्रक्रियामे प्राभाकर-सामग्रीक द्वैत-सात्करण; (ङ) न्यायकणिका आ ब्रह्मतत्त्वसमीक्षाक आत्म-सन्दर्भसँ वाचस्पतिक "सर्वतन्त्रस्वतन्त्र" व्यक्तित्वक झलक। अनुवादक कोनो व्याख्यात्मक थोपल टिप्पणी बिना, पाठ-निष्ठ रहि, ई सभ सिद्धान्त पाठक धरि पहुँचबैत छथि — ई "अनुवादक अदृश्यता"क शास्त्रीय आदर्शक निर्वाह अछि।

९. अनुवाद-कला आ भाषा-वैभव

एहि अनुवादक सभसँ पैघ उपलब्धि ई अछि जे ई "शुद्ध मैथिली"क प्रतिज्ञा केँ पारिभाषिक शुद्धताक संग निभबैत अछि। तीन स्तरपर एकर रणनीति देखल जा सकैत अछि। पहिल, पारिभाषिक शब्दक व्यवहार: जतय संस्कृत पारिभाषिक शब्द (अध्यास, अनिर्वचनीय, समानाधिकरण, प्रत्यभिज्ञा, अन्योन्याश्रय, अर्थापत्ति, संयोग-पृथक्त्व, कूटस्थ, उपादान) अपरिहार्य अछि, ओतय ओ यथावत् राखल गेल अछि, मुदा प्रत्येकक प्रथम-प्रयोगपर मैथिली व्याख्या सङ्ग अछि। दोसर, वाक्य-रचनाक मैथिलीकरण: संस्कृतक दीर्घ समास-गुम्फित वाक्य केँ तोड़ि "बात ई अछि—", "मानि लिअ।", "कहल ई जा रहल अछि—", "एकर उत्तर... दैत छथि", "यही अभिप्राय अछि" सन सूत्रधार-पदसँ शास्त्रार्थक गति-यति स्पष्ट कएल गेल अछि; "ननु"क स्थानपर "मानि लिअ" ई निर्वाह एतेक सुसंगत अछि जे पाठक पूर्वपक्ष-सिद्धान्तक आवाजाही कतहु नहि बिसरैत अछि। तेसर, देशज मुहावराक विवेकपूर्ण प्रयोग: "अन्हर अन्हरक हाथ पकड़ि प्रत्येक डेगपर खसैत अछि", "जौक खीर नोनगर नहि अछि", "हजार शास्त्र मिलियो घट केँ पट नहि बना सकैत अछि", "हजार कारीगरो घटसँ वस्त्र नहि बना सकैत", "बाणक दाँतक परीक्षा जकाँ निरर्थक वस्तुमे जिज्ञासा" — ई सभ स्थल संस्कृत न्यायोक्ति केँ मैथिली लोकवाणीमे रूपान्तरित करैत अछि।

शब्द-चयनमे "इजोत" (आलोक), "अन्हार" (तमस्), "मुस्की" (स्मित), "बाछा" (वत्स), "आँठी" (अङ्गुरीय), "केंचुली" (निर्मोक), "बाँबी" (वल्मीक), "धुँधलका" (सन्ध्या-धूसरता), "गड़ेरिया", "भूँसी", "ओखली", "जुलाहा", "कुम्हार" — ई देशज पदावली दार्शनिक गद्य केँ जीवन-गन्ध दैत अछि, आ तैयो कतहु ग्राम्यताक अतिरेकसँ गम्भीरता खण्डित नहि होइत। लिङ्ग-वचन-सङ्गति, "छथि"क आदरार्थ प्रयोग (ब्रह्म, आत्मा, आचार्यक हेतु) आ "अछि"क सामान्य प्रयोगक विवेक, तथा नुक्ताक अनुशासित व्यवहार (इ/ढ़ मात्र) — सम्पूर्ण पाठमे वर्तनीक स्थैर्य

समीक्षकक दृष्टिमे उल्लेखनीय अछि, जे "AUDIT_CORRECTED" संस्करणक परिश्रमक साक्ष्य अछि।

अनुवाद-सिद्धान्तक दृष्टिँ ई कृति "अर्थानुगामी किन्तु वाक्-स्वतन्त्र" कोटिक अछि — मूलक तर्क-क्रम, दृष्टान्त-क्रम आ प्रमाण-क्रमसँ कतहु विचलन नहि, मुदा वाक्य-विन्यास पूर्णतः मैथिलीक अपन। स्रोत-सन्दर्भक अङ्कन (बृहदारण्यक, भगवद्गीताक स्थल-निर्देश) पाठकीय उपयोगिता बढ़बैत अछि। कठिनतम स्थल — यथा भावना-विमर्श ("धातु उत्पत्तिक अर्थ जनबैत अछि"), विधि-विभाग (फलविधि, विनियोगविधि, प्रयोगविधि, उत्पत्तिविधि), आ आग्नेय-याग-वाक्यक विधेयता-विश्लेषण — मे सेहो अनुवाद अर्थ-हानि बिना पठनीय रहैत अछि; ई मीमांसा-शास्त्रक मैथिली पारिभाषिकीक निर्माण-कार्य अछि, जकर दूरगामी महत्त्व अछि।

१०. भारतीय आ पाश्चात्य समीक्षा-दृष्टिसँ मूल्याङ्कन

भारतीय काव्यशास्त्रक कसौटीपर ई अनुवाद "प्रसाद-गुण"क आदर्श अछि — अर्थ-गाम्भीर्य रहितहुँ शब्द-प्रसन्नता; आ शास्त्रीय गद्यक "समता" (एकरूप रचना-शैली) एकर स्थायी धर्म अछि। वक्रोक्ति-दृष्टिँ वाचस्पतिक उपचार-वक्रता ("बेचारा ज्ञानक... सौभाग्य", "दुर्भाग्यपूर्ण पक्षपात") अनुवादमे सुरक्षित अछि, जे शास्त्रार्थ केँ रस-सिक्त करैत अछि — शान्त रसक आलम्बन निर्विशेष ब्रह्म आ ओकर व्यभिचारी भाव रूपमे तर्क-कौतुक। औचित्य-सिद्धान्तक दृष्टिँ श्लोकक गद्यानुवाद, पारिभाषिकक यथावत्-रक्षण आ लोकोक्तिक स्थान-विवेक — तीनू निर्णय औचित्यपूर्ण अछि।

पाश्चात्य अनुवाद-विमर्शक भाषामे कहल जाए तँ ई अनुवाद "स्रोतोन्मुखी" (मूल-निष्ठ) आ "लक्ष्योन्मुखी" (पाठक-निष्ठ) युक्तिक सन्तुलन अछि: तर्क-संरचनामे पूर्ण स्रोत-निष्ठा, अभिव्यक्तिमे पूर्ण लक्ष्यभाषा-निष्ठा। व्याख्याशास्त्र (हर्मन्यूटिक्स)क दृष्टिँ ई "टीकाक अनुवाद" अछि — अर्थात् व्याख्याक व्याख्या-योग्य पुनर्रचना — आ ई दोहरा दायित्व (शंकरक भाष्य-वाक्य + वाचस्पतिक टीका-वाक्यक स्तर-भेद) अनुवादमे भाष्यांश-उद्धरण आ टीका-गद्यक स्पष्ट विभाजनसँ निभाओल गेल अछि। दर्शन-इतिहासक दृष्टिँ एहि पाठमे उपलब्ध ख्याति-विमर्श, स्वप्रकाशता-विवाद, वस्तुतन्त्र-पुरुषतन्त्र-भेद आ सिद्धार्थ-वाक्यक शब्दबोध-क्षमताक तर्क — ई सभ आधुनिक ज्ञानमीमांसा (प्रत्यक्षवाद, अर्थ-सिद्धान्त, चेतना-दर्शन)क विद्यार्थीक हेतु तुलनात्मक अध्ययनक समृद्ध सामग्री अछि; मैथिली माध्यमसँ ई सम्वाद आब सम्भव भेल — यह एहि अनुवादक बौद्धिक-इतिहासगत देन अछि।

११. मैथिली वाङ्मय आ विदेह-सन्दर्भमे स्थान

वाचस्पति मिश्र मैथिल छलाह — ई गौरव-वाक्य मैथिलीमे बेर-बेर दोहराओल जाइत अछि, मुदा हुनक ग्रन्थ मैथिलीमे नहि छल। ई अनुवाद ओहि गौरव केँ पाठ्य-सम्पत्तिमे बदलैत अछि। विदेहक ग्रन्थ-शृङ्खलामे शास्त्रीय संस्कृत ग्रन्थक जे मैथिली-सेतु बनि रहल अछि, ताहिमे भामती-सन दर्शन-ग्रन्थक समावेश ई सिद्ध करैत अछि जे मैथिली केवल गीत-कथाक नहि, कठोरतम शास्त्र-विमर्शक सेहो सक्षम वाहिका अछि। मिथिलाक नैयायिक-मीमांसक परम्परा (जाहिमे स्वयं वाचस्पति, आ आगाँ गङ्गेश उपाध्यायक तत्त्वचिन्तामणि-धारा अबैत अछि)क संग एहि अनुवादक अन्तःसूत्र स्पष्ट अछि — भामतीक ख्याति-विमर्श आ प्रामाण्य-विमर्श परवर्ती नव्यन्यायक पूर्वपीठिका अछि; अतः मैथिलीमे भामतीक उपलब्धता मिथिलाक अपन बौद्धिक इतिहासक पुनरधिग्रहण अछि। विश्वविद्यालयीय स्तरपर

मैथिली-माध्यमे दर्शनशास्त्रक पाठ्यक्रम, शोध आ शास्त्रार्थ-प्रशिक्षण — तीनूक हेतु ई ग्रन्थ आधार-पाठ बनबाक योग्य अछि।

१२. किछु निरीक्षण आ सुझाव

समग्र शुद्धताक बीच किछु सूक्ष्म बिन्दु भावी संस्करणक हेतु द्रष्टव्य अछि। (१) "अपरोक्ष" रूप पाठमे सात ठाम आएल अछि जखन कि शुद्ध "अपरोक्ष" चारि ठाम — एहि द्वैधक एकरूपीकरण वाञ्छनीय। (२) प्रतिलिप्यधिकार-पङ्क्तिमे "प्रीति ठाकर" मुद्रित अछि; अभीष्ट "प्रीति ठाकुर" बुझना जाइत अछि। (३) रूपान्तरण-त्रयक गणनामे "धर्मलक्षणक अनुसार तीन प्रकारक कहल गेल अछि—" ई वाक्य जतय अछि ओतय गणना-सूची तुरन्त नहि आबि अगिला अनुच्छेदमे व्याख्या अबैत अछि; एकटा योजक-वाक्यसँ प्रवाह आर सहज भऽ सकैत अछि। (४) उपयोगिताक दृष्टिँ भावी संस्करणमे पारिभाषिक शब्दक मैथिली-संस्कृत कोश-परिशिष्ट, सूत्र-भाष्य-टीका स्तरक मुद्रण-भेद (यथा भिन्न टङ्कन-शैली), आ अधिकरण-अनुक्रमणिका जोड़ल जा सकैत अछि। ई सभ परिष्कार-सुझाव अछि, दोष-गणना नहि — पृष्ठ 1-491क एहि विशाल पाठमे स्खलनक ई अल्पता स्वयं "AUDIT" प्रक्रियाक सफलताक प्रमाण अछि।

१३. उपसंहार

गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक ई चतुःसूत्री-भामती-अनुवाद मैथिली गद्यक इतिहासमे एकटा मानक-स्थापक कृति अछि। ई एक संग तीन काज करैत अछि — वाचस्पतिक तर्क-सौध केँ अविकल मैथिलीमे उतारब, मीमांसा-न्याय-वेदान्तक पारिभाषिकीक मैथिली-प्रतिमान गढ़ब, आ मिथिलाक अपन दार्शनिक धरोहर केँ मिथिलाक अपन भाषामे घुसा आनब। अध्यासभाष्यक सूक्ष्मतरंग ख्याति-विमर्शसँ लऽ कऽ समन्वयाधिकरणक विराट शास्त्रार्थ धरि — कतहु तर्कक कड़ी टूटल नहि, कतहु भाषाक साँस फूलल नहि। "जहिना राजपथक पानि गङ्गाक धारमे पड़ि शुद्ध भऽ जाइत अछि" — वाचस्पतिक ई विनयोक्ति एहि अनुवादपर उनटा कऽ लागू होइत अछि: आचार्यक गङ्गा-धार आब मिथिलाक राजपथ धरि आबि गेल अछि, आ पथिक-मात्र ओहिमे अवगाहन कऽ सकैत छथि। मैथिली दर्शन-वाङ्मयक हेतु ई ग्रन्थ दीर्घकाल धरि सन्दर्भ-स्तम्भ रहत, आ शेष भामतीक (प्रथमाध्यायक अवशिष्ट अंशसँ चतुर्थाध्याय धरिक) मैथिली-आगमनक प्रतीक्षा एहि संस्करणक पाठक स्वाभाविके करताह।

१४. समग्र निर्णय

चतुःसूत्री-भामतीक एहि शुद्ध मैथिली रूपान्तरक महत्त्व केवल एतबे नहि जे एकटा संस्कृत दार्शनिक ग्रन्थ मैथिलीमे उपलब्ध भेल। एकर वास्तविक उपलब्धि ई अछि जे अध्यास, अविद्या, अनिर्वचनीयता, आत्माक स्वयंप्रकाशता, प्रमाणक व्यवहारिक आ पारमार्थिक सीमा, कर्म आ ज्ञानक सम्बन्ध, मोक्षक नित्यता, वेदान्त-वाक्यक स्वतन्त्र प्रामाण्य आ ब्रह्मात्मैक्यक अनुभव—एहि सभ अत्यन्त जटिल विषयक तर्क-क्रम मैथिलीमे बिना टूटने चलैत अछि। ग्रन्थक उदाहरण, पूर्वपक्ष, उत्तर, पुनःशङ्का, समाधान आ निष्कर्षक क्रम सुरक्षित रहबाक कारण पाठक केवल निष्कर्ष नहि, अपितु शास्त्रार्थक

सम्पूर्ण प्रक्रिया देखैत छथि। एहि दृष्टिसँ ई कृति मैथिली दार्शनिक गद्यक क्षमता, अनुशासन आ भविष्य
—तीनूक ठोस प्रमाण अछि।

परिशिष्ट: भामतीक शुद्ध मैथिली अनुवाद

भामती [शंकरक ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यपर वाचस्पतिक टीका]

मूल संस्कृत: वाचस्पति मिश्र • संस्कृतसँ मैथिली अनुवाद: गजेन्द्र ठाकुर

“अहाँ” आ “हम” ई दुइ अवधारणाक क्षेत्र—विषय आ विषयी—अपन-अपन स्वभावमे अन्हार आ इजोत जकाँ एक-दोसरक विपरीत अछि। जखन ई सिद्ध अछि जे एक दोसरक स्वरूप बुद्धिगम्य रूपें नहि भऽ सकैत अछि, तखन एकक धर्मसभ दोसरक अधिष्ठानमे एक भऽ जाएब ताहूसँ बेसी अबुद्धिगम्य अछि। एहि कारण “अहाँ” अवधारणाक क्षेत्र जे विषय अछि, ओकर आ ओकर धर्मसभक आरोप “हम” अवधारणाक क्षेत्र जे चैतन्य आत्मा रूप विषयी अछि, ताहि पर; आ एकर विपरीत, एहि विषयमे भ्रान्तिक कारण विषयी आ ओकर धर्मसभक आरोप विषय पर—वास्तवमे केवल मिथ्या अध्यासे भऽ सकैत अछि। तैयो, परस्पर पूर्णतः भिन्न धर्मसभ आ तद्वत् भिन्न अधिष्ठानसभमे एक-दोसरक भेद नहि बूझबाक कारण, एक-दोसरक स्वरूप आ धर्मक आरोप कऽ “हम ई छी” आ “ई हमर अछि” एहन स्वाभाविक व्यवहार होइत अछि; एहि व्यवहारमे सत्य आ असत्यक मेल होइत अछि आ एकर कारण मिथ्याज्ञान अछि।

ओहि अमर ब्रह्म केँ प्रणाम, जे अपरिमेय आनन्द आ ज्ञानस्वरूप छथि; जे प्रभुरूपमे दुइ प्रकारक अनिर्वचनीय अविद्या केँ मन्त्री बना कऽ आकाश, वायु, अग्नि, जल आ पृथ्वीक मिथ्या अभिव्यक्ति करैत छथि; आ जिनकासँ चल-अचल, उच्च-नीच ई समस्त जगत उत्पन्न भेल।

वेद हुनक श्वास छथि, पाँचो महाभूत हुनक दृष्टि छथि, चल-अचल जगत हुनक मुस्की अछि आ हुनक निद्रा महाप्रलय अछि।

नित्य वेद आ भव केँ प्रणाम; वेद छह अङ्ग सँ युक्त छथि आ भव अनेक अविनाशी गुण अथवा अव्यय सँ सम्पन्न छथि।

मार्तण्ड, तिलकस्वामिन् आ महागणपति केँ प्रणाम; ई सभ विश्वव्यापी आराधनाक योग्य आ समस्त मनोरथक फलदाता छथि।

ब्रह्मसूत्रक रचयिता, द्वितीय सृष्टिकर्ता आ भगवान् हरिक ज्ञानशक्तिक अवतार व्यास केँ प्रणाम।

निर्मल ज्ञानस्वरूप, कृपाक समुद्र शङ्कर केँ प्रणाम कऽ हम हुनका लिखल स्पष्ट, मुदा गम्भीर भाष्यक विश्लेषण आरम्भ करैत छी।

जहिना राजपथक पानि गङ्गाक धारमे पड़ि शुद्ध भऽ जाइत अछि, तहिना हमरा सन लोकक तुच्छ वचन आचार्यक रचनासँ जुड़ि पवित्र भऽ जाइत अछि।

अध्यास

एखन, जाहि वस्तुक विषयमे कोनो सन्देह नहि अछि अथवा जकर ज्ञानसँ कोनो प्रयोजन नहि सिद्ध होइत अछि, ओ विवेकी जिज्ञासुक जानबाक इच्छाक विषय नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, तेज इजोतमे उपस्थित, मनसहित नेत्रेन्द्रियक सम्पर्कमे आयल घट; अथवा कौआक दाँत। ब्रह्मक विषय सेहो एतबे अछि; कारण जिज्ञासाक व्याप्य धर्म—सन्देह आ प्रयोजन—जतय उपस्थित नहि अछि, ताहि अवस्थाक विरोधी ज्ञान एतय पहिने सँ उपलब्ध अछि। बात ई अछि—केवल आत्मे ब्रह्म कहल जाइत अछि, कारण ओ महान् अछि अथवा सब किछु कै बढबैत अछि।

ई आत्मा देह, इन्द्रिय, मन, बुद्धि, हुनक विषयसभ आ संक्षेपमे “ई” शब्दसँ निर्दिष्ट होमय योग्य समस्त वस्तुसँ भिन्न “हम” रूप निर्विवाद, अभ्रान्त आ अपरोक्ष अनुभव द्वारा ज्ञात अछि। कृमि-पतङ्गसँ लऽ कऽ देवता आ ऋषि धरि सभ जीवमे ई अनुभव विद्यमान अछि; तँ आत्मा जानबाक इच्छाक विषय नहि भऽ सकैत अछि।

वास्तवमे केओ “ई हम छी कि नहि?” एहन सन्देह नहि करैत अछि, ने “ई सर्वथा हम नहि छी” एहन भूल करैत अछि। ई कहबो उचित नहि जे “हम दुबर छी, मोट छी”, “हम जाइत छी” इत्यादि निर्णय देहक गुणसभक संग समानाधिकरण रूपमे प्रयुक्त होइत देखल जाइत अछि, तँ “हम” शब्दक अधिष्ठान देह अछि। जँ देहे एकर अधिष्ठान रहितय, तँ “हम, जे बाल्यकालमे अपन माता-पिताक संग आनन्द पबैत छलहुँ, एखन वृद्धावस्थामे अपन नाती-पोताक संग आनन्द पबैत छी”—ई प्रत्यभिज्ञा उत्पन्न नहि होइतय।

यौवनक देह आ वृद्धावस्थाक देहक बीच वास्तवमे प्रत्यभिज्ञाक किंचितो चिह्न नहि अछि, जाहिसँ दुनूक एकत्व निश्चित कएल जा सकय। अतः जे परिवर्तनशील वस्तुसभमे निरन्तर एकरूप रहैत अछि, ओ ताहिसँ भिन्न अछि—जहिना फूलसभसँ ओकरा गूँथनिहार सूत भिन्न होइत अछि। तहिना “हम” शब्दसँ निर्दिष्ट आ बाल्य, यौवन आदि देहक परिवर्तनसभमे निरन्तर रहनिहार तत्त्व ओहि देहसभसँ भिन्न अछि।

एहि अतिरिक्त, जे व्यक्ति स्वप्नमे दिव्य देह धारण कऽ तदनुकूल सुख भोगैत अछि, ओ जागलापर अपनाकँ मानवी देहसँ युक्त देखि “हम देव नहि, मनुष्य छी” कहैत अछि। एतय दिव्य देह बाधित भऽ जाइत अछि, मुदा देहसँ भिन्न “हमपन”क अधिष्ठान अबाधित रूपमे अनुभूत होइत अछि। फेर, योगबलसँ बाध बनि जाएबाला व्यक्ति देहक भिन्नताक बादो आत्माक अभिन्नता अनुभव करैत अछि; तँ देह “हमपन”क अधिष्ठान नहि अछि।

इन्द्रियसभो एकर अधिष्ठान नहि छथि; कारण इन्द्रिय भिन्न होइतहुँ “जे हम स्वयं देखलहुँ, से एखन छुबैत छी” एहि वाक्यमे “हमपन”क अधिष्ठानक प्रत्यभिज्ञा होइत अछि। आत्मा विषयसभसँ भिन्न अछि—ई अत्यन्त प्रत्यक्ष अछि। बुद्धि आ मन केवल साधन छथि; अतः कर्ताक बोध करौनिहार “हम” ज्ञानक अधिष्ठान ई साधनसभ यथार्थतः नहि भऽ सकैत छथि।

देह आ आत्मामे अभेद नहि होइतहुँ “हम दुबर छी”, “हम अन्हर छी” इत्यादि वाक्य कहल जाइत अछि। हमरा मतमे एकर अर्थ गौण रूपेँ बुझबाक चाही, जहिना “दीर्घा चिचिया रहल अछि” वाक्यक अर्थ होइत अछि—दीर्घामे बैसल लोक चिचिया रहल छथि। अतः ई सिद्ध भेल जे देह, इन्द्रिय, मन, बुद्धि, विषयसभ आ संक्षेपमे “ई” शब्दसँ निर्दिष्ट होमय योग्य समस्त वस्तुसँ भिन्न आत्मा, “हम”क

अत्यन्त स्पष्ट अनुभवसँ ज्ञात होइत अछि; आ सन्देहक अभावक कारण ओ जानबाक इच्छाक विषय नहि अछि।

जिज्ञासासँ कोनो प्रयोजन नहि होएबाक कारणो आत्मा जिज्ञासाक विषय नहि अछि। बात ई अछि—संसारगमनक निवृत्तिरूप मोक्ष एतय प्रतिपादित करबाक अभिप्रेत फल अछि। आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूपक अनुभव नहि होएब संसारगमनक कारण अछि, आ आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूपक ज्ञान द्वारा एकर निवृत्ति होएबाक अछि।

जँ अनादि संसारगमन आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूपक अनादि ज्ञानक संगहि बनल रहैत अछि, तँ दुनूमे विरोध नहि रहबाक कारण पहिलुकक निवृत्ति केना होएत? आ आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूपक अननुभव केना सम्भव अछि? “हम”क अनुभव छोड़ि आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूपक आन कोनो ज्ञान नहि अछि। देह, इन्द्रिय आदि सँ भिन्न ई आत्मा सभ मनुष्यमे समान रूपेँ विद्यमान अत्यन्त स्पष्ट “हम” अनुभव द्वारा सिद्ध अछि; अनुभवक विरोधी होएबाक कारण हजार उपनिषद सेहो एकरा निषिद्ध नहि कऽ सकैत अछि। हजार शास्त्र मिलियो घट केँ पट नहि बना सकैत अछि। अतः अनुभवक विरोधक कारण हमरा मतमे उपनिषदक वचन गौण अर्थवाला मानल जाए।

एहि विचारसभकेँ मनमे राखि शङ्का उठाओल गेल अछि, आ भाष्यकार ओकर उत्तर दैत छथि—“दुइ अवधारणाक क्षेत्र...” इत्यादि।

“दुइ अवधारणाक क्षेत्र...” सँ “केवल मिथ्या अध्यासे भऽ सकैत अछि” धरि शङ्काक कथन अछि। “तैयो” सँ उत्तर आरम्भ होइत अछि। उत्तरक “तैयो”क अपेक्षामे शङ्कावाक्यमे “यद्यपि” शब्द जोड़ि बुझबाक चाही। जतय “ई” आ “हम” ई दुइ अवधारणाक क्षेत्र कहबाक छल, ओतय “ई”क स्थानमे “अहाँ” शब्दक प्रयोग अनुभवक एहि दुनू पक्षक पूर्ण भिन्नता देखेबाक लेल कएल गेल अछि।

“हम” शब्दक प्रतियोजी “ई” शब्दसँ बेसी “अहाँ” शब्द अछि; कारण “हम ई छी”, “हम ओ छी” एहन प्रयोग व्यापक रूपेँ देखल जाइत अछि।

चैतन्यस्वरूप आत्मा विषयी अछि; जड़ बुद्धि, इन्द्रिय, देह आ बाह्य वस्तुसभ ज्ञानक विषय छथि। कारण ई सभ चैतन्य आत्मा केँ बाँधैत छथि, अर्थात् अपन-अपन रूप द्वारा ओकरा निश्चित आ सीमित रूपमे प्रस्तुत करैत छथि। परस्पर अध्यासक असम्भवताक आधार जे पूर्ण भिन्नता अछि, ओकर उदाहरण “अन्हार आ इजोत जकाँ” देल गेल अछि। इजोत आ अन्हार सन सर्वथा भिन्न वस्तु एक-दोसरक स्वरूप अछि—एना केओ कहियो नहि बुझि सकैत अछि। एकरे ई वाक्य कहैत अछि—“जखन ई सिद्ध अछि जे एक दोसरक स्वरूप बुद्धिगम्य रूपेँ नहि भऽ सकैत अछि।” एकक दोसर होएबाक अर्थ अछि—एकमे दोसरक स्वरूप होएब, अर्थात् दुनूक तादात्म्य; ई बुद्धिगम्य नहि अछि।

ठीक अछि। भिन्न अधिष्ठान—अर्थात् आत्मा आ अनात्मा—परस्पर अभिन्न नहि होथि; तैयो हुनक धर्मसभ, जेना जड़ता आ चैतन्यता, नित्यता आ अनित्यता इत्यादिक परस्पर अध्यास भऽ सकैत अछि। अधिष्ठानसभ भिन्न बुझल गेलोपर हुनक धर्मक आरोप देखल जाइत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, स्फटिक फूलसँ भिन्न बुझल जाइत अछि; तैयो ओकर पूर्ण पारदर्शिताक कारण जपाकुसुमक प्रतिबिम्ब पड़लासँ “लाल स्फटिक”क अनुभवमे लालिमाक भ्रान्ति उत्पन्न होइत अछि।

एहि पर कहल गेल—“तखन एकर गुणो...”। एक अधिष्ठानक धर्म दोसर अधिष्ठानमे उपस्थित होएब, अर्थात् धर्मसभक परस्पर स्थानान्तरण, बुद्धिगम्य नहि अछि। अभिप्राय ई अछि—रङ्गयुक्त पदार्थ अपन पूर्ण पारदर्शिताक कारण आन रङ्गयुक्त पदार्थक प्रतिबिम्ब ग्रहण करैत अछि, यद्यपि ओ दोसर पदार्थ अपनासँ भिन्न बुझल जाइत हो।

मुदा चैतन्य आत्मा रङ्गरहित विषयी अछि; ओ विषयक प्रतिबिम्ब ग्रहण नहि कऽ सकैत अछि। भट्टमतावलम्बी सेहो कहैत छथि—“शब्द, गन्ध, रस आदिक प्रतिबिम्ब कोन प्रकारेँ सम्भव होएत?”

अतः शेष विकल्पसभ हटाओलापर ई निष्कर्ष निकलैत अछि जे विषय आ विषयीसँ नित्य सम्बद्ध धर्मसभक परस्पर स्थानान्तरण केवल एहि दुनू अधिष्ठानक पारस्परिक सम्बन्धक आधार पर सम्भव भऽ सकैत अछि। जँ ई दुनू अधिष्ठान पूर्णतः भिन्न रूपमे ज्ञात होइत आ परस्पर असम्बद्ध रहैत, तँ हुनक धर्मसभ आर स्पष्ट रूपेँ असम्बद्ध रहितय; कारण अपन-अपन अधिष्ठान बीचमे रहबाक कारण ओ धर्मसभ एक-दोसरसँ आर दूर छथि। एकरे “ताहूसँ बेसी...” इत्यादि शब्द कहल अछि।

“एहि विषयमे भ्रान्तिक कारण”क अर्थ अछि—विषयक सम्बन्धमे भेल भ्रान्तिक कारण। “मिथ्या” शब्द आवरणक बोध करबैत अछि। कहल ई जा रहल अछि—अध्यास भेदक अनवगतिक अधीन अछि; एकर विपरीत भेदक अवगति एतय उपस्थित अछि। ई अवगति भेदक अनवगति केँ हटबैत अछि, आ ओकर अधीन अध्यासो केँ हटबैत अछि। वाक्यक अन्वय ई अछि—“यद्यपि ई यथार्थतः केवल मिथ्या अध्यासे भऽ सकैत अछि, तैयो...”।

एहि कथनक अन्तर्निहित अभिप्राय ई अछि—(क) ई सभ तखनहि ठीक होइत, जँ “हम” अनुभवमे आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूप प्रकट होइत। मुदा एना नहि अछि। बात ई अछि—श्रुति, स्मृति, इतिहास आ पुराणमे आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूप समस्त सीमाकारी उपाधिसँ रहित, अनन्त आनन्द आ चैतन्यक एकरस सत्ता, उदासीन, एक आ अद्वितीय कहल गेल अछि। आत्मा केँ एहि स्वरूपमे प्रतिपादित करब जाहि वचनसभक तात्पर्य अछि, हुनका उपक्रम, मध्य आ उपसंहारक वचन तथा तात्पर्ययुक्त पुनरुक्तिक कारण इन्द्र सेहो गौणार्थक नहि बना सकैत छथि। कारण पुनरुक्तिसँ विषयक महत्ता सिद्ध होइत अछि—जहिना “अहो, सुन्दर! अहो, सुन्दर!”—विषयक क्षुद्रता नहि; आ गौणता तँ एहि सँ सेहो बहुत दूर अछि।

“हम”क अनुभव आत्मा केँ सीमित आ अनेक प्रकारक दुःख-शोकसँ मिश्रित देखबैत अछि; तखन ई अनुभव आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूपक विषय केना भऽ सकैत अछि? अथवा ई अभ्रान्त अनुभव केना भऽ सकैत अछि? ईहो नहि कहल जा सकैत अछि जे श्रुति प्रत्यक्षक विरोधी अछि, आ प्रत्यक्ष पुरान तथा ज्येष्ठ प्रमाण अछि, तँ प्रत्यक्ष पर निर्भर श्रुति केँ अवैध अथवा गौण मानल जाए। कारण श्रुति अपौरुषेय अछि, दोषक सम्भावनासँ सेहो सर्वथा मुक्त अछि, आ ज्ञान उत्पन्न करबाक तथ्ये ओकर प्रामाण्य केँ स्वयं प्रकाशित करैत अछि; तँ अपन फल, अर्थात् यथार्थ ज्ञानक विषयमे श्रुति आन प्रमाणसँ स्वतन्त्र अछि।

जँ कहल जाए जे उत्पन्न कएल ज्ञानक विषयमे श्रुति स्वतन्त्र होइतहुँ अपन उत्पत्तिक विषयमे प्रत्यक्ष पर निर्भर अछि, आ प्रत्यक्षक विरोध रहबाक कारण श्रुतिज्ञान उत्पन्न नहि होएत, फलतः श्रुतिक अप्रामाण्य सिद्ध होएत—तँ उत्तर अछि, नहि; कारण ओकर उत्पत्तिक संग कोनो विरोध नहि अछि।

श्रुतिजन्य ज्ञान प्रत्यक्षक व्यवहारिक प्रामाण्य केँ नष्ट नहि करैत अछि; नहि तँ अपन कारणक अभावसँ ओ स्वयं उत्पन्ने नहि होइत। ओ प्रत्यक्षक केवल पारमार्थिक प्रामाण्यक निषेध करैत अछि। श्रुतिज्ञानक कारणो पारमार्थिक रूपेँ सत्य प्रत्यक्ष नहि अछि; कारण व्यवहारिक रूपेँ प्रमाण होइतहुँ पारमार्थिक रूपेँ प्रमाण नहि रहल साधनसभसँ यथार्थ ज्ञान उत्पन्न होइत देखल जाइत अछि।

उदाहरणार्थ, ह्रस्वता आ दीर्घताक गुण अक्षरक नहि, ध्वनिक होइतहुँ अक्षर पर आरोपित होइत अछि आ यथार्थ अर्थबोधक कारण बनैत अछि। लोकमे “नग” आ “नाग” शब्दसँ क्रमशः वृक्ष आ हाथी सन भिन्न वस्तु बुझनिहार लोक वास्तवमे भ्रान्त नहि कहल जाइत छथि।

जाहि शब्दक कोनो दोसर तात्पर्य नहि अछि, ओकर अपनहि अर्थक विषयमे गौण प्रयोग मानब उचित नहि। कहल गेल अछि—“विधिवाक्यमे शब्दक अर्थ ओकर मुख्य अर्थसँ भिन्न नहि भऽ सकैत अछि।” जे ज्ञान आन पर निर्भर नहि अछि, ओकर पूर्वता ओकर बाधित होएबाक आधार भऽ सकैत अछि; आन प्रमाण केँ बाधित करबाक आधार नहि। कारण देखल जाइत अछि जे शुक्तिक विषयमे पहिने उत्पन्न रजतज्ञान पछिला शुक्तिज्ञान द्वारा बाधित होइत अछि। जँ पहिलुक ज्ञान बाधित नहि होइत, तँ पछिला ज्ञान—जकर सार पहिलुकक बाध अछि—ओकर उत्पत्ति बुद्धिगम्य नहि होइत। आ ई देखाओल जा चुकल अछि जे प्रत्यक्षक पारमार्थिक प्रामाण्य स्वतन्त्र रूपेँ सिद्ध नहि अछि।

महर्षि जैमिनिक सूत्र सेहो एतबे कहैत अछि—“जतय पूर्व आ उत्तरक सम्बन्ध हो, ओतय पूर्व पक्ष दुर्बल होइत अछि, जहिना प्रकृति-कर्मक प्रसङ्गमे।” एहि अर्थक एक पद्यो अछि—“जतय दुनू ज्ञान परस्पर निर्भर नहि रहि क्रमशः उत्पन्न होइत अछि, ओतय पछिलुक ज्ञानक श्रेष्ठता पहिलुक पर ज्ञात होइत अछि।”

एहि अतिरिक्त, जे लोक आत्मा केँ “हमपन”क अधिष्ठान मानैत छथि, हुनको मतमे “हम” ज्ञानक सत्यता स्वीकार नहि कएल जा सकैत अछि। कारण “हम एही निवासमे छी आ ज्ञान करैत छी” एहि निर्णयमे सर्वव्यापी आत्मा सीमित रूपमे ज्ञात होइत अछि—जहिना समतल भूमिपर ठाढ़ व्यक्तिक दृष्टिमे ऊँच पर्वतक शिखरक विशाल वृक्षसभ घासक पत्ती सन देखाइत अछि।

ईहो नहि कहल जा सकैत अछि जे अनुभूत सीमितता देहक अछि, आत्माक नहि। जँ एना होइत, तँ अनुभव “हम छी” इत्यादि रूपमे नहि होइत; आ जँ “हम” शब्द देहक गौण अर्थमे प्रयुक्त मानल जाए, तँ अनुभव “ज्ञान करैत छी” रूपमे सेहो नहि होइत।

जखन वक्ता आ अर्थबोध करनिहार श्रोता दुनू ई मानि लैत छथि जे कोनो शब्द आन वस्तुक द्योतक अछि, तखने ओकर प्रयोग गौण होइत अछि; ई प्रयोग भेदज्ञानक पछाति उत्पन्न होइत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, “अग्निहोत्र” शब्द सामान्यतः ओहि नामक नित्य कर्मक द्योतक अछि। मुदा कुण्डपायिनाम् अयनसँ सम्बन्धित भिन्न प्रकृतिक कर्मक प्रसङ्गमे “ओ मास-अग्निहोत्र आहुति दैत अछि” वाक्यमे “अग्निहोत्र” शब्दक प्रयोग दुनू कर्मक साध्य-साम्यक आधार पर गौण अछि। तहिना अनुभवसँ सिहसँ भिन्न ज्ञात शिष्यक विषयमे “सिंह” शब्दक प्रयोग गौण होइत अछि।

मुदा एतय “हम” शब्दक मुख्य अर्थ देह आदि सँ निश्चित आ स्पष्ट रूपेँ भिन्न अनुभव नहि कएल जाइत अछि; केवल एहन अनुभव भेलापर “हम” शब्द देह आदिक गौण अर्थमे प्रयुक्त भऽ सकितय। ईहो नहि मानल जा सकैत अछि जे दीर्घकालीन प्रयोगक कारण कोनो शब्द गौण अर्थमे रूढ़ भऽ गेलापर ओकर गौणता ज्ञात नहि होइत अछि—जहिना “तैल”, जकर शाब्दिक अर्थ तिलक तेल अछि, सरिसोक तेलक लेल प्रयुक्त होइत अछि। कारण एतयो तिल आदिसँ निकलनाइ, चिकनाहट आदि विषयमे भेद पहिने सिद्ध भेलापरहि सरिसोक तेल आदिकेँ मुख्य रूपेँ “तैल” मानबाक अभिमान उत्पन्न होइत अछि आ तकरा “तैल” शब्दसँ निर्दिष्ट कएल जाइत अछि। मुदा तैल आ सरिसोक तेलक अभेद निश्चित नहि होइत अछि। अतः ई निष्कर्ष निकलैत अछि जे जे लोक मुख्य आ गौण दुनू अर्थ जनैत छथि, हुनकर गौण प्रयोग भेदज्ञानसँ व्याप्त रहैत अछि। एतय व्यापक अर्थात् भेदज्ञानक निवृत्ति भेलापर ओकरा सँ व्याप्त गौण प्रयोगो निवृत्त भऽ जाइत अछि।

ईहो नहि कहल जा सकैत अछि जे यौवन आ वृद्धावस्थाक देह भिन्न होइतहुँ “हम ओही छी” एहि निर्णयमे एकहि आत्माक प्रत्यभिज्ञा होइत अछि, अतः देह आदिसँ भिन्न आत्माक अनुभव सिद्ध अछि। वस्तुतः एहन निर्णय तत्त्वविचार करनिहार आलोचकक अछि, साधारण लोकक नहि। व्यवहारिक जीवनमे आलोचक लोकनि सेहो सामान्य लोकक सीमासँ ऊपर नहि उठैत छथि। आदरणीय भाष्यकार आगाँ “पशु आदि सँ कोनो भेद नहि...” एहि शब्दमे एही बात कहैत छथि। बाहरी मतावलम्बी सेहो कहैत छथि—“जे शास्त्रीय उपदेशपर विचार करैत छथि, सेहने ई भेद करैत छथि; मात्र पाठ ग्रहण करनिहार नहि।” अतः अन्य विकल्प हटाओलापर ई मानब उचित अछि जे “हम एही निवासमे छी” इत्यादि कहनिहार साधारण व्यक्ति आत्मा केँ सीमिते बुझैत अछि, जहिना आकाश केँ घट, झारी, पात्र आदि सँ सीमित बुझल जाइत अछि।

“हम” शब्दक प्रयोगक प्रामाण्य बचएबाक लेल ई कहब उचित नहि जे देह आदिक समान आत्मो सीमित अछि। तखन ओकर आकार अणुक समान होएबाक चाही अथवा देहक समान। जँ अणु-जकाँ होएत तँ “हम मोट छी” वा “हम नमहर छी” एहन व्यवहार नहि होएत; जँ देहक आकारक होएत तँ देहक समान अवयवसमुदाय होएबाक कारण ओ अनित्य सिद्ध होएत।

एहि मतमे ईहो मानए पड़त जे या तँ अवयवक समष्टि ज्ञान करैत अछि, अथवा प्रत्येक अवयव स्वयं ज्ञान करैत अछि। जँ प्रत्येक अवयव स्वयं ज्ञान करैत हो, तँ अनेक स्वतन्त्र चेतनासभक बीच सहमति नहि रहबाक कारण विपरीत दिशामे एकसाथ क्रिया होएत आ देह व्याकुल भऽ जाएत, अथवा कोनो क्रिया नहि होएत। जँ चेतना अवयव-समष्टिसँ सम्बद्ध मानल जाए, तँ एक अवयव घायल भेलापर चेतन आत्मा अपनाकेँ आंशिक रूपेँ घायल नहि बुझत। अनेक अवयवक बीच सह-अस्तित्वक कोनो स्थिर सम्बन्धो नहि देखाइत अछि। कोनो एक अवयव नष्ट भेलापर समष्टि ओकर अभावमे ज्ञान नहि कऽ सकैत अछि।

जँ विज्ञान केँ “हम” अवधारणाक अधिष्ठान मानल जाए, तैयो ओकर मिथ्यात्व ओहिना बनल रहैत अछि; कारण “हम” अवधारणा स्थायी द्रव्यक बोध करबैत अछि, मुदा विज्ञानसभ क्षणभङ्गुर अछि। एहि प्रकार “हम मोट छी, हम अन्हर छी, हम जाइत छी” इत्यादि कथन अध्याससँ उत्पन्न बुझाएत।

एहि प्रकार “हम” अवधारणाक आधार सड़ल भूमि जकाँ निराधार सिद्ध भऽ गेलापर पूज्य श्रुति निर्बाध रूपेँ आत्मासँ “हम” अनुभवक फलस्वरूप उत्पन्न कर्तृत्व, भोक्तृत्व, सुख, दुःख, शोक आदि धारणासभ हटेबाक कार्य कऽ सकैत अछि। एहि कारण “एक-दोसर पर आरोप कऽ” इत्यादि वचनमे “हम” अवधारणाक स्वरूप, कारण आ परिणामक विस्तार कएल गेल अछि; एकर मिथ्यात्व समस्त विश्वसनीय श्रुति, स्मृति, इतिहास आ पुराणसँ प्रसिद्ध अछि। देह आ आत्मा—ई दुइ अधिष्ठानमे सँ एकक स्वरूप दोसर पर आरोपित कएल जाइत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, “हम ई देह छी” इत्यादिमे “ई”क संग तादात्म्य व्यवहारगत घटना अछि, ज्ञानरूप निर्णय नहि। “लौकिक व्यवहार”क अर्थ अछि संसारक व्यवहार; अर्थात् “हम ई छी” एहन अभिधान। “हम ई छी” एहि कथनक “इति” शब्दसँ वैध ज्ञान द्वारा देहक लेल हितकर वा अहितकर बुझल वस्तुक स्वीकार, परित्याग आदि सूचित होइत अछि।

एक अधिष्ठानक धर्मो दोसर अधिष्ठान पर आरोपित होइत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, जाहि आत्मापर देह आदिक आरोप भेल अछि, ताहिपर जन्म, मृत्यु, वृद्धावस्था, रोग आदि देहधर्म आरोपित होइत अछि; आ जाहि देह आदिपर आत्मत्वक आरोप भेल अछि, ताहिपर चैतन्य आदि आत्मधर्म आरोपित होइत अछि। एकरे फलस्वरूप “ई वृद्धावस्था, मृत्यु, पुत्र, गाए, स्वामित्व आदि हमर अछि” एहन लौकिक

व्यवहार अथवा वचनप्रयोग होइत अछि। “ई हमर अछि” एहि कथनक “इति” शब्दसँ उपर्युक्त अनुभवक अनुकूल क्रिया आदि सूचित होइत अछि।

“आरोप कऽ लौकिक व्यवहार होइत अछि” ई कथन युक्तिसङ्गत अछि, कारण अध्यास आ लौकिक व्यवहार—दुनू क्रियाक कर्ता एके व्यक्ति मानल जाइत अछि। लौकिक व्यवहारसँ पहिने अध्यासक कालगत पूर्वता देखाओल गेलासँ ई स्पष्ट होइत अछि जे अध्यास लौकिक व्यवहारक कारण अछि। “मिथ्याज्ञानरूप कारणसहित लौकिक व्यवहार” इत्यादि वचनक अभिप्राय एतबे अछि। “मिथ्याज्ञान” अध्यास अछि; ओकरा कारण बना कऽ लौकिक व्यवहारक अस्तित्व वा अनस्तित्व अध्यासक अस्तित्व वा अनस्तित्वक अनुसरण करैत अछि।

एहि प्रकार अध्यासक स्वरूप आ ओकर फल अर्थात् लौकिक व्यवहार बताओलापर भाष्यकार “एक-दोसरक भेद नहि बूझबाक कारण” एहि शब्दसँ ओकर कारण कहैत छथि; अर्थात् दुनूक पृथकता नहि बुझल जाएब। एतय प्रश्न उठैत अछि—जँ दुनूमे सर्वथा भेदे नहि हो, तँ भेद नहि बुझल जाएब स्वाभाविक अछि; मुदा तखन अध्यास केना होएत? एकर उत्तर “पूर्णतः भिन्न धर्म आ अधिष्ठान” एहि शब्दसँ देल गेल अछि। पारमार्थिक दृष्टिसँ भिन्नताक अर्थ अछि—अधिष्ठानक अनैक्य आ धर्मसभक असङ्करता।

मानि लिअ। दुइ वास्तविक वस्तुक भेद नहि बुझल जाएब सँ उत्पन्न तादात्म्यभ्रम बुद्धिगम्य अछि—जहिना शुक्ति आ रजत दुनूक भेद नहि बुझलापर शुक्तिमे रजतक भ्रम। मुदा एतय परमसत्य चैतन्य आत्माक अतिरिक्त देह-जकाँ कोनो वास्तविक वस्तु अछि नहि। तखन चैतन्य आत्मासँ ओकर भेद नहि बुझल जाएब कतयसँ आएल, आ तादात्म्यभ्रम कतयसँ? उत्तर अछि—“सत्य केँ असत्यक संग जोड़बाक कारण।” वाक्यक रचना ई अछि—भेद नहि बूझबाक कारण, अर्थात् सत्य आ असत्य केँ जोड़ि, एक-दोसर पर आरोप कएल जाइत अछि। सत्य चैतन्य आत्मा अछि; असत्य बुद्धि, इन्द्रिय, देह आदि छथि। एहि दुइ अधिष्ठान केँ जोड़बहि “मेलनाइ” अछि। प्रपञ्चक पारमार्थिक सत्यक संग वास्तविक संयोग सम्भव नहि; एहि कारण मूल शब्दमे “मिथुनम्” क बदला “मिथुनी” रूपक “च्वि” प्रत्यय प्रयुक्त भेल अछि, जे “जे वस्तु ओ नहि अछि, मानो ओही बनि जाए” ई अर्थ दैत अछि। कहल ई जा रहल अछि—जे वस्तु प्रकटे नहि हो, ओकर आरोप असम्भव अछि; अतः आरोपित वस्तुक ज्ञान आवश्यक अछि, ओकर वास्तविक अस्तित्व नहि।

मानि लिअ। जखन आरोपित वस्तुक ज्ञान होइत अछि, तखन पूर्वमे देखल वस्तुक आरोप होइत अछि; मुदा स्वयं ओ ज्ञान अध्याससँ सशर्त अछि। एना परस्पराश्रय दोष टारब कठिन बुझाइत अछि। एकर उत्तर “स्वाभाविक” शब्द अछि। ई लौकिक व्यवहार स्वाभाविक आ अनादि अछि। व्यवहारक अनादित्व द्वारा ओकर कारण—अध्यास—क अनादित्व कहल गेल अछि। तँ बुद्धि, इन्द्रिय, देह आदि प्रत्येक पूर्ववर्ती मिथ्याज्ञानमे प्रकट होइत रहैत अछि, आ प्रत्येक पछिला अवसरपर फेर अध्यास होइत अछि। बीज आ अङ्कुरक परम्परा जकाँ ई प्रक्रिया अनादि होएबाक कारण एतय परस्पराश्रय दोष नहि अछि।

ठीक अछि। आरोपमे केवल पूर्वप्रतीति आवश्यक अछि, प्रकट वस्तुक पारमार्थिक सत्यता नहि। मुदा देह, इन्द्रिय आदि पूर्णतः असत्य आ आकाशक कमल-सरोवर जकाँ होथि तँ हुनकर प्रतीतियो बुद्धिगम्य नहि। चैतन्य आत्माक यथार्थतासुद्धाँ ओकर प्रकाशमानता मात्रे अछि, वर्ग-सत्ताक समवाय अथवा अर्थक्रियाकारिता जकाँ ताहिसँ भिन्न कोनो तत्त्व नहि; कारण एहन तत्त्व मानलापर द्वैत उत्पन्न होएत। फेर एहि सत्ता आ अर्थक्रियाकारिताक वास्तविकता निश्चित करबाक लेल आन सत्ता आ आन

अर्थक्रियाकारिता मानल जाए तँ अनन्त प्रत्यावर्तन होएत। अतः प्रकाशमानताक मात्रे यथार्थताक स्वरूप मानए पड़त। फलतः देह आदि प्रकट होएबाक कारण असत्य नहि छथि; ओही चैतन्य आत्मा जकाँ सत्य भऽ जाएत। जँ ओ असत्य छथि तँ प्रकट नहि भऽ सकैत छथि; तखन सत्य आ असत्यक मेल केना सम्भव होएत?

एतय प्रश्न कएल जा सकैत अछि—अध्यास कहल जाएवाला ई वस्तु की अछि? उत्तर अछि—पहिने देखल वस्तुक स्मृतिसदृश स्वरूपमे आन ठाम प्रकट होएब। किछु लोक एक वस्तुक धर्म दोसर ठाम आरोपित होएब केँ अध्यास कहैत छथि। किछु आन लोकक मत अछि जे एक वस्तुक दोसर पर आरोप होइत काल दुनूक भेद नहि बुझल जाएब सँ उत्पन्न भ्रम अध्यास अछि। आन किछु लोक कहैत छथि जे एकक दोसर पर आरोप होइत काल पछिलुकमे विपरीत धर्मक कल्पना होइत अछि। मुदा कोनो मत हो, एक वस्तु दोसरक धर्मसँ युक्त जकाँ प्रकट होइत अछि—एहि लक्षणसँ कोनो मत बाहर नहि जाइत अछि। लोकमे हमरा सभक अनुभवो एही अछि—शुक्ति रजत जकाँ देखाइत अछि, आ एक चन्द्रमा दोसरासहित अर्थात् दुइ जकाँ देखाइत अछि।

एहि परिभाषाक “पहिने देखल” इत्यादिक ई आर व्याख्या अछि। “पूर्वदृष्टावभास”क अर्थ अछि—पहिने देखल वस्तुक प्रकट होएब। आरोपित तत्त्व आ जाहिपर आरोप होइत अछि तकर मेल बिना मिथ्या प्रतीति सम्भव नहि; अतः “पहिने देखल” शब्द आरोपित आ असत्य तत्त्वक बोध करबैत अछि। “देखल” शब्द ई बतएबाक लेल अछि जे आरोपित तत्त्व केवल व्यावहारिक सत्य अछि, पारमार्थिक सत्य नहि। तैयो वर्तमानमे देखाइत वस्तु आरोपित नहि भऽ सकैत अछि; तँ “पहिने” शब्द प्रयुक्त भेल अछि। पहिने देखल वस्तु अपन स्वरूपमे सत्य होइतहुँ आरोपित रूपमे अनिर्वचनीय आ ताहि कारण असत्य अछि। आरोपक सत्य अधिष्ठान “आन ठाम” शब्दसँ कहल गेल अछि; ई “आन ठाम” शुक्ति आदि अछि, जे पारमार्थिक रूपेँ सत्य अछि। एहि प्रकार सत्य आ असत्यक मेल कहल गेल।

मानि लिअ। “पहिने देखल वस्तुक आन ठाम प्रकट होएब” ई परिभाषा अतिव्याप्त अछि। कारण कालाक्षी नामक गाएमे पहिने स्वस्तिमती गाएमे देखल गोत्वक प्रतीति होइत अछि। तहिना पाटलिपुत्रमे पहिने देखल देवदत्त केँ माहिष्मतीमे देखलापर आन ठाम ओही देवदत्तक प्रतीति होइत अछि। ई दुनू यथार्थ ज्ञान अछि। “अवभास” शब्द यथार्थ अनुभवक लेल सेहो प्रसिद्ध अछि—जहिना नीलक अवभास, पीतक अवभास। एकर उत्तर “स्मृतिसदृश स्वरूप” शब्दसँ देल गेल अछि। एकर स्वरूप स्मृतिक स्वरूप जकाँ अछि। स्मृतिमे विषयक अनुपस्थिति मूल धर्म अछि; मुदा यथार्थ प्रत्यभिज्ञामे वर्तमान वस्तुक बोध होइत अछि। तँ परिभाषा अतिव्याप्त नहि अछि।

ई परिभाषा अव्याप्तो नहि अछि; कारण भ्रमपूर्ण स्मृति-जकाँ स्वरूपवाला स्वप्नज्ञानो एहि परिभाषामे अबैत अछि। स्वप्नमे निद्रादोषक कारण स्मरण कएल माता-पिता आदिक वर्तमान अनुपस्थितिपर ध्यान नहि जाइत अछि; तँ जे समय आ स्थानमे हुनका पहिने उपस्थित देखि चुकल रहैत छी, ओ समय आ स्थान वर्तमान अनुभवपर आरोपित होइत अछि।

एही परिभाषा “शुक्ति पीयर अछि” आ “चीनी तीत अछि” सन अनुभवपर सेहो लागू होइत अछि। प्रक्रिया ई अछि—आँखिसँ निकलैत अत्यन्त निर्मल किरणक सम्पर्कमे आयल पित्तमे स्थित पीत वर्ण पित्तसँ पृथक अनुभव होइत अछि; शुक्तियो अनुभव होइत अछि, मुदा इन्द्रियदोषक कारण ओकर श्वेतता आच्छादित रहैत अछि। पीत वर्णक शुक्तिसँ असम्बन्ध अनुभव नहि होइत अछि। असम्बन्ध नहि बुझल जाएबक समानताक कारण पहिने “पीयर सोनाक ढेरी” वा “पीयर बेलक फल” इत्यादि

अनुभवमे देखल समानाधिकरण-सम्बन्ध पीतता आ शुक्तित्वपर आरोपित होइत अछि, आ व्यक्ति “पीयर शुक्ति” कहैत अछि। “चीनी तीत अछि” एहि अनुभवक व्याख्या सेहो एही प्रकार होएत।

एही प्रकार दृष्टेन्द्रियक किरण सामने रहल स्वच्छ दर्पण वा जलपट्टक सम्पर्कमे अबैत अछि; मुदा सूर्यक अधिक प्रबल किरणसँ ओतयसँ परावर्तित भऽ मुखक सम्पर्कमे आबि मुखक ज्ञान करैत अछि। दोषक कारण ओ मुख केँ वास्तविक स्थानमे—अर्थात् अपनासँ विपरीत दिशामे—नहि बुझैत अछि, बल्कि पहिने देखल दर्पण वा जलपट्टक अपन दिशामे मुख कएल रहबाक धर्म मुखपर आरोपित करैत अछि। एहि प्रकार ई परिभाषा प्रतिबिम्बभ्रमपर सेहो लागू होइत अछि। एही प्रकार दुइ चन्द्र देखाइत भ्रम, दिशाभ्रम, अलातचक्र, गन्धर्वनगररूप मृगतृष्णा तथा बाँसक भीतर साँप देखबाक भ्रमक उपयुक्त व्याख्या करबाक चाही।

कहल ई जा रहल अछि—केवल प्रकाशमान होएबे यथार्थता नहि अछि; नहि तँ देह, इन्द्रिय आदि मात्र प्रकट होएबाक कारण सत्य भऽ जाएत। रस्सी आदि साँपक रूपमे आ स्फटिक आदि लाल वर्णयुक्त रूपमे प्रकट नहि होइत अछि—एना नहि; मुदा एहन रूपमे प्रकट होइतहुँ ओ वास्तवमे साँप आदि नहि बनि जाइत अछि, ने सचमुच ओहि धर्मसँ युक्त होइत अछि। जँ एना होइत, तँ मृगतृष्णामे निरन्तर हिलैत, ऊँच-नीच तरङ्गमालासहित मन्दाकिनी मानो लगमे उतरि आयल अछि—एहन निष्कर्ष मानए पड़ितय; आ ओतय दौड़ि गेल व्यक्ति ओहि जल केँ पीबि अपन तृष्णा शान्त कऽ सकितय। अतः आरोपित वस्तु प्रकट होइतहुँ ओकर पारमार्थिक सत्यता स्वीकार नहि कएल जा सकैत अछि, चाहे एहि निष्कर्षक इच्छा नहि हो।

ई प्रश्नो उचित नहि जे मृगतृष्णाक जल असत्य अछि, मुदा मृगतृष्णा अपन स्वरूपमे पारमार्थिक रूपँ सत्य अछि; जबकि देह, इन्द्रिय आदि अपन स्वरूपमे सेहो असत्य छथि, अतः अनुभवक विषय भऽ नहि सकैत छथि—तखन हुनकर आरोप केना होएत? जँ असत्य वस्तु कोनो अनुभवक विषय नहि भऽ सकैत अछि, तँ असत्य मृगतृष्णा जलादिरूपमे अनुभवक विषय केना बनैत अछि? अपन स्वरूपमे सत्य होइतहुँ मृगतृष्णा आदि जलादिरूपमे सत्य नहि भऽ सकैत अछि।

कहल जा सकैत अछि जे भावसँ भिन्न “अभाव” नामक कोनो वस्तु नहि अछि। एक विद्यमान वस्तु दोसर विद्यमान वस्तुक स्वरूपक दृष्टिसँ अभाव कहल जाइत अछि, मुदा अपन स्वरूपमे ओ भावे अछि। कहल गेल अछि—“अभाव दोसर वस्तुक सम्बन्धमे विचारल आन भाव मात्र अछि।” अतः अभाव केँ भावक आन प्रकार मानि अनुभवक विषय बनाओल जा सकैत अछि। मुदा जे जगत सर्वथा असत्य, समस्त सामर्थ्यसँ रहित आ यथार्थ सारहीन अछि, ओ अनुभवक विषय केना बनत? आ चैतन्य आत्मापर ओकर आरोप केना होएत?

ईहो मान्य नहि जे अनुभवक विषयसभ स्वयं प्रकट होएबाक सामर्थ्यसँ सर्वथा रहित होइतहुँ हुनकर-हुनकर ज्ञान, अपन भीतर ज्ञानरूपँ स्थित सामर्थ्य द्वारा, स्वयं एक विशिष्ट प्रकारक परिणामक रूपमे असत्य वस्तुक प्रतीति उत्पन्न करैत अछि; आ ज्ञानक ई सामर्थ्य, जे असत्य केँ प्रकट करैत अछि, अविद्या अछि। प्रश्न अछि—ज्ञानक ई कोन शक्ति अछि जाहिसँ ओ असत्य केँ प्रकट करैत अछि? ओ असत्य वस्तुक विषयमे की करैत अछि? जँ असत्य अछि तँ ओकरा उत्पन्न करैत अछि अथवा केवल प्रकाशित करैत अछि? उत्पन्न नहि कऽ सकैत अछि, कारण असत्यक उत्पत्ति बुद्धिगम्य नहि। प्रकाशितो नहि कऽ सकैत अछि, कारण प्रकाशित करनिहार एहि ज्ञानक अतिरिक्त कोनो दोसर ज्ञान ज्ञात नहि अछि। फेर जे वस्तु एहि प्रकार प्रकट भेल, ओ असत्य अछि; ओकर नव ज्ञानसँ सम्बन्धक व्याख्या करबाक आवश्यकता पड़त, जाहिसँ अनन्त प्रत्यावर्तन होएत। जँ कहल जाए जे

असत्य केँ प्रकट करब ज्ञानक स्वभावे अछि, तँ सत्य आ असत्यक बीच ई सम्बन्ध की अछि? जँ कहल जाए जे यथार्थ ज्ञान आ असत्य वस्तुक सम्बन्ध एहन अछि जे पहिल अर्थात् यथार्थ ज्ञान असत्य वस्तुक नियन्त्रणमे निर्धारित होइत अछि, तँ अहा! बेचारा ज्ञानक ई केहन महान सौभाग्य अछि जे असत्यक द्वारा सेहो निश्चितता प्राप्त कऽ लैत अछि! ज्ञान ओहि असत्य वस्तुमे कोनो क्रिया सेहो नहि करैत अछि, कारण असत्य वस्तु कोनो एहन क्रियाक आश्रय भऽ सकैत अछि—ई मानब अनुचित अछि। जँ कहल जाए जे ज्ञान असत्यक अधीन नहि अछि, बल्कि ज्ञानक स्वभावे एहन अछि जे ओ असत्यसँ पृथक् प्रकट नहि होइत अछि, तँ अहा! असत्यक पक्षमे ई केहन दुर्भाग्यपूर्ण पक्षपात अछि, जाहिसँ ज्ञान सदिखन असत्यसँ जुड़ल रहैत अछि, जखन कि ने ओ असत्यसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि ने ओकर समानस्वरूप अछि। अतः देह, इन्द्रिय आदि, जे सर्वथा असत्य आ वास्तविक सत्तासँ रहित छथि, अनुभवक विषय नहि भऽ सकैत छथि।

एतय हमरा सभक उत्तर अछि—जँ वास्तविक सत्तासँ रहित वस्तु अनुभवक क्षेत्रमे नहि आबि सकैत अछि, तँ की ई किरणसभ जलरूपेँ सत्य छथि, जाहिसँ ओ अनुभवक विषय बनि सकथि? पूर्वपक्षी कहैत छथि—किरणसभमे जलक वास्तविक सत्ता नहि अछि, कारण किरण जलस्वरूप नहि छथि। वस्तुक सत्ता दुइ प्रकारक होइत अछि—अपन स्वरूपक सम्बन्धमे सत्य आ अपनासँ भिन्न वस्तुक सम्बन्धमे असत्य। कहल गेल अछि—“कोनो समय कोनो व्यक्ति वस्तुक सत्ता केँ या तँ ओहि वस्तुक अपन स्वरूपक सम्बन्धमे अथवा आन वस्तुक सम्बन्धमे सत्य वा असत्य रूपमे ग्रहण करैत अछि।” हमरा सभक उत्तर अछि—किरणमे जलक ज्ञान की सत्यक क्षेत्रमे पड़ैत अछि? तखन वैध होएबाक कारण ओ ने भ्रान्त होएत आ ने बाधित। पूर्वपक्षी फेर कहैत छथि—निश्चित ओ बाधित नहि होएत, जँ किरण केँ जलस्वरूप नहि, बल्कि जलसँ भिन्न रूपमे बुझल जाए। मुदा जखन किरण केँ जलस्वरूप बुझल जाइत अछि, तखन ओ ज्ञान अभ्रान्त अथवा अबाधित केना भऽ सकैत अछि? तखन हमरा सभक उत्तर अछि—जाहि किरणक स्वरूप अजलत्व अछि, ताहिमे आरोपित जलत्व सत्य नहि अछि; कारण ओ किरण अजलत्वसँ अभिन्न होएबाक कारण बुद्धिगम्य रूपेँ जलत्वस्वरूप नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। मुदा ओ जलत्व असत्यो नहि अछि, कारण अहाँ स्वयं मानैत छी—“अभाव आन रूपक भावे अछि, आन किछु नहि; कारण एहन कोनो पृथक् वस्तु सिद्ध नहि अछि।” अर्थात् एक वस्तुक असत्यता आन वस्तु मात्र अछि। आरोपित रूपो आन वस्तु नहि अछि; जँ होइत, तँ ओ या तँ किरण होइत अथवा गङ्गाक जल। पहिल विकल्पमे ज्ञान “किरण” रूपक होइत, “जल” रूपक नहि; दोसर विकल्पमे ओ “गङ्गाक जल” रूपक होइत, “एतयक जल” रूपक नहि। विशेष स्थानक स्मरण नहि रहितो ज्ञान “जल” मात्रक होएबाक चाही, “एतय”क नहि। ईहो मान्य नहि जे ओ सर्वथा असत्य, समस्त सत्तासँ रहित मिथ्या वस्तु अछि; कारण एहन वस्तु बुद्धिगम्य रूपेँ अनुभवक क्षेत्रमे आबि नहि सकैत अछि—ई पहिने कहल जा चुकल अछि। अतः किरणपर आरोपित जल केँ अनिर्वचनीय मानए पड़त—ओ ने सत्य अछि, ने असत्य, आ ने सत्य-असत्य दुनू; कारण अन्तिम विकल्प आत्मविरोधी अछि। एहि प्रकार आरोपित जल पारमार्थिक सत्य जलक समान देखाइत अछि आ एही कारण पहिने देखल जलक समान प्रतीत होइत अछि; मुदा वास्तवमे ओ ने जल अछि, ने पहिने देखल जल; ओ असत्य आ अनिर्वचनीय अछि। एही प्रकार देह, इन्द्रिय आदि सम्पूर्ण जगतो अनिर्वचनीय अछि। ओ नव होइतहुँ पूर्ववर्ती भ्रान्त ज्ञानमे प्रस्तुत वस्तु जकाँ आन अधिष्ठान—अर्थात् चैतन्य आत्मा—पर आरोपित होइत अछि। अध्यासक उपर्युक्त परिभाषा एतय पूर्णतः लागू होइत अछि। देह, इन्द्रिय आदि जगतक बाध आगाँ बुझाओल जाएत। चैतन्य आत्मा श्रुति, स्मृति, इतिहास आ पुराणक विषय अछि; एहि सभपर आधारित आ एहि सभसँ अविरोधी तर्क द्वारा निश्चित भेलापर ओकर स्वरूप शुद्धता, चैतन्य आ

स्वतन्त्रता अछि, आ ओ निश्चित रूपेँ सत्य सिद्ध होइत अछि। अबाधित स्वप्रकाशताहि ओकर सत्यता अछि; ई चैतन्य आत्माक अपन स्वरूपे अछि, वर्ग-सत्ताक समवाय अथवा अर्थक्रियाकारिता जकाँ ताहिसँ भिन्न कोनो धर्म नहि। एहि प्रकार सभ किछु स्पष्ट अछि।

उपर्युक्त प्रकारेँ परिभाषित अनिर्वचनीय अध्यास केँ समस्त जिज्ञासु स्वीकार करैत छथि, मुदा ओकर सूक्ष्म विवरणमे पर्याप्त मतभेद अछि। एही कारण ओकर अनिर्वचनीयता दृढ़तापूर्वक स्थापित करबाक लेल भाष्यकार कहैत छथि—“किछु लोक एकरा एना कहैत छथि” इत्यादि।

“दोसरक धर्मक”—अर्थात् एतय रजतविषयक ज्ञानक धर्म, वा ज्ञानक आकार। अध्यास “आन ठाम” होइत अछि, अर्थात् बाह्य वस्तुमे। सौत्रान्तिक मतानुसार बाह्य सत्ता अछि; ओहि बाह्य वस्तुपर ज्ञानाकारक आरोप अध्यास अछि। विज्ञानवादीक मतानुसार बाह्य सत्ता नहि रहैतहुँ अनादि अविद्याक संस्कारसँ उत्पन्न बाह्य मिथ्यात्व अछि, आ ओकरे ऊपर ज्ञानाकारक आरोप होइत अछि। एकर समर्थन ई अछि—सामान्य नियम अछि जे जे वस्तु जाहि विशेष आकारमे अनुभूत हो, तकरा ओही आकारमे स्वीकार करबाक चाही; कारण ताहिसँ भिन्नता तखने सिद्ध होइत अछि जखन अधिक प्रबल ज्ञान ओकरा बाधित करैत अछि। “ई रजत नहि अछि” ई बाधक ज्ञान मात्र “ई” तत्त्व केँ बाधित करैत अछि—एना अर्थ सम्भव होइतहुँ ओकर बाध केँ रजत-तत्त्व धरि पसारब उचित नहि। जँ “रजत” अधिष्ठान बाधित होइत, तँ रजत आ ओकर “ईपन” धर्म दुनू बाधित होइत; अतः ई मानब अधिक उचित अछि जे केवल “ईपन” धर्म बाधित होइत अछि, “रजत” अधिष्ठान नहि। एहि कारण बाह्यता सम्बन्धी रजतक बाध भेलापर अनुमानतः ओ रजत हमरा सभक भीतरक ज्ञानमे सीमित मानल जाइत अछि। फलतः ज्ञानाकारक वस्तुक बाह्य आरोप सिद्ध होइत अछि।

“मुदा किछु आन लोक”—अर्थात् जे ज्ञानाकारक आरोपक सिद्धान्तसँ सन्तुष्ट नहि छथि—कहैत छथि जे “एक वस्तुक दोसरपर अध्यास होइत काल दुनूक भेद नहि बुझल जाएब सँ उत्पन्न भ्रम होइत अछि।” अपन असन्तोषक कारण ओ सभ एना कहैत छथि—रजत आदि ज्ञानाकार अछि, ई या तँ अनुभव अर्थात् प्रत्यक्षसँ सिद्ध होएबाक चाही, अथवा अनुमानसँ। एहि विषयक अनुमानक खण्डन आगाँ कएल जाएत। प्रत्यक्षक सम्बन्धमे ओ या तँ रजतक ज्ञान होएत अथवा ओकर बाधक ज्ञान। रजतक अनुभव ओकर ज्ञानाकारस्वरूपक सूचना नहि दैत अछि; कारण ओ रजत केँ “ई” अधिष्ठानपर स्थित बाह्य वस्तुरूपेँ प्रकाशित करैत अछि, भीतरक वस्तुरूपेँ नहि। नहि तँ ज्ञाता आ ज्ञानक अभेदक कारण ओ ज्ञान “हम रजत छी” एहन रूपक होइत। आत्मख्यातिवादी कहि सकैत छथि—भ्रान्त ज्ञान अपनहि आकार केँ बाह्य रूपमे निश्चित करैत अछि; अतः ओकर विषय “हम” शब्दक अधिष्ठान नहि अछि। ओकर ज्ञानाकारत्व बाधक ज्ञानसँ बुझल जाइत अछि। एहि पर हमरा सभक उत्तर अछि—अहा! दीर्घजीवी महोदय एहि बाधक ज्ञानपर विचार करथि। की ओ हमरा सभक समक्ष उपस्थित वस्तु केँ रजतसँ पृथक् करैत अछि, अथवा ईहो बतबैत अछि जे ओकर स्वरूप ज्ञानाकार अछि? जे व्यक्ति कहैत छथि जे बाधक ज्ञान पूर्वानुभूत वस्तुक ज्ञानाकारस्वरूप प्रकाशित करैत अछि, देवप्रिय हुनकर बुद्धिक प्रशंसा करथि! जँ कहल जाए जे समक्ष रजतक उपस्थितिक निषेधसँ ओकर ज्ञानाकारत्व अनुमानित होइत अछि, तँ ईहो ठीक नहि; कारण अदूरत्वक अग्रहणक निषेधसँ वस्तु ज्ञातासँ दूर सिद्ध होएत, तखन ज्ञाताक अपन स्वरूप जकाँ अत्यन्त निकटता कतयसँ आएत? ई बाधक ज्ञान ने रजतक निषेध करैत अछि, ने “ईपन”क; ओ केवल भेद नहि बुझल जाएब सँ उत्पन्न रजतसम्बन्धी व्यावहारिक प्रयोगक निषेध करैत अछि। शुक्तिमे रजतक ज्ञान स्वयं रजत केँ उत्पन्न करैत अछि—एहन नहि; कारण रजतक प्रस्तुति शुक्ति केँ अधिष्ठान बना नहि सकैत अछि, ई अनुभवक विरुद्ध अछि। शुक्ति मात्र विद्यमान वस्तुरूपेँ—ज्ञात वस्तुरूपेँ नहि—अधिष्ठान अछि, ईहो नहि; कारण एना मानलापर

अधिष्ठानक लक्षण अतिव्याप्त भऽ जाएत, अस्तित्व सभ वस्तुमे समान होएबाक कारण कोनो वस्तु अधिष्ठान भऽ सकैत अछि। शुक्ति ज्ञानक कारणरूपेँ अधिष्ठान अछि, ईहो नहि; कारण इन्द्रिय सेहो कारण अछि। अतः “अधिष्ठान” शब्दक अर्थ केवल प्रकाशमान होएब अछि। मुदा रजतज्ञानमे शुक्ति प्रकट नहि होइत अछि; तखन ओ अधिष्ठान केना? जँ प्रकट होएब स्वीकार कएल जाए, तँ अनुभवसँ विरोध केना नहि होएत? फेर, जखन इन्द्रिय आदि वैध ज्ञान उत्पन्न करबाक सामर्थ्ययुक्त देखल जाइत छथि, तखन हुनकासँ भ्रान्त ज्ञान केना उत्पन्न होएत? जँ कहल जाए जे दोषक संयोगसँ ओ सभ भ्रान्त ज्ञान उत्पन्न करबाक सामर्थ्य प्राप्त करैत छथि, तँ नहि; कारण दोष कारणक उत्पादक सामर्थ्यक केवल प्रतिरोध कऽ सकैत अछि। नहि तँ सुखायल कुटजक बीजसँ वटवृक्षक अङ्कुरो निकलि सकैत छल। फेर जँ ज्ञान अपन उचित विषयसँ नियत नहि रहत, तँ सभ बातपर विश्वास नष्ट भऽ जाएत। अतः मानए पड़त जे प्रत्येक ज्ञान वैध अछि।

एहि प्रकार “रजत” आ “ई”—ई दुनू ज्ञान दुइ प्रकारक छथि—स्मृति आ अनुभव। एतय “ई” हमरा सभक समक्ष उपस्थित केवल वस्तुमात्रक ग्रहण अछि; दोषक कारण ओतय विद्यमान शुक्तित्वजाति ग्रहण नहि होइत अछि। मात्र “ओ”, जे पहिने ग्रहण कएल गेल छल, समानताक कारण पूर्व रजतानुभवक संस्कार जागृत कऽ रजतक स्मृति उत्पन्न करैत अछि। ओ स्मृति पूर्वगृहीत वस्तुक ग्रहणस्वरूप होइतहुँ केवल ग्रहणरूपेँ रहि जाइत अछि; दोषक कारण ओकर गृहीत विषयांश लुप्त भऽ जाइत अछि। एही कारण रजतस्मृति आ समक्ष उपस्थित वस्तुमात्रक ग्रहणक बीचक भेद—चाहे हुनकर अपन ज्ञानस्वरूपमे हो अथवा विषयसम्बन्धमे—ग्रहण नहि होइत अछि। फलतः इन्द्रियसन्निकर्षसँ वास्तवमे उत्पन्न रजतज्ञानक समानता कारण “ई” आ “रजत” नामक ई दुइ ज्ञान, प्रत्यक्ष आ स्मृति रूपेँ भिन्न होइतहुँ, अभिन्न जकाँ व्यावहारिक प्रयोग आ समानाधिकरण अभिधान उत्पन्न करैत अछि। किछु अवस्थामे परस्पर भेद नहि बुझल जाएवाला दुइ प्रत्यक्ष रहैत अछि—जहिना “शुक्ति पीयर अछि।” एहि स्थितिमे, स्वच्छ स्फटिकक उदाहरण जकाँ, आँखिसँ निकलैत प्रकाशक किरणमे उपस्थित पित्तक पीतता ग्रहण होइत अछि, मुदा पित्त स्वयं ग्रहण नहि होइत अछि। कोनो दोषक कारण शुक्तियो मात्र अस्तित्वरूपेँ ग्रहण होइत अछि, मुदा ओकर श्वेतता ग्रहण नहि होइत। गुण आ गुणीक असम्बन्ध नहि बुझल जाएबक समानताक कारण पीत सोनाक ढेरीक ज्ञान जकाँ एतयो अभिन्नता आ समानाधिकरणरूप व्यावहारिक प्रयोग होइत अछि। बाध होइत काल भेद नहि बुझल जाएब सँ उत्पन्न ई अभिन्न व्यावहारिक प्रयोग बाधित होइत अछि; अतः “ई नहि” रूप भेदज्ञानक बाधकता बुझल जाइत अछि। एना बुझल जाएब सँ संसारमे प्रसिद्ध पूर्वज्ञानक भ्रान्तत्वो स्थापित होइत अछि। अतः जाहि सन्दिग्ध वा भ्रान्त ज्ञानक स्वरूपपर विवाद अछि, ओ सभ ज्ञान होएबाक कारण घटज्ञान जकाँ सत्य छथि। “एकक दोसरपर अध्यास होइत काल” एहि शब्दमे एही मतक व्याख्या कएल गेल अछि। शुक्ति आदिपर संसारप्रसिद्ध रजतादिक अध्यास कोनो आन ज्ञानसँ नियन्त्रित नहि अछि; बल्कि एक दिस रजत आ विषयांश लुप्त भऽ केवल ग्रहणरूपेँ रहि गेल ओकर स्मृति, आ दोसर दिस समक्ष “ई” रूपमे उपस्थित वस्तुमात्र तथा ओकर ज्ञान—ई दुनूक पृथकता नहि बुझल जाएब सँ उत्पन्न भ्रम अछि। स्मृति आ ग्रहण केँ परस्पर समानाधिकरणरूपेँ कहल जाएब तथा रजतादिरूप व्यावहारिक प्रयोगे भ्रान्तत्व अछि।

“मुदा आन लोक”, जे एहि मतसँ सेहो सन्तुष्ट नहि छथि, कहैत छथि—“एकक दोसरपर अध्यास होइत काल पछिलुक वस्तुमे विपरीत धर्मक कल्पना होइत अछि।” एकर मूल विचार ई अछि—“ई रजत अछि” एहि ज्ञानक कारण रजत खोजैत व्यक्तिमे समक्ष वस्तुक सम्बन्धमे प्रवृत्ति आ समानाधिकरण अभिधान होइत अछि—ई सभक समान अनुभव अछि। ई केवल स्मृति आ ग्रहण,

अथवा हुनकर-हुनकर विषयक परस्पर भेद नहि बुझल जाएब सँ उत्पन्न नहि भऽ सकैत अछि; कारण बुद्धिमान प्राणीक प्रवृत्ति आ वाणी, जे ग्रहणपर निर्भर अछि, केवल अग्रहणसँ केना उत्पन्न होएत? एतय कहल गेल अछि जे ओ मात्र अग्रहणसँ नहि, बल्कि स्मृति आ ग्रहणसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि, जाहिमे हुनकर स्वरूप आ विषयक भेद ग्रहण नहि होइत अछि; समक्ष उपस्थित वैध रजतज्ञानक समानताक कारण ओ अभिन्नता आ समानाधिकरणरूप व्यावहारिक प्रयोग उत्पन्न करैत अछि। एहि पर अन्यथाख्यातिवादी उत्तर दैत छथि—एहि ज्ञानक वैध रजतज्ञानसँ समानता व्यावहारिक प्रयोगक कारण या तँ ग्रहण कएल जाएबाक द्वारा होएत, अथवा ग्रहण नहि कएल जाएतहुँ ओकर केवल अस्तित्वक द्वारा। जँ ओ ग्रहण कएल जाए, तँ ज्ञानक रूप या तँ एहन होएबाक चाही—“‘ई’ आ ‘रजत’ ज्ञान वैध ज्ञानक समान छथि”; अथवा एहन—“एहि दुइ ज्ञानक स्वरूप अथवा विषयमे कोनो भेद ग्रहण नहि होइत अछि।” पहिल ज्ञान—“ई वैध ज्ञानक समान अछि”—वैध ज्ञान जकाँ व्यावहारिक प्रयोग उत्पन्न नहि कऽ सकैत अछि। “गवय गाए जकाँ अछि” ई ज्ञान गाए खोजैत व्यक्तिमे गवयक सम्बन्धमे प्रवृत्ति उत्पन्न नहि करैत अछि। दोसर ज्ञान—“एहि दुनूक बीच भेद ग्रहण नहि होइत अछि”—आत्मविरोधी अछि; कारण जँ भेदक अग्रहण अछि तँ ज्ञान “दुनूक बीच” एहन रूपक नहि भऽ सकैत अछि, आ जँ “दुनूक बीच” ग्रहण अछि तँ भेदक अग्रहण केना रहत? अतः कहए पड़त जे भेदक अग्रहण स्वयं ग्रहण नहि होइतहुँ केवल अपन अस्तित्वसँ व्यावहारिक प्रयोगक कारण बनैत अछि। प्रश्न अछि—की ओ अध्यास उत्पन्न कऽ व्यावहारिक प्रयोगक कारण बनैत अछि, अथवा अध्यास उत्पन्न कएने बिना स्वयं कारण बनैत अछि? हमरा सभक मत ई अछि—बुद्धिमान प्राणीक व्यावहारिक प्रयोग अज्ञानक प्रत्यक्ष परिणाम बुद्धिगम्य नहि, अतः भेदक अग्रहण केवल आरोपित ज्ञान उत्पन्न कऽ प्रभावी होइत अछि। एतय आपत्ति कएल जा सकैत अछि—बुद्धिमान प्राणीक प्रवृत्ति अज्ञानक परिणाम नहि, बल्कि एहन ग्रहण आ स्मृतिक परिणाम अछि जाहिक परस्पर भेद ज्ञात नहि। हमर उत्तर अछि—एना नहि। केवल “रजत” शब्दक मूल अर्थक स्मृति प्रवृत्तिक कारण नहि; कारण ई निर्विवाद अछि जे रजत खोजैत व्यक्तिक प्रवृत्ति “ईपन”क अधिष्ठानक दिशामे होइत अछि। “ईपन”क अधिष्ठानक सम्बन्धमे इच्छा बिना व्यक्ति ओतय प्रवृत्त केना होएत? एक वस्तुक इच्छा कऽ आन वस्तुक लेल कर्म करैत अछि—एना कहब आत्मविरोधी अछि। फेर, “ईपन”क अधिष्ठान रजत अछि—ई ज्ञात नहि रहितो रजत खोजैत व्यक्ति ओकर इच्छा केना करत? जँ कहल जाए जे “ईपन”क अधिष्ठान केँ रजतसँ भिन्न रूपमे नहि ग्रहण कएल गेल अछि, एही कारण इच्छा होइत अछि, तँ उत्तर अछि—जखन ओकरा रजतस्वरूप ग्रहण नहि कएल गेल अछि, तखन व्यक्ति ओकर प्रति उदासीन किएक नहि रहैत अछि? एना स्वीकार आ उदासीनता द्वारा विपरीत दिशामे खींचल ई बुद्धिमान व्यक्ति अनिश्चित रहैत अछि; अन्ततः “ईपन”क अधिष्ठानपर रजतक आरोप द्वारा ओकर मन स्वीकारक पक्षमे स्थिर होइत अछि। अतः भेदक अग्रहण अध्यास उत्पन्न कऽ बुद्धिमान व्यक्तिक प्रवृत्तिक कारण बनैत अछि। क्रम ई अछि—भेद नहि बुझल जाएबक कारण रजतधर्म “ईपन”क अधिष्ठानपर आरोपित होइत अछि; तकर बाद रजतजातिक वस्तु लाभदायक अछि—ई बात स्मृतिमे अबैत अछि; फेर “ईपन”क अधिष्ठानपर आरोपित रजतपर ओ लाभदायकता अनुमानित होइत अछि, कारण ओ रजतजातिक अछि; तकर बाद रजत खोजैत व्यक्ति ओहि आरोपित रजतक सम्बन्धमे प्रवृत्त होइत अछि। एहि प्रकार क्रम स्थापित होइत अछि। सामान्य रूपेँ रजतक स्मृति “ईपन”क अधिष्ठानक लाभदायकता अनुमान करबामे सहायक नहि भऽ सकैत अछि; कारण पक्षमे रजतत्वरूप हेतु निवास करैत अछि—ई ज्ञात नहि रहत। अनुमानक कारण पक्ष आ हेतु केँ एकहि स्थानमे देखब अछि, भिन्न स्थानमे देखब नहि। कहल

गेल अछि—“सम्बन्ध जननिहार व्यक्ति द्वारा एकहि स्थानमे पक्ष आ हेतु देखल जाएब सँ अनुमान होइत अछि—”

व्याप्ति)। अध्यासमे एकहि स्थानक ई प्रत्यक्ष होइत अछि। अतः ई अनुमान सिद्ध भेल—विवादक विषय जे रजतादिक ज्ञान अछि, ओकर विषय समक्ष उपस्थित वस्तु अछि; कारण रजतादि खोजैत व्यक्ति ओहि समक्ष वस्तुक दिशामे नियमपूर्वक प्रवृत्त होइत अछि। जे ज्ञान कोनो वस्तु खोजैत व्यक्तिक ओहि वस्तुक प्रति नियमपूर्वक प्रवृत्ति उत्पन्न करैत अछि, ओकर विषय ओही वस्तु होइत अछि—जहिना हमरा-अहाँ दुनू द्वारा मान्य यथार्थ रजतज्ञान। प्रस्तुत ज्ञानो तद्रूप अछि; अतः एकर विषय “ईपन”क अधिष्ठाने अछि। शुक्ति अधिष्ठान नहि अछि, कारण ओकर प्रत्यक्ष उपस्थित नहि—एहि कथनक सम्बन्धमे प्रश्न भेलापर अहाँकेँ स्पष्ट करए पड़ैत जे “ई रजत अछि” एहि ज्ञानक अधिष्ठान शुक्ति नहि अछि—एतय शुक्तित्वक बात कहैत छी वा केवल समक्ष उपस्थित उज्जर चमकीला पदार्थक? जँ शुक्तित्व अधिष्ठान नहि अछि, तँ हमहुँ स्वीकार करैत छी। मुदा जँ समक्ष उपस्थित उज्जर चमकीला पदार्थ अधिष्ठान नहि अछि, तँ ई कहैत अहाँ एकाकी प्रत्यक्ष अनुभवक विरोध करैत छी। बात ई अछि—जे व्यक्ति “ई रजत अछि” अनुभव करैत अछि, ओ अनुभव करैत काल समक्ष पदार्थ दिस अङ्गुली आदिसँ सङ्केत करैत अछि। ईहो देखल जाइत अछि जे जखन दोषक कारण कोनो कारणक सामान्य कार्योत्पादन रुकि जाइत अछि, तखन ओहि कारणमे आन प्रकारक कार्य उत्पन्न करबाक सामर्थ्य आबि जाइत अछि; उदाहरणार्थ, वनाग्निमे झुलसल ईखक बीआ सँ कदलीकाण्ड उत्पन्न होइत अछि; भस्मक रोगसँ ग्रस्त व्यक्तिक जठराग्नि बहुत भोजन पचा लैत अछि। बाधक प्रत्यक्ष द्वारा विषयशून्य सिद्ध कएल भ्रमक सत्यताक अनुमान दोषपूर्ण अछि—जहिना “अग्नि उष्ण नहि अछि” एहि प्रकारक अनुमान। समस्त प्रमाणमे विश्वास समाप्त भऽ जाएत, जँ भ्रमज्ञान अपन विषयसँ अनियत मानल जाए—एहि आपत्तिक उत्तर...

...हम न्याय-कणिकामे दऽ चुकल छी। हमर मतमे ज्ञानक प्रामाण्य ओकर विषयसँ नियत सम्बन्धक कारण नहि, बल्कि ज्ञानबोध करएबाक अपन सामर्थ्यक कारण स्वतः अछि; अतः एतय विस्तार नहि कएल जा रहल अछि। स्मृतिक स्मृतित्व लुप्त भऽ जाएबाक सिद्धान्तक आलोचना एतय संक्षेपमे कएल गेल अछि; ओकर विस्तृत विवेचन ब्रह्मतत्त्वसमीक्षामे देखबाक चाही। अतः कहल गेल अछि—“मुदा आन लोक कहैत छथि जे एक वस्तुक दोसरपर अध्यास होइत काल पछिलुक वस्तुमे विपरीत धर्मक कल्पना होइत अछि।” शुक्ति आदिपर रजत आदिक अध्यास होइत काल रजतादिक ओ धर्मसभ आरोपित होइत अछि जे ओही शुक्ति आदिक धर्मक विपरीत अछि—वाक्यक अन्वय एहि प्रकार अछि।

जिज्ञासुसभक बीच ई मतभेद रहए दिअ; प्रस्तुत प्रसङ्गमे एकर की प्रयोजन? एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार “कोनो प्रकारेँ हो” इत्यादि शब्दसँ दैत छथि। एक वस्तुक धर्म दोसर वस्तुमे कल्पित होएब असत्यता अछि; ऊपर हम स्पष्ट कऽ चुकल छी जे ई असत्यता अनिर्वचनीयता अछि। ताहिसँ ई निष्कर्ष निकलैत अछि जे समस्त जिज्ञासुक मतमे एक वस्तुक धर्म दोसरमे अनिर्वचनीय रूपेँ आरोपित होएबाक स्थान अनिवार्यतः अछि; अतः अनिर्वचनीयता सभ मतक स्वीकृत सिद्धान्त अछि—यही अभिप्राय अछि। जे लोक स्मृति आ अनुभवक भेदक अग्रहणक मत मानैत छथि, हुनकासभकेँ सेहो अनिच्छापूर्वक ई स्वीकार करए पड़ैत अछि; कारण ओ सभ समानाधिकरण अभिधान आ प्रवृत्तिक नियमबद्धता स्वीकार करैत छथि।

फेर, जे अन्तरात्मा विषय नहि अछि, ताहिपर विषय आ ओकर धर्मसभक अध्यास केना भऽ सकैत अछि? प्रत्येक व्यक्ति अपन समक्ष उपस्थित एक विषयपर दोसर विषयक आरोप करैत अछि;

आ अहाँ कहैत छी जे “अहाँ” अवधारणाक क्षेत्रसँ बाहर अन्तरात्मा विषय नहि अछि। उत्तर अछि—ई सर्वथा अविषय नहि; कारण ओ “हम” अवधारणाक विषय अछि आ अन्तरात्माक अनुभूति अपरोक्ष अछि। ई नियमो नहि अछि जे आरोप केवल समक्ष उपस्थित दोसर विषयपर होएत। आकाश प्रत्यक्ष नहि होइतहुँ अविवेकी लोक ताहिपर तल, मलिनता आदि आरोपित करैत छथि। तहिना अन्तरात्मापर अनात्माक अध्यासमे कोनो विरोध नहि। ई असत्यता केवल तत्त्वजिज्ञासुसभक मतमे नहि, साधारण लोकक अनुभवमे सेहो सिद्ध अछि; तँ भाष्यकार कहैत छथि—“लोकमे हमरासभक अनुभव एहेन अछि—शुक्ति रजत जकाँ प्रकट होइत अछि।” “मुदा ई रजत नहि अछि”—ई पहिल वाक्यक पूरक अछि। मानि लिअ। एक वस्तु दोसरक स्वरूपक अछि—एहन भ्रम अनुभवसिद्ध अछि; मुदा जे वास्तवमे एक आ अभिन्न अछि, ताहिमे भेदक भ्रम देखल नहि जाइत अछि। तखन चैतन्य आत्मासँ अभिन्न जीवसभमे भेदभ्रम कतयसँ आएल? एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार दैत छथि—“एक चन्द्रमा होइतहुँ ओ दोसर चन्द्रमासहित जकाँ प्रकट होइत अछि।”

“फेर, केना” इत्यादि शब्दमे चैतन्य आत्मापर अध्यासक पुनः आपत्ति कएल गेल अछि। अभिप्राय ई अछि—ई चैतन्य आत्मा प्रकाशित अछि वा नहि? जँ प्रकाशित नहि अछि, तँ ताहिपर विषय आ ओकर धर्मसभक अध्यास केना होएत? हमरा समक्ष स्थित अप्रकाशित पदार्थपर रजत वा रजतधर्मक आरोप नहि होइत अछि। जँ आत्मा प्रकाशित अछि, तँ जड़ होइत, घटादि जकाँ दोसरक आश्रित प्रकाशसँ प्रकाशित होएब युक्तिसङ्गत नहि। प्रकाशित आत्मा या तँ स्वयंप्रकाश होएत अथवा दोसरसँ प्रकाशित; दोसर विकल्प सम्भव नहि, आ पहिल विकल्प सेहो अहाँक मतमे स्वीकार्य नहि। एके वस्तु विरोधक कारण कर्ता आ कर्म दुनू नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। कर्म ओ अछि जे दोसरमे निहित क्रियाक फल धारण करैत अछि; ज्ञानक्रिया आत्मासँ भिन्न कोनो दोसरमे निहित नहि अछि; तखन आत्मा ओकर कर्म केना होएत? विरोधक कारण एके वस्तु स्वयंप्रकाश आ परप्रकाश दुनू नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। जँ ज्ञानक्रिया दोसर आत्मामे समवेत मानल जाए, तँ ज्ञेय आत्मा ओहि क्रियाक कर्ता नहि रहलासँ अनात्मा भऽ जाएत। फेर ओहि दोसर आत्माक ज्ञान लेल तेसर आत्मा आ तकर लेल आर आत्मा मानए पड़त; एहि प्रकार अनन्त परम्परा होएत। जे चेतना स्वयंप्रकाश अछि, मुदा आत्मा स्वयंप्रकाश नहि—एहन मत माननिहार कहि सकैत छथि—मानि लिअ। आत्मा जड़ होइतहुँ समस्त वस्तुक ज्ञानमे प्रकाशित होइत अछि; तथापि ओ कर्म नहि, केवल कर्ता अछि। जहिना चैत्र अपन क्रियाक फल धारण करैत होइतहुँ दोसरमे निहित क्रियाक फल धारण करएवाला नहि भेलाक कारण कर्म नहि, तहिना आत्मो कर्म नहि। चैत्र अपना मे निहित क्रियासँ नगर पहुँचैत अछि...

...ओहि क्रियाक परिणाम चैत्र आ नगर दुनूमे रहितहुँ कर्मत्व केवल नगरक अछि; कारण दोसर अर्थात् चैत्रमे निहित क्रियाक फल धारण करबाक धर्म नगरमे अछि। चैत्रो क्रियाक फल पबैत अछि, मुदा गमनक्रिया केवल चैत्रमे निहित अछि, तँ ओ कर्म नहि। ई मत शास्त्रविरोधी होएबाक कारण युक्तिसङ्गत नहि। श्रुति स्पष्ट कहैत अछि—“ब्रह्म सत्य, ज्ञान आ अनन्त अछि।”

ई बात युक्तिसँ सेहो स्पष्ट अछि। विषयक प्रकाश जे फल अछि—अर्थात् जाहिमे विषय आ आत्मा दुनू प्रकाशित होइत छथि—ओ जड़ अछि वा स्वयंप्रकाश? जँ ओ जड़ हो, तँ विषय आ आत्मा दुनू जड़ होएत; तखन तीनूमे कोनो भेद नहि रहला पर केकरा द्वारा के प्रकाशित होएत? फलतः समस्त जगत अप्रकाशित रहि जाएत। तीनूक परस्पर आश्रय सेहो कोनो लाभ नहि देत; कहबियो अछि—“अन्हर

अन्तरक हाथ पकड़ि प्रत्येक डेगपर खसैत अछि।” ईहो नहि कहल जा सकैत अछि जे ज्ञान स्वयं अप्रकाशित रहितहुँ चक्षु आदि इन्द्रिय जकाँ विषय आ आत्मा दुनू केँ प्रकाशित करैत अछि; कारण प्रकाशित करबाक अर्थ ज्ञान उत्पन्न करब अछि, आ उत्पन्न ज्ञान जड़ भेलासँ अन्तर द्वारा अन्तर केँ मार्ग देखएबाक उपर्युक्त दोष दूर नहि कऽ सकत। पछिला ज्ञानसभो जड़ होएत; फलतः अनन्त परम्परा होएत। अतः चेतना केँ दोसरक आश्रय बिना स्वयं प्रकाशित मानब आवश्यक अछि। एना मानलापर सेहो स्वभावतः जड़ विषय आ आत्माक सम्बन्धमे अहाँकेँ की लाभ भेल? अहाँ कहि सकैत छी—लाभ ई जे हुनकर चेतना जड़ नहि अछि।

मुदा एहि कारण ई निष्कर्ष नहि निकलैत अछि जे चेतनाक कारण विषय आ आत्मो जड़ नहि छथि। पुत्र विद्वान् अछि, तँ की पिता सेहो विद्वान् भऽ जाएत? अहाँ कहि सकैत छी—स्वयंप्रकाश चेतनाक स्वभावे विषय आ आत्मासँ सम्बन्धित होएब अछि। तखन विद्वान् पुत्रक स्वभावो अपन पितासँ सम्बन्धित होएब अछि—ई समान उत्तर भेल। सम्बन्धक परिभाषा अहाँ एना कऽ सकैत छी—चेतनाक प्रकाश विषय आ आत्माक प्रकाशक संग रहैत अछि; विषय आ आत्माक प्रकाश बिना कखनो नहि रहैत अछि; एही ओकर स्वभाव अछि। तखन प्रश्न अछि—चेतना एक दिस अपन प्रकाशसँ, आ दोसर दिस विषय तथा आत्माक प्रकाशसँ भिन्न अछि की? जँ भिन्न अछि, तँ चेतना स्वयंप्रकाश नहि रहत आ विषय-आत्माक प्रकाशो नहि बनत। तखन अहाँ कहब जे चेतनाक प्रकाश आ विषय-आत्माक प्रकाश—दुनू चेतनासँ भिन्न नहि, बल्कि चेतनास्वरूपे अछि। एना कहला पर “चेतना विषय आ आत्माक संग रहैत अछि” एहि कथनसँ “चेतनाक प्रकाश विषय आ आत्माक प्रकाशक संग रहैत अछि” एतबे कहल गेल; मतमे कोनो प्रगति नहि भेल। अतः अहाँ जे सिद्ध करए चाहैत छी—स्वयं जड़ आत्मा स्वयंप्रकाश चेतनाक आश्रय अछि—ओ सिद्ध नहि होइत अछि। अतीत आ भविष्यक विषयवाला चेतनामे विषयक सहस्थिति सेहो नहि अछि, यद्यपि एखन धरि तर्कक लेल ई सहस्थिति मानल गेल। अहाँ कहि सकैत छी—ओहि विषयक त्याग, ग्रहण...

...वा उदासीनताक ज्ञान उत्पन्न होइत अछि, तँ विषयक सहस्थिति अछि। हमर उत्तर—नहि; कारण त्यागादिक ज्ञान, स्वयं विषयचेतना जकाँ, अतीत वा भविष्यक ओहि वस्तु केँ बुद्धिगम्य रूपेँ अपन विषय नहि बना सकैत अछि। त्यागादि उत्पन्न करबाक कारण त्यागादिक ज्ञानो वस्तु केँ अपन विषय बनबैत अछि; आ विषयवाला त्यागादिक ज्ञान उत्पन्न करबाक कारण विषयचेतनो ओहि विषय केँ अपन विषय बनबैत अछि—जँ एना कहल जाए, तँ हमरा सभक प्रश्न अछि—कोनो विषयक सम्बन्धमे शारीरिक क्रिया आरम्भ वा बन्द करबाक कारण प्रयत्नशील आत्मा आ देहक संयोग अछि; तखन की ओ संयोगो विषयक प्रकाश अछि? अहाँ कहब—जड़ होएबाक कारण देह-आत्माक संयोग विषयक प्रकाश नहि। तखन ई चेतना स्वयंप्रकाश होइतहुँ जुगनूक इजोत जकाँ केवल अपनासँ सम्बन्धमे प्रकाशित अछि; विषयक सम्बन्धमे ओ जड़ अछि। विद्वान् पुत्र आ पिताक दृष्टान्तसँ ई बात पहिने स्पष्ट कएल जा चुकल अछि। विज्ञानवादी जेना मानैत छथि, विषयसभ स्वयं प्रकाशस्वरूप नहि। विषय सीमित, नमहर, स्थूल आदि रूपमे अनुभूत होइत अछि; मुदा प्रकाश अपनाकेँ आन्तरिक, न स्थूल न सूक्ष्म, न छोट न नमहर रूपमे प्रकाशित करैत अछि। अतः स्वयंप्रकाश आत्मासँ भिन्न विषय निश्चित रूपेँ अनिर्वचनीय अछि—जहिना एक चन्द्रमाक संग अनुभव होएवाला दोसर चन्द्रमा। एहि प्रकाशमे स्वभावतः कोनो भेद अनुभूत नहि होइत; अतः एक आत्मासँ एकर तादात्म्यमे बाधा नहि। अनिर्वचनीय विषयसभक भेदो...

...निश्चित प्रकाशमे भेद उत्पन्न नहि कऽ सकैत अछि; नहि तँ अतिप्रसङ्ग होएत। आगाँ ईहो देखाओल जाएत जे परस्पर भेद प्रमाणज्ञानक क्षेत्रमे नहि अबैत अछि। अतः ई प्रकाश—जे

स्वयंप्रकाश, एक, अविकारी, नित्य आ निरवयव अछि—अन्तरात्मा अछि; अर्थात् ओ आत्मा जे अनिर्वचनीय देह, इन्द्रिय आदि सँ भिन्न निश्चित आत्माक ज्ञान करैत अछि। जे आत्मा अपन प्रकाश लेल दोसरपर निर्भर नहि आ निरवयव अछि, ओ ज्ञानक विषय नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। तखन देह, इन्द्रिय आदि विषयक धर्मसभक आरोप ताहिपर केना होएत? भाष्यमे “केना” शब्द आपत्तिक अर्थमे अछि—एहन अध्यास युक्तिसङ्गत नहि; यही आपत्ति अछि। ओ युक्तिसङ्गत किएक नहि? उत्तर—“प्रत्येक व्यक्ति अपन समक्ष उपस्थित एक विषयपर दोसर विषयक आरोप करैत अछि।” अभिप्राय ई अछि—जे वस्तु दोसरक आश्रयमे प्रकाशित होइत अछि आ अवयवयुक्त अछि, ओ इन्द्रियदोषक कारण अपन सामान्य स्वरूपमे ग्रहण होइतहुँ विशिष्ट स्वरूपमे नहि ग्रहण भेलासँ अपन वास्तविक स्वरूपसँ भिन्न जकाँ प्रकट होइत अछि। मुदा अन्तरात्मा अपन प्रकाश लेल दोसरपर निर्भर नहि; ओकर ज्ञान लेल कोनो इन्द्रियक आवश्यकता नहि, जाहिक दोषसँ आत्मज्ञान दोषयुक्त हो। ओकर कोनो अवयवो नहि, जाहिमे किछु भाग ग्रहण हो आ किछु नहि। एके वस्तु एकहि समय अपनहि द्वारा ग्रहणो हो आ अग्रहणो—ई सम्भव नहि। अतः आत्माक स्वयंप्रकाशताक मतमे अध्यास नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। आ जँ आत्मा कखनो प्रकाशिते नहि हो, तँ...

...अध्यास नहि भऽ सकैत अछि; कारण ओ समक्ष उपस्थित अर्थात् अपरोक्ष अनुभूत नहि अछि। जखन शुक्ति समक्ष नहि रहैत अछि, तखन “ई रजत अछि” रूपमे रजतक आरोप नहि होइत अछि। अतः पूर्ण ग्रहण आ सर्वथा अग्रहण—दुनू अवस्थामे अध्यास असम्भव सिद्ध होइत अछि। मानि लिअ। जँ चैतन्य आत्मा विषय नहि होइत, तँ ताहिपर अध्यास नहि भऽ सकितय; मुदा ओ “हम” अवधारणाक विषय अछि। तखन अध्यास किएक नहि होएत? एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार “जे सदैव ‘अहाँ’ अवधारणाक क्षेत्रसँ बाहर अछि” एहि शब्दसँ दैत छथि। जँ चैतन्य आत्मा विषय होइत, तँ विषयी ओकरासँ भिन्न होएत। मुदा वास्तविक विषयी स्वयं चैतन्य आत्मे अछि; विषय ताहिसँ भिन्न आ “अहाँ” अवधारणाक क्षेत्रमे मानल जाएत। अतः “अहाँ अवधारणाक क्षेत्रसँ बाहर” ई विशेषण आत्माक अनात्मत्व आ अनन्त परम्पराक सम्भावना दूर करबाक लेल अछि। फलतः आत्माकेँ अविषय कहब अनिवार्य अछि; आ एहि कारण ताहिपर अध्यास नहि—यही अभिप्राय अछि। भाष्यकार उत्तर दैत छथि—“उत्तर ई अछि—ई सर्वथा अविषय नहि।” किएक? “कारण ओ ‘हम’ अवधारणाक विषय अछि।” अभिप्राय ई अछि—ई सत्य जे अन्तरात्मा स्वयंप्रकाश भेलासँ विषय नहि आ निरवयव अछि; तैयो जीवभाव प्राप्त कऽ, यद्यपि वास्तवमे अनिर्वचनीय अनादि अविद्या द्वारा कल्पित बुद्धि, मन, सूक्ष्म आ स्थूल शरीर तथा इन्द्रिय आदि विशेषक धर्मसँ सीमित नहि, तथापि सीमित जकाँ प्रकट होइत अछि; अभिन्न होइतहुँ भिन्न जकाँ; अकर्ता होइतहुँ कर्ता जकाँ;...

...अभोक्ता होइतहुँ भोक्ता जकाँ; आ अविषय होइतहुँ “हम” अवधारणाक विषय जकाँ प्रकट होइत अछि। जहिना घट, कलश, पात्र आदि उपाधिक भेदसँ आकाश भिन्न-भिन्न आ विविध धर्मयुक्त जकाँ प्रकट होइत अछि। एकरस चैतन्यस्वरूप आत्मामे चैतन्यतत्त्व ग्रहण भेलापर वास्तवमे किछुओ अग्रहित नहि रहैत अछि। आनन्द, नित्यता, व्यापकता आदि ओकर चैतन्यस्वभावसँ भिन्न नहि, जाहिसँ चैतन्य ग्रहण भेलापर ई सभ अग्रहित रहि जाए। ई सभ निश्चयपूर्वक ग्रहण भेल रहितहुँ कल्पित भेदक कारण पृथक् रूपेँ विवेचित नहि जकाँ प्रकट होइत अछि, अतः अग्रहित कहल जाइत अछि। आत्मा आ बुद्धि आदिक भेदो वास्तविक नहि, जाहिसँ चैतन्य आत्माक ग्रहणक संग ओ भेदो ग्रहण भऽ जाए; कारण बुद्धि आदि अनिर्वचनीय अछि, अतः आत्मासँ हुनकर भेदो अनिर्वचनीय आ मिथ्या अछि। एहि प्रकार स्वयंप्रकाश आ असंकीर्ण चैतन्य आत्मामे बुद्धि आदि सीमाक भेद नहि बुझल जाएब आ तकर फलस्वरूप हुनकर अध्यास—एहिसँ जीवभाव उत्पन्न होइत अछि। “ई नहि” अर्थात्

अविषय चैतन्य आत्मा आ “ई” अर्थात् जड़ विषय—दुनूक स्वरूपमे सहभागी एहि जीवक “हम” अवधारणाक विषय होएब बुद्धिगम्य अछि। क्रम ई अछि—“हम” अवधारणामे चैतन्य आत्मा कर्ता आ भोक्ताक रूपमे प्रकट होइत अछि। उदासीन आत्मामे कर्म करबाक वा भोग करबाक सामर्थ्य नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। आ देह तथा इन्द्रियक कार्यसमुदाय—अर्थात् बुद्धि आदि—जाहिमे...

कर्म करबाक आ भोग करबाक सामर्थ्य अछि, ताहिमे चैतन्य नहि अछि। अतः चैतन्य आत्मा कार्यरूप देह आ करणरूप इन्द्रियसभक समुदायसँ संयुक्त भऽ कर्तृत्व आ भोक्तृत्वक सामर्थ्य प्राप्त करैत अछि। स्वयंप्रकाश होइतहुँ बुद्धि आदि विषयसभक संसर्गसँ किछु प्रकारँ “हम” अवधारणाक विषय, अहन्ताक अधिष्ठान बनैत अछि आ जीव, जन्तु अथवा क्षेत्रक ज्ञाता—क्षेत्रज्ञ—इत्यादि नामसँ कहल जाइत अछि। जीव वास्तवमे चैतन्य आत्मसँ भिन्न नहि। श्रुति कहैत अछि—“अपन स्वरूपमे ओही जीवक रूपमे...” इत्यादि। अतः जीव स्वयंप्रकाश होइतहुँ चैतन्य आत्मसँ अभिन्न भेलाक कारण “हम” अवधारणा द्वारा लोकव्यवहारमे कर्ता आ भोक्ताक रूपमे उपयुक्त बनाओल जाइत अछि; एही कारण ओ “हम” अवधारणाक अधिष्ठान कहल जाइत अछि। ई कहबो उचित नहि जे एतय अन्योन्याश्रय दोष अछि—अध्यास भेलापर जीव विषय बनैत अछि आ जीव विषय बनलापर अध्यास होइत अछि। कारण ई प्रक्रिया बीआ आ अङ्कुरक सम्बन्ध जकाँ अनादि अछि; आ परवर्ती प्रत्येक अध्यासक विषय ओहि वस्तु केँ बनबामे कोनो विरोध नहि, जे पहिलुक प्रत्येक अध्यास आ ओकर संस्कार द्वारा विषय बनाओल जा चुकल अछि। भाष्यमे “ई स्वाभाविक लोकव्यवहार” कहि ई बात पहिनहि स्पष्ट कएल गेल अछि। अतः “ई सर्वथा अविषय नहि” ई कथन पूर्णतः युक्तिसङ्गत अछि। जीव चैतन्य आत्मसँ अभिन्न आ स्वयंप्रकाश रूपमे विषय नहि होइतहुँ अपन उपाधिबद्ध रूपमे विषय अछि—यही अभिप्राय अछि।

मानि लिअ। हम एहि आधारपर अध्यासक निषेध नहि करैत छी जे जीव विषय नहि अछि, कारण ओकर प्रकाश दोसरपर निर्भर नहि; बल्कि हमर अभिमत ई अछि जे अन्तरात्मा न अपनहि सँ प्रकाशित होइत अछि, न दोसरक सहायतासँ, आ तँ विषय नहि अछि। तखन जे अन्तरात्मा कखनो प्रकाशिते नहि होइत अछि, ताहिपर अध्यास केना सम्भव? एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार दैत छथि—“अन्तरात्माक अनुभूति अपरोक्ष अछि।” “प्रथा” अन्तरात्माक साक्षात्कार अछि, कारण ओ साक्षात्कार अपरोक्ष अछि। यद्यपि अन्तरात्मामे साक्षात्कार आत्मसँ भिन्न किछु नहि, तथापि “आत्माक साक्षात्कार” एहि पदमे सूचित भेद गौण अछि—जहिना “आत्माक चैतन्य” पदमे। कथनक सार ई अछि—चैतन्य आत्मकेँ अपरोक्ष अनुभूत मानब अनिवार्य अछि; कारण ओकर अप्रकाशित रहला पर समस्त वस्तु अप्रकाशित रहि जाएत आ जगत अन्हार भऽ जाएत—ई बात पहिने कहल जा चुकल अछि। एहि अर्थक श्रुतियो अछि—“ओ प्रकाशित भेलापर सभ किछु प्रकाशित होइत अछि; ओकर इजोतसँ ई समस्त प्रकाशित अछि।”

ई वास्तविक उत्तर दऽ भाष्यकार प्रौढवादक रीति सँ चैतन्य आत्माक परोक्षता मानि दोसर उत्तर दैत छथि—“आ एहि विषयमे कोनो नियम नहि” इत्यादि। “केवल अपन समक्ष उपस्थित दोसर विषयपर”—अर्थात् केवल अपरोक्ष प्रत्यक्ष वस्तुपर—अध्यास होइत अछि, एहन नियम किएक नहि? उत्तर—“कारण प्रत्यक्ष नहि होइतहुँ आकाशपर...” इत्यादि। “हि” अव्ययक अर्थ अछि—“एहि कारण जे।” आकाश द्रव्य होइतहुँ रूप आ स्पर्शसँ रहित अछि...

उपर्युक्त स्वरूपक एहि अध्यास केँ ज्ञानी लोक अविद्या कहैत छथि; आ ताहिसँ भिन्न वस्तुक वास्तविक स्वरूपक निश्चय केँ ज्ञान कहैत छथि। एहन स्थितिमे जखन...
...तँ बाह्य इन्द्रिय द्वारा आकाशक ज्ञान नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। मनसँ सेहो ओकर ज्ञान नहि होइत अछि;

कारण इन्द्रियक सहायता बिना मन बाह्य वस्तुक सम्बन्धमे कार्य नहि करैत अछि। अतः आकाश प्रत्यक्ष नहि होइत अछि। ताहिपर “बालक”—अर्थात् विवेकज्ञानसँ रहित, दोसरक देखाओल वस्तु मात्र देखनिहार लोक—कखनो पृथ्वीक गुण नीलिमा आ कखनो अग्निगुण उज्जरता आरोपित करैत छथि; आ ओकरा नीलकमलक पङ्खुड़ी जकाँ नील वा राजहंसक पाँति जकाँ उज्जर निश्चय करैत छथि। एतयो स्मृतिरूपमे पहिने देखल इजोत वा अन्हारक धर्म प्रकट होइत अछि। एहि प्रकार ओ लोक आकाशपर “सतह”क अध्यास करैत छथि आ ओकर तुलना इन्द्रनील मणिसँ बनल विशाल उलटल कटोरा सँ करैत छथि। भाष्यकार निष्कर्ष दैत छथि—“एही प्रकार”—अर्थात् ऊपर कहल रीति सँ समस्त आपत्तिक उत्तर दऽ—“अनात्मा”, अर्थात् बुद्धि आदिक, “अन्तरात्मापर सेहो अध्यासमे कोनो विरोध नहि।”

अध्यास हजारो प्रकारक अछि; तखन आपत्ति आ उत्तरक कथन द्वारा एहि विशेष अध्यासक विस्तार किएक? केवल अध्यासक सामान्य स्वरूपक निरूपण किएक नहि? एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार दैत छथि—“उपर्युक्त स्वरूपक ई अध्यास...”

...जखन एक वस्तुक दोसरपर अध्यास होइत अछि, तखन पछिलुक वस्तुपर पहिलुक वस्तुसँ उत्पन्न गुण वा दोषक अणुमात्रो प्रभाव नहि पड़ैत अछि। आत्मा आ अनात्माक उपर्युक्त परस्पर अध्यास—जे अविद्या कहल जाइत अछि—एकरहि अनन्तर प्रमाण, प्रमाणक साधन आ ताहिसँ सम्बन्धित समस्त लौकिक व्यवहार; तथा विधि, निषेध आ मोक्षसँ सम्बन्धित समस्त शास्त्रीय उपदेश प्रवृत्त होइत अछि।

“उपर्युक्त स्वरूपक एहि अध्यास केँ ज्ञानी लोक अविद्या कहैत छथि।” श्रुति, स्मृति, इतिहास आ पुराण आदिसँ ई प्रसिद्ध अछि जे अविद्या समस्त अनर्थक बीआ अछि; आगाँ कहल जाएत जे वेदान्त एहि अविद्याक निवारण लेल प्रवृत्त होइत अछि। अन्तरात्मापर अनात्माक अध्यासे समस्त अनर्थक एकमात्र कारण अछि, शुक्तिमे रजतक भ्रम नहि। अतः एकरे अविद्या कहल जाइत अछि; कारण अपन स्वरूपक ज्ञानक अभावमे एकर नाश नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। एहि कारण सामान्य अध्यास नहि, विशेष रूपसँ एकरहि निरूपण कएल गेल अछि। “एहि स्वरूपक” शब्दसँ एकर अनर्थकारिता सूचित अछि; कारण एहन होएबाक कारणे ओ अनर्थक हेतु अछि। इच्छा आदिसँ रहित अन्तरात्मापर इच्छा आदिसँ युक्त प्रतिकूल अन्तःकरणक धर्म आरोपित कऽ ई निरदुःख अन्तरात्मा केँ दुःखी बना दैत अछि; एही कारण ई अनर्थक हेतु अछि। दोसर मतावलम्बी सेहो अध्यास केँ एही रूपमे मानैत छथि; नहि तँ एकर निरूपणक आवश्यकता नहि रहितय। तँ कहल गेल अछि—“ज्ञानी लोक मानैत छथि” इत्यादि।

आब, अनादि, दृढमूल आ घन संस्कारसँ युक्त ई अविद्या दूर नहि भऽ सकैत अछि, कारण ओकर निवारणक कोनो साधन नहि—एना माननिहारक लेल ओकर निवारणक साधन एहि प्रकार कहल गेल अछि—“आ ताहिसँ भिन्न वस्तुक स्वरूपक निश्चय”, अर्थात् वस्तुक स्वरूपक संशयरहित ज्ञान, केँ “ज्ञानी लोक ज्ञान कहैत छथि।” बुद्धि आदिसँ सर्वथा भिन्न अन्तरात्मामे, बुद्धि आदिसँ भेदक अग्रहणक कारण, बुद्धि आदिक स्वरूप आ धर्मक अध्यास होइत अछि। श्रवण—अर्थात् वेदान्ताध्ययन—मनन आदि द्वारा भेदज्ञान उत्पन्न भऽ भेदक अग्रहण दूर भेलापर जे अविद्याक बाध करैत अछि, ओ वस्तुस्वरूपक निश्चय अर्थात् चैतन्य आत्मास्वरूप ज्ञान अपन वास्तविक स्वरूपमे प्रकट होइत अछि—यही

अभिप्राय

अछि।

मानि लिअ। दृढमूल आ घन संस्कारयुक्त अविद्या ज्ञानसँ बाधित भेलापर सेहो अपन संस्कारक कारण फेर प्रकट भऽ सकैत अछि आ अपन अनुकूल फल—नवीन संस्कार आदि—उत्पन्न कऽ सकैत अछि। एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार दैत छथि—“एहन स्थितिमे”—अर्थात् वस्तुक वास्तविक स्वरूपक एहन निश्चय

उपस्थित रहला पर—“जखन एक वस्तुक दोसरपर अध्यास होइत अछि, तखन पछिलुक वस्तुपर पहिलुक वस्तुसँ उत्पन्न गुण वा दोषक अणुमात्रो प्रभाव नहि पड़ैत अछि...”

...चैतन्य आत्मापर अन्तःकरण आदिक दोष—इच्छा आदि—प्रभाव नहि दैत अछि, आ अन्तःकरण आदिपर चैतन्य आत्माक कल्याणकारी धर्म—चैतन्य, आनन्द आदि—प्रभाव नहि दैत अछि। कथनक अर्थ ई अछि—सत्यक निश्चयक पुनरावृत्तिक स्वभावे एहन अछि जे ओ अनादि आ दृढमूल घन संस्कारयुक्त भ्रमज्ञान केँ दूर करैत अछि। बुद्धिक स्वभाव सत्यक पक्षमे झुकल रहब अछि। बाहरी मतावलम्बी सेहो कहैत छथि—“भ्रमसँ अप्रभावित वस्तुक वास्तविक स्वरूपक बाध नहि होइत अछि; कारण बुद्धि प्रयत्न नहि करितहुँ ओकर पक्षमे स्वाभाविक झुकाव रखैत अछि।” विशेषतः प्रश्न ई अछि—चैतन्य आत्मास्वरूप, सर्वथा आन्तरिक आ अपरोक्ष सत्यज्ञानक बाध अनिर्वचनीय अविद्या द्वारा कतयसँ भऽ सकैत अछि? “सत्य आ असत्य केँ मिला कऽ, परस्पर विवेक नहि भेलासँ ‘हम ई छी’, ‘ई हमर अछि’ एहन लोकव्यवहार होइत अछि”—एहि कथनमे शब्दात्मक अभिधानरूप लोकव्यवहार स्पष्ट कहल गेल अछि। “इति” शब्दसँ सूचित साधारण लोकव्यवहार एहि वचनमे देखाओल गेल अछि—“आत्मा आ अनात्माक उपर्युक्त परस्पर अध्यास, जे अविद्या कहल जाइत अछि, ओकर अनन्तर...” इत्यादि। ई स्वतः स्पष्ट अछि।

फेर, प्रत्यक्ष आदि प्रमाण आ शास्त्रीय उपदेश अविद्यायुक्त व्यक्तिकेँ विषय किएक बनबैत अछि? उत्तर ई अछि—देह, इन्द्रिय आदिमे “हम” आ “हमर”क अभिमानसँ रहित व्यक्ति ज्ञाता भऽ सकैत अछि—ई बुद्धिगम्य नहि; अतः प्रमाणसभक व्यापारो बुद्धिगम्य नहि। इन्द्रियक प्रयोग बिना प्रत्यक्षादिसँ सम्बन्धित लोकव्यवहार सम्भव नहि; नियन्त्रण बिना इन्द्रियक व्यापार सम्भव नहि; आ जाहि देहपर आत्मस्वभावक अध्यास नहि अछि, तकर द्वारा कोनो कार्य कराओल नहि जा सकैत अछि। एहि सभक अभावमे असङ्ग आत्मा ज्ञाता भऽ सकैत अछि—ईहो बुद्धिगम्य नहि। ज्ञाताक अभावमे प्रमाणसभक व्यापार नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। अतः प्रत्यक्ष आदि प्रमाण आ शास्त्रीय उपदेश अविद्यायुक्त व्यक्तिकेँ विषय करैत अछि। एतय आपत्ति कएल जाइत अछि—“फेर, प्रत्यक्ष आदि प्रमाण अविद्यायुक्त व्यक्तिकेँ विषय केना करैत अछि?” विद्या अर्थात् यथार्थ ज्ञान सत्यक निश्चय अछि; तखन ज्ञानक साधन प्रमाण, जे ओहि सत्यज्ञानक उपकरण अछि, अपन आश्रय अविद्यायुक्त वस्तुमे केना पाबि सकैत अछि? प्रमाणसभक फल ज्ञान अविद्याक विरोधी अछि; अतः अविद्यायुक्त वस्तुमे हुनकर आश्रय नहि भऽ सकैत अछि—यही अभिप्राय अछि। अथवा अहाँक कथनानुसार प्रत्यक्षादि लोकव्यवहारमे प्रमाण मानल जाए; मुदा मनुष्यक हितक उपदेश देनिहार शास्त्र अविद्याक विरोधी अछि, तँ अविद्यायुक्त व्यक्तिकेँ विषय केना बनाएत? एहि कारण भाष्यकार “आ शास्त्रीय उपदेश” कहैत छथि।

उत्तर अछि—“जखन देह, इन्द्रिय आदिमे ‘हम’ आ ‘हमर’क अभिमानसँ रहित”, अर्थात् आत्माक स्वरूप आ धर्मक अध्याससँ रहित व्यक्ति “ज्ञाता भऽ सकैत अछि—ई बुद्धिगम्य नहि; प्रमाणसभक व्यापारो बुद्धिगम्य नहि।” अभिप्राय ई अछि—ज्ञाता होएबाक अर्थ ज्ञानरूप क्रियाक कर्ता होएब अछि; आ एहन कर्तृत्व ज्ञानक्रियाक सम्बन्धमे स्वतन्त्रता अछि। ई स्वतन्त्रता एहि रूपमे अछि जे ज्ञातासँ भिन्न समस्त कारणसामग्री ओकर द्वारा प्रेरित हो, मुदा ओ ताहिसभ द्वारा प्रेरित नहि हो। अतः प्रमाण अर्थात् ज्ञानक साधन केँ ज्ञाता द्वारा प्रेरित होएब आवश्यक अछि। ज्ञाताक अपन क्रिया बिना कोनो उपकरण प्रेरित नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। अविकारी, नित्य, चैतन्य आत्मा—जे परिवर्तनमे असमर्थ अछि—स्वतः क्रियाशील नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। अतः क्रियाशील बुद्धि आदिक धर्मक अध्यास द्वारा सक्रिय

बनि ओ प्रमाणसभक नियन्त्रण कऽ सकैत अछि; तँ प्रमाणसभक आश्रय अविद्यायुक्त व्यक्तिमे अछि। मानि लिअ जे प्रमाणसभ कार्य नहि करए; ताहिसँ हमर की क्षति? भाष्यकार उत्तर दैत छथि—“वास्तवमे इन्द्रिय आदिक प्रयोग बिना प्रत्यक्षादिसँ सम्बन्धित लोकव्यवहार सम्भव नहि।” “व्यवहार” शब्दक अर्थ फल अछि; प्रमाणक प्रयोग ओकर फल लेल होइत अछि। प्रमाणसभक फल...

...प्रत्यक्षादि ज्ञान एतय अभिप्रेत अछि। “इन्द्रिय” शब्दसँ इन्द्रिय मात्र नहि, अनुमानक हेतु आदि सेहो ग्रहण करबाक चाही; जहिना “दण्डी”—दण्ड धारण कएनिहार—शब्द “दण्डधारी लोक जा रहल छथि” वाक्यमे दण्डरहित लोक केँ सेहो सङ्ग्रह करैत अछि। एहि प्रकार “प्रत्यक्षादि” पदमे “आदि”क प्रयोग बुद्धिगम्य होइत अछि। “व्यवहार” पदक क्रिया कर्ताक अपेक्षा करैत अछि; अतः “व्यवहार” आ “प्रयोग बिना” दुनूक एकहि कर्ता अछि। वाक्यक अन्वय अछि—प्रयोग बिना होएवाला लोकव्यवहार। ज्ञाता प्रमाणसभक प्रयोग किएक करत? प्रमाणसभ अपनहि सँ कार्य किएक नहि करत? एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार दैत छथि—“आ इन्द्रियसभक व्यापार”, अर्थात् प्रमाणसभक व्यापार, “नियन्त्रण बिना सम्भव नहि।” कर्ता द्वारा नियन्त्रित नहि भेल उपकरण अपन विषयक सम्बन्धमे कखनो कार्य नहि करैत अछि; नहि तँ जुलाहाक नियन्त्रण बिना तुरी आदि सँ कपड़ा बनि जाएत। तखन देह स्वयं नियन्त्रक किएक नहि हो? एना मानला पर आत्माक अध्यास निरर्थक भऽ जाएत। उत्तर—“जाहि देहपर आत्मस्वभावक अध्यास नहि अछि, तकर द्वारा कोनो कार्य कराओल नहि जा सकैत अछि”; नहि तँ सुषुप्तिमे सेहो क्रिया होइत—यही अभिप्राय अछि। मानि लिअ। जहिना जुलाहा तुरी आदिपर अपन स्वभावक अध्यास नहि करितहुँ ओकरा चलाबि कपड़ाक कर्ता बनैत अछि, तहिना देह, इन्द्रिय आदिपर अपन स्वभावक अध्यास बिना ओकरा चलाबि हुनकर ज्ञाता आत्मा ज्ञाता भऽ सकैत अछि। एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार दैत छथि—“आ जखन एहि सभमे सँ कोनो नहि”—अर्थात् स्वरूप आ धर्मक परस्पर अध्यास...

...उपस्थित अछि—तखन समस्त धर्म आ अधिष्ठानसँ सभ प्रकारें आ सभ काल भिन्न “असङ्ग आत्मा ज्ञाता भऽ सकैत अछि—ई बुद्धिगम्य नहि।” जुलाहा आदि तुरी आदि केँ नियन्त्रित आ चलबैत छथि; मुदा जाहि आत्माक आत्मभाव देह आदिपर आरोपित नहि अछि, ओ असङ्ग भेलाक कारण कोनो क्रिया नहि कऽ सकैत अछि—यही अभिप्राय अछि। अतः प्रमाणसभक स्थिति अनिवार्यतः अध्यासमे अछि। तँ भाष्यकार कहैत छथि—“आ ज्ञातृत्व बिना प्रमाणसभक कोनो व्यापार नहि भऽ सकैत अछि।” जे प्रमाणफल यथार्थ ज्ञानक सम्बन्धमे स्वतन्त्र अछि, ओएह ज्ञाता बनैत अछि। यथार्थ ज्ञान जेय विषय दिस प्रवृत्त अन्तःकरणक वृत्तिविशेष अछि आ कर्तामे विद्यमान चैतन्यस्वरूप अछि। जँ चैतन्य आत्माक अध्यास जड़ अन्तःकरणपर नहि होइत, तँ जड़ अन्तःकरणक वृत्ति चैतन्यस्वरूप केना भऽ सकितय? फेर, जँ क्रियाशील अन्तःकरणक अध्यास चैतन्य आत्मापर नहि होइत, तँ एहि वृत्तिक कर्ता चैतन्य आत्मा केना भऽ सकितय? अतः परस्पर अध्याससँ यथार्थ ज्ञान नामक फल उत्पन्न होइत अछि, जे कर्तारूप चैतन्य आत्माके स्थित अछि; ओ फल उत्पन्न भेलापर ज्ञातृत्व उत्पन्न होइत अछि। ओही यथार्थ ज्ञान केँ विषय बना कऽ प्रमाणसभक व्यापार आरम्भ होइत अछि। “ज्ञातृत्व” शब्दक प्रयोगसँ यथार्थ ज्ञानो अभिप्रेत अछि। जँ प्रमाणफल यथार्थ ज्ञान नहि रहितय, तँ प्रमाणसभ सक्रिय नहि होइत; फलतः ओ प्रमाणे नहि रहितय—यही अभिप्राय अछि। अन्तमे भाष्यकार कहैत छथि—“अतएव प्रत्यक्ष आदि प्रमाण केवल अविद्यायुक्त व्यक्तिकेँ विषय करैत अछि।”

आ पशु आदिसँ कोनो भेद नहि अछि। वास्तवमे पशु आदि जखन अपन श्रवणेन्द्रिय आदि केँ शब्द आदि सँ सम्बन्धित करैत अछि, तखन जँ शब्द आदिक प्रतिकूल ज्ञान उत्पन्न होइत अछि तँ ओ ताहिसँ

हाटि जाइत अछि, आ जँ अनुकूल ज्ञान उत्पन्न होइत अछि तँ ओहि दिस बढैत अछि। हाथमे ऊपर उठाओल लाठी लेने कोनो मनुष्य केँ निकट अबैत देखि “ई हमरा मारए चाहैत अछि” एना बुझि ओ भागए लगैत अछि; मुदा ओकर हाथमे हरियर घास भरल देखि ओकरा लग चलि जाइत अछि। एही प्रकार संस्कृत बुद्धिवाला मनुष्यो हाथमे ऊपर उठाओल तरुआरि लेने उग्र आकृतिवाला बलवान पुरुषसभ केँ चिचियाइत देखि ताहिसँ दूर हटैत छथि, आ विपरीत स्वभाववाला लोकक समीप जाइत छथि। अतः मनुष्यक विषयमे प्रमाण आ प्रमेयसँ सम्बन्धित लौकिक व्यवहार पशुक व्यवहारक समान अछि। पशु आदिक विषयमे ई सुप्रसिद्ध अछि जे प्रत्यक्षादिसँ सम्बन्धित व्यवहार सदा अविवेकक अनन्तर होइत अछि। हुनकासँ समानता देखल जाएबाक कारण ई निष्कर्ष निकलैत अछि जे विद्वानक विषयमे सेहो प्रत्यक्षादिसँ सम्बन्धित व्यवहार तत्काल ओहने होइत अछि।

मानि लिअ। अज्ञानी लोकक विषयमे ई एना रहए। मुदा जे लोक श्रुति आ तदनुकूल तर्कसँ प्रतिपादित अन्तरात्माक यथार्थ स्वरूप बुझि चुकल छथि, हुनकासँ सेहो प्रमाण, प्रमाणक साधन आ ताहिसँ ज्ञात विषयसभक सम्बन्धित लौकिक व्यवहार देखल जाइत अछि; तखन प्रमाण केवल अविद्याविशिष्ट व्यक्तिकेँ विषय केना बनैत अछि? एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार दैत छथि—“आ पशु आदिसँ कोनो भेद नहि अछि।” श्रुति आ तर्कसँ भलँ ओ देह, इन्द्रिय आदिसँ भिन्न अन्तरात्मा केँ जानैत छथि, मुदा प्रमाण आ प्रमेयसँ सम्बन्धित व्यवहारमे ओ केवल प्राण धारण करनिहार प्राणीक लक्षणसँ ऊपर नहि उठैत छथि। एहन विद्वानक क्रिया सेहो पशु-पक्षीक क्रिया समान देखल जाइत अछि, जिनकर अविवेक निर्विवाद अछि। एहि समानताक कारण लौकिक व्यवहारक समय विद्वानक विषयमे सेहो अविद्याविशिष्टता अनुमानित होइत अछि। “आ” अव्यय पहिने कहल कारणसँ एहि कारण केँ जोड़ैत अछि। अभिप्राय ई अछि—उपर्युक्त तर्क आ आपत्तिक उपर्युक्त उत्तर, दुनू मिलि, प्रमाणसभक विषय अविद्याविशिष्ट व्यक्ति होइत अछि, ई सिद्ध करैत अछि। एकरहि विश्लेषण “वास्तवमे पशु...” इत्यादि द्वारा कएल गेल अछि। “जखन हुनकर श्रवणेन्द्रिय आदि शब्द आदि सँ सम्बन्धित होइत अछि” एहि वचनसँ प्रमाणरूप प्रत्यक्ष देखाओल गेल अछि। “शब्द आदिक ज्ञान” ओकर फल अछि। “जँ ओ प्रतिकूल हो” एहि वचनसँ अनुमानक फल कहल गेल अछि। पहिने शब्दक स्वरूपक ज्ञान होइत अछि, फेर ओहि प्रकारक शब्दक प्रतिकूलता स्मरण कऽ ओहि वर्गसँ सम्बन्धित प्रत्यक्ष वस्तुमे प्रतिकूलता अनुमानित कएल जाइत अछि। एकर उदाहरण अछि—“हाथमे ऊपर उठाओल लाठी लेने मनुष्य केँ अबैत देखि...” इत्यादि। शेष अर्थ स्पष्ट अछि।

मुदा शास्त्रीय उपदेशसँ सम्बन्धित व्यवहारक विषयमे स्थिति भिन्न अछि। विचारशील व्यक्ति आत्माक परलोकसँ सम्बन्ध नहि बुझने रहला धरि अपना केँ ओहि शास्त्रीय कर्मक अधिकारी नहि मानैत अछि। तथापि केवल वेदान्तसँ ज्ञात होमय योग्य, क्षुधा आदिसँ अतीत, ब्राह्मण, क्षत्रिय आदि भेदसँ रहित आ संसारगमनसँ मुक्त यथार्थ आत्मा अधिकारक लेल आवश्यक नहि अछि; कारण ओ अधिकारक कोनो उपयोगक नहि आ अधिकारक विरुद्ध अछि। आत्माक एहन स्वरूपक साक्षात्कारसँ पूर्व प्रवृत्त होमयवाला कोनो शास्त्रीय उपदेश अविद्याविशिष्ट व्यक्तिकेँ विषय बनेने बिना नहि रहैत अछि। उदाहरणतः “ब्राह्मण यज्ञ करए” एहन वाक्य आत्मापर वर्ण, आश्रम, आयु आदि भेदक अध्यासक आधारपर प्रवृत्त होइत अछि।

मानि लिअ जे प्रत्यक्ष आदि प्रमाण अविद्याविशिष्ट व्यक्तिकेँ विषय बनबैत अछि। मुदा “जे स्वर्ग चाहैत अछि, से ज्योतिष्टोम यज्ञ करए” इत्यादि उपदेश देनिहार शास्त्र देहक आत्मापर अध्यास द्वारा प्रवृत्ति केना उत्पन्न करत? एतय अधिकारी व्यक्ति ओ मानल जाइत अछि जे परलोकमे फल भोगबाक योग्य अछि। एही कारण महान् आचार्यक सूत्र अछि—“शास्त्रमे विहित कर्मक फल उपदिष्ट

व्यक्तिकेँ भैतै अछि, कारण उपदेशक स्वरूपे एहन अछि; अर्थात् शब्दप्रमाणसँ ज्ञात ‘जे स्वर्ग चाहैत अछि, से ज्योतिष्टोम यज्ञ करए’ एहन विधि ओहि व्यक्तिकेँ अपना द्वारा विहित कर्ममे प्रवृत्त करैत अछि।” भस्म भऽ जाएवाला देह आदि परलोकक फल भोगबाक योग्य नहि अछि; अतः शास्त्र देह आदिसँ भिन्न कोनो अधिकारी व्यक्ति केँ अर्थापत्तिसँ मानैत अछि। ओकर ज्ञान विद्या अछि; तखन शास्त्र अविद्याविशिष्ट व्यक्तिकेँ विषय केना बनबैत अछि? एहि आपत्ति केँ उठबैत भाष्यकार कहैत छथि—“मुदा शास्त्रीय उपदेशसँ सम्बन्धित व्यवहारक विषयमे...” इत्यादि। “मुदा” अव्यय प्रत्यक्षादिसँ सम्बन्धित लौकिक व्यवहारसँ शास्त्रीय व्यवहारक भेद देखबैत अछि। स्वर्गकाम व्यक्तिक परलोकसँ सम्बन्ध नहि मानल जाए तँ अधिकारविषयक शास्त्र प्रवृत्त नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। तँ शास्त्र केँ अर्थापत्तिसँ एतबे मानब आवश्यक अछि; ओकर संसारचक्रसँ मुक्ति सेहो नहि, कारण अधिकारक दृष्टिसँ तकर कोनो उपयोग नहि। उपनिषद्मे प्रतिपादित व्यक्ति न कर्ता अछि, न भोक्ता; अतः ओ अधिकारक प्रतिकूल अछि। जे कर्ममे प्रवृत्त होइत अछि आ कर्मजन्य फलरूप भोगक भोक्ता अछि, ओएह कर्मक अधिकारी आ ओकर स्वामी अछि। अकर्ता कर्ममे केना प्रवृत्त होएत? अभोक्ता कर्मजन्य भोगक भोक्ता केना होएत? अतः विधि-निषेधात्मक शास्त्र अनादि अविद्यासँ प्राप्त कर्तृत्व, भोक्तृत्व, ब्राह्मणत्व आदिक अभिमानवाला मनुष्यक विषयमे प्रवृत्त होइत अछि।

एही प्रकार वेदान्तो केवल अविद्याविशिष्ट व्यक्तिकेँ विषय बनबैत अछि; ज्ञाता, ज्ञान आ ज्ञेयक भेद बिना ओकर अर्थबोध सम्भव नहि। वेदान्त अविद्याविशिष्ट व्यक्ति केँ उपदेश दऽ ओकरा अपन प्रतिपादित ओहि स्वरूपमे प्रतिष्ठित करैत अछि जाहिमे समस्त अविद्या मेटि जाइत अछि। विधि-शास्त्रसँ एकर भेद ई अछि जे विधि अन्तिम प्रतिष्ठा नहि करैत अछि। अतः सिद्ध भेल जे शास्त्र केवल अविद्याविशिष्ट व्यक्तिकेँ विषय बनबैत अछि। मानि लिअ। विरोध आ अनुपयोगिताक कारण उपनिषद्मे प्रतिपादित व्यक्ति अधिकारक लेल आवश्यक नहि अछि; मुदा नियत अध्ययनक क्रममे उपनिषद्सँ ओकर ज्ञान होइत अछि आ ओ ज्ञान अधिकारक मार्गमे बाधक भऽ सकैत अछि। तखन वेदक एक भागक अर्थ दोसर भागक अर्थ केँ नष्ट करबाक कारण सम्पूर्ण वेद प्रमाणत्व गमा देत। एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार दैत छथि—“आ आत्माक एहन स्वरूपक साक्षात्कारसँ पूर्व प्रवृत्त होमयवाला कोनो शास्त्रीय उपदेश...” इत्यादि। उपनिषद्मे प्रतिपादित व्यक्तिक ज्ञान अधिकारक विरोधी अवश्य अछि; मुदा ओ ज्ञान उत्पन्न होएबाक पहिने कर्मविधि उपयुक्त लौकिक व्यवहार उत्पन्न करैत अछि, आ अखनो अनुत्पन्न ब्रह्मज्ञान ओकर बाध नहि कऽ सकैत अछि। ज्ञानविशिष्ट आ अविद्याविशिष्ट भिन्न-भिन्न व्यक्तिसँ हुनकर सम्बन्ध मानल जाए तँ दुनूक विषयक्षेत्रक भेद बुद्धिगम्य होइत अछि; अतः परस्पर बाधो नहि होइत अछि। उदाहरणतः कर्तव्यतत्त्वक दृष्टिसँ “कोनो प्राणी केँ चोट नहि पहुँचाउ” निषेध रहितहुँ “जे अपन शत्रु केँ अभिचारकर्मसँ मारए चाहए, से श्येन यज्ञ करए” एहन शास्त्रीय उपदेश “हिंसा नहि करू” सँ बाधित नहि होइत अछि। एकर कारण सम्बोधित व्यक्तिक भेद अछि। क्रोधरूपी शत्रु केँ जीतनिहार व्यक्ति निषेधक अधिकारी अछि; मुदा क्रोधरूपी शत्रुक वशमे रहल व्यक्ति श्येन आदिक उपदेशक अधिकारी अछि।

हम पहिनहि कहि चुकल छी जे अध्यास ओहि वस्तुक ज्ञान ओहि रूपमे होएब अछि जाहि रूपमे ओ वास्तवमे नहि अछि। पुत्र, पत्नी आदि स्वस्थ वा अस्वस्थ भेलापर मनुष्य बाह्य वस्तुक धर्म अपनपर आरोपित कऽ कहैत अछि—“हम स्वयं स्वस्थ छी” अथवा “हम स्वयं अस्वस्थ छी।” एही प्रकार देहक धर्मक अध्याससँ कहैत अछि—“हम मोट छी”, “हम दुबल छी”, “हम गोरा छी”, “हम ठाढ़ छी”, “हम जाइत छी”, “हम कुदैत छी।” इन्द्रियक धर्मक अध्याससँ कहैत अछि—“हम गूँग छी”,

“हम एकनयन छी”, “हम नपुंसक छी”, “हम बहिर छी”, “हम अन्तर छी।” एही प्रकार इच्छा, सङ्कल्प, संशय, निश्चय आदि अन्तःकरणक धर्म सेहो अपनपर आरोपित करैत अछि। एहि प्रकार अपन समस्त क्रियाक साक्षी अन्तरात्मापर “हम” अवधारणाक वाच्य अन्तःकरणक अध्यास कऽ, फेर उलटा दिशासँ सर्वसाक्षी अन्तरात्मा केँ अन्तःकरण आदिपर आरोपित करैत अछि।

“सम्बोधित व्यक्तिक भेदक कारण”—एहि उत्तरक अर्थ ऊपर स्पष्ट कएल गेल अछि। “एहि प्रकार” वचनसँ शास्त्रक विषय अविद्याविशिष्ट व्यक्ति होएबाक बात फेर स्पष्ट होइत अछि। वर्णक अध्यास—“राजा राजसूय यज्ञ करए” इत्यादि; आश्रमक अध्यास—“गृहस्थ समान वर्णवाली स्त्रीसँ विवाह करए” इत्यादि; आयुक अध्यास—“जकर केश कृष्ण अछि, से अग्निसेवा करए” इत्यादि; अवस्थाक अध्यास—“जकर रोग असाध्य अछि, से जलमे प्रवेश कऽ प्राणत्याग करए” इत्यादि। “आदि” पद वर्णसंकर, अनधिकार वा अशुद्धि उत्पन्न करनिहार महापातक, उपपातक आ एहि प्रकारक अन्य अध्याससभ केँ सङ्ग्रह करैत अछि। एहि प्रकार आपत्ति आ उत्तर द्वारा आत्मा आ अनात्माक परस्पर अध्यासक निरूपण कऽ, प्रमाण आ प्रमेयक विवेचनसँ ओकर पुष्टि कऽ, भाष्यकार ओकर पहिने कहल स्वरूप केँ फेर स्मरण करबैत छथि, जाहिसँ ओकर अनर्थक कारण होएबाक बातक विस्तारसँ विवेचन कएल जा सकए—“हम पहिनिहि कहि चुकल छी जे अध्यास...”

“अध्यास ओहि वस्तुक ज्ञान ओहि रूपमे होएब अछि जाहि रूपमे ओ नहि अछि”—ई पहिने कहल “पहिने देखल वस्तुक स्मृतिसदृश रूपमे अन्यत्र प्रकट होएब”क संक्षिप्त कथन अछि। एतय केवल अधिष्ठानक स्वरूपरूप “हम”क अध्यास, धर्मरूप “हमर”क अध्यास उत्पन्न नहि करए धरि, अनर्थक कारण नहि बनि सकैत अछि। अतः धर्मक अध्यास—“हमर”क भाव—संसारचक्रक समस्त अनर्थक प्रत्यक्ष कारण अछि। एकर विस्तार “पुत्र, पत्नी आदि...” वचनसँ कएल गेल अछि। आत्मापर देहक तादात्म्य आरोपित कऽ, फेर ओहि देहपर पुत्र, पत्नी आदिक स्वामित्वधर्म आरोपित कऽ मनुष्य, मोटाइ आदि देहधर्मक अध्यास जकाँ, कहैत अछि—“हम स्वयं स्वस्थ छी” अथवा “हम स्वयं अस्वस्थ छी।” सम्पत्ति पूर्ण रहला पर स्वामित्व पूर्ण होइत अछि आ स्वामी अपना केँ पूर्ण मानैत अछि; सम्पत्तिक अभावमे स्वामित्व अपूर्ण होइत अछि आ स्वामी अपना केँ अपूर्ण मानैत अछि। स्वामित्वक माध्यमसँ देहपर लगनिहार स्वास्थ्य-अस्वास्थ्य जकाँ बाह्य धर्मसभ केँ मनुष्य आत्मापर आरोपित करैत अछि—यही अभिप्राय अछि। बाह्य उपाधिकेँ आश्रित स्वामित्व जकाँ देहधर्मक विषयमे जखन ई स्थिति अछि, तखन बाह्य उपाधिपर निर्भर नहि रहनिहार दुबराइ आदि देहधर्मक विषयमे कहबाक की आवश्यकता? एही कारण भाष्यकार कहैत छथि—“एही प्रकार देहक धर्म...” इत्यादि।

देहसँ अधिक अन्तरङ्ग इन्द्रियसभपर आत्मस्वभावक अध्यास कएल गेल अछि; ताहि इन्द्रियक बहिरापन आदि धर्म केँ मनुष्य आत्मापर आरोपित करैत अछि। ताहूसँ अधिक अन्तरङ्ग अन्तःकरणपर आत्मस्वभावक अध्यास कएल गेल अछि; ताहि अन्तःकरणक इच्छा, सङ्कल्प आदि धर्मो आत्मापर आरोपित करैत अछि—वाक्यक अन्वय ई अछि। एहि निरूपणमे धर्मक अध्यास कहला पश्चात् भाष्यकार ओकर आधार—अधिष्ठानक अध्यास—कहैत छथि—“एहि प्रकार ‘हम’ अवधारणाक वाच्य केँ आरोपित कऽ...” इत्यादि। जाहिमे “हम”रूप वृत्ति उत्पन्न होइत अछि, अर्थात् अन्तःकरण, ओ “हम” अवधारणाक वाच्य अछि। ओ अन्तःकरण अन्तरात्मापर आरोपित होइत अछि; अन्तरात्मा अपन चैतन्य आ उदासीनताक कारण अन्तःकरणक समस्त वृत्तिक साक्षी अछि। एहि प्रकार कर्तृत्व आ भोक्तृत्वक व्याख्या भऽ गेल। चैतन्यक व्याख्या “उलटा दिशासँ” एहि वचनसँ होइत अछि—अन्तःकरण आदि जड़ अछि, तकर विपरीत चैतन्य अछि;

ओहि चैतन्य द्वारा, अर्थात् एहि प्रकार, “सर्वसाक्षी अन्तरात्मा केँ अन्तःकरण आदिपर आरोपित करैत अछि।” एतय अभिप्राय ई अछि—अन्तःकरण आदिसँ परिच्छिन्न, “ई” आ “ई नहि” दुनूक मिश्रणरूप चैतन्य जीव अछि; ओ कर्ता, भोक्ता, कार्यरूप आ कारणरूप दुनू प्रकारक अविद्याक आश्रय, अहन्ताक अधिष्ठान, संसारी, समस्त दुःखसमूहक पात्र आ परस्पर अध्यासक उपादान कारण अछि। तकर उपादान कारण फेर अध्यासे अछि। अतः बीआ आ अङ्कुरक समान ई प्रक्रिया अनादि अछि आ एतय अन्योन्याश्रय दोष नहि अछि।

एहि प्रकार भ्रमज्ञानस्वरूप, कर्तृत्व, भोक्तृत्व आदि उत्पन्न करनिहार ई अनादि, अनन्त आ स्वाभाविक अध्यास समस्त लोक केँ प्रत्यक्ष अनुभूत अछि। एहि अनर्थक कारणक निवारण आ आत्मैकत्वज्ञानक प्राप्तिक लेल सम्पूर्ण वेदान्त आरम्भ होइत अछि। सम्पूर्ण वेदान्तक तात्पर्य ई केना अछि, से हम एहि शारीरकमीमांसामे देखाएब।

प्रमाण आ प्रमेयक विवेचनसँ अध्यासक पुष्टि कएलाक बाद शिष्यक हित लेल भाष्यकार ओकर स्वरूप फेर कहि ओकरा आर दृढ़ करैत छथि, कारण समस्त लोक ओकर अनुभव करैत अछि—“एहि प्रकार ई अनादि आ अनन्त...” इत्यादि। “अनन्त”क अर्थ अछि—यथार्थ ज्ञानक अभावमे जकर नाश नहि होइत अछि। ओकर अनादित्व आ अनन्तत्वक कारण “स्वाभाविक” कहल गेल अछि। “भ्रमज्ञानस्वरूप”—भ्रमज्ञानक स्वरूप अनिर्वचनीयता अछि; एतय जाहिमे ओ स्वरूप अछि तकर उल्लेख कएल गेल अछि, अर्थात् अध्यास अनिर्वचनीय अछि। “उलटा दिशासँ”क व्याख्या द्वारा ईहो स्पष्ट भेल जे अन्तःकरण आदि जड़ अछि आ तकर विपरीत चैतन्य अछि; ओहि चैतन्य द्वारा अन्तरात्मा केँ अन्तःकरण आदिपर आरोपित कएल जाइत अछि। भाष्यकार विषयक उपसंहार करैत छथि—“एहि अनर्थक कारणक निवारण लेल...” इत्यादि। विरोधी ज्ञानक अभावमे एकर निवारण कतयसँ होएत? उत्तर—“आत्मैकत्वज्ञानक प्राप्तिक लेल।” “प्राप्ति”क अर्थ उपलब्धि अछि; ई उद्देश्य मात्र मन्त्र-जप वा कर्मक अनुष्ठान नहि। आत्माक एकत्व आनन्दस्वरूप रहैत समस्त विश्वसँ पूर्ण असङ्गता अछि। एहि उपलब्धि केँ निःसन्देह उत्पन्न करनिहार वेदान्त अध्यास केँ जड़िसँ नष्ट करैत अछि। अभिप्राय ई अछि—जँ आत्मविषयक “हम” अवधारणा यथार्थ होइत, तँ आत्मा पहिनहि ज्ञात आ ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा निष्फल भेलाक कारण ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा नहि उठितय। ओहि इच्छाक अभावमे ब्रह्मज्ञानक लेल वेदान्तक अध्ययन नहि होइत, केवल अनभिप्रेत रूपमे मन्त्र-जपक उपयोग भऽ रहितय। तखन उपनिषद्क आत्मविषयक अवधारणा प्रमाणत्व प्राप्त नहि करितय। बारम्बार दोहराओल गेल एहन अप्रमाण अवधारणा आत्माक वास्तविक कर्तृत्व, भोक्तृत्व आदि केँ दूर करबामे समर्थ नहि होइत। वस्तुतः यथार्थ ज्ञान आरोपित रूप केँ दूर करैत अछि, वास्तविक स्वरूप केँ नहि।

आ असत्य ज्ञान द्वारा वास्तविक स्वरूपक निवारण नहि होइत अछि। रस्सीक रस्सीस्वरूप केँ सर्पक हजारो बेर निरन्तर ज्ञान सेहो बाधित नहि कऽ सकैत अछि। मुदा भ्रान्त ज्ञानसँ उत्पन्न रूप यथार्थ ज्ञान द्वारा बाधित होइत अछि; आ भ्रान्त ज्ञानक संस्कार बहुत दृढ़ होइतहुँ, एकाग्रतापूर्वक, अविच्छिन्न रूपेँ आ दीर्घकाल धरि कएल यथार्थ ज्ञानक पुनरावृत्तिसँ उत्पन्न संस्कार द्वारा नष्ट होइत अछि।

मानि लिअ। वेदान्तमे प्राण आदि उपासनाक उपदेश सेहो बहुत ठाम देखल जाइत अछि। तखन समस्त वेदान्त-वाक्यक एकमात्र तात्पर्य आत्माक एकत्वक प्रतिपादन केना भऽ सकैत अछि? एकर उत्तर भाष्यकार “सम्पूर्ण वेदान्तक तात्पर्य एहीमे अछि” इत्यादि वचनसँ दैत छथि। शरीर केँ स्वयं

शारीरक कहल जाइत अछि; ताहिमे रहनिहार शारीरक अर्थात् जीवात्मा अछि। एतय ओहि विचारक उल्लेख अछि जकर प्रयोजन “तत्त्वमसि” वाक्यक “त्वम्” पदसँ सूचित आत्माक स्वरूप “तत्” पदसँ सूचित परमात्माक स्वरूपे होएब देखाएब अछि।

एतय अभिप्रेत बातक सार ई अछि—(१) अपन वेद-शाखाक अध्ययनक विधि सम्पूर्ण वेद केँ ओकर अर्थक फलदायक बोध धरि पहुँचयबाक लेल अध्ययन करबाक आदेश दैत अछि; अतः “अपन वेद-शाखा” पदसँ सूचित कर्मविधि आ निषेधसभ जकाँ वेदान्तो अपन अर्थक फलदायक ज्ञान उत्पन्न करबाक लेल अध्ययनक विषय होइत अछि। (२) “वाक्यक अर्थ सामान्य व्यवहारक अर्थसँ पृथक नहि होइत अछि” एहि न्यायक अनुसार वेदान्तक बोधक शक्ति मन्त्रसभ जकाँ सर्वत्र मान्य अछि। (३) वेदान्तसँ विश्वसँ असम्बद्ध, चैतन्य आ आनन्दक एकरस राशि, कर्तृत्व आ भोक्तृत्वसँ मुक्त एक अन्तरात्माक ज्ञान होइत अछि; तथापि ई वेदान्त “हम” अवधारणासँ टकराइत अछि—ओ “हम” अवधारणा जे संशयरहित आ अबाधित बुझाइत अछि तथा आत्मा केँ कर्तृत्व, भोक्तृत्व, दुःख, शोक आ मोहसँ युक्त रूपमे ग्रहण करैत अछि। ताहि कारण वेदान्त अपन प्रत्यक्ष वाच्यार्थसँ हटि केवल लाक्षणिक अर्थ देत अथवा मन्त्र-जपक साधन मात्र रहत; तखन ओकर घोषित करबाक लेल अभिप्रेत अर्थसँ भिन्न अर्थ होएत। अतः ओकर अर्थक विचार लेल आरम्भ होमयवाली चार अध्यायवाली शारीरकमीमांसा आरम्भ करबाक आवश्यकता नहि रहत।

सभ मनुष्यक “हम” अनुभवमे प्रत्यक्ष आत्मा संशयास्पद नहि अछि, आ ओकर ज्ञानसँ कोनो फलो नहि—एना मानल जाए तँ ओकरा जानबाक इच्छा सँ कोनो विचार आरम्भ नहि होएत। ई पूर्वपक्ष अछि। सिद्धान्त ई अछि—जँ “हम” अवधारणा यथार्थ होइत तँ उपर्युक्त आपत्ति उचित रहित। मुदा ई अवधारणा शास्त्रीय वचनसभक बाध नहि कऽ सकैत अछि; शास्त्र आ समस्त आचार्य-सम्प्रदाय सेहो एकरा यथार्थ नहि मानैत अछि। अतः ई आरोपित अछि। वेदान्तक अभिप्राय घोषित अर्थसँ भिन्न वा लाक्षणिक नहि, बल्कि मुख्य अर्थ अछि। केवल अन्तरात्मा ओकर प्रधान विषय अछि। ताहि अन्तरात्माक विषयमे संशय सेहो अछि आ ज्ञानक फल सेहो; अतः ओकरा जानबाक इच्छा उचित अछि। एही दृष्टिसँ सूत्रकार जानबाक इच्छा केँ सूत्ररूपमे कहैत छथि—“अतः आब ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा।”

जाहि वेदान्त-विचारशास्त्रक व्याख्या करबाक प्रस्ताव अछि, ताहि शास्त्रक ई पहिल सूत्र अछि—

अतः आब ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा

“जानबाक इच्छा” पदसँ भाष्यकार संशय आ फल—दुनूक अस्तित्व सूचित करैत छथि। एतय ब्रह्मज्ञान केँ स्पष्ट रूपेँ फल कहल गेल अछि, कारण ओ प्रत्यक्षतः इच्छाक विषय अछि। कर्मज्ञानक बाद होमयवाला अनुष्ठान आ तकर परिणाम जकाँ ब्रह्मज्ञानक बाद कोनो दोसर वस्तु मुख्य फल नहि अछि। समस्त संशयसँ मुक्त ब्रह्मज्ञान स्वयं परम फल अछि; ओ समस्त दुःखक अन्त आ एकरस आनन्दस्वरूप अछि। वेदान्त द्वारा प्रतिपादित एहि ज्ञानक विषय ब्रह्ममीमांसा नामक तर्कपद्धतिसँ जानल जाइत अछि। दक्ष विचारक एहि लक्ष्यक प्राप्ति केँ लेल अधिक निश्चयपूर्वक प्रवृत्त होइत छथि। यद्यपि ओ लक्ष्य पहिनहिसँ प्राप्त अछि, तथापि अनादि अविद्याक कारण अप्राप्त जकाँ प्रतीत होइत अछि आ इच्छाक विषय बनैत अछि। जहिना अपनहि गरदनमे पड़ल हार केँ नहि देखिकऽ मनुष्य ओकरा अनुपस्थित मानैत अछि, आ दोसरक देखाएलापर ओकरा प्राप्त करैत अछि—यद्यपि हार पहिनहिसँ प्राप्त छल—तहिना ब्रह्मज्ञानक प्राप्ति होइत अछि।

एहि सूत्रमे “अथ” शब्दक अर्थ “तत्काल अनन्तर” मानल गेल अछि, “आरम्भ कएल जाएब” नहि; कारण ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा स्वयं आरम्भ कराओल वस्तु नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। जानबाक इच्छा संशयसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि, अतः ओ संशय केँ अपन कारणरूपमे सूचित करैत अछि। संशय विचारक आरम्भ केँ सार्थक बनबैत अछि। दक्ष विचारक केँ एहि शास्त्रीय विचारमे प्रवृत्त करनिहार कारण—संशय आ फल—दुनू केँ सूचित करबाक कारण सूत्र केँ शास्त्रक आरम्भे राखब उचित अछि। एही कारण पूज्य भाष्यकार कहैत छथि—“जाहि वेदान्त-विचारशास्त्रक व्याख्या करबाक प्रस्ताव अछि, ताहि शास्त्रक ई पहिल सूत्र अछि।” “मीमांसा” शब्द आदरयोग्य विचारक बोध करबैत अछि। ई विचार आदरयोग्य अछि, कारण एकर फल अत्यन्त सूक्ष्म अर्थक निश्चय अछि, जे परम पुरुषार्थक कारण बनैत अछि। “मीमांसाशास्त्र” ओ शास्त्र अछि जे एहि विचारक उपदेश दैत अछि; एकरा “शास्त्र” एहि कारण कहल गेल अछि जे ताहि द्वारा शिष्यसभ केँ ई विचार सिखाओल अथवा यथार्थ रूपेँ व्याख्यायित कएल जाइत अछि। सूत्र ओहि वचन केँ कहल जाइत अछि जे अल्प अक्षर आ अल्प शब्दमे रचल होइतहुँ बहुत अर्थ सूचित करैत अछि आ सारपूर्ण होइत अछि। सूत्रक तात्पर्य एहि प्रकार बुझाएलाक बाद भाष्यकार पहिल शब्द “अथ”क व्याख्या करैत छथि—“एतय ‘अथ’ शब्द तत्काल अनन्तरक अर्थमे ग्रहण कएल गेल अछि।” सूत्रक पदसभमे आएल “अथ” शब्द तत्काल अनन्तरक अर्थ दैत अछि—ई अन्वय अछि।

“मङ्गल”क अर्थक वाक्यार्थसँ कोनो व्याकरणिक सम्बन्ध नहि अछि। वास्तवमे “अथ” शब्द दोसर अर्थमे प्रयुक्त भेलापर अपन मात्र ध्वनिसँ मङ्गल उत्पन्न कऽ सकैत अछि। पूर्ववर्ती विषयक निर्देश परिणामतः तत्काल अनन्तरसँ भिन्न नहि होइत अछि। जखन “तत्काल अनन्तर” अर्थ मानल जाइत अछि, तखन जहिना धर्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा अपन वेदक अध्ययनरूप पूर्ववर्ती क्रियासँ अनिवार्य रूपेँ जुड़ल अछि, तहिना ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक लेल सेहो कोनो पूर्ववर्ती कारण अवश्य मानब पड़त। अपन वेद-शाखाक अध्ययनक तत्काल अनन्तरता धर्मजिज्ञासा आ ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा—दुनू लेल समान अछि।

आब प्रश्न उठैत अछि—“अथ” शब्द “आरम्भ”क अर्थमे सेहो देखल जाइत अछि; उदाहरणार्थ वेदमे “अथातोऽयं ज्योतिष्टोमः”—अर्थात् आब ई ज्योतिष्टोम आरम्भ होइत अछि—आ लौकिक व्यवहारमे “अथ शब्दानुशासनम्” अथवा “अथ योगानुशासनम्”—अर्थात् आब शब्दशास्त्र अथवा योगशास्त्र आरम्भ होइत अछि। तखन एतय “अथ” केँ आरम्भक अर्थमे किएक नहि बुझल जाए? उत्तर—“आरम्भक अर्थ नहि।” किएक? “कारण ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा आरम्भ कएल जाएब योग्य वस्तु नहि अछि।” एहि सूत्रक शब्द-विन्यासमे “जानबाक इच्छा” ब्रह्म अथवा ब्रह्मज्ञानसँ अधिक प्रधान रूपमे प्रकट होइत अछि। “दण्डधारी अनुमति आ प्रत्युत्तरक पाठ करैत अछि” एहि वाक्यमे दण्ड गौण होइतहुँ अभिप्रेत अछि; एही प्रकार एतहुँ ब्रह्म आ ब्रह्मज्ञान गौण होइतहुँ अभिप्रेत भऽ सकैत अछि—एना कहल नहि जा सकैत अछि। कारण एतय “जानबाक इच्छा” संशय आ फल सूचित कऽ ब्रह्मविचाररूप शास्त्रीय प्रवृत्तिक सहायक अछि। जँ ब्रह्म आ ब्रह्मज्ञान अभिप्रेत नहि होइत, तँ संशय आ फलो अभिप्रेत नहि होइत; फलतः विवेकी विचारक बाणक दाँतक परीक्षा जकाँ निरर्थक वस्तुमे जिज्ञासा नहि करितथि। तखन ब्रह्म आ ब्रह्मज्ञान शास्त्रक विषय आ फल नहि भऽ सकितय। “हम” अवधारणासँ विपरीत विषयपर अध्यासक अभावमे वेदान्तक प्रमाणत्वो बुद्धिगम्य नहि रहितय। कर्ममे प्रवृत्ति कराबयवाला लाक्षणिक अर्थ वा “हुम्” अक्षर जकाँ मन्त्र-जपमे उपयोगी अर्थ अपन वेद-शाखाक अध्ययन-विधिपर निर्भर रहितहुँ सम्भव अछि। अतः शब्द आ सम्पूर्ण वाक्य—दुनू द्वारा संशय आ फल सूचित करनिहार “जानबाक इच्छा”क प्रधानता अभिप्रेत अछि।

“जिज्ञासा” शब्द केँ “आरम्भ कएल जाएब”क अर्थमे सेहो नहि बुझल जा सकैत अछि, जाहिसँ ओकर समीप रहनिहार “अथ” शब्दो आरम्भ सूचित करए; कारण प्रत्येक प्रकरणमे जिज्ञासाक आरम्भमे विवेच्य विषय नहि अछि। जानबाक इच्छा केँ विशेषित करनिहार ब्रह्मज्ञान केँ आरम्भ कएल जाएब योग्य मानल जा सकैत अछि; मुदा ओहो “अथ” शब्दसँ सम्बद्ध नहि होइत, कारण ब्रह्मज्ञान एतय प्रधान नहि अछि। जानबाक इच्छा आ विचार एकहि वस्तु नहि, जाहिसँ योगशास्त्रक आरम्भ जकाँ विचारक आरम्भ मानल जाए। “मीमांसा” शब्द “मान्” धातुसँ विचारक अर्थमे निष्पन्न अछि, मुदा “जिज्ञासा” शब्दक अर्थ “जानबाक इच्छा” अछि। जानबाक इच्छा मनुष्य केँ विचारमे प्रवृत्त करैत अछि। प्रवृत्त करनिहार आ जाहिमे प्रवृत्ति होइत अछि, दुनू एक नहि भऽ सकैत; एकहि वस्तु मानलापर प्रेरक आ प्रेरितक सम्बन्ध बुद्धिगम्य नहि होएत। जखन शब्दक अपन अर्थ उचित अछि, तखन दोसर अर्थ कल्पित करब सेहो अनुचित विस्तार होएत। अतः ई कथन उचित अछि—“कारण ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा आरम्भ कएल जाएब योग्य वस्तु नहि अछि।”

आब “अथ” शब्दक अर्थ मङ्गल किएक नहि मानल जाए? तखन सूत्रक अर्थ होएत—मङ्गल उत्पन्न करबाक कारण ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा प्रतिदिन करबाक चाही। उत्तर अछि—“मङ्गल”क अर्थक वाक्यार्थसँ कोनो व्याकरणिक सम्बन्ध नहि अछि। शब्दक ओही अर्थ वाक्यार्थक अङ्ग बनैत अछि जकर वाक्यार्थसँ व्याकरणिक सम्बन्ध हो; ओ अर्थ स्पष्ट रूपेँ कहल अथवा निहित होइत अछि। एतय मङ्गल “अथ” शब्दक न स्पष्ट आ न निहित अर्थ अछि; ओ तऽ शब्दक मात्र ध्वनि सुनलासँ उत्पन्न परिणाम अछि, जहिना मृदङ्ग अथवा शङ्खक ध्वनि सुनलासँ होइत अछि। शब्द-प्रयोगमे शब्दक ध्वनिसँ उत्पन्न वा स्मरण कराओल परिणामक वाक्यार्थसँ व्याकरणिक सम्बन्ध नहि देखल जाइत अछि। आपत्ति—एतय आ अन्यत्र प्रयुक्त “अथ” शब्द मङ्गल सूचित करैत अछि; स्मृतियो कहैत अछि—“ॐ आ अथ—ई दुइ शब्द ब्रह्माक कण्ठसँ पहिने प्रकट भेल; अतः दुनू मङ्गलकारी अछि।” उत्तर—“अथ” शब्द दोसर अर्थमे प्रयुक्त भेलापर मात्र ध्वनिसँ मङ्गल उत्पन्न करैत अछि। तत्काल अनन्तर आदि अर्थमे प्रयुक्त “अथ” सेहो अपन ध्वनिमात्रसँ, बाँसुरी वा वीणाक ध्वनि जकाँ

अथवा दोसर प्रयोजन लेल आनल जलपूर्ण कलशक दर्शन जकाँ, मङ्गल उत्पन्न करैत अछि। अतः स्मृतिक वचनसँ कोनो विरोध नहि। तत्काल अनन्तरक अर्थ रहितहुँ केवल ध्वनि सुनलासँ मङ्गलार्थ प्राप्त भऽ जाइत अछि—ई अभिप्राय अछि।

मानि लिअ। “अथ” शब्द तत्काल अनन्तरक अर्थ नहि दैतहुँ कोनो पूर्ववर्ती कारणपर निर्भर भऽ सकैत अछि। ई बात एना बुझू—“अथ” शब्द तत्काल अनन्तरक अर्थमे प्रयुक्त अछि अथवा आरम्भक अर्थमे? प्रश्नवाक्यमे प्रयुक्त “अथ” पहिल विकल्प कहला पश्चात् दोसर विकल्प प्रस्तुत करैत अछि। एतय दोसर बेर आएल “अथ”क अर्थ “तत्काल अनन्तर” नहि, कारण पूर्वपक्षक कथन पहिल “अथ” आ दोसर “अथ”क बीचमे अछि। तथापि ओ पहिने कहल विषयपर निर्भर अछि; जँ निर्भरता नहि होइत, तँ प्रश्नक विषय पहिल विषयसँ भिन्न भऽ जाइत आ विकल्परचना असम्भव होइत। केओ एना प्रश्न नहि करैत अछि—“आत्मा नित्य अछि अथवा बुद्धि अनित्य अछि?” अतः “तत्काल अनन्तर”क अर्थ नहियो मानल जाए, तखन “अथ” शब्द पूर्ववर्ती विषयपर निर्भर किएक नहि होएत?

उत्तर अछि—“पूर्ववर्ती विषयक निर्देश परिणामतः तत्काल अनन्तरसँ भिन्न नहि होइत अछि।” अभिप्राय ई अछि—हम “तत्काल अनन्तर” अर्थक आग्रह केवल शीघ्रताक लेल नहि करैत छी; हमर उद्देश्य एहन पूर्ववर्ती कारण निश्चित करब अछि जे ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक कारण बनए। “अथ” शब्द केँ पूर्ववर्ती विषयपर निर्भर मानलापर सेहो जखन एहि अर्थक सिद्धि भऽ जाइत अछि, तखन तत्काल अनन्तर अर्थ निश्चित करबाक आग्रह निष्फल बुझाएत। “परिणामतः” शब्दसँ एही बातक संकेत अछि। मुदा वास्तवमे ई दोसर मत अछि जे “अथ” पूर्ववर्ती विषयपर निर्भर अछि। एतय कोनो स्पष्ट विकल्प नहि देल गेल अछि; अतः अन्य अर्थसभ हटि गेलापर “तत्काल अनन्तर” मात्र शेष रहैत अछि—एही मत उचित अछि।

मानि लिअ जे “तत्काल अनन्तर” अर्थ अछि; मुदा ताहिसँ की सिद्ध होइत अछि? उत्तर—“जखन अर्थ ‘तत्काल अनन्तर’ हो...” तत्काल अनन्तरता कोनो निश्चित वस्तुक अनन्तरता होएबाक चाही; केवल एना कहब पर्याप्त नहि। मनुष्य किछु कएलाक बाद अनिवार्यतः किछु दोसर करैत अछि; मुदा केवल अनन्तरता सँ न प्रत्यक्ष लाभ देखल जाइत अछि, न अदृष्ट लाभ। अतः एहन वस्तुक तत्काल अनन्तरता बतएबाक चाही जकर अभावमे ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा उत्पन्न नहि हो, आ जकर उपस्थितिमे ओ निश्चय उत्पन्न हो। एहि बात केँ एहि वचनसँ कहल गेल अछि—“एहन किछु पूर्ववर्ती वस्तु, जाहिसँ ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा अनिवार्य रूपेँ सम्बन्धित अछि।”

मानि लिअ। धर्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा जकाँ ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा सेहो अपन वेद-शाखाक अध्ययनक तत्काल बाद होइत अछि; कारण धर्म जकाँ ब्रह्म केवल शास्त्रसँ जानल जाइत अछि। शास्त्र ज्ञात नहि भेलापर ओकर अपन विषय—धर्म आ ब्रह्म—क ज्ञान उत्पन्न नहि होइत; आ “मनुष्य अपन वेद-शाखाक अध्ययन करए” एहि अध्ययन-विधिक कारण शास्त्रक बोध अनिवार्य रूपेँ होइत अछि। अतः ब्रह्मजिज्ञासाक विषयमे सेहो “अथ” शब्दक अर्थ केवल वेदाध्ययनक तत्काल अनन्तरता अछि। भाष्यकार कहैत छथि—“अपन वेदक अध्ययनक तत्काल अनन्तरता धर्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा आ ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा—दुनू लेल समान अछि।” एतय “अपन वेद” वचनसँ वेदक विषय अभिप्रेत अछि, आ ताहि विषयक अध्ययन निहित रूपेँ बुझल जाइत अछि। ई अनन्तरता पहिल सूत्र “अथातो धर्मजिज्ञासा” सँ सेहो निष्पन्न होइत अछि। वर्तमान सूत्र केँ अलगसँ आरम्भ करबाक आवश्यकता नहि रहितय; कारण ओहि सूत्रमे प्रयुक्त “धर्म” शब्द सम्पूर्ण वेदक अर्थ केँ सूचित करैत अछि, आ ब्रह्मो धर्म जकाँ वेदक अर्थ अछि। अतः वेदाध्ययनक तत्काल अनन्तरता दुनू पर समान रूपेँ लागू होइत

अछि—ई अभिप्राय अछि। आब आपत्ति उठैत अछि—“धर्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक अपेक्षामे ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक एतय विशिष्टता की अछि?” उत्तर देल जाइत अछि—“कर्मज्ञानक ठीक तत्काल अनन्तरता।” नहि; कारण धर्म केँ जानबाक इच्छासँ पहिनेहुँ वेदान्तक अध्ययन कएने व्यक्तिये ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा सम्भव अछि। हृदय-ग्रन्थि छेदन आदिक प्रसङ्गमे तत्काल अनन्तरताक नियम अवश्य अछि, कारण ओतय क्रमक प्रतिपादन अभिप्रेत अछि; मुदा एतय ताहि प्रकारक क्रम प्रतिपादित करब अभिप्रेत नहि अछि। धर्मजिज्ञासा आ ब्रह्मजिज्ञासाक बीच न तऽ गौण-प्रधान सम्बन्धक कोनो प्रमाण अछि, न पहिनेसँ अधिकारी व्यक्तिक फेर अधिकार-सम्बन्धक।

“धर्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक अपेक्षामे ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक विशिष्टता कर्मज्ञानक ठीक तत्काल बाद होएब अछि”—एकर अभिप्राय ई अछि। “यज्ञ द्वारा जानबाक इच्छा करैत छथि” इत्यादि वचनमे तृतीया-विभक्तिक स्पष्ट प्रयोगसँ यज्ञादि केँ ब्रह्मज्ञानक सहायक रूपमे जोड़ल गेल अछि। कारण इच्छाक मुख्य विषय केवल ज्ञान अछि; जे वस्तु मुख्य नहि अछि, ओकर सम्बन्ध मुख्य वस्तुसँ स्थापित करब पड़ैत अछि। मुदा एतयो यज्ञादि वाक्यार्थज्ञानक उत्पत्तिक सहायक नहि अछि, कारण वाक्य स्वयं ओ ज्ञान उत्पन्न करैत अछि। ईहो युक्तिसंगत नहि जे वाक्य केँ कर्मक सहायताक आवश्यकता हो। जे व्यक्ति शब्द आ ओकर अर्थक सम्बन्ध जानैत अछि, ध्वनि-प्रयोग केँ नियन्त्रित करनिहार सिद्धान्तक वास्तविक स्वरूप बुझैत अछि, वस्तुसभक गौण-प्रधान आ पूर्व-उत्तर सम्बन्ध तथा आकाङ्क्षा, सन्निधि आ योग्यताक आवश्यकतासभ स्मरण रखैत अछि, ओ कोनो कर्म नहि कएलहुँ वाक्यार्थक ज्ञान निर्बाध रूपेँ प्राप्त करैत अछि। जँ ई ज्ञान उत्पन्न नहि होइत, तँ विधि आ निषेध-वाक्यक अर्थक ज्ञानो नहि होइत; फलतः ओहि वाक्यसभक अर्थरूप अनुष्ठान आ निवृत्ति विफल भऽ जाइत। जँ हुनकर ज्ञानसँ अनुष्ठान आ निवृत्ति उत्पन्न मानल जाए, तँ परस्परश्रय दोष होएत—ज्ञान रहला पर वाक्यार्थक अनुष्ठान आ निवृत्ति होइत अछि, आ ओहि अनुष्ठान-निवृत्तिसँ फेर तकर ज्ञान। ईहो नहि मानल जा सकैत अछि जे केवल वेदान्त-वाक्य अपन अर्थ बुझयबाक लेल कर्मपर निर्भर अछि, आन वाक्य नहि; कारण एहि भेदक कोनो विशेष कारण नहि अछि।

आब जे लोकक बुद्धि आरम्भमे अशुद्ध अछि, ओ “तत्त्वमसि” वाक्य द्वारा “त्वम्” पदसँ सूचित कर्ता-भोक्ता-स्वरूप जीव आ “तत्” पदसँ सूचित नित्यशुद्ध, चैतन्यमय आ असङ्ग परमात्माक अभेदक प्रामाण्य तुरन्त नहि बुझि सकैत अछि; कारण दुनू पदक वाक्यार्थमे अयोग्यता निश्चित बुझाइत अछि। मुदा यज्ञ, दान, तपस्या, उपवास आदिसँ जकर अन्तःकरणक मल क्षीण भऽ गेल अछि आ जे श्रद्धायुक्त अछि, ओ “तत्” आ “त्वम्”क योग्यता बुझि दुनूक अभेद जानत। जँ ई कहल जाए, तँ पूछब—प्रमाज्ञानक कारणभूत योग्यताक निश्चय की स्वयं अप्रमाण कर्मसँ होइत अछि, अथवा प्रत्यक्ष आदिक अतिरिक्त कर्मो प्रमाण अछि? जँ वेदान्त-अविरोधी आ वेदान्ताधारित तर्कसँ योग्यताक निश्चय होइत अछि, तँ कर्मक आवश्यकता नहि। अतः “तत्त्वमसि” आदिक श्रवणसँ जीवक स्वरूप परमात्मास्वरूप अछि—ई ज्ञान प्राप्त कऽ, आ ओहि ज्ञान केँ तदनुकूल तर्कसँ दृढ़ कऽ, तखन दीर्घकाल धरि अविच्छिन्न रूपेँ ओहि सत्यक भावना अर्थात् निदिध्यासन कएलासँ ब्रह्मक साक्षात्कार होइत अछि; यज्ञादि एहि निदिध्यासनमे सहायक होइत अछि। जेना कहल गेल अछि—“दीर्घकाल धरि, निरन्तर आ सत्कारपूर्वक अभ्यास कएल चित्तानुशासन दृढ़ आधार पबैत अछि।” ब्रह्मचर्य, तपस्या, श्रद्धा, यज्ञ आदि सत्कार अछि। एही हेतु शास्त्र कहैत अछि—“ओहि एक केँ जानि विद्वान ब्राह्मण प्रज्ञाक अभ्यास करए।” शब्द-प्रमाण आ तर्कसँ जानलाक बाद निदिध्यासनमे प्रवृत्त होएब चाही।

एतय किछु लोकक मत अछि जे यज्ञादि मोक्षक शत्रु अन्तःकरणक मल नष्ट करैत अछि, एतबे ओकर उपयोगिता अछि। दोसरक मत अछि जे ओ साधक व्यक्तिक शुद्धि करैत अछि। यज्ञादिसँ शुद्ध

व्यक्ति भक्तिपूर्वक आ दीर्घकाल धरि अविच्छिन्न ब्रह्मभावना कऽ अनादि अविद्याक समस्त संस्कार मूलसँ उखाड़ि दैत अछि; फलतः अन्तरात्मा निर्मल, शुद्ध आ प्रकाशमय होइत अछि। एही हेतु स्मृति कहैत अछि—“ब्रह्मयज्ञ, देवयज्ञ, पितृयज्ञ आदि महायज्ञ आ यज्ञसभ द्वारा मनुष्य ब्रह्मप्राप्तिक योग्यता उत्पन्न करैत अछि”; आ “जकर ई अड़तालीस शुद्धिकारक संस्कार सम्पन्न भेल अछि।” आनो लोक कहैत छथि जे तीन ऋण चुकाबयबाक माध्यमसँ कर्म ब्रह्मज्ञानक उपकार करैत अछि। स्मृतिमे कहल अछि—“तीन ऋण चुकाए मनुष्य मोक्षमे चित लगबाए।” आन लोकक मत अछि जे विभिन्न कर्म अपन-अपन फल लेल विधिकृत रहितहुँ “ब्राह्मण वेदाध्ययन, यज्ञ आदि द्वारा ओकरा जानबाक इच्छा करैत छथि” एहन वचनक कारण संयोग-पृथक्त्व सम्बन्धसँ ब्रह्मभावनाक सहायक होइत अछि। जहिना खदिर-काष्ठ यूपरूपेँ यज्ञक प्रयोजन साधैत समय यजमानक वीर्य सेहो उत्पन्न करैत अछि; कारण नियम अछि—“एक वस्तु दू प्रयोजन साधए तँ सम्बन्ध संयोग-पृथक्त्व कहल जाइत अछि।”

एही हेतु महान ऋषि बादरायणक सूत्र सेहो अछि—“यज्ञादिक शास्त्रीय वचनक कारण ब्रह्मभावनामे सभक आवश्यकता अछि, जहिना अश्वक प्रसङ्गमे।” एतय “सभ” शब्द यज्ञ, दान, तपस्या आदि सूचित करैत अछि; ब्रह्मभावनाक लेल एहि सभक आवश्यकता अछि—ई अर्थ। अतः प्रमाण शास्त्र हो वा महर्षिक सूत्र, सभ स्थितिमे यज्ञादिसँ संयुक्त आ भक्ति, दीर्घकालीनता आ अविच्छिन्नता—एहि तीन गुणसँ सम्पन्न ब्रह्मभावनाए अनादि अविद्या आ ओकर संस्कार नष्ट कऽ ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार, अर्थात् मोक्ष, उत्पन्न करबामे समर्थ होइत अछि। एही प्रयोजनसँ कर्मक अनुष्ठान आवश्यक अछि। मुदा कर्मसभक अनेक भेद, तिनकर दृष्ट आ अदृष्ट फल, ताहिसँ सम्बन्धित वस्तुसभक समवायी वा दूरस्थ कारणरूप सम्बन्ध, प्रत्यक्ष उपदिष्ट अथवा अतिदेशसँ प्राप्त अङ्ग, क्रमपर्यन्त समस्त सहायक अङ्ग, आ विभिन्न कर्म लेल विभिन्न अधिकारी व्यक्तिक ज्ञान बिना एहि कर्मसभक अनुष्ठान सम्भव नहि। धर्ममीमांसाक समीक्षात्मक अध्ययन बिना ई ज्ञान नहि होइत अछि। अतः उचिते कहल गेल अछि—“विशिष्टता कर्मज्ञानक ठीक तत्काल अनन्तरता अछि।”

वास्तवमे कर्मज्ञानक कारणे ब्रह्मभावनामे कर्मक सहयोग प्राप्त होइत अछि। भाष्यकार एहि मतक खण्डन करैत छथि—“नहि।” किएक नहि? कारण “कर्मज्ञानसँ पहिनहियो अपन वेदक अध्ययन कएने व्यक्तिमे ब्रह्म कै जानबाक इच्छा सम्भव अछि।”

एहि कथनक अन्तर्निहित आशय ई अछि—कहल जाइत अछि जे ब्रह्मभावना अर्थात् निदिध्यासनक लेल कर्म आवश्यक अछि। प्रश्न अछि—कर्म कोन प्रकारेँ आवश्यक अछि? की ओ फल उत्पन्न करबाक लेल आवश्यक अछि, जहिना आग्नेय आदि कर्ममे अन्तिम अदृष्ट फल उत्पन्न करबाक हेतु समिद् आदि अङ्गक आवश्यकता होइत अछि? अथवा कर्म अपन अस्तित्वक हेतु आवश्यक अछि, जहिना द्विधा काटल पुरोडाश आ अग्नि देवताक आवश्यकता होइत अछि? फलोत्पत्तिक हेतु कर्म आवश्यक मानब जाँचमे टिकैत नहि। ब्रह्मभावना ब्रह्मस्वरूपक साक्षात्कार उत्पन्न करैत अछि—ई मानए पड़त। मुदा ई साक्षात्कार आटाक गोला सानलासँ बनल पिण्ड जकाँ कोनो उत्पाद्य वस्तु नहि; धान कुटलासँ चाउर जकाँ कोनो विकार नहि; छिड़कावसँ ओखली आदिक शुद्धि जकाँ कोनो संस्कार नहि; आ दूध दुहिलासँ प्राप्त दूध जकाँ कोनो प्राप्य वस्तु नहि। पहिल बात—ई उत्पाद्य नहि अछि। ब्रह्मभावनासँ उत्पन्न ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार घटादिक इन्द्रियजन्य ज्ञान जकाँ घटादिसँ भिन्न जड़ वस्तु नहि अछि। ब्रह्म स्वयं आन प्रकाशपर निर्भर भऽ प्रकाशित नहि होइत; ओकर साक्षात्कार ओकर अपन नित्य स्वरूपे अछि, तँ ओकर उत्पत्ति बुद्धिगम्य नहि।

भावनासँ उत्पन्न भिन्न प्रकारक कोनो अनुभूति कल्पित विचार जकाँ संशययुक्त होएत, आ तँ प्रमाणिक नहि भऽ सकत; कारण भावनाक सहायतासँ उत्पन्न एहन विचार प्रायः चञ्चल देखल जाइत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, अत्यन्त जाइसँ जकर देह सुन्न भऽ गेल अछि, ओ अनुमानसँ जानल अग्नि क भावना करैत-करैत विशाल ज्वालायुक्त अग्नि अनुभव करए, तँ ई अनुभव आन प्रमाणिक ज्ञानसँ मेल नहि खाइत; कारण संसारमे एहने अनुभवक विपरीत परिणाम व्यापक रूपेँ देखल जाइत अछि। अतः यथार्थ साक्षात्कारक विशेषता एहि प्रक्रियासँ उत्पन्न नहि होइत, आ भावनासँ कोनो फल उत्पन्न करबाक हेतु कर्मक आवश्यकता नहि। अपरिवर्तनशील, नित्य आ सर्वव्यापक ब्रह्ममे भावनासँ न विकार, न शुद्धि, न प्राप्ति सम्भव अछि।

मानि लिअ जे ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार उत्पन्न नहि होइत, मुदा द्विविध अनिर्वचनीय अविद्याक आवरण हटबासँ शुद्धि होइत अछि। जहिना परदासँ झाँपल नर्तकीक परदा मंचकर्मी उठा दैत अछि आ ओ दर्शकक प्रत्यक्ष विषय बनि जाइत अछि, तहिना कर्मक उपयोग आवरण हटेबामे हो। मुदा अन्तर एतेक अछि—परदा उठलापर नर्तकी दर्शकक प्रत्यक्ष विषय बनैत अछि; एतय केवल अविद्याक आवरणक निवृत्तिये उत्पन्न होइत अछि, आन किछु नहि, कारण ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार उत्पन्न नहि भऽ सकैत अछि; ब्रह्मक स्वरूप नित्य अछि। एतय प्रश्न उठैत अछि—“ब्रह्मभावना की अछि?” की शब्दप्रमाणसँ जे किछु बुझल गेल, ओकर क्रमिक पुनरावृत्ति? अथवा प्रमाणिक शब्दसँ प्राप्त असन्दिग्ध ज्ञानसभक निरन्तर क्रम? जँ शब्दप्रमाणसँ बुझल वस्तुक पुनरावृत्ति हो, तँ बारम्बार अभ्यासो मूल अविद्या नहि हटा सकत। सत्यक निश्चय आ ओकर निरन्तर पुनरावृत्तिये त्रुटि आ ओकर संस्कार मूलसँ नष्ट करैत अछि; संशयक पुनरावृत्ति अथवा केवल सामान्य ज्ञानक पुनरावृत्ति नहि। “खम्भा अथवा मनुष्य” वा “कोनो लम्बा विशाल पदार्थ” एहि ज्ञान केँ सौ बेर दोहराएलहुँ, विशेष ज्ञानक अभावमे ई निश्चय नहि होएत जे ओ मनुष्ये अछि।

आब कहल गेल अछि जे श्रवणजन्य ज्ञानसँ जीवक वास्तविक स्वरूप परमात्मारूप बुझल गेलाक बाद मननजन्य ज्ञानसँ ओकर पुष्टि होइत अछि। अतः विधिवत् शब्दप्रमाणपर आधारित असन्दिग्ध ज्ञानसभक निरन्तर क्रमक भावना, कर्मक सहायतासँ, द्विविध अविद्याक विनाशक कारण बनैत अछि। मुदा ई विनाश ब्रह्मानुभव उत्पन्न किए बिना सम्भव नहि। अपरोक्ष अनुभवस्वरूप भ्रान्तिक निवृत्ति केवल अपरोक्ष यथार्थ ज्ञानसँ होइत अछि, परोक्ष निरूपणसँ नहि। दिशाभ्रम, अग्निचक्र, चलैत वृक्ष आ मृगतृष्णाक जल—ई सभ अपन-अपन यथार्थ प्रत्यक्ष ज्ञानसँ हटैत अछि; केवल शब्दप्रमाण, अनुमान आदि द्वारा दिशादिक निश्चयसँ दिशाभ्रम दूर नहि होइत। तँ अपेक्षित ज्ञान ई अछि—“त्वम्” पदक वाच्य वास्तवमे “तत्” पदक वाच्यस्वरूप अछि। एही प्रकारेँ, आन कोनो उपायसँ नहि, दुःख-शोक आदिसँ ग्रस्त “त्वम्” पदवाच्य जीवक अनुभव निवृत्त होइत अछि।

ई साक्षात्कार केवल शब्दप्रमाणसँ उत्पन्न नहि होइत, चाहे ओकर सङ्गमे विचार रहए; ओ प्रत्यक्षसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि, कारण साक्षात्कार प्रत्यक्षक अनिवार्य फल अछि। अन्यथा काटल कुटज-बीजसँ बरगदक अंकुर निकलि सकैत—एहन असम्भव निष्कर्ष मानए पड़त। अतः ई उचित अछि जे महावाक्यसभक असन्दिग्ध अर्थक भावना द्वारा संस्कृत अन्तःकरण, तुरन्त अनुभूत “त्वम्” पदवाच्य जीवक उपाधियुक्त रूपसभक निषेध कऽ ओकर “तत्” पदवाच्य ब्रह्मरूप स्वरूप प्रकट करैत अछि। ई अनुभव ब्रह्मक उत्पत्ति नहि, कारण ब्रह्म उत्पन्न वस्तु नहि; ई स्वयं अन्तःकरणक ब्रह्मविषयक विशेष वृत्ति अछि। ताहिसँ ब्रह्म आन प्रकाशसँ प्रकाशित नहि होइत। शब्दप्रमाण ब्रह्म केँ प्रकाशित करैत अछि, मुदा ब्रह्म अनात्मा जकाँ परप्रकाश्य नहि भऽ जाइत। जे समस्त उपाधिसँ मुक्त अछि, ओ

स्वयंप्रकाश चैतन्य कहल जाइत अछि; उपाधियुक्त वस्तु नहि। भाष्यकार स्वयं कहैत छथि—“ई अनिवार्य रूपेँ अविषय नहि अछि।”

ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कारक समयो उपाधिसँ पूर्ण मुक्ति नहि अछि; कारण अन्तःकरण-वृत्ति स्वयं उपाधि अछि, जे अपन आ अन्य उपाधिसभक विनाशक सीमापर स्थित अछि। जँ अन्तःकरण-वृत्ति चैतन्यसँ उपाधिरूपेँ सम्बद्ध नहि होइत, तँ जड़ वृत्तिक स्वयंप्रकाशत्व बुद्धिगम्य नहि होइत; कारण ओतय चैतन्यक प्रतिबिम्ब नहि रहित, आ वृत्ति ज्ञान उत्पन्न नहि कऽ सकित। ईहो अमान्य नहि जे अनुमानित विचार अथवा अनुमानित अग्निक ध्यानसँ अग्निक अनुभव होइत अछि; कारण ओतय अग्निक स्वरूप परोक्ष अछि, जखन एतय उपाधिसँ मलिन जीवक, जकर स्वरूप ब्रह्म अछि, प्रारम्भसँ अपरोक्ष अनुभव विद्यमान अछि। शुद्धता, चैतन्यता आदि गुण वास्तवमे जीवसँ बाहर नहि छथि; ओ जीवसँ भिन्न नहि। उपाधिमुक्त जीव स्वयं शुद्धता, चैतन्यता आदिस्वरूप ब्रह्म कहल जाइत अछि। उपाधिसँ मुक्ति सेहो जीवसँ भिन्न कोनो आन वस्तु नहि।

जेना संगीतशास्त्रक बारम्बार अभ्याससँ उत्पन्न संस्कारक सहायतासँ श्रवणेन्द्रिय विभिन्न आरोह-अवरोहमे षड्ज आदि भिन्न स्वर प्रत्यक्ष अनुभव करैत अछि, तहिना वेदान्त-वाक्यक अर्थक पुनरावृत्तिसँ उत्पन्न संस्कारसहित अन्तःकरण द्वारा जीव अपन ब्रह्मस्वरूपक प्रत्यक्ष अनुभव करैत अछि। जँ कहल जाए जे अन्तःकरण-वृत्ति अर्थात् ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार उत्पन्न करबाक लेल कर्मक सहयोग चाही, तँ उत्तर नहि अछि; कारण भावनाक सङ्ग कर्मक सहअस्तित्व नहि। जे व्यक्ति “तत्त्वमसि” आदि वाक्यसँ निःसन्देह बुझैत अछि जे ओ देहसँ भिन्न, शुद्ध, चैतन्यमय, असङ्ग, अकर्ता आ अभोक्ता आत्मा अछि, ओ अपन लेल कर्मक अधिकार केना बुझैत? जे एहन अधिकार बुझैत अछि, ओ कर्ता वा अधिकारी केना भऽ सकैत अछि?

कहल जा सकैत अछि—सत्य निश्चय भऽ गेलहुँ भ्रान्तिजन्य व्यवहार चलैत रहैत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, चीनी मीठ अछि ई निश्चय रहितहुँ, पित्तदोषग्रस्त मनुष्य केँ ओ तीत अनुभव होइत अछि; ओ चीनी खिखे थूक दैत अछि आ छोड़ि दैत अछि। तँ अविद्याक संस्कार रहबाक कारण कर्मानुष्ठान चलैत रहैत अछि, आ कर्म ज्ञानक सहायक भऽ ओ संस्कार नष्ट करैत अछि—एना मानब उचित अछि। मुदा प्रश्न अछि—“अविद्यास्वरूप कर्म स्वयं अविद्या केँ केना नष्ट करत? आ ओकर विनाशक कर्मक विनाश कोनसँ होएत?” अनेक वस्तु स्वयं केँ आ अपनहि वर्गक आन वस्तु केँ नष्ट करैत देखल जाइत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, गायक दूध स्वयं पचैत अछि आ आन दूध पचबैत अछि; विष स्वयं नष्ट होइत अछि आ आन विषक निवारण करैत अछि; गँदला पानिमे डालल निर्मलीक धूरा स्वयं पानिसहित तलमे बैसि जाइत अछि आ पानि साफ करैत अछि। तहिना अविद्यारूप कर्म आन अविद्या केँ हटा कऽ स्वयं निवृत्त भऽ जाइत अछि।

एहि उत्तरमे कहल गेल अछि—ई सत्य अछि जे “आरम्भमे केवल अस्तित्व छल, हे प्रिय” सँ शुरू भऽ “तत्त्वमसि” पर समाप्त होमयवाला वाक्यसभक पुनः-पुनः श्रवण, ब्रह्मजिज्ञासाक सहायतासँ, देहादिसँ भिन्न अन्तरात्माक विषयमे निःसन्देह यथार्थ ज्ञान उत्पन्न करैत अछि; ई अन्तरात्मा भौतिक देहादिक कारण नहि, बल्कि अनादि अविद्ये ओकर उपादान कारण अछि। तइयो अविद्याक संस्कार बनल रहबाक कारण संसारगमनक धारणा आ तदनुकूल लौकिक व्यवहार चलैत रहैत अछि। मुदा ज्ञानी एहि व्यवहार आ धारणासभ केँ मिथ्या बुझैत अछि, आ तिनका पर विश्वास नहि करैत; जहिना पित्तदोषग्रस्त व्यक्ति चीनी तीत लगितहुँ ओहि तीततापर विश्वास नहि करैत।

एहि प्रकार, कर्म, कर्ता, साधन, विधि आ फल—ई समस्त वस्तु अवास्तविक अछि—ई निश्चित जाननिहार व्यक्ति कर्मक अधिकारी केना होएत? जे एहि सभ केँ यथार्थ मानैत अछि, ओएह अधिकारी होइत अछि। अन्यथा पशु, बालक आदिक अधिकार रोकब कठिन होएत। कर्म-विधि सम्बन्धी प्रकरणमे कर्म, कर्ता आदि भेदक जाननिहार व्यक्ति ज्ञानी कहल जाइत अछि। एही कारण पूज्य भाष्यकार शास्त्रीय उपदेश केँ अविद्यायुक्त व्यक्तिक विषय बतबैत छथि। तँ जहिना राजसूयक अनुष्ठान केवल राजवर्गक अपनपन माननिहार व्यक्ति करैत अछि, ब्राह्मण अथवा वैश्य अपनपन माननिहार व्यक्ति नहि; तहिना द्विजत्व, कर्तृत्व, कर्म, साधन आदिक भेदबुद्धियुक्त व्यक्तिये कर्मक अधिकारी होइत अछि। जकर एहि भेदसभक धारणा नहि, ओकर अधिकार नहि। ब्राह्मण वा क्षत्रिय द्वारा कएल वाजपेय यज्ञ जकाँ, अनधिकारी व्यक्ति कुशल आ फल भोगबामे समर्थ रहितहुँ वैदिक कर्मक फल नहि पबैत अछि। अतः प्रत्यक्ष फलवाला कर्ममे सामर्थ्य आ कर्मारम्भ रहला पर फल प्राप्ति देखल जाइत अछि; मुदा अदृष्ट फलवाला कर्ममे फल केवल शास्त्रीय उपदेशसँ ज्ञात होइत अछि, तँ अनधिकारी व्यक्तिपर ओकर प्रयोग नहि। एही कारण निदिध्यासनमे कर्मक आवश्यकता नहि।

मानि लिअ। जेना विहित कर्मक अधिकारी होएबाक लेल “हम मनुष्य छी” एहन धारणा आवश्यक अछि, तहिना निषेधक विषयमे सेहो अधिकारी ओएह अछि जकरा ई धारणा अछि। जकरा मनुष्य होएबाक धारणा नहि, ओकर निषेधमे अधिकार नहि; पशु आदि जकाँ। फलतः एहन व्यक्ति निषिद्ध आचरण कएलासँ अधम पशुसँ बेसी पापी नहि होएत; एहिसँ शास्त्रक उल्लङ्घन होएत। उत्तर—नहि। वर्तमान जीवनमे साक्षात्कार प्राप्त व्यक्ति “हम मनुष्य छी” एहि भावसँ पूर्णतः मुक्त नहि; अविद्याक संस्कार रहबाक कारण ओकर सूक्ष्म अंश बनल रहैत अछि। तथापि जे किछु मिथ्या रूपेँ चलैत अछि, ताहिपर ओकर यथार्थ विश्वास नहि होइत। मुदा ताहिसँ की निष्कर्ष? निष्कर्ष ई अछि—विधिपर श्रद्धा रखनिहार व्यक्ति अधिकारी अछि; श्रद्धाहीन नहि। अतः मनुष्यत्वादिक भावपर विश्वास नहि रखनिहार व्यक्ति विधिशास्त्रक अधिकारी नहि। स्मृति सेहो कहैत अछि—“श्रद्धाविहीन आहुति अथवा दान...”। निषेधात्मक शास्त्र केँ श्रद्धाक आवश्यकता नहि; ओ निषिद्ध कर्ममे प्रवृत्त मनुष्यक विषयमे स्वतः प्रवृत्त होइत अछि।

तँ ब्रह्मक सत्यस्वरूप जानलाक बादो, जँ व्यक्ति संसार-बन्धनमे पड़ल मनुष्य जकाँ निषेध उल्लङ्घन करैत अछि, तँ ओ पाप अर्जित करैत अछि। अतः शास्त्र-विरोधी आचरण स्वीकार करनिहार कोनो मत मान्य नहि। एहि कारण फलोत्पत्तिक लेल निदिध्यासनमे कर्म आवश्यक नहि। निदिध्यासनक उत्पत्तिक लेलो कर्म आवश्यक नहि; कारण शब्दप्रमाणसँ निःसन्देह ज्ञान उत्पन्न भेलाक बाद कर्मक अधिकार नहि रहैत। शास्त्र कहैत अछि—“न कर्मसँ, न सन्तानसँ, न धनसँ, केवल त्यागसँ अमृतत्व प्राप्त होइत अछि।”

तखन की एतय कर्मक कोनो उपयोगे नहि? एना हो तँ “यज्ञ द्वारा ओ जानबाक इच्छा करैत छथि” एहन वचन असत्य भऽ जाएत। उत्तर—नहि। यज्ञादि कर्म दूरस्थ सहायक अछि। बात ई अछि—वेदाध्ययन द्वारा ब्राह्मण ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा करैत छथि, अर्थात् जानबाक इच्छा उत्पन्न करैत छथि, ज्ञान स्वयं नहि। यद्यपि इच्छा अपेक्षाकृत गौण अछि आ ज्ञान प्रधान, मुदा शब्दरूपमे धात्वर्थ गौण आ प्रत्ययार्थ इच्छा प्रधान होइत अछि; क्रिया प्रधान वस्तुसँ सम्बन्धित होइत अछि। “राजाक मनुष्य केँ आनू” कहला पर राजाकेँ नहि, बल्कि “मनुष्य” पदक विशेष्य व्यक्तिकेँ आनल जाइत अछि। यद्यपि राजा वस्तुतः प्रधान छथि, शब्दमे “मनुष्य” पदक विशेषण मात्र छथि; पदमे प्रधान वस्तु मनुष्ये अछि। एहि प्रकार यज्ञ आ वेदाध्ययन केँ ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक साधनरूपमे विधान कएल गेल अछि। उपवासरूप तपस्याक सेहो एही प्रकार विधान अछि।

अन्न नहि खाएब मात्र तपस्या नहि। उचित समय आ इच्छानुसार शुद्ध, हितकर, संयमित भोजन करैत जकरामे ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा उत्पन्न होइत अछि, ओ तपस्वी अछि; पूर्ण उपवास करैत व्यक्ति नहि, कारण ओ मरि जाएत। चान्द्रायण आदि व्रत-उपवासो तपस्याक वास्तविक स्वरूप नहि; कारण एहन व्यक्तिक दोष-साम्य भङ्ग भऽ सकैत अछि। नित्य-नैमित्तिक कर्म पाप क्षीण कऽ साधक केँ शुद्ध करैत अछि। शास्त्र कहैत अछि—आत्मयाजी ओ छथि जे बुझैत छथि, “एहि कर्मसँ हमर ई शरीर शुद्ध होइत अछि, एहि कर्मसँ हमर शरीर पोषित होइत अछि।” एतय “एहि कर्मसँ” पद यज्ञादिकेँ सूचित करैत अछि। स्मृतियो कहैत अछि—“जकर ई अड़तालीस शुद्धिकारक संस्कार सम्पन्न भेल अछि।” अथर्ववेदक वचन सेहो देखबैत अछि जे नित्य, नैमित्तिक आ काम्य कर्मक अनुष्ठान द्वारा पापक्षय भेलापर, जकर बुद्धि शुद्ध भेल आ जकरामे जिज्ञासा उत्पन्न भेल, ओ व्यक्ति ध्यान द्वारा ब्रह्म केँ देखैत अछि—“शुद्ध बुद्धिवाला मनुष्य ध्यान द्वारा ब्रह्म केँ देखैत अछि।” स्मृतियो कहैत अछि—“पापक क्षय भेलापर ज्ञान उत्पन्न होइत अछि।”

“कर्म” इत्यादि। ई निश्चित अछि जे नित्यकर्म पहिनेसँ अर्जित पाप नष्ट कऽ मनुष्य केँ शुद्ध करैत अछि। एहि प्रकार ज्ञानोत्पत्तिमे नित्यकर्मक गौण सहायकता स्पष्ट भऽ गेलापर संयोग-पृथक्त्वक सिद्धान्तसँ ओकर प्रत्यक्ष सहायकता कल्पित करब उचित नहि, कारण ताहिसँ अनावश्यक अनेक कल्पना करए पड़त। बात ई अछि—नित्यकर्मक अनुष्ठानसँ पुण्य उत्पन्न होइत अछि। संसार स्वभावतः अनित्य, अशुद्ध आ दुःखमय अछि, मुदा नित्यत्व, शुद्धता, सुख आदिक भ्रान्त ज्ञान सत्त्व अर्थात् बुद्धि केँ मलिन करैत अछि; एहि मलिनताक कारण पाप अछि। पापक क्षय भेलापर प्रत्यक्ष आ तर्कक द्वार खुलि जाइत अछि, आ मनुष्य प्रत्यक्ष तथा अनुमान द्वारा संसारक अनित्यता, अशुद्धता आ दुःखमयता निर्बाध रूपेँ जानैत अछि। ताहिसँ संसारप्रति अनासक्तिरूप वैराग्य उत्पन्न होइत अछि; ताहिसँ संसार हटेबाक इच्छा जागैत अछि; ताहिसँ ओकर निवृत्तिक साधनक खोज होइत अछि। आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूपक ज्ञान ओहि निवृत्तिक साधन अछि—ई सुनि मनुष्य ओकरा जानबाक इच्छा करैत अछि; तखन श्रवण, अध्ययन आदि क्रमसँ ओकर ज्ञान प्राप्त करैत अछि। अतः बुद्धिरूप सत्त्वक शुद्धि द्वारा ज्ञानोत्पत्तिमे कर्म दूरस्थ सहायक अछि—ई युक्तिसंगत अछि। भगवद्गीतामे सेहो एही अर्थक पुनरुक्ति अछि—“योग प्राप्त करबाक इच्छुक मुनिक लेल कर्म कारण कहल गेल अछि; योगारूढ़क लेल शम कारण कहल गेल अछि।”

एना रहला पर, जे व्यक्ति एहि जन्ममे कर्म नहि करितहुँ पूर्वजन्ममे कएल कर्मक कारण शुद्ध बुद्धिवाला अछि, आ संसारक सारहीनता बुझलासँ जकरामे वैराग्य उत्पन्न भऽ गेल अछि, ओकरा वैराग्य उत्पन्न करबाक लेल कर्मानुष्ठानक आवश्यकता नहि। कारण वैराग्य तकरा पूर्वजन्मक कर्मसँ पहिनहिसँ प्राप्त अछि। एही सन्दर्भमे शास्त्र श्रेष्ठ मनुष्यक विषयमे कहैत अछि—“अथवा छात्रावस्थासँ सेहो सीधे संन्यास ग्रहण करए।” एतय “कर्मज्ञानसँ पहिनहियो वेदान्त पढ़ने व्यक्तिमे ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा सम्भव अछि”—ई कहल गेल अछि। अतः छात्राश्रममे रहनिहार व्यक्तिक एहन कोनो ऋण नहि, जकर परिशोधन लेल ओकरा कर्म करए पड़ए। एही अनुरूप “ब्राह्मण तीन ऋणक संग जन्म लैत अछि” ई वचन गृहस्थ बननिहार व्यक्तिक विषयमे बुझबाक चाही। अन्यथा “अथवा छात्राश्रमसँ सीधे संन्यास ग्रहण करए” ई शास्त्रवचन विरोधी भऽ जाएत। गृहस्थो द्वारा ऋण-परिशोधन केवल बुद्धिशुद्धिक लेल होइत अछि। वृद्धावस्थामे मृत्यु, देहक भस्म होएब आ अन्त्येष्टि सम्बन्धी विधान कर्मानुष्ठानमे दृढ़ आ आत्माक सत्यस्वरूप नहि जाननिहार अज्ञानी व्यक्तिक विषयमे अछि; ज्ञानीक विषयमे नहि। अतः “अथ” शब्द ओहि वस्तुक ठीक अनन्तरता सूचित करैत अछि, जकर अभावमे ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा उत्पन्न नहि होइत, आ जकर उपस्थितिमे ओ इच्छा अवश्य उत्पन्न होइत अछि।

कर्मज्ञान एहन वस्तु नहि। एहि कारण स्पष्ट अछि जे एतय “अथ” शब्द कर्मज्ञानक ठीक तत्काल बादक क्रम नहि बतबैत अछि।

मानि लिअ जे अर्थसामर्थ्यसँ कोनो क्रम निश्चित नहि होइत, जहिना अग्निहोत्र आ ओकर लेल यवागू तैयार करबाक बीच क्रम होइत अछि; मुदा प्रत्यक्ष श्रुति—एतय “क्त्वा” प्रत्यय—सँ क्रम निश्चित होइत अछि। जाबाल-वचन कहैत अछि—“गृहस्थ भऽ, तखन वनवासी हो; वनवासी भऽ, तखन संन्यास ग्रहण कर।” एतय “गृहस्थ भऽ” पद यज्ञादिक अनुष्ठान सूचित करैत अछि। एहि अर्थक स्मृतिवचन सेहो अछि—“नियमानुसार वेद पढ़ि, पुत्र उत्पन्न कऽ, अपन सामर्थ्यानुसार यज्ञ कऽ, मन केँ मोक्षमे लगाबए।” निन्दावचन सेहो अछि—“जे द्विज वेद नहि पढ़ि, सन्तान नहि उत्पन्न कऽ आ यज्ञ नहि कऽ मोक्षक इच्छा करैत अछि, ओ अधोगति पबैत अछि।” उत्तर देल जाइत अछि—“हृदय छेदनक प्रसङ्गमे तत्काल क्रमक नियम अछि।” अर्थात् “पहिने हृदय काटए, तखन जिह्वा, तखन पार्श्व”—एहन वचनमे “पहिने” आ “तखन” पदसँ क्रम प्रतिपादित करब अभिप्रेत अछि। एतय एहन कोनो क्रम प्रतिपादित करब अभिप्रेत नहि; कारण एही शास्त्रमे आगाँ कहल अछि—“अथवा छात्राश्रम, गृहस्थाश्रम अथवा वनप्रस्थाश्रम—कोनो अवस्थासँ संन्यास ग्रहण करए।” एहि समस्त वचनसँ वैराग्यक अनिवार्यता सूचित होइत अछि। एही कारण शास्त्र कहैत अछि—“जहि दिन वैराग्य उत्पन्न हो, ओही दिन संन्यास ग्रहण करए।” निन्दावचन अशुद्ध बुद्धिवाला व्यक्तिक उद्देश्यसँ अछि। अशुद्ध बुद्धिवाला व्यक्ति मोक्षक उपायमे स्थिर नहि रहैत; आलस्यवश गृहस्थक नित्य आ नैमित्तिक कर्मो नहि करैत, आ प्रत्येक क्षण बढ़ैत पापक भारसँ अधोगतिमे जाइत अछि—ई तकर अर्थ अछि।

मानि लिअ प्रत्यक्ष श्रुति अथवा अर्थसामर्थ्यसँ क्रम सिद्ध नहि; तखन पाठक्रम, स्थान, प्रधानता अथवा प्रवृत्तिक आधारपर क्रम किए नहि मानल जाए? उत्तर अछि—“गौण आ प्रधान सम्बन्धक कोनो प्रमाण नहि।” समिद् आदि सहायक अङ्ग आ आग्नेय आदि प्रधान कर्म एकहि फल उत्पन्न करैत अछि, एकहि प्रक्रियावाक्यसँ बोध्य अछि, एकहि अधिकारी द्वारा कएल जाइत अछि आ एकहि काल—पूर्णिमा अथवा अमावस्या—सँ सम्बद्ध अछि। तिनकर एकसाथ अनुष्ठान असम्भव होएबाक कारण क्रम आवश्यक होइत अछि; आ विशेष क्रम निर्धारित करबाक लेल पाठ, स्थान आदि प्रमाण बनैत अछि। मुदा जतय गौण-प्रधान सम्बन्ध नहि, एकहि फल अथवा एकहि अधिकारी द्वारा अनुष्ठानक नियमो नहि—जेना सौर्य, अर्यम्ण आ प्राजापत्य आदि पृथक् कर्ममे—ओतय विशेष क्रमक आवश्यकता नहि; अतः पाठ आदि कोनो विशेष क्रम निर्धारित करबाक प्रमाण नहि बनैत, यद्यपि सभ शब्द एकहि समय उच्चारित नहि भऽ सकबाक कारण कोनो न कोनो क्रम अनिवार्य रूपेँ घटित होइत अछि। धर्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा आ ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक बीच गौण-प्रधान सम्बन्ध सिद्ध करबाक लेल प्रत्यक्ष वचन अथवा आन कोनो प्रमाण नहि अछि।

आपत्ति होइत अछि—गौण-प्रधान सम्बन्ध नहि रहितहुँ क्रमक नियम देखल जाइत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, गोदोहन पात्र पशुकाम व्यक्तिक लेल दर्शपूर्णमास यज्ञक अङ्ग जल-प्रणयनमे प्रयुक्त होइत अछि; अथवा “दर्शपूर्णमास कऽ सोमयज्ञ करए” एहि विधानमे दर्शपूर्णमास आ सोमयज्ञ गौण-प्रधान नहि रहितहुँ क्रम निश्चित अछि। उत्तर—“पहिनेसँ अधिकारी व्यक्तिक फेर अधिकारक सम्बन्धक प्रमाणो नहि।” स्वर्गक इच्छा करनिहार व्यक्ति दर्शपूर्णमासक अधिकारी अछि; पशुक इच्छा करनिहार ओही व्यक्ति जल-प्रणयनमे दूध दुहबाक पात्रक अधिकारी होइत अछि, कारण ई पात्र दर्शपूर्णमासक अङ्गक सहायक अछि। दूधक पात्र स्वयं सीधा पशु उत्पन्न नहि करैत; ओकर कोनो आन क्रियामे प्रवेशक शास्त्रीय विधानो नहि, नहि तँ ओ दर्शपूर्णमासक अङ्गक्रमसँ बाहर भऽ जाएत। मुदा “पात्रसँ जल छिड़कए; पशुक इच्छा करनिहार दूध दुहबाक पात्रसँ”—एहि वचनमे जल-

छिड़कावक निकट सम्बन्ध आ जल छिड़कबाक योग्यता कारण ई पात्र जल-प्रणयनपर निर्भर बुझाईत अछि। अतः दूधक पात्र यद्यपि केवल मानवीय प्रयोजनक हेतु योगदान दैत अछि, तथापि ओ अपन सहायक जल-प्रणयनक क्रमक कारण ओही क्रममे आबैत अछि। सोमयज्ञ आ दर्शपूर्णमास-इष्टिक बीच जे क्रम अछि, ओकर एतय प्रयोग प्रत्यक्ष विधानक निषेधसँ पहिनिहिसँ निरस्त भऽ गेल अछि।

गौण-प्रधान सम्बन्ध अथवा पहिनेसँ अधिकारी व्यक्तिक पुनः अधिकार—ई दुनू नहि रहितहुँ, जँ कर्मसभ एकहि फलसँ परिभाषित होथि तँ क्रम मानल जा सकैत अछि। जेना आग्नेय आदि छह यज्ञक एकहि लक्ष्य स्वर्गप्राप्ति अछि, तँ तिनकर क्रम मानल जाइत अछि। अथवा जँ धर्म ब्रह्मक एक अङ्ग होइत, तँ चारि अध्यायक ब्रह्मसूत्रमे क्रम मानल जा सकैत छल; कारण चारू अध्यायमे प्रतिपादित ब्रह्मक कोनो-कोनो पक्ष परस्पर सम्बद्ध रहैत आ ज्ञेय वस्तुक अभेदसँ क्रम बनैत। तखन धर्म आ ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा एकहि ज्ञेय वस्तुक विषय होएबाक कारण दुनूक बीच क्रम मानल जा सकैत छल। मुदा एतय एहि दुनूमे सँ कोनो स्थिति नहि अछि। एही हेतु कहल गेल अछि—“जानबाक इच्छाक फल आ विषय सेहो भिन्न अछि।” धर्मज्ञानक फल अभ्युदय अर्थात् समृद्धि अछि, आ ई अनुष्ठानपर निर्भर अछि; ब्रह्मज्ञानक फल निःश्रेयस अर्थात् परम कल्याण अछि, आ ई कोनो आन अनुष्ठानपर निर्भर नहि। एतय “ज्ञानक फल”क अर्थ “जानबाक इच्छाक फल” अछि। भेद केवल फलसभक स्वभावमे नहि, ओकर प्राक्तिक प्रक्रियामे सेहो अछि; एही कारण कहल अछि—“आ ई अनुष्ठानपर निर्भर अछि।”

धर्म—जे जानबाक इच्छाक विषय अछि—उत्पन्न कएल जाएब जरूरी अछि; ज्ञान होएबाक समय ओ विद्यमान नहि रहैत, कारण ओ मनुष्यक क्रियापर निर्भर अछि। मुदा एतय जानबाक इच्छाक विषय नित्य विद्यमान ब्रह्म अछि; ओ अनादि-अनन्त विद्यमान अछि आ मानवीय क्रियापर निर्भर नहि। दुनू विषयक ज्ञान देनिहार साधनक कार्यप्रकारो भिन्न अछि। धर्मक प्रतिपादन करनिहार शास्त्र मनुष्य केँ क्रियामे प्रवृत्त कऽ उपदेश दैत अछि। ब्रह्मविषयक शास्त्र मात्र उपदेश दैत अछि; कारण ज्ञान शास्त्रवाक्यसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि, ज्ञानक सम्बन्धमे मनुष्य केँ कोनो क्रियाक आदेश नहि देल जाइत। जेना इन्द्रिय आ विषयक सन्निकर्षसँ विषयक ज्ञान स्वतः उत्पन्न होइत अछि, एतयो तहिना। उत्पन्न होएब योग्य वस्तु कर्ताक क्रियासँ उत्पन्न कएल जाइत अछि, ताहिपर निर्भर रहैत अछि आ उत्पत्तिसँ पहिने विद्यमान नहि रहैत। जे नित्य विद्यमान अछि, ओ सदैव सत्य अछि; कोनो कालमे असत्य नहि। ज्ञेय विषयक ई भेद केवल स्वभावक भेद नहि, ज्ञान देनिहार सम्बन्धित साधनसभक कार्यप्रकारक भेद सेहो अछि। एही हेतु कहल गेल अछि—“शास्त्रक कार्यमे सेहो भेद अछि।”

एतय “चोदना” शब्दक अर्थ शास्त्रीय उपदेश अछि, केवल विधिवाक्य नहि; विशेषवाचक पदसँ सामान्य अर्थ गौण रूपेँ ग्रहण कएल गेल अछि। अपौरुषेय शास्त्रमे आज्ञा देनिहार वचनक स्थान नहि, कारण आज्ञा मनुष्यक इच्छाक अभिव्यक्ति होइत अछि; अतः एतय “चोदना”क अर्थ शिक्षण अथवा उपदेश अछि। एही कारण कहल गेल अछि—“धर्म केँ जानबाक साधन उपदेश अछि।” ई उपदेश “भावना”—अर्थात् शास्त्र द्वारा सिखाओल मानवीय क्रिया—आ ओकर विषय यज्ञादिसँ सम्बन्धित अछि। यज्ञ आदि भावनाक विषय अछि, कारण प्रयत्नरूप क्रिया ओकरापर निर्भर भऽ निश्चित होइत अछि; “विषय” शब्दक व्युत्पत्ति सेहो बन्धनक अर्थवाला धातुसँ मानल गेल अछि, अर्थात् प्रयत्न जाहिसँ बान्हल अछि। शास्त्र यज्ञादिरूप धर्म केँ एना जानबैत अछि जे मनुष्य केँ इच्छित फल प्राप्त करबाक सहायक साधनक प्रयोगमे प्रवृत्त करैत अछि; क्रियासभक ज्ञान करबैत आ ताहि द्वारा यज्ञ केँ इच्छित फल प्राक्तिक साधन बतबैत अछि। आन प्रकारेँ धर्मशास्त्र कार्य नहि करैत। मुदा ब्रह्मविषयक उपदेश केवल व्यक्ति केँ सत्य बतबैत अछि, क्रियामे प्रवृत्त नहि करैत। कारण उपदेशसँ क्रियानिर्देशरहित ज्ञान उत्पन्न होइत अछि।

आपत्ति कएल जा सकैत अछि—वेदान्त “आत्मा कै जानए” एहन वचनसँ ब्रह्मक उपदेश दैत अछि; विधिरूप वचनसँ वाक्यगत एकता रहबाक कारण ई मनुष्य कै ज्ञानक्रियामे प्रवृत्त करैत अछि। तँ ब्रह्मोपदेशो धर्मोपदेश जकाँ भेल। उत्तर अछि—“ज्ञानक सम्बन्धमे व्यक्ति कै क्रियामे प्रवृत्त नहि कएल जाइत।” अभिप्राय ई अछि—ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कारक सम्बन्धमे मनुष्य कै कोनो क्रियाक आदेश नहि देल जा सकैत, कारण ओ ब्रह्मस्वरूप, नित्य आ अनुत्पाद्य अछि। निदिध्यासनक सम्बन्धमे सेहो नहि; कारण अन्वय-व्यतिरेकक निरीक्षणसँ स्थापित कारण ज्ञानक एकमात्र कारण होएबाक कारण निदिध्यासन विधिक विषय नहि बनि सकैत। शब्दप्रमाणजन्य ज्ञानक सम्बन्धमे सेहो विधि नहि; कारण वेद पढ़ने, शब्द आ अर्थक सम्बन्ध जाननिहार आ शब्दजन्य ज्ञानक यथार्थ नियम बुझनिहार व्यक्तिमे ई ज्ञान निर्बाध उत्पन्न होइत अछि। उदाहरणार्थ इन्द्रिय-विषयक सन्निकर्षसँ विषयक ज्ञान जेना उत्पन्न होइत अछि, एतयो तहिना। भाष्यकार “एतयो एही प्रकार” कहि एहि उदाहरण कै विषयसँ जोड़ैत छथि। आ जँ आत्मज्ञानक आदेश देनाइए वेदान्त-वाक्यसभक तात्पर्य मानल जाए, तँ आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूपक निश्चय शब्दप्रमाणजन्य ज्ञान नहि रहत; कारण वाक्यसभक तात्पर्य तखन आत्मस्वरूप नहि, ओकर ज्ञानक विधि भऽ जाएत। जकर तात्पर्य आन वस्तुमे अछि, ताहिसँ प्रतिपादित वस्तुक वास्तविक स्वरूपक निश्चय नहि होइत—ई कहि नहि सकैत जे ज्ञान ज्ञेयपर निर्भर अछि आ तँ ज्ञेयक आवश्यकता रहैत अछि; कारण आरोपित ज्ञानो ज्ञेयक वास्तविक स्वरूपक ज्ञान नहि होइतहुँ ज्ञेयपर निर्भर मानल जाइत अछि। अतः सिद्ध भेल जे वेदान्तक तात्पर्य ज्ञानक विधि नहि अछि।

वर्तमान प्रसङ्गक निष्कर्ष एना कएल जाइत अछि—“अतः किछु एहन साधन बताओल जाए, जकर ठीक अनन्तर ब्रह्म कै जानबाक इच्छा उत्पन्न होइत अछि।” जकर अभावमे ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा नहि हो, आ जकर उपस्थितिमे ओ अवश्य हो—ओ साधन ई अछि: नित्य आ अनित्य वस्तुक विवेक; एहि लोक अथवा परलोकक फलभोगप्रति वैराग्य; शम, दम आदि साधनसम्पत्ति; आ मोक्षक इच्छा। ई साधन उपस्थित रहला पर धर्मजिज्ञासासँ पहिनहुँ अथवा ओकर बादो ब्रह्म कै जानबाक इच्छा आ ब्रह्मज्ञान सम्भव अछि; मुदा एहि सभक अभावमे नहि। अतः “अथ” शब्द पहिने कहल साधनसम्पत्तिक ठीक अनन्तरता सूचित करैत अछि।

जँ नित्य-अनित्य वस्तुक ई विवेक निश्चयात्मक हो, तँ ब्रह्म पहिनहिसँ ज्ञात भऽ गेल आ ब्रह्म कै जानबाक इच्छा निरर्थक भऽ जाएत। आ जँ ई केवल सामान्य ज्ञान हो, निश्चय नहि, तँ एकरामे सत्य निश्चय सँ भिन्न सन्देह वा भ्रम रहि सकैत अछि; एहन ज्ञान वैराग्य उत्पन्न नहि कऽ सकैत अछि। जँ वैराग्य नहि उत्पन्न भेल, तँ ई ब्रह्मजिज्ञासाक कारण केना बनत? अतः बात एना बुझबाक चाही—“नित्य आ अनित्य वस्तु” सँ हुनक गुण अभिप्रेत अछि। “नित्य आ अनित्य वस्तुक विवेक”क अर्थ अछि—नित्य आ अनित्य अधिष्ठानसभक संगहि हुनक गुणसभक विवेक। भिन्न-भिन्न नित्य आ अनित्य अधिष्ठानक विषयमे “ई सत्य आ नित्य अछि”, “ई असत्य आ अनित्य अछि” एहन विशेष निर्णय अनिवार्य नहि; सामान्य रूपेँ अधिष्ठानसभ आ हुनक गुणसभक बीच नित्य-अनित्य भेदक निश्चय पर्याप्त अछि। नित्य होएबाक अर्थ सत्य होएब; जाहिमे सत्यता अछि, से नित्य आ सत्य अछि, आ तँ ओ इच्छाक विषय बनैत अछि। अनित्य होएबाक अर्थ असत्य होएब; जाहिमे असत्यता अछि, से अनित्य आ असत्य अछि, अतः ओ इच्छाक विषय नहि होइत। “अहाँ” आ “हम” अवधारणाक विषय-विषयी रूपेँ अनुभव होमयवाला वस्तुसभमे जे सत्य, नित्य आ सुखरूप सिद्ध होइत अछि, ओ इच्छाक क्षेत्रमे अबैत अछि; मुदा जे अनित्य, असत्य आ त्रिविध दुःखसँ भरल अछि, ओकर त्याग कएल जाएब चाही। पूर्वजन्म वा एहि जन्ममे कएल कर्मसभसँ शुद्ध भेल बुद्धिवाला मनुष्य कै अनुभव आ युक्तिसँ नित्य-अनित्य वस्तुक ई विवेक उत्पन्न होइत अछि।

ई नहि कहल जा सकैत अछि जे सत्य नामक कोनो वस्तुए नहि अछि; कारण सत्यक अभावमे सत्य केँ अधिष्ठान बना कऽ देखाइत असत्यो बुद्धिगम्य नहि होएत। शून्यवादियो लेल शून्य स्वयं सत्य मानल जाइत अछि। मनुष्यलोकक श्रेष्ठतम व्यक्तिसभक अनुभव आ तर्कक प्रकाशमे विवेकपूर्वक विचार कऽ, आ अपनाकेँ शेष चेतन जगतसँ संगहि निरन्तर जन्म-मरण करैत देखि—सत्यलोकसँ अवीचि धरि समस्त लोकमे त्रिविध दुःखसँ घेरायल आ संसारसागरक तरङ्गमे असहाय भटकल देखि—क्षण, मुहूर्त, याम, दिन, राति, पक्ष, मास, ऋतु, अर्धवर्ष, वर्ष, युग, चारि युगक काल, मन्वन्तर, प्रलय आ महाप्रलय धरि समयक प्रत्येक विभागमे एहि संसारक अनित्यता, अशुद्धता आ दुःखमयताक चिन्तन उत्पन्न होइत अछि। नित्य-अनित्य वस्तुक एहि विवेकजन्य चिन्तनसँ “एहि लोक वा परलोकक फलभोगप्रति वैराग्य” उत्पन्न होइत अछि। “अर्थ” अर्थात् जे चाहल जाए, से फल। ओकरा भोगयोग्य नहि बुझि ओकर प्रति उदासीनता वैराग्य अछि। एहि सँ “शम, दम आदि साधनसम्पत्तिक प्रचुरता” प्राप्त होइत अछि। राग आदि मलरूपी मदिरासँ मतवाला मन विभिन्न इन्द्रिय केँ ऊँच-नीच विषय दिस दौड़बैत, अनेक कर्म करबैत आ पुण्य-पापरूप फल उत्पन्न करैत अछि; भयङ्कर संसाराग्निमे ओ आत्मा केँ आहुति बना दैत अछि, आ एहि प्रकार अनेक दुःखक नामसँ भरल एकटा विशाल पुंज उत्पन्न करैत अछि।

रागादिक मदिरासँ उत्पन्न मनक ई उन्माद ऊपर कहल चिन्तनक निरन्तर अभ्याससँ प्राप्त वैराग्यक परिपाक द्वारा समाप्त भऽ जाइत अछि। तखन मन आत्माक अधीन भऽ नियंत्रित होइत अछि। वैराग्यजन्य एहि मनोनिग्रह केँ शम, वा वशीकृत-शम कहल जाइत अछि। नियंत्रित मन केँ सत्यक अनुसन्धानेँ लगबाक योग्य बना देब दम अथवा समाधान अछि—जहिना शान्त आ प्रशिक्षित बाछा हल अथवा गाड़ी खींचबाक योग्य बनैत अछि। भाष्यक “आदि” शब्दमे विषयसभसँ निवृत्तिक इच्छा अर्थात् उपरति, सहनशीलता अर्थात् तितिक्षा, आ सत्यप्रति श्रद्धा समाहित अछि। एहि कारण श्रुति कहैत अछि—“शम, दम, उपरति, तितिक्षा, समाधान आ श्रद्धासँ सम्पन्न भऽ मनुष्य आत्मा केँ आत्मामे देखैत अछि, आ आत्मामे सभ किछु देखैत अछि।” शमदमादि-साधनसम्पत्ति नाम एहि साधनसभक प्रचुर उपलब्धि अछि। एकर बाद संसारबन्धनसँ मुक्त होएबाक इच्छा उत्पन्न होइत अछि; तँ भाष्यकार “मोक्षक इच्छा” कहैत छथि। जे व्यक्ति नित्यशुद्ध-बुद्ध ब्रह्मक ज्ञान केँ मोक्षक कारण सुनि चुकल अछि, ओकरामे धर्मजिज्ञासासँ पहिने अथवा ओकर बादो ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा उत्पन्न भऽ सकैत अछि। अतः “अथ” शब्दक ठीक अनन्तरता केवल एहि साधनसम्पत्तिक अनन्तरता अछि, धर्मजिज्ञासाक अनन्तरता नहि।

“अतः” शब्द कारण सूचित करैत अछि। वेदमे “एहि लोकमे कर्मसँ प्राप्त भोग नष्ट होइत अछि, तहिना परलोकमे धर्मसँ प्राप्त भोगो नष्ट होइत अछि” एहन वचन अग्निहोत्रादि समृद्धिदायक कर्मक फल अनित्य होएबाक प्रतिपादन करैत अछि; आ “ब्रह्म केँ जाननिहार परम पद प्राप्त करैत अछि” एहन वचन ब्रह्मज्ञानसँ परम पुरुषार्थ सिद्ध होएबाक शिक्षा दैत अछि। एहि कारण ऊपर कहल साधनसम्पत्तिक प्रचुरता प्राप्त भेलाक ठीक बाद ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा होएबाक चाही। केवल जिज्ञासा नहि, ओहि जिज्ञासासँ ज्ञानो उत्पन्न होइत अछि; तँ भाष्यकार “आ जानबाक” कहैत छथि, आ अन्तमे “अतः” कहि निष्कर्ष दैत छथि। क्रममे अबैत “अतः” शब्दक व्याख्या एना अछि—ई कारणक अर्थ दैत अछि। भाष्यकार “वेदमे स्वयं...” इत्यादिसँ ओकर कारणात्मकता स्पष्ट करैत छथि। एतय प्रश्न उठैत अछि—मानि लिअ, उपर्युक्त साधनसम्पत्ति प्राप्त भेलापर ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा उत्पन्न होइत अछि; मुदा ई बात स्वयं असङ्गत अछि, कारण एहि लोक वा परलोकक फलभोगप्रति वैराग्य

होएब सम्भव नहि। फल इच्छाक विषय अछि, अतः लाभदायक बुझल जाइत अछि; जे वस्तु स्वयं आसक्ति उत्पन्न करैत अछि, ओकर प्रति वैराग्य केना होएत?

कहल जा सकैत अछि—सुखक संग दुःख जुड़ल रहबाक कारण सुखप्रति वैराग्य होइत अछि। मुदा तखन दुःखक संग सुखो जुड़ल अछि, तँ दुःखप्रति आसक्ति किएक नहि होएत? अतः मनुष्य सुख स्वीकार करैत दुःख दूर करबाक चेष्टा करए; दुःख अनिवार्य रूपेँ आबियो जाए, तँ ओकर उपचार कऽ केवल सुखक भोग करए। एहि प्रकार माछ चाहनिहार काँटा आ शल्कसहित माछ आनैत अछि, भोग्य अंश लैत अछि आ शेष छोड़ि दैत अछि; धान चाहनिहारो भूँसीसहित धान आनैत, उपयोगी अंश लैत आ बाकी त्यागैत अछि। तँ दुःखक भय सँ एहि लोक वा परलोकक लाभदायक सुखक त्याग उचित नहि। खेतमे वन्य पशु रहबाक कारण किसान बीज बोएनाइ नहि छोड़ैत, ने भिखारी रहबाक कारण भोजन बनौनाइ छोड़ल जाइत अछि। अत्यन्त भीरु व्यक्ति दृश्य सुख छोड़ियो देत, कारण चन्दनलेप वा स्त्रीसुख उपभोगक संग क्षयजन्य दुःख जुड़ल अछि; मुदा स्वर्गादिक परलोकिक सुखपर ई तर्क लागू नहि होइत, कारण श्रुति ओकरा अविनाशी कहैत अछि—“हम सोम पी चुकल छी, अमर भऽ गेल छी”; आ “चातुर्मास्य यज्ञ करनिहारक पुण्य क्षीण नहि होइत” सेहो कहल अछि। उत्पन्न वस्तु विनाशी होइत अछि—एहि आधारपर एतय विनाशशीलताक अनुमानो सम्भव नहि, कारण श्रुति ओकर बाध करैत अछि, जहिना शङ्खादिक समानतासँ मनुष्यक खोपड़ीक शुद्धताक अनुमान बाधित होइत अछि।

अतः ऊपर कहल साधनसम्पत्ति अस्तित्वहीन ठहरत, आ ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक कोनो अवसर नहि रहत। एहि निष्कर्षक निराकरण लेल पूज्य सूत्रकार “अतः” शब्द प्रयोग करैत छथि, आ भाष्यकार “वेदमे स्वयं...” इत्यादिसँ ओकर अर्थ स्पष्ट करैत छथि। आशय ई अछि—पशु, भिखारी आदिक कारण उत्पन्न अनेक प्रकारक दुःख खेती वा भोजन-पाकक फलमे बाधा बनि सकैत अछि; मुदा ओकर उपचार सम्भव अछि। दीर्घकालमे पराधीन साधनक अपेक्षा आ निरन्तर क्षय—ई दुनू सभ प्रकारक उत्पन्न सुखक संग अविच्छिन्न रूपेँ जुड़ल अछि। मधुमे विष मिलल भोजनसँ श्रेष्ठतम पाककुशलो विष अलग कऽ केवल मधु नहि खा सकैत अछि। एहि प्रकार क्षयक प्रतिपादन करनिहार “एहि लोकमे कर्मसँ प्राप्त भोग...” आदि वचन “हम सोम पी अमर भऽ गेल छी” आदि वचनक गौण अर्थ निश्चित करैत अछि, कारण ओहि वचनक मुख्य अर्थ असम्भव अछि। पौराणिक वचन अछि —“प्रलय धरि स्थायित्व केँ अमरत्व कहल जाइत अछि।” एतय “ब्रह्म” शब्दसँ ब्रह्मक ज्ञानक प्रमाण, अर्थात् वेद, स्मरणमे अबैत अछि। “एहि लोकमे कर्मसँ प्राप्त भोग...” आदि उपयुक्त वचनसभ केँ “अतः” सर्वनामसँ कारणरूपेँ ग्रहण कएल गेल अछि; पंचमी-विभक्तिक ‘तस्’ प्रत्यय ओकर कारणभाव सूचित करैत अछि।

ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा अर्थात् ब्रह्मक विषयमे जानबाक इच्छा। ब्रह्म ओ अछि जकर लक्षण आगाँ “जाहिसँ एहि जगतक उत्पत्ति आदि होइत अछि” एहि सूत्रसँ कहल जाएत। एहि कारण “ब्रह्म” शब्दमे जाति आदि कोनो अन्य अर्थक सन्देह नहि रहैत अछि। “ब्रह्मक” पद षष्ठी-विभक्तिमे कर्मक अर्थमे अछि, शेषसम्बन्धक अर्थमे नहि; कारण जानबाक इच्छाक लेल जानल जाएबय योग्य वस्तु आवश्यक अछि, आ अन्य कोनो वस्तु केँ जानल जाएबय योग्य नहि कहल गेल अछि। “अतः” सर्वनाम पछिला वाक्यक कारण केँ ग्रहण करैत अछि, आ ‘तस्’ प्रत्यययुक्त पंचमी-विभक्ति ओ कारणत्व सूचित करैत अछि। मानि लिअ, स्वर्गादि उत्पन्न सुख जकाँ ब्रह्मसुखो दुःखसहित होएत; उत्तर अछि—“ब्रह्मक ज्ञानसँ मनुष्यक परम लक्ष्य प्राप्त होइत अछि” एहन प्रतिपादन अछि। श्रुति स्वर्गादिक भोगक क्षय बतबैत अछि आ ब्रह्मज्ञान केँ परम पुरुषार्थ कहैत अछि; अतः ऊपर कहल साधनसम्पत्तिक प्रचुरता

होएत आ ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा निश्चित उत्पन्न होएत। “ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा” समस्तपदक अर्थ अछि—ब्रह्मक विषयमे जानबाक इच्छा। एकरा षष्ठी-तत्पुरुष मानल गेल अछि; पूर्ववर्ती व्याख्याकारसभक चतुर्थी-समासरूप “ब्रह्मणे जिज्ञासा”—ब्रह्म लेल जिज्ञासा—व्याख्या एतय निरस्त बुझबाक चाही। कात्यायनक नियम अछि—चतुर्थी-समासमे आधारभूत वस्तु आ ओकर विकारक सम्बन्ध ग्रहण कएल जाए।

चतुर्थी-समास केवल ओतहि होइत अछि जतय मूल वस्तु आ ओकर विकारक सम्बन्ध हो—जहिना यूपक लेल काठ अथवा यज्ञक पशु बाँधबाक खूँटा। जतय समस्त पदसभक सम्बन्ध मूल-विकाररूप नहि, ओतय चतुर्थी-समास नहि होइत। “अश्वक चारा” आदि पद षष्ठी-समास मानल गेल अछि। षष्ठी-समासमे सेहो “जानबाक इच्छा”क अपेक्षामे ब्रह्मक प्राधान्य बोधगम्य अछि, कारण वाक्यमे जानबाक इच्छे मुख्य कहल गेल अछि। मानि लिअ “ब्रह्मक विषयमे जानबाक इच्छा”मे “ब्रह्म” अनेक अर्थमे प्रयुक्त होइत अछि; तखन सन्देह उठत—ई जिज्ञासा कोन ब्रह्मक अछि? ‘ब्रह्महत्या’मे ब्राह्मण जाति, ‘ब्रह्मोज्झम्’मे वेद, आ “ब्रह्म कै जाननिहार स्वयं ब्रह्म भऽ जाइत अछि”मे परमात्मा—एहि सभ अर्थमे ब्रह्म शब्द अबैत अछि। भाष्यकार ई सन्देह “ब्रह्म ओ अछि जकर लक्षण आगौं कहल जाएत” कहि दूर करैत छथि। ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा पहिने मानि कऽ तत्पश्चात् परमात्माक लक्षण कहल जाएत; एहि सँ बुझाइत अछि जे एतय जिज्ञासा केवल परमात्मा कै जानबाक अछि, ब्राह्मण जाति आदिक नहि। तथापि षष्ठी कै कर्मार्थ नहि, शेषसम्बन्धार्थ मानबाक आपत्ति रहैत अछि। शेषसम्बन्ध सामान्य सम्बन्ध सूचित करैत अछि, केवल कर्मसम्बन्ध नहि; “ब्रह्मक विषयमे जानबाक इच्छा” कहला पर ब्रह्मसँ सम्बन्धित सभ किछु जानबाक इच्छा अर्थ निकलि सकैत अछि।

ब्रह्म कै जानबाक इच्छाक सहायक वस्तुसभ—ब्रह्मक स्वरूप, ओकर ज्ञानक प्रमाण, तर्क, प्राक्तिक साधन आ फल—प्रत्यक्ष वा परोक्ष रूपेँ ब्रह्मसँ सम्बन्धित होएबाक कारण “ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा” नामक अन्तर्गत बुझल जा सकैत अछि। मुदा षष्ठी कै कर्मार्थ मानला पर “ब्रह्म” केवल कर्म, अर्थात् ब्रह्मक स्वरूप, सूचित करत; ज्ञानक साधनादि ओहि अन्तर्गत नहि आएत, आ तखन अनारम्भित विषयक जिज्ञासा उठि जाएत। एहन मतवाला कै उत्तर देल जाइत अछि—“ब्रह्मक” पद षष्ठी-विभक्तिमे कर्मक अर्थमे अछि। कारण कहल गेल अछि—“जानबाक इच्छाक लेल जानल जाएबय योग्य वस्तु आवश्यक अछि।” जिज्ञासाक सिद्धि ज्ञानसँ जुड़ल अछि, आ ज्ञानक विषय ब्रह्म अछि। ज्ञेय वस्तुक अभावमे ज्ञान निश्चित नहि होइत, आ ज्ञानक अभावमे जिज्ञासो निश्चित नहि होइत। जिज्ञासा मुख्यतः एकटा कर्मवस्तुक अपेक्षा करैत अछि, सामान्य सम्बन्धक नहि; सामान्य सम्बन्ध नहि रहितहुँ कर्म उपस्थित रहला पर जिज्ञासा निश्चित होइत अछि। सूर्य वा चन्द्रमा देखलाक बाद “ई ककर सम्बन्धी अछि?” एहन खोज नहि उठैत; मुदा “ज्ञान” शब्द सुनला पर “ककर ज्ञान?” अर्थात् ओकर कर्मवस्तु किएक नहि पूछल जाएत? अतः मुख्य अपेक्षित होएबाक कारण ब्रह्म कै केवल कर्मरूपेँ सम्बन्धित कएल गेल अछि, सामान्य सम्बन्धरूपेँ नहि; ई गौण अर्थ अछि। फलतः समास षष्ठी-तत्पुरुष अछि, जाहिमे षष्ठी कर्मार्थ अछि।

मानि लिअ षष्ठी कै शेषसम्बन्धक सामान्य अर्थमे स्वीकार कएल जाए, तखनहुँ ब्रह्म जिज्ञासाक कर्म अछि—एहि बातक विरोध नहि होइत; कारण सामान्य सम्बन्धको कोनो विशेष सम्बन्धपर आधारित रहैत अछि। तथापि जे व्यक्ति ब्रह्मक प्रत्यक्ष कर्मत्व छोड़ि सामान्य सम्बन्धक मार्गसँ परोक्ष कर्मत्व मानैत अछि, ओकर प्रयास व्यर्थ अछि। आब आपत्ति होइत अछि—सत्य, ज्ञेय वस्तुक अभावमे जिज्ञासा निश्चित नहि होइत; मुदा जिज्ञासाक कोनो आन कर्मवस्तु भऽ सकैत अछि, आ ब्रह्म ओकर संग शेषसम्बन्धसँ जुड़ल रहि सकैत अछि। भाष्यकार उत्तर दैत छथि—“अन्य कोनो वस्तु कै जानल

जाएबय योग्य नहि कहल गेल अछि।” प्रत्यक्ष कर्मत्व जे जिज्ञासाक मुख्य अपेक्षा अछि आ सर्वप्रथम सम्बन्धित होएबाक योग्य अछि, ओकरा छोड़ि बादमे कोनो प्रकार आवश्यक सामान्य सम्बन्ध केँ प्रधान बना देब—एहि प्रकार गौण मुख्य बनि जाइत अछि आ मुख्य गौण। “प्रत्यक्ष” आ “परोक्ष” सम्बन्धक नामकरण सेहो एहि क्रमपर आधारित अछि।

एखन ई निरर्थक नहि अछि; कारण एकर प्रयोजन ब्रह्मपर निर्भर समस्त शेष विषयसभक जिज्ञासा केँ पूर्वमान्य रूपेँ ग्रहण करब होएत। उत्तर अछि—नहि; कारण प्रधान केँ स्वीकार कएला पर ओकर आश्रित समस्त विषय स्वतः अर्थापत्तिसँ समाविष्ट भऽ जाइत अछि। ज्ञान द्वारा प्राप्त करबाक लेल सर्वाधिक अभीष्ट ब्रह्मे प्रधान अछि। जानबाक इच्छाक विषय रूपमे ओहि प्रधान केँ स्वीकार कएलापर, जकरा जानबाक पृथक् इच्छा नहि रहितहुँ ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा सम्भव नहि, एहन सभ विषय स्वतः अर्थापत्तिसँ ग्रहण भऽ जाएत; सूत्रमे ओकर पृथक् उल्लेख आवश्यक नहि। जहिना “एतय राजा जाइत छथि” कहलापर राजाक संग हुनकर समस्त अनुचरवर्गक गमन बुझल जाइत अछि, तहिना एतहु बुझबाक चाही। ई श्रुतिक अनुरूप सेहो अछि।

भाष्यमे प्रयुक्त पदसभ “प्रधान” आ “अप्रधान”, “व्यक्त” आ “अव्यक्त” अर्थमे अछि। आपत्तिकर्ता अपन मत एना प्रकट करैत अछि—“ई व्यर्थ नहि, कारण एकर प्रयोजन ब्रह्मपर निर्भर समस्त शेष विषयसभक जिज्ञासा केँ पूर्वमान्य करब होएत।” एकर व्याख्या ऊपर भऽ चुकल अछि। सिद्धान्ती अपन मत “नहि; कारण प्रधान केँ स्वीकार कएला पर...” इत्यादिसँ प्रकट करैत छथि। वाक्यमे प्रत्यक्ष रूपेँ नहि रहितहुँ वास्तविक प्रधानता ब्रह्मक अछि। भाष्यक शेष अर्थ उदाहरणसहित स्पष्ट अछि; श्रुतिक समर्थन सेहो सहज बुझाईत अछि।

“जाहिसँ ई प्राणीसभ उत्पन्न होइत अछि” सँ आरम्भ होमयवाला श्रुतिवाक्य आ “ओहि ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा करू; ओ ब्रह्म अछि” एहन वचन स्पष्ट रूपेँ देखबैत अछि जे ब्रह्म जानबाक इच्छाक विषय अछि। षष्ठी-विभक्ति केँ कर्मार्थमे स्वीकार कएलापर ई सूत्रसँ पूर्ण सामञ्जस्य रखैत अछि। अतः “ब्रह्मक” पद षष्ठीमे कर्मक अर्थमे अछि।

जिज्ञासा अर्थात् जानबाक इच्छा। ‘सन्’ प्रत्ययसँ व्यक्त इच्छाक विषय ओ ज्ञान अछि जे साक्षात्कारमे परिणत होइत अछि; कारण फल इच्छाक विषय होइत अछि। वास्तवमे प्रमाणजन्य ज्ञान द्वारा साक्षात् करबाक विषय ब्रह्म अछि। ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार पुरुषार्थ अछि, कारण ओ अविद्या आदि समस्त अनर्थक आ सम्पूर्ण संसारबीजक उन्मूलन करैत अछि। तँ ब्रह्मे जानबाक इच्छाक विषय होएबाक योग्य अछि।

एहि प्रकार अपन मान्य समास स्थापित कऽ भाष्यकार “जिज्ञासा जानबाक इच्छा अछि” कहैत ‘जिज्ञासा’ शब्दक अर्थ स्पष्ट करैत छथि। मानि लिअ। मुदा ज्ञान इच्छाक विषय नहि; सुखक प्राप्ति अथवा दुःखक निवारण इच्छाक वास्तविक क्षेत्र होइत अछि, वा ओकर साधन इच्छित होइत अछि। ब्रह्मज्ञान एहन नहि अछि। ओकर अनुभव न तँ लाभरूप सुख जकाँ होइत अछि, न अनिष्टक समाप्ति जकाँ; आ न ओ ई दुनूक साधन अछि—कारण ज्ञान उत्पन्न भऽ गेलापर विशेष सुख न देखाइत अछि आ दुःखो चलैत रहैत अछि। तथापि सूत्रकारक वचनक कारण ज्ञान इच्छाक विषय अछि—ई निष्कर्ष नहि निकलैत। एहि आपत्तिक उत्तरमे कहल गेल अछि—“साक्षात्कारमे परिणत होमयवाला ज्ञान।” केवल ज्ञान इच्छित नहि, बल्कि ओ ज्ञान इच्छित अछि जे साक्षात्कार अथवा अनुभूतिमे परिणत होइत अछि; ‘सन्’ प्रत्ययसँ व्यक्त इच्छाक विषय ओहि परिणतिकारी ज्ञान अछि। “कारण फल इच्छाक

विषय होइत अछि”—इच्छा फल प्राप्त होए धरि ओकर साधनपर प्रवृत्त रहैत अछि; एही अर्थमे एकरा बुझबाक चाही।

मानि लिअ ज्ञान साक्षात्कारमे परिणत होइत अछि; तैयो की ओ इच्छित वस्तु भऽ जाइत अछि? जे ज्ञान अनावश्यक वस्तुक हो, ओ साक्षात्कारमे परिणत भऽ गेलोपर इच्छित नहि होइत। उत्तर अछि—“वास्तवमे प्रमाणजन्य ज्ञान द्वारा साक्षात् करबाक विषय ब्रह्म अछि।” मानि लिअ ब्रह्मविषयक साक्षात्कार होइत अछि; तथापि ओ इच्छित किएक? उत्तर—“ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार वास्तवमे पुरुषार्थ अछि।” की ओ समृद्धि अछि? नहि; ओ ब्रह्मस्वरूप परम आनन्द अछि, समस्त दुःख-मल दूर भऽ गेलापर प्रकट होमयवाला अखण्ड परमानन्द; अतः ओ सर्वोच्च पुरुषार्थ अछि।

मानि लिअ ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार पुरुषार्थ नहि; कारण पुरुषार्थ ओ होइत अछि जे मानवीय प्रयत्नसँ व्याप्त हो। ब्रह्मस्वरूप साक्षात्कारमे उत्पत्ति, विकार, संस्कार वा प्राप्तिमे सँ किछुओ नहि होइत; ब्रह्म नित्य अछि, अतः ओ मानवीय क्रियासँ व्याप्त नहि भऽ सकैत। तखन ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार पुरुषार्थ कोना भेल? उत्तर अछि—“कारण ओ अविद्या आदि अनर्थसभ आ समस्त संसारबीजक उन्मूलन करैत अछि।” सत्य ई अछि जे ब्रह्मस्वरूप साक्षात्कारमे उत्पत्ति आदि नहि होइत; मुदा अनादि अनिर्वचनीय अविद्याक प्रभावसँ ब्रह्मक स्वरूप, आन प्रकाशसँ प्रकाशित नहि होइतहुँ आ स्वयं प्रकाशमान रहितहुँ, अप्रकाशित जकाँ आ आन वस्तुसँ प्रकाशित जकाँ देखाइत अछि; देह, इन्द्रिय आदिसँ भिन्न रहितहुँ अभिन्न जकाँ प्रतीत होइत अछि। तँ अविद्या आदि संसारबीजक नाशसँ पहिने ब्रह्म मानो अप्राप्त अछि, आ ओकर नाश भेलापर मानो प्राप्त भऽ जाइत अछि। एहि रूपमे मनुष्य ओकरा चाहैत अछि; अतः ओ युक्तिपूर्वक पुरुषार्थ कहल जाइत अछि।

‘अविद्या आदि’मे ‘आदि’ शब्द अविद्याक संस्कारसभ केँ समेटैत अछि। अविद्या आदिक निवृत्ति मननजन्य साक्षात्कार—अन्तःकरणक ब्रह्माकार वृत्तिरूप अनुभूति—क प्रभावसँ होइत अछि। अतः मोक्षक आकाङ्क्षी, ऊपर कहल योग्यता सँ सम्पन्न व्यक्ति लेल ब्रह्मे जानबाक इच्छाक विषय अछि। एहन ज्ञान बिना अविद्या आ ओकर संस्कार—जे अनेक दुःखक मूल कारण अछि—नष्ट नहि होइत; आ ओकर नाश बिना जीवक ब्रह्मस्वरूप परम आनन्दक अनुभूति प्रकट नहि होइत, जाहिमे समस्त दुःख-मल दूर भऽ जाइत अछि। अतः ब्रह्मस्वरूप आनन्दक साक्षात्कार चाहनिहार व्यक्तिक लेल तकर साधन—ज्ञान—इच्छित होएबाक चाही। ई ज्ञान वेदान्तवाक्यसँ अपने आप नहि, बल्कि ब्रह्मजिज्ञासासँ सहायक भऽ उत्पन्न होइत अछि। फलतः इच्छाक माध्यमँ मनुष्य ब्रह्मजिज्ञासामे प्रवृत्त होइत अछि, वेदान्तवाक्यक अर्थ बतएबाक इच्छामे नहि; कारण ओ प्रयोजन “अथातो धर्मजिज्ञासा” सूत्रँ, जे अपन वेदाध्ययनक विधि आ अर्थबोधक संकेत करैत अछि, पहिनहिसँ सिद्ध भऽ चुकल अछि। धर्मक जिज्ञासा वेदक अर्थक जिज्ञासा केँ सूचित करैत अछि, आ धर्मक ज्ञान—वेदक पूर्ण अर्थक अङ्ग होएबाक कारण—ब्रह्म आ अधर्मक ज्ञान केँ सेहो गौण रूपँ समेटैत अछि। तथापि ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा धर्मजिज्ञासा जकाँ वेदार्थ-जिज्ञासासँ सूचित भऽ सकैत अछि, मुदा ओकरा धर्मजिज्ञासाक तुरन्त बाद आरम्भ करबाक नियम नहि अछि। केवल वेदाध्ययनक तुरन्त बादो ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा आरम्भ नहि होइत। तँ ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा आरम्भ करबाक लेल आ ई देखेबाक लेल जे ओ नित्य-अनित्य-वस्तुविवेक आदि साधनक ठीक अनन्तर होइत अछि, ई सूत्र कहल गेल; अतः पुनरुक्ति नहि।

मानि लिअ एहि सूत्रसँ कहल गेल जे ब्रह्मज्ञानक साधन जिज्ञासा अछि। मुदा ई बात विचारसंगत नहि, कारण एकर परीक्षा सम्भव नहि; अतः प्रश्न उठैत अछि—“ओ ब्रह्म फेर...”。 ब्रह्म या तँ ज्ञात

होएत अथवा अज्ञात। जँ ज्ञात अछि तँ ओकरा जानबाक इच्छा नहि होएबाक चाही; आ जँ अज्ञात अछि तँ ओकरा जानबाक इच्छा सर्वथा सम्भव नहि।

उत्तर अछि—नित्य शुद्ध, बुद्ध, मुक्त, सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान ब्रह्म अवश्य विद्यमान अछि। ‘ब्रह्म’ शब्दक व्युत्पत्ति विचारनिहार व्यक्ति ‘बृह’ धातुक अर्थानुरूप नित्यत्व, शुद्धता आदि अर्थ बुझैत अछि। सभक आत्मा होएबाक कारण ब्रह्मक अस्तित्व प्रसिद्ध अछि। प्रत्येक व्यक्ति अपन अस्तित्व जानैत अछि; केओ “हम नहि छी” नहि जानैत। जँ आत्माक अस्तित्व प्रसिद्ध नहि रहितय, समस्त जगत “हम नहि छी” एहन ज्ञान करितय। आ आत्मे ब्रह्म अछि।

अपौरुषेय वेदान्तवाक्य स्वतः प्रमाण अछि। ब्रह्म या तँ ज्ञात होएत अथवा अज्ञात। जँ ज्ञात अछि तँ वेदान्तवाक्यसँ उत्पन्न निश्चयात्मक ज्ञानक विषय बनि चुकल अछि; तँ ओकरा पुनः जानबाक इच्छा नहि होएबाक चाही, कारण फल उत्पन्न कऽ चुकल प्रमाण अपन विषयपर फेर क्रिया नहि करैत—अन्यथा प्रमाणक परिभाषाक उल्लङ्घन होएत। आ जँ वेदान्तसँ ब्रह्म ज्ञात नहि अछि, तँ वेदान्त ओकर उपदेश नहि करैत; फलतः ब्रह्म सदैव अज्ञात रहत आ ओकरा जानबाक इच्छा नहि उठि सकत। इच्छा अनुभूत आ प्रिय वस्तुमे होइत अछि, कखनहुँ पूर्व-अनुभूत वस्तुमे नहि। मानि लिअ ओ प्रिय हो; तैयो प्रमाणक अभावमे ओकर ज्ञान सम्भव नहि। शब्दप्रमाण केँ ओकर ज्ञानक साधन कहल जाएब चाही—आगाँ “शास्त्रयोनित्वात्” कहि एही बातक प्रतिपादन होएत। जँ शास्त्र ब्रह्मक ज्ञान नहि करबैत अछि, तँ एहि विषयमे ओकर प्रमाणता कतयसँ? आ ब्रह्मविषयमे अन्य कोनो प्रमाण लागू नहि होइत। अतः ज्ञात वस्तु जानबाक इच्छाक विषय नहि, आ अज्ञात वस्तु न इच्छाक विषय भऽ सकैत अछि न ज्ञेय; फलतः ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा असम्भव—ई आपत्ति अछि।

समाधान अछि—“नित्य शुद्ध, बुद्ध, मुक्त ब्रह्म अवश्य विद्यमान अछि।” अभिप्राय ई जे ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा आरम्भ होएबाक पहिनहिसँ वेदाध्ययन कएल व्यक्ति, निरुक्त, व्याकरण आदि पढ़ि शब्द आ तकर अर्थक सम्बन्ध बुझि, “आदिमे केवल सत् छल” सँ “तत्त्वमसि” धरि वाक्यसभक सामान्य अर्थसँ ब्रह्मक नित्यत्व आदि स्वरूपक सामान्य ज्ञान पबैत अछि; जिज्ञासा बिना सेहो ई सम्भव अछि। भाष्यमे “ब्रह्म” आदि पदसँ ज्ञानविषयक निर्देश कऽ, गौण रूपेँ ब्रह्मविषयक ज्ञानो सूचित कएल गेल अछि; कारण ब्रह्मक अस्तित्व जिज्ञासाक आरम्भमे सर्वथा अज्ञात नहि, केवल सन्दिग्ध अछि। “नित्य” शब्द क्षयजन्य दुःखक निषेध करैत अछि; “शुद्ध” शब्द देहादि उपाधिक कारण होमयवाला दुःख दूर करैत अछि; “बुद्ध” शब्द ब्रह्म केँ आन प्रकाशसँ प्रकाशित नहि, स्वयं प्रकाशमान आनन्दस्वरूप देखबैत अछि, कारण आनन्द आ प्रकाश अभिन्न अछि।

मानि लिअ। जँ मोक्ष पहिनहिसँ विद्यमान रहितय, तँ ब्रह्मक नित्य शुद्ध आदि गुण प्रकट रहितय; मुदा मोक्षसँ पहिने जन्म, वृद्धावस्था, मृत्यु आदि देहधर्मक संग अभेदबुद्धिक कारण दुःखसँ सम्बन्ध रहैत अछि। उत्तर अछि—“मुक्त।” ब्रह्म सदा मुक्त अछि; तथापि अनादि अविद्याक मोहसँ देहादिसँ अभिन्न जकाँ प्रतीत होइत अछि। एहि प्रकार ब्रह्मक निरुपाधिक रूप देखौला बाद भाष्यकार अविद्योपाधिक रूप कहैत छथि—“सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान।” जगतक कारण होएबाक आधारपर ई सिद्ध होइत अछि; कारण किछु कारण बनत कि नहि, ई शक्ति आ ज्ञानक उपस्थित अथवा अनुपस्थितिपर निर्भर अछि। फेर एहि स्वरूपक ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार कतयसँ? उत्तर—“जे ‘ब्रह्म’ शब्दक अर्थक विश्लेषण करैत अछि...”। ब्रह्मक एहि स्वरूपक अनुभूति केवल “आदिमे सत् मात्र छल” आदि वाक्यसभक पूर्वापर विचारसँ नहि, स्वयं ‘ब्रह्म’ शब्दक व्युत्पत्तिसँ सेहो होइत अछि। ‘बृह’ धातु वृद्धि

अथवा उत्कृष्टता सूचित करैत अछि; एहि उत्कृष्टताक कारण ब्रह्ममे आन पदसँ प्रतिपादित नित्यत्व, शुद्धता, बुद्धत्व आदि गुण उपपन्न होइत अछि।

एहि प्रकार 'तत्' शब्दक वाच्यार्थमे शुद्धता आदि प्रसिद्ध देखौला बाद भाष्यकार 'त्वम्' शब्दक वाच्यार्थक सम्बन्धमे कहैत छथि—“सभक आत्मा होएबाक कारण ब्रह्मक अस्तित्व प्रसिद्ध अछि।” धूलिसँ भरल पएरवाला साधारण कृषको धरि सभक लेल ब्रह्मक अस्तित्व प्रसिद्ध अछि। कतयसँ? कारण ओ स्वयं तिनके आत्मा अछि। एहि अर्थमे कहल गेल—“प्रत्येक व्यक्ति अपन अस्तित्व जानैत अछि।” फेर “नहि नहि” कहि आत्म-अज्ञानक निषेध द्वारा आत्मज्ञानक पुष्टि कएल गेल अछि—व्यक्ति “हम छी” जानबाकमे विफल नहि होइत, बल्कि निश्चित रूपेँ जानैत अछि। केओ कहि सकैत अछि—“हम छी” जानितो आत्मा नहि जानि सकैत अछि। उत्तर—“जँ आत्माक अस्तित्व प्रसिद्ध नहि रहितय...”। जँ ‘हमपन’क अधिष्ठान जीवरूप आत्मा केँ ओ नहि जानितय, तँ ‘हम’क ज्ञानो नहि होइत। मानि लिअ सभ लोक ‘हमपन’क अधिष्ठान आत्मा केँ जानैत अछि; ताहिसँ ब्रह्मक की सम्बन्ध? उत्तर—“आ आत्मे ब्रह्म अछि।” ‘तत्’ आ ‘त्वम्’क समानाधिकरण सम्बन्धक कारण; श्रुतिसँ ‘तत्’क वाच्यार्थक शुद्धता, बुद्धता आदि प्रसिद्ध अछि, प्रत्यक्ष अनुभवसँ ‘त्वम्’क वाच्य जीव प्रसिद्ध अछि, आ पदार्थज्ञान वाक्यार्थज्ञानसँ पहिने होइत अछि। अतः “तत्त्वमसि” वाक्यसँ ‘त्वम्’क वाच्यार्थ जीवक ब्रह्मस्वरूपक अनुभूति उपपन्न होइत अछि।

जँ लोकमे आत्मरूप ब्रह्म प्रसिद्ध अछि, तँ ओ पहिनहिसँ ज्ञात भेल; फेर ओकरा जानबाक इच्छा नहि होएबाक चाही। उत्तर—नहि; कारण ओकर विशेष स्वरूपक विषयमे परस्पर-विरोधी अनेक मत अछि। साधारण लोक आ लोकायत आत्मा केँ केवल चैतन्ययुक्त देह मानैत अछि। आन किछु लोक केवल चेतनेन्द्रियसभ केँ आत्मा कहैत अछि। किछु मन केँ आत्मा मानैत अछि। किछु क्षणिक ज्ञानमात्र केँ, किछु शून्य केँ। आन किछु देहसँ भिन्न, देहान्तरगामी, कर्ता आ भोक्ता आत्मा मानैत अछि।

आपत्तिकर्ता एहि विकल्पसभमे प्रथमक दोष बतबैत अछि—“जँ लोकमे...”। एतय ‘लोक’क अर्थ गुरु-शिष्य-परम्परा अछि। जँ “तत्त्वमसि” वाक्यसँ ब्रह्म आत्मरूप प्रसिद्ध अछि—जतय ‘ब्रह्मरूप आत्मा’ कहबाक चाही—तँ ई अभेद प्रतिपादनक उद्देश्यसँ कहल गेल अछि; तखन फेर निष्कर्ष निकलत जे ज्ञात होएबाक कारण ओ जिज्ञासाक विषय नहि। उत्तर—“नहि।” किएक? “कारण ओकर विशेष स्वरूपक विषयमे परस्पर-विरोधी अनेक मत अछि।” एहन विरोधी मत प्रमाणक अभावमे निश्चय-अनिश्चयक कारण बनैत अछि। अतः ब्रह्मक सामान्य अस्तित्व ज्ञात रहितहुँ ओकर यथार्थ विशेषस्वरूप सन्दिग्ध अछि; एही कारण जिज्ञासा आवश्यक अछि।

किछु लोकक मतमे आत्मा केवल भोक्ता अछि, कर्ता नहि। आन किछु लोक कहैत छथि जे ओहि आत्मसँ भिन्न सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान ईश्वर छथि। दोसर किछु लोकक मत अछि जे ईश्वर ओहि भोक्ता जीवक आत्मा छथि। एहि प्रकार अनेक लोक युक्ति तथा प्रमाणसिद्ध वा भ्रान्त शास्त्रवचनक आधारपर भिन्न-भिन्न मत मानैत छथि। एहि मतसभमे सँ कोनो एक मत केँ विचार-विमर्श बिना स्वीकार कएनिहार व्यक्ति परम कल्याणसँ वञ्चित भऽ अनर्थ प्राप्त करत। अतः ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छाक कथनसँ आरम्भ कऽ वेदान्तवाक्यक आदरपूर्वक विचार शुरू कएल जाइत अछि; वेदान्तसँ अविरोधी तर्क एकर सहायक अछि आ परम आनन्दक प्राप्ति एकर प्रयोजन अछि।

एहि मतभेदक कारण ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा युक्तिसंगत होइत अछि। जे अधिष्ठान विवादक विषय अछि, ओकर सामान्य अस्तित्व सभ दर्शनक निष्कर्षसँ सिद्ध मानए पड़त; अन्यथा परस्पर-विरोधी मत सम्भव नहि होइत, कारण निराधार मतसभक परस्पर विरोध नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। अलग-

अलग अधिष्ठानक विषयमे कहल मतो परस्पर-विरोधी नहि होइत—“बुद्धि अनित्य अछि” आ “आत्मा नित्य अछि” ई दुनू कथन एक-दोसरक विरोधी नहि। अतः सभ दर्शन ई मानैत अछि जे वेदान्तसँ ज्ञात “तत्” पदक वाच्यक शुद्धता आदि कोनो अधिष्ठानमे अछि, आ “त्वम्” पदक वाच्य जीव अनुभवसँ सिद्ध अछि। मतभेद केवल ओकर प्रकट वा अप्रकट होएबाक ढङ्ग तथा विभिन्न अवस्थासभक विषयमे अछि। तँ अधिष्ठानक सामान्य ज्ञान रहितो ओकर विशेष स्वरूपक विषयमे विरोधी मत रहबाक कारण सन्देह सर्वथा उचित अछि।

एहि मतसभमे भाष्यकार पहिने “त्वम्” पदक वाच्यक विषयमे विरोधी धारणा देखबैत छथि—“साधारण मनुष्य” सँ आरम्भ कऽ “केवल भोक्ता, कर्ता नहि” धरि। आत्मा केँ चैतन्ययुक्त देह, इन्द्रिय, मन अथवा क्षणिक विज्ञान मानलापर “तत्” पदक वाच्यक नित्यत्व आदि धर्म “त्वम्” पदक वाच्यसँ सम्बन्धित नहि भऽ सकैत, कारण दुनूमे परस्पर असामञ्जस्य अछि। शून्यवादियो जे वस्तु केँ कथनयोग्य नहि मानैत छथि आ जे कोनो शब्दक अर्थ नहि अछि, ओकरा “तत्” आ “त्वम्” पदक वाच्य कोना मानल जा सकैत अछि? कर्ता आ भोक्तारूप आत्मा सेहो विकारशील होएबाक कारण “तत्” पदक वाच्यक नित्यत्व आदिसँ मेल नहि खाइत अछि। जे मत आत्मा केँ कर्ता नहि, केवल भोक्ता मानैत अछि, ताहूमे भोक्तृत्व विकार सूचित करैत अछि, तँ नित्यत्व आदिसँ असामञ्जस्य रहैत अछि। जे मत आत्मासभ केँ अनेक मानैत अछि, भलँ हुनका भोक्ता नहि मानए, ताहूमे बहुत्वक कारण अनित्यत्व आदि दोष उत्पन्न होइत अछि आ अद्वैतक परित्याग होइत अछि।

“त्वम्” पदक वाच्यक विषयमे जे विरोधी मत अछि, ठीक ताहि प्रकार “तत्” पदक वाच्यक विषयमे सेहो मतभेद अछि। लोकायत आ वेद केँ अप्रमाण माननिहार लोक “तत्” पदक वाच्यक ज्ञान केँ मिथ्या मानैत छथि। वेद केँ प्रमाण माननिहारो किछु लोक कहैत छथि जे “तत्” पदक वाच्य केवल लाक्षणिक अछि अथवा वेदान्त-वाक्यक मुख्य प्रतिपाद्य नहि अछि। एहि प्रकार “त्वम्” पदक वाच्यक विषयमे मतभेद देखबैत भाष्यकार “तत्” पदक वाच्यक विषयमे मतभेदक संकेत करैत छथि।

एखन “तत्” पदक वाच्यसँ प्रत्यक्षतः सम्बन्धित विरोधी मत कहल जाइत अछि—किछु लोक कहैत छथि जे जीवसभसँ भिन्न सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान ईश्वर छथि। एतय “तत्” पद जीवात्मासभक अपेक्षामे प्रयुक्त अछि। ईश्वर केवल देह आदिसँ नहि, जीवात्मासभसँ सेहो भिन्न छथि आ सम्पूर्ण जगतक नियन्ता छथि। सर्वज्ञता आ सर्वशक्तिमत्ता—ई दुनू स्वाभाविक गुण हुनक नियन्त्रित्व स्थापित करबाक लेल कहल गेल अछि। मुदा जीवसभसँ भिन्न ई ईश्वर “त्वम्” पदक वाच्यक संग समानाधिकरण सम्बन्ध नहि राखि सकैत छथि। तँ अन्तिम मत कहल गेल—“किछु लोक कहैत छथि जे ईश्वर भोक्ताक आत्मा छथि।” अर्थात् अविद्यासँ उपहित भोक्ता जीवक आत्मा, “तत्” पदक वाच्य ईश्वर छथि; अतः जीव ईश्वरसँ वास्तवमे अभिन्न अछि, जहिना घटाकाश महाकाशसँ अभिन्न अछि।

विरोधी मतसभक उल्लेख समाप्त कऽ भाष्यकार ओकर कारण कहैत छथि—“एहि प्रकार अनेक लोक...”। किछु मत यथार्थ युक्तिपर, किछु कुतर्कपर; किछु यथार्थ अर्थमे बुझल शास्त्रवचनपर, किछु अनुचित अर्थ लगाओल शास्त्रवचनपर आधारित अछि। मानि लिअ विरोधी मतसभ अछि आ ओहिसँ सन्देह उत्पन्न होइत अछि; तथापि ब्रह्मक जिज्ञासा किएक आरम्भ हो? उत्तर अछि—“एहि मतसभमे सँ जे व्यक्ति विचार बिना कोनो एक केँ स्वीकार करैत अछि...”। परम कल्याण सत्यज्ञानसँ प्राप्त होइत अछि, असत्यज्ञानसँ नहि। असत्यज्ञानक कारण श्रद्धा नष्ट होइत अछि आ अनर्थ प्राप्त होइत अछि; एहि कारण कहल गेल अछि—“आ अनर्थ प्राप्त करत।” अन्तमे “अतः” शब्दसँ सूत्रक अभिप्रायक निष्कर्ष कएल गेल अछि।

वेदान्तक जिज्ञासामे वेदान्त-वाक्यक अर्थविचारे प्रधान तर्क अछि। एकर अविरोधी आन तर्क सेहो सहायक होइत अछि—जहिना वेदक प्रामाण्यक विचारमे पूर्वमीमांसा, आ प्रत्यक्ष आदि प्रमाणक विचारमे न्यायशास्त्रक तर्क। जकर ई सभ सहायक अछि, ताहि ब्रह्मजिज्ञासाक चर्चा एतय कएल गेल अछि। अतः ब्रह्मज्ञान उत्पन्न करौनिहार आ परम कल्याणक साधन बननिहार ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा अवश्य आरम्भ करबाक चाही।

ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक विषय मानल गेल अछि। एखन एहि ब्रह्मक लक्षण की अछि? पूज्य सूत्रकार कहैत छथि—

जाहिसँ एहि जगतक जन्म आदि होइत अछि

पहिल सूत्रमे जिज्ञासाक आरम्भ उचित सिद्ध कऽ सूत्रकार एखन ब्रह्मक अनुसन्धान आरम्भ करैत छथि —“जाहिसँ एहि जगतक जन्म आदि होइत अछि।” भाष्यकार एहि सूत्रक प्रस्तावना करैत कहैत छथि —“ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छा करबाक चाही—ई कहल गेल। एखन एहि ब्रह्मक लक्षण की अछि?” यद्यपि ब्रह्मस्वरूपक ज्ञान केँ प्रधान विषय मानला मात्रसँ ओकर सहायक प्रमाण आदि विषयसभो प्रतिज्ञात भऽ जाइत अछि, तथापि ब्रह्मक स्वरूपे प्रधान अछि; तँ आपत्ति आ समाधान द्वारा पहिने ओकरे स्थापित कएल जाइत अछि। जे किछु अनुभवमे अबैत अछि, ओ सीमित, अशुद्ध, जड़ आ विनाशी अछि। एहि वस्तुसभक ज्ञानसँ ब्रह्मक स्वरूपक लक्षण नहि कएल जा सकैत, कारण ब्रह्म एकर विपरीत—नित्य, शुद्ध आ चैतन्यस्वरूप—अछि। उत्पन्न वस्तुसँ नित्य वस्तुक लक्षण केओ नहि करैत अछि।

ब्रह्मक अपन नित्यत्व आदि गुणसँ सेहो लक्षण नहि कएल जा सकैत, कारण ई गुणसभ पहिने सँ ज्ञात नहि अछि। लक्षण ओहि वस्तुसँ होइत अछि जे प्रसिद्ध हो, सर्वथा अज्ञात वस्तुसँ नहि। शब्दप्रमाण मात्रसँ सेहो एतय लक्षण सिद्ध नहि होएत; कारण जँ ब्रह्म सर्वथा अज्ञात अछि, तँ ओ कोनो शब्दक अर्थ नहि बनि सकैत आ फलतः वाक्यार्थो नहि भऽ सकैत। अतः लक्षणक अभावमे ब्रह्म जानबाक इच्छाक विषय नहि बनि सकैत—ई आपत्तिकर्ताक मत अछि।

पूज्य सूत्रकार एहि आपत्तिक उत्तर दैत छथि—“जाहिसँ एहि जगतक जन्म आदि होइत अछि।” अनुभवसिद्ध जगत स्वयं ब्रह्मक लक्षण ओकर गुण अथवा ओकर संग तादात्म्यक कारण नहि हो; मुदा ब्रह्मसँ उत्पन्न होएबाक कारण जगत ब्रह्मक लक्षण भऽ सकैत अछि—जहिना विभिन्न देशमे पहुँचब सूर्यक गतिक लक्षण होइत अछि। “जन्म आदि”क अर्थ अछि उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाश। सूत्रकार लाघवक कारण नपुंसकलिङ्गमे “जन्मादि” शब्द प्रयोग करैत छथि; भाष्यकार एकरा स्पष्ट करबाक लेल समानाधिकरण नपुंसकलिङ्ग पद—जन्म, स्थिति आ भङ्ग—दैत छथि।

उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाशमे उत्पत्तिक प्राधान्य श्रुतिवचन आ वस्तुस्वभाव—दुनू सँ सिद्ध अछि। श्रुति कहैत अछि—“जाहिसँ ई प्राणीसभ उत्पन्न होइत अछि।” उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ प्रलयक क्रमो स्वाभाविक अछि; स्थिति आ विनाश ओहि अधिष्ठानक होइत अछि जे उत्पत्तिसँ अस्तित्वमे आएल हो। “एहि जगतक” पदमे “ई” शब्द प्रत्यक्ष आदि प्रमाणसँ ज्ञात जगत केँ सूचित करैत अछि; षष्ठी-विभक्ति एकर उत्पत्ति आदि सँ सम्बन्ध बतबैत अछि। “जाहिसँ” कारणक निर्देश अछि।

नाम आ रूपसँ विभक्त, अनेक कर्ता आ भोक्ता सँ युक्त, तथा देश, काल, कारण, क्रिया आ फलसँ निश्चित रूपँ व्यवस्थित एहि जगतक रचना-बिन्यास मनसँ कल्पना करबो कठिन अछि। एहन जगतक उत्पत्ति आदि जाहि कारणसँ होइत अछि, ओ कारण सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान ब्रह्म अछि। “जाहिसँ एहि जगतक जन्म आदि होइत अछि—ओ ब्रह्म अछि”—एहि प्रकार सूत्रक वाक्य पूरा होइत अछि।

“नाम आ रूपसँ विभक्त” आदि पदसभ स्वयं स्पष्ट अछि। मानि लिअ जगतक अनेक सम्भावित कारणक चर्चा चलैत अछि—प्रधान प्रकृति, काल, ग्रहदेवता अथवा दिशारक्षक इन्द्रादिक क्रिया, आकस्मिकता, वस्तुस्वभाव अथवा अभाव। तखन सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान ब्रह्म केँ जगतक उत्पत्ति

आदिक कारण किएक मानल जाए? उत्तर अछि—“नाम आ रूपसँ विभक्त, अनेक कर्ता आ भोक्ता सँ युक्त...”। “विभक्त” आदि विशेषण बुद्धिमान कारणक स्थापना करैत अछि आ अचेतन प्रधान, मनोकल्पित कारण वा अभाव आदिक कारणत्वक निषेध करैत अछि।

नाम-रूपसँ विभक्त घट आदि वस्तु बुद्धिमान कर्तासँ उत्पन्न होइत देखल जाइत अछि। विवादाधीन जगतो नाम-रूपसँ विभक्त अछि; अतः एकर बुद्धिमान कर्ता स्वीकार करए पड़त। कुम्हार पहिने अपन बुद्धिमे “घट” नाम आ सँकुचित कण्ठ आदि रूपक विचार करैत अछि, तखन बाहरी घट बनबैत अछि। अतः उत्पन्न होमयवाला घट पहिने कर्ताक सङ्कल्पमे विषय-कारणरूपेँ उपस्थित रहैत अछि—“ओ घट बनबैत अछि।” न्यायो कहैत अछि—“जे बुद्धिमे उपस्थित अछि, ओ सर्वथा अभावरूप नहि अछि।” जे अचेतन वस्तु अपन बुद्धिमे किछु विचार नहि कऽ सकैत, ओकरा द्वारा जगत-सृष्टिक कल्पना नहि कएल जा सकैत।

कहल जा सकैत अछि जे बुद्धिमान ग्रहदेवता अथवा दिशारक्षक देवतासभ नाम-रूपक विचार अपन बुद्धिमे कऽ जगत बनबैत छथि; तखन ऊपर कहल स्वरूपवाला ब्रह्म अनावश्यक अछि। उत्तर अछि—“अनेक कर्ता आ भोक्ता सँ युक्त।” किछु व्यक्ति रसोइया आ यज्ञक ऋत्विज् जकाँ कर्ता छथि, भोक्ता नहि। किछु आन व्यक्ति श्राद्धमे पितर तथा वैश्वानरेष्टिमे पुत्र जकाँ भोक्ता छथि, कर्ता नहि। तँ सूत्रमे कर्ता आ भोक्ता दुनूक उल्लेख कएल गेल अछि।

देश, काल, कारण, क्रिया आ फल—ई इतरेतर-द्वन्द्व समास अछि आ प्रत्येक पद केँ अलग-अलग ग्रहण करबाक चाही। एहि कर्ता-भोक्तासभक निवासस्थान ई जगत अछि। एहि जगतमे किछु प्राणी निश्चित देशमे उत्पन्न होइत अछि—जहिना कृष्णमृग। किछु निश्चित कालमे—जहिना कोइलीक कूजब। किछु निश्चित कारणसँ—जहिना वर्षाक आरम्भमे मेघगर्जनक कारण बगुलाक गर्भाधान। किछु निश्चित कर्म करैत अछि—जहिना दोसरक लेल यज्ञ करबाक अधिकार केवल ब्राह्मणक अछि, आनक नहि। तहिना किछु निश्चित फल भोगैत अछि—किछु सुखी, किछु दुःखी; आ जे एतय सुखी अछि, ओ आन ठाम दुःखी भऽ सकैत अछि।

एहन सूक्ष्म व्यवस्था आकस्मिकतासँ, वस्तुस्वभाव मात्रसँ अथवा सर्वज्ञ-सर्वशक्तिमान नहि रहनिहार कोनो सीमित कर्तासँ मेल नहि खाइत। ग्रहदेवता आ दिशारक्षक देवताक ज्ञान आ सामर्थ्य सीमित अछि; तँ ओ सभ सम्पूर्ण जगतक ज्ञान राखि ओकर निर्माण नहि कऽ सकैत छथि। एकटा देहक रचनाक पूर्ण विन्यासो कोनो समय मनसँ सहज कल्पित नहि भऽ सकैत; सम्पूर्ण विश्वक विन्यासक कल्पना तऽ आओर दूरक बात अछि। अतः जगतक उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाशक सर्वज्ञ-सर्वशक्तिमान कारण ब्रह्मे छथि। एहि प्रकार सूत्रक शेष वाक्य पूरा होइत अछि—“ओ ब्रह्म अछि।”

मानि लिअ। मुदा “जन्म आदि” पदसँ केवल उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाशे किएक बुझल जाए? वृद्धि, रूपान्तरण आ क्षय आदि भावविकार किएक नहि? उत्तर अछि—अन्य समस्त भावविकार एहि तीनूमे समाहित अछि; तँ एतय उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाशे कहल गेल अछि। यास्क छह भावविकार गनबैत छथि—जन्म लैत अछि, अस्तित्वमे रहैत अछि, बढ़ैत अछि, रूप बदलैत अछि, क्षीण होइत अछि आ नष्ट होइत अछि। मुदा वृद्धि आदि जगतक स्थितिकालमे घटित होइत अछि; एहि कारण मूल कारणसँ जगतक उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाश स्पष्ट नहि होएबाक सन्देह भऽ सकैत छल। एहि सन्देहक निराकरण लेल ब्रह्मसँ उत्पत्ति, ब्रह्ममे स्थिति आ ब्रह्ममे लय—ई तीनू प्रधान रूपेँ ग्रहण कएल गेल अछि।

वृद्धि भागसभक बढ़ब अछि। जहिना दूटा सूतसँ बहुत भागवाला पैघ कपड़ा उत्पन्न होइत अछि, तहिना वृद्धि वस्तुतः उत्पत्तिक अन्तर्गत अछि। रूपान्तरण धर्मलक्षणक अनुसार तीन प्रकारक कहल गेल अछि—

अवस्था-परिवर्तन आ लक्षण-परिवर्तन सेहो मूलतः उत्पत्ति अछि। उदाहरणार्थ, सुवर्णरूपी आधारमे कङ्कण बनब धर्मलक्षण-परिवर्तन अछि; ई कङ्कणक उत्पत्ति मात्र अछि। तहिना कङ्कणक वर्तमानता आदि लक्षण-परिवर्तन अछि; सेहो उत्पत्ति अछि। नवीनता, पुरानापन आदि भेद अवस्था-परिवर्तन अछि; ईहो उत्पत्ति अछि। क्षय भागसभक घटब अछि, अतएव विनाशक अन्तर्गत अछि। एहि प्रकार यथायोग्य उत्पत्ति आदि मे वृद्धि आदि समाहित भऽ जाइत अछि; तँ ओकर पृथक् उल्लेख नहि कएल गेल। मानि लिअ जे ई सभ उत्पत्ति आदि मे समाहित नहि होइत, तखनहुँ केवल उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाशक उल्लेख उचित होइत; कारण वेदवाक्य—“जाहिसँ ई प्राणीसभ उत्पन्न होइत अछि” आदि—स्मरणमे आबि ब्रह्म जगतक मूल कारण रूपेँ निश्चित होइत। अन्यथा उत्पत्ति, सत्ता, वृद्धि आदिक ग्रहणसँ यास्कक निरुक्तवाला पाठ स्मरणमे अबैत, जे मूल कारण नहि, बल्कि सृष्टिक पश्चात् स्थितिक कालमे वस्तुक विकारसभक चर्चा करैत अछि। एहि आपत्तिक निराकरण लेल वेदमे कहल उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ विनाशे ग्रहण कएल गेल अछि।

ऊपर वर्णित विशेषतासँ युक्त जगतक उत्पत्ति आदि अचेतन प्रधान, परमाणु, अभाव, संसारी जीव अथवा सर्वज्ञ-सर्वशक्तिमान ईश्वरक अतिरिक्त आन कोनो कारणसँ मानल नहि जा सकैत अछि। ई वस्तुस्वभाव मात्रसँ सेहो नहि होइत, कारण एतय विशेष देश, काल आ कारणक अपेक्षा देखाइत अछि। जे लोक ईश्वरक कारणत्वक अनुमान करैत छथि, ओ एहि अनुमान केँ संसारी जीवसँ भिन्न ईश्वरक अस्तित्व आदिक प्रमाण मानैत छथि। मानि लिअ उत्पत्तिमात्र कहला सँ स्थिति आ विनाश अनिवार्यतः बुझाइत अछि; तखन सूत्रमे “जन्म आदि” कहबाक की प्रयोजन? उत्तर—“जन्मादिक कारण ब्रह्म अछि” इत्यादि। एहि शब्दसँ ब्रह्मक उपादान-कारणत्व सूचित होइत अछि; केवल उत्पत्ति तऽ निमित्त-कारणमे सेहो सामान्य अछि, अतः उपादान-कारणत्व स्पष्ट नहि करैत। पूर्वोक्त विशेष कारण आ परिणामक प्रयोजन “ऊपर वर्णित विशेषतासँ युक्त जगत” इत्यादि वाक्यमे कहल गेल। एहि लेखांशद्वारा प्रतिज्ञात ब्रह्मस्वरूपक लक्षणरूप स्थापना कएल गेल; ओकर ज्ञानक प्रमाण आगाँ कहल जाएत।

एतय सेहो सूत्र “जाहिसँ एहि जगतक जन्म आदि होइत अछि” मे ओही विषयक प्रतिज्ञा भऽ गेल—एहन नहि। सूत्रसभक प्रयोजन वेदान्त-वाक्यसभ केँ फूलक माला जकाँ एक सूत्रमे गूँथब अछि। कारण ब्रह्म-साक्षात्कारक विचार आ समर्थन सूत्रक विषय बनाओल वेदान्त-वाक्यसभक आधारपर होइत अछि। नैयायिकसभ कहैत छथि—प्रतिज्ञामे सम्भव मानल विषय केँ प्रमाणसँ सिद्ध कएल जा सकैत अछि; मुदा जे प्रतिज्ञा उत्पन्न होइतहि बाधित भऽ जाए, ओकर कोनो प्रमाण रक्षा नहि कऽ सकैत, जहिना “बाँझ स्त्री माता अछि”। एहि कारण उत्पत्ति आदि केँ प्रतिज्ञाक आधार मानल गेल। वैशेषिक आदि सेहो एहि आधारसँ ईश्वरक अनुमान करैत छथि। भाष्यकार ई बात एहि लेल कहैत छथि जे एहि आधारसभ केँ प्रतिज्ञाक हेतु रूपमे दृढ़ कएल जाए—“एहि अनुमानसँ” इत्यादि। “एतय सेहो” कहि प्रश्न उठाओल गेल अछि जे जखन एहि प्रसङ्गसँ अधिकारविषय समाप्त भऽ गेल, तखन मित्रक सामर्थ्यक उदाहरणसँ अगिला प्रसङ्गक विषयमे प्रश्न किएक? उत्तर—सूत्रसभ वेदान्त-वाक्यक तात्पर्य केँ क्रमबद्ध करबाक लेल अछि। वेदान्त-वाक्यसभक विचारसँ अविद्याक द्विविध—आवरण आ संस्कार—नाश भऽ ब्रह्मक अभिव्यक्ति अर्थात् साक्षात्कार सिद्ध होइत अछि।

ग्रन्थक अन्तमे वेदान्त-वाक्यक अर्थविचार पूर्ण होइतहि ब्रह्मक अभिव्यक्ति सिद्ध होइत अछि; अनुमान आदि आन प्रमाणसँ ई सिद्ध नहि होइत। तथापि जगतक उत्पत्तिक कारण बतौनिहार वेदान्त-वाक्यसभक अर्थक पुष्टि लेल वेदान्तविरोधी नहि रहने अनुमानो प्रमाण होइत अछि; कारण शास्त्र स्वयं तर्क केँ सहायक मानैत अछि। श्रुति कहैत अछि—“एकरा सुनबाक, मनन करबाक अछि”; आ “पण्डित बुद्धिमान व्यक्ति गान्धार देश पहुँचि जाइत अछि”—अर्थात् आचार्यवाला मनुष्य अपन बुद्धिसँ सहायता पबैत अछि। एहि ब्रह्मक विषयमे शब्दप्रमाणक अतिरिक्त आन प्रमाण नहि अछि—एहन कहला पर मनन कतयसँ होएत, आ ब्रह्मानुभूति कतयसँ? उत्तर—“मुदा वेदान्त-वाक्यसभ अछि।” एतय अनुमान ओहि प्रकारक बुझबाक अछि जे वेदान्तसँ विरोध नहि करैत हो आ वेदान्तपर आश्रित हो। शब्दप्रमाणसँ विरोध नहि करैत, ओकर आधारपर चलैत युक्तियुक्त निर्णय केँ मनन कहल जाइत अछि। तर्क अनुमान अथवा अर्थापत्ति दुनूमे सँ कोनो भऽ सकैत अछि।

धर्म केँ जानबाक इच्छामे जकाँ केवल श्रुति आदि प्रमाण होइत अछि, ब्रह्म केँ जानबाक इच्छामे एहन नहि; एतय श्रुति आदि, अनुभव आदि—जतय-जतय लागू हो—सभ प्रमाण अछि, कारण ब्रह्मज्ञानक पर्यवसान अनुभवमे होइत अछि। मानि लिअ। जखन मानव-बुद्धि धर्मज्ञानमे सहायक नहि, तखन ब्रह्मज्ञानमे सेहो किएक सहायक होएत? उत्तर—“धर्म-जिज्ञासा जकाँ नहि।” धर्मक विषयमे श्रुति, इतिहास, पुराण आ स्मृति प्रमाण अछि। अनुभव अन्तःकरणक विशेष वृत्ति अर्थात् ब्रह्म-साक्षात्कार अछि; एहि प्रमाणक फल अविद्या हटला सँ ब्रह्मस्वरूपक अभिव्यक्ति होइत अछि। फल शब्दकेँ उपचारसँ कहल गेल, कारण ई कोनो नवीन उत्पादित वा संस्कारित वस्तु नहि। धर्म-जिज्ञासामे प्रत्यक्ष आदि अनुभव सहायक रूपमे चलैत अछि, प्रत्यक्षतः नहि; मुदा ब्रह्म-जिज्ञासामे अनुभव—अर्थात् साक्षात्कार—प्रत्यक्ष रूपेँ होइत अछि। ब्रह्म-जिज्ञासाक विषय स्वयं अनुभवगम्य ब्रह्म अछि; तँ कहल गेल—“ब्रह्मज्ञान अनुभवमे समाप्त होइत अछि।” ब्रह्मानुभव, अर्थात् ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार, समस्त दुःख नष्ट भेला पछाति परम आनन्दरूप होएबाक कारण परम पुरुषार्थ अछि।

आ ब्रह्मज्ञानक विषय विद्यमान वस्तु अछि। जे कर्तव्य अछि, ओकर प्रामाण्य केवल शास्त्रक होइत अछि; कारण ओ अनुभवपर निर्भर नहि आ कर्तव्यक अस्तित्व व्यक्तिक कर्मपर निर्भर अछि। लौकिक वा वैदिक कर्म कएल जा सकैत अछि, नहि कएल जा सकैत अछि, वा अन्य प्रकारेँ कएल जा सकैत अछि—जहिना घोड़ापर, पैदल वा अन्य प्रकारेँ जाएब, अथवा सर्वथा नहि जाएब। तहिना “अतिरात्रमे सोलहम पात्रक उपयोग करू”, “सोलहम पात्रक उपयोग नहि करू”; “सूर्योदयक बाद आहुति दिअ”, “सूर्योदयक पहिने आहुति दिअ”—एहन विधि-निषेध विकल्प अथवा सामान्य नियम आ अपवाद रूपेँ सार्थक होइत अछि। मानि लिअ जिज्ञासाक विषय ब्रह्मानुभव अछि; मुदा ब्रह्म ओकर विषय नहि बनि सकैत—एहन आपत्तिक उत्तर अछि—“आ ब्रह्मज्ञानक विषय विद्यमान वस्तु अछि।” ज्ञाता-ज्ञेयक सम्बन्ध जगताभाववाली वृत्तिक मिथ्या आकार अछि। धर्मज्ञान एहन अनुभवमे समाप्त नहि होइत; कारण धर्मक अनुभव स्वयं पुरुषार्थ नहि, ओकर पालनसँ प्राप्त फल पुरुषार्थ अछि; केवल शब्दप्रमाणेँ धर्मपालन निश्चित भऽ जाइत अछि, अनुभवक आवश्यकता नहि।

वस्तु “एहि प्रकार” वा “ओहि प्रकार नहि”, “अस्ति” वा “नास्ति” जकाँ विकल्प स्वीकार नहि करैत। विकल्प मनुष्यक बुद्धिपर निर्भर होइत अछि; मुदा वस्तुक सत्यस्वरूपक ज्ञान मानवबुद्धिपर नहि, स्वयं वस्तुपर निर्भर अछि। एकहि खम्भाक विषयमे सत्य ज्ञान “ई खम्भा अछि” अथवा “ई मनुष्य अछि”—दुनू रूपमे नहि होइत। “ई खम्भा अथवा अन्य कोनो मनुष्य अछि” भ्रमात्मक ज्ञान अछि; “ई निश्चय खम्भा अछि” सत्य ज्ञान अछि, कारण ई वस्तुपर निर्भर अछि। अतः विद्यमान वस्तुक

प्रामाण्य वस्तु-तन्त्र होइत अछि। सहजज्ञानक विषय वर्तमान समयमे विद्यमान नहि, कारण ओ अद्यापि निश्चित नहि; “जे कर्तव्य अछि, ओकर अस्तित्व कर्म करनिहार व्यक्तिपर निर्भर अछि।” लौकिक आ वैदिक कर्मक कर्तृत्व मनुष्यपर निर्भर अछि, तँ कएल जा नहि कएल जा सकैत अछि। घोड़ापर जाएब आदिसँ लौकिक कर्मक अनिश्चितता, आ अतिरात्रक पात्रविधान आदिसँ वैदिक कर्मक अनिश्चितता देखाओल गेल अछि।

मनुष्य कै कर्तव्यक विषयमे स्वतन्त्रता अछि; एहि कारण विधि आ निषेध सार्थक होइत अछि, कारण कर्म करब वा छोड़ब हुनकर अधीन अछि। “उपयोग करबाक चाही” विधि अछि, “उपयोग नहि करबाक चाही” निषेध। सूर्योदयक पहिने अथवा बाद आहुति देबाक विधान, मनुष्यक अस्थि स्पर्श नहि करबाक निषेध आ ब्रह्महत्या करनिहार लेल ओहि अस्थिक आभूषण धारण करबाक विशेष विधान— ई सभ एहि प्रकारक विधि-निषेध अछि। ई विकल्प, सामान्य नियम आ अपवाद रूपेँ सार्थक होइत अछि। दू परस्पर-विरोधी, समान बलवाला विधान एकेठाम लागू होएत तऽ विकल्प अनिवार्य होइत अछि। मानव-अस्थि स्पर्शक सामान्य निषेध कै ब्रह्महत्या करनिहारक आभूषण-धारणक विशेष विधान बाधित करैत अछि; अतः एतय विकल्प नहि, अपवाद अछि। केवल विधि-निषेध द्वारा एहन अप्राप्त किन्तु उत्पन्न कएल जा सकनिहार वस्तु सिद्ध होइत अछि, जाहिमे मनुष्यक प्रवृत्ति-निवृत्तिक स्वतन्त्रता अछि।

विद्यमान वस्तु सभमे एहन नहि; तँ कहल गेल—“वस्तु एहि प्रकार वा ओहि प्रकार नहि, अस्ति वा नास्ति—एहन विकल्प नहि करैत।” एतय द्रव्यक अस्तित्व वा अनस्तित्वमे विकल्पक निषेध अछि। मानि लिअ विद्यमान वस्तुमे सेहो विकल्प देखाइत अछि, जहिना “ई खम्भा अछि वा मनुष्य।” तखन वस्तु विकल्प नहि करैत—ई बात केना? उत्तर—विकल्प मनुष्यक अन्तःकरणमे होइत अछि। संशय आ भ्रम अन्तःकरण आ ओकर संस्कारपर निर्भर होइत अछि—सपना जकाँ केवल मनसँ, अथवा मन, इन्द्रिय आ संस्कारक संयुक्त क्रियासँ। खम्भा मनुष्य अछि कि नहि—एहन संशय, अथवा खम्भामे मनुष्यक भ्रम, वास्तविक खम्भा वा मनुष्यपर निर्भर नहि; सामान्य गुणक अधिष्ठानक ग्रहणपर निर्भर अछि। अतः संशय-भ्रम वस्तुक स्वरूप नहि बदलैत। सत्यज्ञान बुद्धिपर नहि, वस्तुपर निर्भर अछि; तँ वस्तुक स्वरूप संशयादि नहि, यथार्थ ज्ञानसँ निश्चित होइत अछि।

तखन ब्रह्मज्ञानो वस्तुतन्त्र होएत, कारण ओकर विषय विद्यमान वस्तु अछि। यदि विद्यमान वस्तु अछि, तऽ ब्रह्म आन प्रमाणक विषय अवश्य होएत; तखन वेदान्त-वाक्यक विचार निरर्थक नहि भऽ जाएत? नहि, कारण ब्रह्म इन्द्रियक विषय नहि, अतः अन्य प्रमाणसँ ओकर सम्बन्ध ग्रहण नहि होइत। इन्द्रिय स्वभावतः विषय ग्रहण करैत अछि, ब्रह्म कै नहि। यदि ब्रह्म इन्द्रियविषय होइत, तऽ इन्द्रिय ब्रह्मसँ कार्य-कारण सम्बन्ध ग्रहण करित। एतय प्रश्न उठैत अछि—विद्यमान वस्तु विषयक वाक्य प्रायः पुनरुक्ति होइत अछि, जहिना “नदीक तटपर फल अछि।” वेदान्त-वाक्य सेहो विद्यमान वस्तुक विषयमे अछि; तखन ओ आन प्रमाणसँ ज्ञात बातक पुनरुक्ति मात्र होएत। नहि; ब्रह्मक विषयमे जगतक उत्पत्ति आदिक आधारवाला अनुमान एक अन्य प्रमाण कहल गेल, मुदा ओ ब्रह्मक सम्पूर्ण स्वरूप नहि बतबैत। वेदान्तक प्रयोजन अद्वितीय ब्रह्मस्वरूपक प्रत्यक्ष बोध करब अछि, जे इन्द्रिय अथवा स्वतन्त्र अनुमानसँ सम्भव नहि।

जखन ई नहि बुझल गेल हो जे ओकर सम्बन्ध ब्रह्मसँ अछि अथवा आन किछुसँ, तखन एकर निश्चय नहि भऽ सकैत अछि। अतएव “जाहिसँ एहि जगतक जन्म आदि होइत अछि” ई सूत्र अनुमानक सङ्केत देबाक लेल नहि, वेदान्त-वाक्यसभ कै देखेबाक लेल अछि। ओ वेदान्त-वाक्य कोन

अछि, जकर निर्देश एहि सूत्रसँ कएल गेल अछि? भृगु, वरुणक पुत्र, अपन पिता वरुणक समीप गेलाह आ कहलनि—“भगवन्, हमरा ब्रह्मक उपदेश दिअ।” एतयसँ आरम्भ भऽ कऽ कहल गेल अछि—“जाहिसँ ई सभ प्राणी उत्पन्न होइत अछि, उत्पन्न भऽ कऽ जाहिसँ जीवित रहैत अछि, आ जाहिमे अन्ततः प्रवेश करैत अछि, ओहि केँ जानबाक इच्छा करू; ओ ब्रह्म अछि।” ई एहि विषयक निर्णायक वाक्य अछि। “आनन्दहि सँ ई सभ प्राणी उत्पन्न होइत अछि; आनन्दहि सँ उत्पन्न भऽ कऽ जीवित रहैत अछि; आनन्दहि मे प्रवेश करैत अछि”—ईहो निर्णायक वाक्य अछि। ब्रह्मक नित्यशुद्ध, नित्यबुद्ध, नित्यमुक्त स्वरूप आ सर्वज्ञ कारणरूपता बतौनिहार आन वेदान्त-वाक्य सेहो उद्धृत कएल जा सकैत अछि।

एहि विषयक विस्तृत विवेचन हम न्याय-कणिका मे कऽ चुकल छी। आगाँ सेहो स्पष्ट करब जे विद्यमान वस्तु विषय होयबाक कारण वेदान्त-वाक्य केवल पुनरुक्ति नहि अछि। अतएव सभ किछु स्पष्ट अछि। श्रुति “जाहिसँ” आदि पदसँ उत्पत्ति, “जाहिसँ उत्पन्न भऽ कऽ जीवित रहैत अछि” पदसँ स्थिति, आ “जाहिमे प्रवेश करैत अछि” पदसँ लय देखबैत अछि। “एहि विषयक ई निर्णायक वाक्य अछि”—एहि कथनसँ प्रधान आदि केँ विषय मानबाक सम्भावना दूर कएल गेल अछि; निर्णायक वाक्य अछि—“आनन्दहि सँ।” अर्थात् जहिना अविद्यासहित रस्सीक उपादान रस्सी होइत अछि, रस्सी रहला पर ओ प्रतीत होइत अछि आ रस्सीमे लीन होइत अछि, तहिना अविद्यासहित जगतक उपादान ब्रह्म अछि; जगत ब्रह्महि मे स्थित अछि आ ब्रह्महि मे लीन होइत अछि।

शास्त्रक स्रोत होयबाक कारण

जगतक सम्बन्धमे कारणताक निरूपणसँ ई सूचित भऽ गेल जे ब्रह्म सर्वज्ञ अछि। एहि बात केँ दृढ़ करबाक लेल कहल जाइत अछि—“शास्त्रक स्रोत होयबाक कारण।” ऋग्वेद आदि सँ बनल, असङ्ख्य विद्यास्थानसँ परिपूरित, मशाल जकाँ सभ वस्तु केँ प्रकाशित करैत विशाल शास्त्र-समूहक, जे सर्वज्ञक समान अछि, स्रोत अर्थात् कारण ब्रह्म अछि। ऋग्वेद आदि सँ युक्त एहन शास्त्र-समूह, जाहिमे सर्वज्ञताक गुण अछि, केवल सर्वज्ञ सत्तासँ उत्पन्न भऽ सकैत अछि। व्याकरण आदि कोनो विस्तृत विषयवला शास्त्र जखन पाणिनि आदि कोनो विशेष व्यक्तिसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि, तखन अनुभवसिद्ध अछि जे ओकर रचयिता ओहि शास्त्रक विषयसँ बेसी व्यापक ज्ञान रखैत छथि। तखन ई महान् सत्ता, जकर श्वासक समान अनायास ऋग्वेद आदि अनेक शाखामे विभक्त शास्त्र उत्पन्न होइत अछि—जाहिमे देवता, निम्न प्राणी, मनुष्य, वर्ण आ आश्रमक भेद, तथा समस्त ज्ञानक भण्डार समाहित अछि—ओहि ब्रह्मक अतुलनीय सर्वज्ञता आ सर्वशक्तिमत्ता स्वीकार नहि करब की सम्भव अछि?

शास्त्र सर्वज्ञता सिद्ध करैत अछि। “ऋग्वेद आदि सँ बनल महान् शास्त्र-समूह”—ऋग्वेद आदि “शास्त्र” कहल जाइत अछि, कारण ओ चारि वर्ण आ चारि आश्रमक नित्य, नैमित्तिक आ काम्य कर्मक विधान, गर्भाधानसँ अन्त्येष्टि धरि सभ कर्तव्यक निरूपण, आ ब्रह्मसम्बन्धी सत्यक शिक्षा दैत अछि। महान् विषयसँ सम्बन्धित होयबाक कारण ओ महान् अछि; संगहि अनेक अङ्ग-उपाङ्गसँ पूर्ण होयबाक कारण सेहो महान् अछि। एहि कारण कहल गेल—“असङ्ख्य विद्यास्थानसँ परिपूरित।” पुराण, न्याय, मीमांसा आदि दश विद्यास्थान अछि; प्रत्येक अपन-अपन प्रकारेँ वेदक पूरक अछि। एहि कारण शास्त्रक प्रामाण्यपर शङ्का सेहो दूर भऽ जाइत अछि, कारण सभ योग्य पुरुष ओकरा मानैत छथि। पुराणादिक रचयिता महान् ऋषि छथि; वेदक अर्थकेँ अपन-अपन ग्रन्थमे विस्तार दऽ कऽ, श्रद्धापूर्वक आचरण कऽ कऽ, ओ वेदक प्रामाण्य स्वीकारैत छथि। ई शास्त्र उपदेश देबामे असफल नहि होइत, नहि अस्पष्ट उपदेश दैत अछि; अन्यथा ओकर प्रामाण्य सन्देहास्पद होइत। तँ कहल गेल—“मशाल जकाँ सभ वस्तु केँ प्रकाशित करैत।” ई सभ प्रकारेँ सभ विषय केँ प्रकाशित करैत अछि; तँ नहि निरुपदेशक अछि, नहि अस्पष्ट उपदेशक। एहि कारण ई सर्वज्ञकल्प, अर्थात् सर्वज्ञक समान अछि। सर्वज्ञक ज्ञान सभ विषय धरि पहुँचैत अछि, आ शास्त्रक विषयवस्तु सेहो सभ वस्तु धरि विस्तार पबैत अछि; एहि कारण उपमा उपयुक्त अछि।

कारण आ कार्यक सह-अस्तित्व बताकऽ आब ओकर सह-अभाव बताओल जाइत अछि—“वास्तवमे एहन शास्त्रक।” सर्वज्ञक विशेषता सभ विषयक ज्ञान अछि; ई गुण शास्त्रमे सेहो अछि, कारण ओकर विषयवस्तु सभ किछु धरि पहुँचैत अछि। एहि बात केँ उदाहरणसँ सिद्ध कएल गेल—“जखन विस्तृत विषयवला शास्त्र कोनो विशेष व्यक्तिसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि, तखन ओ व्यक्ति ओहि शास्त्रसँ अधिक व्यापक ज्ञान रखैत अछि।” आजुक दिनो जखन कियो अनेक विषयवला शास्त्र लिखैत अछि, तखन वक्ताक ज्ञान ओकर कथनसँ अधिक व्यापक होइत अछि। वस्तुसभक सूक्ष्म विशेषता अनुभवमे आबि सकैत अछि, मुदा शब्दसँ पूरा-पूरा कहब सम्भव नहि; जइसे ईखक रस, दूध आ गुड़क मिठासक अन्तर अनुभव होइत अछि, मुदा वाणी सँ स्पष्ट नहि कएल जा सकैत अछि। “विस्तृत” शब्द ई बतबैत अछि जे कथनक विषय व्यापक भऽ सकैत अछि, मुदा वक्ताक ज्ञानक

बराबर नहि होइत। “की कहबाक आवश्यकता?” एहि अनुप्रयोगसँ निष्कर्ष देल गेल अछि—जाहि महान् पुरुषसँ वेदक उत्पत्ति श्वासक समान सहज रूपेँ होइत अछि, हुनकर अद्वितीय सर्वज्ञता आ सर्वशक्तिमत्ता कहबाक आवश्यकता की अछि? “अनेक शाखामे विभक्त” पद “विविध रूपमे विभक्त” सँ “उत्पत्ति” धरि लागू होइत अछि; “ओहि महान् पुरुषक” सँ निष्कर्ष आरम्भ होइत अछि, आ “सर्वशक्तिमत्ता” धरि जाइत अछि। “अत्यल्प प्रयाससँ” अर्थात् लगभग बिना प्रयासक, जहिना कहल जाइत अछि—“जौक खीर नोनगर नहि अछि।” जे काज दिव्य ऋषिसभ बहुत प्रयासो सँ नहि कऽ सकैत छथि, ब्रह्म ओहि केँ खेल जकाँ अत्यल्प प्रयाससँ कऽ दैत छथि; एहि सँ हुनकर अनुपम सर्वज्ञता आ सर्वशक्तिमत्ता सिद्ध होइत अछि। वेदक सहज उत्पत्ति विषयक श्रुति सेहो उद्धृत अछि—“एहि महान् पुरुषक” आदि।

अक्षर केँ नित्य माननिहार मीमांसकसभो शब्द आ वाक्यक अनित्यता स्वीकार करबाक पड़त। शब्द क्रमविशिष्ट अक्षरसभसँ बनैत अछि, आ वाक्य क्रमविशिष्ट शब्दसभसँ। क्रम अभिव्यक्तिक गुण अछि, अक्षरक नहि; अक्षर नित्य आ सर्वव्यापी होयबाक कारण हुनकामे काल वा देशक पूर्वापर सम्बन्ध सम्भव नहि। अभिव्यक्ति अनित्य अछि; तखन अक्षरक अभिव्यक्ति नित्य भले हो, शब्दत्व नित्य केना भऽ सकैत अछि? शब्द अनित्य भेलासँ वाक्य आदि सेहो अनित्य सिद्ध भऽ जाइत अछि। शब्दक पुनरावृत्ति नृत्यक अनुकरण जकाँ अछि। नृत्य-शिक्षक जे क्रममे अङ्गसञ्चालन आ भाव देखबैत छथि, शिष्य ओही क्रमक अनुसरण करैत अछि; मुदा शिक्षकक ठीक ओही अङ्गसञ्चालन नहि देखबैत। तहिना शिष्य गुरु सँ सुनल वेदक अक्षर आ शब्दक क्रमक अनुसरण करैत अछि, मुदा ठीक ओही ध्वनि उच्चारित नहि करैत; शिष्यक ध्वनि गुरुक ध्वनिसँ भिन्न होइत अछि। अतएव लौकिक वा वैदिक शब्द-वाक्यक उत्पत्ति विषयमे अक्षरक नित्यता वा अनित्यता माननिहार दुनू पक्षमे वास्तविक विवाद नहि अछि। मतभेद केवल वैदिक वाक्यक विषयमे मनुष्यक पूर्ण स्वतन्त्रता स्वीकार करब वा नहि करब एहिपर अछि। जैमिनीय, जे सृष्टि आ प्रलय नहि मानैत छथि, गुरु-शिष्य-परम्परासँ अनादि आ अविच्छिन्न वेदाध्ययन मानैत छथि। व्यासमतानुयायी मानैत छथि जे श्रुति-स्मृति-इतिहासादिसँ सिद्ध सृष्टि-प्रलयक सिद्धान्तक अनुसार परमात्मा, जे अनादि अविद्यासम्बन्धक कारण सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान छथि, नित्य वेदक सर्जक छथि; तथापि वेदक क्रम ओ पूर्वसृष्टिक अनुरूप रखैत छथि।

ई ओहि प्रकारेँ अछि जहिना यज्ञ आ ब्रह्महत्या, जे ब्रह्मक मायिक कार्य होइतहुँ नूतन सृष्टिमे अपन स्वभाव नहि बदलैत—पहिल सद्फलक आ दोसर दुष्फलक कारणे रहैत अछि। कोनो सृष्टिमे ब्रह्महत्या पुण्यक कारण नहि बनैत, नहि अश्वमेध पापक; जहिना अग्नि कखनो भिजबैत नहि, जल कखनो जरबैत नहि। तहिना एहि सृष्टिमे निश्चित क्रममे वेदाध्ययन कल्याण आ मोक्षक कारण अछि, आ विपरीत क्रममे अध्ययन अनर्थक, वज्रतुल्य शब्ददोषक कारण बनैत अछि; आन सृष्टिमे सेहो एहेन रहैत अछि। अतएव सर्वज्ञ-सर्वशक्तिमान सृष्टिकर्ता पूर्वसृष्टिक अनुरूप वेदक रचना करैत छथि; एहि दृष्टिसँ हुनका पूर्ण मनमानी स्वतन्त्रता नहि अछि। जैमिनीय “अपौरुषेय” शब्दसँ कर्ताक सम्पूर्ण स्वतन्त्रताक अभाव बुझैत छथि। ई बात हमर मतमे सेहो स्वीकार्य अछि, यद्यपि प्रयोजन भिन्न अछि। ई आपत्ति उचित नहि जे एक व्यक्ति द्वारा प्रकट वस्तु शास्त्रमे ग्राह्य नहि होइत। अनेक दोषयुक्त व्यक्ति द्वारा प्रकट बात अविश्वसनीय होइत अछि; मुदा सत्यज्ञ, सर्वदोषरहित पुरुषक वचन निश्चय विश्वसनीय अछि। प्रथम सृष्टिक प्रजापति आ दिव्य ऋषि जकाँ धर्म, प्रज्ञा, वैराग्य आ ऐश्वर्यसँ सम्पन्न पुरुषक वचन विश्वसनीय अछि; हुनक सत्यज्ञान निश्चित अछि, हुनक श्रद्धासँ उत्तरवर्ती लोकक श्रद्धा उत्पन्न

होइत अछि। एहि कारण ब्रह्मक शास्त्र-स्रोतत्व, शास्त्रक अपौरुषेयता आ प्रामाण्य—सभ बोधगम्य अछि।

एकर दोसर व्याख्या ई अछि—ऋग्वेद आदि सँ बनल पूर्वोक्त शास्त्र-समूह ब्रह्मक विषयमे यथार्थ ज्ञानक स्रोत अर्थात् प्रमाण अछि। केवल शास्त्रक प्रामाण्यसँ ब्रह्म जगतक उत्पत्ति आदिक कारण रूपेँ ज्ञात होइत छथि। पछिला सूत्रमे “जाहिसँ ई सभ प्राणी उत्पन्न होइत अछि” आदि श्रुति उद्धृत कएल गेल छल। यदि ओतहि शास्त्रक स्रोतत्व सिद्ध भऽ गेल, तखन एहि सूत्रक प्रयोजन की? उत्तर—ओतय शास्त्र केँ प्रमाणरूपेँ स्पष्ट नहि कहल गेल छल। सम्भव छल जे सूत्र “जाहिसँ जगतक उत्पत्ति” द्वारा केवल अनुमानक सङ्केत देइत हो। ई शङ्का दूर करबाक लेल एहि सूत्रमे स्पष्ट कहल गेल —“शास्त्रक स्रोत होयबाक कारण।” अर्थात् अनुभवगम्य जगतमे उत्पादसभक उदाहरणसँ ब्रह्मक अस्तित्व अनुमानित भऽ सकैत अछि; मुदा ब्रह्मक यथार्थ स्वरूप विषयमे श्रुति एकमात्र प्रमाण अछि। टीकाक अर्थ स्पष्ट अछि।

अर्थात् जन्मादि-सूत्रसँ केवल अनुमानक सङ्केत नहि देल गेल; “शास्त्रक स्रोत होयबाक कारण” ई अगिला सूत्र तामाश्रयद्वारा पहिल सूत्रक निश्चय करैत अछि। लक्षणक उल्लेख कऽ देल गेल अछि; ओहि लक्षणसँ अनुमान द्वारा ब्रह्मक सामान्य अस्तित्व जानल जा सकैत अछि। मुदा ब्रह्मक विशिष्ट, असाधारण स्वरूपक ज्ञान केवल शास्त्रसँ होइत अछि; एहि कारण शास्त्र प्रमाण अछि, आ ब्रह्म वेदान्त-वाक्यक विषय अछि।

फेर प्रश्न उठैत अछि—जखन ब्रह्म शास्त्रप्रमाणक विषय अछि, तखन “अथातो ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा” आदि क्रममे ब्रह्मविचारक प्रयोजन की? उत्तर ई जे शास्त्रसँ प्राप्त वाक्यार्थक निश्चय हेतु मनन आवश्यक अछि। सामान्य श्रुति-वाक्यक अर्थ अनेक प्रकारेँ बुझल जा सकैत अछि; तर्क-विचार बिना संशय दूर नहि होइत। तथापि स्वतन्त्र अनुमान ब्रह्मक स्वरूप प्रमाणित नहि करैत; अनुमान केवल श्रुत्यनुकूल सहायक अछि। वेदान्तक तात्पर्यक निर्णय श्रवण, मनन आ निदिध्यासनक क्रमसँ होइत अछि। एहि कारण सूत्रकार शास्त्रप्रमाणक अधीन रहि कऽ ब्रह्मविचार आरम्भ करैत छथि, नहि कि शास्त्रसँ निरपेक्ष तर्कद्वारा।

फेर प्रश्न उठैत अछि—जखन ‘शास्त्र कर्मक प्रयोजन लेल अछि, अतएव जे वाक्य कर्मक प्रयोजन नहि साधैत, ओ निरर्थक अछि’—एहन देखाओल गेल अछि, तखन ब्रह्मक विषयमे शास्त्र केँ प्रमाण केना कहल जा सकैत अछि? अतएव वेदान्तक कोनो उपयोग नहि रहि जाएत। एतय जे बात पहिने केवल प्रतिज्ञारूपेँ कहल गेल छल—ब्रह्मक विषयमे शास्त्र प्रमाण अछि—ओकरे एहि सूत्रमे सिद्ध कएल जाइत अछि। ‘फेर केना’ इत्यादिसँ भाष्यकार पूर्वपक्षक आरम्भ करैत छथि। ‘केना’ आपत्ति सूचित करैत अछि। वेदान्तक निरर्थकता एहि कारण मानल जाएत जे ओ पुरुषार्थ नहि पढ़बैत, कारण ओ स्वभावतः शुद्ध, चेतन आ उदासीन ब्रह्मक उपदेश करैत अछि, जाहिमे त्याज्य वा ग्राह्य किछु नहि। फेर, विद्यमान वस्तुक विषय होयबाक कारण वेदान्त लौकिक वाक्यक समान मात्र पुनर्वचन बनि जाएत आ स्वतंत्र प्रमाण नहि रहत। मुदा एहन मानब उचित नहि। वेदान्त निष्फल नहि अछि, कारण ओकर अध्ययन-विधिसँ फल सिद्ध होइत अछि। अतएव ओ सम्बन्धित विधिमे अपेक्षित कर्ता, देवता आदि केँ बोध करबैत सहायक भऽ सकैत अछि; अथवा ध्यान आदि आन कर्मक विधान करैत अछि। विद्यमान वस्तुक स्वरूपक स्वतन्त्र उपदेश असम्भव अछि, कारण विद्यमान वस्तु प्रत्यक्ष आदि प्रमाणक विषय होइत अछि। एहि प्रकार, पूर्वपक्षक आशय ई अछि जे वेदान्तक प्रामाण्य आ

उपयोगिता अन्य प्रमाणपर निर्भर भऽ जाएत। जैमिनिक सूत्रक उद्धरण पूर्वपक्ष केँ दृढ़ करबाक लेल अछि, ओकर अन्तिम सिद्धान्त मानबाक लेल नहि।

‘उपयोग’ एतय अनुपयोग आ स्वतंत्र ज्ञान उत्पन्न नहि करबाक अर्थमे अछि, कारण पुनर्वचनरूप वेदान्त अन्य प्रमाणपर निर्भर मानल जाइत अछि। ‘अतएव’ सँ लऽ कऽ ‘ध्यान आदि अन्य कर्मक विधान करैत होएत’ धरि पूर्वपक्षक संयुक्त कथन अछि। ‘निश्चय ही असम्भव अछि’ सँ लऽ कऽ ‘अथवा एहन बुझल जा सकैत अछि’ धरि ओकर विश्लेषण अछि। यदि वेदान्तक स्वतन्त्र प्रामाण्य स्वीकार नहि कएल जाए, तऽ ओ केवल विधिक सहायक बनत अथवा ध्यानादि कर्मक विधान करैत बुझल जाएत; एहि प्रकार ओ ब्रह्मक स्वतन्त्र प्रमाण नहि रहत।

मानि लिअ वेदान्त कर्मक सहायक नहि अछि, तथापि ब्रह्मस्वरूपक विषयमे ओकर तात्पर्य एक विधिमे मानल जाएत; जैमिनिक सिद्धान्तक अन्तिम सूत्र सेहो एहि मतक समर्थन करैत अछि —‘विधिसँ वाक्यक एकता होयबाक कारण ओ विधिक स्तुति करैत अछि।’ ‘अग्नि भोजन पकबैत अछि’ आदि मन्त्र कर्म वा ओकर उपकरणक उल्लेख करैत छथि; अतएव विधिसँ असम्बद्ध वैदिक वाक्यक प्रयोजन कतहु सिद्ध नहि होइत। विद्यमान वस्तुक स्वरूपमे विधि नहि हो सकैत, कारण विधिक विषय कर्म अछि। तथापि उत्तर ई अछि—वेदान्तक तात्पर्य ब्रह्मस्वरूपक बोध करबयमे अछि, आ ओकर उपयोग एहि ज्ञानमे अछि; ओकरा कर्मविधिक अधीन मानब आवश्यक नहि।

विद्यमान वस्तुक विषयमे सेहो वेदान्त ब्रह्मक अज्ञात स्वरूप केँ प्रकाशित करैत अछि। ‘विधिसँ वाक्यक एकता’ वाला नियम केवल ओतय लागू होइत अछि जतय वाक्य वास्तवमे कर्मविधानक अङ्ग हो; ब्रह्मविषयक वाक्य एहन नहि। सभ विधि केवल एहन भावी कार्यक विषय होइत अछि जे एखन अस्तित्वमे नहि अछि आ जे उत्पन्न करबाक अछि। फलविधि, विनियोगविधि, प्रयोगविधि आ उत्पत्तिविधि—ई सभ परस्पर सम्बद्ध भऽ सकैत अछि, मुदा विद्यमान ब्रह्मक विषयमे नहि। एहि कारण, वेदान्त केँ कर्मविधिक सहायक ठहरायब उचित नहि।

परन्तु ओ, समन्वयक कारण

पूर्वपक्ष हटबय लेल सूत्र कहल गेल अछि—‘परन्तु ओ, समन्वयक कारण।’ ‘परन्तु’ शब्द पूर्वपक्षक निषेध करैत अछि। जे सर्वज्ञ आ सर्वशक्तिमान ब्रह्म जगतक उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ प्रलयक कारण छथि, हुनका केवल वेदान्त-शास्त्रसँ जानल जाइत अछि। केना? समन्वयक कारण। समस्त वेदान्त-वाक्य एकहि तात्पर्यसँ ब्रह्ममे समन्वित होइत अछि। ‘सदेव सोम्य इदमग्र आसीत्’, ‘एकमेवाद्वितीयम्’, ‘आत्मा वा इदमेक एवाग्र आसीत्’, ‘ई ब्रह्म पूर्व-पश्चिम, भीतर-बाहर सभसँ रहित अछि’, ‘ई आत्मा ब्रह्म अछि, सभक अनुभवकर्ता’, ‘अमर ब्रह्म मात्र सभ दिशामे अछि’—एहन अनेक वाक्य एकहि ब्रह्मक प्रतिपादन करैत अछि।

‘जाहिसँ ई भूतसभ उत्पन्न होइत अछि’ वाला वाक्य पहिने जगतक उत्पत्ति, स्थिति आ प्रलयक कारण बतबय लेल उद्धृत भऽ चुकल अछि; एतय ओकर पुनरुक्ति आवश्यक नहि। वाक्यक आरम्भ आ अन्त जाहि विषयपर एकमत होइत अछि, अर्थविचारक नियम अनुसार ओहि विषय केँ मुख्य तात्पर्य मानल जाइत अछि। उपांशु यज्ञक प्रसङ्गमे सेहो पूर्ववर्ती आ परवर्ती वाक्यक एकवाक्यता सँ तात्पर्य निश्चय कएल जाइत अछि। एहि प्रकार ‘सदेव सोम्य इदमग्र आसीत्’ सँ आरम्भ आ ‘तत्त्वमसि’ सँ समाप्त समस्त प्रकरण ब्रह्म, अर्थात् जीवात्मासँ अभिन्न ब्रह्म, केँ मात्र प्रतिपादित करैत अछि। अतएव वेदान्तक स्वतन्त्र ब्रह्मप्रमाणता समन्वयसँ सिद्ध अछि।

एहि प्रकारेँ एहि ग्रन्थसभक वाक्यमे जखन ब्रह्मस्वरूपक विषयमे सुनिश्चित समन्वय मानल जाइत अछि, तखन ओकर कोनो दोसर तात्पर्य मानब उचित नहि; कारण एहन मानलासँ प्रत्यक्ष रूपेँ कहल विषयक परित्याग आ अकहल विषयक कल्पना करबाक दोष होयत। ईहो नहि कहल जा सकैत अछि जे एहि वाक्यसभक प्रयोजन कर्ता, देवता आदिक स्वरूप बतायब अछि; कारण “तखन केकर द्वारा आ केकरा देखल जाएत?” जकाँ श्रुति कर्म, कारण आ फलक निषेध करैत अछि।

ब्रह्म यद्यपि पहिनहिसँ विद्यमान वस्तु छथि, तथापि प्रत्यक्ष आदिक विषय नहि छथि। “तत्त्वमसि” मे कहल गेल जे ब्रह्म स्वयं आत्मा छथि; अतएव पूर्वापर वाक्यक विचारक बिना हुनका बुझल नहि जा सकैत अछि। जखन एही प्रसङ्गमे अन्य वाक्यसभक तात्पर्य सेहो ब्रह्ममे सिद्ध होइत अछि, तखन कोनो अदृष्ट दोसर तात्पर्य मानब अनुचित विस्तार होयत। कर्ता आदिमे तात्पर्य मानब केवल अदृष्ट नहि, अपितु असम्भवो अछि।

पूर्वपक्षी कहैत अछि जे विद्यमान वस्तुक उल्लेखक कारण वेदान्तक परनिर्भरता मानल जाए। मुदा ई परनिर्भरता वस्तु विद्यमान होयबाक कारण नहि, बल्कि वाक्य मनुष्यक रचना होयबाक कारण उत्पन्न होइत अछि। विद्यमान वस्तुक ज्ञान देनिहार प्रत्यक्षादि सेहो वस्तुकेँ विषय बनबैत अछि, मुदा इन्द्रिय आदि स्थिर कारणसँ उत्पन्न होयबाक कारण ओकर प्रामाण्य नष्ट नहि होइत अछि। तहिना वेद मनुष्यक बुद्धिपर निर्भर नहि होयबाक कारण स्वयंप्रमाण अछि।

कोनो कहि सकैत अछि जे वेदक अपौरुषेयत्व सिद्ध होइतहुँ विद्यमान वस्तुक विषयमे ओकर प्रामाण्य सिद्ध नहि होइत, कारण मनुष्य अन्य प्रमाणसँ विद्यमान वस्तु जानि सकैत अछि आ ताहि अनुसार वाक्य रचि सकैत अछि। मुदा कर्तव्यक विषयमे ई सम्भव नहि, कारण कर्तव्य नूतन अछि,

अन्य प्रमाणक विषय नहि, आ पूर्वानुभूत नहि होयबाक कारण मनुष्यक बुद्धिमे स्वतः प्रवेश नहि करैत। अतएव कर्मविधायक वेद अपौरुषेय आ प्रमाण मानल जाइत अछि।

हम एहि तर्कपर पूछैत छी—हे दीर्घायु, ई मनुष्यसँ अज्ञेय कर्तव्य आखिर की अछि? जँ कहल जाए जे ई अदृष्ट सामर्थ्य अथवा अपूर्व अछि, तखन लिङ् आदि विधिप्रत्ययसँ ओकर बोध केना होयत? अपूर्व इन्द्रियगोचर नहि अछि, ताहिसँ शब्दक सम्बन्ध पहिने सँ ज्ञात नहि। सामान्य व्यवहारमे विधिप्रत्ययसँ केवल अनुभूत क्रियाक कर्तव्यताक बोध होइत अछि।

जँ कहल जाए जे “स्वर्गकामो यजेत” सँ स्वर्गक इच्छुक व्यक्ति बुझैत अछि जे स्वर्गप्राप्तिक साधन यज्ञ करबाक चाही, तखन क्षणिक कर्म भविष्यक स्वर्ग केना देत? एहि कठिनाई दूर करबाक लेल वेदसँ अपूर्वक कल्पना कएल जाइत अछि। मुदा एही तर्कसँ चैत्य आदिक बौद्ध वाक्यमे सेहो अपूर्व मानब पड़त, आ तखन ओहो अपौरुषेय सिद्ध भऽ जाएत। जँ ओहि वाक्यक मनुष्य-रचित होयब स्पष्ट मानि अपूर्वक निषेध करब, तखन वेदो वाक्यसमूह होयबाक कारण मनुष्य-रचित अनुमानित भऽ सकैत अछि।

एहि आपत्तिक उत्तर ई अछि जे वेदक अपौरुषेयत्व केवल अपूर्वक बोधपर आधारित नहि। एकर विस्तृत स्थापना अन्यत्र कएल गेल अछि। एतय एतबे कहब पर्याप्त अछि जे अपौरुषेयत्व सिद्ध भेलापर वेदान्त विद्यमान ब्रह्मक विषयमे सेहो अन्य प्रमाणपर निर्भर नहि रहैत। ब्रह्म अन्य उपायसँ ज्ञात नहि छथि; जीवक ब्रह्मत्व केवल वेदान्तसँ बुझल जाइत अछि।

पूर्वपक्षक दोसर कारण—‘जे वस्तु ग्रहण वा त्यागक विषय नहि, ओकर ज्ञान निष्फल अछि’—सेहो असंगत अछि। आत्माक ब्रह्मरूप ज्ञानसँ समस्त बाधाक नाश होइत अछि आ परम पुरुषार्थक प्राप्ति होइत अछि। देवता आदिक ज्ञान ध्यानक सहायक होइतहुँ एहि ब्रह्मज्ञानक विरोधी नहि।

ब्रह्मक विषयमे ध्यान-विधानक सहायक रूपेँ वेदान्त केँ मानब सम्भव नहि। ध्यानमे ध्याता, ध्यान, ध्येय आदिक भेद आवश्यक अछि; मुदा ब्रह्म एकमेव छथि आ ग्रहण-त्यागादिक सर्व भेदसँ रहित छथि। एकत्वज्ञान उत्पन्न भेलापर द्वैतबुद्धिक पुनरुत्थान सम्भव नहि, अतएव ब्रह्मज्ञान केँ ध्यान-विधिक अङ्ग नहि बनाओल जा सकैत अछि।

मनुष्यक प्रयोजन दू प्रकारक होइत अछि—एकटा अप्राप्त वस्तु प्राप्त करब, दोसर प्राप्त वस्तुकेँ भ्रमवश अप्राप्त बुझि ओकर प्राप्तिक अनुभूति करब। त्यागो दू प्रकारक अछि—जे वस्तु हटाओल नहि गेल अछि ओकर त्याग, आ जे वस्तु वास्तवमे हटि चुकल अछि मुदा आरोपवश उपस्थित बुझाइत अछि ओकर ज्ञानद्वारा त्याग।

बाह्य साधनक अनुष्ठान अप्राप्त वस्तु प्राप्त करैत अछि अथवा अनत्यक्त वस्तु हटबैत अछि; मात्र ज्ञान वास्तविक उपस्थित सर्प केँ नहि हटबैत। मुदा आरोपित वस्तु—जइमे प्राप्त वस्तु अप्राप्त वा त्यक्त वस्तु अत्यक्त बुझाइत अछि—सत्यज्ञान मात्रसँ हटि जाइत अछि। रस्सीपर आरोपित सर्प जकाँ अज्ञानजन्य जीवभाव ब्रह्मस्वरूपपर आरोपित अछि। “तत्त्वमसि”क यथार्थ ज्ञान एहि आरोपक नाश करैत अछि।

एहि ज्ञानसँ नित्यप्राप्त आनन्द मानो नूतन प्राप्त होइत अछि, आ नित्यत्यक्त शोक-दुःख मानो आब त्यक्त होइत अछि। “आत्मा ब्रह्म छथि” एहि अनुभूतिसँ जीवक समस्त अवरोध, अर्थात् अज्ञान आ ओकर संस्कार, शीघ्र नष्ट होइत अछि; तखन दुःखनिवृत्ति आ आनन्दप्राप्तिरूप परम पुरुषार्थ सिद्ध होइत अछि।

ध्यानसम्बन्धी “केवल आत्माक उपासना करू” अथवा “आत्माकें सत्य आनन्दरूपें ध्यान करू” जकाँ वाक्यसभक आधार लऽ कऽ वेदान्तक तात्पर्य केवल उपासनामे अछि—ई मत स्वीकार्य नहि। ब्रह्मक विषयमे उपासक, उपास्य आ उपासनाक भेद टिकि नहि सकैत, कारण वेदान्त एहि भेदसभक मूल अज्ञानक नाश करैत अछि।

जँ मानल जाए जे वेदान्त विधिरूप नहि होइतहुँ प्रमाण अछि, तखन “ओ चिल्लायल” जकाँ स्वतंत्र वाक्य सेहो प्रमाण मानल जाएत, यद्यपि ओ ग्रहण वा त्यागक कोनो प्रयोजन नहि जनबैत। वास्तवमे प्रमाणक फल केवल स्वीकार वा परित्यागक निर्णय नहि; कखनो उदासीन रहबाक निर्णय सेहो ज्ञानक फल अछि। अतएव ब्रह्मज्ञानक प्रामाण्यकें कर्मविधिसँ जोड़ब आवश्यक नहि।

अन्य स्थानमे वैदिक वाक्य विधिसँ सम्बन्ध बिना प्रमाण नहि मानल जाइत—एहन सामान्य नियम बनबाओल नहि जा सकैत। आत्मज्ञान स्वयं परम फलमे परिणत होइत अछि; अतएव आत्मविषयक श्रुतिक प्रामाण्य अस्वीकार नहि कएल जा सकैत। एकरा निषेधवाक्य “बर्हिषि रजत नहि देबाक चाही” जकाँ अनावश्यक सेहो नहि कहल जा सकैत।

सम्पूर्ण वेद स्वाध्याय-विधिक क्रममे ग्रहण कएल जाइत अछि आ पुरुषार्थक साधन मानल जाइत अछि। ओकर एक अक्षरो निष्फल नहि। मुदा “ओ चिल्लायल” जकाँ वाक्यक अर्थ बुझलासँ कोनो पुरुषार्थ सीधेँ सिद्ध नहि होइत; एहन वाक्य अन्य पूरक वाक्यक अपेक्षा करैत अछि। निषेधवाक्य स्वयं निषिद्ध कर्मसँ निवृत्ति उत्पन्न करैत अछि, अतएव ओकर स्वतंत्र प्रयोजन अछि।

वेदान्तक स्थिति भिन्न अछि। ओकर अर्थबोध मात्रसँ, अन्य कोनो कर्म वा प्रमाणक अपेक्षा बिना, आत्मा-ब्रह्मैक्यक ज्ञान उत्पन्न होइत अछि आ परम पुरुषार्थ सिद्ध होइत अछि। एहि कारण वेदान्त कें कर्मविधिसँ जोड़ि कऽ मात्र प्रमाण मानबाक आवश्यकता नहि।

अन्य प्रमाणसँ ब्रह्मक प्रामाणिक ज्ञान प्राप्त नहि होइत। प्रत्यक्ष, अनुमान आदि केवल अपन-अपन विषयमे कार्य करैत अछि; ब्रह्म इन्द्रियातीत छथि। अनुमानसँ जँ शास्त्रक प्रामाण्य सिद्ध मानल जाए तखन उदाहरणक अपेक्षा उठैत, मुदा ब्रह्मविषयक प्रमाण अन्ततः शास्त्र स्वयं अछि।

कोनो आचार्य कहैत छथि—शास्त्र ब्रह्मक बोध करैत अछि, मुदा केवल ध्यानविधिक विषय रूपेँ; अर्थात् ब्रह्म स्वतंत्र ज्ञेय नहि, उपासनाक हेतु मात्र छथि। ई मत सेहो उचित नहि। संसारक बुद्धिमान व्यक्ति जे वस्तु न ग्रहणयोग्य अछि, न त्याज्य, ओकर अनावश्यक विशेषरूप घोषित नहि करैत। ब्रह्मक बोध स्वयं मोक्षक कारण अछि, ताहि लेल ओकर वर्णन निरर्थक नहि।

अत्रात्रे प्रत्यवस्थिते—यद्यपि शास्त्र ब्रह्मक प्रमाण अछि, तथापि प्रतिपत्तिविधिक विषयत्वक माध्यमेसँ मात्र शास्त्र ब्रह्मक बोध करैत अछि—एहन मत उपस्थित कएल गेल अछि। वृद्धसभक व्यवहारसँ ज्ञात होइत अछि जे शब्दक तात्पर्य कर्तव्यवस्तुमे होइत अछि। किछु शब्द कर्तव्यकें प्रत्यक्ष रूपेँ कहैत अछि, किछु अपन अर्थकें कर्तव्यक सहायक रूपेँ प्रकट करैत अछि; मुदा शब्दक तात्पर्य विद्यमान वस्तुमे नहि होइत अछि।

कोनो शब्द अपन अर्थक बोध करबैत अछि—ई बात दोसर व्यक्तिक शब्दार्थज्ञानक अनुमान आ ओहि ज्ञानक वस्तुसत्ता अथवा असत्तासँ मेलक आधारपर बुझल जाइत अछि। मुदा विद्यमान वस्तुक केवल स्वरूपविषयक ज्ञानसँ प्रवृत्ति वा निवृत्तिक कोनो चिन्ह नहि भेटैत। कर्तव्यज्ञानमे, एकर विपरीत, प्रवृत्ति अथवा निवृत्ति देखाइत अछि। ताहि कारण शब्दक कर्तव्यविषयक तात्पर्य सिद्ध होइत अछि, ब्रह्मस्वरूपक केवल कथनमे नहि।

वेदान्त वेदक अङ्ग होयबाक कारण शास्त्र कहल जाइत अछि। शास्त्रक परिभाषा सेहो ओहि वाक्यसमूह लेल अछि जे मनुष्यकें नित्य, नैमित्तिक वा काम्य कर्ममे प्रवृत्त करैत अछि अथवा निषिद्ध कर्मसँ हटबैत अछि। अतएव वेदान्तक केवल ब्रह्मस्वरूप प्रतिपादन करब—ई मान्यता शास्त्रक प्रसिद्ध स्वरूपसँ मेल नहि खाइत।

एहन वाक्यसभक प्रयोजन सेहो स्पष्ट नहि, जकर तात्पर्य केवल ब्रह्मस्वरूपक शिक्षा हो। ‘ई रस्सी अछि, सर्प नहि’ एहन वाक्य सुनलासँ भय समाप्त होइत अछि। मुदा ‘तत्त्वमसि’ सुनलाक बादो संसारधर्म—सुख, दुःख, भय आदि—पहिनेक जकाँ बनल रहैत अछि। जँ केवल श्रवणसँ संसारभाव दूर भऽ जाइत, तखन श्रवणक बाद मनन आ निदिध्यासनक विधान किएक होइत?

एहि आधारपर पूर्वपक्षी कहैत अछि जे वेदान्तक प्रयोजन कर्तव्यरूप आत्मोपासना अछि। अपन आत्मा मे जे उपासना करबाक विधान अछि, से ‘नियोग’ कहल जाइत अछि; अन्य प्रमाणसँ ज्ञात नहि होयबाक कारण ई ‘अपूर्व’ अछि। आत्मोपासनाक निरन्तर अभ्यास बिना ई फल नहि देत, अतएव कर्तव्यक ज्ञानसँ ओकर विषय—आत्मा—आ साधन—ध्यान—दुनू बुझल जाइत अछि।

जँ ई आपत्ति कएल जाए जे कर्तव्यक विषय स्वयं आत्मा अछि, तखन आत्मा स्वतःसिद्ध होयबाक कारण विधिक विषय केना बनत? उत्तर ई जे आत्माक जे विशिष्ट रूप उपासना लेल ग्रहण कएल जाइत अछि, से स्वतःसिद्ध नहि। ‘जे रूप एतय आरोपित कएल गेल अछि, ओहि रूपमे आत्माकें ध्यान करू’—एहि प्रकारक विधान सम्भव अछि।

जइ प्रकार यूप, आहवनीय अग्नि अथवा यज्ञस्तम्भ आदि पहिनहिसँ विद्यमान होइतहुँ शास्त्रमे विशेष संस्कार, आकार वा सम्बन्धक माध्यमसँ विधिक अङ्ग बनैत अछि, तइ प्रकार आत्मा सेहो विशिष्ट ध्यानरूप सम्बन्धसँ विधिक विषय बनि सकैत अछि। कर्तव्यताक अर्थ ध्यानक अभ्यासमे अछि; आत्मा ओकर विषय अछि।

पूर्वपक्ष अपन मतक समर्थनमे अनेक मीमांसक वचन उद्धृत करैत अछि—शास्त्रक प्रयोजन कर्मक शिक्षा अछि; विधि प्रवृत्तिक प्रेरक वचन अछि; विद्यमान वस्तु जनबैत शब्दक अर्थ कर्मविधिसँ जुड़ल रहैत अछि; शास्त्र जँ कर्मक प्रयोजनसँ रहित हो, तखन निरर्थक होयत। एहि सबसँ ओ निष्कर्ष दैत अछि जे वेदान्तो केवल उपासनाविधिक सहायक रूपेँ सार्थक अछि।

अमरत्व चाहनिहार लेल ब्रह्मज्ञानक विधान होइत अछि—एहन पूर्वपक्षी कहैत अछि। जइ प्रकार स्वर्गक इच्छुक लेल अग्निहोत्र आदि साधनक विधान अछि, तइ प्रकार अमरत्वक इच्छुक लेल ब्रह्मज्ञान अथवा ब्रह्मोपासनाक विधान होयत। ‘ब्रह्म वेद ब्रह्मैव भवति’ जकाँ वाक्य प्रशंसात्मक होइतहुँ ओहि विधानक अधिकारीक सूचक मानल जाएत।

एतय धर्मजिज्ञासा आ ब्रह्मजिज्ञासाक फलभेद स्पष्ट कएल जाइत अछि। कर्मकाण्डमे जे धर्म उत्पन्न होयब वाला अछि, ओकर ज्ञान चाहल जाइत अछि; वेदान्तमे नित्यसिद्ध ब्रह्मक ज्ञान चाहल जाइत अछि। धर्मज्ञानक फल अनुष्ठानपर निर्भर अछि, मुदा ब्रह्मज्ञानक फल स्वतः ज्ञानसिद्ध अछि—ई भेद उत्तरपक्ष उपस्थित करैत अछि।

उत्तरपक्ष कहैत अछि—‘द्रष्टव्यः’ आदि वाक्यमे आत्माक साक्षात्कार स्वयं विधेय नहि। ‘देखू’ क्रिया ज्ञानसूचक अछि, आ ज्ञान वस्तुतन्त्र होइत अछि; ओकर रूप मनुष्यक इच्छासँ बनैत नहि। प्रत्यक्षो कखनहु विधिक विषय नहि होइत, कारण प्रत्यक्षज्ञान स्वाभाविक अछि। आत्मज्ञान सेहो उपासनारूप मानसिक क्रियासँ भिन्न अछि।

उपनिषद् आत्माक नित्य, सर्वज्ञ, सर्वव्यापी, नित्यतृप्त, नित्यशुद्ध, बुद्ध, मुक्त, ज्ञानस्वरूप आ आनन्दस्वरूप रूपक प्रतिपादन करैत अछि। एहि सत्यज्ञानसँ अज्ञानक नाश होइत अछि आ मोक्ष प्राप्त होइत अछि। जँ वेदान्त केवल उपासनाविधि होइत, तखन ब्रह्मस्वरूपक स्वतंत्र प्रतिपादन निरर्थक भऽ जाइत।

‘ई रस्सी अछि, सर्प नहि’ एहन तथ्यवचन भ्रमजनित भय हटबैत अछि; तइ प्रकार आत्मा संसारधर्मी नहि छथि—एहि सत्यक ज्ञान संसारित्वक भ्रम हटबैत अछि। ई पूछल जा सकैत अछि जे केवल सुनलासँ भ्रम किएक नहि हटैत। उत्तर ई जे श्रवणक अर्थ वाक्यक तात्पर्यक यथार्थ ग्रहण अछि; मनन आ निदिध्यासन बाधक संशय आ विपरीतभावना हटबैत अछि, न कि कोनो नूतन कर्मफल उत्पन्न करैत अछि।

पूर्वपक्षी कहैत अछि जे श्रवणक बादो सुख-दुःख आदि देखाइत अछि, अतएव केवल ज्ञान पर्याप्त नहि। उत्तरपक्ष कहैत अछि जे अज्ञाननाशक सम्यग्ज्ञान उत्पन्न भेलाक बाद संसारित्वक वास्तविकता समाप्त होइत अछि; देहादिक प्रारब्धगत व्यवहार रहलहुँ ज्ञानी आत्माकेँ ब्रह्मरूपेँ जानैत अछि।

कर्म आ ब्रह्मक ज्ञान तथा फलमे मूलभूत भेद अछि। कर्म शरीर, वाणी अथवा मनसँ सम्पन्न होइत अछि, शास्त्र आ स्मृतिसँ धर्म कहल जाइत अछि, आ ओकर फल सुख-दुःखरूप उत्पाद्य आ विनाशी अछि। ब्रह्मज्ञानक फल नित्य, अशरीर, अनुपम आ स्वभावसिद्ध अछि; अज्ञान हटिते ओ प्रकट होइत अछि।

धर्म आ अधर्मक फलमे सुख-दुःखक क्रमिक स्तर होइत अछि—मनुष्यलोकसँ ब्रह्मलोक धरि सुखक, आ निम्न लोकधरि दुःखक। ई सभ उत्पाद्य आ नश्वर अछि। आत्मज्ञानक फल एहन क्रमिक नहि; मोक्ष नित्य आ अनुत्पाद्य अछि।

ज्ञान उत्पन्न होयब मनक वृत्तिक माध्यमसँ होइतहुँ ओकर सत्यता वस्तुपर निर्भर अछि। श्रवण, मनन आ निदिध्यासन ज्ञानक साधन आ बाधकनिवारक अछि; ई मोक्षकेँ नूतन रूपेँ उत्पन्न नहि करैत। मोक्ष आत्माक स्वाभाविक दशा अछि।

उपासनासँ उत्पन्न संस्कार मनकेँ एकाग्र करैत अछि आ ज्ञानक सहायक भऽ सकैत अछि; मुदा मोक्षक कारण स्वयं ब्रह्मज्ञान अछि। जइ प्रकार सङ्गीतक अभ्यास स्वरज्ञानक क्षमता बढ़बैत अछि, मुदा स्वरक सत्यता अभ्याससँ निर्मित नहि होइत, तइ प्रकार ध्यान ज्ञानक साधक भऽ सकैत अछि, मोक्षक उत्पादक नहि।

ज्ञान आ ध्यानक उत्कृष्टताक कारण यज्ञादि करनिहार लोक उत्तरमार्गसँ जा सकैत छथि; मुदा केवल आहुति, लोकहितक कर्म आ दानक साधनसँ ओ धूमादिक क्रमवाला दक्षिणमार्गसँ जाइत छथि। एतहुँ सुखक तारतम्य आ ओकर साधनक तारतम्य “ओतय भोग समाप्त होयब धरि रहैत छथि” एहि श्रुतिसँ बुझल जाइत अछि। तहिना मनुष्यसँ लऽ कऽ जइ पदार्थ धरि जे सभसँ न्यून सुख सम्भव अछि, सेहो विधिसँ परिभाषित धर्मक कारणेँ होइत अछि आ ओकरो तारतम्य अछि।

वेदान्तवाक्यक अर्थक ध्यानसँ उत्पन्न संस्कार जीवक ब्रह्मस्वरूपक साक्षात्कार कराबयमे समर्थ अछि; ताहि लेल कोनो अदृष्ट अपूर्वक आवश्यकता नहि। अतएव ध्यानसँ उत्पन्न कथित अपूर्वक अमरत्वक कारण नहि होयबाक कारण, अमरत्व चाहनिहार केँ ओकरा कर्तव्य रूपमे जानब उचित नहि। एक वस्तु चाहि दोसर वस्तुक साधन करब विरोधाभास अछि।

ईहो नहि कहल जा सकैत अछि जे अमरत्व चाहनिहार ध्यानक क्रियाकें स्वयं कर्तव्य रूपमे बुझत, ओकर अदृष्ट अपूर्वकें नहि। कारण ध्यानक अमरत्व-साधनता अन्य प्रमाणसँ ज्ञात अछि; तखन ओकर विधान निरर्थक होयत। धान कूटबाक विधानक समानता सेहो नहि, कारण ओतय निषेधक कारणसँ उत्पन्न अपूर्व अन्य वाक्यसँ ज्ञात नहि होइत।

शरीरधारी प्राणीसभमे ऊपर वा नीचाँ जे दुःखक तारतम्य देखाइत अछि, ताहिसँ ओकर कारण—निषेधविधिसँ परिभाषित अधर्म—आ अधर्म करनिहारसभक तारतम्य सेहो बुझल जाइत अछि। अज्ञानादि दोषयुक्त जीवसभक सुख-दुःखक भेद पुण्य-पापक भेदसँ उत्पन्न, शरीरधारणक पश्चात् फलित, अनित्य आ संसारस्वरूप अछि—ई श्रुति, स्मृति आ युक्तिसँ प्रसिद्ध अछि।

मोक्ष यदि प्रशंसावाक्यसँ बताओल अमरत्वक अतिरिक्त किछु होइत आ अमरत्व चाहनिहार ध्यानक अधिकारी होइत, तखन ऋषिसत्रक उदाहरणपर स्वर्ग जकाँ ध्यानक फल अमरत्व मानल जा सकैत छल। मुदा अमरत्व नाशरहित आ क्षयरहित अछि, ताहि लेल ध्यानसँ उत्पन्न कोनो फल स्थायी नहि भऽ सकैत। अज्ञानक आवरण हटिते ब्रह्मभाव प्रकट होइत अछि; वेदान्तार्थक साक्षात्कारसँ अज्ञान दूर होइत अछि, आ ध्यानजन्य संस्कार केवल मनकें सहायक होइत अछि। अतएव “आत्मा रूपें ध्यान करू” वाक्य वास्तविक विधि नहि, विधिसदृश वाक्य मात्र अछि।

“शरीरधारी रहैत सुख-दुःखक सम्पूर्ण नाश सम्भव नहि” ई संसारस्वरूपक पुनः कथन अछि। “अशरीरीकें प्रिय-अप्रिय स्पर्श नहि करैत” एहि श्रुतिमे प्रिय-अप्रियक स्पर्शक निषेधसँ बुझल जाइत अछि जे मोक्षरूप अशरीरभाव विधिलक्षित धर्मक फल नहि। जँ ओ धर्मक फल होइत, तखन प्रिय-अप्रियक स्पर्शक निषेध असङ्गत होइत।

अशरीरभाव स्वयं धर्मक फल सेहो नहि, कारण श्रुति ओकरा स्वाभाविक कहैत अछि—“बुद्धिमान पुरुष देहमे रहैतहुँ आत्माकें अशरीर, परिवर्तनशीलमे स्थिर, महान् आ सर्वव्यापी जानि शोक नहि करैत”; “ई आत्मा प्राणरहित, मनरहित, शुद्ध अछि”; “ई आत्मा असङ्ग अछि।” अतएव कर्मफलसँ भिन्न मोक्षरूप अशरीरता नित्य सिद्ध अछि।

किछु वस्तु परिवर्तनशील होइतहुँ क्रमविकासमे नित्य कहल जाइत अछि, कारण “ई ओहि अछि” एहन प्रत्यभिज्ञा नष्ट नहि होइत; पृथ्वी आदि अथवा सांख्यक गुणसभ एहन उदाहरण होइ सकैत अछि। मुदा ब्रह्मक नित्यता पूर्ण, अपरिवर्तनशील आ आकाशसमान सर्वव्यापी अछि; ओ सभ विकारसँ रहित, नित्यतृप्त, निरवयव आ स्वप्रकाश छथि; पुण्य-पाप आ तिनकर फल तीनू कालमे हुनका स्पर्श नहि करैत। ई मोक्षरूप अशरीरता श्रुतिसँ सिद्ध अछि।

अन्य मत नित्यताक दू प्रकार कहैत अछि—कूटस्थ नित्यता आ परिणामिनित्यता। जँ परिणामिनित्यताकें नित्य मानल जाए, तखन प्रश्न उठैत अछि—परिवर्तन सम्पूर्ण वस्तुमे होइत अछि वा ओकर एक भागमे? सम्पूर्णमे होइत त मूल प्रकृति नष्ट भऽ जाएत। भागमे होइत त ओ भाग वस्तुसँ भिन्न अछि कि अभिन्न? भिन्न होइत त मूल वस्तुक परिवर्तन नहि कहल जाएत; अभिन्न होइत त सम्पूर्ण वस्तुक परिवर्तन मानब पड़त।

एहि द्विविध परिणामक कोनो युक्तिसङ्गत निष्कर्ष नहि। बुद्धिवादी वैचित्र्यक कारण पृथ्वी आदि जगत कें नित्य मानि सकैत छथि, वा सांख्य गुणसभकें नित्य मानैत छथि; मुदा ब्रह्म पारमार्थिक कूटस्थ नित्य छथि—सभ विकाररहित, निरवयव आ स्वप्रकाश।

जँ मोक्ष कर्तव्यक साधनसँ प्राप्त हो, तखन ओ अनित्य होयत। श्रुति कहैत अछि—“धर्मसँ भिन्न, अधर्मसँ भिन्न, कृत-अकृतसँ भिन्न, भूत-भविष्यसँ भिन्न जे अछि, से कहू।” एहि प्रसङ्गमे

ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा उठैत अछि। जँ ब्रह्मकेँ कर्तव्यक सहायक रूपमे पढ़ाओल जाए आ मोक्ष कर्तव्यसँ साध्य मानल जाए, तखन मोक्ष कर्मफल जकाँ अनित्य होयत। मुदा सभ मोक्षवादी मोक्षकेँ नित्य मानैत छथि; अतएव ब्रह्मोपदेश केँ कर्माङ्ग मानब उचित नहि।

भेद-अभेदवाद कहि सकैत अछि जे कारणरूपेँ वस्तु अभिन्न आ कार्यरूपेँ भिन्न अछि—जइ प्रकार सुवर्णरूपेँ कङ्कण अभिन्न, मुदा कङ्कणरूपेँ कुण्डलसँ भिन्न। मुदा भेद आ अभेद परस्पर विरोधी होयबाक कारण एके वस्तुमे दुनू केना रहत? उत्तर देल जाइत अछि जे प्रमाणसिद्ध वस्तुमे विरोध नहि मानल जाए; “ई कुण्डल सुवर्ण अछि” एहन समानाधिकरणबोधमे भेद-अभेद दुनू स्पष्ट होइत अछि।

जँ अभेद पूर्ण होइत, तखन विषय आ विधेय रूपमे दुइ बेर प्रतीति नहि होइत। जँ भेद पूर्ण होइत, तखन गाय आ घोड़ा जकाँ समानाधिकरण सम्भव नहि होइत। घट केँ ‘एहि मे बदरी अछि’ नहि कहल जाइत, आ चैत्र-मैत्र एक आसनपर रहितहुँ ‘चैत्र मैत्र अछि’ नहि कहल जाइत। अतएव कार्य-कारणक बीच अभेद आ भेद दुनूक बोध अबाधित, संशयरहित आ सार्वभौम मानल जाइत अछि। कार्य कारणस्वरूप होयबाक कारण जतय कारण अछि, ओतय कार्यक सत्ता रहैत अछि; मुदा कार्यरूपेँ जगतमे गाय, घट आदि परस्पर भिन्न अछि।

एहि मतपर प्रश्न अछि—भेद वास्तवमे की अछि जे अभेदक संग एक स्थानमे रहैत? जँ भेद परस्पर-अभाव अछि, तखन कङ्कण आ सुवर्णक बीच ई अभाव अछि वा नहि? नहि अछि त केवल अभेद; अछि त केवल भेद। सत्ता आ असत्ता एक संग सम्भव नहि।

जँ कहल जाए जे सुवर्णरूपेँ अभेद अछि, कङ्कणरूपेँ कुण्डल आदिसँ भेद अछि, तखन उत्तर अछि—जँ कङ्कण सुवर्णसँ अभिन्न अछि, तखन सुवर्णक पुनरावृत्ति जहाँ-जहाँ अछि, ओतय कङ्कणो पुनरावृत्ति होयबाक चाही। मुदा कुण्डलमे सुवर्णत्व अछि, कङ्कणत्व नहि; अतएव कङ्कण सुवर्णसँ भिन्न अछि।

जँ सभ वस्तु सत्ता-रूपेँ अभिन्न होइत, तखन ‘ई एतय अछि, ओ नहि’, ‘ई एहि सँ उत्पन्न, ओहि सँ नहि’, ‘ई आब अछि, पहिने नहि’, ‘ई एहन अछि, ओहन नहि’ एहन भेदबोध सम्भव नहि होइत। दूरसँ सुवर्ण बुझाइत वस्तुमे कुण्डल आदि विशेषक जिज्ञासा होइत अछि; जँ विशेष सुवर्णसँ अभिन्न होइत, तखन सुवर्ण ज्ञात होइतहि विशेषो ज्ञात भऽ जाइत।

भेद रहबाक कारण सुवर्ण ज्ञात भेलापर कुण्डल आदि अज्ञात रहैत अछि। जँ अभेदो अछि तखन ओ अज्ञात किएक? अभेदक सामान्य नियम ई अछि जे कारणक ज्ञानसँ कार्यक ज्ञान होइत। अतएव जे वस्तु एकर ज्ञानसँ ज्ञात नहि होइत, से एकरा सँ भिन्न अछि—जइ प्रकार ऊँट ज्ञात होइत गदहा ज्ञात नहि होइत। दूरसँ सुवर्ण ज्ञात होइत कुण्डल ज्ञात नहि होइत; अतएव कुण्डल सुवर्णसँ भिन्न अछि।

“कुण्डल सुवर्ण अछि” एहन समानाधिकरण किएक? समर्थक कहैत अछि—आधार-आधेय सम्बन्ध वा समानाश्रयक कारण। उत्तर अछि जे घट-बदरी अथवा एक आसनपर चैत्र-मैत्रमे एहन समानाधिकरण नहि देखाइत। अतएव केवल एक स्थानमे रहब समानाधिकरणक पर्याप्त कारण नहि।

भेद अभेदपर निर्भर होइत आ अभेद भेदपर निर्भर होइत त परस्पराश्रय दोष होयत। वस्तुतः अभेदबोध लेल दोसर किछु आवश्यक नहि; भेदबोध ‘ई नहि, बल्कि ओ’ रूपेँ प्रतिपक्षी वस्तुक ज्ञानपर निर्भर अछि। ताहि कारण केवल अभेदक आधारपर अनिवार्य भेदक आरोप सम्भव मानल जा सकैत अछि; भेदक आधारपर अभेदक स्थापना युक्तिसङ्गत नहि।

श्रुति सेहो कहैत अछि—“माटि मात्र सत्य अछि”; ताहि लेल कूटस्थ, अपरिवर्तनशील नित्यता मात्र पारमार्थिक अछि, परिणामिनित्यता नहि। “आकाशसमान” उदाहरण अन्य मतक अनुकूल कहल गेल अछि, यद्यपि ओ सभ आकाशकें उत्पन्न मानि अनित्य कहैत छथि। “कूटस्थ नित्य” कहि मोक्षकें प्राप्तव्य वस्तु नहि, “सर्वव्यापी” कहि उपलब्धव्य नहि, “सभ विकारसँ रहित” कहि परिवर्तनीय नहि, “निरवयव” कहि संस्कारयोग्य नहि सिद्ध कएल गेल अछि।

श्रुति स्पष्ट करैत अछि जे ब्रह्मज्ञानक तुरन्त बाद मोक्ष होइत अछि, बीचमे कोनो कर्म शेष नहि—“जे ब्रह्म जानैत अछि, ओ ब्रह्म भऽ जाइत अछि”; “परावर ब्रह्म देखलापर ओकर कर्म नष्ट भऽ जाइत अछि”; “ब्रह्मानन्द जाननिहार कतहुँसँ भय नहि पबैत”; “हे जनक, अहाँ अभय प्राप्त कऽ लेलहुँ”; “आत्माकें ‘हम ब्रह्म छी’ रूपें जानल, ताहिसँ ई सम्पूर्ण जगत भऽ गेल।”

“नित्यतृप्त” शब्द ब्रह्मक पुरुषार्थरूपता बतबैत अछि। तृप्ति दुःखरहित सुखक सूचक अछि; इच्छा-दुःखक समाप्तिसहित जे सुख अछि, से तृप्ति अछि। सुख यदि अनुभूत नहि हो, तखन पुरुषार्थ नहि भऽ सकैत; ताहि लेल ब्रह्म “स्वप्रकाश” कहल गेल अछि।

एहि प्रकार श्रुति आदिसँ मोक्ष नित्य सिद्ध कऽ, कर्मसाध्य मोक्षक अनित्यताक विस्तार कएल जाइत अछि। ज्ञानक मोक्षमे साधनता केवल अज्ञानरूपी दू प्रकारक बाधा हटाबयमे अछि; ज्ञान स्वयं मोक्षकें उत्पन्न, संस्कारित, परिवर्तित वा प्राप्त नहि करैत।

श्रुति कहैत अछि—“जे ब्रह्मकें जानैत अछि, ओ ब्रह्म भऽ जाइत अछि”; “हृदयक ग्रन्थि छिन्न होइत अछि, समस्त संशय नष्ट होइत अछि, कर्मसभ क्षीण भऽ जाइत अछि”; “ब्रह्मानन्द जाननिहार कें ककरोसँ भय नहि होइत”; “हे जनक, अहाँ अभय प्राप्त कऽ लेलहुँ”; “आत्माकें ‘हम ब्रह्म छी’ रूपें जानल, ताहिसँ ई सम्पूर्ण जगत भऽ गेल।” एहि वाक्यसभसँ स्पष्ट अछि जे ब्रह्मज्ञान आ मोक्षक बीच कोनो अन्य क्रिया, अपूर्व वा कर्मफल मध्यस्थ नहि अछि।

‘नित्यतृप्त’ शब्द दुःखरहित सुखक बोध करबैत अछि। शुद्ध सुख तृप्ति अछि, आ जे सुख स्वयं प्रकाशमान नहि हो, से पुरुषार्थ नहि होयत; अतएव ब्रह्म ‘स्वप्रकाश’ छथि। ज्ञान उत्पन्न भेलाक तुरन्त बाद मोक्ष प्रकट होइत अछि; मोक्ष ज्ञानक क्रियाजन्य फल नहि, अज्ञान हटलापर स्वभावक अभिव्यक्ति मात्र अछि।

श्रुति एहि बातकें आरो दृढ़ करैत अछि—एकरस ब्रह्मस्वरूप देखने व्यक्ति लेल फेर की भ्रम आ की शोक? वामदेव ऋषि ब्रह्मकें देखि तत्काल बुझलनि—“हम मनु भेलहुँ, हम सूर्य भेलहुँ।” जइ प्रकार “ठाढ़ रहिते ओ गाबैत अछि” वाक्यमे ठाढ़ होयब आ गानक बीच कोनो अलग कर्तव्य नहि, तइ प्रकार ब्रह्मदर्शन आ सर्वात्मभावक बीच कोनो मध्यवर्ती कर्म नहि।

“अहाँ हमर पिता छी, जे हमरा अज्ञानक पार लऽ जाइत छी”; “हम आत्मज्ञानी व्यक्तिसँ सुनने छी जे आत्माकें जाननिहार शोकक पार उतरैत अछि; हम शोकमे छी, हमरा शोकक पार लऽ चलू”; “सनत्कुमार हुनका अन्धकारक पार लऽ गेलाह”—एहन श्रुतिसभ ब्रह्मज्ञानक फल मोक्षमे बाधक अज्ञानक निवृत्ति मात्र बतबैत अछि।

आचार्यक युक्तिसम्मत सूत्र सेहो कहैत अछि—दुःख, जन्म, प्रवृत्ति, दोष आ मिथ्याज्ञानमे पछिला-पछिलाक नाशसँ पहिल-पहिलाक नाश होइत अछि, आ अन्ततः मोक्ष सिद्ध होइत अछि। मिथ्याज्ञान नष्ट भेलासँ दोष नष्ट होइत अछि; दोष नष्ट भेलासँ प्रवृत्ति; प्रवृत्ति नष्ट भेलासँ जन्म; जन्म नष्ट भेलासँ दुःख।

मिथ्याज्ञान अर्थात् अविद्या संसारक मूल कारण अछि; ई राग-द्वेष आदिकें उत्पन्न करैत अछि। ओकर प्रतिपक्ष सत्यज्ञान अछि—ब्रह्म आ आत्माक एकत्वक प्रत्यक्ष अनुभूति। एहि कारण मोक्ष ब्रह्मस्वरूपक अभिव्यक्ति अछि, विद्या वा ध्यानक निर्मित फल नहि। सूत्रक आशय एतबे मान्य अछि जे सत्यज्ञानसँ मिथ्याज्ञानक नाश होइत अछि; न्यायमतक अन्य विशेष अर्थ एतय स्वीकार्य नहि।

पूर्वपक्षी कहि सकैत अछि जे ब्रह्म-आत्मैक्यक ज्ञान वस्तुस्थितिक ज्ञान नहि, कल्पित तादात्म्य मात्र अछि; तखन ई इच्छापर निर्भर होयबाक कारण विधेय बनि सकैत अछि। जइ प्रकार मनक अनन्त वृत्तिक समानतासँ मनमे विश्वदेवताक कल्पना कएल जाइत अछि, तइ प्रकार जीवमे ब्रह्मस्वरूपक कल्पना कऽ ध्यान कएल जा सकैत अछि।

मुदा ब्रह्म-आत्मैक्यक ज्ञान कल्पित तादात्म्य नहि। “मन ब्रह्म अछि”, “आदित्य ब्रह्म अछि” एहन उपासनावक्यसभमे एक वस्तुपर दोसरक गुण आरोपित होइत अछि। “तत्त्वमसि”, “अहं ब्रह्मास्मि”, “अयमात्मा ब्रह्म” एहन वाक्यसभ वस्तुस्थितिक वास्तविक एकत्व कहैत अछि।

कल्पित तादात्म्य मानलासँ “हृदयक ग्रन्थि छिन्न होइत अछि, सभ संशय नष्ट होइत अछि” एहि श्रुतिफलक विरोध होयत; “ब्रह्म ज्ञाननिहार ब्रह्म भऽ जाइत अछि” वाक्यो असङ्गत भऽ जाएत। ताहि कारण ब्रह्म-आत्मैक्यबोध न कल्पना अछि, न आरोपित ध्यान।

घृतपर दृष्टि देबाक प्रसङ्गमे दृष्टि घृतक शुद्धिकारक सहायक कर्म होइत अछि। मुदा “आत्माकेँ देखबाक चाही” एहन वाक्य कोनो एक कर्मप्रसङ्गमे नहि अछि। आत्माक यज्ञक संग असङ्गत सम्बन्ध मानि ओकर ज्ञानकेँ यज्ञाङ्ग कहब कठिन अछि। जँ आत्मज्ञान प्रधान कर्म हो, तखन ओ शुद्धिकारक सहायक नहि; जँ सहायक हो, तखन कोन कर्मक अङ्ग—ई स्पष्ट नहि।

प्राण अथवा वायुमे ‘संवर्ग’क उपासना सेहो विशिष्ट गुण-संबन्धपर आधारित अछि—बाह्य वायु अग्नि आदिकेँ अपना मे लय करैत अछि, आ आन्तरिक प्राण वाणी, नेत्र आदि इन्द्रियसभकेँ मृत्युक समय अपना मे समेटैत अछि। एहन उपासनामे गुणक आधार स्पष्ट अछि। जीवकेँ ब्रह्म रूपेँ कल्पना करब एहन गुणसाम्यपर आधारित नहि।

मन, आदित्य वा प्राणक उपासनामे उपास्य आ आधार भिन्न रहैत अछि; ब्रह्मक गुण ओहि आधारपर आरोपित होइत अछि। मुदा जीव वास्तवमे ब्रह्म छथि—ई ज्ञानमे आधार-आधेयक भेद नहि। अतएव ब्रह्म-आत्मैक्यज्ञानकेँ उपासना, संस्कार, कर्माङ्ग वा शुद्धिकर्म मानब उचित नहि।

जँ ब्रह्म-आत्मैक्यबोध केवल कल्पित मानल जाए, तखन “तत्त्वमसि”, “अहं ब्रह्मास्मि”, “अयमात्मा ब्रह्म” वाक्यसभक पदसम्बन्ध नष्ट होयत। “ज्ञानीक हृदयग्रन्थि छिन्न होइत अछि” आ “ब्रह्मविद् ब्रह्म भऽ जाइत अछि” एहन श्रुतिसभ कल्पित तादात्म्यसँ फलित नहि भऽ सकैत।

ताहि कारण ब्रह्मज्ञान मनुष्यक क्रियापर निर्भर नहि। प्रत्यक्षादि प्रमाणज ज्ञान जइ प्रकार वस्तुतन्त्र होइत अछि, तइ प्रकार ब्रह्मज्ञान सेहो वस्तुमात्रपर निर्भर अछि। ब्रह्म वा ब्रह्मज्ञानकेँ कर्तव्यक क्षेत्रमे प्रवेश कराबय लेल कोनो तर्कसङ्गत मार्ग नहि।

ब्रह्म ज्ञानक्रियाक कर्म सेहो नहि छथि। केनश्रुति कहैत अछि—“ओ ज्ञातसँ भिन्न छथि, अज्ञातसँ सेहो परे छथि”; “जकर द्वारा सभकेँ जानल जाइत अछि, ओकरा केना जानब?” “जे वाणी सँ प्रकट नहि होइत, बल्कि जकर कारण वाणी प्रकट होइत अछि, ओहि केँ ब्रह्म जानू, उपास्य वस्तु नहि।”

जँ ब्रह्म वस्तु नहि, तखन शास्त्र ओकर प्रमाण केना? शास्त्रक प्रयोजन अविद्यासँ कल्पित भेदक निवृत्ति अछि। शास्त्र ब्रह्मकेँ ‘ई’ अथवा ‘ओ’ वस्तु रूपेँ प्रस्तुत नहि करैत; ओ आन्तरिक आत्मा रूपेँ ब्रह्मकेँ अविषय बतबैत अछि, आ ज्ञाता-ज्ञेयक द्वैत हटबैत अछि।

संसारिक वस्तुमे सेहो शब्द सम्पूर्ण विशेषभेद नहि कहि सकैत—ईख, दूध आ गुड़मे मधुरताक भेद शब्दसँ पूर्णतः व्यक्त नहि होइत। आन्तरिक आत्मा त इन्द्रियातीत छथि; ताहि लेल शास्त्र निषेध, लक्षणा आ समन्वयद्वारा अविद्याजन्य भेद हटबैत अछि।

“जकरा द्वारा ई विचारल जाइत अछि, ओ ओकरा नहि जानैत; जे कहैत अछि ‘हम जानैत छी’, ओ नहि जानैत”; “दृष्टिक द्रष्टाकेँ नहि देखि सकैत, श्रवणक श्रोताकेँ नहि सुनि सकैत, मननक मनिताकेँ नहि सोचि सकैत, ज्ञानक ज्ञाताकेँ नहि जानि सकैत”—एहन श्रुतिसभ आत्माकेँ सर्वथा अविषय सिद्ध करैत अछि।

अविद्यासँ उत्पन्न ज्ञाता, ज्ञेय आ ज्ञानक भेद समाप्त भेलापर आत्माक स्वभाव पुनः प्रकट होइत अछि; संसारित्व निवृत्त होइत अछि आ नित्य मोक्ष सिद्ध होइत अछि। अतएव मोक्षमे अनित्यताक दोष नहि।

जे मोक्षकेँ उत्पन्न वस्तु मानैत अछि, ओकरा मानसिक, वाचिक अथवा शारीरिक कर्म आवश्यक मानब पड़ैत; जँ मोक्ष परिवर्तन हो, तखनो कर्म चाही। दुनू मतमे मोक्ष अनित्य होयत, कारण दही जकाँ विकार आ घट जकाँ उत्पाद्य वस्तु कखनो नित्य नहि होइत।

प्राप्तव्य वस्तुक सम्बन्धमे सेहो कोनो कर्तव्यक आवश्यकता नहि अछि। कारण, जँ ओ अपन आत्मस्वरूप अछि, तखन ओ प्राप्तव्य नहि; आ जँ अपन आत्मस्वरूपसँ भिन्न अछि, तखन ब्रह्म प्राप्तव्य नहि होइत, कारण ब्रह्म सर्वव्यापी होयबाक कारण आकाश जकाँ स्वभावतः सभकेँ नित्यप्राप्त अछि।

पूर्वपक्षी कहैत अछि—संसारावस्था छोड़ि आत्माक कैवल्यावस्था प्राप्त करब मोक्ष अछि; अतएव मोक्ष एक प्रकारक परिवर्तन अछि। जइ प्रकार दूध पहिल अवस्था छोड़ि दहीरूप दोसर अवस्था प्राप्त करैत अछि, तइ प्रकार आत्मा संसारावस्था छोड़ि कैवल्यावस्था पबैत अछि। एहि दुनू मतमे मोक्ष नित्य नहि रहैत, कारण दही वा घट जकाँ उत्पादित वस्तु अनित्य होइत अछि।

“तखन, स्वर्गसँ परे जे ज्योति चमकैत अछि” आदि श्रुतिसँ ब्रह्मक स्थानभेद, परिवर्तनशील स्थान आ अपरिवर्तनशील स्थान बुझल जाइत अछि। अतएव ध्यान-विधानादिसँ ब्रह्मकेँ अपरिवर्तनशील स्थानपर पहुँचाओल जा सकैत अछि आ तखन ब्रह्म प्राप्तव्य वस्तु भऽ सकैत अछि—एहन आपत्ति उठाओल जाइत अछि। उत्तर अछि—प्राप्तव्य वस्तु रूपेँ सेहो ब्रह्मकेँ कोनो कर्तव्यक अपेक्षा नहि।

नाविक नावमे रहि परिवर्तनशील समुद्रतट, फेनसमूह आ तरङ्गसभ छोड़ि तरङ्गरहित, शान्त, स्वच्छ, स्थिर आ अपरिवर्तनशील मध्यभागमे पहुँचैत अछि। मुदा जीव ब्रह्मसँ भिन्न नहि, स्वयं ब्रह्म छथि; तखन जीव की प्राप्त करथि आ कोन साधनसँ? प्राप्ति भेदपर आधारित अछि। जँ जीव ब्रह्मसँ भिन्न मानल जाए, तखनो सर्वव्यापी ब्रह्म नित्यप्राप्त छथि; एहि कारण ‘अपन स्वभावसँ भिन्न होइतहुँ’ शब्दसँ आपत्ति निरस्त कएल गेल अछि।

मोक्ष शुद्ध कएल जाएब वाला वस्तु सेहो नहि, नहि त शुद्धिकर्मक आवश्यकता होइत। शुद्धि दू प्रकारेँ होइत अछि—गुण जोड़लासँ अथवा दोष हटाओलासँ। मोक्ष ब्रह्मस्वरूप अछि; ब्रह्ममे कोनो

उत्कृष्ट गुण जोड़ल नहि जा सकैत। ब्रह्म नित्यशुद्ध छथि; ताहि लेल हुनकामे दोष हटाओल सेहो सम्भव नहि।

गुण जोड़ि शुद्धि होयबाक उदाहरण अछि—लाखक रससँ जवा फूल रंगलापर ओहि रंगक फल उत्पन्न करैत अछि। दोष हटाकऽ शुद्धि होयबाक उदाहरण अछि—ईटक चूर्णसँ घसलापर दर्पणक मल हटि ओ उज्ज्वल होइत अछि। एहि दुनू उपायमे कोनो उपाय ब्रह्मपर लागू नहि होइत।

जँ कहल जाए—मोक्ष आत्माक स्वभाव होइतहुँ अज्ञानसँ ढकल अछि; कर्मद्वारा आत्मा शुद्ध भेलापर ओ प्रकट होइत अछि, जइ प्रकार दर्पण घसलापर ओकर चमक प्रकट होइत अछि—तखन उत्तर अछि: आत्मा क्रियाक आश्रय बनि नहि सकैत। जे क्रियाक आश्रय होइत अछि, ओ क्रियासँ अपरिवर्तित रहि नहि सकैत; क्रिया ओकरामे कोनो परिवर्तन करैत अछि। आत्मा परिवर्तनशील मानल गेलासँ “ई अविनाशी कहल गेल अछि” आदि श्रुति बाधित होयत।

ब्रह्ममे जोड़ल जाएब वाला गुण ब्रह्मस्वरूप अछि कि भिन्न? जँ ब्रह्मस्वरूप अछि, तखन नित्य होयबाक कारण जोड़ल नहि जा सकैत। जँ भिन्न अछि, तखन उत्पादित होयबाक कारण मोक्ष अनित्य होयत। भिन्न वस्तुसभमे गुण-गुणी सम्बन्ध सेहो गाय-घोड़ाक सम्बन्ध जकाँ सम्भव नहि। भेद आ अभेदक संयुक्त मत पहिने विरोधी सिद्ध कएल जा चुकल अछि। अतएव ब्रह्मस्वरूप मोक्षमे कोनो उत्कृष्टता जोड़ल नहि जा सकैत।

दोष हटेबाक मत सेहो असंगत अछि। दर्पणमे मल उपस्थित होइत अछि, ताहि लेल हटाओल जाइत अछि। ब्रह्ममे मल कखनो उपस्थित नहि; ब्रह्म नित्यशुद्ध छथि। जे पहिनहिसँ सर्वथा अनुपस्थित अछि, ओकर हटेबाक प्रश्न नहि।

आपत्ति अछि—मोक्ष आत्माक स्वभाव अछि, मुदा अनादि मलरूप अविद्यासँ आवृत अछि; ध्यानकर्मद्वारा आत्मा शुद्ध भेलापर मोक्ष प्रकट होइत अछि, उत्पन्न नहि होइत। उत्तर: आत्माकैँ क्रियाक आश्रय मानल नहि जा सकैत। क्रिया अपन आश्रयकैँ परिवर्तित करैत अछि; तखन आत्मा अनित्य भऽ जाएत।

अविद्या ब्रह्ममे स्थित नहि, जीवमे स्थित कहल जाइत अछि। मुदा जीव स्वयं अनिर्वचनीय अविद्यासँ सीमित ब्रह्म मात्र छथि; ब्रह्म नित्यशुद्ध छथि। जँ ब्रह्ममे दोष मानि कर्मसँ शुद्ध कएल जाए, तखन कर्म ब्रह्ममे अन्तर्निहित होयबाक चाही, जइ प्रकार दर्पण घसबामे ईटक चूर्णक संयोग-वियोग दर्पणक सतहमे घटैत अछि। एहन कर्म ब्रह्मकैँ परिवर्तित कऽ हुनकर नित्यताक नाश करत।

जँ कर्म कोनो दोसर आश्रयमे स्थित हो, तखन ओ ब्रह्मक शुद्धिमे केना सहायक होयत? दर्पण घसलापर रत्न शुद्ध नहि होइत। “ई अविनाशी, उच्चतम अछि” एहन श्रुति आत्मामे क्रियाक प्रवेश निषेध करैत अछि। अतएव आत्माश्रित कर्म सम्भव नहि; अन्याश्रित कर्म अविषय आत्माकैँ शुद्ध नहि कऽ सकैत।

पूर्वपक्षी फेर कहैत अछि—स्नान, आचमन, यज्ञोपवीत धारण आदि शरीराश्रित कर्मसँ शरीरधारी आत्मा शुद्ध होइत देखाइत अछि। उत्तर: जे शुद्ध होइत अछि, ओ अविद्यासँ शरीरादिसँ संयुक्त मानल आत्मा अछि। स्नान, आचमन आदिक शरीरमे स्थित होयब प्रत्यक्ष अछि। शरीराश्रित कर्मक फल ओहि शरीरसँ संयुक्त, शरीरकैँ ‘हम’ माननिहार जीवपर लागू होइत अछि।

जड़ प्रकार शरीराश्रित चिकित्सासँ धातुसाम्य उत्पन्न भेलापर “हम रोगमुक्त छी” एहन ज्ञान शरीराभिमानी जीवमे होइत अछि, तइ प्रकार स्नान, आचमन, यज्ञोपवीतादिसँ “हम शुद्ध छी” एहन बोध होइत अछि। ई शुद्धि शरीरसँ संयुक्त जीवक व्यवहारिक शुद्धि अछि, न परमात्माक।

‘हम’ प्रत्ययक विषय, ज्ञानक कर्ता आ कर्मफल भोक्ता जीव छथि। मन्त्र कहैत अछि—“एक पक्षी मधुर फल खाइत अछि, दोसर नहि खाइत केवल देखैत अछि।” फल खेनिहार जीवात्मा छथि; नहि खेनिहार साक्षी परमात्मा छथि।

जीव स्थूल-सूक्ष्म शरीर, इन्द्रिय आ अन्तःकरणसँ संयुक्त छथि; एहि समूहक मध्य स्थित, ओकरासँ अभिन्न मानल जाइत आ ‘हम’ प्रत्ययक विषय बनैत छथि। ताहि कारण शरीरक शुद्धि व्यवहारतः आत्मपर आरोपित होइत अछि, जड़ प्रकार नायिकाक सुगन्ध सखीपर आरोपित कहल जाइत अछि। पारमार्थिक रूपेँ आत्मामे न कर्म अछि, न शुद्धि।

श्रुति कहैत अछि—“शरीर, इन्द्रिय आ मनसँ संयुक्त आत्माकेँ ज्ञानीजन भोक्ता कहैत छथि।” “एक देव सभ प्राणीमे गुप्त, सर्वव्यापी, सभक अन्तरात्मा, कर्माध्यक्ष, सभ प्राणीमे निवास करनिहार, साक्षी, चेतन, एक आ निर्गुण छथि।” “ओ सभमे व्याप्त, तेजस्वी, अशरीरी, घावरहित, स्नायुरहित, शुद्ध आ पापरहित छथि।” एहि मन्त्रसभसँ सिद्ध अछि जे ब्रह्ममे कोनो उत्कृष्टता जोड़ल नहि जा सकैत आ ओ नित्यशुद्ध छथि। ब्रह्मभावक प्राप्तिमे मोक्ष अछि; अतएव मोक्ष स्वयं शुद्ध कएल जाएब वाला वस्तु नहि।

एहि चार प्रकार—उत्पाद्य, आप्य, विकार्य आ संस्कार्य—बाहेक कोनो पाँचम मार्ग नहि, जकर द्वारा कर्म मोक्षमे प्रवेश कऽ सकय। अतएव ज्ञान बाहेक कर्मक छाया मोक्षमे प्रवेश नहि पबैत।

आपत्तिः ज्ञानो मानसिक क्रिया अछि। उत्तरः ज्ञान आ क्रियामे भेद अछि। क्रिया ओ कहल जाइत अछि जाहिमे वस्तुक वास्तविक स्वरूपक परवाह बिना विधि रहैत अछि आ जे पुरुषक इच्छापर निर्भर अछि। उपासना, ध्यान आदि पुरुष कऽ सकैत अछि, नहि कऽ सकैत अछि वा अन्य प्रकारेँ कऽ सकैत अछि।

ज्ञान, यद्यपि मानसिक वृत्ति अछि, तथापि वस्तुतन्त्र अछि। ओकर फल ब्रह्म नहि, कारण स्वप्रकाश ब्रह्म ज्ञानक्रियाक कर्मरूप सम्बन्धसँ बोधगम्य नहि। सत्यज्ञान प्रमाणसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि, व्यक्तिक इच्छासँ नहि।

यज्ञमे देवताक जकर रूप मानि आहुति देबाक अछि, ओकरा मनमे ध्येय मानल जाए; “सन्ध्याकालीन देवताक ध्यान करू” आदि वाक्यमे ध्यान मानसिक होइतहुँ पुरुषतन्त्र अछि। पुरुष ओकरा करथि, नहि करथि वा अन्य प्रकारेँ करथि—सम्भव अछि। मुदा ज्ञान एहन नहि।

सत्यज्ञान वस्तु जड़ रूपमे अछि, ओही रूपकेँ विषय बनबैत अछि। अतएव ओकरा इच्छा अनुसार उत्पन्न, अनुत्पन्न वा भिन्न रूपेँ उत्पन्न नहि कएल जा सकैत। ओ न विधिपर निर्भर अछि, न व्यक्तिपर; केवल वस्तुपर निर्भर अछि। एहि कारण मानसिक होइतहुँ ज्ञान क्रियासँ स्वभावतः अत्यन्त भिन्न अछि।

“मन वास्तवमे अग्नि अछि, गौतम”; “स्त्री वास्तवमे अग्नि अछि, गौतम”—एहन उपासनामे पुरुष मनुष्य वा स्त्रीमे अग्निबुद्धि उत्पन्न करैत अछि। ई ज्ञान वास्तविक अग्निक ज्ञान नहि, विधिनिर्दिष्ट ध्यान अछि। मुदा वेदान्तक “सदेव सोम्य इदमग्र आसीत्” सँ “तत्त्वमसि” धरि वचन सुनि शब्दार्थ आ सम्बन्ध बुझनिहार मनुष्यमे ब्रह्मात्मैक्यक यथार्थ ज्ञान प्रमाणशक्तिसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि।

जड़ प्रकार इन्द्रिय आ वस्तुक यथार्थ सन्निकर्षसँ उज्ज्वल प्रकाशमे घटक अनुभव स्वयं उत्पन्न होइत अछि, तड़ प्रकार उपनिषद्वाक्यक सामर्थ्यसँ आत्मा ब्रह्म छथि—ई ज्ञान उत्पन्न होइत अछि। मनुष्यक इच्छा एहि ज्ञानकेँ अन्य प्रकारक बना नहि सकैत, नहि रोकि सकैत; अतएव ई देवताध्यान जकाँ विधेय क्रिया नहि।

पुरुष आ स्त्रीक सम्बन्धमे सेहो। मुदा ई केवल क्रिया अछि आ पुरुषपर निर्भर अछि, कारण एकर उत्पत्ति मात्र विधिसँ होइत अछि। किन्तु प्रसिद्ध अग्निक विषयमे अग्निबुद्धि न विधिपर निर्भर अछि, न पुरुषपर। तखन ई की अछि? प्रत्यक्षक विषयभूत वस्तुमात्रपर निर्भर होयबाक कारण ई निश्चय ज्ञान अछि, क्रिया नहि। सभ प्रमाणक विषयभूत वस्तुसभक सम्बन्धमे सेहो एहि प्रकार बुझबाक चाही।

एहन स्थितिमे ब्रह्म आ आत्मा जड़ वास्तविक रूपमे छथि, ओहि रूपकेँ विषय बनबयवाला ज्ञानो विधिपर निर्भर नहि अछि। यद्यपि ओहि विषयक प्रसङ्गमे विधिलिङ् आदि प्रयोग भेटैत अछि, तथापि अविधेय वस्तुकेँ विषय बनबयबाक कारण ओ सभ पाथरपर चलाओल छुराक धार जकाँ कुण्ठित भऽ जाइत अछि; कारण विषय एहन वस्तु अछि जे न त्याज्य अछि, न ग्राह्य। तखन “आत्माकेँ देखबाक, सुनबाक चाही” आदि विधिछायावाला वाक्यसभक प्रयोजन की? हमर उत्तर अछि—ओ सभ मनुष्यकेँ स्वाभाविक कर्मक विषयसभसँ विमुख करबाक लेल अछि। जे बहिर्मुख व्यक्ति “हमरा सुखद वस्तु भेटय, दुःखद वस्तु नहि भेटय” कहैत कर्ममे प्रवृत्त रहैत अछि आ ताहिसँ परम पुरुषार्थ नहि पबैत अछि, परम पुरुषार्थ चाहनिहार ओहि व्यक्तिकेँ “आत्माकेँ देखबाक चाही” आदि वाक्य कार्य-कारणक समूह, अर्थात् विषय आ इन्द्रियसभ रूप स्वाभाविक प्रवृत्तिक वस्तुसभसँ हटबैत अछि आ अन्तर्मुख आत्माक प्रवाहमे प्रवृत्त करैत अछि। आत्मान्वेषणमे प्रवृत्त व्यक्तिक लेल निम्न वाक्यसभ आत्माक सत्य स्वरूपकेँ एहन वस्तु रूपमे सिखबैत अछि जे न त्याज्य अछि, न ग्राह्य—“ई सभ जे अछि, ओ आत्मे अछि” (बृहदारण्यक उपनिषद् २.४.६); “जखन ई सभ आत्मे अछि, तखन केकर द्वारा आ केकरा देखल जाएत?... केकर द्वारा आ केकरा जानल जाएत?... ज्ञाताकेँ केकर द्वारा जानल जाएत?” (बृहदारण्यक उपनिषद् ४.५.१५); “ई आत्मा ब्रह्म अछि” (बृहदारण्यक उपनिषद् २.५.१९) आदि।

फेर जे कहल गेल जे आत्मज्ञान मुख्यतः कर्तव्यसँ सम्बन्धित नहि होयबाक कारण न ग्रहणमे सहायक अछि, न त्यागमे—से हम स्वीकार करैत छी। ई त हमर पक्षक भूषण अछि जे ब्रह्मसाक्षात्कार भेलापर सभ कर्तव्य नष्ट भऽ जाइत अछि आ जे किछु सिद्ध करबाक छल, सभ सिद्ध भऽ जाइत अछि। श्रुति सेहो कहैत अछि—“जँ मनुष्य आत्माकेँ ‘हम ओ छी’ एहि रूपमे जानि लैत, तखन कोन वस्तुक इच्छा आ कोन प्रयोजनसँ शरीरक दुःखक संग दुःखी होयत?” (बृहदारण्यक उपनिषद् ४.४.१२)। स्मृति सेहो अछि—“ई जानि मनुष्य ज्ञानी आ कृतकृत्य भऽ सकैत अछि, हे भारत” (भगवद्गीता १५.२०)। अतएव ब्रह्मक प्रतिपादन ध्यानविधिक अङ्ग रूपमे नहि अछि।

किछु लोक कहैत छथि—“वेदक कोनो भाग एहन नहि जे केवल विद्यमान वस्तुक चर्चा करैत हो; वेद केवल प्रवृत्ति-निवृत्तिक विधि आ ओकर सहायक वस्तुसभक प्रतिपादन करैत अछि।” ई ठीक नहि। उपनिषद्मे प्रतिपादित आत्मा कोनो दोसर वस्तुक अङ्ग नहि छथि। उपनिषद् मात्रसँ ज्ञात, असंसारी, ब्रह्मस्वरूप, उत्पाद्य आदि चारि प्रकारक पदार्थसँ भिन्न, अपन स्वतंत्र प्रसङ्गमे वर्णित आ अन्य ककरो सहायक नहि—एहन आत्माक विषयमे ई नहि कहल जा सकैत अछि जे ओ छथि नहि वा ज्ञात नहि छथि; कारण “ओ आत्मा ई नहि, ओ नहि” वाक्यमे “आत्मा” शब्द अछि (बृहदारण्यक

उपनिषद् ३.९.२६), आ आत्माक निषेध सम्भव नहि; जे निषेध करैत अछि, ओकरो आत्मभाव रहिते अछि।

जँ वृद्धजनक व्यवहारमे ई नियम मानल जाइत जे शब्द केवल कर्तव्य वा ओकर सहायक वस्तुकेँ बोध करबैत अछि, तखन उपनिषद् आत्मारूप ब्रह्मकेँ—जे न त्याज्य अछि, न ग्राह्य—तात्पर्य नहि बना सकैत छल; कारण अनुभवमे शब्दक एहन सामर्थ्य ज्ञात नहि होइत, आ वैदिक अर्थक ज्ञान अनुभवमे शब्दार्थज्ञानक बाद होइत अछि। मुदा जँ अनुभवमे विद्यमान वस्तुसँ सेहो शब्दक सम्बन्ध ग्रहण कएल जा सकैत अछि, तखन उपनिषद्मे पूर्वापर विचारसँ ज्ञात विद्यमान ब्रह्मकेँ तात्पर्य मानब सँ रोकल नहि जा सकैत, आ ओकर स्थानपर कर्तव्यक कल्पना नहि कएल जा सकैत; नहि त प्रत्यक्ष कहल अर्थ छोड़ि अकहल अर्थ ग्रहण करबाक दोष होयत।

कोनो अकर्तव्य अर्थसँ शब्दसम्बन्धक ग्रहण केवल तखने असम्भव होइत, जँ अनुभवमे एहन तात्पर्यवला कोनो प्रयोग नहि भेटैत आ शब्दार्थज्ञ व्यक्तिमे ओ अर्थज्ञानक अनुमान नहि कएल जा सकैत। मुदा अनुभवमे विद्यमान वस्तुकेँ कहनिहार एहन वाक्यसमूहक व्यापक प्रयोग भेटैत अछि, जे आनन्द उत्पन्न करैत वा भय आदि समाप्त करैत अछि, तथापि कर्तव्यक प्रतिपादन नहि करैत। उदाहरणार्थ—“पर्वतराज सुमेरु इन्द्रादि लोकपालसभ, सिद्ध, विद्याधर, गन्धर्व आ अप्सरासभक समूहक निवासस्थान अछि; ब्रह्मलोकसँ झहरैत मन्दाकिनीक जलधारासँ धोएल सुवर्णशिलासँ बनल अछि, आ नन्दनवनसदृश रमणीय उपवनमे खेलैत स्फटिकसदृश पक्षीक स्वर सँ मनोहर अछि”; अथवा “ई सर्प नहि, रस्सी अछि” आदि।

ईहो नहि जे शब्दार्थज्ञ व्यक्तिमे विद्यमान वस्तुक ज्ञानक अनुमान नहि कएल जा सकैत; आनन्द आदि तकर अनुमानक आधार बनैत अछि। उदाहरण ई अछि। आर्यभाषाक अर्थ नहि जाननिहार एक द्रविड़ नगर जाय लेल राजमार्गक कात देवदत्तक घरमे बैसल अछि। ओ जानैत अछि जे पुत्रजन्म पिताक आनन्दक कारण होइत अछि। ओ दूतक संग नगरमे देवदत्तक लग जाइत अछि। दूत शिशुक पयर धोएल केसरजलमे भिजाओल वस्त्र अर्पित कऽ कहैत अछि—“देवदत्त, अहाँक समृद्धि बढ़य; अहाँक पुत्र जन्मल अछि।” ओ तत्क्षण देवदत्तक रोमाञ्च, आँखि आ मुखकेँ पूर्ण विकसित कमल जकाँ खिलल देखैत अछि। ओ देवदत्तमे उत्पन्न आनन्दक अनुमान करैत अछि, आ ईहो अनुमान करैत अछि जे जे आनन्द पहिने नहि छल आ वचन सुनिहो उत्पन्न भेल, ओकर कारण ई वचन अछि। ओ बुझैत अछि जे वाक्य एहन अर्थ कहलक जे आनन्दक कारण अछि; कारण आनन्दक कारण अर्थ नहि सिखबैत ई कथन स्वयं आनन्द उत्पन्न नहि कऽ सकैत। दोसर कोनो आनन्दकारण देखाइत नहि, आ पुत्रजन्म आनन्दक कारण बुझल जाइत अछि; अतएव ओ निश्चय करैत अछि जे दूत एहि बातेक सूचना देलक। भय, शोक आदि विषयमे सेहो एही प्रकार उदाहरण बुझबाक चाही।

एहि प्रकार विद्यमान वस्तुकेँ कहनिहार वाक्य फलदायक होयबाक कारण विवेकी जिज्ञासुद्वारा ओकर प्रयोग पूर्णतः युक्तिसङ्गत अछि। ब्रह्मस्वरूपज्ञान परम पुरुषार्थक कारण अछि; आ वेदान्त मनुष्यकेँ कर्ममे प्रवृत्त वा निवृत्त करबैत नहि होइतहुँ ओकर हितक शिक्षा दैत अछि। अतएव वेदान्तक शास्त्रत्व सिद्ध अछि। एहि आधारपर विवादास्पद वाक्यसभ विद्यमान वस्तुकेँ विषय बनबैत अछि—ई सिद्ध होइत अछि; कारण ओ सभ विद्यमान वस्तुक विषयमे प्रमाणज्ञान उत्पन्न करैत अछि। जे प्रमाणज्ञान उत्पन्न करैत अछि, ओकर विषय ओहि ज्ञानक विषय होइत अछि—जइ प्रकार रूपादिक विषयवला चक्षु आदि। एहि वाक्यसभक स्थिति सेहो एही अछि। अतएव उचित कहल गेल—“ई मत ठीक नहि, कारण उपनिषद्मे प्रतिपादित आत्मा कोनो दोसर वस्तुक अङ्ग नहि छथि।”

“उपनिषद्” शब्द “उप” आ “नि” उपसर्गयुक्त “सद्” धातुसँ, विनाशार्थक अर्थमे, क्विप् प्रत्ययसँ बनल अछि। ई ब्रह्मज्ञानक नाम अछि; कारण अद्वैत ब्रह्मकेँ समीप लाबि ई अविद्या आ ओकर संस्कारसभक नाश करैत अछि। एहि ज्ञानक कारण होयबाक कारण वेदान्तो उपनिषद् कहल जाइत अछि; आ जे एहि सँ ज्ञात होइत छथि, ओ उपनिषद्प्रतिपाद्य पुरुष छथि।

एहि बातक विश्लेषण “ओ आत्मा, जे केवल उपनिषद्सँ ज्ञात छथि” आदि वचनसँ कएल गेल अछि। “जे संसार नहि करैत छथि” कहि हुनका अहंप्रत्ययक विषय जीवसँ भिन्न कएल गेल। अकर्मस्वरूप होयबाक कारण ओ उत्पाद्य, आप्य, विकार्य आ संस्कार्य—चारि प्रकारक पदार्थसँ भिन्न छथि। ताहि कारण ओ अन्य ककरो सहायक नहि। जे विद्यमान पदार्थ दोसरक सहायक होइत अछि, से कर्तव्य रूपमे इच्छित होइत अछि आ उत्पत्ति आदि द्वारा साध्य होइत अछि—जइ प्रकार “यूप बनबाउ।” मुदा जे अन्य ककरो सहायक नहि, से विद्यमान स्वरूप अछि आ प्रयोजनक अवशेष नहि—जइ प्रकार “सुवर्ण धारण करबाक चाही”, “आटाक आहुति देबाक चाही” आदि प्रसङ्गमे सुवर्ण वा आटा; कारण उत्पत्ति आदि द्वारा ओकर सिद्धि नहि होइत।

आब आपत्ति कएल जाइत अछि—आत्मा “हम” प्रत्ययक विषय छथि; तखन ई बात असङ्गत बुझाइत अछि जे हुनका केवल उपनिषद्सँ जानल जा सकैत अछि। उत्तर अछि—नहि; कारण ओहि “हम” प्रत्ययक विषयक साक्षी रूपमे ई आपत्ति पहिनहि निरस्त कएल जा चुकल अछि। “हम” प्रत्ययक विषय कर्ता शरीर-इन्द्रियादिक समूहसँ सीमित जीवात्मा छथि; मुदा हुनकर साक्षी, सभमे विद्यमान, सभठाम समान, एक, कूटस्थनित्य आ सभक आत्मा परमात्माकेँ ने वेदक कर्मकाण्डसँ आ ने केवल तर्क-वितर्कसँ कियो जानि सकल अछि।

एहि पर भाष्यकार कहैत छथि—“आ आत्माक निषेध सम्भव नहि होयबाक कारण।” वास्तवमे प्रकाशस्वरूप आत्मा सभक आत्मा छथि, कारण जगत् रूपी भ्रमक आश्रय ओही छथि। आश्रय नहि रहिते भ्रम सम्भव नहि; रस्सी नहि रहिते ओहि ठाम रस्सीकेँ सर्प अथवा जलधारा बुझबाक भ्रम कहियो नहि होइत। आत्माक स्वप्रकाशताक प्रकाश जगत् प्रकाशित होइत अछि। श्रुति सेहो कहैत अछि—“ओकर प्रकाशसँ दोसर सभ प्रकाशित होइत अछि; ओकर प्रकाश ई सम्पूर्ण जगत् प्रकाशित अछि।” आत्माक प्रकाशस्वरूपताक निषेध कएलापर जगतक प्रकट होयबो असङ्गत भऽ जाएत। अतएव आत्माक निषेध असम्भव होयबाक कारण वेदान्तसँ ओहि ब्रह्मस्वरूपक साक्षात्कार होइत अछि, जे अन्य प्रमाणक विषय नहि आ समस्त उपाधिसँ रहित अछि।

जे व्यक्ति “आत्मा केवल उपनिषद्सँ ज्ञात छथि” एहि सीमाकेँ स्वीकार नहि करैत, ओ फेर आपत्ति करैत अछि—आत्मा तँ सभ मनुष्यक “हम” प्रत्ययक विषय छथि; ओ कर्ता, भोक्ता आ संसारी छथि। साधारण मनुष्य आ आत्मजिज्ञासु दुनू “आत्मा” शब्दक प्रयोग एही अर्थमे करैत छथि। लोकव्यवहारमे प्रयुक्त शब्द वेदोमे प्रयुक्त होइत अछि आ दुनू ठाम ओकर अर्थ समान होइत अछि; अतएव उपनिषद्मे “आत्मा” शब्द एही प्रसिद्ध अर्थमे लागू होयबाक चाही, एकर विपरीत कोनो दोसर अर्थमे नहि—ई आपत्तिक आशय अछि।

उत्तर ई अछि जे उपनिषद्प्रतिपाद्य आत्माक निषेध कियो नहि कऽ सकैत, आ हुनका कोनो विधिक सहायक अङ्ग सेहो नहि बनाओल जा सकैत। सभक आत्मा होयबाक कारण ओ ने त्याज्य छथि, ने ग्राह्य। आत्मा धरि पहुँचयवला विनाशी विकारसभक सम्पूर्ण समूह नष्ट होइत अछि; मुदा आत्मा विनाशक कोनो कारण नहि होयबाक कारण अविनाशी छथि, आ परिवर्तनक कोनो कारण नहि होयबाक कारण कूटस्थनित्य छथि। एही कारण ओ स्वभावतः नित्यशुद्ध, चेतन आ मुक्त छथि।

“आत्मासँ उच्चतर किछु नहि; ओएह सीमा आ परम गति छथि” तथा “हम ओहि आत्माक विषयमे पुछैत छी, जिनकर प्रतिपादन उपनिषद्मे कएल गेल अछि”—एहन वचनमे “उपनिषद्मे प्रतिपादित” विशेषण तखने सार्थक अछि, जखन आत्मा उपनिषद्क मुख्य प्रतिपाद्य छथि। अतएव “वेदक कोनो भाग विद्यमान वस्तुक प्रतिपादन नहि करैत” ई कथन केवल असावधानीपूर्ण हठ अछि।

भाष्यकार उत्तर दैत छथि—“नहि”; उपनिषद्प्रतिपाद्य पुरुष साधारण “हम” प्रत्ययक विषय नहि छथि। “हम” प्रत्ययक विषय शरीर आ इन्द्रियक समूहसँ सीमित कर्ता जीवात्मा छथि; उपनिषद्प्रतिपाद्य परमात्मा ओहि जीवक साक्षी छथि। एहि कारण “हम” प्रत्ययक विषय जीवक परमात्मा मानबाक मत निरस्त होइत अछि। “जीवरूपे अपन यथार्थ स्वरूपमे प्रवेश कऽ आत्मा...” आदि वाक्यमे जीव आ परमात्माक एकत्व पारमार्थिक अछि; उपाधिसँ सीमित रूप जीव कहल जाइत अछि, मुदा शुद्ध रूप ओकर साक्षी अछि। ई शुद्ध साक्षी अन्य प्रमाणसँ ज्ञात नहि, उपनिषद्क विषय छथि। एही बातकेँ “हम” प्रत्ययक विषय कर्तासँ भिन्न ओकर साक्षी” कहि विस्तार देल गेल अछि।

आत्माकेँ कोनो विधिक सहायक रूपमे जोड़ल नहि जा सकैत। किएक? कारण ओ आत्मा छथि। आत्मा कोनो दोसर वस्तुक लेल नहि, बल्कि सभ दोसर वस्तु आत्माक लेल अछि। श्रुति कहैत अछि—“सभ वस्तु सभ वस्तुक प्रेमक कारण प्रिय नहि, आत्माक प्रेमक कारण सभ वस्तु प्रिय अछि।” सभक आत्मा होयबाक कारण ओ ने त्याज्य छथि, ने ग्राह्य। सम्पूर्ण जगत्मे ब्रह्म मात्र यथार्थ आत्मा छथि। अपन स्वभावकेँ त्यागल नहि जा सकैत, अतएव ओ त्याज्य नहि; आ ओ पहिनहिसँ प्राप्त छथि, अतएव ग्राह्य सेहो नहि। विधि आ निषेधक विषय त्याज्य वा ग्राह्य वस्तु होइत अछि; ताहि लेल ओकर विषय आत्माक यथार्थ स्वरूप नहि भऽ सकैत। फलतः सम्पूर्ण जगत्मे आत्मा मात्र सत्य छथि।

एही बातकेँ “आत्मा धरि विनाशी विकारसभक सम्पूर्ण समूह नष्ट होइत अछि” कहि स्पष्ट कएल गेल अछि। आत्मा पारमार्थिक सत्य छथि—श्रुति, स्मृति, इतिहास, पुराण आ एहि सभक विरोध नहि करयवला युक्तिसँ ई सिद्ध अछि। अनादि अविद्यासँ प्रकट जगत् पारमार्थिक सत्य नहि। एहि मिथ्याजगतक उपादान पारमार्थिक आत्मा छथि, जइ प्रकार सर्पभ्रमक उपादान सत्य रस्सी अछि। अनिर्वचनीय आ अस्थिर स्वभाववला जगत् नष्ट होइत अछि; आत्मा पारमार्थिक सत्य छथि आ हजारो कारण हुनका मिथ्या नहि बना सकैत। हजार कारीगरो घटसँ वस्त्र नहि बना सकैत। अतएव समस्त विकारक नाश अविनाशी आत्मापर समाप्त होइत अछि, जइ प्रकार शुक्तिमे देखल रजत आ रस्सीमे देखल सर्पक नाश क्रमशः सत्य शुक्ति आ रस्सीपर समाप्त होइत अछि। जगतक समस्त विकारमे आत्मा मात्र सत्य छथि। अनन्त होयबाक कारण आत्माक विनाश सम्भव नहि।

जे व्यक्ति आत्माक विनाश सम्भव मानैत अछि, ओकरा लेल कहल गेल—“आत्माक विनाशक कोनो कारण नहि होयबाक कारण ओ अविनाशी छथि।” हजारो कारण एक वस्तुकेँ दोसर वस्तु नहि बना सकैत। जँ कहल जाए जे आत्माक मूल स्वरूप त्याज्य वा ग्राह्य नहि सही, मुदा हुनकर कोनो गुण त्यागल अथवा ग्रहण कएल जा सकैत अछि, तकर उत्तर अछि—“परिवर्तनक कोनो कारण नहि होयबाक कारण ओ कूटस्थनित्य छथि।” आत्मामे धर्म, लक्षण आ अवस्था—एहि तीनू प्रकारक परिवर्तनमे सँ एको नहि होइत। पारमार्थिक आत्माक गुण सेहो पारमार्थिक होयबाक कारण आत्मा जकाँ ओकर परिवर्तन कोनो कारणसँ नहि भऽ सकैत। गुणक परिवर्तन छोड़ि दोसर कोनो परिवर्तन होइत नहि; अतएव आत्मा पूर्णतः अपरिवर्तनशील छथि।

शास्त्रक तात्पर्य जाननिहारक “शास्त्रक प्रयोजन कर्मक शिक्षा अछि” आदि उद्धरण विधि आ निषेधवला शास्त्रक विषयमे बुझबाक चाही, कारण ओतय धर्मजिज्ञासा प्रसङ्ग अछि। “शास्त्रक

प्रयोजन...” वचनकें सर्वत्र अपरिवर्तनीय रूपें लागू कएल जाए त विद्यमान वस्तुक प्रतिपादन निरर्थक ठहरत। जँ शास्त्र प्रवृत्ति आ निवृत्तिक अतिरिक्त विद्यमान वस्तुओक शिक्षा दैत अछि, तखन जे उत्पन्न होयबाक अछि ओकर हेतु विद्यमान वस्तु बताओल जा सकैत अछि; फेर कूटस्थनित्य ब्रह्मक शिक्षा शास्त्र नहि दैत—एहन कहबाक कोनो कारण नहि। विद्यमान वस्तुक प्रतिपादन ओकरा क्रिया नहि बना दैत।

कियो कहि सकैत अछि—यद्यपि विद्यमान वस्तु स्वयं क्रिया नहि, तथापि ओ क्रियाक साधन होइत अछि; अतएव ओकर शिक्षा केवल क्रियाक लेल होइत अछि। उत्तर अछि—क्रियाकें सिद्ध करबाक सामर्थ्यवला वस्तु निश्चय विद्यमान होइत अछि; क्रियाक प्रयोजनसँ ओकर प्रतिपादन भेलहुँ वस्तुक अस्तित्व नष्ट नहि होइत आ न ओकर शिक्षा निरर्थक होइत अछि। “एहन विद्यमान वस्तु पढ़ाओलासँ अहाँकें की लाभ?”—एहि प्रश्नक उत्तर अछि जे अज्ञात आत्मतत्त्वक शिक्षा सेहो निश्चय फलदायक अछि। ओकर ज्ञानसँ संसारक कारण मिथ्याज्ञानक निवृत्ति होइत अछि; अतएव प्रयोजनक दृष्टिसँ आत्मतत्त्वक शिक्षा क्रियाक साधन वस्तुक शिक्षासँ हीन नहि।

धर्मजिज्ञासा प्रसङ्गमे धर्म कर्मस्वरूप होयबाक कारण “कर्मक शिक्षा” कहल गेल अछि; मुदा एहि वचनसँ विद्यमान ब्रह्मक शिक्षा बाधित नहि होइत। सोम शर्मा प्रसङ्गमे हुनकर सद्गुणक वर्णन भेलासँ विष्णु शर्मासँ सद्गुणक निषेध नहि होइत। विधिशास्त्र विहित कर्मक आ निषेधशास्त्र निषिद्ध कर्मक प्रतिपादन करैत अछि; दुनूक विषय कर्म अछि। मुदा एहि कारण विद्यमान ब्रह्मक प्रतिपादनक सामर्थ्य वेदसँ समाप्त नहि होइत। जैमिनिक वचन—“शास्त्र कर्मक अर्थ जनबैत अछि” आदि—कर्मजिज्ञासा प्रसङ्गमे अछि।

जँ “अर्थ” शब्द केवल वाच्यार्थकें सूचित करैत हो, तखन द्रव्य, गुण आ क्रिया—जे स्वयं कर्तव्य नहि—वाच्य नहि होयबाक कारण अर्थहीन ठहरत। उत्तरमे कहल गेल अछि—जे लोक उक्त शास्त्रवचनकें सर्वत्र अपरिवर्तनीय मानैत छथि, हुनक मतमे “कर्तव्यसँ सम्बन्धित अर्थवान् होयब”क अर्थ स्वयं कर्तव्यकें वाच्य बनायब नहि, बल्कि कर्तव्यक उपकारक होयब अछि। द्रव्य आ गुणवाचक शब्द विद्यमान द्रव्य आ गुणकें कर्तव्यक सहायक रूपमे जनबैत अछि; ओ सभ अपन स्वरूपमे स्थित रहितहुँ वाच्य होइत अछि। शास्त्रज्ञ कहैत छथि—“विधिवाक्य पहिनहिसँ विद्यमान वस्तु, वर्तमान वस्तु, उत्पन्न होयवला वस्तु आदि सभकें जना सकैत अछि।” अर्थात् विधिवाक्य कर्तव्य जनबैत काल ओकर प्रयोजनक लेल पहिनहिसँ विद्यमान वस्तुओक बोध करबैत अछि।

शब्दक अर्थ विद्यमान वस्तु होइतहुँ ओकर अर्थसम्बन्ध केवल कर्तव्यक उपकार करयवला रूप धरि सीमित नहि। शब्दक तात्पर्य केवल अलग-अलग अपन पदार्थमे सेहो समाप्त नहि होइत। जँ प्रत्येक शब्दक तात्पर्य अपन स्वतंत्र अर्थमे मात्र होइत, तखन वाक्यार्थक ज्ञान सम्भव नहि होइत; कारण परस्पर प्रधान-गौण सम्बन्धसँ रहित, स्वतन्त्र रूपें प्रधान पदार्थसभमे वाक्यैकता नहि बनैत। शब्दसभ अपन-अपन अर्थ जनबैतहुँ एक साझा फलदायक वाक्यार्थकें तात्पर्य बनबैत अछि। प्रत्येक पदार्थसँ विशेषित एक वाक्यार्थक ज्ञान एही कारण सम्भव होइत अछि।

शास्त्रज्ञक कथन अछि—“यद्यपि वर्ण सीधें पदार्थक बोध करबैत अछि, तथापि ओतहि निष्फल रूपें समाप्त नहि होइत; वाक्यार्थक प्रमाणज्ञान उत्पन्न करबाक प्रक्रियामे पदार्थज्ञान अनिवार्य मध्यवर्ती अवस्था अछि, जइ प्रकार भोजन पकबामे ईन्धनक ज्वाला।” अतएव शब्दसभ दोसर शब्दक अर्थसँ अन्वित वाक्यार्थकें तात्पर्य बनबैत अछि; एहि सँ ई नियम सिद्ध नहि होइत जे सभ वाक्यक

तात्पर्य अनिवार्यतः कर्तव्यसँ अन्वित हो। फलतः कूटस्थनित्य ब्रह्मस्वरूपकेँ वाक्यक तात्पर्य मानबामे कोनो दोष नहि।

“भव्य” अर्थात् जे उत्पन्न होयबाक अछि, से कर्तव्य अछि। आपत्ति अछि—कर्तव्यक लेल प्रतिपादित विद्यमान वस्तु वस्तुतः विद्यमान नहि, कारण कर्तव्यसँ जुड़ल रूपमे ओहो उत्पन्न होयवला बनि जाइत अछि। उत्तर अछि—“वास्तवमे विद्यमान वस्तुएँ प्रतिपादित होइत अछि।” सम्बन्धक अर्थ तादात्म्य नहि; कर्तव्यसँ ओकर सम्बन्ध साध्य फल आ ओकर साधनक सम्बन्ध होइत अछि। उत्पत्तिरूप प्रक्रियाक विषय बनैत काल विद्यमान वस्तुक सम्बन्ध क्रिया आ कारकक सम्बन्ध होइत अछि; एहि कारण विद्यमान वस्तु स्वयं क्रियारूप नहि भऽ जाइत।

पूर्वपक्षी कहैत अछि—“यद्यपि ओ क्रिया नहि...” अर्थात् जे ब्रह्म क्रियाक सहायक नहि आ कूटस्थनित्य छथि, हुनकर शास्त्रीय प्रतिपादन बुझब कठिन अछि। उत्तर अछि—“एतय कोनो कठिनाइ नहि; क्रियाक लेल प्रतिपादित भेलहुँ...” विद्यमान वस्तु क्रियाक प्रयोजनसँ प्रतिपादित भेलापर सेहो विद्यमानसँ भिन्न नहि भऽ जाइत; उलटे, क्रियाकेँ सम्पन्न करबाक सामर्थ्यवला वस्तु निश्चय विद्यमान होइत अछि।

जे शब्द विद्यमान वस्तुकेँ जनबैत अछि, ओकर प्रयोग किछु ठाम कोनो क्रियासँ वाक्यगत सम्बन्ध बिना अपनामे स्थित विद्यमान वस्तुकेँ विषय बनबैत देखल जाइत अछि। एहन शब्दकेँ जबर्दस्ती क्रियासम्बन्धक अर्थमे मोड़ब उचित नहि। सीमित प्रयोग सएह बेर देखल गेलहुँ कतहु देखल असीम प्रयोग अदृश्य नहि भऽ जाइत। लोकव्यवहारमे वन आदिक वर्णन जकाँ अनेक वाक्य भेटैत अछि, जाहिमे केवल “होयब” क्रियाक सम्बन्ध अछि, मुदा जे कोनो कर्तव्यक सहायक नहि। क्रियासँ सम्बन्धित वाक्यो कखनो केवल सम्बन्धक बोध कराबि समाप्त होइत अछि—“ई मनुष्य केकर अछि?” प्रश्नक उत्तर “राजाक” होइत अछि। तहिना कखनो केवल प्रातिपदिक अर्थक विशेषता पुछल जाइत अछि—“ई गाछसभ केहन अछि?” उत्तर “फलवाला” होइत अछि। प्रश्नकर्ताकेँ मनुष्य वा गाछक अस्तित्व-अनस्तित्व नहि, बल्कि मनुष्यक विशिष्ट स्वामी वा गाछक विशिष्ट प्रकार जानबाक इच्छा होइत अछि। जाननिहार व्यक्ति ओही इच्छित विशेषक उत्तर दैत अछि, अस्तित्वक नहि। एहि सँ सिद्ध अछि जे फलदायक विद्यमान वस्तुक विषयमे शब्दक सार्थक प्रयोग होइत अछि।

फेर प्रश्न अछि—“जँ विद्यमान वस्तुक शिक्षा देल गेल, तखन शिक्षक वा श्रोताकेँ ओकर की लाभ?” ताहि लेल केवल फलदायक विद्यमान वस्तु पढ़ाओल जाए, निष्फल नहि। ब्रह्म निष्फल प्रतीत होइत छथि, कारण ओ समस्त क्रियासँ रहित आ उदासीन छथि; ताहि सँ कोनो क्रियाक उपकार सम्भव नहि। उत्तर अछि—“अज्ञात आत्मतत्त्वक शिक्षा सेहो निश्चय एही प्रकारक अर्थात् फलदायक अछि।” “च” शब्द एतय “अपि”—“सेहो”—अर्थमे अछि। ब्रह्म क्रियारहित छथि, तथापि हुनकर विषयमे शब्दप्रमाणसँ उत्पन्न आ साक्षात्कारमे परिणत ज्ञान अपन विरोधी, संसारक मूल कारण अविद्याकेँ नष्ट करैत अछि; अतएव ई ज्ञान पूर्णतः फलदायक अछि।

आरो, जे सभ शब्दक तात्पर्य केवल कर्तव्य मानैत छथि, ओहो “ब्राह्मणकेँ नहि मारबाक चाही”, “मदिरा नहि पीबाक चाही” एहन निषेधवाक्यमे कोन कर्तव्य प्रतिपादित अछि—ई नहि देखाबि सकैत। कर्तव्य संकल्पक सीमासँ निर्धारित होइत अछि, संकल्पसँ व्याप्त रहैत अछि आ संकल्प समाप्त भेलापर समाप्त होइत अछि, जइ प्रकार वृक्षत्व समाप्त भेलापर शिशपात्व समाप्त होइत अछि। संकल्प मनुष्यक प्रयत्न अछि आ ओकर निर्धारण विषयक अनुसार होइत अछि। संकल्पक विषय साध्य वस्तु होयबाक कारण उत्पत्तिप्रक्रिया होयबाक चाही—जाहिमे पूर्वापर क्रम अछि आ जे कोनो

अन्य फल उत्पन्न करैत अछि; ओ ने द्रव्य भऽ सकैत अछि, ने गुण। कारण संकल्प सीधे ओही वस्तुकेँ व्याप्त करैत अछि जे संकल्पक विषय अछि; विद्यमान द्रव्य आ गुण संकल्पसँ व्याप्त नहि होइत। एहि कारण शास्त्रकार कहैत छथि—“धातु उत्पत्तिक अर्थ जनबैत अछि; ओकर माध्यमसँ क्रिया ज्ञात होइत अछि।” द्रव्य आ गुणवाचक शब्दक विषयमे आगाँ विचार जारी अछि।

द्रव्य आ गुणक सम्बन्ध कर्तव्यसँ तखन होइत अछि जखन ओ सभ प्रसङ्गवश उपस्थित होइत अछि। मुदा भावना अर्थात् उत्पादन-क्रियाक कर्तव्यसँ सम्बन्ध स्वयं ओकर स्वभावसँ अछि; द्रव्य आ गुणबोधक शब्दक ई सम्बन्ध केवल भावना-सँ संयोगक माध्यम होइत अछि। ताहि कारण नवीन यागादिक बोध भावना-बोधक शब्दसँ होइत अछि, द्रव्य वा गुणबोधक शब्दसँ नहि।

“दधिसँ आहुति देबाक चाही” वा “निरन्तर सिंचन करबाक चाही” एहन वाक्यमे दधि आदि कर्तव्यक विषय नहि अछि। एतहु कर्तव्यक वास्तविक विषय केवल भावना-क्रिया—आहुति देब अथवा सिंचन करब—अछि। “सोमरससँ याग करबाक चाही” जकाँ दधिसँ विशेषित आहुति आ निरन्तरतासँ विशेषित सिंचनक विधान भेलासँ “अग्निहोत्रक आहुति देबाक चाही” वा “घृतसँ सिंचन करबाक चाही” वाक्य ओकर पुनर्वचन भऽ जाइत अछि—एहन निष्कर्षो नहि निकलैत।

एतहु कर्तव्यक विषय भावना-क्रियाए अछि; तथापि द्रव्य आ गुण, स्वयं विषय नहि होइतहुँ, भावनाक पूरक रूपेँ विधेय होइत अछि। केवल कारकक निर्विशेष व्यापार रूप भावना विशेष द्रव्यादि कारकसँ विशेषित आ निश्चित होइत अछि; ताहि लेल द्रव्य आदि ओकर अङ्ग अछि। भावना विधेय भेलापर ओ अपन अङ्गसभक संग विधेय होइत अछि; अतएव द्रव्य आ गुण विषय नहि होइतहुँ अङ्गरूपेँ विधेय भऽ जाइत अछि। एहि प्रकार विधि भावनाक माध्यम होइत द्रव्य आ गुणपर लागू होइत अछि। विस्तारक भय सँ, मूल कर्तव्य अन्यत्र सिद्ध रहैत, ओकर पुनर्वचन द्रव्यादि पूरक पदार्थकेँ तात्पर्य बनबैत अछि। फलतः सभ प्रसङ्गमे विधिक विषय केवल भावना-क्रियाए अछि।

एहि सँ “आठ कपालवला आग्नेय याग” आदि वाक्यमे यागक द्रव्य आ देवतासँ सम्बन्ध विधिक विषय अछि—ई मत खण्डित होइत अछि। विधिक विषय केवल ‘होयब’ नहि भऽ सकैत। जँ भावनाक कर्ता पहिनहिसँ विद्यमान अछि, तखन सिद्ध वस्तु फेर उत्पन्न होयबाक कर्ता नहि भऽ सकैत; आ जँ कर्ता अविद्यमान अछि, तखन आकाशक फूल जकाँ अविद्यमान वस्तुपर विधि लागू नहि भऽ सकैत। अतएव विधिक विषय उत्पादक कर्ताक व्यापार अछि—जे उत्पन्न करैत अछि। ‘होयब’ शब्दसँ उत्पन्न वस्तुक व्यापार सूचित होइत अछि; एहि व्यापारकेँ भावना, इच्छा वा प्रयत्न कहल जाइत अछि।

ई भावना जँ विषयविहीन हो, तखन ओकर ज्ञान सम्भव नहि; ताहि कारण विषयक आवश्यकता सँ “आग्नेय” शब्द जे द्रव्य आ देवताक सम्बन्ध स्मरण करबैत अछि, से भावनाक विषय मानल जाइत अछि—एहन मत उपस्थित कएल जाइत अछि। मुदा क्रियारूप व्यापारकेँ विषय बनबयवला मनुष्यक प्रयत्न क्रियारहित द्रव्य-देवता-सम्बन्धपर केना लागू होयत? “घट बनाउ” एतहु मनुष्यक प्रयत्न संज्ञापदक प्रत्यक्ष अर्थ घटपर नहि, हाथक माध्यम दण्ड आदि साधनक व्यापारपर लागू होइत अछि। ताहि कारण वाक्य घटक प्रयोजनसँ क्रियारूप व्यापारकेँ विषय बनबयवला प्रयत्न बतबैत अछि; घट प्रत्यक्ष विषय नहि, केवल उद्दिष्ट अछि।

एही प्रकार “ओ आग्नेय याग” आदि वाक्यमे विधेय केवल कर्तव्य याग अछि, जे द्रव्य आ देवताक सम्बन्धसँ सूचित होइत अछि। “जे आग्नेय याग कएल जाइत अछि” वाक्यक अर्थ अछि—“आग्नेय यागद्वारा इच्छित फल उत्पन्न करबाक चाही।” ताहि लेल “जे एहि प्रकार जानि पूर्णमास याग करैत अछि” आ “जे एहि प्रकार जानि अमावस्या याग करैत अछि” एहन वाक्य “ओ आग्नेय याग” आदि

वाक्यमे विहित छह यागक पुनर्वचन बनैत अछि। “स्वर्गकाम व्यक्ति दर्श आ पूर्णमास याग करय” एहि वाक्यमे फलक सम्बन्ध केवल विहित कर्मक एहि पुनर्वचनक माध्यम होइत अछि।

अतएव प्रत्येक ठाम विधिक विषय प्रयत्नक माध्यम केवल क्रियात्मक व्यापार अछि। “नहि मारू”, “नहि पीबू” आदिमे जँ कोनो कर्तव्य मानल जाए, तखन ओकर व्यापक संकल्प वा प्रयत्न सेहो मानब पड़त, आ तकर विषय बननिहार भावना सेहो। प्रजापति-व्रतक समान, ‘नहि मारब’ अथवा ‘नहि पीब’ एहन संकल्पक लक्षणाद्वारा निषेधक अर्थ मानल जाए, तखन अवसरप्राप्त कर्मक निषेधरूप नञर्थक अन्येष्टि भऽ जाएत। प्रत्यक्ष अर्थ सम्भव रहिते लक्षणा उचित नहि। “उगैत सूर्यकेँ नहि देखू” एहन वाक्य “ई हुनकर व्रत अछि” कहि आरम्भ होइत अछि, ताहि कारण ओतय अवसरप्राप्त दर्शनक निषेधक भिन्न व्यवस्था सम्भव अछि।

“ब्राह्मणकेँ नहि मारबाक चाही” जकाँ वाक्य प्रवृत्तिसँ निवृत्ति सिखबैत अछि। ई निवृत्ति स्वयं कोनो क्रिया नहि, नहि क्रियाक साधन। जँ क्रियाक प्रयोजनसँ रहित उपदेश निरर्थक मानल जाए, तखन “ब्राह्मणकेँ नहि मारबाक चाही” जकाँ निवृत्तिक उपदेश निरर्थक ठहरत; ई स्वीकार्य नहि। नञ्-शब्दकेँ कोनो असिद्ध क्रियाक बोधक मानबो सम्भव नहि, किएक तँ हत्या-क्रियाक अर्थ स्वभावतः सिद्ध अछि; नञ् ओकर अभाव बतबैत अछि, हत्या-विषयक कोनो नवीन क्रिया नहि।

नञ्-शब्दक स्वभाव ई अछि जे ओ जकरा संग जुड़ैत अछि, ओकर अभावक बोध करबैत अछि। अभावक ज्ञान उदासीनताक कारण होइत अछि, आ ई ज्ञान अपन कारण समाप्त भेलापर, इन्धन समाप्त अग्नि जकाँ, स्वयं शान्त भऽ जाइत अछि। अतएव प्रजापति-व्रत आदि विशेष प्रसङ्ग छोड़ि “ब्राह्मणकेँ नहि मारबाक चाही” आदि निषेधक अर्थ अवसरप्राप्त कर्मसँ निवृत्तिरूप उदासीनता मात्र अछि। ताहि कारण जे आख्यानादि केवल विद्यमान वस्तुक प्रशंसा करैत अछि आ मानव-पुरुषार्थक सेवा नहि करैत, तिनका विषयमे निष्फलताक कथन बुझबाक चाही।

एहि पर कहल जाइत अछि—अभावज्ञान उदासीनताक स्थापनाक कारण अछि। “ज्वर भेलापर पथ्य भोजन करू” अथवा “साँपकेँ अपन आँठी नहि दिअ” सुनि वृद्ध व्यक्ति पथ्य ग्रहण करैत छथि, वा आँठी देबाक प्रवृत्ति छल ताहिसँ निवृत्त होइत छथि। ई देखि सीखयवला बालक अनुमान करैत अछि जे वृद्धक प्रवृत्ति आ निवृत्तिक कारण क्रमशः इच्छा आ द्वेष अछि। वृद्धक प्रवृत्ति-निवृत्ति स्वतंत्र अछि आ इच्छा-द्वेषसँ उत्पन्न अछि, जइ प्रकार हमर अपन प्रवृत्ति-निवृत्ति।

इच्छा आ द्वेषक पहिले ओही वस्तुमे इच्छित वा अनिच्छित फल प्राप्त कराबयवला साधनताक ज्ञान होइत अछि। आत्मनिरीक्षणमे हम पबैत छी जे इच्छा-द्वेष केवल शब्दज्ञान, क्रियाज्ञान, वक्ताक अभिप्राय अथवा त्रिकालातीत अदृष्ट विधिशक्तिसँ उत्पन्न नहि होइत; ओ इच्छित-अनिच्छित फलसँ साधनसम्बन्धक ज्ञानक पश्चात् उत्पन्न होइत अछि। ताहि कारण वृद्धक प्रवृत्ति, निवृत्ति, इच्छा आ द्वेष सेहो ओहि साधनताज्ञानसँ व्याप्त अछि; पूर्वापर क्रमसँ कारण-कार्यसम्बन्ध सिद्ध होइत अछि।

ई साधनताज्ञान पहिने नहि छल; शब्द सुनिने उत्पन्न भेल, ताहि कारण शब्दश्रवण ओकर कारण अछि। “याग करबाक चाही” एहन वाक्य प्रवृत्ति उत्पन्न करैत अछि; शब्द स्वयं कर्तव्य क्रिया, इच्छित फलक साधनता आ ओकर अनिवार्यताक ज्ञान करबैत अछि। ई दुइ ज्ञान अन्य उपायसँ प्राप्त नहि होइत, आ जे अर्थ अन्य उपायसँ प्राप्त नहि हो, से शब्दक विशिष्ट अर्थ होइत अछि।

मुदा “नहि मारू”, “नहि पीबू” आदिमे अनिवार्यता अन्य प्रकार—राग वा आवेगजन्य प्रवृत्तिसँ—पहिनहिसँ प्राप्त अछि। एतय नञ्-सहित विधिप्रत्यय ओकर पुनर्वचन करैत अछि आ हत्या वा मद्यपानक अनर्थ-साधनता बतबैत अछि, जे अन्य प्रकारसँ सिद्ध नहि छल। इच्छित फलक साधनता त

प्रत्यक्ष ज्ञात अछि; नहि त ओ इच्छा-विषय बनिते नहि। अतएव निषेधवाक्य अनर्थक साधनताक ज्ञान करबैत अछि, कर्तव्यताक विधान नहि। प्रतिबन्धित कर्मक अनर्थ-साधनताक ज्ञानए ओकर अभावक ज्ञानक समान कार्य करैत अछि।

बुद्धिमान व्यक्ति बाह्य रूपेँ प्रवृत्तिक अवसर रहितहुँ भविष्यक अनर्थ विचारि ओहि क्रियाक अभाव बुझैत अछि, निवृत्त होइत अछि आ उदासीन अवस्थामे स्थित होइत अछि। जँ अभावज्ञान उदासीनताक कारण अछि, तखन उदासीनता रहब धरि ओ ज्ञान रहबाक चाही; मुदा एहन नहि। उदासीन व्यक्ति दोसर विषयमे मन लगाएल रहैत अछि, तखन निषिद्ध क्रियाक अभावक निरन्तर ज्ञान नहि रहैत। कारण हटिते प्रभाव सदैव नष्ट हो—एहन नियम नहि; खम्भा हटिते ऊपरक भवन अवश्य नहि टिकैत, मुदा रक्षक कारण हटिते रक्षित वस्तु तत्काल नष्टो नहि होइत।

ताहि लेल कहल गेल—ई ज्ञान इन्धन समाप्त अग्नि जकाँ स्वयं शान्त भऽ जाइत अछि। अनर्थ-साधनताक ज्ञान होयब धरि मात्र कर्मप्रवृत्ति रहैत अछि; ओ ज्ञान प्रवृत्तिक मूल उखाड़ि दैत अछि आ स्वयं शान्त भऽ जाइत अछि। अभावज्ञान उदासीनताक स्थापनाक कारण अछि, स्थायित्वक आधार नहि; ओ विनाशकारी बाह्य कारणसँ रक्षा करैत कवच जकाँ अछि। कवच हटिते, जँ बाणक आक्रमण नहि, योद्धाक जीवन तत्काल नष्ट नहि होइत। अतएव निषेधक अर्थ अवसरप्राप्त कर्मसँ निवृत्तिरूप उदासीनता अछि; अनर्थ-साधनताक ज्ञान ओकर उपलक्षण मात्र अछि।

जे आपत्ति छल जे कर्तव्य-विधिमे प्रवेश बिना केवल विद्यमान वस्तुक उल्लेख “पृथ्वीक सात द्वीप अछि” जकाँ निष्फल होयत, से खण्डित भऽ गेल। “ई रस्सी अछि, सर्प नहि” एहन केवल वस्तुवचनसँ सेहो भय दूर होइत अछि। ईहो कहल गेल छल जे ब्रह्मवाक्य सुनलाक बादो संसारित्व पहिने जकाँ देखाइत अछि, ताहि कारण रस्सीक यथार्थ ज्ञान जकाँ ओकर प्रयोजन नहि। उत्तर अछि—जे व्यक्ति ब्रह्मकेँ आत्मारूपेँ साक्षात् जानि लेने अछि, ओकरामे संसारित्व देखाओल नहि जा सकैत।

पहिनेक जकाँ संसारित्व देखाओल नहि जा सकैत, कारण ई प्रमाणरूप वेदसँ उत्पन्न आत्मारूप ब्रह्मक ज्ञानक विरोधी अछि। जे व्यक्ति शरीर आदिमे आत्मबुद्धि रखैत अछि, तकरामे दुःख, भय आदि देखाइत अछि। मुदा ओही व्यक्तिमे प्रमाणरूप वेदसँ आत्मारूप ब्रह्मक साक्षात्कार भेलापर जखन एहन आत्माभिमान समाप्त भऽ जाइत अछि, तखन मिथ्याज्ञानजन्य ओही दुःख आ भयक बन्धन फेरो रहैत अछि—एहन मानब सम्भव नहि। धनवान् गृहस्थ धनमे अपनत्वबुद्धि रखैत अछि, ताहि कारण धन चोरी भऽ जयबाक भय ओकरामे रहैत अछि; मुदा ओही व्यक्ति धन त्यागि धनाभिमानसँ मुक्त भऽ गेलापर धन चोरी भऽ जयबाक ओ भय नहि रहैत।

तहिना कुण्डल धारण कएनिहार व्यक्ति कुण्डलधारणक अभिमानसँ सुख अनुभव करैत अछि; मुदा ओही व्यक्ति कुण्डल त्यागि कुण्डलधारणक अभिमानसँ मुक्त भऽ गेलापर कुण्डलधारणजन्य सुख ओकरामे नहि रहैत। श्रुति कहैत अछि—‘अशरीरी आत्माकेँ प्रिय आ अप्रिय स्पर्श नहि करैत।’ जँ कहल जाए जे शरीर नष्ट भेलापर अशरीरत्व सम्भव अछि, जीवित अवस्थामे नहि—तखन ई उचित नहि।

शरीरित्व मिथ्याज्ञानसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि। आत्माक शरीरित्व शरीरमे आत्मबुद्धिरूप मिथ्याज्ञानक अतिरिक्त कोनो दोसर प्रकारेँ मानल नहि जा सकैत। अशरीरत्व नित्य अछि, कारण ओ कोनो कर्मसँ उत्पन्न नहि; ई बात पहिनिहिसँ कहल जा चुकल अछि। जँ कहल जाए जे आत्माद्वारा अर्जित धर्म-अधर्म शरीरित्वक कारण अछि, तखन सेहो नहि; कारण आत्माक शरीरसँ सम्बन्ध सिद्ध नहि अछि, आत्मा धर्म-अधर्म अर्जित करैत अछि—ईहो सिद्ध नहि, आ शरीरसम्बन्ध तथा धर्म-अधर्मार्जनक बीच

परस्पराश्रय दोष उत्पन्न होइत अछि। एहि सम्बन्धकें अनादि मानि लेब अन्हाराक शृङ्खला जकाँ निराधार अछि।

आत्मामे क्रियाक समवाय नहि, ताहि कारण ओकर कर्तृत्व बुझल नहि जा सकैत। जँ कहल जाए जे राजा आदिमे केवल निकटतासँ कर्तृत्व मानल जाइत अछि, तखन सेहो नहि; कारण हुनकर कर्तृत्व धनादि देनाइ सँ उत्पन्न सेवकसम्बन्धद्वारा बुझल जाइत अछि। आत्मा आ शरीर आदिक बीच स्वामी-सेवक सम्बन्ध स्थापित करबाक लेल धनदान जकाँ कोनो कारण कल्पित नहि कएल जा सकैत। शरीरसँ आत्माक सम्बन्धक प्रत्यक्ष कारण मिथ्या अभिमान अछि। एही सँ आत्माकें यज्ञकर्ता मानल जयबाक व्यवहारो बुझल जाइत अछि।

एतय किछु लोक कहैत छथि—शरीरादिसँ भिन्न आत्माक अपन शरीर आदिमे ‘हम’ बुद्धि गौण अछि, मिथ्या नहि। ई मत ठीक नहि; मुख्य आ गौण प्रयोग केवल ओही व्यक्तिक लेल सम्भव अछि जे दुनू वस्तुक भेद नीक जकाँ जानैत अछि। जकरा वस्तुसभक भेद ज्ञात अछि, ओ मुख्य आ गौण अर्थक अन्तर बुझि सकैत अछि।

उदाहरणार्थ, अयाल आ विशिष्ट आकृतिवला पशुमे सहस्थिति आ सहाभावद्वारा ‘सिंह’ शब्द आ सिंहबुद्धिक मुख्य अर्थ सिद्ध होइत अछि। क्रूरता, साहस आदि सिंहक सामान्य गुणसँ युक्त कोनो मनुष्य लेल ओही ज्ञानी व्यक्तिक ‘सिंह’ शब्द आ सिंहबुद्धि गौण रूपेँ प्रयुक्त होइत अछि। मुदा जकरा सिंह आ मनुष्यक भेद ज्ञात नहि, ओकरामे एक वस्तुक शब्द आ बुद्धि दोसर वस्तुमे गौणतासँ नहि, भ्रमसँ उत्पन्न होइत अछि। साँझक धुँधलकामे जकर विशिष्टता स्पष्ट नहि भेल, ओहि खम्भाकें ‘ई मनुष्य अछि’ बुझल जाइत अछि; एतय मनुष्य-शब्द आ मनुष्यबुद्धिक विषय खम्भा भऽ जाइत अछि। तहिना सीपमे अज्ञात कारणसँ ‘ई चानी अछि’ एहन शब्द आ बुद्धि उत्पन्न होइत अछि।

एही प्रकार शरीरादिक समूहमे आत्मा आ अनात्माक अविवेकसँ ‘हम’ शब्द आ ‘हम’ बुद्धि उत्पन्न होइत अछि; एकरा गौण केना कहल जा सकैत अछि? आत्मा-अनात्माक विवेकजन्य ज्ञान राखनिहार विद्वान् लोक सेहो व्यवहारक अभ्यासमे, गड़ेरिया आ बकरी चरबनिहार जकाँ, ‘हम’ शब्द आ बुद्धिक भेद स्पष्ट नहि कऽ पबैत छथि। ताहि कारण शरीरादिसँ भिन्न आत्मा माननिहार लेल शरीरमे ‘हम’ बुद्धि मिथ्या अछि, गौण नहि।

शरीरित्व मिथ्याज्ञानसँ उत्पन्न होयबाक कारण ज्ञानी व्यक्ति जीवित अवस्थामे सेहो अशरीर छथि। ब्रह्मज्ञानीक विषयमे श्रुति कहैत अछि—‘जइ प्रकार साँपक त्यक्त केंचुली बाँबीपर मृत आ फेकल पड़ल रहैत अछि, तहिना ई शरीर पड़ल रहैत अछि; तखन ई अशरीर, अमृत प्राण ब्रह्म मात्र, ज्योति मात्र अछि।’ आर कहल गेल अछि—‘आँखि रहितहुँ मानू आँखि नहि, कान रहितहुँ मानू कान नहि, वाणी रहितहुँ मानू वाणी नहि, मन रहितहुँ मानू मन नहि, प्राण रहितहुँ मानू प्राण नहि।’ स्मृतिमे सेहो ‘स्थितप्रज्ञक भाषा की अछि?’ आदि प्रश्नद्वारा स्थितप्रज्ञक लक्षण कहैत ई देखाओल गेल अछि जे ज्ञानीक कोनो कर्मप्रवृत्तिसँ वास्तविक सम्बन्ध नहि रहैत। अतएव आत्मारूप ब्रह्मक साक्षात्कार कएनिहार व्यक्तिमे पहिनेक जकाँ संसारित्व नहि रहैत; जकरामे पहिनेक जकाँ संसारित्व अछि, ओ आत्मारूप ब्रह्मक साक्षात्कार नहि कएने अछि। एहि मतमे कोनो दोष नहि।

ईहो कहल गेल छल जे श्रवणक बाद मनन आ निदिध्यासन देखल जाइत अछि, ताहि कारण ब्रह्म कोनो विधिक अङ्ग अछि आ अपन स्वतन्त्र सत्तामे समाप्त नहि होइत। ई उचित नहि; कारण श्रवण जकाँ मनन आ निदिध्यासन सेहो साक्षात्कारक प्रयोजनसँ कएल जाइत अछि।

अतएव ब्रह्म ध्यानविधिक विषय होयबाक कारण शास्त्रक प्रमाणविषय नहि बनैत; वेदान्तवाक्यसभक समन्वयसँ ई सिद्ध अछि जे ब्रह्म स्वतन्त्र रूपेँ शास्त्रप्रमाणक विषय छथि। एहि कारण ‘अथातो ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा’—अर्थात् आब ब्रह्मकेँ जानबाक इच्छा—एहि रूपमे ब्रह्मविषयक पृथक् शास्त्रक आरम्भ युक्तिसङ्गत अछि। जँ एकर तात्पर्य ध्यानविधि होइत, तखन पृथक् शास्त्र आरम्भ नहि होइत; ‘अथातो धर्मजिज्ञासा’ सँ आरम्भ भेल शास्त्रमे ओकर आरम्भ पहिनहिसँ भऽ गेल होइत। आ जँ फेरो आरम्भ आवश्यक होइत, तखन ‘अथातो धर्मक शेष अंशक जिज्ञासा’ एहन रूप होइत—जइ प्रकार ‘आब यज्ञक प्रयोजनक साधन आ पुरुषार्थक साधनक जिज्ञासा’ कहल गेल अछि। ओहि धर्मशास्त्रमे ब्रह्म आ आत्माक एकत्वक साक्षात्कारक प्रतिज्ञा नहि अछि; ताहि कारण एहि प्रयोजनसँ ‘अथातो ब्रह्मजिज्ञासा’ रूपेँ दोसर शास्त्रक आरम्भ युक्तिसङ्गत अछि।

अतएव ‘हम ब्रह्म छी’—एहि ज्ञानमे सभ विधि आ अन्य समस्त प्रमाण समाप्त भऽ जाइत अछि। अद्वैत आत्माक साक्षात्कार भेलापर, जे आत्मा न त्याज्य छथि न ग्राह्य, विषयविहीन आ ज्ञातासँ रहित विधि अथवा प्रमाण फेर प्रमाणक कार्य करबाक योग्य नहि रहैत।

पूर्वपक्षी फेर कहैत छथि—जखन गौण आ मिथ्या आत्मा नहि रहत, तखन पुत्र, शरीर आदिक बाधित भऽ गेलापर ‘हम सत्य ब्रह्मस्वरूप छी’ ई कर्तव्यरूप ज्ञान केना उत्पन्न होयत? खोजल जाएवला आत्माक ज्ञानसँ पहिने आत्मामे ज्ञातृत्व रहैत अछि। खोजल जाएवला वस्तु केवल ज्ञाता अछि—पाप, दोष आदिसँ रहित। शरीरमे आत्मबुद्धिकेँ जइ प्रकार प्रमाण मानल जाइत अछि, तहिना आत्माक निर्णय होयब धरि ई व्यवहारिक ज्ञानो प्रमाण मानल जाइत अछि।

पुत्र आदिमे आत्मबुद्धि गौण अछि। अपन दुःखसँ मनुष्य दुःखी आ अपन सुखसँ सुखी होइत अछि; पुत्र आदिमे उपस्थित दुःख-सुखसँ सेहो ओ तहिना दुःखी-सुखी अनुभव करैत अछि, ताहि कारण ई गौण प्रयोग अछि। मुदा एतय एकत्वबुद्धि नहि, कारण अनुभवमे भेद स्पष्ट अछि; अतएव ई ‘वाहिक बैल अछि’ जकाँ गौण बुद्धि अछि। शरीर, इन्द्रिय आदिमे आत्मबुद्धि गौण नहि, कारण ओहि सभसँ अभेदक अनुभव होइत अछि; सीपमे चानीक ज्ञान जकाँ ई भ्रम अछि।

आत्मबुद्धिक एहि दू प्रकारक अभिमानसँ संसारक व्यवहार चलैत अछि। जँ ई अभिमान नहि रहैत, तखन संसारक व्यवहारो नहि चलैत, आ ब्रह्म-आत्मैक्यक अनुभवो नहि होइत; कारण ओकर साधन—श्रवण, मनन आदि—नहि रहैत। ‘पुत्र, शरीर आदिक बाधित होयब’क अभिप्राय ई अछि: गौण आत्मबुद्धि नष्ट भेलापर पुत्र, पत्नी आदिमे ‘हमर’ बुद्धि बाधित होइत अछि; मिथ्या आत्मबुद्धि नष्ट भेलापर शरीर, इन्द्रिय आदि बाधित होइत अछि, आ तिनकर संग श्रवण आदि सेहो बाधित होइत अछि।

एहि कारण केवल संसारक व्यवहारक अन्त नहि होइत; जागरणस्वरूप ‘हम सत्य ब्रह्मस्वरूप छी’ ई कर्तव्य ज्ञान—अर्थात् अद्वैतक साक्षात्कार—सेहो केना उत्पन्न होयत? एहि असम्भवक कारण बतबैत कहल गेल अछि—‘खोजल जाएवला आत्माक ज्ञानसँ पहिने आत्मामे ज्ञातृत्व रहैत अछि।’ एतय ‘ज्ञातृत्व’ शब्द उपलक्षण अछि; प्रमाण, प्रमेय आ प्रमाणक साधनक भेद सेहो बुझबाक चाही।

ई भेद अद्वैतसाक्षात्कारक कारण अछि, कारण ओ साक्षात्कारसँ पहिने अनिवार्य रूपेँ रहैत अछि। अतएव ई भेद नहि रहत तखन ओकर फलो उत्पन्न नहि होयत। खोजल जाएवला आत्मा ज्ञाता आत्मसँ भिन्न नहि; ताहि लेल कहल गेल—‘खोजल जाएवला केवल ज्ञाता अछि—पाप, दोष आदिसँ रहित।’ अपन गरदनमे पहिनल हारक उदाहरण पहिनहिसँ देल जा चुकल अछि।

मानल जाए। मुदा अप्रमाणसँ परम सत्य अद्वैतानुभव केना उत्पन्न भऽ सकैत अछि? उत्तर अछि—‘शरीरमे आत्मबुद्धिकेँ जइ प्रकार प्रमाण मानल जाइत अछि, तहिना ई व्यवहारिक ज्ञानो प्रमाण मानल जाइत अछि।’ एकर सीमा बताओल गेल अछि—‘आत्माक निर्णय होयब धरि’, अर्थात् ब्रह्मस्वरूपक साक्षात्कार होयब धरि।

जगतक परम सत्यता माननिहारो स्वीकार करैत छथि जे शरीर आदिमे आत्मबुद्धि मिथ्या अछि, कारण प्रमाणजन्य ज्ञान ओकर बाध करैत अछि। तथापि एही मिथ्या आत्मबुद्धिकेँ सभ प्रमाणज्ञानक कारण आ संसारक वास्तविक व्यवहारक आधार मानल जाइत अछि। अद्वैतसाक्षात्कारक सम्बन्धमे हमर मत सेहो एही प्रकारक अछि। अद्वैतक साक्षात्कार अन्तःकरणक कोनो विशेष वृत्ति रूपमे परम आ अविचल सत्य नहि; जे साक्षात्कार वास्तविक अछि, ओ कर्तव्य नहि, कारण ओ ब्रह्मस्वरूप अछि।

अविद्या दोसर अविद्याकेँ नष्ट करय अथवा उत्पन्न करय—एतय कोनो असङ्गति नहि। श्रुति सेहो कहैत अछि—‘विद्या आ अविद्या दुनूकेँ संग-संग जाननिहार अविद्याद्वारा मृत्युकेँ पार करैत अछि आ विद्याद्वारा अमरत्व प्राप्त करैत अछि।’ अतएव सभ बात स्पष्ट अछि।

एतय चतुःसूत्री-भामती समाप्त होइत अछि।

अध्याय ४

भामती
(चतुःसूत्री)

विस्तृत बिबलियोग्राफी

सन्दर्भ-ग्रन्थसूची, टीका-परम्परा आ शोध-सहायक विवरण

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तैयारी तिथि: ६ अगस्त २०२६

सम्पादकीय टिप्पणी

ई बिबलियोग्राफी समीक्ष्य मैथिली पोथीक पाठ, ओकर दार्शनिक पृष्ठभूमि, भामती-प्रस्थानक टीका-परम्परा, विवरण-प्रस्थानसँ तुलनात्मक अध्ययन, वाचस्पति मिश्रक अन्य रचना, आधुनिक शोधग्रन्थ तथा विश्वसनीय डिजिटल संग्रह—एहि सभकेँ एकहि ठाम व्यवस्थित करैत अछि।

मूल संस्करण आ बादक पुनर्मुद्रण केँ यथासम्भव अलग-अलग चिन्हित कएल गेल अछि। जाहि दुर्लभ टीका वा पाण्डुलिपिक पूर्ण प्रकाशन-विवरण विश्वसनीय सूचीमे एकरूपेँ नहि भेटल, ओकर नाम अलग खण्डमे देल अछि आ सत्यापनक आवश्यकता स्पष्ट लिखल गेल अछि; कोनो अपुष्ट विवरण केँ निश्चित तथ्यक रूपमे नहि प्रस्तुत कएल गेल अछि।

प्रत्येक मुख्य प्रविष्टिक बाद “उपयोगिता” टिप्पणी देल अछि, जाहिसँ शोधार्थी बुझि सकथि जे कोन ग्रन्थ मूल पाठ, पाठभेद, टीका-परम्परा, दर्शन-इतिहास, प्रमाणमीमांसा, जीवन्मुक्ति, ख्यातिवाद वा अनुवाद-अध्ययनक हेतु विशेष उपयोगी अछि।

संक्षिप्त संकेत: सम्पा. = सम्पादक; अनु. = अनुवादक; खं. = खण्ड; पुनर्मु. = पुनर्मुद्रण; पृ. = पृष्ठ; सं. = संस्करण।

विषय-अनुक्रम

प्रविष्टिसभ विषयगत क्रममे अछि; अन्तिम खण्डमे दुर्लभ आ अपूर्ण-विवरणवला ग्रन्थ अलग राखल गेल अछि।

१. समीक्ष्य मैथिली संस्करण
२. ब्रह्मसूत्र आ शाङ्करभाष्यक आधार-संस्करण
३. भामतीक प्रमुख संस्कृत संस्करण
४. चतुःसूत्री-केंद्रित अनुवाद आ सम्पादित पाठ
५. भामतीपर टीका, उपटीका आ व्याख्या
६. विवरण-प्रस्थान आ तुलनात्मक मूलग्रन्थ
७. वाचस्पति मिश्रक अन्य प्रमुख रचना
८. वाचस्पति मिश्र आ भामतीपर आधुनिक अध्ययन
९. अद्वैत वेदान्तक इतिहास, पद्धति आ प्रमाणमीमांसा
१०. सहायक मूलग्रन्थ, उपनिषद् आ प्रस्थानत्रयी
११. डिजिटल संग्रह आ ऑनलाइन सन्दर्भ
१२. दुर्लभ वा प्रकाशन-विवरण अनिश्चित ग्रन्थ

१. समीक्ष्य मैथिली संस्करण

एहि बिबलियोग्राफीक केन्द्रमे वर्तमान मैथिली अनुवाद अछि।

१. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। भामती (चतुःसूत्री): शंकरक ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यपर टीका। मूल संस्कृतसँ शुद्ध मैथिली अनुवाद, सम्पादन आ पुस्तक-विन्यास: गजेन्द्र ठाकुर। विदेह — प्रथम मैथिली पाक्षिक ई-पत्रिका, प्रथम संस्करण २००४; परिवर्धित आ ऑडिट-संशोधित संस्करण २०२६। ISSN 2229-547X।
उपयोगिता: एहि पोथीक प्रत्यक्ष समीक्ष्य पाठ। अध्यासभाष्य आ ब्रह्मसूत्रक पहिल चारि सूत्रपर भामतीक सम्पूर्ण चतुःसूत्री अंश मैथिलीमे उपलब्ध करबैत अछि।

२. ब्रह्मसूत्र आ शाङ्करभाष्यक आधार-संस्करण

भामती शंकराचार्यक ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यपर टीका अछि; अतः भाष्यक विश्वसनीय पाठ आ अनुवाद अनिवार्य सहायक सामग्री अछि।

२. बादरायण। ब्रह्मसूत्र। शंकराचार्यक शारीरकभाष्यसहित विविध संस्कृत संस्करण।
उपयोगिता: सूत्र, भाष्य आ भामतीक त्रिस्तरीय पाठ-संरचना बुझबाक मूल आधार। शोधमे प्रयुक्त संस्करणक सम्पादक आ प्रकाशन-वर्ष अवश्य उल्लेखनीय।
३. शंकराचार्य। ब्रह्मसूत्र-शाङ्करभाष्य: रत्नप्रभा, भामती आ न्यायनिर्णयसहित। सम्पा. महादेव शास्त्री बाकरे आ वासुदेव लक्ष्मण शास्त्री पणशीकर। तृतीय संस्करण। बम्बई: पाण्डुरङ्ग जावजी, १९३४।
उपयोगिता: एकहि पृष्ठभूमिमे भाष्य, भामती आ अन्य व्याख्या देखबाक सुविधा; पाठ-तुलना आ टीका-स्तरक अनुसंधान लेल विशेष उपयोगी।
४. शंकराचार्य। ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्य। अङ्ग्रेजी अनु. स्वामी गम्भीरानन्द। कलकत्ता: अद्वैत आश्रम, १९६५; तृतीय संस्करण १९७७।
उपयोगिता: शाङ्करभाष्यक क्रमबद्ध अङ्ग्रेजी अनुवाद। मैथिली अनुवादक दार्शनिक पदावलीक तुलनात्मक अध्ययन लेल सहायक।
५. शंकराचार्य। द वेदान्त-सूत्रस, शाङ्करभाष्यसहित। अङ्ग्रेजी अनु. जॉर्ज थिबो। सेक्रेड बुक्स ऑफ द ईस्ट, खण्ड ३४ आ ३८। ऑक्सफोर्ड: क्लैरेण्डन प्रेस, १८९० आ १८९६; बादक भारतीय पुनर्मुद्रण उपलब्ध।
उपयोगिता: पाश्चात्य भाषामे आरम्भिक मानक अनुवाद; ऐतिहासिक अनुवाद-पद्धति आ पद-निर्वचनक तुलनाक हेतु उपयोगी।
६. शंकराचार्य। ब्रह्मसूत्र शाङ्करभाष्य। अङ्ग्रेजी अनु. वी. एम. आपटे। बम्बई: पॉप्युलर बुक डिपो, १९६०।
उपयोगिता: भाष्यक वैकल्पिक अङ्ग्रेजी प्रस्तुति; कठिन अधिकरणक अर्थ-तुलना लेल उपयोगी।
७. बादरायण आ शंकराचार्य। ब्रह्मसूत्र-शाङ्करभाष्यम्। डिजिटल प्रतिलिपि: भारतीय डिजिटल लाइब्रेरी/इंटरनेट आर्काइवमे उपलब्ध विविध संस्करण।
उपयोगिता: दुर्लभ मुद्रित संस्करणक खोज आ पृष्ठ-सत्यापन लेल उपयोगी; उद्धरण देबाक समय स्कैनक मूल प्रकाशकीय पृष्ठ अवश्य जाँचल जाए।

३. भामतीक प्रमुख संस्कृत संस्करण

एहि खण्डमे ऐतिहासिक मुद्रण, संयुक्त टीका-संस्करण आ आधुनिक पुनर्मुद्रण देल अछि।

८. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। भामती। सम्पा. बालशास्त्री। बिब्लियोथेका इंडिका शृङ्खला। कलकत्ता: एशियाटिक सोसाइटी ऑफ बंगाल; मुद्रण: बनारस प्रिन्टिङ्ग प्रेस, १८७६-१८८०। आठ फासिकल, लगभग ७६६ पृष्ठ।
उपयोगिता: भामतीक आरम्भिक आधुनिक मुद्रित पाठसभमे प्रमुख। ऐतिहासिक पाठभेद आ सम्पादन-परम्परा लेल आधारभूत।

९. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। भामती। सम्पा. जीवनानन्द विद्यासागर। कलकत्ता: सरस्वती प्रेस, १८९१। लगभग ६५३ पृष्ठ।
उपयोगिता: उन्नैसम शताब्दीक स्वतंत्र मुद्रित संस्करण; आरम्भिक बङ्गीय संस्कृत-मुद्रण परम्पराक साक्ष्य।
१०. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। भामती। सम्पा. ढुण्डिराज शास्त्री। काशी संस्कृत सीरीज, सं. ११६। बनारस: जयकृष्णदास-हरिदास गुप्त, १९३५।
उपयोगिता: काशी परम्पराक सुगम संस्कृत संस्करण; चतुःसूत्री पाठक संदर्भ लेल व्यापक रूपेँ प्रयुक्त।
११. शंकराचार्य, वाचस्पति मिश्र, अमलानन्द आ अप्पय दीक्षित। ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्य, भामती, वेदान्तकल्पतरु आ कल्पतरुपरिमलसहित संयुक्त संस्करण। श्रीरङ्गम्: श्री वाणी विलास प्रेस, लगभग १९०७।
उपयोगिता: भाष्यसँ परिमल धरि चारि व्याख्यात्मक स्तर एकठाम; टीका-परम्पराक अन्तःसम्बन्ध देखबाक उत्कृष्ट साधन।
१२. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। भामती। बालशास्त्री-सम्पादित १८७६-१८८० संस्करणक पुनर्मुद्रण। ओस्नाब्रुक: बिब्लियो फेरलाग, १९९९। ISBN 3764813881।
उपयोगिता: आरम्भिक बिब्लियोथेका इंडिका पाठक आधुनिक पुनःप्राप्ति; पुरान संस्करण अनुपलब्ध होयत तँ उपयोगी।
१३. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। भामती। सम्पा. ढुण्डिराज शास्त्री। द्वितीय/पुनर्मुद्रित संस्करण। वाराणसी: चौखम्भा संस्कृत संस्थान, २०१०।
उपयोगिता: शोधार्थीक लेल सहज उपलब्ध आधुनिक पुनर्मुद्रण; मुद्रणान्तरक कारण मूल १९३५ संस्करणसँ पृष्ठ-संख्या भिन्न भऽ सकैत अछि।
१४. शंकराचार्य। ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्य: रत्नप्रभा, भामती आ न्यायनिर्णयसहित। सम्पा. महादेव शास्त्री बाकरे तथा वि. ल. पणशीकर। बम्बई, १९३४।
उपयोगिता: भामतीक पाठ केँ अन्य शाङ्कर-व्याख्यासँ समानान्तर पढ़बाक मुख्य संयुक्त संस्करण।

४. चतुःसूत्री-केंद्रित अनुवाद आ सम्पादित पाठ

समीक्ष्य पोथी चतुःसूत्री धरि सीमित अछि; एहि कारण एहि अंशक पृथक् संस्करण विशेष महत्त्व रखैत अछि।

१५. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। द भामती ऑफ वाचस्पति ऑन शंकराज ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्य (चतुःसूत्री)। सम्पा. आ अङ्ग्रेजी अनु. एस. एस. सूर्यनारायण शास्त्री आ सी. कुन्हन राजा; भूमिका: सर्वपल्ली राधाकृष्णन। अड्यार लाइब्रेरी जनरल सीरीज, खं. १२। अड्यार, मद्रास: थियोसोफिकल सोसाइटी, १९३३; पुनर्मुद्रण: अड्यार लाइब्रेरी एण्ड रिसर्च सेंटर, १९९२। ISBN 9788185141091।
उपयोगिता: चतुःसूत्रीक संस्कृत पाठ आ अङ्ग्रेजी अनुवादक मानक संस्करण; मैथिली अनुवादक तुलनात्मक परीक्षण लेल सर्वाधिक प्रत्यक्ष सहायक।
१६. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। भामती (चतुःसूत्री)। मैथिली अनु. गजेन्द्र ठाकुर। विदेह, २००४/२०२६।
उपयोगिता: भारतीय भाषामे चतुःसूत्रीक अर्थानुगामी, देशज आ दार्शनिक पदावली-सचेत प्रस्तुति; मैथिली दर्शन-गद्यक अध्ययनक प्राथमिक स्रोत।

५. भामतीपर टीका, उपटीका आ व्याख्या

भामती-प्रस्थानक विकास मूल भामती, कल्पतरु आ परिमलक परस्पर संवादसँ बुझल जा सकैत अछि।

१७. अमलानन्द सरस्वती। वेदान्तकल्पतरु। सम्पा. रामशास्त्री तैलङ्ग। विजयनगर संस्कृत सीरीज, सं. १३।
बनारस: ई. जे. लाजरस एण्ड कम्पनी, १८९५-१८९७। दुइ खण्ड।
उपयोगिता: भामतीपर सर्वाधिक प्रभावशाली उपटीका; भामती-प्रस्थानक मध्यकालीन व्यवस्थित विकासक मुख्य स्रोत।
१८. अप्पय दीक्षित। वेदान्तकल्पतरुपरिमल। सम्पा. रामशास्त्री तैलङ्ग। मूल मुद्रण उन्नैसम शताब्दीक अन्तः; पुनर्मुद्रण: दिल्ली, भारतीय विद्या प्रकाशन, १९९२। तीन भाग।
उपयोगिता: कल्पतरुक सूक्ष्म विवेचन, पाठभेद आ शाङ्करभाष्यसँ सामञ्जस्य-विवादक अध्ययन लेल अनिवार्य।
१९. वल्लालसूरी। भामतीतिलक (चतुःसूत्री)। सम्पा. वी. एस. वी. गुरुस्वामी शास्त्रिगल आ वी. आर. कल्याणसुन्दर शास्त्रिगल। मद्रास: आदि शङ्कर अद्वैत रिसर्च सेंटर, १९८४। XXV + २२४ पृष्ठ।
उपयोगिता: चतुःसूत्री अंशपर विशेष टीका; समीक्ष्य मैथिली पोथीक सीमासँ सीधा मेल खाइत अछि।

६. विवरण-प्रस्थान आ तुलनात्मक मूलग्रन्थ

भामती-प्रस्थानक विशिष्टता विवरण-प्रस्थानक संग तुलना कएने अधिक स्पष्ट होइत अछि—विशेषतः अविद्याक आश्रय, जीव-ब्रह्म सम्बन्ध आ शब्दापरोक्षवादक प्रश्नपर।

२०. पद्मपादाचार्य आ प्रकाशात्मयति। पञ्चपादिका तथा पञ्चपादिकाविवरण। सम्पा. पोलकम श्रीराम शास्त्री आ एस. आर. कृष्णमूर्ति शास्त्री। मद्रास: गवर्नमेन्ट ओरिएण्टल मैनुस्क्रिप्ट्स लाइब्रेरी, १९५८।
उपयोगिता: विवरण-प्रस्थानक मूल पाठ; भामतीक जीवाश्रित अविद्या, अवच्छेदवाद आ वृत्तिज्ञान-सिद्धान्तक तुलनात्मक अध्ययन लेल आवश्यक।
२१. प्रकाशात्मयति। कॉन्शसनेस, नॉलेज एण्ड इन्फोरेन्स: पञ्चपादिकाविवरणक प्रथम चारि वर्णक अनुवाद आ विवेचन। अनु. आ व्याख्या: बीना गुप्ता। न्यूयॉर्क: अमेरिकन इन्स्टिट्यूट ऑफ बुद्धिस्ट स्टडीज, कोलम्बिया यूनिवर्सिटी, २०११। ISBN 9781935011033।
उपयोगिता: विवरण-प्रस्थानक चेतना, ज्ञान आ अविद्या-विमर्शक आधुनिक दार्शनिक प्रस्तुति; भामतीसँ तुलनाक हेतु उपयोगी।

७. वाचस्पति मिश्रक अन्य प्रमुख रचना

वाचस्पतिक “सर्वतन्त्रस्वतन्त्र” व्यक्तित्व बुझबाक लेल हुनक न्याय, सांख्य, योग आ मीमांसा-सम्बन्धी रचना पढ़ब आवश्यक अछि।

२२. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। न्यायवार्तिकतात्पर्यटीका। सम्पा. गङ्गाधर शास्त्री तैलङ्ग। बनारस: ई. जे. लाजरस, १८९३।
उपयोगिता: न्याय-दर्शनमे वाचस्पतिक तर्क-शैली, ख्यातिवाद आ प्रमाण-विचारक पृष्ठभूमि स्पष्ट करैत अछि।
२३. गौतम। न्यायदर्शन: वात्स्यायनभाष्य, उद्योतकरवार्तिक, वाचस्पति मिश्रक तात्पर्यटीका आ विश्वनाथवृत्तिसहित। द्वितीय संस्करण। नई दिल्ली: मुंशीराम मनोहरलाल, १९८५।
उपयोगिता: न्यायपरम्पराक बहुस्तरीय पाठ; भामतीमे नैयायिक पूर्वपक्ष आ अन्यथाख्यातिक आलोचना बुझबाक सहायक।

२४. मिश्र, वाचस्पति। सांख्यतत्त्वकौमुदी। संस्कृत पाठ आ अङ्ग्रेजी अनु. गङ्गानाथ झा। बम्बई: थियोसोफिकल पब्लिकेशन फण्ड, १८९६।
उपयोगिता: वाचस्पतिक सांख्य-दृष्टि आ तत्त्व-विभाजनक शैली; भामतीमे प्रकृति, कारणता आ ज्ञान-प्रक्रियाक तुलनात्मक अध्ययन लेल उपयोगी।
२५. ईश्वरकृष्ण आ वाचस्पति मिश्र। सांख्यकारिका, तत्त्वकौमुदीसहित। अनु. स्वामी विरूपाक्षानन्द। मद्रास: श्री रामकृष्ण मठ, १९९५।
उपयोगिता: सांख्यक मूल पदावलीसहित आधुनिक अङ्ग्रेजी प्रस्तुति; वेदान्त-सांख्य तुलनाक प्रवेशग्रन्थ।
२६. पतञ्जलि, व्यास आ वाचस्पति मिश्र। क्लासिकल योग फिलॉसफी एण्ड द लेगेसी ऑफ सांख्य: योगसूत्र, व्यासभाष्य आ तत्त्ववैशारदीक संस्कृत पाठ-अङ्ग्रेजी अनुवाद। जेराल्ड जेम्स लार्सन। दिल्ली: मोतीलाल बनारसीदास, २०१८। ISBN 9788120842014।
उपयोगिता: वाचस्पतिक योग-व्याख्या, चित्तवृत्ति, संस्कार आ ज्ञान-प्रक्रियाक आधुनिक समग्र संस्करण।
२७. पतञ्जलि। साङ्ग योगदर्शन: व्यासभाष्य तथा तत्त्ववैशारदी, पातञ्जलरहस्य, योगवार्तिक आ भास्वतीसहित। बनारस: विद्या विलास प्रेस, १९३५।
उपयोगिता: तत्त्ववैशारदी केँ अन्य योग-टीकासँ तुलना करबाक ऐतिहासिक संयुक्त संस्करण।

८. वाचस्पति मिश्र आ भामतीपर आधुनिक अध्ययन

- एहि खण्डक ग्रन्थसभ जीवनी, कृतित्व, भामती-विवरण मतभेद, वाचस्पतिक दर्शन-समन्वय आ मिथिलाक बौद्धिक इतिहासपर केन्द्रित अछि।
२८. हसुरकर, एस. एस. वाचस्पति मिश्र ऑन अद्वैत वेदान्त। दरभङ्गा: मिथिला इन्स्टिट्यूट ऑफ पोस्ट-ग्रेजुएट स्टडीज एण्ड रिसर्च इन संस्कृत लर्निङ्ग, १९५८। मिथिलाविद्यापीठग्रन्थमाला, सं. ३; स्टडीज इन इङ्गलिश, सं. २। XXX + २६७ पृष्ठ।
उपयोगिता: वाचस्पतिक अद्वैत-विचारपर आरम्भिक विस्तृत अङ्ग्रेजी मोनोग्राफ; भामतीक मुख्य सिद्धान्तक व्यवस्थित अध्ययन।
२९. झा, सहदेव। वाचस्पति मिश्र। पटना: मैथिली अकादमी, १९८४। मैथिली अकादमी प्रकाशन, सं. ३३२। १५४ पृष्ठ।
उपयोगिता: मैथिली पाठक लेल वाचस्पतिक जीवन, कृतित्व आ मिथिला-सन्दर्भक महत्त्वपूर्ण परिचय।
३०. दुबे, राजेन्द्र प्रसाद। वाचस्पति मिश्र। नई दिल्ली: साहित्य अकादेमी, १९९८। १९९ पृष्ठ। ISBN 8126003111।
उपयोगिता: संक्षिप्त किन्तु प्रमाणिक जीवन-कृतित्व अध्ययन; सामान्य पाठक आ शोधक दुनू लेल उपयोगी।
३१. रङ्गनाथ, एस. कॉन्ट्रिब्यूशन ऑफ वाचस्पति मिश्र टू इण्डियन फिलॉसफी। दिल्ली: प्रतिभा प्रकाशन, १९९९। ४०७ पृष्ठ। ISBN 8177020021।
उपयोगिता: वाचस्पतिक बहुदर्शनात्मक योगदानक समग्र परीक्षण; भामती केँ न्याय, सांख्य, योग आ मीमांसासँ जोड़ि देखैत अछि।
३२. लायक, सत्यजित। कॉन्ट्रिब्यूशन ऑफ वाचस्पति मिश्र-१ टू इण्डियन फिलॉसफी। संशोधित संस्करण। कोलकाता: संस्कृत बुक डिपो, २००४।
उपयोगिता: वाचस्पतिक कृतिसभक विषयगत अध्ययन आ दर्शन-समन्वयक आधुनिक विवेचन।

३३. रूदुरमुन, पी. एस. भामती एण्ड विवरण स्कूल्स ऑफ अद्वैत वेदान्तः ए क्रिटिकल अप्रोच। दिल्ली: मोतीलाल बनारसीदास, २००२। ३१४ पृष्ठ। ISBN 9788120818903।
उपयोगिता: दुनू अद्वैत-प्रस्थानक व्यवस्थित तुलनात्मक अध्ययन; अविद्या, जीव, ज्ञान आ मोक्षक मतभेदक हेतु विशेष उपयोगी।
३४. वसन्ता, एम. अद्वैतवेदान्ते भामतीप्रस्थानस्य तुलनात्मकम् अध्ययनम्। दिल्ली: नाग पब्लिशर्स, २०१३। xxvi + ४९३ पृष्ठ। ISBN 8170816882।
उपयोगिता: संस्कृतमे भामती-प्रस्थानक विस्तृत तुलनात्मक शोध; मूल पदावलीसहित गम्भीर अकादमिक उपयोग।
३५. रूज़ा, फेरेंक। “वाचस्पति मिश्र।” एन्साइक्लोपीडिया ऑफ फिलॉसफी ऑफ रिलिजन, २०२१। DOI: 10.1002/9781119009924.eopr0400।
उपयोगिता: आधुनिक विश्वकोशीय परिचय; वाचस्पतिक काल, रचना आ दार्शनिक स्थानक संक्षिप्त सत्यापित सार।

९. अद्वैत वेदान्तक इतिहास, पद्धति आ प्रमाणमीमांसा

- भामतीक तात्त्विक स्थान बुझबाक लेल अद्वैतक ऐतिहासिक विकास, शाङ्कर पद्धति, श्रुति-प्रामाण्य, चेतना, अविद्या आ जीवन्मुक्तिपर निम्न अध्ययन उपयोगी अछि।
३६. पॉटर, कार्ल एच. (सम्पा.)। द एन्साइक्लोपीडिया ऑफ इण्डियन फिलॉसफीज, खण्ड ३: अद्वैत वेदान्त अप टू शंकर एण्ड हिज प्यूपिल्स। प्रिन्सटन/दिल्ली: प्रिन्सटन यूनिवर्सिटी प्रेस, अमेरिकन इन्स्टिट्यूट ऑफ इण्डियन स्टडीज आ मोतीलाल बनारसीदास, १९८१। x + ६३५ पृष्ठ।
उपयोगिता: शंकर आ आरम्भिक अद्वैतक ग्रन्थ-सार, व्यक्तित्व आ तर्क-पृष्ठभूमिक विश्वसनीय संदर्भ।
३७. पॉटर, कार्ल एच. (सम्पा.)। द एन्साइक्लोपीडिया ऑफ इण्डियन फिलॉसफीज, खण्ड ११: अद्वैत वेदान्त फ्रॉम ८०० टू १२००। दिल्ली: मोतीलाल बनारसीदास, २००६। xi + ८२५ पृष्ठ। ISBN 9788120830615।
उपयोगिता: वाचस्पति मिश्र आ आरम्भिक भामती-परम्पराक ग्रन्थ-सार आ बिबलियोग्राफिक मार्गदर्शन।
३८. नकामुरा, हाजिमे। ए हिस्ट्री ऑफ अर्ली वेदान्त फिलॉसफी, खण्ड २। दिल्ली: मोतीलाल बनारसीदास, १९८३; पुनर्मुद्रण २००४।
उपयोगिता: आरम्भिक वेदान्तक पाठ-इतिहास, सिद्धान्त-विकास आ सम्प्रदायगत प्रसङ्गक विस्तृत अध्ययन।
३९. कोमन्स, माइकल। द मेथड ऑफ अर्ली अद्वैत वेदान्त: गौडपाद, शंकर, सुरेश्वर एण्ड पद्मपाद। दिल्ली: मोतीलाल बनारसीदास, २०००। ४९२ पृष्ठ। ISBN 8120817222।
उपयोगिता: शाङ्कर अद्वैतक व्याख्या-पद्धति आ श्रुति-तर्क सम्बन्ध; भामतीक पद्धति बुझबाक पूर्वपीठिका।
४०. डॉइच, इलियट। अद्वैत वेदान्तः ए फिलॉसफिकल रिकन्स्ट्रक्शन। होनोलूलू: ईस्ट-वेस्ट सेंटर प्रेस/यूनिवर्सिटी ऑफ हवाई प्रेस, १९६९।
उपयोगिता: अद्वैतक तत्त्वमीमांसा, ज्ञानमीमांसा आ मोक्ष-सिद्धान्तक आधुनिक दार्शनिक पुनर्निर्माण।
४१. रामबचन, अनन्तानन्द। अकम्प्लिशिङ्ग द अकम्प्लिश्ड: द वेदाज ऐज ए सोर्स ऑफ वैलिड नॉलेज इन शंकर। होनोलूलू: यूनिवर्सिटी ऑफ हवाई प्रेस, १९९१। १७९ पृष्ठ।
उपयोगिता: श्रुति-प्रामाण्य, सिद्धवस्तु-वाक्य आ ब्रह्मज्ञानक स्वतन्त्र फलवत्तापर केन्द्रित; “तत्तु समन्वयात्” प्रकरणक हेतु अत्यन्त प्रासंगिक।

४२. गुप्ता, बीना। द डिसइन्टरेस्टेड विटनेस: ए फ्रैगमेण्ट ऑफ अद्वैत वेदान्त फेनोमेनोलॉजी। एवन्स्टन: नॉर्थवेस्टर्न यूनिवर्सिटी प्रेस, १९९८। २३६ पृष्ठ।
उपयोगिता: साक्षी-चेतना, आत्मानुभूति आ विषय-प्रकाशक आधुनिक दार्शनिक विश्लेषण।
४३. फोर्ट, एण्ड्रू ओ. जीवनमुक्ति इन ट्रांसफॉर्मेशन: एम्बॉडीड लिबरेशन इन अद्वैत एण्ड नियो-वेदान्त। अल्बानी: स्टेट यूनिवर्सिटी ऑफ न्यूयॉर्क प्रेस, १९९८। २५१ पृष्ठ।
उपयोगिता: जीवन्मुक्ति, प्रारब्ध आ देहावशेषक परम्परागत-अर्वाचीन रूपान्तरण; भामतीक जीवन्मुक्ति-विवेचनक तुलनाक हेतु उपयोगी।
४४. दासगुप्त, सुरेन्द्रनाथ। ए हिस्ट्री ऑफ इण्डियन फिलॉसफी, खण्ड १-२। कैम्ब्रिज: कैम्ब्रिज यूनिवर्सिटी प्रेस, १९२२ आ १९३२।
उपयोगिता: भारतीय दर्शनक व्यापक इतिहास; अद्वैत, मीमांसा, न्याय आ सांख्यक अन्तरसम्बन्ध बुझबाक क्लासिक संदर्भ।
४५. डॉच, इलियट आ जे. ए. बी. वान बुइटेनेन (सम्पा.)। ए सोर्स बुक ऑफ अद्वैत वेदान्त। होनोलूलू: यूनिवर्सिटी प्रेस ऑफ हवाई, १९७१।
उपयोगिता: अद्वैतक चयनित मूलपाठक अङ्ग्रेजी अनुवाद; सिद्धान्त-विकासक तुलनात्मक अध्ययन लेल उपयोगी।
४६. इसायवा, नतालिया। शंकर एण्ड इण्डियन फिलॉसफी। अल्बानी: स्टेट यूनिवर्सिटी ऑफ न्यूयॉर्क प्रेस, १९९३।
उपयोगिता: शंकरक दार्शनिक सन्दर्भ, प्रतिपक्ष आ उत्तरवर्ती परम्पराक आधुनिक अध्ययन।
४७. किङ्ग, रिचर्ड। अर्ली अद्वैत वेदान्त एण्ड बुद्धिज्म: द महायान कॉन्टेक्स्ट ऑफ द गौडपादीयकारिका। अल्बानी: स्टेट यूनिवर्सिटी ऑफ न्यूयॉर्क प्रेस, १९९५।
उपयोगिता: अद्वैत-बौद्ध सम्बन्ध आ ख्यातिवाद-विमर्शक ऐतिहासिक पृष्ठभूमि।
४८. हैकर, पॉल। फिलोलॉजी एण्ड कॉन्फ्रन्टेशन: पॉल हैकर ऑन ट्रेडिशनल एण्ड मॉडर्न वेदान्त। सम्पा. विल्हेल्म हाल्फबास। अल्बानी: स्टेट यूनिवर्सिटी ऑफ न्यूयॉर्क प्रेस, १९९५।
उपयोगिता: शाङ्कर परम्पराक पाठ-समालोचना आ आधुनिक व्याख्याक सावधानी बुझबाक हेतु उपयोगी।

१०. सहायक मूलग्रन्थ, उपनिषद् आ प्रस्थानत्रयी

- भामतीक तर्क उपनिषद्-वाक्य, भगवद्गीता, ब्रह्मसूत्र आ मीमांसा-न्यायक सिद्धान्तपर निरन्तर निर्भर अछि।
४९. राधाकृष्णन, सर्वपल्ली (सम्पा. आ अनु.)। द प्रिन्सिपल उपनिषद्स। लन्दन: जॉर्ज एलन एण्ड अनविन, १९५३।
उपयोगिता: मुख्य उपनिषदक संस्कृत पाठ आ अङ्ग्रेजी अनुवाद; भामतीमे उद्धृत श्रुति-वाक्यक व्यापक संदर्भ।
५०. ओलिवेल, पैट्रिक (सम्पा. आ अनु.)। द अर्ली उपनिषद्स: एनोटेटेड टेक्स्ट एण्ड ट्रांसलेशन। ऑक्सफोर्ड: ऑक्सफोर्ड यूनिवर्सिटी प्रेस, १९९८।
उपयोगिता: पाठ-समालोचनात्मक आधुनिक अनुवाद; उपनिषद्-वाक्यक भाषिक आ ऐतिहासिक संदर्भ लेल उपयोगी।
५१. शंकराचार्य। एट उपनिषद्स, शाङ्करभाष्यसहित। अङ्ग्रेजी अनु. स्वामी गम्भीरानन्द। कलकत्ता: अद्वैत आश्रम, दुइ खण्ड।
उपयोगिता: शाङ्कर व्याख्यासहित मुख्य उपनिषदक अध्ययन; ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यक श्रुति-स्रोत मिलान लेल सहायक।

५२. भगवद्गीता, शाङ्करभाष्यसहित। विविध संस्कृत आ अनुवाद-संस्करण।

उपयोगिता: भामतीमे कर्म, ज्ञान, संन्यास, बुद्धिशुद्धि आ मोक्षक प्रसङ्ग बुझबाक प्रस्थानत्रयी-सहायक।

११. डिजिटल संग्रह आ ऑनलाइन सन्दर्भ

ऑनलाइन सामग्रीक उपयोग पृष्ठ-सत्यापन, दुर्लभ संस्करणक खोज आ प्रकाशकीय विवरण मिलान लेल कएल जाए; अन्तिम उद्धरणमे मूल स्कैनक शीर्षक-पृष्ठ देखब आवश्यक अछि। प्रवेश तिथि: ६ अगस्त २०२६।

५३. इंटरनेट आर्काइव। संस्कृत वाङ्मय का बृहद् इतिहास, खण्ड १०: वेदान्त।

उपयोगिता: वेदान्तक ग्रन्थ, आचार्य, प्रस्थान आ टीका-परम्पराक हिन्दी संदर्भ।

<https://archive.org/stream/10.-sanskrit-vang.-brihat-itihas-10-vedant/>

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५४. इंटरनेट आर्काइव/डिजिटल लाइब्रेरी ऑफ इंडिया। ब्रह्मसूत्र-शाङ्करभाष्यम् (स्कैन)।

उपयोगिता: शाङ्करभाष्यक मुद्रित पाठक पृष्ठ-सत्यापन।

<https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.407431>

५५. इंटरनेट आर्काइव। संस्कृत वाङ्मय का बृहद् इतिहास, वेदान्त खण्ड — बलदेव उपाध्याय-सम्बद्ध संस्करण।

उपयोगिता: वाचस्पति मिश्र, भामती आ उत्तरवर्ती अद्वैत-टीकासभक ऐतिहासिक परिचय।

https://archive.org/stream/wtdo_sanskrit-vangmaya-ka-brihad-itihas-of-acharya-baldeva-upadhyay-vol.-10-uttar-pra/Sanskrit%20Vangmaya%20Ka%20Brihad%20Itihas%20of%20Acharya%20Baldeva%20Upadhyay%20Vol.%2010%20-%20Uttar%20Pradesh%20Sanskrit%20Sansthan%20Lucknow_djvu.txt

५६. वर्ल्डकैट। भामतीक १८७६-१८८०, १८९१, १९३५, १९९९ आ अन्य संस्करणक पुस्तकालयीय अभिलेख।

उपयोगिता: प्रकाशन-वर्ष, सम्पादक, पृष्ठ-संख्या आ विश्व-पुस्तकालय उपलब्धताक मिलान।

<https://search.worldcat.org/>

५७. अड्यार लाइब्रेरी एण्ड रिसर्च सेंटर। भामती (चतुःसूत्री), सूर्यनारायण शास्त्री-कुन्हन राजा संस्करणक सूची-अभिलेख।

उपयोगिता: चतुःसूत्री अङ्ग्रेजी अनुवादक मानक संस्करणक सत्यापन।

<https://www.adyarlibrary.org/>

५८. विदेह पोथी। विदेह — प्रथम मैथिली पाक्षिक ई-पत्रिका।

उपयोगिता: गजेन्द्र ठाकुरक मैथिली दर्शन-अनुवाद आ विदेह ग्रन्थ-शृङ्खलाक प्रकाशकीय सन्दर्भ।

<https://www.videha.co.in/pothi.htm>

५९. मोतीलाल बनारसीदास। भामती एण्ड विवरण स्कूल ऑफ अद्वैत वेदान्त तथा अन्य अद्वैत-सन्दर्भग्रन्थक प्रकाशकीय सूची।

उपयोगिता: आधुनिक पुनर्मुद्रण, ISBN आ प्रकाशन-विवरणक मिलान।

<https://www.mlbd.in/>

६०. जैन ई-लाइब्रेरी/जैन क्वाण्टम। सर्वदर्शनसंग्रह आ भारतीय दर्शनक डिजिटल संस्कृत-हिन्दी सामग्री। उपयोगिता: प्रतिपक्ष-दर्शन आ सर्वदर्शनात्मक संदर्भक सहायक डिजिटल स्रोत; पाठक संस्करण अवश्य जाँचल जाए।
<https://jainqg.org/>

१२. दुर्लभ वा प्रकाशन-विवरण अनिश्चित ग्रन्थ

- निम्न शीर्षक भामती-टीका-परम्पराक इतिहासमे उल्लिखित अछि, मुदा उपलब्ध सूचीसभमे लेखक-नाम, पाण्डुलिपि-स्थान, मुद्रण-वर्ष वा संस्करण-विवरण सर्वत्र एकरूप नहि अछि। अतः शोधार्थी राष्ट्रीय पाण्डुलिपि मिशन, न्यू कैटलोगस कैटलोगोरम, संस्कृत विश्वविद्यालयीय पाण्डुलिपि-सूची आ सम्बन्धित मठ-पुस्तकालयसँ पृथक् सत्यापन करथि।
६१. लक्ष्मीनृसिंह। आभोग — वेदान्तकल्पतरुपरिमलक आलोचनात्मक उपटीका। /प्रकाशन-विवरणक पूर्ण सत्यापन अपेक्षित/
उपयोगिता: परिमल आ भामती-कल्पतरु मतभेदक आन्तरिक इतिहास लेल महत्त्वपूर्ण।
६२. अखण्डानुभूति यति। ऋजुप्रकाशिका — भामतीपर टीका। /प्रकाशन-विवरणक पूर्ण सत्यापन अपेक्षित/
उपयोगिता: भामतीक कठिन तर्कस्थलक परम्परागत स्पष्टीकरणक सम्भावित स्रोत।
६३. अच्युतकृष्णतीर्थ। भामती-भावदीपिका। /प्रकाशन-विवरणक पूर्ण सत्यापन अपेक्षित/
उपयोगिता: भामती-पाठक उत्तरवर्ती व्याख्या; मुद्रित वा पाण्डुलिपि उपलब्धताक स्थानीय सत्यापन आवश्यक।
६४. सुब्रह्मण्य शास्त्री। भामती-विवरण। /प्रकाशन-विवरणक पूर्ण सत्यापन अपेक्षित/
उपयोगिता: भामतीक आधुनिक/उत्तरवर्ती संस्कृत व्याख्यात्मक साहित्यक अंश; लेखक-परिचय आ संस्करण भिन्न सूचीमे भिन्न रूपेँ भेटैत अछि।
६५. वेदान्तकल्पतरुमञ्जरी। /प्रकाशन-विवरणक पूर्ण सत्यापन अपेक्षित/
उपयोगिता: कल्पतरु-परम्पराक संक्षिप्त वा व्याख्यात्मक ग्रन्थ रूपमे उल्लेख; कर्तृत्व आ पाठ-साक्ष्य सत्यापित कएल जाए।
६६. भामती-व्याख्या, श्रीरङ्गनाथ-सम्बद्ध। /प्रकाशन-विवरणक पूर्ण सत्यापन अपेक्षित/
उपयोगिता: दक्षिण भारतीय पाण्डुलिपि-परम्परामे सम्भावित व्याख्या; ग्रन्थसूची आ पाण्डुलिपि-संख्या बिना उद्धृत नहि कएल जाए।
६७. भामती-विलास। /प्रकाशन-विवरणक पूर्ण सत्यापन अपेक्षित/
उपयोगिता: शीर्षक विभिन्न सूचीमे भेटैत अछि; लेखक, पूर्णता आ प्रकाशन-विवरणक पुष्टि आवश्यक।

शोधार्थी लेल उपयोग-विधि

एकहि विषयपर सभ ग्रन्थ समान स्तरक प्रमाण नहि अछि। शोधक निम्न क्रम अपनौलासँ पाठ-सन्दर्भ अधिक विश्वसनीय बनत।

१. मूल पाठ पहिने: सूत्र → शाङ्करभाष्य → भामती → कल्पतरु → परिमल, एहि क्रममे पाठ पढ़ू; बादमे आधुनिक व्याख्या देखू।
२. संस्करण स्पष्ट करू: उद्धरणमे केवल “भामती” नहि लिखि सम्पादक, प्रकाशक, वर्ष आ पृष्ठ देब आवश्यक अछि।

३. पाठभेद जाँचू: पुरान बिब्लियोथेका इंडिका, काशी संस्करण आ संयुक्त टीका-संस्करणमे पाठ वा पृष्ठक्रमक भिन्नता रहि सकैत अछि।
४. अनुवादक तुलना: मैथिली अनुवादक कठिन अंश केँ सूर्यनारायण शास्त्री-कुन्हन राजा, गम्भीरानन्द, थिबो आ आप्टेक अनुवादसँ मिलाउ, मुदा मूल संस्कृत केँ निर्णायक राखू।
५. डिजिटल स्रोत सावधानी: ओसीआर-पाठ केँ प्रत्यक्ष उद्धरणक आधार नहि बनाउ; स्कैनक पृष्ठ देखिकेँ मात्र पाठ निश्चित करू।
६. दुर्लभ टीकाक सत्यापन: आभोग, ऋजुप्रकाशिका आदि लेल पाण्डुलिपि-सूची, संस्थागत कैटलॉग आ प्रत्यक्ष पाण्डुलिपि-संख्या दर्ज करू।

— समाप्त —



भामती

वाचस्पति मिश्र - संस्कृतसँ मैथिली अनुवाद: गजेन्द्र ठाकुर

भामती वाचस्पति मिश्रक ओ अमर टीका थिक जे
शंकराचार्यक ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यपर लिखल गेल
अछि। एहिमे प्रसिद्ध अध्यास-भाष्यक
सूक्ष्म व्याख्या अछि, जतय 'हम' (विषयी,
चैतन्य आत्मा) आ 'अहाँ' (विषय, जड़ जगत)क
बीच अन्तर आ इजोत जकों भिन्नताक बावजूदो
होइत मिथ्या अध्यासक सिद्धान्त प्रतिपादित
अछि।

भामती अद्वैत वेदान्तक स्वतंत्र
'भामती-सम्प्रदाय'क आधार-ग्रन्थ थिक, जे
विवरण-सम्प्रदायसँ भिन्न मार्ग देखबैत
अछि। सहस्र वर्षक ई गहन टीका आब पहिल बेर
मैथिलीमे।



मुख्य विमर्श

- * अध्यास-भाष्य — मिथ्या अध्यासक सिद्धान्त
- * जिज्ञासा-सूत्र — आत्मा जानबाक इच्छाक विषय किएक अछि
- * प्रत्यभिज्ञा — देह-भिन्न आत्माक सिद्धि
- * भामती-सम्प्रदाय — विवरणसँ भिन्न स्वतंत्र दृष्टि

अनुवादक गजेन्द्र ठाकुर व्यायकुसुमाञ्जलि,
तत्त्वचिन्तामणि आ आत्मतत्त्वविवेकक मैथिली
अनुवादक सेहो कर्ता छथि; ई सभ ग्रन्थ मिलि
मैथिलीमे एकटा सुसङ्गत दार्शनिक कोश ठाढ़ करैत
अछि।



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Bhāmatī

Vācaspati Miśra's commentary on Śaṅkara's Brahmasūtrabhāṣya

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Gajendra Thakur



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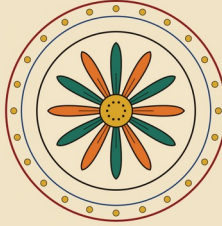
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Translation: Gajendra Thakur

Gajendra Thakur

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Bhamati

(Chatussutri)

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Preface, Philosophical Study, and Source References

Vachaspati Mishra's Bhamati (Chatussutri) and Gajendra
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Preface

Within the long tradition of Indian philosophy, Advaita Vedanta occupies a pre-eminent place. The magnificent edifice of Advaita Vedanta that Acharya Shankara built upon the Prasthanatrayi—the Upanishads, the Bhagavad Gita, and the Brahmasutras—rests upon the Shariraka Bhashya as its foundation-stone. Many commentaries were composed on this Shariraka Bhashya, but the commentary "Bhamati," written in the ninth century by the great philosopher of Mithila, Vachaspati Mishra, came to be established as an independent school of Advaita Vedanta (the Bhamati school) because of its distinctive originality, philosophical depth, and subtle method of reasoning. For more than a thousand years this great work remained confined within the sphere of Sanskrit literature. The faithful translation of Vachaspati Mishra's "Bhamati (Chatussutri)" from the original Sanskrit into pure Maithili by Gajendra Thakur, editor of the Videha e-journal and a distinguished writer, is therefore a historic achievement.

This translation is not merely a transfer from one language to another; it is a successful intellectual undertaking that presents some of the most difficult problems of Advaita philosophy—such as adhyasa, khyativada, the immutable eternity of liberation, and the independent validity of Vedantic statements—with the natural ease of Maithili speech. Published first in 2004 and in an enlarged edition in 2026, this work (ISSN 2229-547X) establishes a standard for philosophical prose in Maithili. The book appears within Videha's book series, where the original Sanskrit work is treated with respect as a classical heritage of the Indian philosophical tradition and as part of the public intellectual inheritance.

Vachaspati Mishra: The 'Sarvatantrasvatantra' Personality and Historical Context

Vachaspati Mishra was a figure of extraordinary genius in the history of Indian philosophy. He flourished in the ninth century. At the end of his Nyaya work "Nyayasutranibandha," Vachaspati Mishra gives its date of composition as Vikrama Samvat 898, that is, 84 CE ("Nyayasutranibandho'savakari sudhiyam mude. Shri-

Vachaspati-Mishrena vasv-anka-vasu-vatsare"), which makes the historical dating of his life clear¹. With the exception of Vaisheshika, authoritative commentaries by him are available on nearly all the orthodox systems of Indian philosophy, and for this reason he was honored with the epithet 'Sarvatantrasvatantra'.

In Nyaya he wrote the 'Nyayavarttikatatparyatika' (because of which he became known in the Nyaya tradition as 'Tatparyacharya'); in Sankhya, the 'Sankhyatattvakaumudi' on Ishvarakrishna's Sankhyakarika; in Yoga, the 'Tattvavaisharadi' on the Vyasa Bhashya; in Purva Mimamsa, the 'Nyayakanika' and 'Tattvabindu' in connection with Mandana Mishra's Vidhiviveka; and on Mandana Mishra's 'Brahmasiddhi,' the 'Brahmatattvasamiksha' (now unavailable). After composing such major works, his final and greatest work, the 'Bhamati,' appeared. Written at the summit of his philosophical maturity, the Bhamati is not merely an explanation of the Shariraka Bhashya; it is an independent and systematic formulation of the doctrines of Advaita Vedanta. Many ideas from Mandana Mishra's 'Brahmasiddhi' are echoed in the Bhamati, for which reason Vachaspati Mishra has also been described as 'Vachaspati, follower in the footsteps of Mandana'. The subtle influence of Mandana Mishra's discipline of meditation and his discussion of niyoga can be seen in Vachaspati's philosophical outlook, although he nowhere departs from the fundamental Advaitic spirit of the Shariraka Bhashya.

The Schools within Advaita Vedanta: Bhamati and Vivarana

In the history of Advaita Vedanta, two principal streams of interpretation of the Shariraka Bhashya emerged—the 'Bhamati school' of Vachaspati Mishra and the 'Vivarana school,' which arose from Prakashtamayati's 'Panchapadika-Vivarana,' a commentary on Padmapadacharya's 'Panchapadika'. The doctrinal differences between these two schools are indispensable for understanding the subtleties of Advaita philosophy, and Gajendra Thakur's translation preserves them with complete fidelity.

Doctrinal and Epistemological Point	Bhamati School (Vachaspati Mishra)	Vivarana School (Padmapada / Prakashatmayati)
Locus of Avidya	The locus of avidya is the 'jiva' (avidya residing in the jiva). Brahman is the object of avidya, not its locus.	The locus of avidya is 'Brahman' (avidya residing in Brahman). Ignorance is situated in Brahman.
Nature of the Jiva and Ishvara	Avacchedavada: the jiva is Brahman limited (delimited) by avidya, like pot-space and great space.	Pratibimbavada: the jiva is the reflection of Brahman in avidya, like the reflection of the sun in water.
Unity or Plurality of Avidya	Avidya is many (many jivas, many avidyas). Each jiva has its own avidya.	Mula-avidya is one. The entire phenomenal universe is the effect of a single avidya.
Means to the Realization of Brahman	The Brahman-shaped modification of the inner organ (mind), arising from reflection, is the principal means to immediate knowledge.	The mahavakya (verbal testimony) directly produces immediate knowledge (shabda-aparokshavada).
Order of Creation and Combination of the Elements	Trivritkarana (combination of three elements—fire, water, and food/earth) is accepted.	Panchikarana (combination of five elements—space, air, fire, water, and earth) is accepted.

In the Bhamati, the jiva is regarded as agent, enjoyer, and locus of avidya. This doctrine that avidya has the jiva as its locus is a fundamental characteristic of the Bhamati. According to Vachaspati Mishra, avidya is in fact indefinable and may be divided into two aspects—concealment and projection (mula-avidya and tula-avidya/impression). This entire background naturally reverberates through Gajendra Thakur's translation, where the translator remains faithful to the text and clarifies the purport of the Bhamati without adding external commentary.

The Tradition of Commentaries on Bhamati and Its Sub-Schools

Vachaspati Mishra's Bhamati is so mature and profound that numerous commentaries were themselves composed on the Bhamati in order to understand it. In the thirteenth century, Amalananda Sarasvati (whose teacher was Anubhavananda) wrote the famous commentary 'Vedantakalpataru' on the Bhamati, through which the Bhamati school gained extraordinary prestige in the field of Advaita Vedanta. In the sixteenth century, Appayya Dikshita wrote 'Kalpataruparimala' on Amalananda's Kalpataru, and Lakshminrisimha wrote the commentary 'Abhoga'. In addition, many other commentaries on the Bhamati are available, such as Vallalasuri's 'Bhamatitilaka,' Akhandanubhuti Yati's 'Rijuprakashika,' Achyutakrishnatirtha's 'Bhamati-Bhavadiipika,' and Subrahmanya Shastri's 'Bhamati-Vivarana'.

At places, subtle differences of doctrine between the Bhamati and the Kalpataru are visible in these commentaries. Wherever Appayya Dikshita, in his 'Parimala,' found Vachaspati and Amalananda to differ from the Shariraka Bhashya, he refuted them and supported the Shariraka Bhashya. Lakshminrisimha, author of the 'Abhoga,' however, sharply criticized this procedure of the Parimala and defended the authors of the Bhamati and the Kalpataru. Thus, two sub-schools also developed within the Bhamati tradition. This entire body of commentarial literature demonstrates the intellectual authority of Vachaspati Mishra's original work.

Structure and Philosophical Depth of Gajendra Thakur's Maithili Translation

Gajendra Thakur's work under review, "Bhamati (Chatussutri)," extends from page 1 to page 491 in the cumulative edition and ends with the colophon, "Here ends the Chatussutri-Bhamati". It contains the invocation of the work, the Adhyasa-Bhashya (introduction), and a complete, faithful translation of the entire commentary on the first four sutras of the Brahmasutra—Athato Brahmajijnasa (1.1.1), Janmadyasya Yatah (1.1.2), Shastrayonitvat (1.1.), and Tattu Samanvat (1.1.4)3.

The structure of the translation is as follows: 1. Cover and publication pages. 2. A Maithili rendering of the original text of Shankara's Adhyasa-Bhashya. . Translation of Vachaspati Mishra's seven invocatory verses. 4. A complete prose translation of the Bhamati commentary on the "Adhyasa" section. 5. A Maithili rendering of the detailed debate and exposition from the first sutra through the fourth. Nearly one-third of the work is devoted solely to the explanation of the sutra 'Tattu Samanvayat' (the Samanvayadhikarana), which contains some of the subtlest discussions of Advaita epistemology and the nature of liberation and is evidence of the translator's patience and fidelity to the original work³.

Linguistic Beauty of the Invocation

The gateway to the Bhamati is formed by its seven invocatory verses. In translating a philosophical work, Gajendra Thakur gives priority to preserving meaning rather than preserving metre, and therefore renders these verses in prose. In the first verse, Brahman is saluted as "of immeasurable bliss and the nature of knowledge" and as the maker of the false manifestation of the five elements, "having made the two forms of indefinable avidya his ministers." The use of the word 'minister' brings the political metaphor of the original Sanskrit vividly into Maithili and points toward the twofold avidya of Advaita (concealment and residual impression).

The translation of the second verse displays extraordinary beauty in its worldly and native idiom: "The Vedas are his breath, the five great elements are his sight, the moving and unmoving world is his smile, and his sleep is the great dissolution." Here the use of the Maithili word 'muski' (smile) gives the cosmic play an intimate, domestic quality. The humble declaration of the seventh verse—"Just as water from a royal road becomes pure when it falls into the current of the Ganga, so the insignificant words of people like me become sanctified when joined to the Acharya's composition"—embodies the classical decorum with which the commentator positions himself.

Subtle Analysis of the Adhyasa-Bhashya

Vachaspati Mishra's commentary on Shankaracharya's Adhyasa-Bhashya begins with an elaborate purvapaksha. The argument of the opponent is that the Atman cannot be an object of inquiry, because inquiry into that about which there is no doubt and knowledge of which serves no purpose is meaningless.

Construction of the Purvapaksha and Its Logical Refutation

The opponent argues that the experience of "I" (aham) is undisputed in all beings, from worms and insects to gods and sages. To establish both the absence of doubt in this experience and the uselessness of inquiring into it, the opponent gives witty examples—"a pot present in bright light and in contact with the visual organ attended by the mind; or the teeth of a crow". Gajendra Thakur's translation preserves the sharpness of these everyday examples in Maithili.

Through recognition extending from childhood to old age ("I, who in childhood took delight with my parents, now in old age take delight with my grandchildren"), the opponent argues for the self-evident existence of an Atman distinct from the body. The opponent's strongest declaration is: "Even a thousand scriptures together cannot turn a pot into cloth". That is, Shruti that contradicts direct experience should be taken in a secondary sense. This famous Nyaya maxim has been translated in a distinctly Maithili cadence, preserving the aggressiveness of the philosophical debate.

On the siddhanta side, Vachaspati Mishra establishes Shruti's presentation of the unconditioned Atman on the basis of indicators of purport such as beginning, conclusion, and repetition. Knowledge born of Shruti does not destroy the practical validity of perception; it negates only its ultimate validity. Through analysis of figurative usage such as "Dirgha is crying," and through examples involving the 'Agnihotra' of the Kundapayinam Ayana, the lion and the pupil, and oil and mustard oil, it is established that secondary usage occurs after cognition of difference; but because in the use of

"I" there is no cognition of difference from the body, that use is not secondary but false—that is, adhyasa.

Discussion of Khyativada and Establishment of Anirvacaniyakhyati

What is the nature of erroneous cognition? Indian philosophy contains an extensive debate over theories of error in response to this question. In Gajendra Thakur's translation, this philosophical controversy appears without any loss of argument: 1. Atmakhyati (Buddhist-Sautrantika/Vijnanavada): denying the reality of an external object and projecting the internal form of cognition outward. 2. Akhyati (Mimamsaka-Prabhakara): failure to apprehend the distinction between memory and perception; the memorial character of memory is lost. . Anyathakhyati (Nyaya): cognition of one existing object in the form of another, as when market silver is cognized in a shell³.

Vachaspati Mishra sharply refutes all these positions. Refuting the Naiyayika theory of anyathakhyati, he remarks sarcastically: "Ah! What extraordinary good fortune poor cognition possesses, that it can attain certainty even through falsity!". This irony is fully matched by the expressive power of Maithili. The examples of a banana stalk arising from sugarcane seed scorched in a forest fire and the digestive fire of a sufferer from bhasmaka disease are used to analyze with precision how a defect can give a cause the capacity to produce a different effect. Vachaspati Mishra's self-references—"I have already answered this objection in the Nyayakanika" and "its detailed discussion should be seen in the Brahmatattvasamiksha"—are preserved in the translation, revealing the breadth of his literary corpus.

As the siddhanta, Vachaspati Mishra establishes anirvacaniyakhyati. Water superimposed upon rays in a mirage is "neither real, nor unreal, nor both real and unreal, because the last alternative is self-contradictory". This establishment of what is different from both being and non-being lies at the heart of Advaita epistemology. If the superimposed water were real, the cognition would be in the form "rays" or "water of the Ganga," but the cognition is "water here." "Mere appearance is not reality"—if it were, a thirsty man could descend to the "Mandakini with its rising

and falling waves" seen in the mirage and drink its water. This doctrine is present intact in the Maithili translation with its full pictorial force.

The Self-Luminosity of the Atman and the State of Jivahood

A doubt is raised concerning the possibility of adhyasa: how can the non-self be superimposed upon the Atman, which is not an object and is self-luminous? Vachaspati Mishra argues that if the Atman were regarded as inert, a situation would arise like "one blind man holding another blind man's hand and falling at every step"—the fault of an endless chain of the blind. The postulation of another cognition leads to infinite regress. The Vijñanavadin doctrine that the object itself shines forth is rejected on the ground that the object appears as limited and gross, whereas illumination appears as internal and unrestricted.

After establishing the self-luminosity of the Atman, he answers "in the manner of a mature argument" that even upon imperceptible space an indiscriminating child superimposes stain or "a huge inverted bowl made of sapphire". Just as space appears divided because of the limiting adjuncts of pot, jar, and vessel, so the condition of being a jiva arises upon the non-objectifiable Atman through the limiting adjuncts of intellect, mind, and body.

The animal analogy for adhyasa—"fleeing on seeing a man with a raised stick, approaching on seeing green grass"—is so vivid in the Maithili prose that a clear picture of rural life stands before the reader. Along with the subtle analysis of superimposed attributes ("I am mute, one-eyed, deaf") and superimposition of the substrate, the introduction to the Adhyasa-Bhashya concludes with the commitment that "through repeated practice of true knowledge, the impressions of error are eradicated".

First Sutra: 'Athato Brahmajijnasa'

"Therefore, now, the desire to know Brahman"—the explanation of the first sutra contains an extensive analysis of 'atha' (sequence/immediacy), 'atah' (reason), and 'brahmajijnasa' (the compound). 1. Analysis of the word atha: the meanings of

auspiciousness, commencement, and entitlement are rejected, and the meaning of sequence is established. The auspicious sound is illustrated by "the sound of a drum or conch" and "the sight of a water-filled pitcher brought for some other purpose". 2. Refutation of the sequence of ritual action and knowledge: the Mimamsaka purvapaksha that inquiry into Brahman must follow inquiry into dharma is vigorously refuted. Liberation is not something produced (like a lump of dough), modified (like curd), purified by ritual preparation (like sprinkling a mortar), or attained (like obtaining milk by milking). Action is only a "remote aid" to dispassion and purification of the intellect. . The fourfold discipline: discrimination between the eternal and non-eternal, dispassion toward enjoyment here and hereafter, the sixfold wealth beginning with tranquility and restraint, and the desire for liberation. In this section, lively examples are used against arguments opposed to dispassion—such as bringing a fish with bones and taking the edible portion, grain with husk, not abandoning seed for fear of wild animals, and not abandoning food for fear of beggars—making the Maithili prose an extraordinary celebration of lived imagery. "Even the finest cook cannot separate poison from food in which poison has been mixed with honey and eat only the honey"—this example links ordinary practical intelligence to Vedanta. 4. The compound in brahmajijnasa: the interpretation "inquiry for Brahman" as a dative compound is rejected and "inquiry into Brahman" as a genitive tatpuruṣa is established. It is demonstrated by Katyayana's rule, as in 'wood for the sacrificial post.' This is historically important because Vachaspati here refutes the pre-Shankaran tradition of commentators³.

Second Sutra: 'Janmadyasya Yatah'

"From which the birth and so forth of this world proceed." The opponent asks how Brahman can be defined by the characteristics of a limited, inert, and perishable world. As siddhanta, an indirect defining mark is established: "just as reaching different places is a mark of the sun's movement". The neuter gender in 'janmadi' is a matter of grammatical economy. Yaska's six modifications of being—birth, existence, growth, transformation, decline, and destruction—are subsumed under origination, continuance, and destruction

(dissolution), with growth included in origination and decline in destruction.

To establish an omniscient and omnipotent cause, striking natural examples are given of the world's fixed order: "the birth of the blackbuck in a particular region, the cuckoo's call at a particular season, and the impregnation of the crane through thunder at the beginning of the rains for a particular cause." This nature-image has been translated into Maithili with its native fragrance intact. In this sutra it is established that the sutra is not an independent inferential proof, but points to the Bhrigu-Varuna dialogue in the Taittiriya Shruti and to Upanishadic statements. Through the analogy of the rope serving as the material basis for the snake together with avidya, Brahman—together with avidya—is established as the material cause.

Third Sutra: 'Shastrayonitvat'

"Because it is the source of Scripture." Two scripturally accepted interpretations of this sutra are presented. 1. Brahman as the cause of Scripture: Brahman is the womb or source of the vast body of Scripture, filled with countless branches of knowledge such as the Rigveda and "illuminating all things like a torch." Just as Panini's knowledge is more extensive than his grammatical treatise, what then can be said of the knowledge of the creator of the universe! The example of the ineffable differences among the sweetness of sugarcane juice, milk, and jaggery indicates the superiority of the speaker's knowledge to what can be expressed. The Maithili saying "barley pudding is not salty" is used to indicate 'very little effort'. 2. Scripture as the proof of Brahman: Scripture is the source, that is, the means of knowledge, of Brahman. Brahman is known only through Scripture, not through independent inference.

The reconciliation between the Jaimini tradition and the followers of Vyasa in the discussion of the eternality of the Veda is remarkable. A Mimamsaka who holds phonemes to be eternal must still accept the non-eternality of words and sentences in their specific sequence. The order of Vedic recitation in the teacher-pupil tradition is clarified through the example of a dance teacher and the pupil's movements. "In no creation does brahminicide become a

cause of merit, nor an Ashvamedha a cause of sin; just as fire never wets and water never burns"—this subtle discussion of fixed natural properties is made readily intelligible in Maithili.

Fourth Sutra: 'Tattu Samanvayat'

The Samanvayadhikarana occupies nearly one-third of the entire work and contains its most concentrated philosophical debate. The purvapaksha takes the injunction-oriented character of Purva Mimamsa as its basis: "The purpose of Scripture is to teach action." The Mimamsaka attempt to regard Vedantic statements as an 'injunction to meditate on Brahman for one who desires immortality' (pratipatti-vidhi) is presented. Statements about already existing things, such as "there is fruit on the riverbank," are treated as redundant in an attempt to dismiss their independent purpose.

Siddhanta: Samanvaya and Intrinsic Validity

The siddhanta side establishes, by beginning, conclusion, and the other indicators of purport (including recollection of the Upamshuyaja principle), that "all Vedantic statements converge upon Brahman with a single purport." In Advaita philosophy, knowledge is 'object-determined,' not 'person-determined' as action is.

The Immutable Eternity of Liberation and the Rejection of Bhedabhedavada

Liberation is not produced by action. If it were produced by action, it would be non-eternal.

- Not producible: liberation is not a newly produced object like curd or a pot.
- Not something to be attained: through the beautiful analogy of the boatman and boat—leaving the changing bank, foam, and waves and reaching the quiet middle—the ever-attained nature of Brahman is established.
- Not something to be purified or perfected: both the addition of a quality (a hibiscus flower dyed with lac juice) and the removal of a defect (a mirror rubbed with brick powder) are

impossible in Brahman. The Atman is denied to be a locus of action. "Purity through bathing and sipping water belongs to the empirical jiva, just as the heroine's fragrance is superimposed upon her companion". The conclusion is: "Apart from these four modes there is no fifth way... not even the shadow of action can enter liberation apart from knowledge." This line in Gajendra Thakur's translation brings the essence of Advaita to completion.

In this context there is a distinction between immutable eternity and changing continuity, along with an extended refutation of bhedabhedavada—"A pot is not said to be a jujube contained in it, and even though Chaitra and Maitra sit on the same seat, Chaitra is not said to be Maitra." One may know from afar that an ornament is gold while not knowing that it is an earring; and the argument exposing the mutual dependence involved in difference-and-non-difference has been translated without leaving any knot unresolved.

The Fruitfulness of Statements about Established Reality and Philosophy of Language

The objection of the purvapaksha was that statements about established realities are fruitless. To refute this, Vachaspati gives an ornate description of Mount Sumeru and the famous story of a Dravidian who did not know the Arya language. When the messenger tells the father, "Devadatta, may your prosperity increase; a son has been born to you," the Dravidian infers the understanding of the sentence from Devadatta's horripilation and his face blooming like a fully opened lotus. This establishes that the power of words can also be learned in relation to established realities. This epoch-making argument in the philosophy of language—which later became a foundation of Vedantic discussions of verbal cognition—flows like a story in Maithili.

Analysis of Negation and Jivanmukti

"A Brahmana should not be killed"—the negative particle's capacity to express absence, the paryudasa construction in the Prajapati vow ("Do not look at the rising sun"), and the analysis of cessation and non-engagement are translated through striking analogies such as:

"When armor is removed, if no arrow attacks, the warrior's life is not destroyed at once".

Finally, the distinction between figurative and false ego-cognition is drawn (the primary meaning of "lion" in an animal with a mane, and its secondary meaning when applied to a brave man), and jivanmukti is established—"one who has given up wealth and is free from identification with wealth has no fear of theft"; "just as a snake's discarded slough lies dead and cast off upon an anthill, so this body lies there". The analogy of a "chain of the blind" for the beginningless relation with the body and the final doctrine, "I am Brahman—in this knowledge all injunctions and all other means of knowledge come to an end," conclude the philosophical debate. The conclusion also connects the justification for commencing a separate treatise back to the first sutra, producing, from the standpoint of composition, a ring structure.

Translation Theory, Language Strategy, and Native Idiom

Gajendra Thakur's translation is based on the principle "faithful to meaning but independent in expression". It does not deviate in the slightest from the original sequence of arguments, examples, and proofs, but the sentence structure is entirely natural to Maithili. The language strategy of the translation works on three levels:

1. Terminological precision: technical terms such as *adhyasa*, *anirvacaniya*, *samanadhikarana*, *pratyabhijna*, *arthapatti*, *kutastha*, and *upadana* are retained, but a Maithili explanation is supplied at their first occurrence. This has successfully created a Maithili technical vocabulary for *Mimamsa* and *Vedanta*, with far-reaching significance.
2. Maithilization and sentence structure: the long compound-laden sentences of Sanskrit are broken into forms such as "The point is—", "Suppose.", "What is being said is—", and "He answers this by...". The rendering of Sanskrit 'nanu' as 'Suppose' is so consistent that the reader never loses track of the movement between *purvapaksha* and *siddhanta*.
3. Native idiom and proverb: transforming Sanskrit logical maxims into Maithili folk speech is the finest feature of the translation:

- "One blind man holds another blind man's hand and falls at every step" (the defect of a chain of the blind).
- "Barley pudding is not salty" (indicating very little effort).
- "Even a thousand scriptures together cannot turn a pot into cloth" (rejection of Shruti contrary to experience).
- "Even a thousand craftsmen cannot make cloth out of a pot".
- "Inquiry into something meaningless, like examining the teeth of an arrow".

The native flavor of word choice—terms corresponding to light, darkness, smile, calf, ring, slough, anthill, twilight, shepherd, husk, mortar, weaver, and potter—gives philosophical prose the scent of lived life, yet its seriousness is nowhere weakened by excessive rusticity. Disciplined agreement of gender and number, the consistent use of the respectful verbal form for Brahman, the Atman, and the Acharya as against the ordinary form, and the consistent restriction of the nukta to only the two specified dotted retroflex letters attest to the editorial labor of the "AUDIT_CORRECTED" edition. Source references, including locations in the Brihadaranyaka and the Bhagavad Gita, increase the book's usefulness for readers.

The Contribution of Videha and Gajendra Thakur to Maithili Literature

Vachaspati Mishra was a Maithil—this proud statement is repeated again and again in Maithili, yet his works were not in Maithili. Gajendra Thakur's translation fills that historical absence and turns that pride into a body of accessible text. Videha e-journal (established 2000, ISSN 2229-547X) and its book series are building a Maithili bridge to classical Sanskrit works; the inclusion of a philosophical work such as the Bhamati proves that Maithili is not merely a vehicle for songs and stories, but is equally capable of carrying the most rigorous scholastic debate.

The inner connection of this translation with Mithila's Nyaya-Mimamsa tradition—in which Vachaspati himself stands, followed later by the Tattvacintamani tradition of Gangesha Upadhyaya—is clear. The Bhamati's discussions of error and validity form part of

the background to later Navya-Nyaya; therefore, the availability of the Bhamati in Maithili represents a reclamation of Mithila's own intellectual history. At university level, this work is fit to serve as a foundational text for philosophy courses, research, and training in scholastic debate through the medium of Maithili.

Editorial Reflections for a Future Edition

Amid the overall accuracy revealed by the detailed review, a few subtle editorial points deserve attention in a future edition:

- The form "aparokksha" occurs seven times in the text whereas the correct "aparoksha" occurs four times; it would be desirable to standardize this variation.
- The copyright line prints "Preeti Thakar"; the intended form appears to be "Preeti Thakur".
- In the enumeration of the three modes of transformation, where the sentence "According to the characteristic of dharma, three types are stated—" occurs, the numbered list does not follow immediately and the explanation begins in the next paragraph; a connecting sentence could make the flow easier.
- For greater usefulness, a future edition could add a Maithili-Sanskrit glossary of technical terms, typographical differentiation among the sutra, bhashya, and tika levels, and an index of adhikaranas.

These are suggestions for refinement, not a catalogue of faults. In a vast text extending from page 1 to page 491, the small number of such slips is itself evidence of the success of the "AUDIT" process.

Overall Evaluation

This pure Maithili rendering of "Bhamati (Chatussuttri)" by Gajendra Thakur is a standard-setting work in the history of Maithili prose. It accomplishes three tasks at once—it transfers Vachaspati's edifice of reasoning intact into Maithili, builds a Maithili model of the technical vocabulary of Mimamsa, Nyaya, and Vedanta, and brings Mithila's own philosophical heritage back into Mithila's own language.

From the subtlest debate on theories of error in the *Adhyasa-Bhashya* to the vast scholastic argument of the *Samanvayadhikarana*, no link in the reasoning is broken and nowhere does the language become strained. Because the sequence of examples, *purvapaksha*, reply, renewed objection, resolution, and conclusion is preserved, the reader sees not merely conclusions but the entire process of philosophical debate. Measured by the standards of Indian poetics, this translation is an exemplar of the quality of *prasada*—clarity and ease of expression despite profundity of meaning—and the "evenness" of classical prose, a consistent compositional style, is one of its abiding qualities.

"Just as water from a royal road becomes pure when it falls into the current of the Ganga"—Vachaspati's humble declaration can be reversed and applied to this translation: the Acharya's stream of the Ganga has now reached the royal road of Mithila, where every traveler may bathe in it. This work will remain a reference pillar for Maithili philosophical literature for a long time, and readers of this edition will naturally await the arrival in Maithili of the rest of the *Bhamati*—from the remaining portion of the first chapter through the fourth chapter. It is a unique confluence of the living force of *Advaita Vedanta* and the intellectual capacity of the Maithili language, providing rich material for comparative study to students of epistemology, semantics, and philosophy of consciousness.

Chapter 2

Bhamati (Chatussutri)

Vachaspati Mishra's Commentary on Shankara's
Brahmasutra Bhashya

Detailed Philosophical, Translation-Critical, and Literary Review

Original Sanskrit: Vachaspati Mishra

Pure Maithili Translation from Sanskrit: Gajendra Thakur

Text Reviewed: From the Adhyasa-Bhashya to the End of the Chatussutri

Videha — First Maithili Fortnightly E-Journal ISSN 2229-547X

This review systematically examines the invocation of the work, the Adhyasa section, the exposition of the first four sutras of the Brahmasutra, the distinctive doctrines of the Bhamati school, the translator's language strategy, style of argument, Indian and Western critical perspectives, its place in Maithili literature, and the editorial requirements of a future edition.

1. Introduction to the Work and the Nature of the Text under Review

Among Mithila's brightest contributions to the history of Indian philosophy, Vachaspati Mishra's ninth-century "Bhamati" is foremost. This commentary on Shankaracharya's Brahmasutra Bhashya is the foundational work of the "Bhamati school" of Advaita Vedanta, and its author himself was a son of Mithila. Yet it is an irony that for more than a thousand years Maithil readers could not reach this philosophical summit of their own land without climbing the staircase of Sanskrit. Gajendra Thakur's translation fills that historical absence—the Chatussutri portion of the Bhamati, comprising the commentary on Shankara's Adhyasa-Bhashya and the explanation of the first four Brahmasutras, is for the first time available in full, faithfully and in pure Maithili.

The text under review contains the material from pages 1 to 491 of the cumulative edition and ends with the colophon, "Here ends the Chatussutri-Bhamati." Its structure is as follows: (a) cover and publication pages, (b) a Maithili rendering of the original text of Shankara's Adhyasa-Bhashya, (c) translations of Vachaspati's seven invocatory verses, (d) a complete translation of the Bhamati commentary on the Adhyasa-Bhashya under the heading "Adhyasa," (e) the commentary on the first sutra, "Therefore, now, the desire to know Brahman" (Athato Brahmajijnasa), (f) the commentary on the second sutra, "From which the birth and so forth of this world proceed" (Janmadyasya Yatah), (g) the commentary on the third sutra, "Because it is the source of Scripture" (Shastrayonitvat), and (h) the vast commentary on the fourth sutra, "But that, because of the harmonious purport" (Tattu Samanvayat). The Samanvayadhikarana section forms nearly one-

third of the entire book, showing the translator's fidelity to the proportions of the original Bhamati.

The publication page records the first edition as 2004 and the enlarged edition as 2026—that is, the work is the fruit of two decades of mature effort. The publisher is the Videha e-journal (established 2000, ISSN 2229-547X), and the book appears as part of Videha's book series. Copyright is jointly in the names of Gajendra Thakur and Preeti Thakur, while the original Sanskrit work is described as "a classical heritage of the Indian philosophical tradition," respecting its public character; this editorial judgment is commendable.

2. Review of the Invocation

Vachaspati's seven invocatory verses form the gateway to the Bhamati, and in translation they preserve both their philosophical weight and poetic grace. In the first verse Brahman is saluted as "of immeasurable bliss and the nature of knowledge," as the Lord who creates the "false manifestation" of the five elements, "having made the two forms of indefinable avidya his ministers"—the seed-doctrine of the Bhamati school, the twofold avidya pointing toward concealment and residual impression / mula-avidya and tula-avidya, thus meets the reader at the very outset. The metaphor of the "minister" preserves in translation the brilliance of the original political imagery.

The translation of the second verse—"The Vedas are his breath, the five great elements are his sight, the moving and unmoving world is his smile, and his sleep is the great dissolution"—gains an intimate beauty from the Maithili word 'muski'; the play of the cosmos descends into the language of home. There follow, in order, salutations to the Vedas and Bhava, Martanda, Tilakasvamin, Mahaganapati, Vyasa ("the second creator and an incarnation of Lord Hari's power of knowledge"), and Shankara ("of stainless knowledge, an ocean of compassion"). The humble declaration of the seventh verse—"Just as water from a royal road becomes pure when it falls into the current of the Ganga, so the insignificant words of people like me become sanctified when joined to the Acharya's composition"—is a beautiful Maithili equivalent of the

commentator's classical mode of self-positioning. By rendering the verses in prose, the translator places preservation of meaning above preservation of metre—a sound decision for a philosophical work.

3. The Adhyasa Section: Translation of Vachaspati's Commentary on Shankara's Introduction

3.1 The Grand Construction of the Purvapaksha: The Atman Is Not an Object of Inquiry

Before explaining the "yushmad-asmad" passage of the Bhashya, the commentary constructs an extended purvapaksha: that about which there is no doubt and knowledge of which serves no purpose is not a proper object of inquiry. "A pot present in bright light and in contact with the visual organ attended by the mind; or the teeth of a crow"—these two examples, of what is beyond doubt and what is purposeless, retain their wit in translation. The opponent then shows step by step that the immediate experience of "I" exists in all beings "from worms and insects to gods and sages"; that the body is not its substratum because recognition from childhood to old age ("I, who in childhood took delight with my parents, now in old age take delight with my grandchildren") transcends bodily difference; that the examples of the flower and the thread that binds it, the sublation of a divine body in dream, the identity of the self of one who becomes a tiger through yogic power, and the cross-operation of the senses in "what I myself saw, I am now touching" are all translated in sequence. The everyday example "Dirgha is crying" for secondary usage comes naturally into Maithili.

The purvapaksha reaches its climax in the declaration, "Even a thousand scriptures together cannot turn a pot into cloth"—Shruti contrary to experience must be taken in a secondary sense. The translator preserves this famous Nyaya maxim in a distinctly Maithili rhythm, bringing the aggressiveness of the purvapaksha to life. Thereafter come the alternatives that the Atman is atomic in size or coextensive with the body, the objection involving consciousness in a whole and consciousness in each part, and the

refutation of the momentary cognition of Buddhism as the locus of "I"—all these arguments against the background of Nyaya, Buddhism, and Mimamsa appear in their proper order.

3.2 Resolution of the Conflict between Shruti and Perception

On the siddhanta side, the commentary shows, through indicators of purport such as beginning, conclusion, and repetition, that Shruti presents the unconditioned Atman—"Repetition establishes the importance of the subject, as in: Ah, beautiful! Ah, beautiful!" The translation joins Mimamsa terminology with the liveliness of ordinary speech. The apaurusheya character of Shruti, its intrinsic validity, and the subtle distinction that "knowledge born of Shruti does not destroy the practical validity of perception; it negates only its ultimate validity"—the backbone of Advaita epistemology—are rendered in very clear Maithili. The example that the properties of short and long sound, though superimposed upon phonemes, still yield true meanings in forms such as 'naga' and 'naaga'; the sublation of prior cognition by later cognition in shell-silver; and the Jaimini sutra, "where the earlier and later are connected, the earlier side is weaker"—all the evidentiary material is preserved intact.

The analysis of secondary usage is a jewel of this section: the secondary use of the word "Agnihotra" for the monthly Agnihotra of the Kundapayinam Ayana, the use of "lion" for a pupil, and the established use of the word "oil" for mustard oil—through all three examples it is shown that secondary usage presupposes cognition of difference, whereas in the use of "I" there is no cognition of difference from the body and therefore the usage is not secondary but false. This distinction is developed again toward the end of the fourth sutra, and the translation maintains terminological consistency in both places.

3.3 The Definition of Adhyasa and the Debate on Khyativada

"The appearance elsewhere, in a memory-like form, of something previously seen"—the word-by-word explanation of this Bhashya definition of adhyasa (previously seen, appearance, memory-form,

elsewhere) is translated together with tests for over-extension and under-extension: the suspicion of over-extension from recognizing cowness in the cow Kalakshi and from the valid recognition of Devadatta of Pataliputra at Mahishmati; the removal of under-extension through dream cognition; the process of a bile-disorder in "the shell is yellow" and "sugar is bitter"; reflection-errors in mirror and sheet of water; double moon, confusion of direction, the circle of a firebrand, mirage, and a snake in bamboo—this whole everyday repertory of error is fully carried over into Maithili.

Thereafter, behind the Bhashya's phrase "some people... others..." comes the scholastic debate over theories of error—the Atmakhyati of the Sautrantika/Vijnanavadin (outward projection of the form of cognition), the Akhyati of the Prabhakara (non-apprehension of the distinction between memory and perception; "the memorial character of memory disappears"), and the Anyathakhyati of Nyaya. Vachaspati's brilliance in sarcasm acquires extraordinary life in the translation: "Ah! May the long-lived gentleman reflect upon this sublating cognition," "May the beloved of the gods praise his intellect!", "Ah! What extraordinary good fortune poor cognition possesses, that it can attain certainty even through falsity!"—the Sanskrit tradition of irony in debate meets the expressive power of Maithili. In the refutation of Anyathakhyati, the argument that the cognition "the gavaya is like a cow" does not lead one searching for a cow toward a gavaya, and the analysis of the sequence of activity in one seeking silver (failure to apprehend difference → superimposition → inference based on silverhood → action), are exact.

A banana stalk from sugarcane seed scorched in a forest fire, and the digestive fire of one suffering from bhasmaka disease—these examples of a defect giving a cause the capacity to produce a different effect, as well as the fault in an inference whose subject is already sublated, such as "fire is not hot," are all preserved. Particularly noteworthy is that Vachaspati's self-references—"I have already answered this objection in the Nyayakanika" and "its detailed discussion should be seen in the Brahmatattvasamiksha"—are retained in the translation; thus the Maithili reader is naturally introduced to Vachaspati's broader corpus, including the Nyayakanika and Brahmatattvasamiksha.

3.4 Establishment of Anirvacaniyakhyati

The establishment of indefinability as the siddhanta is the philosophical summit of this section: water superimposed on rays is "neither real, nor unreal, nor both real and unreal, because the last alternative is self-contradictory". This threefold exclusion defining what is different from both being and non-being, together with the subtle preceding argument (if the superimposed form were the rays, cognition would take the form "rays"; if it were Ganga water, cognition would take the form "water of the Ganga"; but the cognition is "water here"), appears in Maithili without omitting a single link of the reasoning. "Mere appearance is not reality"—otherwise a thirsty person could descend to the "Mandakini with its rising and falling waves" in a mirage and drink its water—this poetic refutation is preserved with the full pictorial quality of the original. Nor is the grammatical subtlety of the cvi suffix in the "intermingling" of truth and falsehood omitted ("that which is not a certain thing becomes as though that very thing")—evidence of the translation's scholastic care.

3.5 Discussion of the Self-Luminosity of the Atman

In the explanation of the Bhashya phrase "Again, how?" there is an extended debate on the self-luminosity of consciousness—the Atman cannot be both agent and object; if cognition were inert there would be the fault of a "chain of blind men, one holding another's hand and falling at every step"; postulating another cognition leads to infinite regress; the witty refutation of a relation based merely on nature, "If the son is learned, will the father too become learned?"; the objection of a self-luminous consciousness like the light of a firefly; rejection of the Vijnanavadin view that the object itself shines, because the object appears limited and gross while illumination appears internal and unlimited—and finally the conclusion: "This very illumination—which is self-luminous, one, unchanging, eternal, and without parts—is the inner Self." The analysis of Chaitra's going to the city in terms of object and agent is also preserved. The patience with which the translator unfolds this most difficult section sentence by sentence is both a test and a demonstration of the capacity of Maithili philosophical prose.

3.6 Adhyasa upon the Non-Objectifiable Atman: The Analogy of Space and Jivahood

Both the principal answer based on "immediate experience" and the second answer given "in the manner of a mature argument"—"and there is no such rule in this matter"—are translated in sequence. The superimposition of stain below upon imperceptible space by "children," that is, indiscriminating people; the analogy of "a vast inverted bowl made of sapphire"; and the attribution of the colors of blue-lotus petals and rows of royal swans are beautifully rendered in Maithili. Just as space appears divided through the limiting adjuncts of pot, jar, and vessel, so jivahood arises through the intellect, mind, and body imagined by avidya; the jiva, formed through the apparent union of "not this" and "this," becomes the object of the ego-cognition; and mutual dependence is avoided through the seed-and-sprout principle—the entire fabric of the theory of adhyasa is preserved intact.

3.7 Definition of Avidya, the Operation of Pramana, and the Analogy with Animals

"The wise call adhyasa of the above-described form avidya; and the determination of the real nature of a thing distinct from that is called knowledge"—this paired definition of false cognition and right cognition, and the clarification that "the sole cause of all evil is the superimposition of the non-self upon the inner Self, not the illusion of silver in a shell," are clear. The dependence of the status of knower upon adhyasa ("it is not intelligible that a person devoid of the notions 'I' and 'mine' regarding body and senses could be a knower"), the analysis of the operation of instruments through the example of the weaver, and the non-agency of the unattached Atman are all presented step by step. The famous Bhashya passage comparing humans with animals—fleeing from a man with a raised stick, approaching upon seeing green grass; even a learned man withdrawing from a fierce person with a raised sword—is so natural in Maithili that a rural scene stands directly before the reader. The analysis of eligibility for scriptural action, the distinction in eligibility for the Shyena sacrifice ("one who has conquered the enemy called anger is eligible for the prohibition; one who remains under the control of the enemy called anger is

eligible for the teaching of the Shyena and similar rites"), and the four examples of superimposition involving caste, stage of life, and age ("a king should perform the Rajasuya sacrifice," "a householder should marry a woman of the same caste," "one whose hair is black should tend the sacred fire," "one whose disease is incurable should enter the water and give up life")—all this scholastic material is faithfully preserved.

At the conclusion of the chapter-section come the two forms of superimposition expressed as "I" and "mine"—superimposition of attributes and superimposition of their substrate; the experience "I myself am healthy/unhealthy" through the health or illness of son and wife; the attribution of qualities of the senses ("I am mute, one-eyed, deaf, blind") and qualities of the inner organ (desire, intention, doubt, determination); and the declaration of the Shariraka Mimamsa, "for the removal of the cause of this evil and the attainment of knowledge of the oneness of the Self, the whole Vedanta begins"—the entire introduction reaches completion here. The fact that even "thousands of times" of rope-snake illusion do not alter the nature of the rope, and that repeated practice of right knowledge eradicates the impressions of error, becomes a bridge to the explanation of the sutras that follows.

4. First Sutra: "Therefore, now, the desire to know Brahman" (Athato Brahmajijnasa)

4.1 Analysis of the Word "Atha"

At the beginning of the exposition of the sutra, the word jijnasa is taken to indicate both doubt and result; the nature of attaining what is already attained is illustrated by the necklace already lying upon one's own neck; and the terms Mimamsa, shastra, and sutra are explained. Four possible meanings of the word "atha"—sequence, commencement (with examples such as "athato'yam jyotishtomah," "atha shabdanushasanam," and "atha yoganushasanam"), auspiciousness, and entitlement through reference to what precedes—are tested by full scholastic method. In rejecting auspiciousness, examples are given of "the sound of a drum or conch" and "the sight of a water-filled pitcher brought for some other purpose," while the Smriti that "Om and Atha—these

two words first emerged from Brahma's throat" is reconciled by treating the mere sound as auspicious. The priority of inquiry is protected through the example of secondary reference in "the staff-holder recites the permission and response," where 'staff' stands for its bearer—this subtle Mimamsa reasoning is also preserved intact.

4.2 Refutation of the Necessary Sequence of Karma and Knowledge, and the Real Place of Karma

The position that "inquiry into Brahman follows inquiry into dharma" is raised at length and refuted. In the course of this, realization of Brahman is shown to fall outside all four kinds of effected result—something produced, modified, purified, or attained—with the four examples of a lump of dough, paddy and rice, sprinkling a mortar, and milking a cow. Also included are the invalidity of an imagined fire for a person shivering from cold, the example of the curtain being removed before a dancer, the impossibility of certainty arising from the recurring doubt "post or man," the analogy of direct apprehension of the notes shadja and so forth through musical practice, and the sequence of hearing, reflection, and meditation upon "Tat tvam asi." Various views concerning action are discussed—removal of impurity, formation of a disposition, discharge of the three debts, and combined-separate application, with the example of the khadira sacrificial post—and the Badarayana sutra is cited to the effect that "because of the scriptural statements concerning sacrifice and so forth, all are required for the cultivation of Brahman, as in the case of the horse"; yet in the final position action is only a "remote aid": from obligatory action comes the destruction of sin, from that purity of intellect, from that dispassion, and from that inquiry. The Gita statement "for the sage who wishes to attain yoga, action is said to be the means; for one established in yoga, tranquility is the means" is reconciled with the argument; the doctrine of necessary sequence is refuted by the Jabala Shruti, "one may renounce directly from the stage of a student," and by "on the very day dispassion arises, one should renounce." This entire network of proofs is systematically arranged in the translation.

In the explanation of austerity, the translator's practical discernment shines: "not one who observes a total fast, because he would die." Amid dry scholastic discussion, such a straightforward sentence brings a smile to the reader and faithfully reflects the intention of the original. The discussion of sequence involving the vessel for milking, the Darshapurnamasa and Soma rites, and "the rule of immediate sequence in the context of piercing the heart"—the entire Mimamsaka apparatus of textual order, location, principal purpose, and actual performance—is likewise not omitted.

4.3 The Fourfold Discipline and the Word "Atah"

Discrimination between the eternal and non-eternal, dispassion toward the enjoyment of results here and hereafter, the disciplines beginning with tranquility and restraint, and the desire for liberation—the exposition of this fourfold discipline is among the most flowing portions of the work. The dilemma concerning discrimination—"if certainty has arisen, Brahman is already known; if there is only general knowledge, dispassion does not arise"—and its solution through a general distinction between the eternal and non-eternal on the basis of the qualities of the substrate are presented, followed by a lively chain of examples used by the purvapaksha against dispassion: bringing a fish with bones and taking only the edible portion, paddy with husk, a farmer who does not abandon seed for fear of wild animals, not abandoning food for fear of beggars, and the Shruti statement "we have drunk Soma; we have become immortal." The siddhanta responds that "even the finest cook cannot separate poison from food in which poison has been mixed with honey and eat only the honey," and that the statement about immortality through Soma must be taken secondarily in light of the Puranic saying that "continuance until dissolution is called immortality." The whole section becomes a celebration of Maithili prose. In the explanation of tranquility and restraint, the agrarian analogy "a calm and trained calf becomes fit to draw a plough or cart" roots the sense of the original in the soil. The list of temporal measures—"moment, muhurta, watch, day, night, fortnight, month, season, half-year, year, yuga, the duration of the four yugas, manvantara, dissolution, and great dissolution"—

is preserved intact along with contemplation of the threefold suffering from Satyaloka down to Avici.

4.4 Analysis of the Compound in "Brahmanah" and the Object of Inquiry

This section is historically important: "the earlier commentators' explanation of the compound as a dative—brahmane jijnasa, inquiry for Brahman—should here be understood as rejected." Vachaspati thus refutes a pre-Shankaran or divergent commentator tradition that took the dative compound, and establishes the genitive tatpurusha through Katyayana's rule concerning the relation between a base substance and its modification in a dative compound, as in "wood for the sacrificial post." The debate over whether the genitive denotes an object relation or a residual relation is presented through such questions as: "after seeing the sun or moon, does the question arise, to whom does this belong? But on hearing the word knowledge, why should one not ask, knowledge of what?" The automatic inclusion of residual matters belonging to Brahman through implication is compared to understanding the attendants when one hears "the king goes here." The possible meanings of the word Brahman—Brahmana caste in brahmahatya, the Veda in brahmojjham, and the Supreme Self in "the knower of Brahman becomes Brahman"—are resolved by the definition supplied in the next sutra.

In reply to the famous objection based on the alternatives known and unknown, the attributes "eternal, pure, conscious, free, omniscient, and omnipotent Brahman" are explained one by one: eternity negates the suffering of decay, purity negates suffering due to limiting adjuncts, and consciousness establishes self-luminosity and bliss. Brahman is known as the Self even to "ordinary farmers whose feet are covered with dust." There follows a historical survey of the diversity of views about the nature of the Self: the Lokayata view of the conscious body, the doctrine that the senses are the self, the doctrine that mind is the self, momentary cognition, voidism, an agent and enjoyer that passes from body to body, the merely enjoying self in the direction of Sankhya, an omniscient God distinct from the jiva, and finally the Advaitic position that "Ishvara is the Self of that very enjoying jiva." This entire philosophical map,

together with disagreements over the meanings of both tat and tvam, gives the Maithili reader a small encyclopedia of Indian philosophy. The section concludes with the statement of purpose: "A person who accepts any one of these views without examination will be deprived of the highest good and will come to harm."

5. Second Sutra: "From which the birth and so forth of this world proceed" (Janmadyasya Yatah)

The purvapaksha against defining Brahman begins by observing that experienced objects are limited, impure, inert, and perishable, whereas Brahman is their opposite; definition through Brahman's own qualities seems impossible because those qualities are not independently known. The siddhanta establishes an indirect defining mark: "because the world arises from Brahman, the world may serve as a mark of Brahman—just as the sun's reaching different places serves as a mark of its motion." This solar analogy carries the classical explanation of an indirect mark beautifully into Maithili. The neuter gender of "janmadi" is explained through grammatical economy; origination, continuance, and dissolution are taken as the intended three, and Yaska's six modifications of being—birth, existence, growth, transformation, decline, and destruction—are subsumed under the three: growth under origination, as when cloth becomes larger by two threads; the three transformations of dharma, characteristic, and state under origination, as illustrated by gold and bracelet; and decline under destruction. This entire Nirukta discussion, together with the statement that only the origination, continuance, and destruction spoken of in the Veda are intended, makes the dependence on Shruti clear.

The establishment of an omniscient and omnipotent cause from the diversity of the universe begins with the world as "divided by name and form, furnished with many agents and enjoyers, and fixed in an orderly manner by place, time, cause, action, and result," whose "design and arrangement are difficult even to imagine mentally." The intelligent production of a pot by a potter is used as an analogy; the causal claims of Pradhana, time, planetary

deities, chance, inherent nature, and non-being are rejected; and an extraordinary set of examples of regular order is given: "some creatures arise only in particular regions, such as the blackbuck; some at particular times, such as the cuckoo's call; some through particular causes, such as the impregnation of cranes through thunder at the beginning of the rains." These nature-images retain their native fragrance in Maithili. The distinction between agent and enjoyer—cook and ritual priest as agents, the ancestors in shraddha and the son in the Vaishvanara sacrifice as enjoyers—is also rendered precisely.

The decisive turn of the section is the statement that the sutra does not point to an independent inference but presents Vedantic statements: "the purpose of the sutras is to string the Vedantic statements together like flowers on a garland-thread." The Taittiriya passage from the Bhrigu-Varuna dialogue—"that from which these beings are born... that is Brahman"—and a passage from the Ananda-valli are cited as decisive. Brahman's status as material cause, together with avidya, is explained through the rope as material basis of the snake together with ignorance; the Nyaya example of a proposition blocked by birth, "a barren woman is a mother," is given; and a place is allowed for reasoning supported by Shruti, that is, reflection, along with the Shruti "the intelligent learned man reaches the country of Gandhara." The difference in means of knowledge between inquiry into dharma and inquiry into Brahman—here knowledge culminates in direct experience—and the first presentation of the distinction between object-determined and person-determined cognition are also included: "an object does not admit the option that it is this way or that way, that it exists or does not exist," unlike ritual options such as taking the shodashi cup in the Atiratra or offering before or after sunrise. All these points prepare the ground for the fourth sutra.

6. Third Sutra: "Because it is the source of Scripture" (Shastryonitvat)

The translation gives both scripturally accepted interpretations of this sutra in order. First: Brahman's omniscience is established because Brahman is the cause of Scripture, which approaches

omniscience—the source of the "vast body of Scripture composed of the Rigveda and so forth, filled with countless branches of knowledge, illuminating all things like a torch" is Brahman. From the example of Panini and grammar comes the general principle that "the author possesses knowledge broader than the subject matter of that treatise." The ineffable differences among the sweetness of sugarcane juice, milk, and jaggery illustrate the superiority of the speaker's knowledge over expression; the saying "barley pudding is not salty" conveys "very little effort"; and the Shruti describes the Vedas as "like the breath of this great Being." The ten branches of knowledge, including Purana, Nyaya, and Mimamsa, are also mentioned as supplements to the Veda. The second interpretation is that Scripture is the womb or source of Brahman in the sense of being its means of knowledge: "knowledge of Brahman's distinctive, extraordinary nature arises only from Scripture." This removes the suspicion that the Janmadi sutra was intended as an independent inferential sign. The relation of mutual support between the two interpretations—"the following sutra confirms the first sutra"—is made clear.

The discussion of the eternity of the Veda in this context is especially valuable. Even the Mimamsaka who regards phonemes as eternal must accept the non-eternality of words and sentences in their specific sequence; manifestation itself is non-eternal. The striking analogy of dance teacher and pupil is offered: the pupil imitates the sequence of the teacher's bodily movements, not those very movements themselves; likewise in the transmission of Vedic recitation. The Jaimini position, which denies creation and dissolution and posits a beginningless chain of study, is reconciled with the followers of Vyasa, according to whom the omniscient Supreme Self creates the Veda in the same sequence as in a previous creation. "In no creation does brahminicide become a source of merit, nor an Ashvamedha a source of sin; just as fire never wets properties and water never burns"—this is the statement of fixed natural properties. The meaning of "apaurusheya" accepted by both sides is the absence of complete freedom on the part of an author. This entire analysis of Vedic authority becomes available in Maithili here with unusual depth. Finally, the nature of inquiry into Brahman as dependent on Scripture—"the sutra-author begins the

inquiry into Brahman while subject to the authority of Scripture, not through reasoning independent of Scripture"—sets the stage for the fourth sutra.

7. Fourth Sutra: "But that, because of the harmonious purport" (Tattu Samanvayat)

7.1 Purvapaksha: The Action-Orientation of the Veda

The Samanvayadhikarana is the largest and most debate-intensive portion of the work. The purvapaksha stands upon the Mimamsaka doctrine that "the purpose of Scripture is to teach action." Statements about existing things are either redundant, as in "there is fruit on the riverbank," or dependent upon other means of knowledge; Vedanta must therefore be either subordinate to injunction, teaching the agent or deity, or itself enjoin acts such as meditation, or constitute "an injunction to meditate on Brahman for one who desires immortality"—the theory of pratipatti-vidhi. The Jaimini sutra that "because a sentence has unity with an injunction, it praises the injunction" is invoked. The Mimamsaka effort to preserve the apaurusheya nature of the Veda by postulating an unseen result is answered by showing the over-extension that would result if an unseen result were similarly postulated for Buddhist sentences enjoining worship of a chaitya. The experiential objection is raised that "even after hearing Tat tvam asi, worldly conditions such as pleasure, pain, and fear remain as before," and the existing self is made an auxiliary to injunction through the analogy of the sacrificial post and the Ahavaniya fire. The entire fortress of the purvapaksha is erected in the translation at full strength, in keeping with the ethics of scholastic debate: Vachaspati's method is not to weaken the opponent before defeating him.

7.2 Independent Validity through Samanvaya

The foundational statement of the siddhanta—"all Vedantic statements converge upon Brahman with one and the same purport"—is supported by clusters of Shruti such as "O gentle one, this was Being alone in the beginning," "one without a second," and "the Self alone was this in the beginning," by the unity of beginning

and conclusion, with recollection of the Upamshuyaja principle, and by the fault involved in "abandoning what has been directly stated and imagining what has not been stated." This analysis of purport is well structured. In defending the intrinsic validity of the Veda, the distinction is made that "dependence does not arise because an object exists; it arises because a sentence is a human composition," together with the example of perception arising from the stable causal capacity of the senses. This subtle point in the theory of knowledge is preserved in translation.

7.3 The Eternity of Liberation: Rejection of the Four Modes of Effected Result

The sequential refutation of the four possibilities that liberation is produced, modified, purified, or attained forms the backbone of this adhikarana. "A modified thing like curd and a produced thing like a pot can never be eternal." In refuting attainment, the beautiful analogy of boatman and boat is used: leaving behind the changing bank, foam, and waves, one reaches the "waveless, quiet, clear, stable" middle, just as Brahman is ever attained because it is all-pervading. In refuting purification, both the addition of a quality—a hibiscus flower colored with lac juice—and removal of a defect—a mirror rubbed with brick powder—are shown to be impossible in Brahman. The Atman is denied to be a locus of action; action performed on something else cannot benefit it, "polishing a mirror does not purify a jewel"; and purity through bathing, sipping water, or wearing the sacred thread belongs empirically to the jiva, "like the heroine's fragrance superimposed upon her companion." The distinction between enjoyer and witness in the "two birds" mantra is also included. The conclusion, "apart from these four modes there is no fifth way by which action could enter liberation; therefore, apart from knowledge, not even the shadow of action enters liberation," is among the finest lines of the translation.

In the same sequence comes the distinction between immutable eternity and continuity through transformation, with objections to both total and partial transformation; an extended refutation of bhedabhedavada through the discussion of co-reference in gold, bracelet, and earring; the counterexample, "a pot is not said to be the jujube contained in it, and though Chaitra and Maitra sit on the

same seat, Chaitra is not said to be Maitra"; the fact that one may know from afar that an ornament is gold while not knowing that it is an earring; and the fault of mutual dependence in difference and non-difference. The position of immutable reality is decided through the Shruti, "clay alone is real" in the doctrine of name as merely a verbal beginning. The body of Shruti passages making liberation appear to have a beginning and end—"the knower of Brahman becomes Brahman," "the knot of the heart is cut," "O Janaka, you have attained fearlessness"—is interpreted; Vamadeva's "I became Manu, I became the sun," the principle of immediate connection illustrated by "standing there, he sings," and the Nyaya-sutra sequence in which suffering, birth, activity, defects, and false knowledge disappear one after another are respectfully but only partially accepted. All these sections come into Maithili without leaving any knot of argument unresolved.

7.4 Knowledge as Object-Determined, the Shadow of Injunction, and the Fruitfulness of Statements about Established Reality

"Knowledge, although a mental modification, is nevertheless object-determined"—this Bhashya doctrine is established by distinguishing superimpositional meditation such as "the mind indeed is fire, Gautama," which is person-determined, from cognition of a familiar fire as fire, which is object-determined; and by the self-established knowledge of the identity of Brahman and Atman arising from the power of an Upanishadic sentence, like the experience of a pot in bright light. The function of apparently injunctive statements such as "it is to be seen" is explained: among injunctions "blunted like a knife used on stone," they turn outward-facing people away from "the objects of natural activity" and set them flowing "toward the inward Self." This is translated along with references to the Brihadaranyaka statements "all this that is, is the Self" (2.4.6), "by what and whom would one see?" (4.5.15), "this Self is Brahman" (2.5.19), "if a person knows the Self as 'I am this'..." (4.4.12), and Bhagavad Gita 15.20. Supplying these original locations is a valuable service to the student-reader.

In establishing the fruitfulness of statements about established reality, two unforgettable passages of the Bhamati retain their full

radiance in translation. The first is the ornate prose description of Mount Sumeru—"made of golden rock washed by the stream of the Mandakini descending from Brahmaloaka... delightful with the voices of crystal-like birds"—as an example of a declarative statement that gives pleasure. The second is the famous story of the Dravidian who does not know the Arya language: the messenger says, "Devadatta, may your prosperity increase; a son has been born to you," and the Dravidian infers comprehension of the sentence from seeing Devadatta's "horripilation, and his eyes and face blooming like a fully opened lotus." Thus the power of words is learned in relation to established realities as well. This epoch-making argument in the philosophy of language, which became a basis of later Vedantic discussion of verbal cognition, is so vivid in Maithili that it reads like a story.

7.5 Analysis of Negation and the Distinction between Figurative and False Cognition

The analysis of "a Brahmana should not be killed"—the negative particle's capacity to indicate absence, the paryudasa construction of the Prajapati vow "do not look at the rising sun," the knowledge of absence that subsides by itself "like a fire whose fuel has been exhausted," and the striking armor-and-warrior analogy, "when the armor is removed, if no arrow strikes, the warrior's life is not immediately destroyed"—presents the entire Mimamsa analysis of cessation and non-engagement with rare clarity in the translation. It is joined by the child's acquisition of word-power from the behavior of elders, with examples such as "when there is fever, eat suitable food" and "do not give your ring to a snake," and by analysis of the causal sequence from knowledge of what accomplishes the desired end, to desire, to action.

The final section distinguishes figurative and false ego-cognition: the primary meaning of "lion" in a maned animal, its secondary meaning in a brave man, and the error of one ignorant of the difference; mistaking a post for a man in evening twilight; the behavior even of the learned "like shepherds and goat-herders"; the figurative identification in relation to sons and the like, as in "Vahika is an ox," versus false self-cognition in relation to body and the like. Jivanmukti is then established: one who has abandoned

wealth and identification with wealth has no fear of theft; the Shruti says, "just as a snake's discarded slough lies dead and cast off upon an anthill, so this body lies there"; and Smriti evidence from the section on the person of steady wisdom is cited. These passages embody the practical fruit of Advaita. The analogy of an endless "chain of the blind" for the beginningless body-relation, the rejection of agency merely because of nearness to a king, and the final doctrine "I am Brahman—in this knowledge all injunctions and all other means of knowledge come to an end," together with the practical validity attached to distinctions among knowers "until the Self is ascertained," and support from the Isha Shruti, "one who knows vidya and avidya together..." for destroying avidya through avidya, bring the logical circle of the work to completion. The justification for beginning a separate treatise—"if its purport were an injunction to meditate, then its beginning would already have occurred in the treatise that begins with Athato dharmajijnasa"—returns by implication to the first sutra and closes the argument. From the standpoint of literary structure, this ring composition deserves notice.

8. Distinctive Features of the Bhamati School: As Available in This Portion

Many seed-doctrines of the Bhamati school are present in the Chatussutri portion, and the translation allows them to emerge clearly: (a) the invocation's "two kinds of indefinable avidya" and later the mention of the destruction of the two forms, "concealment and impression"; (b) "avidya is not said to reside in Brahman but in the jiva"—the Bhamati doctrine that the jiva is the locus of avidya, which forms the basis of its difference from the Vivarana view that Brahman is the locus; (c) the description of realization of Brahman as "realization born of reflection—the experiential modification of the inner organ into the form of Brahman," together with the causal role of nididhyasana established by positive and negative concomitance—the Bhamati approach in which verbal testimony gives mediate knowledge and the transformation of mind gives immediate knowledge; (d) "adhyasa depends upon non-apprehension of difference"—Advaita's assimilation of Prabhakara

material into a process of superimposition rooted in failure to apprehend difference; and (e) Vachaspati's 'Sarvatantrasvatantra' personality glimpsed through self-references to the Nyayakanika and Brahmatattvasamiksha. Without adding any interpretive commentary of his own, the translator remains faithful to the text and lets these doctrines reach the reader—fulfilling the classical ideal of "translator invisibility."

9. The Art of Translation and Richness of Language

The greatest achievement of this translation is that it fulfills its pledge of "pure Maithili" while preserving terminological precision. Its strategy can be seen at three levels. First, the handling of technical terms: where Sanskrit terms such as *adhyasa*, *anirvacaniya*, *samanadhikarana*, *pratyabhijna*, *anyonyashraya*, *arthapatti*, *samyoga-prithaktva*, *kutastha*, and *upadana* are indispensable, they are retained, but each is accompanied by a Maithili explanation at first use. Second, Maithilization of sentence structure: long Sanskrit sentences woven from compounds are broken into expressions such as "The point is—", "Suppose.", "What is being said is—", "He answers this by...", and "This is the intention," so that the pace and pauses of scholastic debate become clear. The rendering of "nanu" as "Suppose" is so consistent that the reader never loses track of the movement between *purvapaksha* and *siddhanta*. Third, the judicious use of native idiom: "one blind man holds another blind man's hand and falls at every step," "barley pudding is not salty," "even a thousand scriptures together cannot turn a pot into cloth," "even a thousand craftsmen cannot make cloth out of a pot," "inquiry into something meaningless, like examining the teeth of an arrow"—all these passages transform Sanskrit logical maxims into Maithili folk speech.

In word choice, native expressions for "light," "darkness," "smile," "calf," "ring," "slough," "anthill," "twilight haze," "shepherd," "husk," "mortar," "weaver," and "potter" give philosophical prose the scent of lived life, yet seriousness is nowhere weakened by excessive rusticity. Agreement of gender and number, the respectful verbal form used for Brahman, the Atman,

and the Acharya as distinct from the ordinary form, and the disciplined restriction of the nukta to only the two specified dotted retroflex letters make the stability of spelling throughout the text noteworthy to the reviewer and bear witness to the labor of the "AUDIT_CORRECTED" edition.

From the standpoint of translation theory, the work belongs to the category "faithful to meaning but independent in expression"—it never departs from the original sequence of reasoning, examples, and proofs, yet its sentence structure is wholly Maithili. Numbered source references, including locations in the Brihadaranyaka and Bhagavad Gita, increase its usefulness to readers. Even in the most difficult passages—such as the discussion of bhavana, "the verbal root conveys the sense of production"; the divisions of injunction into fruit-injunction, application-injunction, performance-injunction, and origin-injunction; and the analysis of what is enjoined in the sentence concerning the Agneya sacrifice—the translation remains readable without loss of meaning. This is constructive work toward a Maithili technical vocabulary of Mimamsa, with far-reaching significance.

10. Evaluation from Indian and Western Critical Perspectives

Measured by the standards of Indian poetics, this translation is an exemplar of the quality of prasada—clarity of expression despite profundity of meaning—and "evenness," a uniform compositional style, is its abiding feature as classical prose. From the perspective of vakrokti, Vachaspati's ironic obliquity—"poor cognition's... good fortune," "unfortunate partiality"—is preserved in translation, giving flavor to scholastic debate: Brahman without attributes is the basis of the peaceful rasa, while the play of reasoning appears as its transitory mood. From the standpoint of propriety, the three decisions to render verses in prose, retain technical terminology, and use proverbs with discrimination are all appropriate.

In the language of Western translation theory, this translation balances a "source-oriented" strategy, faithful to the original, with a "target-oriented" strategy, faithful to the reader: complete fidelity to the source in the structure of reasoning, complete fidelity to the

target language in expression. From a hermeneutic perspective, it is a "translation of a commentary"—a reconstructive interpretation of an interpretation—and this double responsibility, maintaining the levels of Shankara's Bhashya sentence and Vachaspati's commentary sentence, is met by a clear separation between quoted Bhashya passages and expository prose. From the standpoint of intellectual history, the discussions in this text of theories of error, self-luminosity, the object-determined/person-determined distinction, and the capacity of statements about established realities to produce verbal cognition offer rich material for comparative study by students of modern epistemology, semantics, and philosophy of consciousness. Through the medium of Maithili, this dialogue has now become possible; this is the intellectual-historical contribution of the translation.

11. Its Place in Maithili Literature and in the Context of Videha

Vachaspati Mishra was a Maithil—this proud statement is repeatedly made in Maithili, but his works were not in Maithili. This translation turns that pride into a body of text. Within Videha's book series, a Maithili bridge is being built to classical Sanskrit works, and the inclusion of a philosophical work such as the Bhamati proves that Maithili is not only a language of songs and stories but also a capable vehicle for the most rigorous scholastic debate. The inner connection of this translation with Mithila's Nyaya-Mimamsa tradition—in which Vachaspati himself stands, followed by the Tattvacintamani line of Gangesha Upadhyaya—is clear: the Bhamati's debates over error and validity are part of the background to later Navya-Nyaya. Therefore, the availability of the Bhamati in Maithili constitutes a reclamation of Mithila's own intellectual history. At university level it is fit to serve as a foundational text for philosophy courses, research, and training in scholastic debate through Maithili.

12. Some Observations and Suggestions

Amid the overall accuracy, a few subtle points deserve attention in a future edition. (1) The form "aparokksha" occurs seven times in

the text whereas the correct "aparoksha" occurs four times; this variation should be standardized. (2) The copyright line prints "Preeti Thakar"; the intended form appears to be "Preeti Thakur." (3) In the enumeration of the three transformations, where the sentence "According to the characteristic of dharma, three types are stated—" occurs, the numbered list does not follow immediately and the explanation comes in the next paragraph; a linking sentence could make the flow easier. (4) For greater usefulness, a future edition could add a Maithili-Sanskrit glossary of technical terms, typographical differentiation among the sutra, bhashya, and tika levels, and an index of adhikaranas. These are suggestions for refinement, not a catalogue of faults—the small number of slips in this vast text of pages 1–491 itself proves the success of the "AUDIT" process.

13. Conclusion

Gajendra Thakur's translation of the Chatussutri-Bhamati is a standard-setting work in the history of Maithili prose. It performs three tasks at once—it transfers Vachaspati's edifice of reasoning intact into Maithili, creates a Maithili model of the technical vocabulary of Mimamsa, Nyaya, and Vedanta, and brings Mithila's own philosophical heritage back into Mithila's own language. From the subtlest debate on theories of error in the Adhyasa-Bhashya to the vast scholastic argument of the Samanvayadhikarana, no link in the reasoning breaks and nowhere does the language become strained. "Just as water from a royal road becomes pure when it falls into the current of the Ganga"—Vachaspati's humble declaration can be reversed and applied to this translation: the Acharya's stream of the Ganga has now reached the royal road of Mithila, and every traveler may bathe in it. This work will remain a reference pillar for Maithili philosophical literature for a long time, and readers of this edition will naturally await the arrival in Maithili of the rest of the Bhamati, from the remaining portion of the first chapter through the fourth chapter.

14. Overall Judgment

The importance of this pure Maithili rendering of the Chatussutri-Bhamati lies not merely in the fact that a Sanskrit philosophical work has become available in Maithili. Its real achievement is that the sequence of reasoning on such extremely difficult subjects as adhyasa, avidya, indefinability, the self-luminosity of the Atman, the practical and ultimate limits of means of knowledge, the relation between action and knowledge, the eternity of liberation, the independent validity of Vedantic statements, and the experience of the identity of Brahman and Atman proceeds in Maithili without breaking. Because the sequence of examples, purvapaksha, reply, renewed objection, solution, and conclusion is preserved, the reader sees not merely conclusions but the entire process of scholastic debate. In this respect, the work is concrete evidence of the capacity, discipline, and future of Maithili philosophical prose.

Appendix: Pure Maithili Translation of Bhamati

Bhamati [Vachaspati's Commentary on Shankara's
Brahmasutra Bhashya]

Original Sanskrit: Vachaspati Mishra • Sanskrit-to-Maithili Translation:
Gajendra Thakur

The fields of the two notions, “you” and “I”—the object and the subject—are, by their very natures, opposed to one another like darkness and light. When it is established that the nature of one cannot intelligibly be that of the other, it is even less intelligible that the attributes of one should become united in the substratum of the other. Therefore, the superimposition upon the conscious Self, the subject that is the field of the notion “I,” of the object that is the field of the notion “you” and of its attributes; and conversely, owing to error in this matter, the superimposition of the subject and its attributes upon the object—can in truth occur only as false superimposition. Nevertheless, because the distinction between mutually and completely different attributes, and likewise between their different substrata, is not apprehended, there arises the natural usage “I am this” and “this is mine,” through the superimposition of each upon the other, both in nature and in attributes. In this usage truth and falsehood are mingled, and its cause is erroneous cognition.

Salutations to that immortal Brahman, whose nature is immeasurable bliss and knowledge; who, as Lord, makes the two kinds of indefinable Avidya his ministers and brings about the false manifestation of ether, air, fire, water, and earth; and from whom this entire world of the moving and the unmoving, the high and the low, has arisen.

The Vedas are His breath, the five great elements are His sight, the moving and unmoving world is His smile, and His sleep is the great dissolution.

Salutations to the eternal Veda and to Bhava; the Veda is endowed with six limbs, and Bhava is possessed of many imperishable qualities, or avyayas.

Salutations to Martanda, Tilakasvamin, and Mahaganapati; all are worthy of universal worship and grant the fruits of every desire.

Salutations to Vyasa, the author of the Brahmasutras, the second creator, and an incarnation of the power of knowledge of Lord Hari.

Having bowed to Shankara, whose nature is stainless knowledge and who is an ocean of compassion, I begin the analysis of the lucid yet profound Bhashya composed by him.

Just as water from the royal road becomes pure when it falls into the stream of the Ganga, so the trifling words of people such as myself become sanctified when joined to the work of the Acharya.

Adhyasa

Now, an object about which there is no doubt, or knowledge of which serves no purpose, cannot become an object that a discriminating inquirer desires to know. For example, a pot present in bright light and brought into contact with the visual organ accompanied by the mind; or the teeth of a crow. The case of Brahman is just the same, because the knowledge opposed to the condition in which the properties pervaded by inquiry—doubt and purpose—are present is already available here. The point is this: only the Self is called Brahman, because it is great or because it makes everything grow.

This Self is known through the undisputed, unerring, and immediate experience of “I” as distinct from the body, the senses, the mind, the intellect, their objects, and, in brief, everything capable of being denoted by the word “this.” This experience is present in all living beings, from worms and insects up to gods and sages; therefore the Self cannot be an object of the desire to know.

Indeed, no one doubts, “Is this I or not?” nor does anyone make the error, “This is absolutely not I.” Nor is it proper to say that because judgments such as “I am thin, I am fat” and “I am going” are seen to be used in coordination with attributes of the body, the body is the substratum of the word “I.” If the body were its substratum, there could be no recognition such as, “I, who enjoyed myself with my parents in childhood, now in old age enjoy myself with my grandchildren.”

There is in fact not the slightest mark of recognition between the youthful body and the aged body by which their identity could be ascertained. Therefore, that which remains continuously the same amid changing things is different from them—just as the thread that strings flowers together is different from the flowers. In the same way, the principle denoted by the word “I,” which persists through the bodily changes of childhood, youth, and so forth, is distinct from those bodies.

Moreover, a person who in a dream assumes a divine body and enjoys pleasures appropriate to it, upon waking and finding himself endowed with a human body, says, “I am not a god; I am a human being.” Here the divine body is sublated, while the substratum of “I-

ness,” distinct from the body, is experienced without sublation. Again, a person who through yogic power becomes a tiger experiences the identity of the Self despite the difference of body; therefore the body is not the substratum of “I-ness.”

Nor are the senses its substratum, because despite the senses being different, recognition of the substratum of “I-ness” occurs in the statement, “What I myself saw, I am now touching.” That the Self is distinct from objects is exceedingly direct. The intellect and the mind are merely instruments; therefore these instruments cannot in reality be the substratum of the cognition “I,” which apprehends the agent.

Although the body and the Self are not identical, statements such as “I am thin” and “I am blind” are made. In my view, their meaning should be understood figuratively, just as the statement “The long hall is shouting” means that the people seated in the long hall are shouting. Thus it is established that the Self, distinct from the body, senses, mind, intellect, objects, and in brief from everything capable of being denoted by “this,” is known through the exceedingly clear experience of “I”; and because there is no doubt, it is not an object of the desire to know.

The Self is not an object of inquiry also because inquiry into it serves no purpose. The point is this: liberation, in the form of cessation of transmigration, is the intended fruit to be taught here. Non-experience of the true nature of the Self is the cause of transmigration, and that transmigration is to cease through knowledge of the true nature of the Self.

If beginningless transmigration continues together with beginningless knowledge of the true nature of the Self, then, since there is no opposition between the two, how can the former cease? And how can there be non-experience of the true nature of the Self? Apart from the experience of “I,” there is no other cognition of the true nature of the Self. This Self, distinct from the body, senses, and so forth, is established by the exceedingly clear experience of “I” that is equally present in all human beings; because it would contradict experience, even a thousand Upanishads cannot negate it. Even a thousand scriptures together cannot turn a pot into cloth. Therefore, because they would contradict experience, in my view

the statements of the Upanishads should be understood in a secondary sense.

Keeping these considerations in mind, an objection is raised, and the commentator answers it with the words, “The fields of the two notions...” and so forth.

From “The fields of the two notions...” through “can in truth occur only as false superimposition” is the statement of the objection. The answer begins with “Nevertheless.” In relation to the “Nevertheless” of the answer, the word “although” should be understood as supplied in the statement of the objection. Where the fields of the two notions “this” and “I” were to be stated, the word “you” has been used in place of “this” in order to show the complete difference between these two sides of experience.

The word “you” is more opposed to the word “I” than the word “this” is, because usages such as “I am this” and “I am that” are widely found.

The Self, whose nature is consciousness, is the subject; the inert intellect, senses, body, and external objects are objects of cognition. For they delimit the conscious Self, that is, they present it in determinate and limited forms through their own respective forms. The complete difference that forms the basis for the impossibility of mutual superimposition is illustrated by the words “like darkness and light.” No one can ever understand utterly different things such as light and darkness as being the nature of one another. This is what the sentence says: “When it is established that the nature of one cannot intelligibly be that of the other.” For one to be the other means that the nature of one is present in the other, that is, that the two are identical; this is unintelligible.

Very well. The different substrata—the Self and the non-Self—may not be mutually identical; nevertheless, their attributes, such as inertness and consciousness, permanence and impermanence, may be mutually superimposed. Even when substrata are known to be different, the superimposition of their attributes is observed. For example, a crystal is known to be different from a flower; yet because of its complete transparency, when the reflection of a hibiscus falls upon it, an illusion of redness arises in the experience “red crystal.”

To this it is said, “Then its qualities also...” The presence of an attribute belonging to one substratum in another substratum—that is, the mutual transference of attributes—is unintelligible. The intention is this: only a substance possessing color, by virtue of complete transparency, receives the reflection of another colored substance, even though that other substance is known to be different from it.

But the conscious Self is a colorless subject; it cannot receive the reflection of an object. Followers of the Bhatta school also say, “In what way could there be a reflection of sound, smell, taste, and so forth?”

Therefore, when the remaining alternatives are eliminated, the conclusion is that mutual transference of the attributes eternally connected with the object and the subject could occur only on the basis of a mutual relation between these two substrata. If these two substrata were known as completely different and remained mutually unrelated, their attributes would be still more clearly unrelated, because, with their respective substrata intervening, those attributes would be even farther removed from one another. This is what is expressed by the words “even less...” and so forth.

“The cause of error in this matter” means the cause of error concerning the object. The word “false” conveys concealment. What is being said is this: superimposition is dependent upon non-apprehension of difference; conversely, apprehension of difference is present here. This apprehension removes the non-apprehension of difference, and it also removes the superimposition dependent upon that non-apprehension. The syntactic connection of the sentence is: “Although this could in truth occur only as false superimposition, nevertheless...”

The implied intention of this statement is as follows. (a) All this would be correct only if the true nature of the Self were manifested in the experience of “I.” But that is not so. The point is this: in Shruti, Smriti, Itihasa, and Purana, the true nature of the Self is said to be free from all limiting adjuncts, a homogeneous reality of infinite bliss and consciousness, indifferent, one, and non-dual. Statements whose purport is to teach the Self in this form cannot be reduced even by Indra to a secondary meaning, because of their

opening, middle, and concluding statements and their purposeful repetition. For repetition establishes the importance of the subject—as in “Ah, beautiful! Ah, beautiful!”—not its insignificance; and secondary meaning is still farther removed from it.

The experience of “I” presents the Self as limited and mixed with many kinds of suffering and grief; how then can this experience have the true nature of the Self as its object? Or how can it be an unerring experience? Nor can it be said that Shruti conflicts with perception, and since perception is an older and senior means of knowledge, Shruti, which depends upon perception, should be considered invalid or secondary. Shruti is authorless, entirely free even from the possibility of defect, and the very fact that it produces cognition makes its validity self-revealing; therefore, with respect to its fruit, namely true knowledge, Shruti is independent of other means of knowledge.

If it is said that although Shruti is independent with respect to the cognition it produces, it depends upon perception with respect to its own origination, and because perception contradicts it, the cognition from Shruti will not arise, so that the invalidity of Shruti follows—the answer is: no, because there is no contradiction with its origination.

Knowledge born of Shruti does not destroy the practical validity of perception; otherwise, through absence of its own cause, it would not arise at all. It negates only the ultimate validity of perception. Nor is the cause of scriptural knowledge a perception that is ultimately true, because true knowledge is observed to arise from instruments that are valid at the practical level even though they are not ultimately valid.

For example, the properties of shortness and length belong not to letters but to sounds, yet they are superimposed upon letters and become causes of correct comprehension of meaning. In ordinary usage, people who understand different objects such as a tree and an elephant respectively from the words “naga” and “naga” are not in fact regarded as deluded.

It is not proper to regard a word that has no other purport as being used secondarily with respect to its own meaning. It has been said, “In an injunctive sentence, the meaning of a word cannot be

different from its primary meaning.” Priority of a cognition that does not depend upon another can be a ground for that cognition’s being sublated, not a ground for sublating another means of knowledge. For it is observed that the cognition of silver first arising in respect of a shell is sublated by the subsequent cognition of the shell. If the earlier cognition were not sublated, the later cognition—whose very essence is the sublation of the earlier—could not intelligibly arise. And it has already been shown that the ultimate validity of perception is not independently established.

The sutra of the great sage Jaimini says only this much: “Where the earlier and the later are connected, the earlier alternative is weaker, as in the case of a prakṛiti rite.” There is also a verse to this effect: “Where two cognitions arise successively without depending upon one another, the superiority of the later cognition over the earlier is known.”

Moreover, even according to those who take the Self to be the substratum of “I-ness,” the truth of the cognition “I” cannot be accepted. For in the judgment “I am in this dwelling and cognize,” the all-pervading Self is cognized as limited—just as, to a person standing on level ground, the huge trees on the summit of a high mountain appear like blades of grass.

Nor can it be said that the experienced limitation belongs to the body and not to the Self. If that were so, the experience would not take the form “I am” and so forth; and if the word “I” were taken as being used secondarily for the body, the experience would not take the form “I cognize” either.

Only when both the speaker and the hearer who understands the meaning accept that a word denotes some other thing is its use secondary; such use arises after knowledge of difference. For example, the word “Agnihotra” ordinarily denotes the obligatory rite bearing that name. But in the context of a rite of a different nature connected with the Kundapayinam Ayana, in the sentence “He offers the month-long Agnihotra,” the word “Agnihotra” is used secondarily on the basis of similarity in the end achieved by the two rites. Likewise, the word “lion” is used secondarily for a pupil known from experience to be different from a lion.

But here the primary referent of the word “I” is not experienced as definitely and clearly distinct from the body and so forth; only after such an experience could the word “I” be used secondarily for the body and so on. Nor can it be maintained that through long usage a word may become conventionally established in a secondary meaning so that its secondary character is no longer known—as with “taila,” whose literal meaning is sesame oil, but which is used for mustard oil. For even there, only after difference has first been established with respect to extraction from sesame or another seed, oiliness, and so forth, does the supposition arise that mustard oil and the like are principally “taila,” and they are denoted by that word. But the identity of sesame oil and mustard oil is not thereby established. The conclusion, therefore, is that in the case of those who know both the primary and secondary meanings, secondary usage is invariably accompanied by knowledge of difference. When the pervader, namely knowledge of difference, is absent here, the secondary usage pervaded by it also disappears.

Nor can it be said that although the youthful and aged bodies are different, in the judgment “I am that same one” there is recognition of one and the same Self, and thus experience of a Self distinct from the body and so forth is established. In fact, such a judgment belongs to a critical inquirer engaged in reflection on reality, not to ordinary people. In practical life even critical inquirers do not rise above the level of ordinary people. The revered commentator later says this very thing in the words “there is no difference from animals and so forth...” Adherents of other schools also say, “Only those who reflect upon scriptural instruction make this distinction, not those who merely receive the text.” Therefore, when the other alternatives are eliminated, it is proper to accept that the ordinary person who says “I am in this dwelling” and so forth understands the Self itself as limited, just as space is understood as limited by a pot, jar, vessel, and so on.

In order to preserve the validity of the use of the word “I,” it is not proper to say that the Self, like the body and so forth, is also limited. Its size would then have to be either like an atom or like the body. If it were atomic, usages such as “I am fat” or “I am tall” would not occur; if it were the size of the body, then because it

would be a composite of parts like the body, it would be established as impermanent.

On this view it must also be admitted either that the aggregate of parts cognizes, or that each part itself cognizes. If each part cognized independently, then, because there would be no agreement among many independent consciousnesses, actions would occur simultaneously in opposite directions and the body would be thrown into disorder, or no action would occur at all. If consciousness were held to belong to the aggregate of parts, then when one part were injured the conscious Self would not understand itself to be partially injured. Nor is any stable relation of coexistence among the many parts observed. When any one part is destroyed, the aggregate lacking that part cannot cognize.

If cognition itself is taken to be the substratum of the notion “I,” its falsity still remains, because the notion “I” apprehends a permanent substance, whereas cognitions are momentary. Thus statements such as “I am fat, I am blind, I am going” would have to be understood as arising from superimposition.

Thus, when the basis of the notion “I” has been shown to be groundless like rotten soil, the revered Shruti can unobstructedly remove from the Self the notions of agency, enjoyership, pleasure, pain, grief, and so forth that arise as consequences of the experience of “I.” Therefore, in the words “superimposing each upon the other” and so forth, the nature, cause, and result of the notion “I” have been elaborated; its falsity is well known from all authoritative Shruti, Smriti, Itihasa, and Purana. Of the two substrata, body and Self, the nature of one is superimposed upon the other. For example, in “I am this body,” identification with “this” is an event of practical usage, not a cognitive judgment. “Ordinary usage” means worldly conduct, that is, an expression such as “I am this.” The word “iti” in the statement “I am this” indicates such actions as accepting or abandoning things understood by valid cognition to be beneficial or harmful to the body.

The attribute of one substratum is also superimposed upon the other. For example, upon the Self on which the body and so forth have been superimposed are superimposed the bodily properties of

birth, death, old age, disease, and so forth; and upon the body and so forth, on which Selfhood has been superimposed, are superimposed the attributes of the Self such as consciousness. As a result there arises ordinary usage or verbal expression such as “This old age, death, son, cow, ownership, and so forth is mine.” The word “iti” in the statement “this is mine” indicates action and the like in conformity with the experience just described.

The statement that “ordinary conduct takes place after superimposition” is reasonable, because the agent of both acts—superimposition and ordinary conduct—is taken to be the same person. By showing that superimposition is temporally prior to ordinary conduct, it becomes clear that superimposition is the cause of ordinary conduct. This alone is intended by the statement “ordinary conduct together with its cause in the form of false cognition” and so forth. “False cognition” is superimposition; with it as the cause, the existence or nonexistence of ordinary conduct follows the existence or nonexistence of superimposition.

Having thus stated the nature of superimposition and its fruit, namely ordinary conduct, the commentator states its cause with the words “because the distinction between one and the other is not apprehended,” that is, because their separateness is not understood. A question arises here: if there were absolutely no difference between the two, failure to apprehend difference would be natural; but then how could superimposition occur? The answer is given by the words “completely different attributes and substrata.” From the ultimate standpoint, difference means non-identity of the substrata and non-mixture of their attributes.

Granted. The illusion of identity produced by failure to understand the distinction between two real things is intelligible—as in the illusion of silver in a shell when the distinction between the shell and silver is not understood. But here, apart from the conscious Self that is the supreme reality, there is no real thing such as the body. Whence then comes the failure to understand its distinction from the conscious Self, and whence the illusion of identity? The answer is: “because truth is joined with falsehood.” The construction of the sentence is that, through non-apprehension of difference—that is, by joining truth and falsehood—each is superimposed upon the other. The truth is the conscious Self; the

false are the intellect, senses, body, and so forth. To join these two substrata is itself the “joining.” Since a real conjunction of the phenomenal world with ultimate truth is impossible, the original expression uses a form implying “making into a pair” rather than a literal union, conveying the sense that something becomes as though what it is not. What is being said is this: superimposition of something that does not appear at all is impossible; therefore cognition of the superimposed thing is necessary, not its real existence.

Granted. When there is cognition of the thing to be superimposed, what was previously seen is superimposed; but that cognition itself is conditioned by superimposition. It therefore seems difficult to avoid the defect of mutual dependence. The answer lies in the word “natural.” This ordinary conduct is natural and beginningless. By stating the beginninglessness of conduct, the beginninglessness of its cause—superimposition—is also stated. Thus intellect, senses, body, and so forth continue to appear in each preceding false cognition, and at each subsequent occasion superimposition occurs again. Since this process is beginningless like the succession of seed and sprout, there is no defect of mutual dependence here.

Very well. Superimposition requires only a prior appearance; it does not require the ultimate reality of the appearing object. But if body, senses, and so forth were utterly unreal, like a lotus lake in the sky, even their appearance would be unintelligible. Even the reality of the conscious Self consists only in its luminosity; there is no principle distinct from that, such as inherence in a class called existence or causal efficacy, for admitting such a principle would produce duality. Again, if another existence and another causal efficacy were required to establish the reality of this existence and causal efficacy, there would be infinite regress. Therefore luminosity alone must be accepted as the nature of reality. Consequently, because body and so forth appear, they would not be unreal; they too would become real like the conscious Self. If they are unreal, they cannot appear; how then can truth and falsehood be joined?

Here it may be asked: what is this thing called superimposition? The answer is: the appearance elsewhere, in a form resembling

memory, of something previously seen. Some say that superimposition is the attribution elsewhere of the properties of one thing. Others hold that when one thing is superimposed upon another, superimposition is the illusion produced by failure to apprehend the distinction between the two. Still others say that when one thing is superimposed upon another, contrary properties are imagined in the latter. But whatever the view, none falls outside the characteristic that one thing appears as though endowed with the properties of another. Our ordinary experience is also precisely this: a shell appears like silver, and one moon appears together with another, that is, as two.

The words “previously seen” and so forth in this definition are further explained as follows. “The appearance of what was seen before” means the manifestation of an object previously seen. False appearance is impossible without a conjunction of the superimposed element and that upon which it is superimposed; therefore the words “previously seen” indicate the superimposed and unreal element. The word “seen” is intended to show that the superimposed element is only empirically real, not ultimately real. Yet what is presently being seen cannot be what is superimposed; therefore the word “previously” is used. Though the thing previously seen is true in its own form, in its superimposed form it is indefinable and therefore false. The true substratum of superimposition is expressed by the words “elsewhere”; this “elsewhere” is the shell and the like, which is ultimately real. In this way the conjunction of truth and falsehood is stated.

Granted. The definition “the appearance elsewhere of something previously seen” is too broad, because in the cow named Kalakshi there is the perception of cowhood previously seen in the cow Svastimati. Likewise, when Devadatta previously seen at Pataliputra is seen at Mahishmati, there is the perception elsewhere of that same Devadatta. Both are valid cognitions. The word “appearance” is also well known in connection with valid experience, as in “the appearance of blue” and “the appearance of yellow.” The answer is given by the words “in a form resembling memory.” Its form is like the form of memory. In memory, absence of the object is the essential feature, whereas in valid recognition there is cognition of

the presently existing object. Therefore the definition is not too broad.

Nor is the definition too narrow, because dream cognition, whose form resembles erroneous memory, also falls under this definition. In a dream, owing to the defect of sleep, attention is not given to the present absence of remembered parents and others; therefore the time and place in which they had previously been seen as present are superimposed upon the present experience.

The same definition also applies to experiences such as “the shell is yellow” and “sugar is bitter.” The process is this: the yellow color situated in bile that has come into contact with an exceedingly clear ray issuing from the eye is experienced as separate from the bile; the shell too is experienced, but owing to a defect of the sense organ its whiteness remains concealed. The non-relation of the yellow color to the shell is not experienced. Because this non-apprehension of non-relation resembles earlier experiences such as “a heap of yellow gold” or “a yellow bael fruit,” the relation of co-location previously seen there is superimposed upon yellowness and shellhood, and the person says “yellow shell.” The experience “sugar is bitter” is to be explained in the same way.

In the same way, the ray of the visual organ comes into contact with a clear mirror or sheet of water in front; but, overpowered by the stronger rays of the sun, it is reflected from there, comes into contact with the face, and produces cognition of the face. Owing to a defect, it does not apprehend the face in its real location—that is, in the direction opposite itself—but superimposes upon the face the property, previously seen in the mirror or sheet of water, of facing toward itself. Thus the definition applies also to the illusion of reflection. In the same way should be explained the illusion of seeing two moons, error concerning direction, the circle of a firebrand, a mirage in the form of a celestial city, and the illusion of seeing a snake inside a bamboo.

What is being said is this: mere manifestation is not reality; otherwise the body, senses, and so forth would become real merely because they appear. It is not that a rope and the like do not appear as a snake, or that a crystal and the like do not appear as endowed with redness; yet despite appearing in such forms, they do not

actually become a snake and so forth, nor are they really endowed with those attributes. If they were, then one would have to accept that in a mirage the Mandakini itself, with constantly moving high and low waves, had descended nearby; and a person who ran there could drink that water and quench his thirst. Therefore, even though a superimposed object appears, its ultimate reality cannot be accepted, however unwelcome that conclusion may be.

Nor is it proper to ask: the water of a mirage is unreal, but the mirage itself is ultimately real in its own form; whereas the body, senses, and so forth are unreal even in their own form and therefore cannot be objects of experience—how then can they be superimposed? If an unreal object can never be an object of any experience, how does the unreal mirage become an object of experience as water and so forth? Even though a mirage is real in its own form, it cannot be real in the form of water and the like.

It may be said that there is no entity called “absence” distinct from positive being. One existing thing is called absent with respect to the form of another existing thing, while in its own form it is positive being. It has been said: “Absence is merely another positive entity considered in relation to another thing.” Thus absence can be regarded as another mode of positive being and made an object of experience. But how can a world that is utterly unreal, devoid of all efficacy, and without any real essence become an object of experience? And how can it be superimposed upon the conscious Self?

Nor can it be accepted that although the objects of experience are utterly devoid of any capacity to manifest themselves, their respective cognitions, through a power residing within cognition itself as cognition, produce the appearance of unreal objects as a particular kind of transformation; and that this power of cognition, which manifests the unreal, is Avidya. The question is: what is this power of cognition by which it manifests the unreal? What does it do with respect to an unreal object? If the object is unreal, does it produce it, or merely illuminate it? It cannot produce it, because the production of the unreal is unintelligible. Nor can it illuminate it, because no cognition other than this very cognition that illuminates it is known. Again, the thing thus manifested is unreal; its relation to a fresh cognition would then have to be explained, leading to

infinite regress. If it is said that manifesting the unreal is simply the nature of cognition, then what is this relation between truth and falsehood? If it is said that the relation between valid cognition and an unreal object is such that the former, namely valid cognition, is determined under the control of the unreal object—ah! what extraordinary good fortune for poor cognition, that it acquires determinacy even from the unreal! Nor does cognition perform any action upon that unreal object, because it is improper to suppose that an unreal object can be the substratum of such an action. If it is said that cognition is not subordinate to the unreal, but that it is simply the nature of cognition never to appear apart from the unreal—ah! what unfortunate partiality in favor of the unreal, by which cognition is always bound to it, although cognition is neither produced by the unreal nor of the same nature as it. Therefore, the body, senses, and so forth, which are utterly unreal and devoid of real existence, cannot be objects of experience.

Our answer here is this: if what lacks real existence cannot enter the field of experience, are these rays then really water, so that they may become objects of experience? The opponent says: there is no real existence of water in the rays, because the rays are not of the nature of water. The existence of a thing is twofold: true with respect to its own nature and false with respect to something different from itself. It has been said: “At any time a person apprehends the existence of a thing as true or false either with respect to that thing's own nature or with respect to another thing.” Our answer is: does the cognition of water in the rays fall within the sphere of truth? Then, being valid, it would be neither erroneous nor sublated. The opponent again says: certainly it would not be sublated if the rays were understood not as water but as something different from water. But when the rays are understood as water, how can that cognition be unerring or unsublated? Our answer then is: the waterness superimposed upon rays whose nature is non-water is not true, because those rays, being identical with non-waterness, cannot intelligibly be of the nature of waterness. But that waterness is not false either, because you yourself admit that “absence is nothing but a positive entity in another form, not anything else, since no such separate entity is established.” That is, the falsity of one thing is only another thing. Yet the superimposed

form is not another thing either. If it were, it would be either the ray or water of the Ganga. On the first alternative the cognition would take the form “ray,” not “water”; on the second it would take the form “water of the Ganga,” not “water here.” Even if the particular place were not remembered, the cognition should be merely “water,” not “here.” Nor can it be accepted that it is utterly false, an illusory object devoid of all existence, because it has already been said that such a thing cannot intelligibly enter the field of experience. Therefore the water superimposed upon the rays must be regarded as indefinable: it is neither true, nor false, nor both true and false, because the last alternative is self-contradictory. Thus the superimposed water appears like ultimately real water and for that reason seems like water previously seen; but in reality it is neither water nor the water previously seen; it is false and indefinable. In the same way, the body, senses, and the entire world are indefinable. Though new, they are superimposed upon another substratum—the conscious Self—as though they were objects presented in preceding erroneous cognition. The definition of superimposition given above applies perfectly here. The sublation of the world consisting of body, senses, and so forth will be explained later. The conscious Self is the subject matter of Shruti, Smriti, Itihasa, and Purana; when ascertained by reasoning based upon and not opposed to these, its nature is purity, consciousness, and freedom, and it is definitely established as true. Its unsublated self-luminosity itself is its truth; this is the very nature of the conscious Self, not an attribute different from it, such as inherence in a class called existence or causal efficacy. Thus everything is clear.

All inquirers accept the indefinable superimposition defined above, but there is considerable disagreement regarding its finer details. Therefore, in order firmly to establish its indefinability, the commentator says, “Some people describe it thus,” and so forth.

“Of another's attribute” means here the attribute of a cognition whose object is silver, or the form of the cognition. Superimposition occurs “elsewhere,” that is, in an external object. According to the Sautrantika view, external existence is real; superimposition is the attribution of the form of cognition to that external object. According to the Vijñānavāda view, though there is no external

reality, an external falsity is produced by the impressions of beginningless Avidya, and the form of cognition is superimposed upon that. The support for this view is as follows: the general rule is that whatever is experienced in a particular form should be accepted in precisely that form, because difference from that form is established only when a stronger cognition sublates it. Although it is possible to interpret the sublating cognition “This is not silver” as sublating only the element “this,” it is not proper to extend its sublation to the silver-element. If the substratum “silver” were sublated, then both silver and its attribute of “thisness” would be sublated; therefore it is more reasonable to hold that only the attribute of “thisness” is sublated, not the substratum silver. Consequently, when the externality of silver is sublated, that silver is inferentially taken to be confined within our cognition. Thus the external superimposition of an object that is the form of cognition is established.

“But some others”—that is, those not satisfied with the doctrine that the form of cognition is superimposed—say that “when one thing is superimposed upon another, there is an illusion arising from non-apprehension of the distinction between the two.” They state the reason for their dissatisfaction thus: that silver and the like are forms of cognition must be established either by experience, namely perception, or by inference. The inference on this matter will be refuted later. As for perception, it would have to be either the cognition of silver or the cognition that sublates it. The experience of silver does not indicate that silver is of the form of cognition, because it reveals silver as an external object situated on the substratum “this,” not as an internal object. Otherwise, because knower and cognition would be identical, the cognition would take the form “I am silver.” The proponent of Atmakhyati may say: erroneous cognition determines its own form as external; therefore its object is not the substratum of the word “I.” Its being the form of cognition is understood from the sublating cognition. To this we reply: ah! let the long-lived gentleman examine this sublating cognition. Does it distinguish the object present before us from silver, or does it also tell us that its nature is a form of cognition? Let the gods praise the intelligence of the person who says that the sublating cognition reveals the previously experienced object as

being of the nature of cognition! If it is said that from the denial of the presence of silver before us its being a form of cognition is inferred, that too is incorrect; for from denial of failure to apprehend remoteness, the object would be established as distant from the knower—how then would the extreme nearness of the knower's own nature follow? This sublating cognition negates neither silver nor “thisness”; it negates only the practical usage concerning silver that arose from failure to apprehend their difference. Nor does the cognition of silver in a shell itself produce silver, because it is contrary to experience to say that the manifestation of silver can have the shell as its substratum. Nor can it be said that the shell is the substratum merely as an existent thing, not as a known thing; for then the definition of substratum would be overextended, since existence is common to all things and anything could become the substratum. Nor is the shell the substratum as a cause of cognition, because the sense organ too is a cause. Thus the word “substratum” can mean only “that which is manifest.” But in the cognition of silver the shell is not manifest; how then is it the substratum? If its manifestation is accepted, how does this not contradict experience? Again, when the senses and so forth are seen to possess the capacity to produce valid cognition, how can erroneous cognition arise from them? If it is said that through conjunction with a defect they acquire the capacity to produce erroneous cognition, no; for a defect can only obstruct a cause's capacity to produce its proper effect. Otherwise, even a banyan sprout could arise from a dried seed of kutaja. Again, if cognition were not restricted to its proper object, confidence in everything would be destroyed. Therefore it must be accepted that every cognition is valid.

Thus the two cognitions, “silver” and “this,” are of two kinds: memory and experience. Here “this” is the apprehension merely of the object present before us; owing to a defect, the shellhood present there is not apprehended. The mere “that” which had previously been apprehended, because of similarity, awakens the impression of the former experience of silver and produces a memory of silver. Although that memory is of the nature of apprehension of an object previously apprehended, it remains merely as apprehension; because of the defect, the aspect

“previously apprehended” belonging to its object disappears. For this reason the distinction between the memory of silver and the apprehension of the mere object present before us—whether in their own cognitive forms or in relation to their objects—is not apprehended. Consequently, because they resemble a cognition of silver actually produced by sense-contact, these two cognitions called “this” and “silver,” though different as perception and memory, produce practical usage and co-ordinate predication as though they were one. In some cases there are two perceptions whose mutual difference is not apprehended, as in “the shell is yellow.” In this situation, as in the example of a transparent crystal, the yellowness of bile present in the ray of light issuing from the eye is apprehended, but the bile itself is not apprehended. Owing to some defect the shell too is apprehended merely as existing, while its whiteness is not apprehended. Because non-apprehension of the non-relation between quality and qualified resembles the cognition of a heap of yellow gold, here too there arises practical usage in the form of identity and co-ordinate predication. At the time of sublation, this practical identity produced by non-apprehension of difference is sublated; therefore the sublating force of the cognition of difference in the form “not this” is understood. Understood in this way, even the erroneous character of the earlier cognition, well known in the world, is established. Thus all cognitions whose doubtful or erroneous nature is disputed are, because they are cognitions, true like the cognition of a pot. This view is explained in the words “when one thing is superimposed upon another.” The worldly superimposition of silver and the like upon a shell and the like is not governed by some other cognition; rather, on one side there is the memory of silver in which the aspect of its object has disappeared and only apprehension remains, and on the other side there is the mere object present before us in the form “this” and its cognition. The illusion arises from non-apprehension of the separateness of these two. The erroneous character consists only in speaking of memory and apprehension as co-ordinate with one another and in practical usage as silver and the like.

“But others,” who are not satisfied even with this view, say: “When one thing is superimposed upon another, contrary attributes are imagined in the latter.” The basic consideration is this: everyone

has the same experience that the cognition “this is silver” causes a person seeking silver to act toward the object before him and to use co-ordinate predication. This cannot arise merely from memory and apprehension, or from non-apprehension of the mutual difference between their respective objects; for how could the action and speech of an intelligent being, which depend upon apprehension, arise merely from non-apprehension? It has been said here that they arise not from mere non-apprehension but from memory and apprehension in which the difference of their forms and objects is not apprehended; because of their resemblance to a valid cognition of silver present before one, they produce practical usage in the form of identity and co-ordinate predication. To this the proponent of Anyathakhyati replies: the resemblance of this cognition to valid silver-cognition as a cause of practical usage must either itself be apprehended or, without being apprehended, operate merely by its existence. If it is apprehended, the cognition would have to take one of two forms: “the cognitions ‘this’ and ‘silver’ resemble a valid cognition,” or “no difference is apprehended in the nature or object of these two cognitions.” The first cognition—“this resembles a valid cognition”—cannot produce the practical usage produced by a valid cognition. The cognition “a gavaya is like a cow” does not make a person seeking a cow act toward a gavaya. The second cognition—“no difference between these two is apprehended”—is self-contradictory; for if there is non-apprehension of difference, the cognition cannot take the form “between these two,” and if “between these two” is apprehended, how can difference remain unapprehended? Thus it must be said that non-apprehension of difference, without itself being apprehended, becomes a cause of practical usage merely by its existence. The question is: does it cause practical usage by producing superimposition, or does it itself become the cause without producing superimposition? Our view is that practical usage by an intelligent being cannot intelligibly be the direct result of ignorance; therefore non-apprehension of difference becomes effective only by producing a superimposed cognition. An objection may be raised: the action of an intelligent being is not the result of ignorance, but of an apprehension and memory whose mutual difference is not known. Our answer is: not so. Mere memory of the primary meaning of the word “silver” is not a cause

of action, because it is indisputable that a person seeking silver acts toward the substratum of “thisness.” Without desire regarding the substratum of “thisness,” how could the person act toward it? To say that one desires one thing but acts for another is self-contradictory. Again, if it is not known that the substratum of “thisness” is silver, how can a person seeking silver desire it? If it is said that desire arises because the substratum of “thisness” has not been apprehended as different from silver, the reply is: when it has not been apprehended as being silver, why does the person not remain indifferent to it? Pulled in opposite directions by acceptance and indifference, this intelligent person would remain undecided; finally, through the superimposition of silver upon the substratum of “thisness,” his mind settles on acceptance. Therefore non-apprehension of difference causes the action of an intelligent person by producing superimposition. The sequence is this: because difference is not understood, the property of silver is superimposed upon the substratum of “thisness”; then the fact that an object of the class silver is beneficial is remembered; next, that beneficialness is inferred of the silver superimposed upon the substratum of “thisness,” because it belongs to the class silver; thereafter the person seeking silver acts toward that superimposed silver. Thus the sequence is established. A general memory of silver cannot help infer that the substratum of “thisness” is beneficial, because it would not be known that the probans, silverhood, resides in the subject. Inference arises from seeing the subject and probans in the same locus, not in different loci. It has been said: “Inference arises when one who knows the pervasion sees the subject and the reason in the same locus—”

pervasion). In superimposition, this perception of one locus occurs. Therefore this inference is established: the cognition of silver and the like that is under dispute has the object present before one as its object, because a person seeking silver and the like invariably acts toward that present object. A cognition that invariably causes a person seeking an object to act toward that object has that very object as its object, as with the valid cognition of silver admitted by both you and us. The cognition in question is of that kind; therefore its object is the substratum of “thisness” itself. When it is said that the shell is not the substratum because it

is not directly present, you must clarify whether by saying “the shell is not the substratum of the cognition ‘this is silver’” you mean shellhood or merely the bright, shining substance present before one. If shellhood is not the substratum, we too accept this. But if the bright, shining substance before one is not the substratum, then in saying so you stand alone against direct experience. The fact is that a person who experiences “this is silver,” while having that experience, points with a finger and so forth toward the object before him. It is also observed that when, because of a defect, a cause's production of its ordinary effect is obstructed, that cause acquires a capacity to produce a different kind of effect; for example, from a sugarcane seed scorched in a forest fire there arises a plantain shoot, and the digestive fire of a person afflicted with the disease Bhasmaka digests a great quantity of food. An inference of the truth of an illusion that has been established by sublating perception to be objectless is defective, like an inference that “fire is not hot.” The objection that confidence in all means of knowledge would collapse if erroneous cognition were regarded as unrestricted to its own object has been answered...

...by me in the Nyayakanika. In my view, the validity of cognition is intrinsic because of its own capacity to make known, not because of a fixed relation to its object; therefore the matter is not elaborated here. The doctrine that memory loses its character as memory has been criticized briefly here; its detailed discussion should be seen in the Brahmatattvasamiksha. Therefore it is said: “But others say that when one thing is superimposed upon another, contrary attributes are imagined in the latter.” When silver and the like are superimposed upon a shell and the like, those attributes of silver and the like that are contrary to the attributes of that very shell and the like are superimposed—this is the syntactic connection of the sentence. Let this disagreement among the inquirers remain; what use has it in the present context? The commentator answers with the words “in whatever way it may be” and so forth. The imagining of one thing's attribute in another thing is falsity; above we have made clear that this falsity is indefinability. From this it follows that in the view of every inquirer there must necessarily be a place for the indefinable superimposition of the attributes of one thing upon another; therefore indefinability is a doctrine accepted

by all views. This is the intention. Even those who hold the theory of non-apprehension of the difference between memory and experience must unwillingly accept it, because they accept co-ordinate predication and the regularity of action.

Again, how can an object and its attributes be superimposed upon the inner Self, which is not an object? Everyone superimposes one object upon another object present before him; and you say that the inner Self, lying outside the field of the notion “you,” is not an object. The answer is: it is not wholly non-objective, because it is the object of the notion “I,” and the experience of the inner Self is immediate. Nor is there a rule that superimposition occurs only upon another object present before one. Though space is not perceptible, indiscriminating people superimpose upon it surface, impurity, and so forth. In the same way there is no contradiction in the superimposition of the non-Self upon the inner Self. This falsity is established not only according to the views of inquirers into reality, but also in ordinary experience; therefore the commentator says, “Our experience in the world is such: a shell appears like silver.” “But this is not silver” completes the first sentence. Granted. Experience proves an illusion in which one thing is of the nature of another; but in what is actually one and undivided, an illusion of difference is not observed. Whence then comes the illusion of difference among Jivas who are in reality non-different from the conscious Self? The commentator answers: “Though there is one moon, it appears as though accompanied by another moon.”

In the words “Again, how...” and so forth, an objection is once more raised against superimposition upon the conscious Self. The intention is this: is the conscious Self manifest or not? If it is not manifest, how can an object and its attributes be superimposed upon it? Silver or the attributes of silver are not superimposed upon an unmanifest substance standing before us. If the Self is manifest, then, if it were inert, it would not reasonably be illuminated by a light dependent upon another, as a pot and the like are. A manifest Self must either be self-luminous or illuminated by another. The second alternative is impossible, and the first too is not acceptable

on your view. Because of contradiction, one and the same thing cannot be both agent and object. An object is that which bears the result of an action residing in another; the act of cognition does not reside in anything other than the Self; how then can the Self be its object? Because of contradiction, the same thing cannot be both self-luminous and something illuminated by another. If the act of cognition is taken to inhere in another Self, then the Self that is known, not being the agent of that act, would become non-Self. Again, to know that second Self a third Self would have to be postulated, and another for that; thus there would be an infinite regress. One who holds that consciousness is self-luminous but the Self is not self-luminous may say: granted. Though inert, the Self is manifested in every cognition of an object; nevertheless it is not the object, but only the agent. Just as Chaitra, although he bears the fruit of his own action, is not an object because he does not bear the fruit of an action inhering in another, so too the Self is not an object. Chaitra reaches the city through an action inhering in himself...

...the result of that action belongs both to Chaitra and to the city, yet objecthood belongs only to the city, because the city possesses the property of bearing the fruit of an action residing in another, namely Chaitra. Chaitra too obtains the fruit of the action, but since the act of going inheres only in Chaitra, he is not the object. This view is unreasonable because it contradicts Scripture. Shruti clearly says, "Brahman is truth, knowledge, and infinite." The same is also clear through reasoning. Is the result called manifestation of the object—that in which both object and Self are manifest—inert or self-luminous? If it is inert, both object and Self would be inert; then, when there is no difference among the three, by what would what be illuminated? Consequently, the entire world would remain unmanifest. Nor would mutual dependence among the three be of any help; as the saying goes, "The blind, holding the hand of the blind, fall at every step." Nor can it be said that although cognition itself is unmanifest, it manifests both object and Self like the eye and other senses; for to manifest means to produce cognition, and since the cognition produced would be inert, it could not remove the aforesaid defect of one blind person showing the way to another. Subsequent cognitions would also be inert; consequently

there would be an infinite regress. Therefore consciousness must necessarily be accepted as manifest by itself without dependence on another. Even if this is accepted, what advantage have you gained concerning the object and Self, which are by nature inert? You may say: the advantage is that their consciousness is not inert.

But it does not follow from this that because consciousness is not inert, the object and Self are also not inert. If the son is learned, does the father also become learned? You may say that it is the very nature of self-luminous consciousness to be related to object and Self. Then the parallel reply is that it is also the nature of a learned son to be related to his father. You may define the relation thus: the manifestation of consciousness coexists with the manifestation of object and Self; it never exists without their manifestation; this is its nature. Then the question is: is consciousness different, on one side, from its own manifestation and, on the other, from the manifestation of object and Self? If it is different, consciousness will no longer be self-luminous and will not constitute the manifestation of object and Self. You will then say that the manifestation of consciousness and the manifestation of object and Self are not different from consciousness, but are the very nature of consciousness. If so, by the statement “consciousness exists together with object and Self” nothing more has been said than “the manifestation of consciousness exists together with the manifestation of object and Self”; no progress has been made in the position. Therefore what you wish to prove—that the Self, itself inert, is the substratum of self-luminous consciousness—is not established. Nor do past and future objects coexist with the consciousness whose objects they are, although this coexistence has so far been granted for the sake of argument. You may say: cognition of rejection, acceptance...

...or indifference toward that object arises, and therefore the object coexists. Our answer is: no; because cognition of rejection and so forth, like the object-consciousness itself, cannot intelligibly take that past or future thing as its object. If it is said that because it

produces rejection and so forth, the cognition of rejection and so forth makes the thing its object, and because it produces an object-directed cognition of rejection and so forth, the object-consciousness likewise makes that object its object, then we ask: the cause of beginning or ceasing bodily action regarding an object is the conjunction of the striving Self and the body; is that conjunction too a manifestation of the object? You will say: because it is inert, the conjunction of body and Self is not a manifestation of the object. Then this consciousness, though self-luminous, is like the light of a firefly: it is luminous only with respect to itself; with respect to the object it is inert. This has already been made clear by the example of the learned son and his father. Nor, as the Vijñānavādins hold, are objects themselves of the nature of luminosity. Objects are experienced as limited, long, gross, and so forth; but luminosity reveals itself as internal, neither gross nor subtle, neither short nor long. Therefore an object distinct from the self-luminous Self is certainly indefinable, like the second moon experienced together with the one moon. In this luminosity no difference is naturally experienced; therefore there is no obstacle to its identity with the one Self. Nor can the differences among indefinable objects...

...produce difference in determinate luminosity; otherwise there would be overextension. It will also be shown later that mutual difference does not enter the field of valid cognition. Therefore this luminosity itself—which is self-luminous, one, changeless, eternal, and without parts—is the inner Self; that is, it is the Self that cognizes as the determinate Self distinct from the indefinable body, senses, and so forth. The Self that does not depend upon another for its illumination and is without parts cannot be an object of cognition. How then can the attributes of objects such as the body and senses be superimposed upon it? In the Bhashya the word “how” expresses the objection: such superimposition is not reasonable. Why is it not reasonable? The answer is: “Everyone superimposes one object upon another object present before him.” The intention is this: a thing that is illuminated in dependence upon another and has parts, though apprehended in its general form, may, because of a defect of a sense organ, fail to be apprehended in its specific form and thus appear as though different from its true

nature. But the inner Self does not depend upon another for its illumination; no sense organ is required to know it, whose defect could make cognition of the Self defective. Nor does it have parts, some of which might be apprehended and others not. It is impossible for one and the same thing at the same time to be both apprehended and unapprehended by itself. Therefore, on the doctrine of the Self's self-luminosity, superimposition cannot occur. And if the Self were never manifested at all, then...

...superimposition could not occur, because it would not be present before one, that is, immediately experienced. When a shell is not present before one, silver is not superimposed in the form "this is silver." Thus superimposition is shown to be impossible both in complete apprehension and in total non-apprehension. Granted. If the conscious Self were not an object, superimposition could not occur upon it; but it is the object of the notion "I." Why then could superimposition not occur? The commentator answers with the words "which is always outside the field of the notion 'you'." If the conscious Self were an object, the subject would be different from it. But the real subject is the conscious Self itself; an object is different from it and falls within the field of the notion "you." Therefore the qualification "outside the field of the notion 'you'" is intended to remove the possibility that the Self might be non-Self and to avoid infinite regress. Consequently, the Self must necessarily be called non-objective; and for this reason there is no superimposition upon it—this is the intention. The commentator answers: "The answer is: it is not wholly non-objective." Why? "Because it is the object of the notion 'I.'" The intention is this: it is true that the inner Self, being self-luminous, is not an object and is without parts; nevertheless, having assumed the condition of Jiva, although in reality it is not limited by the properties of the particular intellect, mind, subtle and gross bodies, senses, and so forth imagined by beginningless and indefinable Avidya, it appears as though limited; though non-different, as though different; though a non-agent, as though an agent;...

...though a non-enjoyer, as though an enjoyer; and though non-objective, as though the object of the notion “I.” It is like space, which appears divided and possessed of diverse properties owing to the differences of limiting adjuncts such as pot, jar, and vessel. When the principle of consciousness has been apprehended in the Self whose nature is homogeneous consciousness, in reality nothing at all remains unapprehended. Bliss, eternality, all-pervasiveness, and so forth are not different from its nature as consciousness, so that they might remain unapprehended when consciousness is apprehended. Though all these have been apprehended with certainty, because of imagined difference they appear as though not separately discriminated, and are therefore called unapprehended. Nor is the difference between the Self and intellect and so forth real, such that that difference too would necessarily be apprehended together with the apprehension of the conscious Self; for intellect and so forth are indefinable, and therefore their difference from the Self is also indefinable and false. Thus, in the self-luminous and unmixed conscious Self, non-apprehension of the differences that limit it as intellect and so forth, and the consequent superimposition of those limiting factors, produce the condition of Jiva. It is intelligible that this Jiva, participating in the nature of both “not this,” namely the non-objective conscious Self, and “this,” namely the inert object, should become the object of the notion “I.” The sequence is this: in the notion “I,” the conscious Self appears as agent and enjoyer. In an indifferent Self there can be no capacity to act or enjoy. And the aggregate of the activities of body and senses—that is, intellect and so forth—in which...

...there is capacity to act and enjoy, lacks consciousness. Therefore the conscious Self, joined with the aggregate of the body as effect and the senses as instruments, acquires the capacity for agency and enjoyership. Though self-luminous, through association with objects such as the intellect it somehow becomes the object of the notion “I,” the substratum of egoity, and is called Jiva, creature, or knower of the field—Kshetrajna—and so forth. The Jiva is in reality not different from the conscious Self. Shruti says, “In its own nature, as that very Jiva...” and so forth. Therefore the Jiva, though self-luminous and non-different from the conscious Self, is fitted in ordinary usage by the notion “I” to appear as agent and enjoyer; for

this reason it is called the substratum of the notion “I.” Nor is it proper to say that there is mutual dependence here—that when superimposition occurs the Jiva becomes an object, and when the Jiva becomes an object superimposition occurs. For this process is beginningless like the relation of seed and sprout; and there is no contradiction in each subsequent superimposition having as its object that which has already been made an object by each preceding superimposition and its impression. This has already been made clear in the Bhashya by the words “this natural ordinary usage.” Therefore the statement “it is not wholly non-objective” is entirely reasonable. Though the Jiva, being non-different from the conscious Self and self-luminous, is not an object in itself, it is an object in its form conditioned by limiting adjuncts. This is the intention.

Granted. We do not deny superimposition on the ground that the Jiva is not an object because its illumination does not depend upon another; rather, our position is that the inner Self is illuminated neither by itself nor with the help of another, and therefore is not an object. How then is superimposition possible upon an inner Self that is never manifested at all? The commentator answers: “The experience of the inner Self is immediate.” “Pratha” is the realization of the inner Self, because that realization is immediate. Although in the inner Self realization is not anything different from the Self, the distinction suggested in the phrase “realization of the Self” is secondary, just as in the phrase “consciousness of the Self.” The essence of the statement is this: the conscious Self must necessarily be accepted as immediately experienced, because if it remained unmanifest, all things would remain unmanifest and the world would become dark; this has already been stated. Shruti too says to this effect: “When It shines, everything shines; by Its light all this is illumined.” Having given this real answer, the commentator, in the manner of a mature dialectician, grants for argument's sake the indirectness of the conscious Self and gives another answer: “And there is no such rule in this matter,” and so forth. Why should there not be a rule that superimposition occurs “only upon another object present before one,” that is, only upon an object directly and immediately perceived? The answer is: “Because even though space is not perceived...” and so forth. The particle “hi” means “because.”

Although space is a substance, it is devoid of color and touch...

The wise call superimposition of the form described above Avidya; and they call the ascertainment of the real nature of a thing, distinct from that superimposition, knowledge. In such a condition, when... Therefore space cannot be known by an external sense organ. Nor is it known by the mind, because without the aid of a sense organ the mind does not operate with respect to external objects. Thus space is not perceived. Upon it “children”—that is, people devoid of discriminative knowledge who see merely what others point out—sometimes superimpose blueness, a quality of earth, and sometimes brightness, a quality of fire; and they determine it to be blue like the petal of a blue lotus or white like a row of royal swans. Here too, in the form of memory, there appears a property of light or darkness previously seen. In this way those people superimpose a “surface” upon space and compare it to a huge inverted bowl made of sapphire. The commentator concludes: “In the same way”—that is, after answering all objections in the manner stated above—“there is no contradiction in the superimposition upon the inner Self of the non-Self,” namely intellect and so forth. Superimposition is of thousands of kinds; why then elaborate this particular superimposition by stating objection and answer? Why not describe merely the general nature of superimposition? The commentator answers: “This superimposition of the form described above...”

...when one thing is superimposed upon another, not even the slightest effect of a merit or defect arising from the former thing falls upon the latter. It is only after the mutual superimposition of Self and non-Self described above—which is called Avidya—that the means of knowledge, the instruments of those means, and all ordinary conduct connected with them; as well as all scriptural instruction concerning injunction, prohibition, and liberation, become operative. “The wise call this superimposition of the form described above Avidya.” From Shruti, Smriti, Itihasa, Purana, and so forth it is well known that Avidya is the seed of every evil; it will be said later that Vedanta operates for the removal of this Avidya.

The superimposition of the non-Self upon the inner Self alone is the sole cause of all evil, not the illusion of silver in a shell. Therefore this alone is called Avidya, because it cannot be destroyed in the absence of knowledge of one's own nature. For this reason, not superimposition in general but this one in particular has been described. The words "of this form" indicate its character as a cause of evil; because it is such, it is the cause of evil. By superimposing upon the inner Self, which is free from desire and so forth, the attributes of the adverse inner organ, which is endowed with desire and so forth, it makes the sorrowless inner Self sorrowful; for this reason it is the cause of evil. Adherents of other views too accept superimposition in this form; otherwise there would be no need to describe it. Therefore it is said, "the wise hold," and so forth.

Now, for one who thinks that this beginningless Avidya, firmly rooted and possessed of dense impressions, cannot be removed because there is no means for its removal, the means of its removal is stated thus: "and the ascertainment of the nature of a thing distinct from it," that is, doubt-free knowledge of the nature of the thing, "is called knowledge by the wise." In the inner Self, which is completely different from intellect and so forth, the nature and attributes of intellect and so forth are superimposed because the difference from intellect and so forth is not apprehended. When, through hearing—that is, the study of Vedanta—reflection, and so forth, knowledge of difference arises and the non-apprehension of difference is removed, the ascertainment of the nature of the thing that sublates Avidya, namely knowledge whose nature is the conscious Self, appears in its real form. This is the intention. Granted. Even after Avidya, firmly rooted and endowed with dense impressions, has been sublated by knowledge, it may appear again owing to its impressions and may produce effects favorable to itself, such as fresh impressions. The commentator answers: "In such a condition"—that is, when such ascertainment of the real nature of the thing is present—"when one thing is superimposed upon another, not even the slightest effect of a merit or defect arising from the former thing falls upon the latter..."

...the defects of the inner organ and so forth—desire and the like—do not affect the conscious Self, and the auspicious attributes of the conscious Self—consciousness, bliss, and so forth—do not affect the inner organ and so forth. The meaning is this: the very nature of repeated ascertainment of truth is such that it removes erroneous cognition endowed with beginningless, firmly rooted, dense impressions. The nature of the intellect is to incline toward truth. Adherents of other schools too say: “The real nature of a thing unaffected by error is not sublated, because even without effort the intellect naturally inclines toward it.” In particular, the question is: how could true knowledge whose nature is the conscious Self, wholly inward and immediate, ever be sublated by indefinable Avidya? In the statement “by joining truth and falsehood, because there is no mutual discrimination, ordinary conduct such as ‘I am this’ and ‘this is mine’ occurs,” ordinary conduct in the form of verbal expression was explicitly stated. The ordinary worldly conduct indicated by the word “iti” is shown in the statement “After the mutual superimposition of Self and non-Self described above, which is called Avidya...” and so forth. This is self-evident.

Again, why do means of knowledge such as perception and scriptural instructions have an Avidya-afflicted person as their subject? The answer is this: it is unintelligible that a person devoid of the notions “I” and “mine” with respect to body, senses, and so forth could be a knower; therefore the operation of the means of knowledge too would be unintelligible. Ordinary conduct connected with perception and so forth is impossible without employing the senses; the operation of the senses is impossible without control; and no action can be brought about by a body upon which the nature of the Self has not been superimposed. In the absence of all these, it is also unintelligible that the unattached Self could be a knower. In the absence of a knower, the means of knowledge cannot operate. Therefore means of knowledge such as perception and scriptural instruction have an Avidya-afflicted person as their subject. Here the objection is raised: “Then how do means of knowledge such as perception have an Avidya-afflicted person as their subject?” Vidya, that is, valid knowledge, is ascertainment of truth; how then can the means of knowledge, which are

instruments of that true knowledge, find their locus in something afflicted by Avidya? The fruit of the means of knowledge is knowledge, which is opposed to Avidya; therefore those means cannot have their locus in something afflicted by Avidya. This is the intention. Or, according to your statement, let perception and so forth be admitted as means of knowledge in ordinary conduct; but Scripture, which teaches what is beneficial to human beings, is opposed to Avidya, so how can it have an Avidya-afflicted person as its subject? For this reason the commentator says “and scriptural instruction.”

The answer is: “When a person is devoid of the notions ‘I’ and ‘mine’ with respect to the body, senses, and so forth,” that is, devoid of superimposition of the nature and attributes of the Self, “it is unintelligible that he could be a knower; and the operation of the means of knowledge too is unintelligible.” The intention is this: to be a knower means to be the agent of the act called cognition; and such agency is independence with respect to the cognitive act. This independence consists in all causal factors other than the knower being impelled by him while he is not impelled by them. Therefore the means of knowledge, that is, the instruments of cognition, must be impelled by the knower. No instrument can be set in motion without an act of the knower himself. The immutable, eternal, conscious Self, incapable of change, cannot by itself become active. Therefore, becoming active through superimposition of the properties of the active intellect and so forth, it can control the means of knowledge; thus the means of knowledge have their locus in a person afflicted by Avidya. Granted that the means of knowledge do not operate; what loss is there to us? The commentator answers: “Indeed, without the employment of the senses and so forth, ordinary conduct connected with perception and the like is impossible.” The word “conduct” means fruit; the means of knowledge are employed for the sake of their fruit. The fruit of the means of knowledge...

...namely cognition such as perception, is intended here. The word “sense” should be understood to include not only sense organs but also inferential reasons and so forth, just as the word

“staff-bearer” in the sentence “the staff-bearing people are going” may include people without staffs as well. In this way the use of “and so forth” in the expression “perception and so forth” becomes intelligible. The word “conduct” denotes an action and requires an agent; therefore “conduct” and “without employing” have the same agent. The syntactic connection is: ordinary conduct that would occur without employment. Why should the knower employ the means of knowledge? Why do the means of knowledge not operate by themselves? The commentator answers: “And the operation of the senses,” that is, the operation of the means of knowledge, “is impossible without control.” An instrument not controlled by an agent never operates with respect to its object; otherwise cloth would be produced by the shuttle and the like without the control of a weaver. Why then should the body itself not be the controller? If this were accepted, superimposition of the Self would become pointless. The answer is: “No action can be brought about by a body upon which the nature of the Self has not been superimposed”; otherwise action would occur even in deep sleep. This is the intention. Granted. Just as a weaver, without superimposing his own nature upon the shuttle and the like, moves them and becomes the maker of cloth, so the Self, without superimposing its own nature upon body, senses, and so forth, may move them and become their knower. The commentator answers: “And when none of these”—that is, when mutual superimposition of nature and attributes...

...is present—then it is unintelligible that “the unattached Self,” which is in every way and at all times distinct from all attributes and substrata, “could become a knower.” A weaver and others control and move the shuttle and so forth; but the Self whose Selfhood has not been superimposed upon body and so forth, being unattached, cannot perform any action. This is the intention. Therefore the very existence of the means of knowledge necessarily rests upon superimposition. Hence the commentator says, “And without knowerhood, no operation of the means of knowledge can occur.” That which is independent with respect to valid knowledge, the fruit of the means of knowledge, becomes the knower. Valid

knowledge is a particular modification of the inner organ directed toward the object to be known and is of the nature of consciousness present in the agent. If the conscious Self were not superimposed upon the inert inner organ, how could the modification of the inert inner organ be of the nature of consciousness? Again, if the active inner organ were not superimposed upon the conscious Self, how could the conscious Self be the agent of this modification? Therefore, from mutual superimposition there arises the fruit called valid knowledge, which abides in the conscious Self as agent; when that fruit arises, knowerhood arises. With that valid knowledge as its object, the operation of the means of knowledge begins. By the use of the word “knowerhood,” valid knowledge itself is also intended. If the fruit of the means of knowledge were not valid knowledge, the means of knowledge would not become active; consequently they would not be means of knowledge at all. This is the intention. Finally the commentator says: “Therefore means of knowledge such as perception have only a person afflicted by Avidya as their subject.”

And there is no difference from animals and the like. Indeed, when animals and the like bring their auditory sense and other senses into relation with sound and other objects, if a cognition of those sounds and so forth as unfavorable arises, they withdraw from them; and if a favorable cognition arises, they advance toward them. Seeing a man approaching with a raised stick in his hand, they understand, “He wants to strike me,” and begin to run away; but seeing green grass in his hand, they go toward him. In the same way, human beings endowed with cultivated intelligence, seeing fierce-looking strong men shouting with raised swords in their hands, withdraw from them and approach people of the opposite disposition. Therefore, with respect to human beings, ordinary conduct concerning means of knowledge and objects of knowledge is similar to the conduct of animals. In the case of animals and the like it is well known that conduct connected with perception and the other means of knowledge always follows non-discrimination. Because the same pattern is observed in them, it follows that even in the case of learned persons, conduct connected with perception and the like is at that very moment of the same kind.

Granted. Let this be so in the case of ignorant people. But even in those who have understood the true nature of the inner Self as taught by Shruti and reasoning consistent with it, ordinary conduct connected with means of knowledge, the instruments of those means, and the objects known by them is observed. How then can the means of knowledge have only a person qualified by Avidya as their subject? The commentator answers: “And there is no difference from animals and the like.” Though through Shruti and reasoning they know the inner Self to be distinct from body, senses, and so forth, in conduct concerning means and objects of knowledge they do not rise above the characteristics of living beings that merely sustain life. The actions even of such learned persons are seen to be like the actions of animals and birds, whose lack of discrimination is undisputed. Because of this similarity, at the time of ordinary conduct Avidya is inferred even in the learned person. The particle “and” joins this reason to the one already stated. The intention is that the reasoning given above and the answer to the foregoing objection together establish that the subject of the means of knowledge is a person qualified by Avidya. This is analyzed in the words “Indeed, animals...” and so forth. The statement “when their auditory sense and so forth are related to sound and so forth” illustrates perception as a means of knowledge. “Cognition of sound and so forth” is its fruit. The words “if it is unfavorable” state the fruit of inference. First the nature of the sound is cognized; then, remembering the unfavorableness of that kind of sound, unfavorableness is inferred in the perceived object belonging to that class. The example is “seeing a man approaching with a raised stick in his hand...” and so forth. The rest of the meaning is clear.

But the situation is different with conduct connected with scriptural instruction. A reflective person does not regard himself as entitled to a scriptural rite until he understands the Self's relation to the next world. Nevertheless, the true Self—knowable only from Vedanta, beyond hunger and so forth, free from distinctions such as Brahmin and Kshatriya, and liberated from transmigration—is not required for eligibility, because it is of no use for eligibility and is contrary to it. No scriptural instruction that becomes operative before realization of such a nature of the Self can avoid having a person qualified by Avidya as its subject. For example, a statement

such as “A Brahmin should sacrifice” becomes operative on the basis of superimposition upon the Self of distinctions of varna, ashrama, age, and so forth.

Granted that means of knowledge such as perception have a person qualified by Avidya as their subject. But how will Scripture, which gives instructions such as “He who desires heaven should perform the Jyotishtoma sacrifice,” produce activity through superimposition of the body upon the Self? Here the person entitled to the rite is held to be one capable of enjoying the fruit in the next world. Hence the sutra of the great Acharya says: “The fruit of an act enjoined by Scripture accrues to the person instructed, because such is the nature of the instruction; that is, the injunction known through verbal testimony, ‘He who desires heaven should perform the Jyotishtoma sacrifice,’ impels that person toward the act enjoined by it.” The body and so forth, which will turn to ashes, are not capable of enjoying the fruit in the next world; therefore Scripture, by postulation, assumes some eligible person distinct from body and so forth. Knowledge of that person is Vidya; how then does Scripture have a person qualified by Avidya as its subject? Raising this objection, the commentator says, “But in the case of conduct connected with scriptural instruction...” and so forth. The particle “but” shows the difference between scriptural conduct and ordinary conduct connected with perception and so forth. Unless the person who desires heaven is accepted as related to the next world, the Scripture concerning eligibility cannot operate. Therefore Scripture must, by postulation, assume this much alone. It need not assume that person's liberation from the cycle of transmigration, because that is of no use from the standpoint of eligibility. The person taught in the Upanishads is neither an agent nor an enjoyer; therefore he is contrary to eligibility. One who acts and who enjoys the experience that is the fruit produced by action is the person entitled to the rite and its master. How can a non-agent act? How can a non-enjoyer enjoy an experience produced by action? Therefore Scripture consisting of injunction and prohibition operates with respect to a person who, through beginningless Avidya, has the notions of agency, enjoyership, Brahminhood, and so forth.

In the same way, Vedanta too has only a person qualified by Avidya as its subject; without the distinction among knower, knowledge, and known, comprehension of its meaning is impossible. Vedanta instructs the person qualified by Avidya and establishes him in the very nature it teaches, in which all Avidya is erased. Its difference from injunctive Scripture is that injunction does not bring about this final establishment. Thus it is established that Scripture has only a person qualified by Avidya as its subject. Granted. Because the person taught in the Upanishads is contrary to and useless for eligibility, he is not required for eligibility; but in the prescribed course of study he is known from the Upanishads, and that knowledge may obstruct the path of eligibility. Then, because the meaning of one part of the Veda destroys the meaning of another part, the entire Veda would lose its status as a means of knowledge. The commentator answers: “And any scriptural instruction that becomes operative before realization of such a nature of the Self...” and so forth. Knowledge of the person taught in the Upanishads is indeed opposed to eligibility; but before that knowledge arises, the injunction to action produces the appropriate ordinary conduct, and Brahma-knowledge that has not yet arisen cannot sublate it. If their relation is taken to be with different persons—one qualified by knowledge and the other by Avidya—the difference in their respective fields becomes intelligible; therefore they do not mutually sublate one another. For example, although from the standpoint of duty there is the prohibition “Do not injure any living being,” a scriptural instruction such as “One who wishes to kill his enemy by an abhichara rite should perform the Shyena sacrifice” is not sublated by “Do not commit violence.” The reason is the difference in the person addressed. One who has conquered the enemy called anger is entitled to the prohibition; but one who remains under the control of that enemy called anger is entitled to the instruction concerning the Shyena and the like.

I have already said that superimposition is cognition of a thing in a form in which it does not actually exist. When a son, wife, and so forth are well or unwell, a person superimposes upon himself the property of the external object and says, “I myself am well” or “I myself am unwell.” Likewise, by superimposing properties of the

body he says, “I am fat,” “I am thin,” “I am fair,” “I am standing,” “I am going,” “I am jumping.” By superimposing properties of the senses he says, “I am mute,” “I am one-eyed,” “I am impotent,” “I am deaf,” “I am blind.” In the same way he superimposes upon himself the properties of the inner organ such as desire, resolve, doubt, and determination. Thus he superimposes upon the inner Self, the witness of all his activities, the inner organ denoted by the notion “I,” and then, in the reverse direction, superimposes the inner Self, witness of all, upon the inner organ and so forth.

The meaning of the answer “because of the difference in the person addressed” has been made clear above. By the words “in this way,” it is again made clear that the subject of Scripture is a person qualified by Avidya. Superimposition of varna: “A king should perform the Rajasuya sacrifice,” and so forth; superimposition of ashrama: “A householder should marry a woman of the same varna,” and so forth; superimposition of age: “One whose hair is black should tend the sacred fire,” and so forth; superimposition of condition: “One whose disease is incurable should enter the water and abandon life,” and so forth. The word “and so forth” includes admixture of varna, major sins, secondary sins, and other such superimpositions that produce disqualification or impurity. Having thus described the mutual superimposition of Self and non-Self through objection and answer, and having confirmed it by an examination of means and objects of knowledge, the commentator again recalls its previously stated nature so that its character as the cause of evil may be discussed in detail: “I have already said that superimposition...”

“Superimposition is cognition of a thing in a form in which it is not” is a concise statement of what was said earlier: “the appearance elsewhere, in a form resembling memory, of something previously seen.” Here the superimposition of “I,” the nature of the substratum, cannot become a cause of evil until it produces the superimposition of “mine,” the nature of an attribute. Therefore the superimposition of an attribute—the sense of “mine”—is the direct cause of all the evils of the cycle of transmigration. This is elaborated by the words “son, wife, and so forth.” Having superimposed identity with the body upon the Self, and then having

superimposed upon that body the property of ownership regarding son, wife, and so forth, a person, just as in the superimposition of bodily qualities such as fatness, says, “I myself am well” or “I myself am unwell.” When property is intact, ownership is intact and the owner regards himself as complete; when property is lacking, ownership is incomplete and the owner regards himself as incomplete. Through ownership a person superimposes upon the Self external properties such as the well-being or ill-being that attach to the body. This is the intention. If this is the case with an externally conditioned property such as ownership, what need is there to speak of bodily properties such as thinness, which do not depend upon an external adjunct? For this reason the commentator says, “Likewise, the properties of the body...” and so forth.

The nature of the Self is superimposed upon the senses, which are more inward than the body; a person then superimposes upon the Self such properties of those senses as deafness. The nature of the Self is superimposed upon the inner organ, which is still more inward; he then superimposes upon the Self properties of that inner organ such as desire and resolve. This is the syntactic connection. After describing the superimposition of attributes, the commentator states its basis—the superimposition of the substratum—in the words “Thus, superimposing that which is denoted by the notion ‘I...’ and so forth. That in which a modification of the form ‘I’ arises, namely the inner organ, is what is denoted by the notion ‘I.’” That inner organ is superimposed upon the inner Self; by reason of its consciousness and indifference, the inner Self is the witness of all modifications of the inner organ. Thus agency and enjoyership have been explained. Consciousness is explained by the words “in the reverse direction”: the inner organ and so forth are inert; consciousness is the opposite of that. Through that consciousness, that is, in this manner, “he superimposes the inner Self, witness of all, upon the inner organ and so forth.” The intention here is this: the Jiva is consciousness delimited by the inner organ and so forth, a mixture of “this” and “not this”; it is the agent and enjoyer, the locus of both kinds of Avidya as effect and cause, the substratum of egoity, the transmigrating being, the receptacle of the entire mass of suffering, and the material cause of mutual superimposition. Its material cause in turn is superimposition itself. Therefore, like seed

and sprout, this process is beginningless, and there is no defect of
 mutual dependence here.

Thus this beginningless, endless, and natural superimposition, whose nature is erroneous cognition and which produces agency, enjoyership, and so forth, is directly experienced by everyone. The whole of Vedanta begins for the removal of this cause of evil and for the attainment of knowledge of the oneness of the Self. How this is the purport of the entire Vedanta will be shown by us in this Shariraka Mimamsa.

After confirming superimposition by examining means and objects of knowledge, the commentator, for the benefit of the student, states its nature again and makes it still firmer, because everyone experiences it: “Thus this beginningless and endless...” and so forth. “Endless” means that it is not destroyed in the absence of valid knowledge. Because it is beginningless and endless it is called “natural.” “Whose nature is erroneous cognition”: the nature of erroneous cognition is indefinability; what possesses that nature is referred to here, namely superimposition is indefinable. The explanation of “in the reverse direction” has also made clear that the inner organ and so forth are inert and that consciousness is their opposite; through that consciousness the inner Self is superimposed upon the inner organ and so forth. The commentator concludes the topic: “For the removal of this cause of evil...” and so forth. How can it be removed in the absence of opposed cognition? The answer is: “for the attainment of knowledge of the oneness of the Self.” “Attainment” means realization; the purpose is not merely mantra-recitation or performance of ritual action. The oneness of the Self is its complete non-association with the entire world while being of the nature of bliss. Vedanta, which unfailingly produces this realization, destroys superimposition at its root. The intention is this: if the notion “I” concerning the Self were valid, the Self would already be known and inquiry into Brahman would be fruitless; consequently no desire to know Brahman would arise. In the absence of that desire, there would be no study of Vedanta for the sake of Brahma-knowledge; it would merely be used incidentally for mantra-recitation. Then the Upanishadic conception concerning the Self would not acquire the status of a means of

knowledge. Such an invalid conception, however often repeated, could not remove the real agency, enjoyership, and so forth of the Self. In truth, valid knowledge removes an attributed form, not a real nature.

And false cognition cannot remove a real nature. Even the continuous cognition of a rope as a snake thousands of times cannot sublimate the rope's nature as a rope. But a form produced by erroneous cognition is sublated by valid cognition; and even though the impression of erroneous cognition may be very strong, it is destroyed by the impression produced through concentrated, uninterrupted, and long-continued repetition of valid cognition.

Granted. In Vedanta too, instructions concerning meditations on Prana and the like are seen in many places. How then can the sole purport of all Vedanta sentences be the teaching of the oneness of the Self? The commentator answers in the words "The purport of the whole of Vedanta lies in this" and so forth. The body itself is called shariraka; the one dwelling in it, the shariraka, is the individual Self. What is referred to here is the inquiry whose purpose is to show that the nature of the Self indicated by the word "tvam" in the sentence "tat tvam asi" is precisely the nature of the Supreme Self indicated by the word "tat."

The substance of what is intended here is as follows. (1) The injunction to study one's own Vedic branch commands study of the entire Veda up to the fruitful comprehension of its meaning; therefore, just as ritual injunctions and prohibitions indicated by the expression "one's own Vedic branch," Vedanta too is an object of study for producing fruitful knowledge of its meaning. (2) According to the principle that "the meaning of a sentence is not separate from the meaning found in ordinary usage," the power of Vedanta to convey meaning, like that of mantras, is admitted everywhere. (3) Vedanta produces knowledge of the one inner Self, unrelated to the world, a homogeneous mass of consciousness and bliss, free from agency and enjoyership; nevertheless this Vedanta conflicts with the notion "I"—a notion that appears doubtless and unsublated and apprehends the Self as endowed with agency, enjoyership, suffering, grief, and delusion. Because of this, Vedanta would have to depart from its direct literal meaning and yield only

a figurative meaning, or remain merely an instrument for mantra-recitation; then its meaning would differ from the meaning it intends to declare. Consequently, there would be no need to begin the four-chapter Shariraka Mimamsa whose purpose is inquiry into its meaning.

If it is held that the Self directly present in every person's experience of "I" is not doubtful and that knowledge of it yields no fruit, then no inquiry would begin from a desire to know it. This is the Purvapaksha. The Siddhanta is this: if the notion "I" were valid, the foregoing objection would be proper. But this notion cannot sublate scriptural statements, and neither Scripture nor the entire tradition of Acharyas regards it as valid. Therefore it is superimposed. The purport of Vedanta is not a meaning different from what it declares, nor a figurative meaning, but its primary meaning itself. The inner Self alone is its principal subject. There is doubt concerning that inner Self, and knowledge of it also has a fruit; therefore the desire to know it is proper. From this standpoint the sutra-author expresses the desire to know in the form of the sutra: "Therefore, now, the desire to know Brahman."

This is the first sutra of the Vedanta inquiry whose exposition is proposed:

Therefore, now, the desire to know Brahman

By the expression “desire to know,” the commentator indicates the existence of both doubt and fruit. Here knowledge of Brahman is explicitly called the fruit, because it is directly the object of desire. Unlike ritual action that follows knowledge of a rite and the result of that action, no other thing following Brahma-knowledge is the principal fruit. Brahma-knowledge, free from every doubt, is itself the supreme fruit; it is the end of all suffering and is of the nature of homogeneous bliss. The object of this knowledge taught by Vedanta is known through the method of reasoning called Brahma-mimamsa. A competent inquirer proceeds toward this goal with greater certainty. Although that goal is already attained, because of beginningless Avidya it appears as though unattained and becomes an object of desire. Just as a person who fails to notice a necklace already hanging around his own neck regards it as absent and, when another person points it out, “obtains” it—although the necklace was already possessed—so too is Brahma-knowledge attained.

In this sutra the word “atha” is taken to mean “immediately after,” not “let there be a beginning,” because the desire to know Brahman is not itself something that can be initiated. The desire to know arises from doubt, and therefore indicates doubt as its cause. Doubt makes the beginning of inquiry meaningful. Because it indicates both the cause that impels a competent inquirer to undertake this scriptural inquiry—doubt—and the fruit, it is proper that the sutra be placed at the very beginning of the treatise. For this reason the revered commentator says, “This is the first sutra of the Vedanta inquiry whose exposition is proposed.” The word “mimamsa” denotes inquiry worthy of respect. This inquiry is worthy of respect because its fruit is ascertainment of an exceedingly subtle meaning, which becomes the cause of the highest human end. A “Mimamsa-shastra” is a treatise that teaches

this inquiry; it is called “shastra” because by it this inquiry is taught or correctly expounded to students. A sutra is a statement which, though composed with few syllables and few words, indicates much meaning and is full of substance. After explaining the purport of the sutra in this way, the commentator explains the first word, “atha”: “Here the word ‘atha’ is understood in the sense of immediate succession.” The syntactic connection is that the word “atha” occurring among the words of the sutra conveys the sense of immediate succession.

The meaning “auspiciousness” has no grammatical connection with the meaning of the sentence. In fact, when the word “atha” is used in another sense, it can produce auspiciousness by its mere sound. Reference to a preceding topic is, in effect, not different from immediate succession. When the meaning “immediately after” is accepted, then, just as the desire to know Dharma is necessarily connected with the preceding act of study of one’s Veda, some preceding cause must likewise be accepted for the desire to know Brahman. Immediate succession to the study of one’s own Vedic branch is common to both the inquiry into Dharma and the inquiry into Brahman.

Now a question arises: the word “atha” is also seen in the sense of “beginning”; for example, in the Veda, “athato’yam jyotishtomah”—that is, now this Jyotishtoma begins—and in ordinary usage, “atha shabdanushasanam” or “atha yoganushasanam”—that is, now the science of words or the science of Yoga begins. Why then should “atha” not be understood here in the sense of beginning? The answer is: “not in the sense of beginning.” Why? “Because the desire to know Brahman is not a thing that can be initiated.” In the wording of this sutra, “desire to know” appears as more prominent than Brahman or Brahma-knowledge. Nor can it be said that, just as in the sentence “the staff-bearer recites the permission and response” the staff, though subordinate, is intended, so here Brahman and Brahma-knowledge, though subordinate, may be intended. For here the “desire to know,” by indicating doubt and fruit, assists the scripturally prescribed activity in the form of inquiry into Brahman. If Brahman and Brahma-knowledge were not intended, doubt and fruit would not be intended either; consequently a discriminating inquirer

would not inquire into something pointless, like examining the teeth of an arrow. Brahman and Brahma-knowledge could then not be the subject matter and fruit of the treatise. In the absence of superimposition upon a subject contrary to the notion “I,” the status of Vedanta as a means of knowledge would also become unintelligible. A figurative meaning that impels one toward action, or a meaning useful in mantra-recitation like the syllable “hum,” can remain dependent upon the injunction to study one's Vedic branch. Therefore the prominence of the “desire to know,” which indicates doubt and fruit through both the word and the complete sentence, is intended.

Nor can the word “jijnasa” be understood in the sense “to be begun,” so that the neighboring word “atha” might also indicate a beginning, because in every section the beginning of the desire to know is not itself the topic to be examined. The knowledge of Brahman that qualifies the desire to know might be regarded as something that can be begun, but even that is not connected with the word “atha,” because Brahma-knowledge is not principal here. Desire to know and inquiry are not one and the same thing, so that a beginning of inquiry could be understood as in the beginning of the Yoga-shastra. The word “mimamsa” is derived from the root “man” in the sense of inquiry, whereas the word “jijnasa” means “desire to know.” The desire to know impels a person toward inquiry. The impeller and that into which one is impelled cannot be one; if they were one, the relation of mover and moved would be unintelligible. When a word's own meaning is appropriate, imagining another meaning would also be an improper extension. Therefore the statement is proper: “because the desire to know Brahman is not a thing that can be initiated.”

Why, then, should the meaning of the word “atha” not be “auspiciousness”? The sutra would then mean: because it produces auspiciousness, the desire to know Brahman should be undertaken daily. The answer is: “The meaning ‘auspiciousness’ has no grammatical connection with the meaning of the sentence.” Only that meaning of a word becomes a constituent of the sentence-meaning which has a grammatical relation to it; such a meaning is either explicitly stated or implied. Here auspiciousness is neither the explicit nor the implied meaning of “atha”; it is merely an effect

produced by hearing the sound of the word, just as by hearing the sound of a drum or conch. In verbal usage, an effect produced or recalled by the sound of a word is not seen to have a grammatical connection with the meaning of the sentence. Objection: here and elsewhere the word “*atha*” indicates auspiciousness; Smṛiti too says, “Om and *atha*—these two words first emerged from the throat of Brahma; therefore both are auspicious.” Answer: when the word “*atha*” is used in another sense, it produces auspiciousness by its mere sound. “*Atha*” used in the sense of immediate succession and so forth also produces auspiciousness merely through its sound, like the sound of a flute or vina, or like the sight of a water-filled pitcher brought for some other purpose. Therefore there is no conflict with the statement of Smṛiti. Even while retaining the meaning of immediate succession, auspiciousness is obtained merely by hearing the sound. This is the intention.

Granted. Even without conveying the meaning of immediate succession, the word “*atha*” may depend upon some preceding cause. Understand this as follows: is the word “*atha*” used in the sense of immediate succession, or in the sense of beginning? In this interrogative sentence the second “*atha*” presents the second alternative after the first alternative has been stated. Here the second occurrence of “*atha*” does not mean “immediately after,” because the statement of the opponent intervenes between the first “*atha*” and the second. Nevertheless, it depends upon the topic previously stated; if there were no dependence, the subject of the question would become different from the first subject and the framing of an alternative would be impossible. No one asks, “Is the Self eternal, or is the intellect impermanent?” Therefore, even if the meaning “immediately after” is not accepted, why should the word “*atha*” not depend upon a preceding topic?

The answer is: “Reference to a preceding topic is, in effect, not different from immediate succession.” The intention is this: we do not insist on the meaning “immediately after” merely for the sake of temporal proximity; our purpose is to ascertain a preceding cause that becomes the cause of the desire to know Brahman. If, by accepting that the word “*atha*” depends upon a preceding topic, this meaning is still established, insistence upon immediate succession may seem fruitless. The word “in effect” indicates this. But in fact

this is another position: that “atha” depends upon a preceding topic. No explicit alternative is presented here; therefore, when the other meanings are eliminated, only “immediate succession” remains. This view is proper.

Granted that the meaning is “immediately after”; what is thereby established? The answer is: “When the meaning is ‘immediately after’...” Immediate succession must be succession after some definite thing; simply saying “after” is not enough. After doing something, a person necessarily does something else, but mere succession is seen to yield neither a perceptible benefit nor an unseen benefit. Therefore one must identify a thing immediately after which the desire to know Brahman occurs, such that in its absence that desire does not arise and in its presence it necessarily arises. This is stated in the words: “some preceding thing with which the desire to know Brahman is necessarily connected.”

Granted. Like the desire to know Dharma, the desire to know Brahman too arises immediately after study of one's own Vedic branch, because Brahman, like Dharma, is known only through Scripture. When Scripture is not known, knowledge of its own subject—Dharma and Brahman—does not arise; and because of the injunction to study, “A person should study his own Vedic branch,” knowledge of Scripture necessarily occurs. Therefore, even in the case of inquiry into Brahman, the word “atha” means only immediate succession to Vedic study. The commentator says: “Immediate succession to the study of one's own Veda is common to both the desire to know Dharma and the desire to know Brahman.” Here, by “one's own Veda,” the subject matter of the Veda is intended, and study of that subject matter is implicitly understood. This succession also follows from the first sutra, “Athato dharmajijnasa.” There would be no need to begin the present sutra separately, because the word “Dharma” used in that sutra indicates the meaning of the entire Veda, and Brahman too, like Dharma, is a meaning of the Veda. Therefore succession to Vedic study applies equally to both. This is the intention. Now an objection arises: “What distinction does the desire to know Brahman have here in comparison with the desire to know Dharma?” The answer is: “Immediate succession specifically to knowledge of ritual action.” No; because the desire to know Brahman is possible in a person

who has studied Vedanta even before the desire to know Dharma. In the context of cutting the knot of the heart and the like, a rule of immediate sequence is indeed present, because there an ordered sequence is intended to be taught; but here no such sequence is intended. There is no evidence of a subordinate-principal relation between inquiry into Dharma and inquiry into Brahman, nor of a renewed relation of eligibility in one who is already eligible.

The meaning is this: "The distinction of the desire to know Brahman, in comparison with the desire to know Dharma, consists in its occurring immediately after knowledge of ritual action." In statements such as "They desire to know through sacrifice," the explicit use of the instrumental case connects sacrifice and the like as auxiliaries to Brahma-knowledge. For the principal object of desire is knowledge alone; what is not principal must be related to the principal thing. But even here sacrifice and the like are not auxiliaries to the production of knowledge of the sentence-meaning, because the sentence itself produces that knowledge. Nor is it reasonable that a sentence should require the assistance of action. A person who knows the relation between words and their meanings, understands the true nature of the principles governing the use of sounds, remembers the relations of subordinate and principal, earlier and later among things, and the requirements of expectancy, proximity, and semantic fitness, obtains unobstructed knowledge of the sentence-meaning even without performing any action. If such knowledge did not arise, knowledge of the meaning of injunctive and prohibitive sentences would also not arise; consequently performance and abstention, which are the meanings of those sentences, would fail. If performance and abstention are held to arise from knowledge of them, there would be mutual dependence: when there is knowledge, performance and abstention according to the sentence-meaning occur, and from that performance and abstention, knowledge of it again arises. Nor can it be maintained that only Vedanta sentences depend upon action for making their meaning understood, while other sentences do not, because there is no special reason for such a distinction.

Now, a person whose intellect is initially impure cannot immediately comprehend the validity of the identity, taught by the sentence "tat tvam asi," between the Jiva denoted by "tvam," whose

nature is that of agent and enjoyer, and the Supreme Self denoted by “tat,” which is eternally pure, conscious, and unattached, because incompatibility in the literal meanings of the two words appears certain. But one whose impurities of the inner organ have been diminished by sacrifice, gift, austerity, fasting, and the like, and who possesses faith, will understand the compatibility of “tat” and “tvam” and know their identity. If this is said, we ask: is the ascertainment of the compatibility that is a cause of valid cognition itself produced by action, which is not a means of knowledge, or is action, in addition to perception and the other means, also a means of knowledge? If compatibility is ascertained through reasoning that does not conflict with Vedanta and is based upon Vedanta, action is unnecessary. Therefore, by hearing “tat tvam asi” and similar statements, one obtains the knowledge that the nature of the Jiva is the nature of the Supreme Self; having strengthened that knowledge by reasoning consistent with it, one then realizes Brahman by long, uninterrupted contemplation of that truth, that is, by nididhyasana. Sacrifice and the like assist this nididhyasana. As it has been said: “Discipline of mind practiced for a long time, continuously and with reverence, acquires a firm foundation.” Celibacy, austerity, faith, sacrifice, and so forth constitute that reverence. For this reason Scripture says, “Having known that One, the learned Brahmin should practice wisdom.” After knowing through verbal testimony and reasoning, one should engage in nididhyasana.

Some hold here that sacrifice and the like merely destroy the impurities of the inner organ, which are enemies of liberation; this alone is their utility. Others hold that they purify the aspirant. A person purified by sacrifice and the like, through devotional and long-continued uninterrupted contemplation of Brahman, uproots all impressions of beginningless Avidya; consequently the inner Self becomes stainless, pure, and luminous. Hence Smriti says: “Through Brahma-yajna, Deva-yajna, Pitri-yajna and the other great sacrifices and sacrifices generally, a person produces fitness for the attainment of Brahman”; and, “One in whom these forty-eight purificatory samskaras have been completed.” Others say that action aids Brahma-knowledge by discharging the three debts. Smriti says, “Having discharged the three debts, a person should fix

his mind on liberation.” Still others hold that although various actions are enjoined for their own respective fruits, because of statements such as “Brahmins desire to know It through Vedic study, sacrifice, and so forth,” they assist contemplation of Brahman through a relation of conjunctive separateness. Just as khadira wood, while serving the purpose of a sacrifice as a sacrificial post, also produces virility in the sacrificer, because the rule is, “When one thing serves two purposes, the relation is called conjunctive separateness.”

For this very reason there is also the sutra of the great sage Badarayana: “Because of scriptural statements concerning sacrifice and the like, all are required for contemplation of Brahman, as in the case of a horse.” Here the word “all” indicates sacrifice, gift, austerity, and so forth; the meaning is that all these are required for contemplation of Brahman. Therefore, whether one takes authoritative Scripture or the sutra of the great sage, in every case only contemplation of Brahman joined with sacrifice and the like and endowed with the three qualities of devotion, long duration, and uninterruptedness is capable of destroying beginningless Avidya and its impressions and producing realization of Brahman, that is, liberation. For this purpose the performance of action is necessary. But performance of these actions is impossible without knowledge of their many distinctions, their seen and unseen fruits, the relation of things connected with them as inherent or remote causes, auxiliary rites directly prescribed or obtained by extension, all subsidiary components down to their order, and the different qualified persons for different rites. Such knowledge does not arise without critical study of Dharma-mimamsa. Therefore it was properly said: “The distinction is immediate succession to knowledge of ritual action.”

Indeed, only because of knowledge of ritual action can action assist contemplation of Brahman. The commentator refutes this view: “No.” Why not? Because “even before knowledge of ritual action, the desire to know Brahman is possible in one who has studied his Veda.”

The implied meaning of this statement is as follows. It is said that action is necessary for contemplation of Brahman, that is, nididhyasana. The question is: in what manner is action necessary?

Is it necessary for producing the fruit, just as in an Agneya rite and the like auxiliaries such as fuel-sticks are required for producing the final unseen fruit? Or is action necessary for its own existence, just as a cake split in two and the deity Agni are required? The view that action is necessary for the production of the fruit does not withstand examination. It must be accepted that contemplation of Brahman produces realization of Brahman's nature. But this realization is not a product like a lump made by kneading flour; not a modification like rice produced by pounding paddy; not a purification like the cleansing of a mortar by sprinkling; and not an acquisition like milk obtained by milking. First, it is not a product. The realization of Brahman produced by contemplation is not an inert thing distinct from Brahman, like a sense-born cognition of a pot distinct from the pot. Brahman is not manifested in dependence upon another light; its realization is its own eternal nature. Therefore its production is unintelligible.

Any different kind of experience produced by contemplation would be doubtful like an imagined thought and therefore could not be authoritative, because such thoughts produced with the aid of contemplation are often seen to be unstable. For example, if a person whose body has become numb from extreme cold, while repeatedly contemplating a fire known by inference, experiences a huge blazing fire, that experience does not accord with other authoritative cognition, because contrary results of such experiences are widely observed in the world. Therefore the distinctive character of valid realization is not produced by this process, and action is not required for producing any fruit through contemplation. In the changeless, eternal, and all-pervading Brahman, contemplation can produce neither modification, purification, nor acquisition.

Granted that realization of Brahman is not produced; but perhaps purification occurs through removal of the covering of twofold indefinable Avidya. Just as a stagehand raises the curtain concealing a dancer and she becomes an object of direct perception for the audience, perhaps action serves to remove the covering. But there is this difference: when the curtain is raised, the dancer becomes an object of the audience's perception; here only the cessation of Avidya's covering is produced, nothing else, because

realization of Brahman cannot be produced; Brahman's nature is eternal. Here the question arises: what is “contemplation of Brahman”? Is it the successive repetition of what has been understood from verbal testimony? Or a continuous sequence of doubtless cognitions obtained from authoritative words? If it is repetition of what has been understood from verbal testimony, even repeated practice cannot remove original Avidya. Only ascertainment of truth and its continuous repetition destroy error and its impressions at the root, not repetition of doubt or merely repetition of general knowledge. Even if the cognition “a post or a man” or “some tall large object” is repeated a hundred times, in the absence of specific knowledge it will not be ascertained that the object is a man.

It has now been said that after the cognition born of hearing has revealed the Jiva's real nature as the Supreme Self, cognition born of reflection confirms it. Therefore a continuous sequence of doubtless cognitions based in due form upon verbal testimony, when contemplated with the assistance of action, becomes the cause of destruction of twofold Avidya. But this destruction is impossible without producing the experience of Brahman. The cessation of an error whose nature is immediate experience occurs only through immediate valid cognition, not through an indirect description. Errors concerning direction, the circle of fire, a moving tree, and water in a mirage are removed by their respective valid perceptions; mere determination of the direction and so forth through verbal testimony, inference, and the like does not remove the error of direction. Therefore the required cognition is: that which is denoted by “tvam” is in reality of the nature of that which is denoted by “tat.” In this way, and by no other means, the experience of the Jiva denoted by “tvam” as afflicted by suffering, grief, and so forth ceases.

This realization does not arise merely from verbal testimony, even when accompanied by reflection; it arises from perception, because realization is the necessary fruit of perception. Otherwise one would have to accept the impossible conclusion that a banyan sprout could arise from a cut kutaja seed. Therefore it is proper that the inner organ, refined by contemplation of the doubtless meaning of the great sentences, negates the adjunct-conditioned forms of the

immediately experienced Jiva denoted by “tvam” and manifests its true nature as Brahman denoted by “tat.” This experience is not a production of Brahman, because Brahman is not a produced thing; it is itself a particular modification of the inner organ concerning Brahman. Brahman is not illuminated by another light through that modification. Verbal testimony reveals Brahman, but Brahman does not thereby become other-illuminated like the non-Self. That which is free from all limiting adjuncts is called self-luminous consciousness, not an adjunct-conditioned object. The commentator himself says, “It is not necessarily wholly non-objective.”

Even at the time of realization of Brahman there is not yet complete freedom from limiting adjuncts, because the modification of the inner organ is itself a limiting adjunct, standing at the boundary where it destroys itself and other adjuncts. If the modification of the inner organ were not related to consciousness as an adjunct, the self-luminosity of an inert modification would be unintelligible, because there would be no reflection of consciousness there and the modification could not produce knowledge. Nor is it unacceptable that an inferred thought or contemplation of inferred fire produces an experience of fire; because there the nature of fire is indirect, whereas here the Jiva obscured by limiting adjuncts, whose nature is Brahman, is immediately experienced from the outset. Purity, consciousness, and the other qualities are not in reality outside the Jiva; they are not different from it. The Jiva free from limiting adjuncts is called Brahman, whose nature is purity, consciousness, and so forth. Freedom from limiting adjuncts too is not some other thing different from the Jiva.

Just as, with the aid of impressions produced by repeated practice of the science of music, the auditory sense directly experiences the distinct notes such as shadja in different ascending and descending sequences, so, through the inner organ endowed with impressions produced by repeated contemplation of the meaning of Vedanta sentences, the Jiva directly experiences its own nature as Brahman. If it is said that the cooperation of action is required to produce the modification of the inner organ, namely realization of Brahman, the answer is no; because action does not coexist with contemplation. A person who understands without

doubt from sentences such as “tat tvam asi” that he is the Self distinct from the body, pure, conscious, unattached, a non-agent, and a non-enjoyer—how can he understand himself to be eligible for action? And one who understands such eligibility—how can he be a non-agent or non-eligible?

It may be said: even after truth has been ascertained, behavior produced by error continues. For example, although a person knows that sugar is sweet, one afflicted by a disorder of bile experiences it as bitter; he tastes the sugar, spits it out, and rejects it. Therefore, because impressions of Avidya remain, ritual performance continues, and action, assisting knowledge, destroys those impressions. It is proper to accept this. But the question is: “How can action, which is itself of the nature of Avidya, destroy Avidya? And by what will the action that destroys it itself be destroyed?” Many things are seen to destroy themselves and other things of their own class. For example, cow’s milk digests itself and helps digest other milk; poison destroys itself and neutralizes other poison; powder of nirmali placed in muddy water settles to the bottom together with the impurities and clears the water. In the same way, action of the nature of Avidya removes other Avidya and then itself ceases.

In reply to this it is said: it is true that repeated hearing of the sentences beginning “In the beginning, dear one, there was only Being” and ending in “tat tvam asi,” aided by inquiry into Brahman, produces doubtless valid knowledge concerning the inner Self distinct from the body and so forth; this inner Self is not the material cause of the physical body and the like, but beginningless Avidya alone is their material cause. Nevertheless, because impressions of Avidya remain, the notion of transmigration and the corresponding ordinary conduct continue. But the knower understands this conduct and these notions to be false and does not place trust in them, just as a person afflicted by bile, though sugar tastes bitter to him, does not believe that bitterness to be real.

How then can a person who knows with certainty that action, agent, instrument, injunction, and fruit—all these things are unreal—be qualified for action? Only one who regards all these as real is qualified. Otherwise it would be difficult to prevent animals, children, and the like from being qualified. In a section concerning

ritual injunction, the person who knows the distinctions among action, agent, and so forth is called knowledgeable. For this very reason the revered commentator says that scriptural instruction has a person afflicted by Avidya as its subject. Thus, just as the Rajasuya is performed only by one who identifies himself with the royal class, not by one who identifies himself as Brahmin or Vaishya, so only a person possessing the cognition of distinctions such as twice-born status, agency, action, and instrument is qualified for ritual action. One who has no notion of these distinctions has no eligibility. As in the case of a Vajapeya performed by a Brahmin or Kshatriya, an unqualified person does not obtain the fruit of a Vedic rite even though capable of performing it skillfully and of enjoying the fruit. Thus, in actions with perceptible fruits, attainment of the fruit is observed when capacity and commencement of action are present; but in actions with unseen fruits, the fruit is known only from scriptural instruction, and therefore the rite does not apply to an unqualified person. For this reason action is not required in nididhyasana.

Granted. Just as the notion “I am a human being” is required for eligibility for an enjoined act, so too in the case of prohibition only one who has this notion is qualified as its subject. One who has no notion of being human has no eligibility with respect to a prohibition, just like an animal and so forth. Consequently, such a person, even if he performs a prohibited act, would not be more sinful than a low animal; this would violate Scripture. The answer is: no. A person who has attained realization in the present life is not completely free from the notion “I am a human being”; because the impressions of Avidya remain, a subtle trace of it persists. Nevertheless, he does not have genuine conviction in what continues only falsely. What follows from this? The conclusion is: one who has faith in an injunction is qualified; one without faith is not. Therefore, one who does not believe in notions such as human status is not qualified for injunctive Scripture. Smriti too says, “An offering or gift made without faith...” Prohibitive Scripture does not require faith; it applies of itself to a person who engages in a prohibited act.

Therefore, even after knowing the true nature of Brahman, if a person, like one bound in worldly bondage, violates prohibitions, he

incurs sin. Hence no doctrine that accepts conduct contrary to Scripture is admissible. For this reason action is not necessary in nididhyasana for producing the fruit. Nor is action necessary for the arising of nididhyasana; because once doubtless knowledge has arisen from verbal testimony, there is no eligibility for action. Scripture says: “Not by action, not by progeny, not by wealth; immortality is attained only by renunciation.”

Then is action of no use at all here? If so, a statement such as “They desire to know through sacrifice” would be false. The answer is: no. Sacrifice and the like are remote auxiliaries. The point is this: through Vedic study a Brahmin desires to know Brahman, that is, produces the desire to know, not knowledge itself. Although desire is relatively subordinate and knowledge principal, in the verbal form the meaning of the verbal root is subordinate while the suffixal meaning, desire, is principal; an action is related to what is grammatically principal. When one says “Bring the king's man,” it is not the king who is brought but the person qualified by the word “man.” Although the king is in reality principal, in the expression he is merely the qualifier of the word “man”; grammatically the principal entity is the man. In the same way, sacrifice and Vedic study are enjoined as means to the desire to know Brahman. Fasting as austerity is enjoined in the same manner.

Mere abstention from food is not austerity. One in whom the desire to know Brahman arises while eating pure, wholesome, measured food at the proper time and according to need is an ascetic; not one who observes complete fasting, because he would die. Nor are vows and fasts such as Chandrayana the real nature of austerity, because the balance of bodily humors may be disturbed in such a person. Daily and occasional duties diminish sin and purify the aspirant. Scripture says: an Atmayajin is one who understands, “By this act my body is purified; by this act my body is nourished.” Here the words “by this act” indicate sacrifice and the like. Smṛiti too says, “One in whom these forty-eight purificatory samskaras have been completed.” A statement of the Atharvaveda also shows that after sin has been diminished by performance of daily, occasional, and desire-motivated actions, a person whose intellect is purified and in whom inquiry has arisen sees Brahman through meditation: “A person of purified intellect sees Brahman

through meditation.” Smriti too says, “When sin has been diminished, knowledge arises.”

“Action,” and so forth. It is certain that daily rites destroy previously accumulated sin and purify a person. Once the indirect assistance of daily action in the arising of knowledge has thus become clear, it is not proper to imagine its direct assistance through the doctrine of conjunctive separateness, because that would require many unnecessary assumptions. The point is this: performance of daily rites produces merit. The world is by nature impermanent, impure, and full of suffering, but erroneous cognitions of permanence, purity, happiness, and so forth defile *sattva*, that is, the intellect; the cause of this defilement is sin. When sin is diminished, the doors of perception and reasoning open, and through perception and inference a person unobstructedly knows the impermanence, impurity, and painfulness of the world. From that arises dispassion in the form of non-attachment to the world; from that awakens the desire to remove worldly existence; from that follows a search for the means of its cessation. Hearing that knowledge of the true nature of the Self is the means of that cessation, the person desires to know it; then, through the sequence of hearing, study, and so forth, he obtains that knowledge. Therefore it is reasonable that action is a remote auxiliary to the arising of knowledge through purification of *sattva* in the form of the intellect. The Bhagavadgita too repeats this meaning: “For the sage who wishes to attain Yoga, action is said to be the cause; for one established in Yoga, tranquility is said to be the cause.”

If this is so, a person whose intellect is already pure because of action performed in a previous birth, even though he performs no action in this life, and in whom dispassion has arisen from understanding the lack of essence in worldly existence, does not need to perform action in order to produce dispassion. For dispassion is already obtained by him through the actions of a previous birth. In this context Scripture says concerning the superior person: “Or he may renounce directly even from the stage of studentship.” Here it has been said: “Even before knowledge of ritual action, the desire to know Brahman is possible in one who has studied Vedanta.” Therefore a person remaining in the student stage has no such debt whose discharge would require him to

perform action. Accordingly, the statement “A Brahmin is born with three debts” should be understood as referring to one who becomes a householder. Otherwise it would conflict with the scriptural statement “Or he may renounce directly from studentship.” Even the householder’s discharge of the debts is only for purification of the intellect. The provisions concerning death in old age, reduction of the body to ashes, and funeral rites apply to the ignorant person firmly attached to ritual performance and not knowing the true nature of the Self, not to the knower. Therefore the word “atha” indicates immediate succession to that thing in whose absence the desire to know Brahman does not arise and in whose presence it necessarily arises. Knowledge of ritual action is not such a thing. Hence it is clear that here the word “atha” does not state a sequence immediately after knowledge of ritual action.

Granted that no sequence is fixed by force of meaning, as there is between the Agnihotra and preparing the gruel for it; but perhaps sequence is fixed by direct Shruti—here by the suffix “ktva.” The Jabala statement says: “Having become a householder, then become a forest-dweller; having become a forest-dweller, then renounce.” Here “having become a householder” indicates performance of sacrifice and the like. There is also a Smṛiti statement to the same effect: “Having studied the Veda according to rule, produced a son, and performed sacrifices according to one’s capacity, one should direct the mind toward liberation.” There is also a condemnatory statement: “The twice-born who desires liberation without studying the Veda, producing progeny, and performing sacrifice goes downward.” The answer is: “In the context of cutting the heart, there is a rule of immediate sequence.” That is, in a statement such as “first cut the heart, then the tongue, then the side,” the words “first” and “then” are intended to teach sequence. Here no such sequence is intended, because later in this same Scripture it is said: “Or he may renounce from any stage—studentship, householder life, or forest life.” All these statements indicate the indispensability of dispassion. Therefore Scripture says: “On the very day that dispassion arises, one should renounce.” The condemnatory statement is addressed to a person of impure intellect. Such a person does not remain steady in the means to liberation; out of laziness he also fails to perform the daily and occasional duties of a

householder and, under the burden of sin increasing at every moment, falls into a lower state. This is its meaning.

Granted that sequence is not established by direct Shruti or by force of meaning; why then should sequence not be accepted on the basis of textual order, position, principal-subordinate relation, or procedure? The answer is: "There is no evidence for a subordinate-principal relation." Auxiliary components such as fuel-sticks and principal rites such as the Agneya produce one and the same fruit, are taught by one procedural sentence, are performed by the same qualified person, and are connected with one and the same time—full moon or new moon. Because their simultaneous performance is impossible, sequence is required; and for determining the particular sequence, textual order, position, and so forth become evidence. But where there is no subordinate-principal relation, nor a rule of one fruit or performance by the same qualified person—as in separate rites such as Saurya, Aryamna, and Prajapatya—there is no need for a specific sequence; therefore textual order and the like do not become evidence determining a particular sequence, although because all words cannot be uttered simultaneously, some sequence necessarily occurs. There is no direct statement or other evidence establishing a subordinate-principal relation between the desire to know Dharma and the desire to know Brahman.

An objection is raised: even where there is no subordinate-principal relation, a rule of sequence is observed. For example, for a person desiring cattle, a milking vessel is used in the carrying of water, an auxiliary of the Darshapurnamasa sacrifice; or, in the injunction "Having performed the Darshapurnamasa, he should perform the Soma sacrifice," sequence is fixed between Darshapurnamasa and the Soma sacrifice although they are not subordinate and principal. The answer is: "Nor is there evidence for renewed eligibility in a person already eligible." A person desiring heaven is eligible for Darshapurnamasa; the same person, when desiring cattle, is eligible for the milking vessel in the carrying of water, because that vessel assists an auxiliary of Darshapurnamasa. The milk vessel does not itself directly produce cattle; nor is there a scriptural injunction introducing it into some other act, for then it would fall outside the sequence of the auxiliaries of Darshapurnamasa. But in the statement "He should carry water

with a vessel; one desiring cattle should do so with a milking vessel,” because of the close connection with carrying water and the vessel's fitness for carrying water, it is understood as dependent upon that act. Thus although the milking vessel contributes only to a human purpose, it enters the same sequence through the sequence of the carrying of water which it assists. As for the sequence between the Soma sacrifice and the Darshapurnamasa offering, its application here has already been excluded by denial of a direct injunction.

Even without a subordinate-principal relation or renewed eligibility of a person already eligible, if actions were defined by one and the same fruit a sequence could be accepted. For example, the six sacrifices beginning with the Agneya have one goal, attainment of heaven, and therefore their sequence is accepted. Or if Dharma were a limb of Brahman, a sequence could be accepted in the four chapters of the Brahmasutras, because some aspects of Brahman taught in the four chapters would be mutually connected and the identity of the object to be known would create a sequence. Then, because the desires to know Dharma and Brahman had the same object to be known, sequence between the two could be accepted. But neither situation exists here. Therefore it is said: “The fruit and the object of the desires to know are also different.” The fruit of knowledge of Dharma is *abhyudaya*, worldly prosperity, and it depends upon performance; the fruit of Brahman-knowledge is *niḥshreyasa*, the highest good, and it does not depend upon any further performance. Here “fruit of knowledge” means “fruit of the desire to know.” The difference is not merely in the nature of the fruits but also in the process of attaining them; hence it is said, “and this depends upon performance.”

Dharma, which is the object of the desire to know, has to be brought into being; at the time of knowledge it is not present, because it depends upon human action. But here the object of the desire to know is eternally existent Brahman; it exists without beginning or end and does not depend upon human action. The modes of operation of the means that provide knowledge of these two objects are also different. Scripture that teaches Dharma instructs a person by impelling him to action. Scripture concerning Brahman merely teaches; because knowledge arises from the

scriptural sentence, no action is commanded of the person with respect to knowledge. Just as knowledge of an object arises automatically from contact between sense organ and object, so too here. A thing that is to be produced is produced by the action of an agent, depends upon that action, and does not exist before its production. What exists eternally is always true; it is never false at any time. This difference between the objects of knowledge is not merely a difference of nature but also a difference in the mode of operation of their corresponding means of knowledge. Therefore it is said: “There is also a difference in the function of Scripture.”

Here the word “codana” means scriptural instruction, not merely an injunctive sentence; a general meaning is secondarily conveyed by a word that ordinarily denotes a particular kind. In authorless Scripture there is no place for an utterance expressing a commander's will, because a command is an expression of human desire; therefore here “codana” means teaching or instruction. For this very reason it has been said, “The means of knowing Dharma is instruction.” This instruction concerns “bhavana”—that is, human action taught by Scripture—and its objects, sacrifice and the like. Sacrifice and the like are objects of bhavana because the activity in the form of effort is determined in dependence upon them; even the derivation of the word “object” is understood from a root meaning binding, that is, that to which effort is bound. Scripture makes known Dharma in the form of sacrifice and the like by impelling a person to employ the means conducive to attaining the desired fruit; it makes actions known and thereby presents sacrifice as the means to attain the desired fruit. Dharma-shastra does not operate in any other way. But instruction concerning Brahman merely tells a person the truth; it does not impel him to action, because the instruction produces cognition without prescribing an act.

It may be objected: Vedanta teaches Brahman through statements such as “Know the Self”; because of syntactic unity with a sentence in injunctive form, it impels a person to the act of knowing. Therefore instruction concerning Brahman is like instruction concerning Dharma. The answer is: “With respect to knowledge, a person is not impelled to action.” The intention is this: no action can be commanded of a person with respect to realization of Brahman, because that realization is of the nature of Brahman,

eternal and unproduced. Nor can an action be commanded with respect to *nididhyasana*, because *nididhyasana*, being established by observation of positive and negative concomitance as the sole cause of knowledge, cannot become the object of an injunction. Nor is there an injunction with respect to knowledge produced by verbal testimony, because this knowledge arises unobstructedly in one who has studied the Veda, knows the relation between word and meaning, and understands the proper rules of verbal cognition. It is as with knowledge of an object arising from contact between sense and object. The commentator connects the example to the matter at hand by saying, "So too here." And if prescribing knowledge of the Self were taken to be the purport of Vedanta sentences, ascertainment of the true nature of the Self would no longer be knowledge produced by verbal testimony, because the purport of those sentences would then be an injunction to know the Self, not the nature of the Self itself. It cannot be said that because knowledge depends upon the object to be known, an object taught by a sentence whose purport lies elsewhere can nevertheless be ascertained in its real nature; for even superimposed cognition is said to depend upon an object although it is not cognition of the object's real nature. Therefore it is established that the purport of Vedanta is not an injunction to know.

The conclusion of the present discussion is stated thus: "Therefore let some such means be specified immediately after which the desire to know Brahman arises." That means, in whose absence inquiry into Brahman does not arise and in whose presence it necessarily arises, is this: discrimination between eternal and non-eternal things; dispassion toward enjoyment of fruits in this world or the next; possession of the disciplines beginning with *shama* and *dama*; and desire for liberation. When these means are present, the desire to know Brahman and knowledge of Brahman are possible either before inquiry into Dharma or after it, but not in their absence. Therefore the word "atha" indicates immediate succession to the acquisition of the qualifications just stated.

If this discrimination between eternal and non-eternal things were determinate, Brahman would already be known and the desire to know Brahman would become pointless. And if it were

merely general knowledge, not ascertainment, it could contain doubt or error distinct from a determination of truth; such knowledge could not produce dispassion. If dispassion is not produced, how could this become the cause of inquiry into Brahman? Therefore the matter should be understood thus: by “eternal and non-eternal things” their qualities are intended. “Discrimination between eternal and non-eternal things” means discrimination of their qualities together with the eternal and non-eternal substrata. It is not necessary to make specific judgments concerning each separate eternal and non-eternal substratum such as “this is true and eternal” and “this is false and non-eternal”; a general ascertainment of the distinction of eternal and non-eternal between the substrata and their qualities is sufficient. To be eternal means to be true; that in which truth is present is eternal and true, and therefore becomes an object of desire. To be non-eternal means to be false; that in which falsity is present is non-eternal and false, and therefore does not become an object of desire. Among things experienced as object and subject, as the fields of the notions “you” and “I,” what is established as true, eternal, and of the nature of happiness enters the sphere of desire; but what is impermanent, false, and filled with the three kinds of suffering should be abandoned. In a person whose intellect has been purified by actions performed in a previous birth or in this birth, this discrimination between eternal and non-eternal things arises through experience and reasoning.

It cannot be said that there is no such thing as truth, because in the absence of truth even the false that appears with truth as its substratum would be unintelligible. Even for the nihilist, emptiness itself is accepted as true. Reflecting discriminately in the light of the experience and reasoning of the finest persons in the human world, and seeing oneself together with the rest of the conscious world undergoing continuous birth and death—surrounded by the three kinds of suffering in all worlds from Satyaloka down to Avici, helplessly wandering among the waves of the ocean of transmigration—one contemplates the impermanence, impurity, and painfulness of this worldly existence through every division of time: instant, moment, watch, day, night, fortnight, month, season, half-year, year, yuga, the period of four yugas, Manvantara,

dissolution, and great dissolution. From this contemplation born of discrimination between eternal and non-eternal things arises “dispassion toward enjoyment of fruits in this world or the next.” “Artha” means a fruit that is desired. Indifference toward it after recognizing it as unfit for enjoyment is dispassion. From this comes “abundant possession of the disciplines beginning with shama and dama.” The mind, intoxicated by the liquor-like impurities of attachment and the rest, sends the various senses running toward higher and lower objects, causes many actions to be performed, and produces fruits in the form of merit and sin; into the terrible fire of transmigration it offers the Self as an oblation, and thus produces a vast mass filled with names of many sufferings.

This frenzy of the mind produced by the liquor of attachment and the rest comes to an end through the ripening of dispassion acquired by continuous practice of the contemplation described above. Then the mind, brought under the control of the Self, becomes restrained. This restraint of mind born of dispassion is called shama, or mastery in the form of shama. Making the restrained mind fit to be applied to the investigation of truth is dama or samadhana—just as a quiet and trained calf becomes fit to pull a plough or cart. The word “and so forth” in the Bhashya includes the desire to withdraw from objects, namely uparati; endurance, namely titiksha; and faith in truth. Therefore Shruti says: “Endowed with shama, dama, uparati, titiksha, samadhana, and faith, a person sees the Self in the Self and sees all things in the Self.” Possession of the disciplines beginning with shama and dama means abundant acquisition of these disciplines. After this arises the desire to be free from the bondage of worldly existence; hence the commentator says “desire for liberation.” In a person who has heard that knowledge of Brahman, eternally pure and conscious, is the cause of liberation, the desire to know Brahman can arise either before inquiry into Dharma or after it. Therefore the immediate succession conveyed by the word “atha” is only succession to this acquisition of qualifications, not succession to inquiry into Dharma.

The word “atah” indicates a cause. Vedic statements such as “Just as enjoyment obtained by action in this world is exhausted, so enjoyment obtained by Dharma in the next world is exhausted” teach the impermanence of the fruits of prosperity-producing

actions such as Agnihotra; and statements such as “The knower of Brahman attains the supreme state” teach that knowledge of Brahman accomplishes the highest human end. For this reason, immediately after abundant acquisition of the qualifications stated above, the desire to know Brahman should arise. Not only inquiry, but knowledge too arises from that inquiry; therefore the commentator says “and to know,” and at the end concludes with “therefore.” The word “atah,” occurring in sequence, is explained thus: it conveys the meaning of cause. The commentator makes its causal meaning clear by “in the Veda itself...” and so forth. Here a question arises: granted that inquiry into Brahman arises when the qualifications described above have been acquired; but this itself is inconsistent, because dispassion toward enjoyment of fruits in this world or the next is impossible. A fruit is an object of desire and is therefore understood as beneficial; how can there be dispassion toward something that itself generates attachment?

It may be said that there is dispassion toward pleasure because suffering is joined to it. But then pleasure too is joined to suffering; why should there not be attachment to suffering? Therefore a person should accept pleasure and try to remove suffering; even if suffering inevitably comes, he should treat it and enjoy only the pleasure. In this way, one who wants fish brings fish together with bones and scales, takes the edible portion and leaves the rest; one who wants grain likewise brings grain with husk, takes the useful part, and discards the remainder. Thus it is not proper to abandon beneficial pleasures of this world or the next out of fear of suffering. A farmer does not cease sowing seed because there are wild animals in the field, nor does one cease preparing food because there are beggars. An exceedingly timid person might abandon visible pleasure because the enjoyment of sandal paste or sexual pleasure is joined with suffering caused by exhaustion; but this reasoning does not apply to heavenly and other pleasures of the next world, because Shruti calls them imperishable: “We have drunk Soma; we have become immortal”; and it is also said, “The merit of one who performs the Chaturmasya sacrifice is not exhausted.” Nor can perishability be inferred here from the fact that produced things are perishable, because Shruti sublates such

an inference, just as an inference of the purity of a human skull from its similarity to a conch is sublated.

Thus the qualifications described above would prove nonexistent, and there would be no occasion for the desire to know Brahman. To refute this conclusion, the revered sutra-author uses the word “atah,” and the commentator explains its meaning with “in the Veda itself...” and so forth. The purport is this: the many kinds of suffering caused by animals, beggars, and so forth may obstruct the fruits of agriculture or cooking, but remedies for them are possible. Dependence upon external means over long periods and continual diminution—these two are inseparably joined to every kind of produced pleasure. Even the finest cook cannot separate poison from food in which poison has been mixed with honey and eat the honey alone. Thus statements such as “Enjoyment obtained by action in this world...” which teach diminution determine the secondary sense of statements such as “Having drunk Soma we have become immortal,” because the primary meaning of the latter is impossible. A Puranic statement says: “Continuance until dissolution is called immortality.” Here the word “Brahman” brings to mind the means of knowledge of Brahman, namely the Veda. The relevant statements such as “Enjoyment obtained by action in this world...” are taken by the pronoun “atah” as the cause; the ablative suffix “tas” indicates their causal status.

Brahmajijnasa means the desire to know Brahman. Brahman is that whose characteristic will be stated later by the sutra “From which the origination and so forth of this world proceed.” Therefore there is no doubt here that the word “Brahman” might mean a class or something else. The word “Brahmanah,” in the genitive case, has an objective meaning, not the meaning of some residual general relation, because a desire to know necessarily requires an object to be known, and no other thing has been stated as the object to be known. The pronoun “atah” takes up the cause stated in the preceding sentence, and the ablative case with the suffix “tas” indicates causality. Granted that the bliss of Brahman, like produced pleasures such as heaven, might be accompanied by suffering; the answer is that Scripture teaches: “Through knowledge of Brahman a person attains the supreme goal.” Shruti declares the

exhaustion of enjoyments such as heaven and calls Brahman-knowledge the highest human end; therefore abundant acquisition of the qualifications stated above will occur and inquiry into Brahman will certainly arise. The meaning of the compound “Brahmajijnasa” is “desire to know Brahman.” It is taken as a genitive tatpurusha compound; the interpretation of earlier commentators as a dative compound, “brahmane jijnasa”—inquiry for Brahman—is to be understood as rejected here. Katyayana's rule is that in a dative compound the relation between a basic substance and its modification is understood.

A dative compound occurs only where there is a relation between an original substance and its modification, as in “wood for a sacrificial post,” or a stake for tying the sacrificial animal. Where the members of a compound do not stand in such a substance-modification relation, there is no dative compound. Expressions such as “fodder for a horse” are accepted as genitive compounds. Even in the genitive compound, the prominence of Brahman in relation to the “desire to know” is intelligible, because the desire to know has been stated as principal in the sentence. Granted that in “desire to know Brahman” the word “Brahman” is used in many meanings; then a doubt may arise: inquiry into which Brahman is intended? In “Brahmahatya” it means the Brahmin class; in “brahmojjham” it means the Veda; and in “the knower of Brahman becomes Brahman itself” it means the Supreme Self. The commentator removes this doubt by saying, “Brahman is that whose characteristic will be stated later.” Inquiry into Brahman is first assumed and then the characteristic of the Supreme Self is stated; from this it is understood that here the inquiry is only into the Supreme Self, not into the Brahmin class and so forth. Nevertheless, an objection remains that the genitive should be understood not objectively but as expressing a residual general relation. Such a relation indicates general connection, not only an object-relation; “desire to know concerning Brahman” could therefore mean a desire to know everything related to Brahman.

Things auxiliary to the desire to know Brahman—Brahman's nature, the means of knowing it, reasoning, the means of attainment, and the fruit—being directly or indirectly related to Brahman, could all be understood within the expression

“Brahmajijnasa.” But if the genitive is taken objectively, “Brahman” will indicate only the object, namely the nature of Brahman; the means of knowledge and so forth will not be included, and then inquiry would arise into topics not yet introduced. To one who holds such a view, the answer is given: “The word ‘Brahmanah’ in the genitive has an objective meaning.” The reason is stated: “For a desire to know, an object fit to be known is required.” The accomplishment of inquiry is connected with knowledge, and the object of knowledge is Brahman. In the absence of an object to be known, knowledge is not determined; and in the absence of knowledge, inquiry is not determined. Inquiry primarily requires an object, not a general relation; even without a general relation, when an object is present inquiry is determined. After seeing the sun or moon, one does not ask, “To what is this related?” But upon hearing the word “knowledge,” why should one not ask “knowledge of what?”—that is, what is its object? Therefore, because it is what is principally required, Brahman is connected only as the object, not through a general relation. The general relation would be secondary. Consequently, the compound is a genitive tatpurusha in which the genitive is objective.

Granted that the genitive is accepted in the general sense of residual relation; even then there is no contradiction of the fact that Brahman is the object of inquiry, because a general relation itself rests upon some specific relation. Nevertheless, the effort of one who abandons Brahman's direct objecthood and accepts indirect objecthood by way of a general relation is pointless. Now an objection is raised: true, inquiry cannot be determined in the absence of an object to be known; but inquiry might have some other object, while Brahman is connected with it through a residual relation. The commentator answers: “No other thing has been stated as fit to be known.” To abandon direct objecthood, which is what inquiry primarily requires and is first fit to be connected, and to make some general relation, required only later in some way, principal—this would make the secondary primary and the primary secondary. Even the terms “direct” and “indirect” relation are based upon this order.

But this is not pointless, it may be said, because its purpose would be to include by presupposition inquiry into all the

remaining topics dependent upon Brahman. The answer is: no; because when the principal is accepted, all the topics dependent upon it are automatically included by postulation. Brahman, the thing most desired to be attained through knowledge, is principal. Once that principal is accepted as the object of the desire to know, all those matters without separate desire to know which inquiry into Brahman would nevertheless be impossible are automatically included by postulation; no separate mention of them in the sutra is necessary. Just as when it is said “The king is going here,” the going of his entire retinue together with the king is understood, so should it be understood here. This is also in accordance with Shruti.

The expressions used in the Bhashya, “principal” and “subordinate,” correspond to “explicit” and “implicit.” The objector states his view thus: “This is not pointless, because its purpose would be to presuppose inquiry into all remaining matters dependent upon Brahman.” This has been explained above. The Siddhantin states his position with “No; because when the principal is accepted...” and so forth. Though not explicitly present in the sentence, Brahman has real primacy. The remaining meaning of the Bhashya, together with the example, is clear; the support of Shruti is also readily understood.

The Shruti passage beginning “From which these beings are born” and the statement “Desire to know that Brahman; that is Brahman” clearly show that Brahman is the object of the desire to know. When the genitive case is accepted in the objective sense, this fully agrees with the sutra. Therefore the word “Brahmanah” in the genitive has an objective meaning.

Jijnasa is the desire to know. The object of the desire expressed by the desiderative suffix is the knowledge that culminates in direct realization, because a fruit is the object of desire. In fact, Brahman is what is to be directly realized through knowledge produced by a means of knowledge. Direct realization of Brahman is a human end, because it uproots Avidya and all other evils and the entire seed of transmigration. Therefore Brahman itself is fit to be the object of the desire to know.

Having thus established the compound accepted by him, the commentator explains the meaning of the word “jijnasa” by saying,

“Jijnasa is the desire to know.” Granted. But knowledge is not an object of desire; the real sphere of desire is attainment of pleasure or removal of suffering, or the means to these is desired. Brahma-knowledge is not of this kind. Its experience is neither like the gain of pleasure nor like the cessation of something undesirable, nor is it a means to either—for after knowledge arises, no special pleasure is seen and suffering continues. Still, it does not follow merely from the sutra-author's statement that knowledge is an object of desire. In answer to this objection it is said: “knowledge that culminates in direct realization.” Mere knowledge is not desired; rather, the knowledge that culminates in realization or experience is desired. The object of the desire expressed by the desiderative suffix is that knowledge which culminates in realization. “Because the fruit is the object of desire” should be understood in the sense that desire continues to operate toward the means until the fruit is obtained.

Granted that knowledge culminates in direct realization; does it thereby become desirable? Knowledge of an unnecessary thing does not become desired even if it culminates in direct realization. The answer is: “In fact, Brahman is what is to be directly realized through knowledge produced by a means of knowledge.” Granted that there is direct realization concerning Brahman; why is it desired? The answer is: “Direct realization of Brahman is indeed a human end.” Is it prosperity? No; it is the supreme bliss that is the nature of Brahman, undivided and manifest when all impurities of suffering have been removed. Therefore it is the highest human end.

Granted that direct realization of Brahman is not a human end, because a human end is something pervaded by human effort. In realization that is of the nature of Brahman there is none of production, modification, purification, or acquisition; Brahman is eternal and therefore cannot be pervaded by human action. How then is realization of Brahman a human end? The answer is: “Because it uproots evils such as Avidya and the entire seed of transmigration.” It is true that there is no production and so forth in realization of Brahman's nature; but under the influence of beginningless and indefinable Avidya, the nature of Brahman, though not illuminated by another light and though itself luminous, appears as though unmanifest and as though illuminated by

another; although distinct from body, senses, and so forth, it appears as though non-different from them. Thus before destruction of Avidya and the other seeds of transmigration, Brahman is as though unattained, and after their destruction it is as though attained. In this form a person desires it; therefore it is properly called a human end.

In “Avidya and so forth,” the words “and so forth” include the impressions of Avidya. The cessation of Avidya and the rest occurs through the force of direct realization born of reflection—an experience in the form of a Brahman-shaped modification of the inner organ. Therefore, for a seeker of liberation endowed with the qualifications stated above, Brahman alone is the proper object of the desire to know. Without such knowledge, Avidya and its impressions—the root cause of many sufferings—are not destroyed; and without their destruction, the experience of the supreme bliss that is the Jiva's nature as Brahman, in which all impurities of suffering disappear, does not manifest. Therefore, for one who desires realization of the bliss that is Brahman's nature, its means—knowledge—must be desired. This knowledge does not arise automatically from Vedanta sentences alone; it arises with inquiry into Brahman as an auxiliary. Consequently, through desire a person engages in inquiry into Brahman, not in a desire to determine the meaning of Vedanta sentences, because that purpose has already been accomplished by the sutra “Athato dharmajijnasa,” which indicates the injunction to study one's Veda and the understanding of its meaning. Inquiry into Dharma indicates inquiry into the meaning of the Veda, and knowledge of Dharma, being a part of the complete meaning of the Veda, secondarily includes knowledge of Brahman and Adharma as well. Thus inquiry into Brahman, like inquiry into Dharma, may be indicated by inquiry into the meaning of the Veda, but there is no rule that it must begin immediately after inquiry into Dharma. Nor does inquiry into Brahman begin merely immediately after Vedic study. Therefore this sutra is stated in order to begin inquiry into Brahman and to show that it follows immediately upon qualifications such as discrimination between eternal and non-eternal things; hence there is no repetition.

Granted that this sutra states inquiry to be the means of Brahman-knowledge. But this is not reasonable, because it cannot be examined. Therefore the question arises: “Then Brahman...” Brahman must be either known or unknown. If it is known, there should be no desire to know it; and if it is unknown, a desire to know it is altogether impossible.

The answer is: Brahman, eternal, pure, conscious, free, omniscient, and omnipotent, certainly exists. One who considers the derivation of the word “Brahman” understands, in accordance with the meaning of the root *brih*, meanings such as eternality and purity. Because Brahman is the Self of all, its existence is well known. Every person knows his own existence; no one knows “I do not exist.” If the existence of the Self were not well known, the entire world would cognize “I do not exist.” And the Self itself is Brahman.

The authorless sentences of Vedanta are intrinsically valid. Brahman must be either known or unknown. If it is known, it has already become the object of determinate cognition produced by Vedanta sentences; therefore there should be no further desire to know it, because a means of knowledge that has produced its fruit does not operate again upon its object—otherwise the definition of a means of knowledge would be violated. And if Brahman is not known from Vedanta, Vedanta does not teach it; consequently Brahman would remain forever unknown and no desire to know it could arise. Desire concerns something experienced and dear, never something wholly unexperienced. Granted that it may be dear; still, in the absence of a means of knowledge, knowledge of it is impossible. Verbal testimony must be said to be the means of its knowledge; this will be taught later by “*shastrayonitvat*.” If Scripture does not make Brahman known, whence comes its validity concerning Brahman? And no other means of knowledge applies to Brahman. Therefore a known object is not the object of a desire to know, while an unknown object can be neither desired nor known; consequently inquiry into Brahman is impossible. This is the objection.

The solution is: “Brahman, eternal, pure, conscious, and free, certainly exists.” The intention is that even before inquiry into Brahman begins, a person who has studied the Veda, studied

Nirukta, grammar, and so forth, understood the relation between words and meanings, and grasped the general meaning of the sentences from “In the beginning there was only Being” to “tat tvam asi,” obtains a general cognition of Brahman as eternal and so forth; this is possible even without inquiry. By referring to the object of knowledge with words such as “Brahman” in the Bhashya, knowledge concerning Brahman is secondarily indicated as well; for at the beginning of inquiry Brahman's existence is not altogether unknown, but only doubtful. The word “eternal” negates suffering caused by decay; “pure” removes suffering caused by limiting adjuncts such as body; “conscious” shows Brahman as the blissful Self that is not illuminated by another light but is itself luminous, because bliss and luminosity are non-different.

Granted. If liberation already existed, Brahman's qualities such as eternal purity would already be manifest; but before liberation, because of the cognition of identity with bodily properties such as birth, old age, and death, there is relation to suffering. The answer is: “free.” Brahman is always free; nevertheless, through the delusion of beginningless Avidya it appears as though non-different from body and so forth. Having thus shown Brahman's unconditioned form, the commentator states its form conditioned by Avidya: “omniscient and omnipotent.” This is established on the basis of being the cause of the world, because whether something becomes a cause or not depends upon the presence or absence of power and knowledge. Again, whence comes realization of Brahman in this form? The answer is: “One who analyzes the meaning of the word ‘Brahman’...” Experience of Brahman in this form comes not only from considering the sequence and context of sentences such as “In the beginning there was Being alone,” but also from the derivation of the word “Brahman” itself. The root *brih* indicates growth or excellence; because of this excellence, qualities such as eternality, purity, and consciousness taught by other expressions are fitting in Brahman.

Having thus shown purity and the like to be well known in the literal meaning of “tat,” the commentator speaks concerning the literal meaning of “tvam”: “Because Brahman is the Self of all, its existence is well known.” The existence of Brahman is well known to everyone, even an ordinary farmer with dust-covered feet.

Whence? Because it is his very Self. Hence it is said: “Every person knows his own existence.” Then, by saying “not not,” ignorance of the Self is negated and knowledge of the Self is confirmed: a person does not fail to know “I exist,” but knows it with certainty. Someone may say: even while knowing “I exist,” one may not know the Self. The answer is: “If the existence of the Self were not well known...” If he did not know the Self in the form of the Jiva, the substratum of “I-ness,” there would be no cognition of “I” either. Granted that everyone knows the Self, the substratum of “I-ness”; what connection does that have with Brahman? The answer is: “And the Self itself is Brahman.” Because of the co-ordinate relation between “tat” and “tvam”: from Shruti, purity, consciousness, and the like belonging to the literal meaning of “tat” are known; from direct experience, the Jiva denoted by “tvam” is known; and knowledge of the word-meanings precedes knowledge of the sentence-meaning. Therefore from the sentence “tat tvam asi” the Jiva denoted by “tvam” is experienced as being of the nature of Brahman.

If Brahman as the Self is well known in ordinary life, then it is already known; there should therefore be no desire to know it. The answer is: no, because there are many mutually contradictory views concerning its specific nature. Ordinary people and Lokayatas regard the Self as merely the conscious body. Some others call only the conscious senses the Self. Some regard the mind as the Self. Some take mere momentary cognition as the Self, and some emptiness. Still others accept a Self distinct from the body, passing from one body to another, an agent and enjoyer.

The objector points out the defect in the first of these alternatives: “If in ordinary tradition...” Here “ordinary tradition” means the teacher-pupil succession. If from the sentence “tat tvam asi” Brahman is well known as the Self—where one should say “the Self whose nature is Brahman”—then this is stated for the purpose of teaching identity; it would follow again that, because it is known, Brahman is not an object of inquiry. The answer is: “No.” Why? “Because there are many mutually contradictory views concerning its specific nature.” Such contradictory views, in the absence of proof, become the cause of uncertainty. Therefore, although the general existence of Brahman is known, its true specific nature is doubtful; for this reason inquiry is necessary.

According to some, the Self is only an enjoyer, not an agent. Others say that there is an omniscient and omnipotent Lord distinct from that Self. Still others hold that the Lord is the Self of that enjoying Jiva. In this way many people adopt different views on the basis of reasoning and scriptural statements that are either established by valid means or erroneous. One who accepts any one of these views without inquiry will be deprived of the highest good and obtain evil. Therefore, beginning with the statement of the desire to know Brahman, respectful inquiry into the sentences of Vedanta is undertaken; reasoning that does not conflict with Vedanta is its auxiliary, and attainment of supreme bliss is its purpose.

Because of these differences of view, the desire to know Brahman is reasonable. The general existence of the substratum that is the subject of dispute must be accepted as established by the conclusions of all systems; otherwise mutually contradictory views could not arise, because unsupported views cannot contradict one another. Views concerning different substrata are likewise not mutually contradictory: “the intellect is impermanent” and “the Self is eternal” do not contradict one another. Therefore all systems accept that the purity and other properties of the referent of “tat,” known from Vedanta, reside in some substratum, and that the Jiva denoted by “tvam” is established by experience. Difference of opinion concerns only the manner in which it is manifest or unmanifest and its various states. Thus, even when the substratum is generally known, doubt concerning its specific nature is entirely proper because contradictory views exist.

Among these views, the commentator first shows contradictory conceptions concerning the referent of “tvam,” beginning with “ordinary people” and continuing through “only an enjoyer, not an agent.” If the Self is regarded as the conscious body, the senses, the mind, or momentary cognition, the properties such as eternality belonging to the referent of “tat” cannot belong to the referent of “tvam,” because the two are mutually incompatible. As for the nihilists, how can that which they regard as inexpressible and as the meaning of no word be taken as the referent of “tat” and “tvam”? A Self that is agent and enjoyer also, because it is subject to modification, does not accord with the eternality and other

properties of the referent of “tat.” In the doctrine that takes the Self not as agent but only as enjoyer, enjoyership still indicates modification, so incompatibility with eternality and the like remains. In a view that regards Selves as many, even if they are not taken to be enjoyers, plurality gives rise to defects such as impermanence and abandons non-duality.

Just as there are contradictory views concerning the referent of “tvam,” there are differences of opinion concerning the referent of “tat” as well. Lokayatas and those who reject the Veda as a means of knowledge regard cognition of the referent of “tat” as false. Even among those who accept the Veda as valid, some say that the referent of “tat” is only figurative or is not the principal subject taught by Vedanta sentences. Thus, in showing differences of view concerning the referent of “tvam,” the commentator also indicates differences concerning the referent of “tat.”

Now a contradictory view directly concerning the referent of “tat” is stated: some say that there is an omniscient and omnipotent Lord distinct from the Jivas. Here “tat” is used in contrast to the individual Selves. The Lord is distinct not only from the body and so forth but also from the Jivas, and is the ruler of the entire world. Omniscience and omnipotence, His two natural qualities, are stated to establish His rulership. But this Lord, distinct from the Jivas, cannot stand in a relation of co-ordinate predication with the referent of “tvam.” Therefore the final view is stated: “Some say that the Lord is the Self of the enjoyer.” That is, the Lord denoted by “tat” is the Self of the enjoying Jiva conditioned by Avidya; therefore the Jiva is in reality non-different from the Lord, just as pot-space is non-different from great space.

Having finished mentioning the contradictory views, the commentator states their cause: “In this way many people...” Some views are based on sound reasoning, some on fallacious reasoning; some on scriptural statements understood in their correct sense, some on scriptural statements given an improper interpretation. Granted that contradictory views exist and thereby produce doubt; why nevertheless should inquiry into Brahman be begun? The answer is: “The person who accepts any one of these views without inquiry...” The highest good is attained by true knowledge, not by false knowledge. Because false knowledge destroys faith and leads

to evil, it is said, “and he will obtain evil.” Finally, with the word “therefore,” the purport of the sutra is concluded.

In inquiry into Vedanta, reasoning concerned with the meaning of Vedanta sentences is primary. Other reasoning consistent with it is also auxiliary—for example, Purva Mimamsa in the examination of the validity of the Veda, and the reasoning of Nyaya in the examination of means of knowledge such as perception. Inquiry into Brahman, to which these are auxiliaries, is discussed here. Therefore inquiry into Brahman, which produces Brahma-knowledge and becomes the means to the highest good, must certainly be begun.

Brahman has been accepted as the object to be known. What, now, is the defining characteristic of this Brahman? The revered sutra-author says:

From which the birth and so forth of this world proceed

Having established in the first sutra that beginning inquiry is proper, the sutra-author now begins the investigation of Brahman: “From which the birth and so forth of this world proceed.” Introducing this sutra, the commentator says: “It has been said that one should desire to know Brahman. What now is the defining characteristic of this Brahman?” Although by taking knowledge of Brahman's nature as the principal subject, the auxiliary topics of means of knowledge and so forth are also pledged, Brahman's own nature is principal; therefore it is first established through objection and resolution. Whatever comes within experience is limited, impure, inert, and perishable. Brahman's nature cannot be characterized by knowledge of these things, because Brahman is their opposite—eternal, pure, and of the nature of consciousness. No one characterizes an eternal thing by means of a produced thing.

Nor can Brahman be characterized by its own qualities such as eternality, because these qualities are not already known. A characteristic is given through something well known, not through something wholly unknown. Nor can mere verbal testimony establish the characteristic here; for if Brahman is altogether unknown, it cannot be the meaning of any word and consequently cannot be the meaning of a sentence. Therefore, in the absence of a defining characteristic, Brahman cannot become an object of the desire to know. This is the objector's position.

The revered sutra-author answers this objection: “From which the birth and so forth of this world proceed.” The world established by experience is not itself a defining characteristic of Brahman because it is Brahman's quality or identical with it; rather, because it arises from Brahman, the world can characterize Brahman—just as arrival in different regions is a mark of the sun's motion. “Birth and so forth” means origination, continuance, and dissolution. For brevity the sutra-author uses the neuter expression “janmadi”; to

make this clear the commentator gives the co-ordinate neuter terms birth, continuance, and destruction.

The primacy of origination among origination, continuance, and dissolution is established both by the statement of Shruti and by the nature of things. Shruti says: “From which these beings are born.” The sequence of origination, continuance, and dissolution is also natural; continuance and destruction belong to a substratum that has come into existence through origination. In the expression “of this world,” the word “this” indicates the world known through perception and other means of knowledge; the genitive case shows its relation to origination and so forth. “From which” designates the cause.

The ordered construction of this world—divided by name and form, filled with many agents and enjoyers, and definitely arranged by place, time, cause, action, and fruit—is difficult even to imagine mentally. The cause from which the origination and so forth of such a world proceed is omniscient and omnipotent Brahman. The sentence of the sutra is completed thus: “That from which the birth and so forth of this world proceed is Brahman.”

The expressions “divided by name and form” and so forth are self-explanatory. Granted that many possible causes of the world are under discussion—primordial Prakriti, time, planetary deities or the activity of directional guardians such as Indra, chance, the inherent nature of things, or non-being. Why then should omniscient and omnipotent Brahman be accepted as the cause of the world's origination and so forth? The answer is: “divided by name and form, filled with many agents and enjoyers...” The qualifications beginning with “divided” establish an intelligent cause and exclude the causality of insentient Pradhana, imagined causes, non-being, and the like.

Things such as pots, divided by name and form, are observed to be produced by intelligent makers. The world under dispute too is divided by name and form; therefore an intelligent maker must be accepted for it. A potter first considers in his intelligence the name “pot” and a form such as a contracted neck, and then makes the external pot. Thus the pot to be produced is present beforehand in the maker's intention as an object-cause: “he makes the pot.” Nyaya

too says: "What is present in the intellect is not absolute non-being." An insentient thing that cannot conceive anything in its own intelligence cannot be imagined as creating the world.

It may be said that intelligent planetary deities or guardians of the directions conceive name and form in their intelligence and make the world; then Brahman of the nature described above is unnecessary. The answer is: "filled with many agents and enjoyers." Some persons, like cooks and priests at a sacrifice, are agents but not enjoyers. Others, like the ancestors in a Shraddha and the son in a Vaishvanara offering, are enjoyers but not agents. Therefore the sutra mentions both agents and enjoyers.

Place, time, cause, action, and fruit form an itaretara-dvandva compound and each term should be taken separately. This world is the dwelling place of these agents and enjoyers. In this world some creatures arise in definite places, such as the black antelope. Some occur at definite times, such as the call of the cuckoo. Some through definite causes, such as the conception of a heron caused by thunder at the beginning of the rainy season. Some perform definite actions, such as only a Brahmin, and not another, being entitled to perform a sacrifice for someone else. Likewise some experience definite fruits: some are happy and some unhappy; and one who is happy here may be unhappy elsewhere.

Such subtle order does not accord with chance, mere inherent nature, or a limited agent lacking omniscience and omnipotence. The knowledge and power of planetary deities and guardians of directions are limited; therefore they cannot know and construct the entire world. Even the complete design of a single body cannot at any one time be easily imagined by the mind, much less the design of the entire universe. Therefore Brahman alone is the omniscient and omnipotent cause of the origination, continuance, and dissolution of the world. Thus the remaining sentence of the sutra is completed: "That is Brahman."

Granted. But why should the expression "birth and so forth" be understood as referring only to origination, continuance, and dissolution? Why not to such modifications of being as growth, transformation, and decay? The answer is that all the other modifications of being are included within these three; therefore

only origination, continuance, and dissolution are stated here. Yaska enumerates six modifications of being: it is born, it exists, it grows, it changes form, it declines, and it perishes. But growth and the like occur during the period in which the world continues to exist; hence a doubt might arise that the world's origination, continuance, and dissolution from the primal cause are not clearly indicated. In order to remove this doubt, the three—origination from Brahman, continuance in Brahman, and dissolution into Brahman—are principally intended.

Growth is the increase of parts. Just as from two threads a large cloth having many parts is produced, so growth is in fact included under origination. Transformation is said to be of three kinds according to the characteristics of dharma—

Change of state and change of characteristic are likewise fundamentally forms of origination. For example, when a bracelet is made in the substratum that is gold, this is a change in the characteristic of the dharma; it is simply the origination of the bracelet. Similarly, the present existence and the like of the bracelet constitute change of characteristic; this too is origination. Differences such as newness and oldness constitute change of state; this also is origination. Decay is the diminution of parts and therefore is included under destruction. Thus, as appropriate, growth and the like are included within origination and the rest; hence they are not mentioned separately. Even if it be granted that these are not included within origination and the rest, it would still be proper to mention only origination, continuance, and dissolution, because the Vedic sentence, "From which these beings are born," and so forth, would thereby be recalled and Brahman would be ascertained as the primal cause of the world. Otherwise, by taking origination, existence, growth, and so forth, one would recall the passage in Yaska's Nirukta, which discusses not the primal cause but the transformations of a thing during the period of its continuance after creation. To avoid this objection, only the origination, continuance, and dissolution spoken of in the Veda have been taken here.

The origination and so forth of a world endowed with the characteristics described above cannot be admitted to proceed from

any cause other than unconscious Pradhana, atoms, non-existence, an embodied Jiva, or the omniscient and omnipotent Lord. Nor can it arise merely from the intrinsic nature of things, because dependence upon a particular place, time, and cause is observed here. Those who infer the Lord's causal agency regard this inference as proof of the existence and other attributes of a Lord distinct from embodied Jivas. Granted that if origination alone is stated, continuance and dissolution are necessarily understood; then what is the purpose of the words "birth and so forth" in the Sutra? The answer is: "Brahman is the cause of birth and so forth," and so on. By this expression Brahman's status as the material cause is indicated; mere origination is common also to an efficient cause and therefore does not make material causality clear. The purpose of the previously mentioned special cause and effect has been stated in the sentence, "the world endowed with the characteristics described above," and so forth. By this passage the nature of the Brahman proposed in the thesis has been established in the form of a defining characteristic; the means of knowing it will be stated subsequently.

Nor is it the case that in the Sutra "From which the birth and so forth of this world proceed" the very same subject has again merely been stated as a thesis. The purpose of the Sutras is to string together the Vedanta sentences on one thread like a garland of flowers. For the inquiry into and confirmation of the realization of Brahman proceed precisely on the basis of those Vedanta sentences which are made the subject of the Sutras. The Naiyayikas say that a subject admitted as possible in a thesis can be established by proof, but no proof can save a thesis that is contradicted the moment it is stated, as in "a barren woman is a mother." For this reason origination and so forth are taken as the ground of the thesis. The Vaisheshikas and others also infer the Lord on this basis. The commentator says this in order to establish firmly these grounds as reasons supporting the thesis—"by this inference," and so forth. By saying "here also," the question is raised: when the subject under discussion has been concluded by this context, why is a question about the subject of the next context raised through the example of a friend's capacity? The answer is that the Sutras are intended to arrange in order the purport of the Vedanta sentences. Through

inquiry into the Vedanta sentences, the twofold Avidya—concealment and latent impression—is destroyed and the manifestation of Brahman, that is, realization, is accomplished.

At the end of the treatise, as soon as the inquiry into the meaning of the Vedanta sentences is completed, the manifestation of Brahman is accomplished; it is not accomplished by inference or other independent means of knowledge. Nevertheless, in order to confirm the meaning of the Vedanta sentences that declare the cause of the world's origination, inference too is a means of knowledge so long as it does not contradict Vedanta, because Scripture itself regards reasoning as an aid. Shruti says, "It is to be heard and reflected upon"; and, "The learned and intelligent man reaches the country of Gandhara"—that is, one who has a teacher receives assistance from his own intelligence. If it is said that in regard to this Brahman there is no means of knowledge other than verbal testimony, then whence would reflection arise, and whence realization of Brahman? The answer is: "But there are the Vedanta sentences." Here inference is to be understood as of the kind that does not conflict with Vedanta and depends upon Vedanta. A reasoned determination that does not contradict verbal testimony and proceeds on its basis is called reflection. Reasoning may take the form either of inference or of postulation.

It is not the case with the desire to know Brahman as it is with the desire to know Dharma, where Shruti and the like alone are means of knowledge; here Shruti and the like, experience and the like—all, wherever applicable, are means of knowledge, because knowledge of Brahman culminates in experience. Granted. When human intelligence is not an aid in knowing Dharma, why should it be an aid in knowing Brahman? The answer is: "Not as in the inquiry into Dharma." In matters of Dharma, Shruti, Itihasa, Purana, and Smriti are means of knowledge. Experience is a particular modification of the inner organ, namely realization of Brahman; the fruit of this means of knowledge is the manifestation of Brahman's own nature when Avidya has been removed. The word "fruit" is used figuratively, because this is not something newly produced or refined. In the inquiry into Dharma, perception and other forms of experience function as auxiliary aids, not

directly; but in the inquiry into Brahman, experience—that is, realization—functions directly. The subject of the inquiry into Brahman is Brahman itself, which is accessible to experience; therefore it is said, “Knowledge of Brahman culminates in experience.” Experience of Brahman, that is, realization of Brahman, is the supreme human end because, after all suffering has been destroyed, it is of the nature of supreme bliss.

And the object of Brahma-knowledge is an existent thing. In the case of what ought to be done, only Scripture has authority, because it does not depend upon experience and the existence of what ought to be done depends upon a person's action. A worldly or Vedic action may be done, not done, or done otherwise—as one may go on horseback, on foot, in another way, or not go at all. Likewise injunctions and prohibitions such as “use sixteen vessels in the Atiratra,” “do not use sixteen vessels”; “offer after sunrise,” “offer before sunrise” are meaningful as alternatives, general rules, and exceptions. Granted that the object of inquiry is the experience of Brahman; but the objection that Brahman cannot be its object is answered by: “And the object of Brahma-knowledge is an existent thing.” The relation of knower and known is a false form of a mental modification belonging to the realm of the world. Knowledge of Dharma does not culminate in such experience, because experience of Dharma is not itself a human end; the fruit attained by observing Dharma is the human end. Mere verbal testimony determines the performance of Dharma; experience is unnecessary.

An object does not admit alternatives such as “in this way” or “not in this way,” “exists” or “does not exist.” Alternatives depend upon human intelligence; but knowledge of the true nature of an object depends not upon human intelligence but upon the object itself. Regarding one and the same post, true cognition cannot be both “this is a post” and “this is a man.” “This is a post or some other man” is erroneous cognition; “this is certainly a post” is true cognition because it depends upon the object. Therefore the validity concerning an existent object is object-governed. What is to be done is not presently existent as such, because it is not yet determined; “the existence of what ought to be done depends upon the person

who performs the action.” Agency in worldly and Vedic action depends upon the person, and therefore the act may be done or not done. Going by horse and the like shows the indeterminacy of worldly action, while provisions concerning vessels in the Atiratna and the like show the indeterminacy of Vedic action.

A person has freedom concerning what ought to be done; therefore injunction and prohibition are meaningful, because doing or abandoning an act is under his control. “It should be used” is an injunction; “it should not be used” is a prohibition. The rule of offering before or after sunrise, the prohibition against touching a human bone, and the special rule that one guilty of Brahmin-killing should wear an ornament made of such bone—these are injunctions and prohibitions of this kind. They are meaningful as alternatives, general rules, and exceptions. If two mutually contradictory rules of equal force apply in one place, an alternative is unavoidable. The general prohibition against touching human bone is overridden by the special rule concerning an ornament for one guilty of Brahmin-killing; therefore here there is not an alternative but an exception. Only through injunction and prohibition is established such a previously unattained but producible state of affairs regarding which a person is free to act or refrain.

It is not so with existent things; hence it is said: “An object does not admit alternatives—this way or that way, existent or non-existent.” Here alternative concerning the existence or non-existence of a substance is denied. Granted that alternatives are also seen regarding an existent thing, as in “this is a post or a man.” How then can it be said that the object does not admit alternatives? The answer is: the alternative occurs in a person's inner organ. Doubt and error depend upon the inner organ and its impressions—like a dream upon the mind alone, or upon the combined activity of mind, senses, and impressions. Doubt whether a post is a man, or the illusion of a man in a post, does not depend upon the actual post or man; it depends upon apprehension of a substratum possessing common features. Therefore doubt and error do not alter the object's nature. True cognition depends not upon the intellect but

upon the object; therefore the nature of the object is determined by valid cognition, not by doubt and the like.

Then Brahma-knowledge too is object-governed, because its object is an existent thing. If it is an existent thing, Brahman must be the object of other means of knowledge; would inquiry into Vedanta sentences then not become pointless? No, because Brahman is not an object of the senses, and therefore its relation is not apprehended through other means of knowledge. The senses naturally apprehend their objects, not Brahman. If Brahman were an object of the senses, the senses would apprehend its causal relation. Here the question arises: sentences about existent things are often mere restatements, as in “there is fruit on the riverbank.” Vedanta sentences too concern an existent thing; would they then be only repetitions of what is known through other means? No. An inference based on the origination and so forth of the world has been mentioned as another means concerning Brahman, but it does not reveal Brahman's complete nature. The purpose of Vedanta is direct knowledge of the non-dual nature of Brahman, which is impossible through the senses or independent inference.

When it has not been understood whether the relation is with Brahman or with something else, no determination can be made. Therefore the sutra “From which the birth and so forth of this world proceed” is not intended to indicate an inference, but to point out Vedanta sentences. Which Vedanta sentence is indicated by this sutra? Bhṛigu, the son of Varuna, approached his father Varuna and said, “Revered sir, teach me Brahman.” Beginning from this, it is said: “Desire to know that from which these beings are born, by which, when born, they live, and into which they finally enter; that is Brahman.” This is the decisive statement concerning the matter. “From Bliss indeed these beings are born; by Bliss, when born, they live; into Bliss they enter” is also a decisive statement. Other Vedanta passages can likewise be cited that teach Brahman's eternally pure, eternally conscious, eternally free nature and its character as the omniscient cause.

We have already discussed this matter in detail in the Nyayakanika. It will also be made clear later that because they have an existent thing as their subject, Vedanta sentences are not mere

repetitions. Thus everything is clear. Shruti shows origination by “from which,” continuance by “by which, when born, they live,” and dissolution by “into which they enter.” The statement “This is the decisive sentence on the matter” removes the possibility that Pradhana or the like might be intended; the decisive statement is “from Bliss indeed.” That is, just as a rope together with Avidya is the material cause of the snake—the snake appears while the rope exists and dissolves into the rope—so Brahman together with Avidya is the material cause of the world; the world abides in Brahman and dissolves into Brahman.

Because it is the source of Scripture

By describing causality with respect to the world, it has been indicated that Brahman is omniscient. To make this firm it is said: “Because it is the source of Scripture.” Brahman is the source, that is, the cause, of the vast body of Scripture consisting of the Rigveda and the rest, filled with innumerable branches of learning and illuminating all things like a torch, a body of Scripture that is comparable to an omniscient being. Such a body of Scripture, consisting of the Rigveda and the rest and possessing the quality of omniscience, can arise only from an omniscient reality. When a treatise on some extensive subject, such as grammar, arises from a particular person such as Panini, experience establishes that its author possesses knowledge broader than the subject matter expressed in the treatise. Then how could one refuse to accept the incomparable omniscience and omnipotence of that great Being from whom, effortlessly like breath, arises Scripture divided into many branches such as the Rigveda and containing deities, lower beings, human beings, distinctions of varna and ashrama, and the entire treasury of knowledge?

Scripture establishes omniscience. “The great body of Scripture consisting of the Rigveda and the rest”: the Rigveda and the rest are called “shastra” because they prescribe the daily, occasional, and desire-motivated duties of the four varnas and four ashramas, describe all obligations from conception through funeral rites, and teach truths concerning Brahman. It is great because it concerns great subjects and also because it is complete with many limbs and subsidiary limbs. Hence it is said, “filled with innumerable branches of learning.” Purana, Nyaya, Mimamsa, and the rest constitute ten branches of learning; each in its own way supplements the Veda. This also removes doubt concerning the authority of Scripture, because all competent persons accept it. The authors of the Puranas and the rest are great sages; by elaborating the meaning of the Veda in their respective works and practicing it with faith, they accept the authority of the Veda. This Scripture does not fail to instruct, nor does it give obscure instruction; otherwise

its authority would be doubtful. Therefore it is said, “illuminating all things like a torch.” It illuminates every subject in every way; therefore it neither fails to instruct nor instructs obscurely. For this reason it is like an omniscient being. The knowledge of an omniscient being reaches all subjects, and the subject matter of Scripture likewise extends to all things; therefore the comparison is appropriate.

Having stated the co-presence of cause and effect, the corresponding co-absence is now stated: “Indeed, of such a Scripture.” The distinctive feature of an omniscient being is knowledge of all subjects; Scripture too has this quality, because its subject matter reaches everything. This is established by example: “When a treatise with an extensive subject matter arises from a particular person, that person possesses knowledge more extensive than that treatise.” Even today, when someone writes a treatise covering many subjects, the speaker's knowledge is broader than what he states. Subtle distinctions among things can be experienced but cannot be fully expressed in words, just as the difference in sweetness among sugarcane juice, milk, and jaggery is experienced but cannot be clearly stated in speech. The word “extensive” shows that the subject matter of a statement may be broad but cannot equal the speaker's knowledge. The conclusion is drawn by the application “what need is there to say?”—what need is there to state the unique omniscience and omnipotence of that great Person from whom the Veda arises as effortlessly as breath? The expression “divided into many branches” applies from “divided in diverse forms” through “origination”; the conclusion begins with “of that great Person” and continues through “omnipotence.” “With very little effort” means almost without effort, as in the saying, “Barley pudding is not salty.” What divine sages cannot accomplish even with great effort, Brahman accomplishes playfully with almost no effort; from this His incomparable omniscience and omnipotence are established. Shruti concerning the effortless origination of the Veda is also cited: “Of this great Person...” and so forth.

Even the Mimamsakas who hold phonemes to be eternal must accept the non-eternality of words and sentences. A word consists of

phonemes in a particular sequence, and a sentence of words in a particular sequence. Sequence is a property of manifestation, not of the phonemes themselves; since phonemes are eternal and all-pervasive, no temporal or spatial relation of earlier and later is possible among them. Manifestation is non-eternal; then even if the manifestation of phonemes be eternal, how can wordhood be eternal? Once words are non-eternal, sentences and the rest are likewise proved to be non-eternal. The repetition of words is like the imitation of a dance. The pupil follows the sequence in which the dance teacher displays movements of the limbs and expressions, but does not display exactly the very same bodily movements as the teacher. In the same way, the pupil follows the sequence of phonemes and words of the Veda heard from the teacher, but does not utter exactly the same sound; the pupil's sound is different from the teacher's sound. Therefore, as regards the production of secular or Vedic words and sentences, there is in reality no dispute between those who hold phonemes eternal and those who hold them non-eternal. The difference of opinion concerns only whether complete human freedom is to be admitted with respect to Vedic sentences. The followers of Jaimini, who do not accept creation and dissolution, hold Vedic study through an eternal and uninterrupted succession of teachers and pupils. Followers of Vyasa hold, in accordance with the doctrine of creation and dissolution established by Shruti, Smriti, Itihasa, and the like, that the Supreme Self, omniscient and omnipotent as the cause associated with beginningless Avidya, is the creator of the eternal Veda; nevertheless, He preserves the sequence of the Veda in conformity with the preceding creation.

This is just as sacrifice and Brahmin-slaying, though they are illusory effects of Brahman, do not change their nature in a new creation—the former remains the cause of a good result and the latter of an evil result. In no creation does Brahmin-slaying become a cause of merit, nor the Ashvamedha a cause of sin; just as fire never wets and water never burns. Likewise, in this creation the study of the Veda in its fixed order is a cause of welfare and liberation, while study in a contrary order is harmful and becomes the cause of a verbal fault like a thunderbolt; so it remains in other creations as well. Therefore the omniscient and omnipotent creator

composes the Veda in conformity with the preceding creation; in this sense He does not possess arbitrary freedom. The followers of Jaimini understand by the word “apaurusheya” the absence of complete freedom on the part of an author. This is acceptable in our view also, though the purpose is different. Nor is the objection valid that something revealed by a person cannot be accepted as Scripture. A statement made by a person afflicted by many defects is unreliable; but the word of one who knows the truth and is free from every defect is certainly trustworthy. The statements of persons endowed with Dharma, wisdom, dispassion, and lordly power, such as Prajapati and the divine seers of the first creation, are trustworthy; their true knowledge is certain, and the faith of later people arises from their faith. Thus Brahman’s being the source of Scripture, the Veda’s apaurusheya character, and its authority—all become intelligible.

A second interpretation is this: the previously described body of Scripture consisting of the Rigveda and the rest is the source, that is, the means of valid knowledge, of true knowledge concerning Brahman. It is solely through the authority of Scripture that Brahman is known as the cause of the origination and so forth of the world. In the preceding Sutra, the Shruti passage “From which these beings are born,” and so forth, had been cited. If Scripture’s being the source had already been established there, what is the purpose of this Sutra? The answer is that Scripture was not explicitly stated there to be a means of knowledge. It was possible to suppose that the Sutra “from which the origination of the world” merely indicated an inference. To remove this doubt, this Sutra explicitly states: “Because it is the source of Scripture.” That is, from examples of produced things in the experienced world, the existence of Brahman can be inferred; but regarding the true nature of Brahman, Shruti alone is the means of knowledge. The meaning of the commentary is clear.

That is, the Janmadi Sutra does not merely indicate an inference; the succeeding Sutra, “Because it is the source of Scripture,” determines the meaning of the first by relying upon Scripture. The defining characteristic has been stated; from that characteristic, Brahman’s existence in general may be known by inference. But

knowledge of Brahman's specific and extraordinary nature comes only from Scripture; therefore Scripture is the means of knowledge, and Brahman is the subject of the Vedanta sentences.

Again the question arises: when Brahman is the subject of scriptural testimony, what is the purpose of inquiry into Brahman in the sequence beginning with "Therefore, now, the desire to know Brahman"? The answer is that reflection is necessary in order to ascertain the sentence-meaning obtained from Scripture. The meaning of general Shruti sentences may be understood in several ways; doubt is not removed without reasoning and inquiry. Nevertheless, independent inference does not establish the nature of Brahman; inference is only an auxiliary that accords with Shruti. The purport of Vedanta is determined through the sequence of hearing, reflection, and deep contemplation. Therefore the author of the Sutras begins the inquiry into Brahman while remaining subordinate to scriptural testimony, not by reasoning independent of Scripture.

Again the question arises: when it has been shown that "Scripture exists for the purpose of action, and therefore a sentence that serves no purpose of action is meaningless," how can Scripture be called a means of knowledge concerning Brahman? Vedanta would then have no use. What had earlier been stated merely as a thesis—that Scripture is a means of knowledge concerning Brahman—is established in this Sutra. With "Again, how?" and so forth, the commentator begins the Purvapaksha. "How?" indicates the objection. Vedanta would be regarded as meaningless because it does not enjoin a human end, since it teaches Brahman, who by nature is pure, conscious, and indifferent, and in whom there is nothing to be rejected or accepted. Further, because Vedanta concerns an already existent thing, it would, like a secular sentence, become merely a restatement and would not remain an independent means of knowledge. But it is not proper to think so. Vedanta is not fruitless, because a result follows from the injunction to study it. Therefore it may serve as an auxiliary by making known the agent, deity, and other factors required in the injunction with which it is connected; or it may enjoin some other action such as meditation. An independent instruction concerning the nature of an

existent thing is impossible, because an existent thing is the object of perception and other means of knowledge. Thus the Purvapaksha intends that the authority and utility of Vedanta would become dependent on other means of knowledge. The citation of Jaimini's Sutra is meant to strengthen the Purvapaksha, not to present it as the final doctrine.

“Use” here means the absence of uselessness and the production of independent knowledge, because Vedanta in the form of a restatement is supposed to depend upon another means of knowledge. From “therefore” through “or it may enjoin some other action such as meditation” is the combined statement of the Purvapaksha. From “certainly impossible” through “or it may be understood in this way” is its analysis. If the independent authority of Vedanta is not accepted, it will become merely an auxiliary to an injunction or will be understood as enjoining an action such as meditation; in this way it will cease to be an independent means of knowledge of Brahman.

Granted that Vedanta is not an auxiliary to action; even so, its purport concerning the nature of Brahman may be understood as subordinate to an injunction. The final Sutra of Jaimini's doctrine also supports this view: “Because it forms a single sentence with the injunction, it praises the injunction.” Mantras such as “Agni cooks the food” mention an action or its instrument; accordingly, nowhere is any purpose established for a Vedic sentence unrelated to an injunction. There can be no injunction concerning the nature of an already existent thing, because the subject of an injunction is action. Nevertheless, the answer is this: Vedanta intends to reveal the nature of Brahman, and its usefulness lies in this knowledge; it need not be subordinated to an injunction of action.

Even though its subject is an existent thing, Vedanta reveals the previously unknown nature of Brahman. The rule concerning “unity of sentence with an injunction” applies only where the sentence is actually a constituent of an injunction to action; Brahman-sentences are not of this kind. Every injunction concerns some future act that does not yet exist and is to be produced. Injunctions concerning result, application, procedure, and origination may be mutually related, but not in relation to the

already existent Brahman. Therefore it is not proper to make Vedanta an auxiliary to an injunction of action.

But that, because of the harmonious purport

To remove the Purvapaksha the Sutra says: “But that, because of the harmonious purport.” The word “but” rejects the Purvapaksha. The omniscient and omnipotent Brahman, who is the cause of the origination, continuance, and dissolution of the world, is known only through Vedanta Scripture. How? Because of the harmonious purport. All the Vedanta sentences converge upon Brahman with one and the same purport. “Existence alone, my dear, was this in the beginning”; “One only, without a second”; “The Self alone was this, one only, in the beginning”; “This Brahman is without before and after, without within and without”; “This Self is Brahman, the experienter of all”; “The immortal Brahman alone is in all directions”—many such sentences teach one and the same Brahman.

The sentence “From which these beings are born” has already been quoted to state the cause of the origination, continuance, and dissolution of the world; it need not be repeated here. According to the rule of interpretation, the subject on which the beginning and end of a passage agree is taken to be its principal purport. In the context of the Upamshu sacrifice too, the purport is determined through the unity of the preceding and succeeding sentences. Thus the entire section beginning with “Existence alone, my dear, was this in the beginning” and ending with “That thou art” teaches Brahman alone, namely Brahman non-different from the individual Self. Therefore Vedanta’s independent status as a means of knowledge of Brahman is established by this harmonious convergence.

Thus, when a definite harmonious convergence concerning the nature of Brahman is recognized in the sentences of these texts, it is not proper to suppose that they have some other purport; for doing so would involve the fault of abandoning what is directly stated and imagining what has not been stated. Nor can it be said that the purpose of these sentences is to describe the nature of the agent,

deity, and the like, because Shruti, in passages such as “Then by what and whom would one see?”, negates action, cause, and result.

Although Brahman is an already existent reality, Brahman is not the object of perception and the like. In “That thou art,” it is stated that Brahman is the Self itself; therefore Brahman cannot be understood without examining the preceding and succeeding sentences. When in this very context the purport of the other sentences is likewise established as Brahman, it would be an unwarranted proliferation to posit some unseen second purport. To suppose a purport concerning an agent and the like would be not merely unseen but impossible.

The Purvapakshin says that because Vedanta refers to an already existent thing, its dependence on something else must be admitted. But such dependence arises not because the thing exists already, but because a sentence is a human composition. Perception and the other means that convey knowledge of existent things also have existent things as their objects, yet their authority is not destroyed because they arise from fixed causes such as the senses. Likewise, because the Veda does not depend upon human intelligence, it is self-valid.

Someone may say that even if the *apaurusheya* character of the Veda is established, its authority regarding an existent thing is not thereby established, because a person may know an existent thing through another means of knowledge and compose a sentence accordingly. But this is not possible regarding what ought to be done, because duty is something new, is not the object of another means of knowledge, and, not having been previously experienced, does not enter the human mind of itself. Therefore the Veda that enjoins action is regarded as *apaurusheya* and authoritative.

To this argument we ask: O long-lived one, what exactly is this duty that cannot be known by a human being? If it is said to be an unseen potency or *Apurva*, then how could it be understood from the optative and other injunctive suffixes? *Apurva* is not perceptible to the senses, and consequently the relation of a word to it is not previously known. In ordinary usage an injunctive suffix conveys only the obligatoriness of an experienced action.

If it is said that from “One who desires heaven should sacrifice,” the person desiring heaven understands that a sacrifice ought to be performed as a means to obtaining heaven, then how can a momentary act produce heaven in the future? To remove this difficulty, Apurva is postulated on the basis of the Veda. But by the same reasoning Apurva would also have to be admitted in Buddhist statements concerning chaityas and the like, and then those too would be proved *apaurusheya*. If, taking it as evident that those sentences were composed by human beings, Apurva is denied there, then the Veda too, because it is a collection of sentences, may be inferred to be humanly composed.

The answer to this objection is that the *apaurusheya* character of the Veda is not based solely on its disclosure of Apurva. Its detailed establishment has been given elsewhere. Here it is enough to say that once its *apaurusheya* character has been established, Vedanta does not depend on another means of knowledge even with respect to the already existent Brahman. Brahman is not known by any other means; the identity of the Jiva with Brahman is understood only from Vedanta.

The second reason of the Purvapaksha—“knowledge of what is neither to be accepted nor rejected is fruitless”—is likewise unsound. Through knowledge of the Self as Brahman all obstruction is destroyed and the supreme human end is attained. Knowledge of deities and the like, though auxiliary to meditation, is not opposed to this knowledge of Brahman.

It is not possible to treat Vedanta as merely an auxiliary to an injunction of meditation concerning Brahman. Meditation necessarily involves distinctions among the meditator, meditation, and the object meditated upon; but Brahman is one alone and is devoid of all distinctions of acceptance, rejection, and the like. Once knowledge of oneness has arisen, the re-emergence of the cognition of duality is impossible; therefore knowledge of Brahman cannot be made a limb of an injunction to meditation.

A human purpose is of two kinds: one is to obtain something not yet obtained; the other is to experience as obtained something that is in fact already obtained but is mistakenly regarded as unobtained. Rejection too is of two kinds: rejection of something

that has not actually been removed, and rejection through knowledge of something that has in fact already been removed but is mistakenly regarded, through superimposition, as still present.

The performance of an external means obtains something not yet obtained or removes something not yet discarded; mere knowledge does not remove a real snake actually present. But a superimposed thing—where what is obtained is regarded as unobtained, or what has been discarded as undiscarded—is removed by true knowledge alone. Just as a snake is superimposed on a rope, the state of being a Jiva, born of ignorance, is superimposed upon the nature of Brahman. True knowledge of “That thou art” destroys this superimposition.

Through this knowledge, eternally attained bliss appears as though newly attained, and sorrow and suffering, eternally discarded, appear as though now discarded. Through the experience “The Self is Brahman,” all the Jiva’s obstructions—namely ignorance and its impressions—are quickly destroyed; then the supreme human end, in the form of cessation of suffering and attainment of bliss, is accomplished.

It is not acceptable, on the basis of meditation-related sentences such as “Meditate only on the Self” or “Meditate on the Self as truth and bliss,” to hold that the sole purport of Vedanta is worship or meditation. In Brahman, the distinctions of worshipper, object of worship, and worship cannot persist, because Vedanta destroys the ignorance that is the root of these distinctions.

If it is admitted that Vedanta, though not injunctive in form, is nevertheless a means of knowledge, then an independent sentence such as “He cried out” would also have to be accepted as authoritative even though it indicates no purpose of acceptance or rejection. In fact, the fruit of a means of knowledge is not only a decision to accept or reject; sometimes the decision to remain indifferent is also the fruit of knowledge. Therefore the authority of knowledge of Brahman need not be linked to an injunction of action.

No general rule can be established that elsewhere a Vedic sentence is not authoritative unless connected with an injunction. Knowledge of the Self itself culminates in the supreme result;

therefore the authority of Shruti concerning the Self cannot be rejected. Nor can it be called unnecessary, like the prohibitory sentence “Silver should not be given on the sacred grass.”

The entire Veda is taken up under the injunction to study one’s own Vedic recension and is regarded as a means to the human end. Not even one of its letters is fruitless. But merely understanding the meaning of a sentence such as “He cried out” does not directly accomplish any human end; such a sentence requires another completing sentence. A prohibitory sentence itself produces cessation from the prohibited action, and therefore has an independent purpose.

The case of Vedanta is different. From understanding its meaning alone, without dependence on any other action or means of knowledge, knowledge of the identity of Atman and Brahman arises and the supreme human end is accomplished. Therefore Vedanta need not be regarded as authoritative only by connecting it with an injunction of action.

Authoritative knowledge of Brahman is not obtained through any other means of knowledge. Perception, inference, and the like operate only within their respective spheres; Brahman is beyond the senses. If the authority of Scripture were itself held to be established by inference, there would arise a need for an example, but ultimately Scripture itself is the means of knowledge concerning Brahman.

Some teachers say that Scripture reveals Brahman only as the object of an injunction to meditation; that is, Brahman is not an independently knowable reality but merely the object for worship. This view too is not proper. An intelligent person in the world does not unnecessarily declare a special character of something that is neither to be accepted nor rejected. The knowledge of Brahman is itself the cause of liberation; hence its description is not purposeless.

Atra atre pratyavasthite—although Scripture is the means of knowledge of Brahman, the view is presented that Scripture reveals Brahman only through Brahman’s being the object of an injunction to realization. From the conduct of elders it is known that words have their purport in what ought to be done. Some words directly

state what is to be done; others disclose their own meanings as auxiliaries to what is to be done. But words do not have their purport in an already existent thing.

That a word conveys its meaning is understood on the basis of inferring another person's knowledge of the word-meaning and of the correspondence of that knowledge with the existence or non-existence of the object. But from knowledge that concerns merely the nature of an existent thing, no sign of activity or cessation is observed. In knowledge of what ought to be done, by contrast, activity or cessation is seen. Therefore the purport of words in what ought to be done is established, not in the mere statement of the nature of Brahman.

Vedanta is called Scripture because it forms part of the Veda. The definition of Scripture too applies to that body of sentences which impels a person toward obligatory, occasional, or desire-motivated actions, or withdraws him from prohibited actions. Therefore the view that Vedanta merely teaches the nature of Brahman does not accord with the well-known character of Scripture.

Nor is the purpose clear of sentences whose purport is only to teach the nature of Brahman. On hearing a sentence such as "This is a rope, not a snake," fear disappears. But even after hearing "That thou art," the attributes of worldly existence—pleasure, pain, fear, and the like—remain as before. If the sense of worldly existence disappeared merely upon hearing, why would reflection and deep contemplation be prescribed after hearing?

On this basis the Purvapakshin says that the purpose of Vedanta is the meditation on the Self as something to be performed. The injunction to meditate upon one's own Self is called "niyoga"; because it is not known through another means of knowledge, it is "apurva." Without continuous practice of meditation on the Self it will not yield its result; therefore from knowledge of the duty both its object—the Self—and its means—meditation—are understood.

If it is objected that the Self itself is the object of the duty, then since the Self is self-established, how can it become the object of an injunction? The answer is that the particular form of the Self adopted for meditation is not self-established. An injunction of the

form, “Meditate upon the Self in the form superimposed here,” is possible.

Just as the sacrificial post, the Ahavaniya fire, or other sacrificial implements, though already existent, become limbs of an injunction in Scripture through a particular consecration, form, or relation, so too the Self can become the object of an injunction through a particular relation in the form of meditation. The obligatoriness concerns the practice of meditation; the Self is its object.

In support of its view, the Purvapaksha cites many Mimamsaka statements: the purpose of Scripture is the instruction of action; an injunction is a statement that impels activity; the meaning of a word that makes known an existent thing remains connected with an injunction of action; if Scripture were devoid of a purpose in action, it would be meaningless. From all this it concludes that Vedanta too is meaningful only as an auxiliary to an injunction of meditation.

The Purvapakshin says that knowledge of Brahman is enjoined for one who desires immortality. Just as Agnihotra and other means are enjoined for one who desires heaven, so knowledge of Brahman or meditation on Brahman would be enjoined for one who desires immortality. A sentence such as “The knower of Brahman becomes Brahman,” though eulogistic, would be taken as indicating the qualified person for that injunction.

Here the difference between the fruits of the inquiry into Dharma and the inquiry into Brahman is made clear. In the ritual section, knowledge is sought of Dharma that is yet to be brought into being; in Vedanta, knowledge is sought of eternally established Brahman. The fruit of knowledge of Dharma depends upon performance, whereas the fruit of knowledge of Brahman is accomplished by knowledge itself—this distinction is presented by the Siddhanta side.

The Siddhanta says that in sentences such as “It is to be seen,” the realization of the Self is not itself something enjoined. The verb “see” signifies knowledge, and knowledge is object-dependent; its form is not produced according to human choice. Even perception can never be the object of an injunction, because perceptual knowledge arises naturally. Knowledge of the Self is likewise different from the mental action of meditation.

The Upanishads teach the Self as eternal, omniscient, all-pervading, eternally fulfilled, eternally pure, conscious, free, of the nature of knowledge, and of the nature of bliss. Through this true knowledge ignorance is destroyed and liberation is attained. If Vedanta were merely an injunction to meditation, the independent teaching of the nature of Brahman would become purposeless.

A factual sentence such as “This is a rope, not a snake” removes fear born of error; in the same way, knowledge of the truth that the Self does not possess the attributes of Samsara removes the error of being subject to Samsara. It may be asked why the error does not disappear merely on hearing. The answer is that hearing means the correct apprehension of the purport of the sentence; reflection and deep contemplation remove obstructive doubt and contrary habitual notions, not produce some new result of action.

The Purvapakshin says that pleasure, pain, and the like are still observed after hearing, and therefore knowledge alone is insufficient. The Siddhanta replies that once right knowledge that destroys ignorance has arisen, the reality of being subject to Samsara comes to an end; even though bodily and other activity due to Prarabdha continues, the knower knows the Self as Brahman.

There is a fundamental difference between action and knowledge of Brahman, as also between their fruits. Action is performed by body, speech, or mind, is called Dharma by Scripture and Smriti, and its result, in the form of pleasure or pain, is produced and perishable. The fruit of knowledge of Brahman is eternal, bodiless, incomparable, and established by its own nature; it becomes manifest as soon as ignorance is removed.

In the fruits of Dharma and Adharma there are gradations of pleasure and pain—of pleasure from the human world up to Brahmaloaka, and of pain down to the lower worlds. All these are produced and perishable. The fruit of knowledge of the Self is not graded in this way; liberation is eternal and unproduced.

Although knowledge arises through a modification of the mind, its truth depends upon the object. Hearing, reflection, and deep contemplation are means to knowledge and removers of obstacles; they do not newly produce liberation. Liberation is the natural state of the Self.

The mental impression produced by meditation concentrates the mind and may assist knowledge; but the cause of liberation is knowledge of Brahman itself. Just as practice in music increases the capacity to know notes, but the truth of the notes is not created by practice, so meditation may assist knowledge but does not produce liberation.

Because of the excellence of knowledge and meditation, those who perform sacrifices and the like may travel by the northern path; but through offerings alone, works for public welfare, and gifts, they travel by the southern path whose sequence begins with smoke. Here too gradation of pleasure and gradation of its means are understood from the Shruti, “They remain there until the enjoyment is exhausted.” Likewise, from human beings down to insentient things, whatever minimum degree of pleasure is possible arises from Dharma defined by injunction, and it too has gradations.

The mental impression produced by meditation upon the meaning of Vedanta sentences is capable of bringing about realization of the Jiva’s nature as Brahman; for this no unseen Apurva is required. Therefore, since the alleged Apurva produced by meditation is not the cause of immortality, it is not proper for one desiring immortality to know it as a duty. To desire one thing and perform a means to another would be contradictory.

Nor can it be said that one who desires immortality would understand the act of meditation itself as the duty, not its unseen Apurva. For meditation’s capacity to serve as a means to immortality is known through another means of knowledge; its injunction would then be pointless. Nor is the analogy of an injunction to thresh rice applicable, because there the Apurva generated due to a prohibition is not known from another sentence.

From the gradations of suffering observed above and below among embodied beings, the gradations of their cause—Adharma defined by prohibitory injunctions—and of those who perform Adharma are likewise understood. The differences of pleasure and pain among Jivas afflicted by ignorance and other defects arise from differences of merit and demerit, bear fruit after embodiment, are

impermanent, and constitute Samsara—this is well known from Shruti, Smriti, and reasoning.

If liberation were something other than the immortality described in eulogistic statements, and if the person desiring immortality were qualified for meditation, then, on the analogy of the Rishi session, immortality could be regarded as the fruit of meditation just as heaven is. But immortality is free from destruction and decay; therefore no result produced by meditation can be permanent. When the covering of ignorance is removed, the state of Brahman becomes manifest; realization of the meaning of Vedanta removes ignorance, while impressions produced by meditation merely assist the mind. Therefore a sentence such as “Meditate on the Self” is not a real injunction but only an injunction-like sentence.

“The complete cessation of pleasure and pain is impossible while embodied” is a restatement of the nature of Samsara. From the Shruti, “The pleasant and the unpleasant do not touch the bodiless,” through the denial of contact with pleasant and unpleasant it is understood that the bodiless state that is liberation is not the fruit of Dharma defined by injunction. If it were the fruit of Dharma, the denial of contact with pleasant and unpleasant would be incongruous.

The bodiless state itself is not a fruit of Dharma, because Shruti declares it to be natural: “The wise man, even while dwelling in a body, knowing the Self as bodiless, stable amidst the changing, great and all-pervading, does not grieve”; “This Self is without breath, without mind, pure”; “This Self is unattached.” Therefore bodilessness in the form of liberation, distinct from the fruit of action, is eternally established.

Some things, though changing, are called eternal in a sequence of development because the recognition “this is that” is not destroyed; earth and the like, or the Gunas of Sankhya, may serve as such examples. But Brahman’s eternality is complete, immutable, and all-pervading like space; Brahman is free from all modification, eternally fulfilled, partless, and self-luminous; merit, demerit, and their fruits never touch Brahman in any of the three times. This bodilessness that is liberation is established by Shruti.

Another view speaks of two kinds of eternity—immutable eternity and transformational eternity. If transformational eternity is accepted as true eternity, the question arises: does the transformation occur in the whole thing or in one part of it? If in the whole, the original Prakriti would be destroyed. If in one part, is that part different from the thing or non-different? If different, the transformation would not be a transformation of the original thing; if non-different, one would have to admit transformation of the whole thing.

No logically coherent conclusion follows from this twofold transformation. Those who accept cognition-based diversity may regard the world consisting of earth and so forth as eternal, or the Sankhyas may regard the Gunas as eternal; but Brahman is ultimately immutable and eternal—free from every modification, partless, and self-luminous.

If liberation were attained through a means consisting of something to be done, it would be non-eternal. Shruti says: “Tell me that which is different from Dharma and from Adharma, different from what is done and what is not done, different from past and future.” In this context arises the inquiry into Brahman. If Brahman were taught as an auxiliary to something to be done and liberation were regarded as produced by what is to be done, liberation would be impermanent like the fruit of action. But all who hold liberation accept it as eternal; therefore it is not proper to regard instruction about Brahman as a limb of action.

The doctrine of difference-and-non-difference may say that a thing is non-different as cause and different as effect—just as a bracelet is non-different insofar as it is gold, yet as a bracelet it is different from an earring. But since difference and non-difference are mutually opposed, how can both exist in one and the same thing? The reply offered is that no contradiction should be admitted in a thing established by valid cognition; in a cognition of co-reference such as “This earring is gold,” both difference and non-difference are evident.

If non-difference were complete, there would not be two apprehensions in the forms of subject and predicate. If difference were complete, co-reference would be impossible, as in the case of a

cow and a horse. One does not say of a pot, “the jujube is this,” and even though Chaitra and Maitra sit on one seat, one does not say, “Chaitra is Maitra.” Therefore cognition of both non-difference and difference between effect and cause is said to be unobstructed, doubtless, and universal. Since the effect has the nature of its cause, wherever the cause exists there is the existence of the effect; but as effects, cow, pot, and so forth in the world are mutually different.

The question for this doctrine is: what in reality is difference, such that it resides in the same locus as non-difference? If difference is mutual non-existence, does this non-existence obtain between the bracelet and gold or not? If it does not, there is only non-difference; if it does, there is only difference. Existence and non-existence cannot occur together.

If it is said that there is non-difference insofar as there is gold, but difference from an earring and so forth insofar as it is a bracelet, the answer is this: if the bracelet is non-different from gold, then wherever gold recurs, the bracelet too ought to recur. But goldness is present in an earring, whereas braceletness is not; therefore the bracelet is different from gold.

If all things were non-different in the form of existence, cognitions of difference such as “this is here, that is not,” “this arises from this, not from that,” “this exists now, it did not before,” “this is of this sort, not that sort,” would be impossible. When something is recognized from a distance as gold, inquiry remains concerning whether its particular form is an earring or something else; if the particular form were non-different from gold, then as soon as gold was known the particular form too would be known.

Because difference exists, even when gold is known an earring and the like may remain unknown. If non-difference also exists, why should it remain unknown? The general rule of non-difference is that knowledge of the cause gives knowledge of the effect. Therefore that which is not known through knowledge of another is different from it—just as knowing a camel does not amount to knowing a donkey. From a distance gold is known but the earring is not known; therefore the earring is different from gold.

Why then do we have co-reference in a statement such as “The earring is gold”? The supporter says: because of a relation of

substratum and superstratum, or because both have the same locus. The answer is that no such co-reference is observed between a pot and a jujube, or between Chaitra and Maitra seated on the same seat. Therefore merely occupying one locus is not a sufficient cause of co-reference.

If difference depended on non-difference and non-difference depended on difference, there would be the defect of mutual dependence. In reality, cognition of non-difference requires nothing else; cognition of difference, in the form “not this but that,” depends upon knowledge of the opposed object. Therefore it may be accepted that an indefinable difference is superimposed upon a basis of non-difference; establishing non-difference on the basis of difference is not logically coherent.

Shruti too says, “Clay alone is real.” Therefore only immutable, unchanging eternality is ultimately real, not transformational eternality. The example “like space” is given in accordance with another view, although its adherents regard space itself as produced and therefore non-eternal. By saying “immutably eternal,” liberation is shown not to be something to be produced; by saying “all-pervading,” not something to be reached; by saying “free from all modification,” not something to be transformed; and by saying “partless,” not something capable of refinement.

Shruti clearly states that liberation follows immediately upon knowledge of Brahman, with no intervening action remaining: “He who knows Brahman becomes Brahman”; “When the higher and lower Brahman is seen, his actions perish”; “The knower of the bliss of Brahman fears nothing from anywhere”; “O Janaka, you have attained fearlessness”; “He knew the Self as ‘I am Brahman’; thereby he became this whole universe.”

The word “eternally fulfilled” indicates Brahman’s character as the human end. Fulfilment signifies pleasure free from suffering; the pleasure accompanied by the ending of desire and suffering is fulfilment. If pleasure is not experienced, it cannot be a human end; therefore Brahman is called “self-luminous.”

Thus, after establishing through Shruti and the like that liberation is eternal, the impermanence of a liberation produced by action is explained in detail. Knowledge serves as a means to

liberation only by removing the two kinds of obstruction in the form of ignorance; knowledge does not itself produce, refine, transform, or attain liberation.

Shruti says: “He who knows Brahman becomes Brahman”; “The knot of the heart is cut, all doubts are destroyed, and actions become exhausted”; “The knower of the bliss of Brahman has fear from none”; “O Janaka, you have attained fearlessness”; “He knew the Self as ‘I am Brahman’; thereby he became this whole universe.” From these sentences it is clear that no other act, Apurva, or fruit of action intervenes between knowledge of Brahman and liberation.

The expression “eternally fulfilled” conveys pleasure free from suffering. Pure pleasure is fulfilment, and pleasure that is not itself manifest could not be a human end; therefore Brahman is “self-luminous.” Liberation becomes manifest immediately after knowledge arises; liberation is not an effect produced by the activity of knowledge, but merely the manifestation of one’s own nature when ignorance has been removed.

Shruti further strengthens this point: for one who sees the homogeneous nature of Brahman, what delusion and what sorrow can remain? The seer Vamadeva, on seeing Brahman, immediately understood: “I became Manu; I became the Sun.” Just as in the sentence “While standing, he sings” there is no separate duty intervening between standing and singing, so there is no intervening action between seeing Brahman and the state of being the Self of all.

“You are our father, who carry us beyond ignorance”; “I have heard from persons who know the Self that the knower of the Self crosses beyond sorrow; I am in sorrow, carry me beyond sorrow”; “Sanatkumara carried him beyond darkness”—such Shruti passages state that the fruit of knowledge of Brahman consists merely in the cessation of ignorance that obstructs liberation.

A reasoned Sutra of the teacher likewise says: through the successive destruction, in reverse order, of false knowledge, defects, activity, birth, and suffering, each preceding member is destroyed and liberation is finally accomplished. When false knowledge is destroyed, defects are destroyed; when defects are destroyed,

activity is destroyed; when activity is destroyed, birth; when birth is destroyed, suffering.

False knowledge, that is Avidya, is the root cause of Samsara; it gives rise to attachment, aversion, and the like. Its opponent is true knowledge—the direct realization of the unity of Brahman and the Self. Therefore liberation is the manifestation of the nature of Brahman, not a result produced by knowledge or meditation. Of the Sutra, only this much is accepted here: true knowledge destroys false knowledge; other special meanings assigned to it by the Nyaya school are not accepted here.

The Purvapakshin may say that knowledge of the identity of Brahman and Atman is not knowledge of the actual state of things but merely an imagined identity; then, being dependent on volition, it can become something enjoined. Just as, through a similarity to the mind's innumerable modifications, the conception of the universal deities may be imposed upon the mind, so the nature of Brahman may be imagined in the Jiva and meditated upon.

But knowledge of the identity of Brahman and Atman is not an imagined identity. In meditation-statements such as “Mind is Brahman” and “The Sun is Brahman,” the qualities of one thing are superimposed on another. Sentences such as “That thou art,” “I am Brahman,” and “This Self is Brahman” state the real unity that is the actual condition of the thing.

If the identity were merely imagined, it would contradict the Shruti fruit, “The knot of the heart is cut, all doubts are destroyed”; and the sentence “The knower of Brahman becomes Brahman” would also become incongruous. Therefore cognition of the identity of Brahman and Atman is neither an imagination nor a superimposed meditation.

In the context of looking at clarified butter, the act of looking is an auxiliary action serving to purify the clarified butter. But a sentence such as “The Self is to be seen” does not occur within the context of any single action. It is difficult to call knowledge of the Self a limb of sacrifice by positing an incongruous relation between the Self and sacrifice. If knowledge of the Self is the principal action, it is not a purificatory auxiliary; if it is an auxiliary, it is not clear of what action it is a limb.

The meditation on “absorption” in Prana or Vayu is likewise based on a specific relation of qualities—the external air absorbs fire and the like into itself, and the internal Prana gathers speech, sight, and the other senses into itself at death. In such meditation the basis of the quality is clear. Imagining the Jiva as Brahman is not based on any such similarity of qualities.

In meditation on mind, the Sun, or Prana, the object meditated upon and the supporting basis remain different; the qualities of Brahman are superimposed on that basis. But the Jiva is in reality Brahman—in this knowledge there is no distinction of support and supported. Therefore it is not proper to regard knowledge of the identity of Brahman and Atman as meditation, refinement, a limb of action, or a purificatory act.

If cognition of the identity of Brahman and Atman were regarded as merely imagined, the syntactic relation of the words in “That thou art,” “I am Brahman,” and “This Self is Brahman” would be destroyed. Shruti passages such as “The knot of the knower’s heart is cut” and “The knower of Brahman becomes Brahman” could not yield their stated result from an imagined identity.

Therefore knowledge of Brahman does not depend upon human action. Just as knowledge arising from perception and other means of knowledge is object-dependent, so knowledge of Brahman too depends solely upon the object. There is no logically coherent way to bring Brahman or knowledge of Brahman within the sphere of what is to be done.

Nor is Brahman the object of an act of knowing. The Kena Shruti says: “It is different from the known and also beyond the unknown”; “By what can one know that by which all this is known?” “Know that alone as Brahman which speech does not reveal, but by which speech itself is revealed, not that which people worship as an object.”

If Brahman is not an object, how can Scripture be its means of knowledge? The purpose of Scripture is to remove the difference imagined through Avidya. Scripture does not present Brahman as an object called “this” or “that”; it reveals Brahman as the inner Self, not objectifiable, and removes the duality of knower and known.

Even with regard to worldly objects, words cannot express every particular difference completely—the difference of sweetness among sugarcane juice, milk, and jaggery cannot be fully expressed in words. The inner Self is beyond the senses; therefore Scripture removes distinctions born of Avidya through negation, secondary indication, and harmonious interpretation.

“He by whom this is thought does not know Him; he who says ‘I know’ does not know”; “You cannot see the seer of seeing, hear the hearer of hearing, think the thinker of thought, or know the knower of knowledge”—such Shruti passages establish that the Self is altogether non-objectifiable.

When the distinctions of knower, known, and knowledge produced by Avidya come to an end, the nature of the Self is again manifest; the state of being subject to Samsara ceases and eternal liberation is accomplished. Therefore liberation is not subject to the defect of impermanence.

One who regards liberation as something produced must accept some mental, verbal, or bodily action as necessary; if liberation is a transformation, action is still required. On either view liberation would be impermanent, because a transformed thing such as curd and a produced thing such as a pot are never eternal.

Nor is any duty required in relation to something to be attained. For if it is one’s own essential nature, it is not something to be attained; and if it is different from one’s own essential nature, Brahman still cannot be something to be attained, because, being all-pervading, Brahman is naturally and eternally attained by everyone, like space.

The Purvapakshin says: liberation consists in abandoning the state of Samsara and attaining the isolated state of the Self; therefore liberation is a kind of transformation. Just as milk abandons its first condition and acquires another condition as curd, so the Self abandons the state of Samsara and obtains the state of isolation. On both these views liberation would not remain eternal, because a produced thing like curd or a pot is impermanent.

From Shruti passages such as “Then the light that shines beyond heaven,” one may understand differences of location for Brahman, a changing location and an unchanging location. Hence an objection

is raised that through an injunction to meditation and the like Brahman may be brought to an unchanging place and may then become something to be attained. The answer is that even as something to be attained Brahman requires no duty.

A sailor, remaining in a boat, leaves behind the changing seashore, masses of foam, and waves, and reaches a waveless, calm, clear, stable, and unchanging middle region. But the Jiva is not different from Brahman; the Jiva is Brahman itself. What, then, would the Jiva attain, and by what means? Attainment presupposes difference. Even if the Jiva were regarded as different from Brahman, all-pervading Brahman is eternally attained; therefore the objection is removed by the words “even though different from one’s own nature.”

Liberation is not something to be purified either, for otherwise a purificatory act would be required. Purification occurs in two ways—by the addition of a quality or by the removal of a defect. Liberation is the nature of Brahman; no excellence can be added to Brahman. Brahman is eternally pure; therefore no defect can be removed from Brahman either.

An example of purification by the addition of a quality is this: when a China-rose flower is dyed with lac juice, it produces the effect of that color. An example of purification by removal of a defect is this: when a mirror is rubbed with brick powder, its dirt is removed and it becomes bright. Neither of these two methods applies to Brahman.

If it is said: liberation is the nature of the Self, but it is covered by ignorance; when the Self is purified through action it becomes manifest, just as the brightness of a mirror becomes manifest when the mirror is rubbed—the answer is that the Self cannot be the locus of action. Whatever is the locus of action cannot remain unchanged by that action; action produces some alteration in it. If the Self is regarded as changeable, Shruti passages such as “This is said to be imperishable” would be contradicted.

Is the quality to be added to Brahman the very nature of Brahman or something different? If it is Brahman’s own nature, being eternal it cannot be added. If it is different, then because it is produced liberation would be impermanent. Nor is a relation of

quality and qualified possible between mutually different things, any more than a relation of that kind between a cow and a horse. The combined doctrine of difference and non-difference has already been shown to be contradictory. Therefore no excellence can be added to liberation, which is the nature of Brahman.

The doctrine of removing a defect is likewise incoherent. Dirt is present on a mirror and therefore can be removed. No impurity is ever present in Brahman; Brahman is eternally pure. There can be no question of removing what is entirely absent from the beginning.

The objection is: liberation is the nature of the Self but is covered by beginningless impurity in the form of Avidya; when the Self is purified through the act of meditation, liberation becomes manifest rather than being produced. The answer is that the Self cannot be regarded as the locus of action. Action changes its locus; the Self would then become impermanent.

Avidya is said to reside not in Brahman but in the Jiva. Yet the Jiva itself is merely Brahman limited by indefinable Avidya; Brahman is eternally pure. If a defect were admitted in Brahman and Brahman were purified through action, the action would have to inhere in Brahman, just as in rubbing a mirror the conjunction and disjunction of brick powder occur on the surface of the mirror. Such action would transform Brahman and destroy Brahman's eternality.

If action were located in some other substratum, how could it assist in purifying Brahman? Rubbing a mirror does not purify a jewel. Shruti such as "This is imperishable, the highest" excludes the entry of action into the Self. Therefore action residing in the Self is impossible; action residing elsewhere cannot purify the non-objectifiable Self.

The Purvapakshin again says: through bodily actions such as bathing, sipping water, and wearing the sacred thread, the embodied Self is seen to become pure. The answer is that what becomes purified is the Self regarded through Avidya as connected with the body and the like. The occurrence of bathing, sipping water, and so forth in the body is directly perceived. The fruit of bodily action applies to the Jiva connected with that body and regarding the body as "I."

Just as, when equilibrium of the bodily constituents is produced by treatment applied to the body, the body-identifying Jiva has the cognition “I am free from disease,” so through bathing, sipping water, wearing the sacred thread, and the like there arises the cognition “I am pure.” This purity is the empirical purity of the Jiva connected with the body, not of the Supreme Self.

The Jiva is the object of the cognition “I,” the agent of knowledge, and the enjoyer of the fruits of action. The Mantra says: “One bird eats the sweet fruit; the other does not eat, but merely looks on.” The bird that eats the fruit is the individual Self; the bird that does not eat is the witnessing Supreme Self.

The Jiva is connected with the gross and subtle bodies, the senses, and the inner organ; situated in the midst of this aggregate, it is regarded as non-different from it and becomes the object of the cognition “I.” Therefore the body’s purity is empirically superimposed upon the Self, just as the heroine’s fragrance is said to be transferred to her companion. Ultimately, there is neither action nor purification in the Self.

Shruti says: “The wise call the Self connected with body, senses, and mind the enjoyer.” “The one God, hidden in all beings, all-pervading, the inner Self of all, overseer of actions, dwelling in all beings, witness, conscious, one, and without qualities.” “He pervades all, radiant, bodiless, woundless, without sinews, pure, and untouched by sin.” From these Mantras it is established that no excellence can be added to Brahman and that Brahman is eternally pure. Attainment of the state of Brahman is liberation; therefore liberation itself is not something to be purified.

Apart from these four kinds—what is to be produced, attained, transformed, and purified—there is no fifth route by which action can enter into liberation. Therefore, apart from knowledge, not even the shadow of action gains entry into liberation.

Objection: knowledge too is a mental activity. Answer: knowledge and action are different. Action is that in which an injunction operates without regard to the actual nature of the object and which depends upon a person’s will. A person may perform worship, meditation, and the like, may refrain from performing them, or may perform them otherwise.

Knowledge, although a mental modification, is object-dependent. Its result is not Brahman, because self-luminous Brahman cannot be apprehended as an object standing in a relation to an act of knowledge. True knowledge arises from a means of valid knowledge, not from a person's will.

In sacrifice, whatever form of a deity is to be held in mind while making an offering may be made the object of meditation; in sentences such as "Meditate on the evening deity," meditation, though mental, is person-dependent. A person may do it, not do it, or do it differently. Knowledge is not of this kind.

True knowledge takes as its object the thing exactly as it is. Therefore it cannot be produced, left unproduced, or produced in a different form according to one's wish. It depends neither upon an injunction nor upon a person; it depends only upon the object. Hence, although mental, knowledge is by nature entirely different from action.

In meditations such as "Mind indeed is fire, Gautama" and "Woman indeed is fire, Gautama," a person produces the cognition of fire with reference to mind or woman. This is not knowledge of real fire but an injunction-prescribed meditation. But in one who hears the Vedanta passage from "Existence alone, my dear, was this in the beginning" through "That thou art" and understands the meanings and their relation, true knowledge of the identity of Brahman and Atman arises through the power of the means of knowledge.

Just as, through proper contact of sense and object in bright light, the perception of a pot arises of itself, so through the power of an Upanishadic sentence arises the knowledge that the Self is Brahman. Human will cannot make this knowledge otherwise, nor can it prevent it; therefore it is not an enjoined action like meditation on a deity.

The same applies in relation to man and woman. But that is merely an action and depends upon a person, because its origination occurs solely through an injunction. By contrast, cognition of fire with regard to well-known fire depends neither upon an injunction nor upon a person. What then is it? Because it depends solely upon the object that is the subject of perception, it is

determinate knowledge, not action. The same should be understood with regard to all objects that are the subjects of means of valid knowledge.

In such a situation, knowledge that takes Brahman and the Self exactly as they really are likewise does not depend upon an injunction. Although optative forms and the like occur in passages concerning this subject, because their subject is something not enjoined they become blunted like the edge of a knife drawn over stone; for the subject is something that is neither to be rejected nor accepted. What then is the purpose of injunction-like sentences such as “The Self is to be seen, to be heard”? Our answer is that they serve to turn a person away from the natural objects of action. A person turned outward, who remains engaged in action thinking “May pleasant things come to me; may painful things not come to me,” does not thereby attain the supreme human end. For such a person who seeks the supreme human end, sentences such as “The Self is to be seen” withdraw him from the aggregate of cause and effect—that is, from the objects of natural activity in the form of objects and senses—and direct him inward into the current of the Self. For one thus engaged in the inquiry into the Self, the following sentences teach the true nature of the Self as something that is neither to be rejected nor accepted: “Whatever all this is, it is the Self alone” (Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 2.4.6); “When all this is the Self alone, then by what and whom would one see? ... by what and whom would one know? ... By what would one know the knower?” (Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 4.5.15); “This Self is Brahman” (Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 2.5.19), and so on.

Again, as for the statement that knowledge of the Self, because it is not primarily connected with something to be done, assists neither acceptance nor rejection—we accept it. Indeed, it is an ornament to our position that when Brahman is realized all duties come to an end and everything that had to be accomplished has been accomplished. Shruti too says: “If a person knows the Self as ‘I am He,’ then desiring what and for whose sake would he suffer along with the suffering of the body?” (Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 4.4.12). Smṛiti too says: “Knowing this, a person may become wise and one whose task is accomplished, O Bharata” (Bhagavad Gita

15.20). Therefore the teaching of Brahman is not a limb of an injunction to meditation.

Some say: “There is no part of the Veda that merely discusses an existent thing; the Veda teaches only injunctions to activity and cessation and the things auxiliary to them.” This is incorrect. The Self taught in the Upanishads is not a limb of anything else. The Self, known only from the Upanishads, free from Samsara, of the nature of Brahman, distinct from the four kinds of things—what is produced, attained, transformed, and purified—described in an independent context and auxiliary to nothing else, cannot be said not to exist or not to be known; for in the sentence “That Self is not this, not this” (Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 3.9.26) the word “Self” is present, and negation of the Self is impossible, since even the one who negates remains endowed with selfhood.

If in the usage of elders there were a rule that words reveal only what ought to be done or something auxiliary to it, then the Upanishads could not have as their purport Brahman in the form of the Self—who is neither to be rejected nor accepted—because in experience no such capacity of words would be known, and knowledge of the Vedic meaning follows in experience after knowledge of word-meaning. But if even in experience the relation of words to an existent thing can be apprehended, then nothing prevents us from taking the existent Brahman, known through consideration of preceding and succeeding Upanishadic sentences, as their purport; nor can a duty be imagined in Brahman’s place, for otherwise there would be the fault of abandoning the directly stated meaning and taking up an unstated one.

A relation of words to a non-duty meaning would be impossible only if no usage with such a purport were found in experience and if knowledge of that meaning could not be inferred in a person who knows the meanings of words. But in experience there is widespread use of groups of sentences that speak of existent things and produce joy or remove fear and the like without teaching anything to be done. For example: “The king of mountains, Sumeru, is the dwelling place of Indra and the other guardians of the worlds, of Siddhas, Vidyadharas, Gandharvas, and hosts of Apsarases; it is formed of golden rocks washed by the streams of the Mandakini descending from Brahmaloaka, and is delightful with the voices of

crystal-like birds sporting in lovely groves resembling Nandana”; or, “This is not a snake; it is a rope,” and so forth.

Nor is it true that knowledge of an existent thing cannot be inferred in a person who knows word-meanings; joy and the like provide a basis for such an inference. Here is an example. A Dravidian who does not know the meaning of the Arya language is sitting at Devadatta’s house beside the royal road on his way to the city. He knows that the birth of a son is a cause of joy for a father. He goes with a messenger to Devadatta in the city. The messenger offers a cloth moistened with saffron-water in which the infant’s feet have been washed and says: “Devadatta, may your prosperity increase; a son has been born to you.” At once the Dravidian sees Devadatta’s hair stand on end and his eyes and face bloom like a fully opened lotus. He infers the joy that has arisen in Devadatta, and he also infers that since this joy was not present before and arose immediately upon hearing the words, these words are its cause. He understands that the sentence conveyed a meaning that is the cause of joy, because the statement itself could not produce joy without communicating the meaning that causes joy. No other cause of joy is visible, and the birth of a son is known to be a cause of joy; therefore he determines that the messenger communicated precisely this fact. The same kind of example should be understood with regard to fear, grief, and the like.

Thus, because sentences that state existent things can be fruitful, their use by a discerning inquirer is entirely reasonable. Knowledge of the nature of Brahman is the cause of the supreme human end; and although Vedanta neither impels a person to action nor withdraws him from action, it teaches what is beneficial to him. Therefore Vedanta’s status as Scripture is established. On this basis it is proved that the disputed sentences have existent things as their objects, because they produce valid cognition regarding existent things. Whatever produces valid cognition has as its object the object of that cognition—just as the eye and the like have color and other qualities as their objects. The same is the case with these sentences. Therefore it has rightly been said: “This view is incorrect, because the Self taught in the Upanishads is not a limb of anything else.”

The word “Upanishad” is formed from the root “sad,” with the prefixes “upa” and “ni,” and with the kvip suffix, in the sense of destruction. It is a name for knowledge of Brahman; for by bringing non-dual Brahman near, it destroys Avidya and its impressions. Because Vedanta is the cause of this knowledge, Vedanta too is called Upanishad; and the Person who is known through it is the Person taught by the Upanishads.

This point is analyzed in the words “That Self who is known only from the Upanishads,” and so forth. By saying “who does not undergo Samsara,” Brahman is distinguished from the Jiva that is the object of the I-cognition. Because Brahman is by nature not an action, Brahman is distinct from the four kinds of things—what is produced, attained, transformed, and purified. Therefore Brahman is auxiliary to nothing else. An existent thing that is auxiliary to something else is desired in relation to what is to be done and is accomplished through production and the like—for example, “Make the sacrificial post.” But that which is auxiliary to nothing else is an existent reality and leaves no further purpose to be accomplished—just as, in contexts such as “Gold should be worn” and “An offering of flour should be made,” the gold or the flour is not itself accomplished through production and the like.

Now an objection is raised: the Self is the object of the cognition “I”; how then can it be said that the Self can be known only through the Upanishads? The answer is: no; this objection has already been removed by showing that the Upanishadic Self is the witness of the object of that I-cognition. The object of the I-cognition is the individual Self, an agent limited by the aggregate of body and senses; but no one has been able to know, either through the ritual section of the Veda or by mere reasoning and disputation, the Supreme Self who is its witness, present in all, the same everywhere, one, immutably eternal, and the Self of all.

On this the commentator says: “And because the Self cannot be negated.” In reality, the Self, whose nature is light, is the Self of all, because the delusion in the form of the world rests upon that very Self. Without a substratum, delusion is impossible; if there were no rope, there could never be an error there of taking the rope for a snake or a stream of water. The world is illuminated by the very light of the Self’s self-luminosity. Shruti too says: “By His light all

else is illumined; by His light this entire world shines.” If the luminous nature of the Self were denied, the manifestation of the world itself would become incoherent. Therefore, because the Self cannot be negated, Vedanta brings about realization of that Brahman-nature which is not the object of any other means of knowledge and is free from all limiting adjuncts.

One who does not accept the limitation expressed in “The Self is known only from the Upanishads” raises another objection: the Self is the object of every person’s cognition “I”; it is agent, enjoyer, and subject to Samsara. Both ordinary people and inquirers into the Self use the word “Self” in precisely this sense. Words used in ordinary usage are also used in the Veda and have the same meanings in both places; therefore in the Upanishads the word “Self” ought to apply in this familiar sense and not in some contrary second sense—this is the purport of the objection.

The answer is that no one can negate the Self taught in the Upanishads, nor can that Self be made an auxiliary limb of any injunction. Because the Self is the Self of all, it is neither to be rejected nor accepted. The entire aggregate of perishable modifications extending up to the Self comes to an end; but because there is no cause that can destroy the Self, the Self is imperishable, and because there is no cause of transformation, the Self is immutably eternal. For this very reason the Self is by nature eternally pure, conscious, and free. In statements such as “There is nothing higher than the Self; He is the limit and the supreme goal,” and “I ask about that Self who is taught in the Upanishads,” the qualification “taught in the Upanishads” is meaningful only if the Self is the principal subject taught by the Upanishads. Therefore the statement “No part of the Veda teaches an existent thing” is merely a careless insistence.

The commentator replies: “No.” The Person taught by the Upanishads is not the object of the ordinary cognition “I.” The object of the I-cognition is the agent Jiva, limited by the aggregate of body and senses; the Supreme Self taught by the Upanishads is the witness of that Jiva. Thus the view that the Jiva, the object of the I-cognition, is the Supreme Self is rejected. In sentences such as “Having entered as the Jiva into its own true nature, the Self ...,” the unity of Jiva and Supreme Self is ultimate; the form limited by

adjuncts is called the Jiva, while its pure form is the witness. This pure witness is not known through another means of knowledge; it is the subject of the Upanishads. This very point is elaborated by saying, “its witness, different from the agent who is the object of the I-cognition.”

The Self cannot be connected as an auxiliary to any injunction. Why? Because it is the Self. The Self is not for the sake of anything else; rather, all other things are for the sake of the Self. Shruti says: “It is not for the love of all things that all things are dear, but for the love of the Self that all things are dear.” Because it is the Self of all, it is neither to be rejected nor accepted. In the entire world Brahman alone is the real Self. One’s own nature cannot be abandoned, and therefore it is not to be rejected; and it is already attained, and therefore it is not to be accepted. The subject of injunction and prohibition is something to be rejected or accepted; therefore the true nature of the Self cannot be their subject. Consequently, in the entire world the Self alone is real.

This very point is clarified by the statement, “The whole aggregate of perishable modifications comes to an end in the Self.” The Self is ultimately real—this is established by Shruti, Smriti, Itihasa, Purana, and reasoning that does not conflict with them. The world manifested through beginningless Avidya is not ultimately real. The ultimately real Self is the material basis of this false world, just as the real rope is the material basis of the illusory snake. The world, indefinable and unstable in nature, comes to an end; the Self is ultimately real, and even a thousand causes cannot make the Self unreal. Even a thousand craftsmen cannot make cloth out of a pot. Therefore the destruction of all modifications terminates in the imperishable Self, just as the destruction of silver seen in nacre and of a snake seen in a rope terminates respectively in the real nacre and the real rope. In all the modifications of the world, the Self alone is real. Because the Self is infinite, its destruction is impossible.

For one who supposes that destruction of the Self is possible, it is said: “Because there is no cause of the Self’s destruction, it is imperishable.” Even a thousand causes cannot make one thing into another thing. If it is said that although the Self’s essential nature is neither to be rejected nor accepted, some quality of it may be

abandoned or acquired, the answer is: “Because there is no cause of transformation, it is immutably eternal.” In the Self there is none of the three kinds of transformation—transformation of property, characteristic, or state. Since even the qualities of the ultimately real Self are ultimately real, like the Self itself they cannot be transformed by any cause. Apart from transformation of qualities there is no other transformation; therefore the Self is completely unchanging.

The citations of those who know the purport of Scripture, such as “The purpose of Scripture is the instruction of action,” are to be understood with reference to Scripture consisting of injunctions and prohibitions, because the context there is the inquiry into Dharma. If the statement “The purpose of Scripture...” were applied everywhere without qualification, instruction concerning existent things would have to be declared meaningless. If Scripture teaches existent things in addition to activity and cessation, then an existent thing can be stated as a means to what is to be produced; and there is no reason to say that Scripture cannot teach the immutably eternal Brahman. Teaching an existent thing does not turn it into an action.

Someone may say: although an existent thing is not itself an action, it can be a means to action; therefore instruction concerning it is only for the sake of action. The answer is that a thing capable of accomplishing an action certainly exists; even if it is taught for the sake of action, its existence is not destroyed, nor does instruction concerning it become meaningless. To the question, “What benefit is there to you in teaching such an existent thing?” the answer is that instruction concerning the previously unknown reality of the Self is certainly fruitful as well. Through knowledge of it, the false knowledge that is the cause of Samsara ceases; therefore from the standpoint of purpose, instruction concerning the reality of the Self is in no way inferior to instruction concerning a thing that serves as a means to action.

In the context of the inquiry into Dharma, because Dharma is of the nature of action, “instruction of action” is spoken of; but this statement does not obstruct instruction concerning the existent Brahman. Describing Somasharma’s virtues in the context of Somasharma does not negate virtues in Vishnusharma. Injunctive

Scripture teaches prescribed actions and prohibitory Scripture teaches prohibited actions; the subject of both is action. But for this reason the Veda does not lose its capacity to teach the existent Brahman. Jaimini's statements such as "Scripture communicates the meaning of action" occur in the context of the inquiry into action.

If the word "meaning" indicated only the direct denotation of a word, then substance, quality, and action—which are not themselves things to be done—would, by not being directly denoted as duties, become meaningless. In answer it is said: even according to those who take the scriptural statement in question as universally invariable, "being meaningful through connection with what is to be done" does not mean making what is to be done itself the direct denotation; rather, it means being beneficial to what is to be done. Words denoting substances and qualities reveal existent substances and qualities as auxiliaries to what is to be done; even while remaining in their own nature, they are denoted. The authorities on Scripture say: "An injunctive sentence can make known things already existent, things presently existing, things to be produced, and so forth." That is, while making known what ought to be done, an injunctive sentence also reveals already existent things required for its purpose.

Although the meaning of a word may be an existent thing, its semantic relation is not limited merely to the role of assisting what is to be done. Nor does the purport of words terminate only in their separate individual meanings. If each word had its purport solely in its own independent meaning, knowledge of sentence-meaning would be impossible; for sentence-unity cannot arise among independently principal word-meanings devoid of a mutual relation of principal and subordinate. Even while communicating their respective meanings, words have as their purport a single shared and fruitful sentence-meaning. It is for this reason that knowledge of one sentence-meaning qualified by each word-meaning is possible.

The authorities on Scripture say: "Although phonemes directly convey word-meanings, they do not end fruitlessly there; knowledge of word-meanings is a necessary intermediate stage in the process of generating valid cognition of the sentence-meaning,

just as the flame of fuel in cooking food.” Therefore words have as their purport a sentence-meaning connected with the meanings of other words; but this does not establish a rule that the purport of every sentence must necessarily be connected with something to be done. Consequently, there is no fault in taking the immutable, eternal nature of Brahman as the purport of a sentence.

“Bhavya,” that which is to be produced, is what ought to be done. The objection is that an existent thing taught for the sake of what ought to be done is not really existent, because in its form connected with the duty it too becomes something to be produced. The answer is: “It is in fact an existent thing that is taught.” The meaning of relation is not identity; its relation with what ought to be done is the relation between the result to be accomplished and its means. When an existent thing enters into a process of production, its relation is that of action and causal factor; for this reason the existent thing itself does not become an action.

The Purvapakshin says: “Although it is not an action...” That is, it is difficult to understand scriptural teaching concerning Brahman, who is not an auxiliary to action and is immutably eternal. The answer is: “There is no difficulty here; even though taught for the sake of action...” An existent thing, even when taught for the purpose of an action, does not thereby become other than existent; on the contrary, a thing capable of accomplishing an action must certainly exist.

In some cases words that denote existent things are seen to have as their objects existent things established in themselves, without any syntactic relation to an action. It is not proper forcibly to twist such words into a meaning connected with action. Even if a limited use is seen a hundred times, that does not make an unlimited use seen elsewhere disappear. In ordinary usage many sentences are found, such as descriptions of forests, in which there is only a relation to the verb “to be,” but which are not auxiliaries to any duty. Even a sentence related to an action sometimes terminates merely in conveying a relation: to the question “Whose is this man?” the answer is “The king’s.” Likewise, sometimes only a qualification of the nominal meaning is asked: “What are these trees like?” The answer is “Fruit-bearing.” The questioner does not wish to know the existence or non-existence of the man or trees, but

the man's particular owner or the trees' particular kind. The person who knows answers precisely the desired qualification, not existence. From this it is established that words can be meaningfully used concerning fruitful existent things.

Again the question is: "If an existent thing is taught, what benefit does the teacher or listener gain from it?" Therefore only a fruitful existent thing should be taught, not a fruitless one. Brahman appears fruitless because Brahman is free from all action and indifferent; no action can be assisted by Brahman. The answer is: "Instruction concerning the unknown reality of the Self is certainly of this kind as well," namely fruitful. The word "and" here has the sense of "also." Brahman is actionless; nevertheless, knowledge concerning Brahman, produced by verbal testimony and culminating in realization, destroys its opposite, Avidya, the root cause of Samsara. Therefore this knowledge is entirely fruitful.

Moreover, even those who hold that the purport of every word is solely what ought to be done cannot show what duty is taught in prohibitory sentences such as "A Brahmin should not be killed" and "Liquor should not be drunk." What ought to be done is delimited by volition, pervaded by volition, and ceases when volition ceases, just as shimshapa-hood ceases when treehood ceases. Volition is a person's effort, and its determination depends on its object. Since the object of volition is something to be accomplished, it must be a process of production—one possessing a sequence of prior and posterior and producing some further result; it can be neither a substance nor a quality. For volition directly pervades only that which is its object; existent substances and qualities are not pervaded by volition. Hence the author of the Shastra says: "A verbal root conveys the meaning of production; through it action is known." The discussion of words denoting substances and qualities continues below.

Substance and quality become connected with what ought to be done when they occur contextually. But Bhavana, the productive activity, is connected with duty by its very nature; the connection of words denoting substance and quality with duty arises only through their conjunction with Bhavana. Therefore knowledge of a new sacrifice and the like comes from words expressing Bhavana, not from words expressing substance or quality.

In sentences such as “An offering should be made with curd” or “Continuous sprinkling should be performed,” curd and the like are not the object of the duty. Here too the true object of duty is only the Bhavana-action—making the offering or performing the sprinkling. Nor does it follow that because an offering qualified by curd or sprinkling qualified by continuity is enjoined, a sentence such as “The Agnihotra offering should be made” or “Sprinkling should be performed with clarified butter” becomes a mere repetition of it.

Here too the object of duty is the Bhavana-action; nevertheless, substance and quality, though not themselves the object, are enjoined as completing elements of Bhavana. Bhavana, as the unspecified activity of causal factors, becomes qualified and determined by particular factors such as substances; therefore substance and the like are its limbs. When Bhavana is enjoined, it is enjoined together with its limbs; hence substances and qualities, though not the object, become enjoined as limbs. In this way the injunction applies to substance and quality through Bhavana. For fear of prolixity, when the principal duty has been established elsewhere, its restatement takes the completing factors such as substance as its purport. Consequently, in every context the object of injunction is only the Bhavana-action.

From this the view is refuted that in sentences such as “the Agneya sacrifice with eight potsherds,” the relation of the sacrifice to its substance and deity is the object of the injunction. The object of an injunction cannot be mere “being.” If the agent of Bhavana already exists, an accomplished thing cannot again become the agent of production; and if the agent does not exist, an injunction cannot apply to a non-existent thing like a flower in the sky. Therefore the object of the injunction is the activity of the productive agent—that by which it produces. The word “being” indicates the activity of the thing being produced; this activity is called Bhavana, volition, or effort.

If this Bhavana were without an object, knowledge of it would be impossible; therefore, because an object is required, the word “Agneya,” which recalls the relation of substance and deity, is held to be the object of Bhavana—such is the view presented. But how can a person’s effort, whose object is an activity in the form of an action, apply to an actionless relation between substance and deity?

Even in “Make a pot,” the person’s effort does not apply to the pot, the direct meaning of the noun, but through the hands to the activity of instrumental factors such as the stick. Therefore the sentence communicates an effort whose object is an activity directed toward the purpose of the pot; the pot is not the direct object but only the intended end.

In the same way, in sentences such as “that Agneya sacrifice,” what is enjoined is only the sacrifice to be performed, indicated through the relation of substance and deity. The meaning of “the Agneya sacrifice that is performed” is: “The desired result should be produced by means of the Agneya sacrifice.” Therefore sentences such as “He who, knowing thus, performs the full-moon sacrifice” and “He who, knowing thus, performs the new-moon sacrifice” become restatements of the six sacrifices enjoined in sentences such as “that Agneya sacrifice.” In the sentence “One who desires heaven should perform the Darsha and Purnamasa sacrifices,” the relation to the result occurs only through this restatement of the enjoined actions.

Therefore in every case the object of an injunction, through effort, is only an activity in the form of action. If some duty is admitted in “Do not kill,” “Do not drink,” and the like, then one must also admit the volition or effort that pervades it and the Bhavana that becomes its object. If, on the analogy of the Prajapati vow, the meaning of prohibition is taken by secondary indication from a volition such as “I shall not kill” or “I shall not drink,” then the meaning of the negative would end in prohibition of an action that has become occasioned. Secondary indication is not proper when a direct meaning is possible. A sentence such as “Do not look at the rising sun” begins with “This is his vow,” and therefore a different arrangement involving prohibition of an occasioned act of seeing is possible there.

A sentence such as “A Brahmin should not be killed” teaches withdrawal from an activity. This withdrawal is itself neither an action nor a means to action. If instruction that serves no purpose of action is regarded as meaningless, then an instruction to desist, such as “A Brahmin should not be killed,” would become meaningless; this is not acceptable. Nor can the negative particle be regarded as conveying some unaccomplished action, because the

meaning of the act of killing is naturally established; the negative conveys its absence, not some new action concerning killing.

The nature of the negative particle is to convey the absence of that with which it is connected. Knowledge of absence is the cause of indifference, and this cognition, when its causal work has been completed, subsides of itself like a fire whose fuel has been exhausted. Therefore, except in special contexts such as the Prajapati vow, the meaning of prohibitions such as “A Brahmin should not be killed” is merely indifference in the form of withdrawal from an action that has become occasioned. Consequently, statements about fruitlessness in narratives and the like that merely praise an existent thing and do not serve a human end are to be understood in this light.

On this it is said that knowledge of absence is the cause of establishing indifference. Hearing “When fever occurs, eat wholesome food,” or “Do not give your ring to a snake,” an elder takes wholesome food, or, if he had an inclination to give the ring, withdraws from it. Seeing this, a child who is learning infers that the causes of the elder’s activity and cessation are respectively desire and aversion. The elder’s activity and cessation are voluntary and arise from desire and aversion, just like our own activity and cessation.

Prior to desire and aversion there is knowledge that the same object serves as a means to obtaining a desired result or an undesired result. Through self-observation we find that desire and aversion do not arise merely from knowledge of words, knowledge of action, the speaker’s intention, or an unseen injunctive force transcending the three times; they arise after knowledge of a relation of means to a desired or undesired result. Therefore the elder’s activity, cessation, desire, and aversion are likewise pervaded by that knowledge of instrumentality; the relation of cause and effect is established by the sequence of prior and posterior.

This knowledge of instrumentality did not exist before; it arose immediately upon hearing the words, and therefore hearing the words is its cause. A sentence such as “A sacrifice should be performed” produces activity; the sentence itself conveys

knowledge of the action to be performed, its being a means to the desired result, and its necessity. These two cognitions are not obtained by another means, and a meaning not obtainable by another means is the specific meaning conveyed by words.

But in “Do not kill,” “Do not drink,” and the like, necessity is already present in another form—as an activity produced by attachment or impulse. Here the injunctive suffix joined with the negative restates that situation and communicates that killing or drinking is a means to harm, something not otherwise established. Its being a means to a desired result is directly known; otherwise it would not have become an object of desire. Therefore a prohibitory sentence conveys knowledge of being a means to harm, not an injunction of duty. Knowledge that the prohibited act is a means to harm performs the same function as knowledge of its absence.

An intelligent person, even when there is an external occasion for action, reflects on future harm, understands the absence of that action, withdraws, and remains in a state of indifference. If knowledge of absence is the cause of indifference, then that cognition ought to remain as long as the indifference remains; but this is not so. The indifferent person may have his mind engaged elsewhere, and then there is no continuous cognition of the absence of the prohibited act. There is no universal rule that an effect must cease the instant its cause is removed; when a pillar is removed the structure above does not necessarily remain, yet when a protective cause is removed the protected thing does not always perish immediately either.

Therefore it has been said that this cognition subsides of itself like a fire whose fuel is exhausted. Activity toward the act remains only until knowledge that it is a means to harm arises; that knowledge uproots the basis of the activity and then itself subsides. Knowledge of absence is the cause that establishes indifference, not the basis that sustains it; it is like armor that protects against an external destructive cause. When the armor is removed, if no arrow attacks, the warrior’s life is not immediately destroyed. Thus the meaning of prohibition is indifference in the form of withdrawal from an occasioned action; knowledge of its being a means to harm is only an incidental indicator of it.

The objection that, unless it enters into an injunction of duty, mere mention of an existent thing would be fruitless like saying “The earth has seven continents” has now been refuted. Even a mere factual statement such as “This is a rope, not a snake” removes fear. It had also been said that even after hearing a Brahman-sentence, being subject to Samsara is seen as before, and therefore such a sentence does not have the purpose of true knowledge of a rope. The answer is that one cannot show being subject to Samsara in a person who has directly realized Brahman as the Self.

Being subject to Samsara cannot be shown in that person as before, because it is opposed to the knowledge of Brahman as the Self produced by the Veda, which is a means of valid knowledge. In a person who takes body and the like to be the Self, suffering, fear, and the like are observed. But when in that very person direct realization of Brahman as the Self arises from the Veda as a valid means of knowledge and such self-identification comes to an end, it is impossible to suppose that those bonds of suffering and fear born of false knowledge still remain. A wealthy householder identifies wealth as his own, and therefore fears that it may be stolen; but when the same person renounces the wealth and is free from identification with it, that fear of its being stolen no longer remains.

Similarly, a person wearing earrings experiences pleasure through identification with the wearing of the earrings; but when that same person removes the earrings and is free from identification with wearing them, the pleasure produced by wearing them does not remain. Shruti says: “The pleasant and the unpleasant do not touch the bodiless Self.” If it is said that bodilessness is possible only after the body is destroyed and not while alive, this is not correct.

Embodiment is produced by false knowledge. The Self’s embodiment cannot be admitted in any way other than through false knowledge in the form of identifying the Self with the body. Bodilessness is eternal because it is not produced by any action; this has already been stated. If it is said that Dharma and Adharma acquired by the Self are the cause of embodiment, that too is incorrect; for the Self’s relation to the body has not been established, nor has it been established that the Self acquires

Dharma and Adharma, and a defect of mutual dependence arises between bodily relation and the acquisition of Dharma and Adharma. To call this relation beginningless is baseless, like a chain of blind men.

Action does not inhere in the Self, and therefore agency of the Self cannot be understood. If it is said that in the case of kings and others agency is admitted merely from proximity, that too is not so; their agency is understood through the relation with servants produced by giving wealth and the like. No cause analogous to the giving of wealth can be imagined to establish a master-servant relation between the Self and body and the like. The direct cause of the Self's relation to the body is false identification. This also explains the empirical treatment of the Self as the performer of sacrifice.

Here some say that the cognition "I" in one's body and the like, with respect to a Self different from them, is figurative, not false. This view is incorrect; primary and figurative usage are possible only for a person who clearly knows the difference between the two things. One who knows their difference can understand the distinction between primary and figurative meanings.

For example, in an animal possessing a mane and a distinctive form, the primary meaning of the word "lion" and the cognition of a lion are established through positive and negative concomitance. With regard to a man endowed with qualities common to the lion, such as ferocity and courage, the same knowledgeable person uses the word "lion" and the cognition of a lion figuratively. But in one who does not know the difference between lion and man, the word and cognition belonging to one thing arise with regard to another not figuratively but through error. In the dusk, when its distinctive features are unclear, a pillar is taken to be "a man"; here the pillar becomes the object of the word "man" and the cognition of a man. Similarly, because of an unknown cause, the statement and cognition "this is silver" arise with regard to nacre.

In the same way, through failure to discriminate Self and non-Self in the aggregate of body and the like, the word "I" and the cognition "I" arise; how can this be called figurative? Even learned persons who possess discriminative knowledge of the Self as

different from the non-Self, because of habitual worldly usage, like a shepherd tending goats, may fail to distinguish clearly the word and cognition “I.” Therefore, for one who accepts the Self as different from body and the like, the I-cognition in the body is false, not figurative.

Because embodiment is produced by false knowledge, the wise person is bodiless even while alive. With regard to the knower of Brahman, Shruti says: “Just as a snake’s discarded slough lies dead and cast away upon an anthill, so this body lies; then this bodiless, immortal Prana is Brahman alone, pure light.” And it is said: “Though having eyes, it is as though without eyes; though having ears, as though without ears; though having speech, as though without speech; though having mind, as though without mind; though having Prana, as though without Prana.” Smriti too, by the question “What is the description of one of steady wisdom?” and the ensuing marks of such a person, shows that the knower has no real relation to engagement in action. Therefore being subject to Samsara does not remain as before in one who has realized Brahman as the Self; one in whom it remains as before has not realized Brahman as the Self. There is no defect in this position.

It had also been said that reflection and deep contemplation are seen after hearing, and therefore Brahman is a limb of some injunction and the teaching does not terminate in Brahman’s independent reality. This is not correct, because, like hearing, reflection and deep contemplation are undertaken for the purpose of realization.

Therefore Brahman does not become merely the object of scriptural knowledge through being the subject of an injunction to meditation; rather, through the harmonious convergence of the Vedanta sentences it is established that Brahman is independently the object of scriptural testimony. Hence the beginning of a separate Shastra concerning Brahman in the form “Therefore, now, the desire to know Brahman” is reasonable. If its purport were an injunction to meditation, no separate Shastra would be begun; its beginning would already have occurred in the Shastra that starts with “Therefore, now, the desire to know Dharma.” And if another beginning were still required, it would take a form such as “Therefore, now, the inquiry into the remaining portion of

Dharma,” just as it is said, “Now the inquiry into the means serving the purpose of sacrifice and the means serving the human end.” In that Shastra of Dharma there is no thesis of realization of the unity of Brahman and Atman; therefore for this purpose the beginning of a second Shastra in the form “Therefore, now, the desire to know Brahman” is reasonable.

Thus in the knowledge “I am Brahman,” all injunctions and all other means of knowledge come to an end. When the non-dual Self has been realized—the Self that is neither to be rejected nor accepted—an injunction or means of knowledge, left without an object and without a knower, is no longer capable of functioning as a means of knowledge.

The Purvapakshin again says: when the figurative and false self are no longer there, then, after son, body, and the like have been sublated, how can the knowledge “I am the real nature of Brahman” arise as something to be accomplished? Prior to knowledge of the Self that is being sought, knowerhood remains in the Self. The thing sought is only the knower—free from sin, defect, and the like. Just as cognition of the Self in the body is regarded as valid for practical purposes, so this empirical knowledge too is regarded as valid until the Self is determined.

The cognition of the Self in son and the like is figurative. A person is distressed by his own suffering and pleased by his own pleasure; he likewise experiences distress and pleasure from suffering and pleasure present in his son and the like, and therefore this is figurative usage. But here there is no cognition of identity, because difference is clearly experienced; hence this is a figurative cognition like “the Vahika is an ox.” The cognition of the Self in body, senses, and the like is not figurative, because non-difference with them is experienced; like the cognition of silver in nacre, it is an error.

Through these two kinds of identification with the Self, the affairs of Samsara proceed. If these identifications did not remain, worldly affairs would not proceed, nor would experience of the identity of Brahman and Atman arise, because its means—hearing, reflection, and the like—would not remain. The purport of “son, body, and the like being sublated” is this: when figurative self-

cognition is destroyed, the cognition “mine” with regard to son, wife, and the like is sublated; when false self-cognition is destroyed, body, senses, and the like are sublated, and along with them hearing and the other means are also sublated.

For this reason not only would worldly activity come to an end; how then could the knowledge to be accomplished in the form of awakening—“I am the real nature of Brahman,” that is, the realization of non-duality—arise? Giving the reason for this impossibility, it is said: “Prior to knowledge of the Self being sought, knowerhood remains in the Self.” Here “knowerhood” is indicative; the distinctions of means of knowledge, object of knowledge, and instruments of knowledge are also to be understood.

These distinctions are the cause of realization of non-duality, because they necessarily remain before that realization. Therefore if these distinctions do not remain, their fruit too cannot arise. The Self being sought is not different from the Self that is the knower; therefore it is said, “The sought Self is merely the knower—free from sin, defect, and the like.” The example of the necklace already worn around one’s own neck has already been given.

Granted. But how can the supremely true experience of non-duality arise from something that is not ultimately valid? The answer is: “Just as cognition of the Self in the body is regarded as valid, so this empirical knowledge too is regarded as valid.” Its limit is stated: “until the Self is determined,” that is, until realization of the nature of Brahman.

Even those who hold the world to be ultimately real accept that the cognition of the Self in body and the like is false, because knowledge produced by a valid means sublates it. Yet this very false self-cognition is regarded as the cause of all valid cognitions and the basis of real worldly transactions. Our view is the same with regard to realization of non-duality. Realization of non-duality, as a particular modification of the inner organ, is not itself the ultimate and unshakable truth; the realization that is truly real is not something to be accomplished, because it is the very nature of Brahman.

There is no incongruity in one Avidya destroying or producing another Avidya. Shruti too says: “One who knows both Vidya and

Avidya together crosses death through Avidya and attains immortality through Vidya.” Therefore everything is clear.

Here ends the Chatussutri-Bhamati.

Chapter 4

Bhamati
(Chatussutri)

Detailed Bibliography

*Reference Bibliography, Commentary Tradition, and Research-
Aid Details*

Original Sanskrit: Vachaspati MishraMaithili translation: Gajendra ThakurText
under review: from the Adhyasa Bhashya to the end of the
ChatussutriPublisher: Videha — First Maithili Fortnightly E-Journal

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Editorial Note

This bibliography brings together in one place the text of the Maithili book under review, its philosophical background, the commentary tradition of the Bhamati school, comparative study with the Vivarana school, other works of Vachaspati Mishra, modern research works, and reliable digital repositories.

Original editions and later reprints have been distinguished separately as far as possible. Where full publication details of a rare commentary or manuscript were not found consistently in reliable catalogues, its name has been placed in a separate section and the need for verification has been stated explicitly; no unconfirmed detail has been presented as an established fact.

After each principal entry an “Usefulness” note has been provided so that researchers may understand which work is particularly useful for the original text, textual variants, commentary tradition, history of philosophy, epistemology, Jivanmukti, Khyativada, or translation studies.

Abbreviations: Ed. = Editor; Trans. = Translator; Vol. = Volume; Repr. = Reprint; p. = Page; edn. = Edition.

Subject Index

The entries are arranged thematically; in the final section rare works and works with incomplete publication details are kept separately.

1. Maithili Edition under Review
2. Base Editions of the Brahmasutra and Shankara Bhashya
3. Major Sanskrit Editions of the Bhamati
4. Chatussutri-Centered Translations and Edited Texts
5. Commentaries, Subcommentaries, and Expositions on the Bhamati
6. The Vivarana School and Comparative Primary Texts
7. Other Major Works of Vachaspati Mishra
8. Modern Studies on Vachaspati Mishra and the Bhamati
9. History, Method, and Epistemology of Advaita Vedanta
10. Auxiliary Primary Texts, Upanishads, and the Prasthanatrayi
11. Digital Repositories and Online References
12. Rare Works or Works with Uncertain Publication Details

1. Maithili Edition under Review

The present Maithili translation stands at the center of this bibliography.

1. Mishra, Vachaspati. Bhamati (Chatussutri): Commentary on Shankara's Brahmasutra Bhashya. Pure Maithili translation from the original Sanskrit, editing, and book design: Gajendra Thakur. Videha — First Maithili Fortnightly E-Journal, First Edition 2004; Enlarged and Audit-Corrected Edition 2026. ISSN 2229-547X. Usefulness: The direct text under review in this book. It makes available in Maithili the complete Chatussutri section of the Bhamati on the Adhyasa Bhashya and the first four Sutras of the Brahmasutra.

2. Base Editions of the Brahmasutra and Shankara Bhashya

The Bhamati is a commentary on Shankaracharya's Brahmasutra Bhashya; therefore a reliable text and translation of the Bhashya are indispensable auxiliary materials.

2. Badarayana. Brahmasutra. Various Sanskrit editions with Shankaracharya's Shariraka Bhashya. Usefulness: The fundamental basis for understanding the three-layered textual structure of Sutra, Bhashya, and Bhamati. In research, the editor and publication year of the edition used should always be specified.
3. Shankaracharya. Brahmasutra-Shankara Bhashya, with Ratnaprabha, Bhamati, and Nyayanirnaya. Ed. Mahadeva Shastri Bakre and Vasudeva Lakshmana Shastri Panshikar. Third edition. Bombay: Pandurang Jawaji, 1934. Usefulness: Facilitates viewing the Bhashya, Bhamati, and other expositions against the same background; especially useful for textual comparison and research at the commentary level.
4. Shankaracharya. Brahmasutra Bhashya. English trans. Swami Gambhirananda. Calcutta: Advaita Ashrama, 1965; third edition 1977. Usefulness: A systematic English translation of the Shankara Bhashya. Helpful for comparative study of the philosophical terminology of the Maithili translation.

5. Shankaracharya. The Vedanta-Sutras, with Shankara Bhashya. English trans. George Thibaut. Sacred Books of the East, Vols. 34 and 38. Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1890 and 1896; later Indian reprints available. Usefulness: An early standard translation into a Western language; useful for comparison of historical translation methods and terminological interpretation.
6. Shankaracharya. Brahmasutra Shankara Bhashya. English trans. V. M. Apte. Bombay: Popular Book Depot, 1960. Usefulness: An alternative English presentation of the Bhashya; useful for comparing the meanings of difficult Adhikaranas.
7. Badarayana and Shankaracharya. Brahmasutra-Shankara Bhashyam. Digital copies: various editions available in the Digital Library of India/Internet Archive. Usefulness: Useful for locating rare printed editions and verifying pages; when citing, the original publication page in the scan should always be checked.

3. Major Sanskrit Editions of the Bhamati

This section lists historical printings, combined commentary editions, and modern reprints.

8. Mishra, Vachaspati. Bhamati. Ed. Balashastri. Bibliotheca Indica Series. Calcutta: Asiatic Society of Bengal; printed at Benares Printing Press, 1876–1880. Eight fascicles, approximately 766 pages. Usefulness: One of the principal early modern printed texts of the Bhamati. Fundamental for historical textual variants and the editorial tradition.
9. Mishra, Vachaspati. Bhamati. Ed. Jivananda Vidyasagara. Calcutta: Saraswati Press, 1891. Approximately 653 pages. Usefulness: An independent nineteenth-century printed edition; evidence of the early Bengali Sanskrit-printing tradition.
10. Mishra, Vachaspati. Bhamati. Ed. Dhundhiraja Shastri. Kashi Sanskrit Series, No. 116. Benares: Jayakrishnadas-Haridas Gupta, 1935. Usefulness: An accessible Sanskrit edition in the Kashi tradition; widely used for reference to the Chatussutri text.

11. Shankaracharya, Vachaspati Mishra, Amalananda, and Appayya Dikshita. Combined edition of the Brahmasutra Bhashya, Bhamati, Vedantakalpataru, and Kalpataruparimala. Srirangam: Sri Vani Vilas Press, ca. 1907. Usefulness: Brings together four interpretive levels from the Bhashya through the Parimala; an excellent resource for observing the internal relationships of the commentary tradition.
12. Mishra, Vachaspati. Bhamati. Reprint of the Balashastrya-edited 1876–1880 edition. Osnabrück: Biblio Verlag, 1999. ISBN 3764813881. Usefulness: Modern re-access to the early Bibliotheca Indica text; useful when the old edition is unavailable.
13. Mishra, Vachaspati. Bhamati. Ed. Dhundhiraja Shastri. Second/reprinted edition. Varanasi: Chaukhambha Sanskrit Sansthan, 2010. Usefulness: An easily available modern reprint for researchers; because of reprinting, page numbers may differ from the original 1935 edition.
14. Shankaracharya. Brahmasutra Bhashya, with Ratnaprabha, Bhamati, and Nyayanirnaya. Ed. Mahadeva Shastri Bakre and V. L. Panshikar. Bombay, 1934. Usefulness: A principal combined edition for reading the Bhamati in parallel with other Shankara expositions.

4. Chatussutri-Centered Translations and Edited Texts

The book under review is limited to the Chatussutri; therefore separate editions of this section are especially important.

15. Mishra, Vachaspati. The Bhamati of Vachaspati on Shankara's Brahmasutra Bhashya (Chatussutri). Ed. and English trans. S. S. Suryanarayana Sastri and C. Kunhan Raja; Introduction by Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan. Adyar Library General Series, Vol. 12. Adyar, Madras: Theosophical Society, 1933; reprint: Adyar Library and Research Centre, 1992. ISBN 9788185141091. Usefulness: A standard edition of the Sanskrit text and English translation of the Chatussutri; the most direct aid for comparative examination of the Maithili translation.

16. Mishra, Vachaspati. Bhamati (Chatussutri). Maithili trans. Gajendra Thakur. Videha, 2004/2026. Usefulness: A meaning-oriented, idiomatic, and philosophically terminology-conscious presentation of the Chatussutri in an Indian language; a primary source for the study of Maithili philosophical prose.

5. Commentaries, Subcommentaries, and Expositions on the Bhamati

The development of the Bhamati school can be understood through the mutual dialogue among the original Bhamati, the Kalpataru, and the Parimala.

17. Amalananda Sarasvati. Vedantakalpataru. Ed. Rama Shastri Tailanga. Vizianagaram Sanskrit Series, No. 13. Benares: E. J. Lazarus & Co., 1895–1897. Two volumes. Usefulness: The most influential subcommentary on the Bhamati; a principal source for the systematic medieval development of the Bhamati school.
18. Appayya Dikshita. Vedantakalpataruparimala. Ed. Rama Shastri Tailanga. Original printing, late nineteenth century; reprint: Delhi, Bharatiya Vidya Prakashan, 1992. Three parts. Usefulness: Essential for the subtle analysis of the Kalpataru, textual variants, and disputes concerning agreement with the Shankara Bhashya.
19. Vallalasuri. Bhamatitilaka (Chatussutri). Ed. V. S. V. Guruswami Sastrigal and V. R. Kalyanasundara Sastrigal. Madras: Adi Sankara Advaita Research Centre, 1984. xxv + 224 pages. Usefulness: A special commentary on the Chatussutri section; it directly corresponds to the limits of the Maithili book under review.

6. The Vivarana School and Comparative Primary Texts

The distinctive features of the Bhamati school become clearer when compared with the Vivarana school—especially on the locus of Avidya, the relation of Jiva and Brahman, and the question of direct knowledge through verbal testimony.

20. Padmapadacharya and Prakashatmayati. Panchapadika and Panchapadikavivarana. Ed. Polakam Srirama Sastri and S. R. Krishnamurti Sastri. Madras: Government Oriental Manuscripts Library, 1958. Usefulness: A primary text of the Vivarana school; essential for comparative study of the Bhamati doctrines of Avidya located in the Jiva, Avacchedavada, and knowledge through mental modification.
21. Prakashatmayati. Consciousness, Knowledge and Ignorance: Translation and Exposition of the First Four Varnas of the Panchapadikavivarana. Trans. and commentary by Bina Gupta. New York: American Institute of Buddhist Studies, Columbia University, 2011. ISBN 9781935011033. Usefulness: A modern philosophical presentation of the Vivarana school's discussion of consciousness, knowledge, and Avidya; useful for comparison with the Bhamati.

7. Other Major Works of Vachaspati Mishra

To understand Vachaspati's "Sarvatantrasvatantra" personality, it is necessary to read his works relating to Nyaya, Sankhya, Yoga, and Mimamsa.

22. Mishra, Vachaspati. Nyayavarttikatatparyatika. Ed. Gangadhara Shastri Tailanga. Benares: E. J. Lazarus, 1893. Usefulness: Clarifies the background of Vachaspati's logical style, Khyativada, and analysis of the means of knowledge in Nyaya philosophy.
23. Gautama. Nyayadarshana, with Vatsyayana Bhashya, Uddyotakara Varttika, Vachaspati Mishra's Tatparyatika, and Vishvanatha Vritti. Second edition. New Delhi: Munshiram Manoharlal, 1985. Usefulness: A multi-layered text of the Nyaya tradition; helpful for understanding the Naiyayika Purvapaksha and the critique of Anyathakhyati in the Bhamati.
24. Mishra, Vachaspati. Sankhyatattvakaumudi. Sanskrit text and English trans. Ganganath Jha. Bombay: Theosophical Publication Fund, 1896. Usefulness: Vachaspati's Sankhya perspective and style of categorization; useful for comparative study of Prakriti, causality, and the process of knowledge in the Bhamati.

25. Ishvarakrishna and Vachaspati Mishra. Sankhyakarika, with Tattvakaumudi. Trans. Swami Virupakshananda. Madras: Sri Ramakrishna Math, 1995. Usefulness: A modern English presentation together with the basic terminology of Sankhya; an introductory work for comparison between Vedanta and Sankhya.
26. Patanjali, Vyasa, and Vachaspati Mishra. Classical Yoga Philosophy and the Legacy of Sankhya: Sanskrit Text and English Translation of the Yogasutra, Vyasa Bhashya, and Tattvavaisharadi. Gerald James Larson. Delhi: Motilal Banarsidass, 2018. ISBN 9788120842014. Usefulness: A modern comprehensive edition of Vachaspati's Yoga interpretation, mental modifications, Samskaras, and processes of knowledge.
27. Patanjali. Sanga Yogadarshana, with Vyasa Bhashya and Tattvavaisharadi, Patanjalarahasya, Yogavarttika, and Bhasvati. Benares: Vidya Vilas Press, 1935. Usefulness: A historical combined edition for comparing the Tattvavaisharadi with other Yoga commentaries.

8. Modern Studies on Vachaspati Mishra and the Bhamati

The works in this section focus on biography, writings, differences between the Bhamati and Vivarana schools, Vachaspati's synthesis of philosophical systems, and the intellectual history of Mithila.

28. Hasurkar, S. S. Vachaspati Mishra on Advaita Vedanta. Darbhanga: Mithila Institute of Post-Graduate Studies and Research in Sanskrit Learning, 1958. Mithila Vidyapith Granthamala, No. 3; Studies in English, No. 2. xxx + 267 pages. Usefulness: An early extensive English monograph on Vachaspati's Advaita thought; a systematic study of the principal doctrines of the Bhamati.
29. Jha, Sahadeva. Vachaspati Mishra. Patna: Maithili Academy, 1984. Maithili Academy Publication, No. 132. 154 pages. Usefulness: An important introduction for Maithili readers to Vachaspati's life, works, and significance in the context of Mithila.

30. Dubey, Rajendra Prasad. Vachaspati Mishra. New Delhi: Sahitya Akademi, 1998. 119 pages. ISBN 8126003111. Usefulness: A concise but authoritative study of his life and works; useful for both general readers and researchers.
31. Ranganath, S. Contribution of Vachaspati Mishra to Indian Philosophy. Delhi: Pratibha Prakashan, 1999. 407 pages. ISBN 8177020021. Usefulness: A comprehensive examination of Vachaspati's contributions across several philosophical systems; it views the Bhamati in relation to Nyaya, Sankhya, Yoga, and Mimamsa.
32. Layek, Satyajit. Contribution of Vachaspati Mishra-I to Indian Philosophy. Revised edition. Kolkata: Sanskrit Book Depot, 2004. Usefulness: A thematic study of Vachaspati's works and a modern discussion of his synthesis of philosophical systems.
33. Roodurmum, P. S. Bhamati and Vivarana Schools of Advaita Vedanta: A Critical Approach. Delhi: Motilal Banarsidass, 2002. 314 pages. ISBN 9788120818903. Usefulness: A systematic comparative study of the two Advaita schools; especially useful for their differences concerning Avidya, Jiva, knowledge, and liberation.
34. Vasanta, M. Advaitavedante Bhamatiprasthanasya Tulanatmakam Adhyayanam. Delhi: Nag Publishers, 2013. xxvi + 493 pages. ISBN 8170816882. Usefulness: An extensive comparative study in Sanskrit of the Bhamati school; of serious academic use with original terminology.
35. Ruzsa, Ferenc. "Vachaspati Mishra." Encyclopedia of Philosophy of Religion, 2021. DOI: 10.1002/9781119009924.eopr0400. Usefulness: A modern encyclopedic introduction; a concise, verified overview of Vachaspati's period, works, and philosophical position.

9. History, Method, and Epistemology of Advaita Vedanta

To understand the doctrinal position of the Bhamati, the following studies are useful on the historical development of Advaita, Shankara's method, the authority of Shruti, consciousness, Avidya, and Jivanmukti.

36. Potter, Karl H. (ed.). *The Encyclopedia of Indian Philosophies, Vol. 3: Advaita Vedanta up to Shankara and His Pupils*. Princeton/Delhi: Princeton University Press, American Institute of Indian Studies, and Motilal Banarsidass, 1981. x + 635 pages. Usefulness: A reliable reference for summaries of texts, personalities, and the argumentative background of Shankara and early Advaita.
37. Potter, Karl H. (ed.). *The Encyclopedia of Indian Philosophies, Vol. 11: Advaita Vedanta from 800 to 1200*. Delhi: Motilal Banarsidass, 2006. xi + 825 pages. ISBN 9788120830615. Usefulness: Summaries of texts concerning Vachaspati Mishra and the early Bhamati tradition, with bibliographic guidance.
38. Nakamura, Hajime. *A History of Early Vedanta Philosophy, Vol. 2*. Delhi: Motilal Banarsidass, 1983; reprint 2004. Usefulness: An extensive study of the textual history, doctrinal development, and sectarian context of early Vedanta.
39. Comans, Michael. *The Method of Early Advaita Vedanta: Gaudapada, Shankara, Sureshvara and Padmapada*. Delhi: Motilal Banarsidass, 2000. 492 pages. ISBN 8120817222. Usefulness: The interpretive method of Shankara Advaita and the relation between Shruti and reasoning; background for understanding the method of the Bhamati.
40. Deutsch, Eliot. *Advaita Vedanta: A Philosophical Reconstruction*. Honolulu: East-West Center Press/University of Hawaii Press, 1969. Usefulness: A modern philosophical reconstruction of Advaita metaphysics, epistemology, and the doctrine of liberation.
41. Rambachan, Anantanand. *Accomplishing the Accomplished: The Vedas as a Source of Valid Knowledge in Shankara*. Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press, 1991. 179 pages. Usefulness: Focused on the authority of Shruti, sentences concerning already established realities, and the independent fruitfulness of knowledge of Brahman; highly relevant to the “Tattu Samanvayat” section.

42. Gupta, Bina. *The Disinterested Witness: A Fragment of Advaita Vedanta Phenomenology*. Evanston: Northwestern University Press, 1998. 236 pages. Usefulness: A modern philosophical analysis of witnessing consciousness, experience of the Self, and the illumination of objects.
43. Fort, Andrew O. *Jivanmukti in Transformation: Embodied Liberation in Advaita and Neo-Vedanta*. Albany: State University of New York Press, 1998. 251 pages. Usefulness: Traditional and modern transformations of Jivanmukti, Prarabdha, and the persistence of the body; useful for comparison with the Bhamati's discussion of Jivanmukti.
44. Dasgupta, Surendranath. *A History of Indian Philosophy*, Vols. 1–2. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1922 and 1932. Usefulness: A broad history of Indian philosophy; a classic reference for understanding interrelations among Advaita, Mimamsa, Nyaya, and Sankhya.
45. Deutsch, Eliot and J. A. B. van Buitenen (eds.). *A Source Book of Advaita Vedanta*. Honolulu: University Press of Hawaii, 1971. Usefulness: English translations of selected primary Advaita texts; useful for comparative study of doctrinal development.
46. Isayeva, Natalia. *Shankara and Indian Philosophy*. Albany: State University of New York Press, 1993. Usefulness: A modern study of Shankara's philosophical context, opponents, and later tradition.
47. King, Richard. *Early Advaita Vedanta and Buddhism: The Mahayana Context of the Gaudapadiyakarika*. Albany: State University of New York Press, 1995. Usefulness: Historical background for Advaita-Buddhist relations and discussions of theories of error.
48. Hacker, Paul. *Philology and Confrontation: Paul Hacker on Traditional and Modern Vedanta*. Ed. Wilhelm Halbfass. Albany: State University of New York Press, 1995. Usefulness: Useful for understanding textual criticism of the Shankara tradition and cautions concerning modern interpretation.

10. Auxiliary Primary Texts, Upanishads, and the Prasthanatrayi

The argument of the Bhamati continually depends upon Upanishadic sentences, the Bhagavad Gita, the Brahmasutra, and doctrines of Mimamsa and Nyaya.

49. Radhakrishnan, Sarvepalli (ed. and trans.). The Principal Upanishads. London: George Allen & Unwin, 1953. Usefulness: Sanskrit text and English translation of the principal Upanishads; a broad reference for Shruti passages cited in the Bhamati.
50. Olivelle, Patrick (ed. and trans.). The Early Upanishads: Annotated Text and Translation. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1998. Usefulness: A modern text-critical translation; useful for the linguistic and historical context of Upanishadic sentences.
51. Shankaracharya. Eight Upanishads, with Shankara Bhashya. English trans. Swami Gambhirananda. Calcutta: Advaita Ashrama, two volumes. Usefulness: Study of the principal Upanishads together with Shankara's interpretation; helpful for matching the Shruti sources of the Brahmasutra Bhashya.
52. Bhagavad Gita, with Shankara Bhashya. Various Sanskrit editions and translations. Usefulness: An auxiliary text of the Prasthanatrayi for understanding the Bhamati's discussions of action, knowledge, renunciation, purification of intellect, and liberation.

11. Digital Repositories and Online References

Online material should be used for page verification, locating rare editions, and matching publication details; in final citation it is necessary to consult the title page of the original scan. Access date: 6 August 2026.

53. Internet Archive. Sanskrit Vangmaya ka Brihad Itihas, Vol. 10: Vedanta.Usefulness: A Hindi reference on Vedanta texts, teachers, schools, and commentary traditions.https://archive.org/stream/10.-sanskrit-vang.-brihat-itihas-10-vedant/10.Sanskrit%20Vang.Brihat%20Itihas-10%20%28%20Vedant%20%29_djvu.txt
54. Internet Archive/Digital Library of India. Brahmasutra-Shankara Bhashyam (scan).Usefulness: Page verification of printed texts of the Shankara Bhashya.<https://archive.org/details/in.ernet.dli.2015.407431>
55. Internet Archive. Sanskrit Vangmaya ka Brihad Itihas, Vedanta volume — edition associated with Baladeva Upadhyaya.Usefulness: Historical introduction to Vachaspati Mishra, the Bhamati, and later Advaita commentaries.https://archive.org/stream/wtdo_sanskrit-vangmaya-ka-brihad-itihas-of-acharya-baldeva-upadhyay-vol.-10-uttar-pra/Sanskrit%20Vangmaya%20Ka%20Brihad%20Itihas%20of%20Acharya%20Baldeva%20Upadhyay%20Vol.%2010%20-%20Uttar%20Pradesh%20Sanskrit%20Sansthan%20Lucknow_djvu.txt
56. WorldCat. Library records for the 1876–1880, 1891, 1935, 1999, and other editions of the Bhamati.Usefulness: Matching publication year, editor, page count, and worldwide library availability.<https://search.worldcat.org/>
57. Adyar Library and Research Centre. Catalogue record for the Suryanarayana Sastri–Kunhan Raja edition of Bhamati (Chatussuttri).Usefulness: Verification of the standard edition of the Chatussuttri English translation.<https://www.adyarlibrary.org/>
58. Videha Books. Videha — First Maithili Fortnightly E-Journal.Usefulness: Publication reference for Gajendra Thakur’s Maithili translations of philosophical works and the Videha Book Series.<https://www.videha.co.in/pothi.htm>

59. Motilal Banarsidass. Publisher listings for Bhamati and Vivarana Schools of Advaita Vedanta and other Advaita reference works. Usefulness: Matching modern reprints, ISBNs, and publication details. <https://www.mlbd.in/>
60. Jain eLibrary/Jain Quantum. Digital Sanskrit-Hindi material on Sarvadarshanasangraha and Indian philosophy. Usefulness: An auxiliary digital source for opposing philosophical systems and comparative references; the edition of the text should always be checked. <https://jainqq.org/>

12. Rare Works or Works with Uncertain Publication Details

The following titles are mentioned in histories of the Bhamati commentary tradition, but the author's name, manuscript location, printing year, or edition details are not uniform across the available catalogues.

Researchers should therefore verify them separately through the National Mission for Manuscripts, the New Catalogus Catalogorum, manuscript catalogues of Sanskrit universities, and the relevant monastic libraries.

61. Lakshminrisimha. Abhoga — a critical subcommentary on the Vedantakalpataruparimala. [Full verification of publication details required] Usefulness: Important for the internal history of disagreements between the Parimala and the Bhamati-Kalpataru tradition.
62. Akhandanubhuti Yati. Rijuprakashika — a commentary on the Bhamati. [Full verification of publication details required] Usefulness: A possible source of traditional explanations of difficult argumentative passages in the Bhamati.
63. Achyutakrishnatirtha. Bhamati-Bhavadipika. [Full verification of publication details required] Usefulness: A later exposition of the Bhamati text; local verification of printed or manuscript availability is necessary.

64. Subrahmanya Shastri. Bhamati-Vivarana. [Full verification of publication details required]Usefulness: Part of modern/late Sanskrit expository literature on the Bhamati; author information and edition details appear differently in different catalogues.
65. Vedantakalpatarumanjari. [Full verification of publication details required]Usefulness: Mentioned as a concise or explanatory work in the Kalpataru tradition; authorship and textual evidence should be verified.
66. Bhamati-Vyakhya, associated with Sriranganatha. [Full verification of publication details required]Usefulness: A possible exposition in the South Indian manuscript tradition; it should not be cited without bibliographic evidence and a manuscript number.
67. Bhamati-Vilasa. [Full verification of publication details required]Usefulness: The title is found in different catalogues; confirmation of author, completeness, and publication details is necessary.

Method of Use for Researchers

Not all works on a single subject have the same degree of evidentiary value. The following sequence will make textual references more reliable for researchers.

1. Primary text first: read in the sequence Sutra → Shankara Bhashya → Bhamati → Kalpataru → Parimala; consult modern explanations afterward.
2. Specify the edition: in a citation it is necessary not merely to write “Bhamati” but to give the editor, publisher, year, and page.
3. Check textual variants: the old Bibliotheca Indica edition, the Kashi edition, and combined commentary editions may differ in text or page order.
4. Compare translations: compare difficult passages in the Maithili translation with the translations of Suryanarayana Sastri–Kunhan Raja, Gambhirananda, Thibaut, and Apte, but keep the original Sanskrit decisive.
5. Use digital sources cautiously: do not base direct quotation on OCR text; establish the text only by consulting the page image of the scan.

6. Verify rare commentaries: for Abhoga, Rijuprakashika, and the like, record the manuscript catalogue, institutional catalogue, and direct manuscript number.

— **End** —



भामती वाचस्पति मिश्रक ओ अमर टीका थिक जे
शंकराचार्यक ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यपर लिखल गेल
अछि। एहिमे प्रसिद्ध अध्यास-भाष्यक
सूक्ष्म व्याख्या अछि, जतय 'हम' (विषयी,
चैतन्य आत्मा) आ 'अहाँ' (विषय, जड़ जगत)क
बीच अन्हार आ इजोत जकाँ भिन्नताक बावजूदो
होइत मिथ्या अध्यासक सिद्धान्त प्रतिपादित
अछि।

- ✿ अध्यास-भाष्य — मिथ्या अध्यासक सिद्धान्त
- ✿ जिज्ञासा-सूत्र — आत्मा जानबाक इच्छाक विषय किएक अछि
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- ✿ भामती-सम्प्रदाय — विवरणसँ भिन्न स्वतंत्र दृष्टि



विदेह

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Bhāmatī

Vācaspati Mīśra · Translated by Gajendra Thakur

Bhāmatī is Vācaspati Mīśra's immortal commentary on Śaṅkarācārya's *Brahmasūtrabhāṣya*. It offers a subtle exposition of the celebrated Adhyāsa-bhāṣya, where the doctrine of false superimposition is established even amid the difference — like light and darkness — between the “I” (the knowing self) and the “you” (the inert world).

Bhāmatī is the foundation-text of the independent ‘Bhāmatī school’ of Advaita Vedānta, charting a path distinct from the Vivaraṇa school. This millennium-old commentary now appears in Maithili for the first time.



Key Themes

- * **Adhyāsa-bhāṣya** — The doctrine of false superimposition
- * **Jijñāsā-sūtra** — Why the desire to know the Self arises
- * **Pratyabhijñā** — Establishing the Self as distinct from the body
- * **Bhāmatī school** — An independent view, distinct from Vivaraṇa

Translator Gajendra Thakur has also rendered Nyāyakusumāṅjali, Tattvacintāmaṇi, and Āmatattvaviveka into Maithili; together these works are building a well-organised philosophical lexicon in Maithili.

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